

Essentials of Social Psychology

An Indian Perspective



S. K. Mangal and Shubhra Mangal

ESSENTIALS OF SOCIAL PSYCHOLOGY

Essentials of Social Psychology: An Indian Perspective offers a comprehensive introduction to social psychology with a focus on the cultural and social fabric of Indian society. Split into five sections, the book covers the nature, scope, history and methods of social psychology; individual level processes; interpersonal level processes; social processes; group processes; and social issues.

The authors, S.K. Mangal and Shubhra Mangal, address the latest research trends, and offer a varied insight into a range of topics including social influence, social exchange processes, group dynamics, aggression, prejudice and attitudes. The book also examines topical themes and includes two chapters on social issues facing contemporary Indian society. While highlighting significant Indian research contributions and including examples and case studies from an Indian context, this book goes on to examine the discipline in the context of the socio-psychological background of this subcontinent. Complex concepts are clearly explained and the book aids student learning through useful pedagogical features such as assessment questions, case studies, chapter summaries and boxed key points.

Covering all the core topics within social psychology, this is an essential textbook for graduate or undergraduate courses in social psychology, social work, social neuroscience, community medicine or public health. In addition, it's also a useful introduction for those taking the Psychology option for the Indian and Provincial Civil Services and other competitive examinations.

S.K. Mangal, PhD (Education), is the former principal, professor and the head of the Department of Post Graduate Studies at C. R. College of Education, Rohtak, Haryana. He has authored several books associated with pure and applied aspects of psychology, including *Advanced Educational Psychology*, *Abnormal Psychology*, *Child Psychology and Development*, *Psychology of Learning and Development*, and *Sports Psychology*. With emotional intelligence and teacher adjustment as his areas of interest, he has also devised various educational and psychological tests including the Emotional Intelligence Inventory and Teacher Adjustment Inventory.

Shubhra Mangal, PhD (Education), is the former principal, professor and the head of the Department of Post Graduate Studies, C. R. S. College of Education, Noida. She has authored a number of books related to pure and applied aspects of the subject of psychology which include *Introductory Psychology*, *Our Life and Psychology*, *Emotional Intelligence: Managing Emotions to Win in Life*, *Research Methodology in Behavioural Sciences* and *Psychology of Learning and Development*. She has also contributed to the field with her Emotional Intelligence Inventory for the measurement of emotional intelligence of school teachers. The areas of her research interests include emotional intelligence and teacher education.



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AN INDIAN PERSPECTIVE

S.K. MANGAL & SHUBHRA MANGAL

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PREFACE

What we need in its utmost for our existence, survival, development and progress, in the world we live in, is to remain essentially social in our behavior and living. In turn, it depends on the desirability as well as quality of the social behavior we demonstrate in our behaving and interacting with others individually or as a member of one or the other social groups at one or the other times in our day-to-day living. The task is too delicate and carries a lot of positive and negative implications for us and the society to which we belong. When the social behavior of the people in a society drifts in a positive direction characterized with mutual understanding and liking, proper cognition and perception of the thinking and feelings of others, maintaining desirable attitudes towards others and showing the spirit of cooperation for helping each other at the time of need, the society as a whole develops and progresses in a proper way for enabling its people to enjoy good physical and mental health, happy family life, proper business transaction and economic prosperity. The reverse is also equally true and consequences are quite damaging when people are found to show negativity in their social behavior in interacting and dealing with others as individuals or members of the social group. Decidedly, the welfare of all of us and progress of the society here demands us to know the proper mechanism of understanding the self and others and get engaged in a properly desirable social behavior in the interest of the self, others and the society as a whole. The services of the subject social psychology can be very well availed for this purpose. In its capacity as the science of the social behavior, it can help us not only in understanding others and interacting with them in a proper manner for leading our social life in a properly desired way, but can bring the needed law and order, enforcement of social norms and ethics, finding solutions to the difficulties and problems arising in the path of our society or nation for our needed peaceful coexistence and functioning properly in the interest of ours and the nation as well as humanity at large.

It is this multifaceted use and application of the subject of social psychology that has resulted in its popularity of being adopted as one of the demanding courses in the discipline of psychology and sociology at the undergraduate levels of college and university studies. It has also been introduced as an important option in the discipline of psychology and sociology for the postgraduate students of the academic colleges and departments of universities. The present text is aimed to serve the need of all these courses in a quite comprehensive and understandable way.

For serving its purposes well, the subject matter of the text has been presented in 21 properly sequenced and well-knitted chapters. Further, for maintaining the needed coherence and progression, these chapters have been organized into six well-meaning units named as: Nature, Scope, History and Methods of Social Psychology; Individual Level Processes; Interpersonal and Social Processes; Socialization and Societal Processes; Group Level Processes; and Social Issues and Social Psychology.

We know well that a text of social psychology, aimed to serve its objective well, essentially requires to make its readers acquainted with its true meaning, nature and scope in its very beginning, and the same has been carried out successfully through the discussion carried out in its very beginning in Chapter 1.

The knowledge regarding the derivation, origin and history of a subject is regarded as essential to connect with the ideas, principles and theoretical notions of the subject for getting applied in the field of its operation. With this objective, a detailed account of the history of social psychology has been presented in Chapter 2 with an essential emphasis on its development from a global as well as the Indian perspective. The information regarding the existence of the major social psychology associations and publication of journals in the field of social psychology in printed and electronic forms has also been adequately provided.

We see that where on one hand, social psychology on account of its intimate connection with the discipline sociology is said to fall in the realm of social sciences, it is also designated as behavioral science on account of its popular connection with the discipline of psychology. Taking cognition of both these things, attempts have been made in Chapter 3 to seek and discuss the relation of social psychology with other social sciences, and related branches of the discipline psychology.

Social psychology relates with the study of the social behavior of people and groups, and such study needs from the socio-psychologists and investigators need the use of the appropriate methods of research and investigation sufficiently scientific, objective as well as relevant for carrying out such study. For acquainting the students of social psychology with the use of these research methods, along with the ways of analyzing data and consideration about the ethical issues, a useful attempt has been made in Chapter 4.

We cannot expect to behave in an appropriate way with others unless we are well versed in taking cognizance and perception about their behavior, personality characteristics including our previous experiences and impressions about them. Taking note of the significance of the two phenomena – social cognition and social perception – a quite useful discussion supported through the experimental evidences has been provided in Chapters 5 and 6. Besides this the role of our “self” is quite noteworthy in our all types of social behavior, interaction and functioning well in the society. Consequently, we must know well what we are in our individual self – what type of self-awareness, self-concept, self-esteem, self-efficacy and self-regulation/control we possess for the demonstration of our social behavior and functioning in the variety of social situations faced in our life. For furnishing required information in this concern, the necessary discussion has been provided in the name of self-perception in Chapter 7 of the text.

Our attitudes, the consistent particular ways of reacting and responding to the situations, people and social groups as well as various types of stereotypes, prejudices and discriminations prevalent in the society influence our social behavior and way of life in a quite substantial way. The negative influence of the undesirable attitudes and evil impact of stereotypes, prejudices and discriminations needs to be restrained through persuasion – the process of attitudinal change and the employment of other useful means. The necessary discussion on this account has been given in Chapters 8 and 9 of the text.

In Chapter 10, a useful discussion has been carried out for throwing light on the three important phenomena – conformity, compliance and obedience – of social behavior of the people well linked to the process of social influence – the way one’s behavior is influenced and gets changed by others. It follows with a discussion in Chapter 11 on the phenomenon of social exchange – give and take in one’s interaction with others – incorporating three important social exchange processes named as cooperation, competition and conflict.

Interpersonal attraction – mutual liking or disliking – is the cornerstone of building social relationships with others existing in the form of an early family relationship, close friendship, and romantic love and marriage relationships. A major part of our social behavior and social life is covered through such relationships based on the phenomenon of interpersonal attraction. The necessary discussion on this account has been carried out in Chapter 12 of the text.

Chapter 13 provides a useful description about the social phenomena known as altruism and pro-social behavior – the helping behaviors that are demonstrated on the part of individuals to help others at the time of their need with a motive other than serving their own interests.

Socialization – the process of imbibing certain essential behavioral characteristics and social values – helps much in seeking one's proper adjustment in society along with a considerable increase in one's capabilities of demonstrating the needed social behavior in day-to-day functioning. The discussion carried out in Chapter 14 throws proper light on its concept, theories and the agencies helpful in socializing the individuals from their early childhood.

Changes named as social changes are inevitable in the fabric of the society with regards to its structure as well as functioning. In fact the very foundation of the development and progress of a society is well placed in the continuity of such changes. A useful description about the nature and occurrence of these changes has been provided in Chapter 15. Immediately, it follows with a description in Chapter 16 about the process of social integration, a cementing force and mechanism helping the social groups, nations and world societies to work together for their adequate development, peaceful coexistence and progress.

Our social behavior and functioning of the social groups existing in our society is well directed through the mechanism known as group dynamics and psychology of group behavior. It has been experimentally demonstrated that group behavior is entirely different from the individual behavior shown by the people and performance of the individuals is substantially influenced in the presence of others. The discussion all about these aspects has been carried out in Chapter 17. It has been followed by the discussion in Chapter 18, on leaders and types of leadership provided by them to their respective groups for their needed functioning in carrying out the group goals.

Chapter 19 covers a quite serious behavioral phenomenon known as aggression and violence affecting the quality of the social interaction and social behavior of the people in a quite adverse way. Why people resort to such unwanted social behavior in their social functioning has been explained, here, through the help of various theories of aggression as well as the chief determinants or factors responsible for causing such behavior.

The last two chapters, 20 and 21, have been exclusively devoted to the discussion of the social issues and problems currently faced by our societies and nation as a whole. In this concern, in Chapter 20 attempts have been made to highlight the problems arising on account of alcoholism, drug addiction and criminal behavior (performed in both its forms of delinquency and crime) with the necessary focus on highlighting their ill consequences, causes underlying the behavior, and measures for the prevention of the problem and treatment of the problematic persons. Chapter 21, in this sequence, first tries to throw light on the current issues proving quite damaging and obstructing the harmony and development of the country in the name of poverty, unemployment, corruption, domestic violence, child abuse, sexual violence against women, and Naxalism and terrorists activities. In its second half, it tries to concentrate on the contemporary social issues facing the Indian society at present in their varying shapes such as same gotra or khap marriages, inter-caste marriages, inter-faith marriages, same sex marriages and rights as well as adjustment of the transgender community.

Thus, the coverage of the subject matter of social psychology in the present text is quite wide and exhaustive for serving the needs of the syllabi of the Indian universities meant for the social psychology paper of the undergraduate and postgraduate courses of BA, BA (Hons.), MA and MPhil courses of the academic disciplines psychology and sociology. It is also able to meet the requirements of social psychology courses of the related social science and public health disciplines such as MSW (Master of Social Work), anthropology, social neuroscience, community medicine or public health. Besides this, the text in its aforementioned organized format also stands for providing the needed information, knowledge and skill to the concerned persons who are offering their services as administrators, policy makers and public relations officers, advertisers and persuasive agencies in the field of business transaction, social workers and even parents and teachers for making them adequately equipped with the abilities of establishing good interpersonal relationships and providing needed leadership to the persons and groups they lead in their social and professional functioning.

The text has been adequately illustrated with examples, figures, tables and box material (for the clarity of the important terms and concepts as well as summing up of what has been discussed in the corresponding paragraphs). It will surely assist the readers in their understanding of the concepts and topics discussed in the different chapters. Moreover, the style, language and presentation have been kept simple, engaging and lively for facilitating the readers in their understanding of the concepts and facts of social psychology with a proper synthesis of theory with its practical applications in social life. Here, care has also been taken to lay down the learning objectives at the beginning of each chapter for setting clear directions to the concepts discussed and the content provided in the chapter. In addition, with an aim to help the students in their self-evaluation as well as preparation for the final examination, review questions have been given at the end of each chapter.

Moreover, for helping the readers delve deep into the subject, all the related references have been given at the tail of each chapter besides a detailed Bibliography at the end of the text.

The authors are very much indebted to the various authors, researchers and authorities related to the subject of social psychology, whose views and opinions have been incorporated in the text. The authors are indebted to all of them for their direct and indirect impact in setting the direction and evolution of the ideas for the text material. Authors also obliged to the publisher Routledge (Taylor & Francis Group), especially the editorial and production teams, for their praiseworthy efforts in presenting this text in such a useful form.

With the preceding submission, it is earnestly hoped that the text will be widely read and appreciated by all those for serving whose interests it has been written. However, nothing is ever perfect and complete and, therefore, suggestions for bringing any improvement in the text will be highly appreciated and thankfully acknowledged by the authors and the publisher.

S.K. Mangal
Shubhra Mangal

ABOUT THE AUTHORS

S.K. MANGAL, PhD (Education), was the principal, professor and the head of the Department of Post Graduate Studies at C. R. College of Education, Rohtak, Haryana. He has authored several books associated with the pure and applied aspect of the subject of psychology, including *Essentials of Educational Psychology*, *Advanced Educational Psychology*, *Emotional Intelligence: Managing Emotions to Win in Life*, *Research Methodology in Behavioural Sciences*, *Statistics in Psychology and Education*, *Psychology for Nursing*, *Psychology for Physiotherapy*, *General Psychology*, *Abnormal Psychology*, *Child Psychology and Development*, *Psychology of Learning and Development*, and *Sports Psychology*. Mangal has been a distinguished administrator and researcher. He has devised various educational and psychological tests and has published in reputed journals. The areas of his interest are emotional intelligence and teacher adjustment.

SHUBHRA MANGAL, PhD (Education), was the principal, professor and the head of the Department of Post Graduate Studies, C. R. S. College of Education, Noida. She has devised an emotional intelligence inventory for the measurement of emotional intelligence of school teachers. She has co-authored and also written a number of books related to the pure and applied aspect of the subject of psychology which include *Introductory Psychology*, *Our Life and Psychology*, *Emotional Intelligence: Managing Emotions to Win in Life*, *Research Methodology in Behavioural Sciences*, *Psychology of Learning and Development*, *Child Psychology and Development* and *Sports Psychology*. The areas of her research interest are emotional intelligence and teacher education.



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UNIT I

NATURE, SCOPE, HISTORY AND METHODS OF SOCIAL PSYCHOLOGY



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1.

SOCIAL PSYCHOLOGY

Meaning, Nature and Scope

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- Explain the meaning of and define the term social psychology.
- Throw light on the nature of social psychology.
- Provide your views about the scope of social psychology.
- Tell what is included in the study of the subject social psychology.
- Discuss the uses and applications of social psychology in your day-to-day life.

Social Psychology – Meaning and Definition

Social psychology represents a particular field or branch of study existing within the subject and discipline psychology. Here we try to study the behavior of the individuals in one or the other social situations and group behavior environments. In its word composition, also, the term social psychology stands for the psychology applied to the study the behavior of the organisms in social situations. In Merriam Webster Dictionary (1988:64), it has been defined as “the study of the manner in which the personality, attitudes, motivations, and behavior of the individual influence and are influenced by social groups”.

It clearly conveys that social psychology represents that branch or field of study in psychology which helps us in studying one or the other aspects of human behavior resulted through the interaction between the individuals and the society or group in

which they live and behave. For understanding the meaning and nature of social psychology in a clear term, let us try to pay attention over some of the following definitions cited by the prominent authors and social psychologists.

Gordon Allport (1954): Social psychology is a discipline that uses scientific methods in an attempt to understand and explain how the thought, feeling and behavior of individuals are influenced by the actual, imagined or implied presence of other human beings.

Gordon Allport (1985): Social psychology is the scientific study of the way in which people's affect, behavior and cognitions are influenced by the real, implied or imagined presence of other people and how they influence others.

Baron and Byrne (2006): Social psychology is defined as the scientific field that seeks to understand the nature and causes of individual behavior and thoughts in social situations.

Baron and Byrne (2001:6): Social psychology is the scientific field that seeks to understand the nature and cause of individual behavior and thoughts in social situations. In other words, social psychologists seek to understand how we think about and interact with others.

Gerrig and Zimbardo (2006: G-II): Social psychology is the branch of psychology that studies the effect of social variables on individual behavior, attitudes, perceptions and motives and also studies group and inter-group phenomena.

Myers et al. (2012:1): Social psychology is the scientific study of how people think about, influence and relate to one another.

Barrett (2017:5): Social psychology is the scientific study of the social experiences and behaviors of individuals.

A close analysis of the above cited definitions may reveal the following facts about the meaning and nature of the term and discipline named as social psychology.

- Social psychology is a discipline or subject area that uses scientific methods for studying the behavior of the individuals in social situations involving the presence of others.
- Social psychology is a branch of psychology that deals specifically with the scientific study of the social behavior of the individuals rather than any other types of behavior such as abnormal behavior – the focus of abnormal psychology – or human behavior, in general, studied in general psychology.
- It tells us that our thoughts, feelings and actions are influenced with the interactions and presence of others and vice versa. Proceeding further, it acquaints us with the way these are influenced in the presence of others in one or the other social situations. In other words, thus, social psychology may be found to look at human behavior as influenced by other people and the social context in which this occurs.
- For influencing and affecting our feelings, thoughts and actions, the actual presence of others is not essential. It can happen also with

their imagined and implied presence such as when watching television or following internalized cultural norms.

- Social psychology provides a scientific explanation of what, how and why people think, feel and behave the way they do with others, influence them and have interactions and relationships with them in one or the other social situations.
- It helps us in understanding and explaining the manner in which our thoughts, feelings and actions influence others or get influenced in the presence/interactions with others. Apart from the ongoing behavior of others, social experiences preserved in our memory, and the attitudes formed out of these experiences, and physical factors also influence our behavior towards others.

Social Psychology

An applied branch of the subject psychology that deals with the scientific study of the behavior of individuals in a social context enabling us to get an explanation of the nature and causes of their thoughts, feelings and behaving with others in one or the other social situations.

- In this way, what is available in the form of social as well as other variables to us in our social environment at one or the other time, proves quite significant in influencing our bent of mind (in terms of our attitudes, perceptions and motives) and our actions and behavior at that time and also in future in the similar encounters. By highlighting all such things, social psychology tries to bring out all the factors that lead us to behave in a given way in the presence of others, and look at the conditions under which certain types of behavior/actions and feelings occur.

The conclusions drawn as earlier about the meaning, nature and characteristic features of the

discipline social psychology may help us in arriving in accepting the following as a working definition of the term social psychology for our text.

Social psychology is a branch of a well-accepted discipline psychology that deals with the scientific study of the behavior of individuals in a social context enabling us to get an explanation of the nature and causes of our thoughts, feelings and behaving with others in one or the other social situations.

Nature of Social Psychology

One question, that is often put forward, is “what is the nature of social psychology?” The answer that is more generally and readily available in this concern is also quite straight and it is: “The nature of the subject social psychology is sufficiently scientific.” The arguments provided by the thinkers in this concern may be summarized as follows:

1. Social psychology is an applied branch of the subject psychology. By applying the principles and techniques of psychology, it tries to study the behavior (cognitive, conative and affective) of the individuals in context to social situations. The work and functioning of the subject social psychology possess much similarity to its parent subject psychology. The only difference is that where in psychology we deal with the behavior of the individuals in general in all walks of life, social psychology limits its study to the behavior of the individuals in social situations. Hence, in their functioning and purposes both may be seen to carry out the work of the similar nature – the study of behavior. There is no secret that psychology is defined and accepted as a science of behavior and as a behavioral science its nature is also regarded as sufficiently scientific. If it is so, then, how can we deny the acceptance of the fact that social psychology (one of the major components of the subject psychology) is a science and its nature is scientific?
2. Generally, we accept and include a subject in the category of sciences if it is found (i) to

employ scientific method and approach for its study; (ii) to be able or capable of describing and explaining the what, why and how of things studied by it; (iii) to predict about the future of the things or the events on the basis of their present status and functioning; and (iv) challenging and re-verifying the results of the study.

Let us try to weigh the nature of social psychology on the preceding criterion.

- Social psychology employs scientific methods and adopts scientific approach to study the social behavior of the individuals – the behavior and activities of the individuals going on in the social environment. Look at our emphasis on the suffix ‘scientific’; it is here for distinguishing social psychology from other more subjective ways of looking into the behavior and mental processes of the individuals in context to social situations. The social psychologists and researchers often, in general, are found to base their research findings on the solid grounds of objective observations and field studies involving a sufficiently scientific approach instead of guess work, here saying, vague impressions and arm chair theorizing. The methods used by them in this concern, such as experimental method (carried out in laboratory as well as in field settings) and naturalistic observation method, allow them to set hypotheses, collect the relevant data and then reach valid conclusions for arriving at one of the set hypotheses and lastly to place the so arrived hypothesis under the hammer of objective validity and reliability. In this way, the approach adopted in the studies conducted in social psychology is found to be sufficiently objective, reliable and valid and also found to be true in the repeated similar social conditions much like the subjects or disciplines accepted and recognized as sciences. Like sciences, the studies conducted in social psychology also help in establishing

cause and effect relationships and possess the predictive value as emphasized ahead.

- Social psychology tries to describe and explain the what, when, where, how and why of the behavior and mental processes of the individuals helpful in guiding the ways of their activities and behavior carried out in social situations – such as their interaction and relationship with other individuals, persuasions and conformities, attractions and repulsions, prejudices and stereotyping, cooperation and competition, conflicts and adjustments, etc.
- Its ability to carry out the study in experimental conditions by controlling the involved variables, or having quite systematic observations in an objective way by using the developed observation devices and searching for the common features or general trend of behaving and performing on the part of the individuals in social situations may help well in the prediction of the future behavior of the individuals, groups or events of the social environment in a satisfactory way.
- The results or findings of the studies carried out in social psychology, the rules and principles established and theories framed out of these findings are always open for being re-examined and challenged for the emergence of the new rules, principles and theories at the hands of future researchers. This flexibility and scope for bringing needed changes helps social psychology to remain scientific in its approach as well as application much like the established sciences.

In spite of all this, however, we can't term social psychology a perfect science. It falls in the category of behavioral sciences and hence has its own limitations. The human behavior – individual or social – is unpredictable. It is more variable and less reliable. Therefore, social psychology, the applied behavioral science, cannot claim objectivity, exactness and validity as claimed by natural sciences such as physics, chemistry and biology or even applied sciences like medicine and engineering.

To Sum Up

The nature of the subject social psychology is considered sufficiently scientific because:

- It is one of the branches or components of the subject psychology being defined as a scientific study of social behavior of the individuals.
- It makes use of scientific methods and approach to study the social behavior of the individuals in one or the other social situations. Here, we can carry out the study in experimental conditions by controlling the involved variables or having a quite systematic observation in an objective way.
- It is capable of describing and explaining the what, when, where, how and why of the social behavior of people.
- Like sciences, the studies conducted in social psychology also help in establishing cause and effect relationships and possess the predictive value as it is found to help well in the prediction of the future behavior of the individuals and group in a given social situation in a satisfactory way.

The Scope of Social Psychology

The scope of a subject, in general, may be stated and described by pointing out (i) what is studied or what type of topics and contents are included in the study of that subject, and (ii) what is its field of operation and application or for what use its study can be put to its users? Let us, try to analyze and discuss the scope of social psychology from the above cited angles one by one.

What Is Included in the Study of the Subject Social Psychology?

Social psychology, in its all ways and means, forms and shapes, purposes and objectives, stands for studying and explaining the behavior of the individuals in

context to social situations much in the same way as educational psychology describes and explains the behavior of persons behaving and working in the educational situations and sports psychology studies and points out the behavior of sports personnel in sports situations.

The development and welfare of the individuals' working and behaving in social situations and environment lies in helping them suitably (i) for engaging in their social behavior well as properly as possible and (ii) in caring for their personal development and well-being as a whole in relation to their social life and social environment in which they live and work.

As a result, thus, its study must include the study of the topics helpful in dealing with the what, how, when, where and why of the things needed for improving the behavior of the people working and behaving in social situations including their overall personality development and well-being.

In view of all these considerations, the content material provided in the texts related to the subject social psychology, generally, may be found to be necessarily rich in answering questions such as:

1. Is the social behavior of the individuals different from their behavior displayed as the individual being? What is its nature and what are the factors that contribute for the development and demonstration of one or the other types of social behavior on the part of individuals at one or the other time?
2. What are the methods and techniques employed for the study of social behavior and thought processes of the individuals by the researchers and thinkers?
3. What is that which helps us to take cognizance of other's behavior or the social world around us? What are the different elements or constituents of this social cognition? How do these come into operation and contribute towards our social cognition?
4. What helps us in the process of our social perception i.e., knowing and understanding other persons and the social world around us? How do some of the important elements or constituents of our social perception such as verbal and non-verbal communication, attribution (probable causes of others' behavior) and impression formation work for our social perception?
5. How do we perceive or form concepts about our own self and how our evaluation of the self and search for our identity shape our attitude and behavior towards others? How does the work of self-evaluation and concept formation represented in the shape of one's self-esteem and self-efficacy guide his/her social behavior?
6. How do our attitudes, towards others and our social world, work for behaving and adjusting with them? How are these formed? How can we know about their intensity and magnitude and what are the different ways and means to introduce changes in them? What roles are played by the techniques like persuasion and cognitive dissonance in bringing attitudinal change?
7. How do our negative attitudes, beliefs and behaviors formed and developed towards others in the form of prejudices, stereotyping and discrimination influence and guide our behavior towards them? How are these formed and developed and what can be the ways and means for countering their ill effects?
8. How are an individual's thoughts or actions affected and molded by other people through the processes of social influence such as conformity, compliance and obedience? What are these processes and what determines to adhere to such practices for the individuals?
9. How does the process of social exchange helping or obstructing the social activities of the individuals go on in a group or social setup? What is the nature and relative role of the factors or attributes like cooperation, competition and conflicts associated with such social exchange?
10. What is the nature of interpersonal social behavior existing among the human beings particularly in the form of interpersonal attractions, relationships and influences? What are their possible determinants and forms of visibility among the human societies?
11. What are the nature and characteristics of the social behaviors termed as altruism and pro-social behavior associated with the tasks of

helping others in need? How is such desirable social behavior developed among the human beings and what type of situational factors enhance/hinder the occurrence of such helping behavior on the part of the humans? What type of characteristics and dispositions are visible in the personality of the individuals demonstrating such types of social behavior?

12. What is socialization and how does it help us in demonstrating needed behavior towards others and welfare and progress of our society? What helps in the process of our socialization and how?
13. How does one or the other types of social changes take place in a society? What contributes towards the introduction of such changes as well as provides hurdles for the occurrence of such changes?
14. What contributes towards bringing integration in a social group, society or among the different groups or societies existing in a social setup? What specific measures need to be adopted in achieving the required social integration in one or the other society?
15. What are social groups and the type of behavior termed as group behavior demonstrated by the individuals as the members of such groups? How are these are formed and how do they function? What is group dynamics and why is cohesiveness of the group essential for the proper functioning of a group? What is social loafing and how does it affect the performance of a group? How does the type of leadership affect the working and performance of a group and how may the traits of affective leadership be developed among individuals?
16. What is aggression and violence visible among individuals as social behaviors in one or the other situations? How do such behaviors get developed among individuals and what factors and attributes are responsible for this development? What are spectators and workplace aggressions and what causes such type of aggression among individuals? What type of preventive and controlling measures can be adopted for the needed management of the aggression and violent behaviors among individuals?
17. What types of social problems and thorny issues are visible in our society? What type of intervention can be provided for the management of these problems and issues?

In search of the answers to the aforementioned and other similar nature queries, the subject social psychology is found to include the following types of topics and sub-topics in its study in its quite usual and general form.

- Social psychology – its meaning, nature and scope; distinguishing social psychology from the other fields of psychology such as evolutionary psychology, cultural psychology as well as from the other social sciences such as sociology and anthropology.
- Description about the various methods utilized and modes employed for the study and investigation carried out in the study of the behavior of the individuals in relation to a variety of social situations.
- Description about the concept of social cognition; major cognitive strategies such as social schema, heuristics, automatic and controlled processing guiding one's social behavior; potential source of error in social cognition; affect and cognition (how feelings shape thought and thought shapes feelings).
- Description about the concept of social perception; determinants and perceptual process involving processing of information about others available in the form of verbal and non-verbal communication, attribution and impression formation;
- Description about the concept of self-perception (knowing and identifying the self); self-concept (attitude about self); self-evaluation (evaluating one's self); self-esteem and self-regard; self-efficacy.
- Description about the concept of attitudes, formation of attitudes; theories of attitudes formation; components or dimensions of attitude; measurement of attitudes, impact of attitudes on our behavior, attitudinal changes and the techniques helpful in bringing change in attitudes such as persuasion and cognitive dissonance.

- Description about the concept, nature and development of the negative behaviors and beliefs known as prejudices, stereotyping and discrimination; their impact on our social behavior and the measures employed for countering their ill effects.
- Description about the concept of social influence (group influence) for bringing changes in the behavior of others; forms of social influence such as conformity, compliance and obedience; conformity-meaning and nature, factors affecting conformity, the bases of conformity and classic studies or experiments on conformity; compliance – meaning and nature, underlying principles and tactics used in compliance; obedience – meaning and nature, factors affecting and underlying principles of obedience, destructive obedience and social behavior.
- Description about the concept of social exchange process involving cooperation, competition and conflicts and the description about their nature and impacts on our social behavior.
- Description about the concepts associated with interpersonal attraction, and interpersonal relationships associated with the social behavior of the individuals; interpersonal attraction – meaning, variables and determinants; beginning of the attraction among individuals for their interpersonal social relationships; interpersonal relationship – meaning, affiliation, friendship, love and marriage.
- The description about the concept of altruism and pro-social behavior; determinants of pro-social behavior; stages of development; situational factors enhancing/inhibiting pro-social helping behavior; theories of pro-social behavior; bystander effect explanations; personality variables associated with the pro-social behavior, bystanders and their involvement in helping behavior; the measures for increasing the pro-social behavior.
- Description about the concept of socialization, goals of socialization; agent or agencies of socialization; process and theories of socialization.
- Description about the concept of social change, the forms and kinds of social changes, the factors contributing or obstructing towards the occurrence of social change, and the theories explaining the phenomenon of social change.
- Description about the concept of social integration, the mechanism and measures to achieve social integration.
- The description about the concept of social group, group behavior, group dynamics and group cohesiveness; group norms and their follow-up; factors affecting group behavior and cohesiveness; leadership – nature, styles, theories and ways of developing desirable leadership; social loafing – concept and measures for its reduction.
- The description about the concept social aggression, and violence; aggression – meaning, types, consequences, theories of aggression, causes of human aggression, aggression in long-term relationships, child abuse, bullying and aggression at workplaces, prevention and control of aggression; violence – meaning, nature and kinds of social violence; self-directed violence (suicide), domestic violence, sexual violence, collective violence aggression and violence in India; psychological intervention for aggression and violence.
- The description about the various social problems and psychological intervention; delinquency and crime; alcoholism and drug addiction; poverty, unemployment, corruption and terrorism; the impacts of globalization, industrialization and computerization; strategies to deal with such social issues and problems.

Uses and Applications of Social Psychology in Our Day-to-Day Social Life

Social psychology is best defined as the science of studying and knowing about the behavior of the individuals in context to social situations or environment of their living, behaving and working. In its simple meaning, therefore, it should stand for supplying all the essential knowledge, skills and other related art and techniques to all those who are concerned with

the task of helping or being helped as individuals engaged in one or the other type of interaction and behavior in social situations with a sole purpose of bettering their life and places they live in and work at. In brief, thus the different aspects of the use and applications of social psychology may be summarized as follows.

1. Application of social psychology in the field of relationship building and social adjustment.
2. Application of social psychology in the field of romance, sex and family life.
3. Application of social psychology in the field of work and job performance of the individuals.
4. Application of social psychology in the field of education.
5. Application of social psychology in the field of health and hygiene.
6. Application of social psychology in the field of law and legal system.
7. Application of social psychology in the field of business and industry.
8. Application of social psychology in the field of sports.
9. Application of social psychology in the field of counselling and clinical services.
10. Application of social psychology in the field of environment protection.
11. Application of social psychology in the field of seeking solution of the social problems and maladies.

In this way, with the discussion carried out regarding the scope of social psychology we can easily infer that its scope is quite wide and seems limitless as far as its application to the fields of social life of the individuals is concerned. It studies and explains all what stands for the behavior and activities of the individuals in one or the other social situations associated with his living and working. However, this specific characteristic also draws some limits to the application and scope of the subject social psychology. It neither tries to study and explain the structure of the social systems and working of the social institutions like sociology nor tries to describe the behavior of the individuals

as a whole (individual as well as social behavior) in all their walks of life as done in its parent subject psychology. The field of its study and application is clearly limited to the study of the behavior of individuals in context to the social situations and environment available to them for their living and behaving.

To Sum Up

We can discuss the scope of the subject social psychology in two ways – one by pointing out what is studied here in terms of the topics and contents and the other by stating its uses and applications in our day-to-day life. Such a discussion can make us conclude that the scope of social psychology is quite wide. It studies and explains all that stands for the behavior and activities of the individuals in one or the other social situations associated with their living and working. However, by doing so it seems to be limited in its scope only to the study of the behavior of individuals in context to the social situations and environment available to them for their living and behaving, rather than describing the behavior of the individuals as a whole (individual as well as social behavior) in all their walks of life as done in its parent subject psychology.

Review Questions

1. What is social psychology? Discuss its meaning and nature.
2. To what extent may we term the nature of social psychology as scientific? Discuss.
4. What do you understand by the term “scope of a subject?” Discuss the scope of social psychology in this respect.
5. In general, what needs to be included in terms of the contents and subject matter in the study of the subject social psychology?

6. Discuss the scope of the subject social psychology in relation to its uses and applications in our day-to-day life.

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2.

ORIGIN AND HISTORY OF SOCIAL PSYCHOLOGY

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- Talk about the origin and birth of social psychology.
- Discuss the development and progress in social psychology during the different time periods such as: 1895–1945, 1946–1970 and 1971 onwards.
- Throw light on the development of social psychology in India during the different time periods such as development in Ancient India, development in British India and development after gaining Independence.
- Name the international social psychology journals published worldwide (print as well as electronic).
- Discuss the different social psychology associations of the world.

Origin and Birth of Social Psychology

Social psychology in the capacity of being defined as ‘psychology of all that which is social’ is supposed to have the roots of its origin and development in both of its parent subjects or disciplines psychology and sociology. Sociology, the study of the society and social beings, is relatively much older than psychology. However, we can attempt to search for the roots of both in the writings and viewpoints emphasized by the ancient and early age thinkers and philosophers in the manner emphasized here.

- We may here begin with the ancient Greek philosophers. In this concern, the great thinker and philosopher Plato argued in one of his publications *The Republic* around 375 BC, that the individual

is not self-sufficient. He needs the cooperative efforts of others in the form of society for serving his own essential goals. However, when the individuals come together just like the flocks of animals or birds, they may form a crowd—an irrational mob. Here arises the need of the well-organized societies and the states for governing and assigning social responsibilities to the individuals comprising society. Later on, his disciple, Aristotle (384–322 BC), endorsed the viewpoint of his teacher by saying that man is essentially social and gregarious by nature, and it is this nature that has given birth to the existence of the communities or societies and states, afterwards, for the better control of the individuals and societies.

- The philosophical thoughts continued to dominate the scene of our knowing and understanding about the discipline psychology and sociology for a quite long duration after the brighter periods of world's ancient civilization. We may name the views of the philosophers cum thinkers like Hobbes, Locke, Herbert Spencer, Emile Durkheim, Max Weber, Rousseau and others for this purpose. In this sequence, the German philosopher Hegel (1770–1831) is also well known for introducing the concept that *society has inevitable links with the development of the social mind* (a concept used widely in sociology and social psychology in the name of group mind or group behavior). In this way, what we term as *social* in context to the individuals (their social nature and need of living together), the initiation for knowing about it may be well searched in the viewpoints and writings of the thinkers and philosophers of the ancient days. It can also be well emphasized here that what is known as psychology and sociology by us now was well studied and used in the forms and shapes of *mental philosophy* and *social philosophy* in the earlier days, thus justifying the claim of philosophy as the mother of both the disciplines psychology and sociology.
- Actually, thus, as far as the birth of the discipline social psychology defined as the science of social behavior is concerned, its origin and birth is also well linked with the birth and origin of its parent disciplines sociology and psychology. In context to the birth of the subject sociology in its existing form of being defined as *the science of studying the human society* as well as use of the term *sociology* for the first time the credit for the same is given to the French scholar Auguste Comte (1758–1857). Moreover, according to Gordon Allport (1968), it was he who took initiative in suggesting that the behavior of an individual can be fully studied scientifically with reference to its social and biological influences. Later on, the similar attempt for laying out the foundation stone of psychology for getting it studied

and applied as a scientific discipline was made by Wilhelm Wundt, the well-known German scholar. He is known as the official founder of the discipline of psychology with his publication of the *Principles of Physiological Psychology* in 1873 and establishment of his first psychology laboratory at the University of Leipzig (Germany) in 1879. The birth of sociology and psychology as scientific disciplines of studying human society and human behavior then paved the way of opening the doors of the birth of their offshoot social psychology for studying the behavior of the individuals in context of social situations right before the ending decade of the 19th century. After its birth, social psychology started its journey of subsequent development and progress on the lines and ways as discussed in this chapter ahead.

To Sum Up

The roots of the origin and development of social psychology lie in both of its parent disciplines psychology and sociology. In the earlier days of the ancient era, the philosophical thoughts beginning with the ancient Greek Philosophers Plato and Aristotle and then carried out by the other philosophers such as Locke, Herbert Spencer, Emile Durkheim, Max Weber, Rousseau, Hegel and others dominated the scene of viewing both sociology and psychology from the philosophical angle. In this way, in the earlier days what is known as psychology and sociology by us now was well studied and used in the forms and shapes of *mental philosophy* and *social philosophy*. In the later years both sociology and psychology began to be understood and studied as scientific disciplines with the attempts of the French scholar Auguste Comte and the German scholar Wilhelm Wundt, paving the way for the birth of their offshoot social psychology to study the behavior of individuals in the context of social situations right before the ending decade of the 19th century.

Development and Progress in Social Psychology

After getting its birth from the courtesy of its parent disciplines sociology and psychology, the journey of the subsequent development and progress of the discipline social psychology can be discussed well under the following heads.

1. Development in the early years during the period 1895–1945.
2. Development during the period 1946–1970.
3. Development during the period 1971 onwards.

Let us now carry out our discussion during the above said periods

Development in the Early Years During the Period 1895–1945

The significant events occurring during this era in relation to their contribution towards the development of social psychology may be summarized as follows.

1. The years 1895–1897 can be well remembered as the year of the formal establishment of social psychology as a scientific discipline on the basis of the experimental studies (the first of its kind performed in the history of social psychology) conducted for this purpose at the hands of an American psychologist Norman Triplett (1861–1934). Through his study published in 1897, Triplett tried to investigate about the phenomenon of *social facilitation*, in which performance is affected by the presence of others. He performed two experiments – one with school children and the other with cyclists for this purpose. In his experiment with school children, Triplett asked children to quickly wind line on a fishing reel either alone or in the presence of other children performing the same task. It was found that children wound the line faster when in the presence of others. Similarly, in the other experiment performed with the cyclists, it was found that cyclists tended to cycle faster and performed better when competing against each other than when riding alone.
2. Afterwards, a quite important role for establishing social psychology as a scientific discipline for the study of social behavior was played by the authors of certain books published during 1908–1924. Mentionable in this concern were:
 - (i) *Social Psychology* published in 1908 by the English psychologist William McDougall emphasizing that social behavior stems from innate tendencies or instincts.
 - (ii) *Social Psychology* (bearing the same title) in the same year 1908, by the American sociologist Edward Ross, highlighted the role of groups and structure of the society for the social behavior of the individuals.
 - (iii) *Social Psychology* (bearing the same title) in the same year 1924 by Floyd Allport in which he took a quite balancing stand (much closer to the modern concept of social psychology) by arguing that social behavior stems from many different factors, biological and social, including the presence of other persons and their specific actions.

Besides, this Floyd Allport is also well known for making good use of experimental method for studying the social behavior phenomenon such as conformity, non-verbal communication and social facilitation.
3. Afterwards, the quite mentionable attempts for the progress and development of social psychology were made in the latter half of the 1920s and 1930s by the scholars working in this field especially related to the social attitudes, self and stereotypes. Mentionable attempts in this concern may be cited as follows.
 - (i) The social psychologists like Thurstone and Chave (1929) and Likert (1932) developed scaling methods for the measurement of the attitudes of the people.
 - (ii) In 1933, Katz and Braly published the quite significant studies relating to stereotype behaviors of the people.
 - (iii) In 1934, G.H. Mead published his work about the self and in the same year J.L. Moreno developed sociometry, a quite useful method for knowing about the inter-relationships existing in a group.

- (iv) In 1935, the Turkish-born socio-psychologist Muzafer Sherif brought out his famous study concerning the behavior associated with the conformity demonstrated on the part of individuals.
- (v) Later on, in 1940, Hovland and Sears proposed and tested a theory that explained why individuals behaved aggressively, based on how individuals take out their frustration about their lives on a scapegoat.

Important Events in the Development of Social Psychology During 1895–1945

- Formal establishment of social psychology as a scientific discipline by the American psychologist Norman Triplett on the basis of his experimental study related to the phenomenon of social facilitation in the years 1895–1897.
 - Publishing of the books bearing the title “Social Psychology” during 1908–1924 by the authors like William McDougall, Edward Ross and Floyd Allport.
 - Mentionable attempts made in the latter half of the 1920s and 1930s by the scholars like Thurstone and Chave, Likert, Katz and Bray, G.H. Mead, etc., in the fields related to social attitudes, self and stereotypes.
 - The famous experimental study on the social behavior ‘conformity’ carried out by Muzafer Sherif in the year 1935 and a theory of aggression brought out by Hovland and Sears in 1940.
 - Notable work carried out by Kurt Lewin and his colleagues during the later years of the 1930s in the field of group behavior including leadership and group dynamics.
 - Significant studies made during the period 1939–1945 (World War II) by the socio-psychologists like Festinger, Schachter, Deutsch, Kelley, Thiabut, etc. related to the use of the knowledge of human social behavior in serving the cause of countries warfare programs.
4. In the latter half of the 1930s the progress in the development of social psychology came to a halt worldwide for some time due to the emergence of World War II (1939–1945). During this period a quite mentionable phenomenon took place across the globe. The rise of fascism in Germany, Spain and Italy forced a number of their psychologists and sociologists like Fritz Heider, Gustav Ichheiser, Kurt Lewin and Theodor Adorno, to leave the country and settle in other parts of Europe and America. These migrated scholars and the scholars belonging to these countries then got themselves engaged in conducting useful research work in the field of social psychology in the ways as mentioned next.
 - Kurt Lewin along with his other Gestalt psychologist colleagues carried out notable studies in the field of group behavior including leadership and group dynamics. Lewin, here, specifically attempted to (a) make use of researches in social psychology for dealing with the social problems and thus contributing towards providing social psychology a role of applied science for the benefit of the society and (b) training of the contemporary and budding socio-psychologists like Festinger, Schachter, Deutsch, Kelley, Thiabut, etc.
 - In response to the need of the country, these so settled scholars along with those already working in these countries were persuaded and financed by the respective governmental and philanthropic bodies to conduct studies related to the use of the knowledge of human social behavior in serving the cause of countries’ warfare programs including selection of the officers for their intelligence agencies, war propaganda and measures for raising the morale of their soldiers.

Development Carried Out During the Period 1946–1970

With the end of war in 1945, the task of the progress and development of social psychology gradually picked up its speed in the coming years. Some of the

significant events in this regard may be mentioned as follows.

1. Gordon Allport (1954) brought out a text, *The Nature of Prejudice*, in which he discussed his contact hypothesis emphasizing that when different groups come together, it tends to reduce prejudice, although critically, only under certain conditions.
2. Leon Festinger (1957) conducted studies in the field of social psychology for the development of the theory of cognitive dissonance proposing that human beings dislike inconsistency and strive to reduce it in the demonstration of their social behavior.
3. Fritz Heider conducted quite useful studies during the 1950s in the field of human interpersonal relations. In 1958 he published *The Psychology of Interpersonal Relations* mentioning two important socio-psychological theories, namely balance and attribution theory related to human social cognition and perception. In the subsequent year, 1959, a book named *The Social Psychology of Groups* was published by John Thiabut and Harold Kelley in which they presented a general theory of social exchange and interpersonal relations.

Important Events in the Development of Social Psychology During 1946–1970

- Publishing of the text *The Nature of Prejudice*, by Gordon Allport in 1954.
- Bringing out the theory of cognitive dissonance by Leon Festinger in the year 1957.
- Publishing of a book *Psychology of Interpersonal Relations* by Fritz Heider in 1958 mentioning two important socio-psychological theories, namely balance and attribution theory related to human social cognition and perception.
- Publishing of a book named *The Social Psychology of Groups* in the year 1959

by John Thiabut and Harold Kelley presenting a general theory of social exchange and interpersonal relations.

- Conducting of a famous obedience experiment by Stanley Milgram in the year 1961.
 - Conducting of useful experiment on modelling of social behavior by Albert Bandura in 1963.
 - Conducting of studies related to social phenomena like stereotyping and prejudice, school desegregation, aggression, altruism, bystander intervention, interpersonal relations love, romance and attraction by the social psychologists like Elaine Hatfield, Ellen Berscheid, Bibb Latane and John Darley during the latter half of the 1960s.
4. Stanley Milgram conducted useful studies in the field of social psychology in the 1950s and 1960s. A special mention in this concern may be made of his famous obedience experiments conducted in the year 1961 which examined the situational factors that make individuals more likely to obey destructive authority figures.
 5. Albert Bandura (1963) conducted useful experiments to demonstrate that behavior in the social world could be modelled. Here the observation of the behavior of others (elders or the persons being judged as a model figure) and imitation on the part of children or even adults and its subsequent rewarding/punishing was found to make them learn or unlearn a particular type of social behavior.
 6. In the 1960s, social psychologists like Elaine Hatfield, Ellen Berscheid, Bibb Latane and John Darley conducted research in the socio-psychological fields associated with social phenomena like stereotyping and prejudice, school desegregation, aggression, altruism, bystander intervention, interpersonal relations love, romance and attraction.

Development Carried Out During the Period 1971 Onwards

Social psychology has reached maturity in both theory and method after the work done in this field right from the year 1971 onwards. The notable works and main events happening during this period can be briefed as follows.

1. Tejfel and Turner brought out a useful theory in the early 1970s in the field of social psychology named the *Social Identity Theory* stating that individuals need to maintain a positive sense of personal and social identity; this is partly achieved by emphasizing the desirability of one's own group, focusing on distinction between other "lesser" groups.
 2. In the 1970s, Haney et al. (1973) conducted useful research work for introducing the notion of social influence, and the ways in which this could be observed/tested. During the latter half of the 1970s, socio-psychologists were seen to engage in the area of cross-cultural research with the objective of studying and comparing the same behavior in different cultures. In this concern, Triandis (1977) tried to present a general framework for linking cultural influences to social behavior that helped the contemporary researchers carrying out useful research work in this area.
 3. In the 1980s, Weiner contributed to the field of social psychology by getting interested in the attributions made for experiences of success and failure and introducing the idea that we look for explanations of behavior in the social world. In this concern, he discussed three areas (working as locus of control for exercising control over the situation) that can be either external or internal, stability or instability and controllability.
- Important Events in the Development During the Period 1971 onwards**

 - Bringing out a theory known as the *Social Identity Theory* by Tejfel and Turner in the early 1970s.
- Introduction of the notion of social influence by Haney, Banks and Zimbardo in the year 1973.
 - Presentation of a general framework for linking cultural influences to social behavior by Triandis in the year 1977 for carrying out useful cross-cultural studies.
 - In the 1980s, Weiner introduced in the field of social perception his theory known as Weiner's attribution theory.
 - Regarding the development of social psychology during 19th century, we may witness two significant trends – the growing influence of the cognitive perspective and increased interest in the application of social psychology that has been well carried out in the years followed in 20th and 21st centuries.
 - A lot of research work being done in the areas and topics related to social cognition and social perception, social and cultural diversity, love and happiness, marginalization and deprivation, inequalities and gender discrimination, inter-caste and inter-religion marriages, and other social problems of the day faced by the world societies.
4. From 1900 onward, the notable trend in the development and progress in the field of social psychology may be briefed as follows.
 - (i) A renewed interest with more zeal and enthusiasm has been seen to grow in the socio-psychologists for bringing useful social-cognitive theories emphasizing that individuals employ multiple cognitive strategies based on their current goals, motives and needs. They have tried to make use of the phenomena of both explicit cognition and implicit cognition for explaining the social behavior of individuals. Whereas in the former (explicit cognition) the mode of

information processing is based on effortful, reflective thinking, in the latter (implicit cognition) the mode of information-processing is based on minimal cognitive effort, allowing emitting of behavior through impulsive and unintentional activation carried out by one's emotions, habits or biological drives, often below the radar of consciousness. In this sequence, Pelham et al. (2002) in one of their studies demonstrated that "if something is closer to our self-concept then we tend to like it more". For example, we begin to like or appreciate the persons bearing the same name or caste as ours. Our such behavior occurs on account of implicit cognition with a least awareness to us of the occurrence of this social behavior.

- (ii) The assigning of a quite significant role to one's cognition and brain activities has resulted in providing a lot of importance to the neural activity in the brain for explaining a number of social psychological processes, including self-awareness, self-regulation, attitude formation and attitudinal change, group interaction and group dynamics, stereotyping and prejudices, and human interrelations, love and romance. It has resulted in the birth of a new perspective in the name of neuroscience perspective in social psychology devoted to understanding how biological systems execute social processes and behavior.
- (iii) The other significant trend visible in the development of social psychology in the 1900s and onwards (still persisting at present in the modern social psychology) is the applied aspect of the subject social psychology calling for the applications of the principles, theories and findings of social psychology to a number of uses in day-to-day life and world of work of people such as health and medicine, education, law, politics, sports, industry and business.

- (iv) The years of the 2000s and following two decades of the 21st century have witnessed the continuance of the two quite prominent socio-psychological trends of the 19th century, namely (i) the growing influence of the cognitive perspective and (ii) increasing interest in the application of social psychology. Besides these two, the socio-psychologists have also done quite pioneering work in conducting a lot of research in the areas and topics related to social cognition and social perception, social and cultural diversity, love and happiness, marginalization and deprivation, inequalities and gender discrimination, inter-caste and inter-religion marriages, social problems of the day faced by the world societies. A few of the important research works carried out during this period are cited as follows.

- In 2004, James Surowiecki published a book entitled *The Wisdom of Crowds* about the aggregation of information in groups resulting in decisions that, he argues, are often better than could have been made by any single member of the group.
- During the 2000s, Jonathan Haidt conducted useful research in the field of love and happiness and is credited with developing a useful hypothesis related to happiness of individuals as well as bringing out a publication named *The Happiness Hypothesis: Finding Modern Truth in Ancient Wisdom* in the year 2006.
- Sushan Fiske and Shelley Taylor conducted useful studies in the field of social cognition and social perception and drew heavily on attribution theory. The conclusions of their research findings were published in 2007 under the title *Social Cognition: From Brain to Culture*.
- In 2009, Blanton et al., while working in the area of prejudices and

stereotyping, developed a tool for assessing covert forms of stereotyping of the people.

- During the first decade of the 21st century, H.R. Markus and A.L. Conner conducted important research work in the area of cultural diversity and multi-culturalism of the modern society. Their views and findings appeared in 2014 in their publication *Clash! How to Thrive in a Multicultural World*.

Development of Social Psychology in India

Development of social psychology in India may also be seen to pass through the similar trends as discussed earlier in the case of its origin and development among the western countries. Different periods of Indian history have witnessed different types of development in the field of social psychology. Let us discuss them in brief.

The Development of Social Psychology in Ancient India

Like other parts of the globe, there was nothing like the subject social psychology, sociology or psychology for their study to the scholars in ancient India. The essence of all these subjects was studied, discussed, applied and preserved in the form of philosophical and religious texts or scholarly scripts. Right from the period as early as 2000 to 1500 BC, we Indians are proud to possess the treasure of such valuable treatises popular by their names as Vedas, Upanishads, Puranas, Smritis, Samhitas, Manu Smriti, Kautilya's Arthashastra along with the great epics like Mahabharat and Ramayana as well as classical folk narratives such as Jatak Kathas and Panchtantra. A glimpse on these great treatises may enable us to reveal how, at that time, in our ancient India, the study and application of philosophical thinking and logic was handling all the practical aspects needed for organizing and managing the social behavior of the people and the society. Accordingly, much like the quests and concerns in discourses of Plato and Aristotle, the ancient Indian philosophers and thinkers, like Manu, Gautam,

Yagyavalkya, Kautilya and others, were concerned with the preservation and refinement of social systems and institutions, while maintaining human freedom and social progress in its proper tune.

The trend of looking at the social problem and management of social behavior of the individuals and social institutions through philosophical thinking, logic and religious discourse, preaching and literature then continued not only in the regimes of later Hindu rulers but also in the rulings of the Muslims and Mughal emperors till the arrival of British rule in India. The more mentionable things related to the practical application of social psychology in understanding and managing the social behavior of the people and institutions through philosophical thoughts and logical considerations in this concern may be cited as follows.

- In the ancient literature consisting of Vedas, Upanishadas and other treatises of Dharma-shashtra, much emphasis was paid over dharma (moral duty or proper action) demanding on the part of people to do karma or duty according to their age, sex and division of labor in the society with no intention of harming the interests of others. In all its meaning and actions, abiding with one's dharma was aimed to keep the desired social order in the society along with the maintenance of harmonious relationships among the people. Commenting over the valued aspect of dharma in human life, Kakar (1979:6) has stated:

In its social implication, dharma is an inherent force in human being which holds the individual and society together, or going one step further, the force which makes "individual and society" hold each other together.

- The other striking feature visible in ancient Indian literature is its belief in considering self to be integral to the all-pervasive cosmic reality, binding all living and non-living things in a relationship of functioning in harmony and natural rhythm. Accordingly, the establishment of perfect balance with nature and society was considered as the ultimate goal of human life.

- Another striking feature of the ancient Indian literature is regarding its emphasis on interdependence and interrelatedness of man and society. All of us living in a society are quite interrelated and interdependent to each other as well as to the social institutions to which we belong. As a social being, nobody has any existence outside the network of relationships. Everybody has to function within its network by fulfilling his assigned duties in the social network in the interest of his self and society as a whole.
- The beliefs as well actions of the Indian people right from the period of Rigveda have been guided by the philosophy of Advaita Vedanta making no distinction between human and society or between self and non-self. It has led to the idea of Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam (The whole world is our family) ruling the minds and heart of the Indian people. Besides this, for Indians, the individual and the society have remained in a state of symbiotic relationship, where one cannot separate each other (Sinha, 1981).
- The great epics like Ramayana and Mahabharata through their mythical stories tried to depict the realities of the societies, social structures, social behavior and interactional processes and many other social concepts related to human behavior studied now by us in social psychology. Similarly, the great treatise Kautilya's Arthashastra written during the Gupta regime presented an analytical description of the concept and principles related to economics, power and politics proving effective for running a social structure in an efficient way. Even the classical folk narratives of the ancient Indian literature, like Jatak Kathas and Panchtantra – a blend of both virtues and vices of the mythical characters – tell us in their own ways about the social behavior, interaction and dynamics of social relationships capable enough to teach quite valuable lessons for leading our social life with necessary care by providing meaningful insights and norms regarding various life issues (J.B.P. Sinha, 2002).
- In addition, a quite rich knowledge and practical application of the concepts of social psychology are also available in the philosophical

and religious literature of the religions other than Hinduism such as Jain, Buddha, Islam and Sufism, etc. It may provide us valuable insight into the social behavior of the people, their interaction and relationships, group dynamics, community living, power politics, socio-economic conditions and other related concepts of the modern social psychology.

However, what prevailed in India till the arrival of British rule consisted only in terms of the practical implications of the concepts and principles of social psychology visible in the form of the establishment of social norms and their compliance in the people's social behavior, and interrelations as well as proper functioning of the social institutions. Its continuance in this form (without any existence of the formal studies of the subjects sociology, psychology and social psychology for the people) pervaded all the periods until the beginning of the British rule in India in the 18th century.

To Sum Up

Like other parts of the globe, there was nothing like the subjects social psychology, sociology or psychology for their study to the scholars in ancient India. The essence of all these subjects was studied, discussed, applied and preserved in the form of philosophical and religious texts or scholarly scripts. Accordingly, right from the period as early as 2000 to 1500 BC, there was a practice of looking at the social problem and management of social behavior of the individuals and social institutions through philosophical thinking, logic and religious discourse, preaching and literature. The trend continued not only later on in the regimes of Hindu rulers but much in the rulings of the Muslims and Mughal emperors till the beginning of the British rule in India in the 18th century without any existence of the formal studies of the subjects sociology, psychology and social psychology to the people.

Development of Social Psychology in British India

With the appearance of British people and establishment of their rule in India, Indian people and society got exposed to the European culture and ways of social living affecting and influencing their social behavior and institutions in a different way. The British people, as a colonizer and ruler, were purely interested in serving their own purpose of forcing the people of India to remain slave, and exploit their men and material resources to their own prosperity. Their aim for providing education to the Indians was thus nothing but to seek degree holder individuals, physically Indian but mentally English, for serving their regime. In the similar manner, they tried to put their interest first before making any attempt regarding the development of social psychology as a discipline in India. However, after facing the blunt of Indian public in the first Indian Independence struggle in 1857, they recognized the need of knowing the sociology of the Indian masses in terms of their varying customs, cultural traditions, beliefs, attitudes, strong liking and disliking for the things, along with the practices running in their religious and social institutions. For serving this purpose, they supported the growth of the studies in the disciplines anthropology and sociology in the departments of existing universities in India and by the turn of this century (18th) these disciplines were well established in the Indian academics (Dhanangre, 1985). No efforts for the support and promotion of the research in social psychology or establishment of the departments for its academic study in the universities were, thus, undertaken by them for the simple reason that they did not consider it of much use in serving their colonial interests.

However, getting them established well in the country, the things began to change right from the early 19th century in favor of the promotion and development of the discipline social psychology in the manner as briefed next.

- The beginning was made with the introduction of the discipline psychology as a subject in the philosophy department of Calcutta University

in the year 1905. It was followed by the establishment of a separate department of psychology in the same university in the year 1916. Professor N.N. Sengupta was the first chairman of this department; he had a credit of earning his degree with Hugo Munsterberg (a student of Wilhelm Wundt) at Harvard University and had his basic training in experimental psychology. There existed no watertight compartment between the subjects psychology and sociology at that time with a fine opportunity for the scholars of both the disciplines working together. It facilitated Sengupta from the Department of Psychology to shift at the Lucknow University sociology department to work with the eminent sociologist Radha Kamal Mukherjee. Both of them brought a book on social psychology in the name of *Introduction to Social Psychology: Mind in Society*, the first publication of an Indian author on the subject social psychology. It was published from London in the year 1928. Thus, the beginning of social psychology in India was, in fact, interdisciplinary in nature.

- However, the cooperation between the disciplines sociology and psychology did not continue too long and consequently, the study and research work in social psychology failed to become a bridge between the two sister disciplines. On the footprints of a global trend, in India also there was an emergence of two social psychologies – known as (i) sociologically oriented social psychology (study of collective representation, popular in Europe) and (ii) psychologically oriented social psychology (study of individual representations, popular in USA). Social psychology within the sociological tradition took a lead in the British India on account of the need of doing research in knowing about the social behavior of the people and institutions as well as for its getting influenced by the trend prevalent in Europe including Britain. Therefore, the use of the methods of survey and participant observation remained quite popular in India at that time for carrying out sociology related research work in the discipline of social psychology.

- Three more universities – other than the Calcutta – Mysore University, Madras University and Patna University, achieved a distinction of establishing the Department of Psychology in the years 1924, 1943 and 1946 respectively. At that time, in all the universities' psychology departments both types of researches pertaining to two social psychologies were in vogue in somewhat greater or lesser amount depending upon the scholars performing their research work. As illustration, a few mentionable ones, in this concern, are cited here.
- An experimental investigation (modelled on the research method used by Allport and his colleagues) carried out by Sengupta and Singh (1926) on group effects on performance (phenomenon of social facilitation), known as the very first of its kind, for laying down the foundation of experimental psychology in India.
- A study (based on the technique developed by Bartlett (1932) conducted by Jamuna Prasad (1935) to study the phenomenon of rumor by collecting and analyzing more than 35,000 rumors concerning the famous earthquake of Bihar in 1934.
- A study on color prejudice done by Adinarayan (1941) known as the first one of its kind to lay foundation for later work in the area of attitude and prejudice in India.
- A study examining ability differentials in work in groups and isolation performed by N.P. Mukherjee (1940) famous for doing a pioneer work in the area of knowing about the group influence on behavior.

In this way, there were both types of experimental and survey studies in social psychology conducted by the earlier researchers in India. However, the work done as reviewed by Girindrashekhar Bose (1938) was often the repetition and replication of the western work. Commenting on this aspect further, Ganguli (1971) emphasized that barring few experimental studies, most of the social psychological studies of this time were logical analyses of various social

phenomena. Social psychology before independence was less popular than general psychology and clinical psychology.

To Sum Up

In the early years of British rule in India, there was nothing in the shape of the study of the disciplines sociology, psychology or social psychology as the British rulers were interested in providing the type of education to the Indian people that suited for training them to help in their administration. However, after witnessing the 1857 struggle for independence, they recognized the need of knowing the sociology of the Indian masses and accordingly supported the growth of the studies in the discipline anthropology and sociology in the departments of existing universities in India. In the sequence of the acceptance and development of social psychology as a discipline for studying in Indian universities in British India we may mention the things such as:

- Introduction of psychology as a subject in the philosophy department of Calcutta University in the year 1905 followed by the establishment of a separate department of psychology in the same university in the year 1916.
- Bringing out a first publication in the year 1928 by an Indian author on social psychology entitled *Introduction to Social Psychology: Mind in Society* by Sengupta and Radha Kamal Mukherjee working in the departments of Psychology and Sociology of the Lucknow University.
- Emergence of two social psychologies – known as sociologically oriented social psychology and psychologically oriented social psychology – for carrying out study in the field of social psychology on the footprints of a global trend.

- Establishment of the Department of Psychology in three more universities – other than the Calcutta – Mysore University, Madras University and Patna University, in the years 1924, 1943 and 1946 respectively with the provision of carrying out researches pertaining to psychological and social psychologies.
- Use of experimental as well as survey methods for studying the social phenomenon much on the basis of what was being done in that field in western countries at that time.

Development of Social Psychology After Getting Independence

The research work and development of social psychology in India after gaining independence in the year 1947 started to reshape itself in the way as needed for dealing with the social problems and economic development of the country in the tune of work done and progress going on in the scientific reasoning-led western countries.

Immediately after independence, the country had to face the blunt of communal violence. It compelled the leadership of the country to seek the help of UNESCO for conducting somewhat large scale studies on communalism and social violence. Gardner Murphy, the famous psychologist, was deputed by UNESCO for the purpose. He along with a number of Indian psychologists worked for understanding the socio-psychological consequences of communal hatred, and findings of this work were summarized in his book *In the Minds of Men* brought out by him in the year 1953.

In the subsequent years, the scholars of our independent country enjoyed the privilege of getting exposure from the outside world through the visit of the foreign scholars along with their own visit on exchange programs. Besides this they had the opportunity to get their study as well as research work done in the foreign universities on the available scholarship programs as well as through their independent efforts of studying in the foreign countries. All such

things helped our scholars to get acquainted with the academics and research methodologies in vogue in advanced countries, helpful to them for carrying out their research work and progress in the field of social psychology in their own country. All such encouraging things provided good opportunity to the scholars working in the universities and higher institutions of our country for carrying out their research and project work in the ways learned by them at their training in western countries, influencing their selection of research themes and methodology accordingly.

Hence, there had been a mixed trend of adopting survey and experimental methods in the research work conducted at the hands of scholars in social psychology in India after the independence with a somewhat fluctuating trend in their conduct during the different periods. For instance, the use of experimental method and applicability of western theories picked up its momentum in a quite enhanced way in the '60s and '70s in the Indian universities as a number of Indian socio-psychologists returned from the western countries after their training in experimental psychology and western theories with a clear bent of mind in favor of applying experimental method and western theories for the research work in social psychology. The consequences of such trends got reflected well in the National Seminar on Perspectives in Experimental Social Psychology in India at Allahabad in 1979 with a useful discussion on the ongoing experimental social psychology researches, later on published by Pandey (1981) in a book form.

However, this trend of extreme inclination towards the use of experimental method and applicability of western theories gradually disappeared. It was discovered by Dalal and Sharma (1990) by examining the growth pattern of social psychological researches conducted in the duration 1972–1986 that consistently over the years, only 13–14% of them employed experimental method. Besides this, it was also found that there was a growing disillusionment in our country regarding the applicability of western theories in the studies of social psychology. In this concern Sinha (1997) urged for the use of the methods and theories helpful in the development of indigenous social psychology as the social

psychological theories developed in the western world do not provide solution to the problems of social change and development being faced by our developing country.

Another big thing for pushing up the development of social psychology happened with the establishment and functioning of Indian Council of Social Science Research (ICSSR) in 1969. It began supporting research, training and publications in the social sciences including psychology. The academic and research work in social psychology was, thus, now open to receive assistance from this national level organization for its needed pushing including its description in the *Periodical Survey of Psychological Research* published by ICSSR regularly for the information and progress of the research work in respective areas. The survey reports of the research work done during the different periods published by ICSSR and provides a good testimony for the speedy development going on in the field of social psychology. Whereas in the first Survey of Research in Psychology (Mitra, 1972) covering the period 1920–1967, there was only one chapter in social psychology, in the fifth ICSSR survey (Misra, 2009), covering the period from 1993 to 2003, a full volume out of the total four volumes comprising six chapters was exclusively devoted to the reporting of research work on the different socio-psychological issues.

Another important development concerning the pushing up of the development in social psychology is related to the starting up of the publication of the ICSSR-sponsored six monthly journal named *Indian Psychological Abstracts and Reviews*. Along with the publication of the review articles for psychological researches, it began to do the same for the researches in social psychology from the year 1994 onwards. Such efforts decidedly brought a new incentive for the progress and development in the field of social psychology.

Besides this, another contribution regarding the progress and development in the field of social psychology emerged on the scene in the form of the beginning of MPhil and doctoral programs with course work in the discipline among the Indian universities and higher institutions (including IITs)

from the 1970s onwards. It helped much in training the future leaders and providing opportunities to the scholars for doing the research work on the issues related to social psychology particularly concerning the social reality and practical use of the sociology in solving social problems facing the country. The paper presented and discussion held in the National Seminar on Applied Social Psychology held in 1987 in Bhopal, and the book entitled *Applied Social Psychology in India* (Misra, 1990) resulted through the proceedings of this seminar provide a good testimony of the progress arrived through the efforts of these MPhil and PhD programs of the universities and higher institutions.

Important Events in the Development of Social Psychology in India

- Introduction of psychology as a subject in the philosophy department of Calcutta University in the year 1905.
- The establishment of a separate Department of Psychology in Calcutta University in the year 1916, headed by Professor N.N. Sengupta.
- Bringing out a first publication in the year 1928 by an Indian author on social psychology entitled as *Introduction to Social Psychology: Mind in Society* by R.K. Mukherjee and N.N. Sengupta.
- Establishment of the Department of Psychology in Mysore University, Madras University and Patna University in the years 1924, 1943 and 1946.
- Foundation of Indian Psychological Association in the year 1924.
- Publication of the first psychology journal in India, *Indian Journal of Psychology*.
- Establishment and functioning of Indian Council of Social Science Research (ICSSR) in 1969 in the form of support giving agency for research, training and publications in social psychology.
- Starting of MPhil and doctoral programs with course work in the discipline among

the Indian universities and higher institutions (including IITs) from the 1970s onwards.

- Organization of the National Seminar on Applied Social Psychology in 1987 in Bhopal.
- Publishing of the book entitled *Applied Social Psychology in India* by Professor G. Misra in 1990.
- Publication of a book entitled *Perspectives on Indigenous Psychology* by G. Misra and A.K. Mohanty in (2002).
- Publication of *Handbook of Indian Psychology* incorporating social psychology in the year 2008.

As an outcome of the things discussed earlier, there has been a lot of gradual progress and development in the field of social psychology. We may know about it by getting acquainted with the study and research work carried out by the Indian scholars in a variety of areas, fields and issues related to the discipline social psychology. A few important areas covered in this concern in an article written by Janak Pandey and Purnima Singh (2009) are chosen here for pinpointing about the study and research work carried out by scholars in the field of social psychology from the period of attaining independence onwards.

1. Attitude, Prejudice and Intergroup Relations

The studies about these aspects occupy an immense importance for knowing about the inner mechanism of the social behavior of groups. After independence, the mentionable work carried out in this area may be briefed as follows.

- While commenting on the research studies analyzed in the first ICSSR survey, Rath (1972) emphasized that most of the research until the late '60s of the research studies conducted in the period used the popular attitude measurement techniques such as Likert, Thurstone and Bogardus.
- While working in the area of the social attitude and prejudice, Adinarayan conducted studies on racial and communal attitudes in the year 1953 and on caste attitude in the year 1958. Two years later Rath and Sircar (1960) analyzed inter-caste relationships and examined attitudes and opinions of six caste groups and found the lower caste groups perceiving themselves negatively. Later on, Sidana et al. (1976) concluded through their study that positive attitudes towards one's own caste and negative attitude towards other castes develop quite early among children.
- Some significant studies were conducted by Rath and Sircar (1960), Anant (1970) and others in the field of attitudinal change with reference to the implementation of a number of health and family planning programs, agricultural innovations and other developmental projects of the country. During the same period, another significant study regarding the attitudinal change was conducted by Sinha and Upadhyaya (1960) for measuring the attitudes of Indian toward Chinese and found significant changes in their attitude from positive to negative in the post-war period.
- In the area related to caste-based identities, self-perception and caste prejudice, Paranjpe (1970) concluded through his study on caste prejudice that social contacts between different castes were extremely limited and Dalits had a negative self-image whereas Brahmins had the most positive self-image. Later on an important study was conducted by Majeed and Ghosh (1989) on the groups of scheduled castes and found that they do indeed devalue their own group in the hierarchy of the caste system.
- In the area related to intergroup behavior and group tension Singh A.K. (1988) and De Ridder & Tripathi (1992) recognized the significance of group norms in intergroup behavior. In their opinion, norm violation by one group leads to a chain of negative reactions by both groups and, if this sequence continues, it is likely to escalate violent behavior.

- Another important area concerning terrorism and secessionism, Angomcha (1999) examined the role of relative deprivation and social identity in leading one towards terrorism and secessionism.

2. Social Motives and Development

In the post-independence period, another area popularized for undertaking research work was related to achievement motivation. The country was in great need of necessary progress and development and in this concern many of our scholars were agreed with McClelland (1961), the propagator of need achievement theory, that the low need for achievement is the root cause of India's under-development. In consequence, a small scale Industrial Training Institute was set up in Kakinada, Andhra Pradesh, where many Indian scholars collaborated with him to provide entrepreneurial training on the lines of McClelland's need achievement theory. However, side by side many of the socio-psychologists also began to question the applicability of this theory in Indian socio-cultural and economic context through their own research findings. In this way a somewhat mix trend working in opposition as well as in support was reflected among the research studies conducted in this area during the post-independence era. For illustration:

- J.B.P. Sinha (1968) demonstrated through his findings the non-applicability of need achievement theory in the scarce resource society of India. He found that under scarce resource condition, high need achievement creates an obstacle for the people in helping each other. Later on he along with J. Pandey (Sinha and Pandey, 1970), while comparing the two high need achievement groups, showed that in between these two, one of the selfish type tended to hoard resources more than the altruistic type.
- With a growing emphasis on understanding the meaning of achievement motivation under Indian cultural and economic conditions, Agrawal and Misra (1986) while making use of the eco-cultural and developmental perspective of his subjects of study, attempted to understand the meaning of

achievement in terms of the subject's notions about achievement goals.

- Side by side there were research studies in support of the use of n-ach theory in relation to the industrial development of the country. In this connection, a number of research projects were undertaken for exploring the need for achievement in the improvement of entrepreneurial activities (Sinha, 1969; Hundal, 1971; Hundal and Singh, 1975; Muthayya et al., 1979).

3. Social Influence Processes

The third important area of social psychology in which research studies were held in a significant way during the post-independence era is related with the social influence processes (the processes influencing the social behavior of the people). In this concern, Indian scholars were found to conduct research studies in a variety of social behavior such as helping and altruism, interpersonal attraction and interpersonal relationship, manipulative social behavior, leadership and its effectiveness, social power and control mechanism, etc. Let us discuss the research work done in these respective areas.

- (i) *Helping and Altruism*: The main studies in this aspect of social behavior may be exemplified as:
 - Pandey and Griffitt (1974, 1977) extended the idea that in the Indian context, dependency can be used as a social instrument to seek help and support.
 - Pandey et al. (1987) examined the developmental and social psychological determinants of pro-social behavior and demonstrated the impact of birth order, age and gender on children's helping behavior.
- (ii) *Interpersonal Attraction and Relationship*: The area of interpersonal attraction and relationship has also been an important area for the Indian scholars to conduct the social behavioral studies. In this connection, the contribution provided by the socio-psychologist R. Singh is especially mentionable. R. Singh, independently as well as with his companions (R. Singh, 1974; R. Singh,

1988; R. Singh et al., 1979), performed studies on the reinforcement-affect model of attraction leading him to formulate a research program to study judgment and decision making within the framework of Anderson's information integration theory. In these studies, put up in the category of programmatic research, use of mathematical models was made to structure judgments and decisions. In this way, the attempts on the part of R. Singh along with his companions, started a new trend of using mathematical modelling in behavioral and social sciences research which was clearly reflected through the research paper presented and discussion held in the National Seminar in May 2002 in the Department of Psychology at Allahabad University.

(iii) *Leadership and Its Effectiveness*: The mentionable research work in this field at the hands of Indian scholars may be said to be coming from the mid-1950s. However, the studies done in this connection at the earlier two or three decades were dominated with the use of western framework and available models for study. Later on, Indian scholars began to be innovative in respect of caring for the Indian values and proposing of new models more suitable to the Indian conditions. In this connection, Sinha (1980,1994) proposed a model named "NT (Nurturant Task) model of leadership" showing that effective leadership in India is personalized and is centered on *Shradha* (deference) for the leader by the subordinates and nurturance and *Sneh* (affection) for the subordinate on the part of the leader.

(iv) *Social Power and Control Mechanism*: The social behavior of the people in a society is also very much influenced through the social power and control mechanism. The mentionable research work done in this field during the post-independence era may be briefed as follows.

- McClelland (1975), while analyzing social power within the Indian cultural framework, found that Indians are high on need for power and those in power tend to control others by giving more and thereby demanding more from their subordinates.

- Kakar (1974), through his research work on authority and power in the Indian context, concluded that (i) the image of the superior was either nurturant or assertive, but preference was for the nurturant superior, and (ii) the functioning style of the superior depends upon the personality dynamism, stage of life, and the ideals of the group from which the subordinate derives his sense of identity. In this connection Sinha (1981) further suggested that such relationships (between superior and subordinates) are jointly determined by the power need of the executives and the hierarchical structure.
- Sinha and Singh-Sengupta (1991), while researching on power strategies, identified strategies that are applicable in the Indian social context with an indication of the applicability of one or the other types of strategies in one or the other conditions.

4. Poverty, Deprivation and Social Justice

It constitutes a quite important area for the researchers in social psychology because of its occupying an immense importance in the poverty ridden population of a vast section of the Indian society needing social justice for the faced deprivation. Besides this, a lot of research work is also needed to seek a follow-up in the planning and implementations of projects and schemes launched for dealing with the situation. The mentionable studies performed by the Indian scholars in this field may be highlighted as follows.

- Dandekar and Rath (1971) conducted an important and first exhaustive study on poverty and found that 40% of rural and 50% of urban populations was below the poverty line.
- A few years later, a useful study related to the prolonged deprivation was conducted by Tripathi and Misra (1975). It is known for its leading to significant changes in the measurement of deprivation in real-life conditions. In this concern, they are known to identify 15 aspects of a person's natural environment in which lack of experience results in prolonged deprivation.

- In the later years, inclusion of poverty as a political agenda on the part of the Indian government and liberal funding of the research projects on this account, a number of research studies were undertaken by the Indian scholars during the 1980s and '90s to investigate poverty and to examine the socio-psychological development and educational processes related to it (Misra and Tripathi, 2004). In this concern, a special mention can be made for the research work carried out by Pandey and his associates (Pandey, 2000) emphasizing that instead of using only objective criteria (macro level social and economic processes) an integrated approach involving both the objective and subjective criterion should be employed to study the poverty of Indian masses.
- Research on the issue of providing social justice to the poverty ridden and other deprived section of the society also got started in the 1980s and then picked up its speed in the 1990s with its focus on distributive justice. The mentionable studies conducted in this concern are briefed next.
 - In the 1980s, there were two cross-cultural studies, one conducted by Murphy-Berman et al. (1984) and the other by Berman et al. (1985) comparing US and Indian subjects. The findings of these studies suggested that Indians preferred allocating more funds on the basis of need rule than Americans.
 - Pandey and Singh (1997), on the basis of their so many consecutive studies, tried to conclude that importance of merit or need was dependent on the context of allocation.
 - Krishnan (2000), while conducting a research study on distributive justice in reward allocation in Indian context, demonstrated that people show individual and cultural variations in considering what is fair to them.

5. Environment and Behavior

The research work for knowing about various things related to the environment-behavior interaction and relationship also carries an immense importance in the field of social psychology. The attempts for moving

ahead in this direction were however not made well before the 1980s in our country. Afterwards some of the mentionable work done in this concern is briefed next.

- Jain (1987) conducted a quite useful research work on the phenomenon of crowding and its impact on social behavior. Later on, he got published the findings of his studies in the form of a book.
- At Allahabad, in the same duration and afterward a number of studies were conducted by Nagar and Pandey (1987) and Ruback and Pandey (1991) with an objective of exploring the environment-cognition-behavior relationship.
- At the same time, at Pune University, the socio-psychologists Lepore et al. (1991) conducted an important research program on crowding, daily hassles and coping.
- As a matter of studying the effect of disaster (nature or man-made) on the social behavior and well-being of the people, Misra (1990) conducted a series of studies focused on the famous Bhopal gas tragedy.
- In the same tune, Siddiqui and Pandey (2003) conducted a useful study for highlighting the role of environmental stressor on the health of the people.

5. Social Values and Development

A society essentially needs to pay attention on the values inherent in its social fabric and culture for attaining the development of its own in a desired direction. Actually there exists a close link between social values and the process of development. However, attempts for doing necessary research work in this direction were not given any heed until the early 1970s. Some of the mentionable work done onwards is summarized here.

- J.B.P. Sinha and his associates (Sinha and Sinha, 1974) while performing a systematic study of middle-class values of the Indian people identified a set of values helpful in the development of the country.
- D. Sinha and Kao (1988) in their investigation, while focusing on the relationship of Hindu

religion with personality and behavioral patterns and their association with economic development, tried to show a close link between social values and the process of development.

- D. Sinha (1988), through his research work, identified values that may be regarded as functional and, on its opposite, dysfunctional for national development.
- Tripathi (1988), through the findings of his research studies, suggested to align social values to development and urged the need to increase the capacities of developing societies by focusing on their own culture-specific values.
- Verma (1992) while performing research on individualism and collectivism identified collectivism as a dominant Indian orientation and examined its relationship within the developmental process. On its basis he urged people to make use of some or the other aspects of collectivism such as in-group solidarity for effective work behavior and development.

Concluding Remarks

In this way, the development of social psychology in India as a subject of study and research followed the similar pattern as followed on the part of the western countries for its progress and development. Its study and use in practical form initially took place through the philosophical ideas at the hands of great philosophers and religious people. The charge of its study and application then took up by the

sociologists and psychologists in their own ways giving birth to two distinct forms of social psychologies – sociology-oriented and psychological-oriented social psychology. After a long struggle then, social psychology became capable of establishing itself as a full-fledged discipline adopting survey method of sociology and experimental method of psychology for carrying out its research studies.

The early researches in India in the field of social psychology were found to adopt a similar pattern of substantiating the work of a western researcher by one's own research. However, as things moved on, the well conscious Indian scholars tried to break away from the apron string of the west. In this concern, they also started to give call for the indigenization-process of making discipline appropriate/suited to the socio-cultural soil of the country (D. Sinha, 1994, 1997).

Subsequently, there has been a lot of good research work in the field of social psychology for providing sizable support to the planning and developmental project for the uplift of the people and progress of the country. However, both on theoretical and practical fronts more, in a quite substantial way, needs to be done. The research work going on in the universities and higher institutions requires a fresh look for making it more original, creative and applied. It should directly concern the problems of one or the other kinds facing the Indian society and development of the nation. It should try to provide their solution within the framework of our socio-cultural conditions, national resources and future planning for the necessary progress and development of our country.

To Sum Up

Regarding the development of social psychology, after gaining independence, we may see that the trend of adopting survey and experimental methods in the conduct of research work was continued well in Indian universities after gaining independence. However, there was much inclination towards the use of experimental method and applicability of western theories in the '60s and '70s for the researches in social psychology in the Indian universities as a number of Indian socio-psychologists returned from the western countries after their training in such type of research work. But, in the subsequent years there happened a little enthusiasm for the use of experimental method and applicability of western theories in the studies of social psychology as these theories were failing to provide solutions for the social problems of our country. The development of social psychology picked up a great push with the establishment and functioning of Indian Council of Social Science Research (ICSSR) in 1969 in the form of support received for research, training and publications in social psychology.

The other great pushes in the development of social psychology emerged on account of the starting publication of the review articles for socio-psychological researches from the year 1994 onwards and beginning of MPhil and doctoral programs with course work in the discipline among the Indian universities and higher institutions (including IITs) from the 1970s onwards.

As an outcome of the happening of all these things, there has been a lot of gradual progress and development in all the important areas, fields and issues related to the subject social psychology named as Attitude, Prejudice and Intergroup Relations; Social Motives and Development; Social Influence Processes; Poverty, Deprivation and Social Justice; Environment and Behavior; and Social Values and Development. Besides adopting a similar pattern of substantiating the work of a western researcher by one's own research, there has also been a good quality work as opined by resorting to the indigenization-process of making discipline appropriate/suited to the socio-cultural soil of the country, for providing the sizable support to the planning and developmental project to the uplift of the people and progress of the country. However, both on theoretical and practical fronts more, in a quite substantial way, needs to be done in this respect in our country.

Table 2.1 International Social Psychology Journals

<i>Year of First Publication</i>	<i>Name of the Journal</i>	<i>Frequency of Publication</i>	<i>The Present Publisher/Sponsor or Collaborator</i>
1929	<i>The Journal of Social Psychology</i>	Bimonthly	Routledge, U.K.
1937	<i>Social Psychology Quarterly</i>	Quarterly	Sage Publication on behalf of American Sociological Association
1962	<i>British Journal of Social Psychology</i> Formerly called <i>British Journal of Social and Clinical Psychology</i>	Quarterly	Wiley-Blackwell on behalf of British Psychological Society, U.K.
1965	<i>Journal of Experimental Psychology</i>	Bimonthly	Elsevier, New York on behalf of the Society of Experimental Psychology
1965	<i>Journal of Personality and Social Psychology</i>	Monthly	American Psychological Association, USA
1970	<i>Social Psychology</i>	Bimonthly	Hogrefe Publishing
1971	<i>Journal of Applied Social Psychology</i>	Monthly	Wiley-Blackwell
1971	<i>European Journal of Social Psychology</i>	Monthly	John Wiley & Sons on behalf of European Association of Social Psychology
1974	<i>Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin</i>	Monthly	Sage Publication
1980	<i>Basic and Applied Social Psychology</i>	Bimonthly	Lawrence Erlbaum Associates, USA
1982	<i>Social Cognition (Journal)</i>	Bimonthly	Guilford Press USA
1990	<i>European Review of Social Psychology</i>	Annually	Psychological Press, Taylor and Francis
1991	<i>Journal of Community and Applied Social Psychology</i>	Bimonthly	Wiley-Blackwell on behalf of the British Psychological Society
1995	<i>Asian Journal of Social Psychology</i>	Monthly	Wiley-Blackwell in conjunction with Asian Association of Social Psychology and Japanese Groups Dynamics Association
1997	<i>Personality and Social Psychology Review</i>	Monthly	Sage Publication
2010	<i>Social Psychology and Personality Science</i>	Eight in a year	Sage Publication

Social Psychology Electronic Journals

1. **Asian Journal of Social Psychology**, Wiley Online Library, Published on behalf of the Asian Association of Social Psychology and Japanese Groups Dynamics Association.
2. **British Journal of Social Psychology**, Wiley Online Library, Published on behalf of British Psychological Society.
3. **Current Research in Social Psychology**, the University of IOWA.
4. **Journal of Applied Social Psychology**, Wiley Online Library, Published on behalf of British Psychological Society.
5. **The Journal of Community and Applied Social Psychology**, Wiley Online Library, Published on behalf of British Psychological Society.
6. **Journal of Personality and Social Psychology**, American Psychological Association, USA.

Social Psychology Associations

1. **Asian Association of Social Psychology (AASP)** was formed in 1995. Its headquarter is at Corner High Road and Willeri Drive, Riverton WA6148, Australia. Its official publication is a research journal named *Asian Journal of Social Psychology*.
2. **European Association of Social Psychology (EASP)**, formerly The European Association of Experimental Social Psychology (EAESP), was founded in 1966. It is bringing out five publications regularly named: (i) *European Journal of Social Psychology*, (ii) *European Review of Social Psychology*, (iii) *European Bulletin of Social Psychology*, (iv) *European Monographs in Social Psychology* and (v) *Social Psychology and Personality Science*.
3. **Society of Experimental Social Psychology (SESP)** was founded in 1965 at Chicago. Its official journals are (i) *The Journal of Experimental Social Psychology* and (ii) *Social Psychological and Personality Science*.
4. **Society of Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP)** was founded in 1974. Its headquarter is at Washington, D.C., USA. Its official journal is the *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*.

Review Questions

1. Talk in detail about the origin and birth of the subject social psychology.
2. Throw light on the development and progress of social psychology right from its birth to the present 21st century.
3. Discuss the progress and development of social psychology occurring in the different time periods such as (i) 1895–1945, (ii) 1946–1970 and (iii) 1971 onwards.
4. How has the development and progress in social psychology taken its place in our country? Discuss.
5. Throw light on the progress and development of social psychology (i) in ancient India, (ii) In British India and (iii) after getting independence.
6. What are the various social psychology journals published worldwide in the printed as well as electronic form? Tell about them.
7. Name and give information on various social psychology associations existing worldwide.

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3.

RELATIONSHIP OF SOCIAL PSYCHOLOGY WITH OTHER SOCIAL SCIENCES AND RELATED BRANCHES OF PSYCHOLOGY

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- Throw light on the relationship of social psychology with general psychology.
- Tell about the relationship of social psychology with personality psychology.
- Discuss the relationship of social psychology with environmental psychology.
- Elucidate the relationship of social psychology with cultural psychology.
- Explain the relationship of social psychology with evolutionary psychology.
- Tell how social psychology is related to sociology.
- Give an account about the relationship of social psychology with anthropology.
- Mention how social psychology is related to economics.
- Write about the relationship of social psychology with social neuroscience.

Introduction

Social psychology owes its existence to two of the major disciplines and fields of social sciences, sociology and psychology. It may be seen to have a considerable relationship not only with its parent subjects sociology and psychology but also with the other important sociology-oriented or related social sciences (socio-psychological in nature) as well as with the related branches of psychology (psycho-social in their application). Where in the former category, we may essentially include the disciplines and study of the subjects like anthropology, and socio-neuroscience, in the latter, the disciplines and subjects of the study like personality psychology, environmental psychology, cultural psychology and evolutionary psychology may be properly included. Let

us try to discuss the relationship of social psychology with its parent subjects, psychology and sociology and all other aforementioned sub-disciplines and subjects of the study. For this purpose, let us first start with the discussion of the relationship between social psychology and psychology as a full fleshed subject termed as general psychology.

Relationship of Social Psychology With General Psychology

General psychology as a term refers to a subject of study in which all the essential aspects and issues related to the entire full fleshed subject and discipline of psychology (referred to as a science of behavior) are studied in a generalized way. It helps us to study the behavior

of the people in the different setup or environment in which they behave – live and work. In this way, in general, the subject matter included in the study of general psychology provides a necessary base for the study and understanding of the behavior (conative, cognitive and affective) of the people as individuals or as members of the groups. Its knowledge may help the individuals to go for the proper study of the sub-disciplines or branches of psychology such as educational psychology, sports psychology, social psychology, industrial psychology, abnormal psychology, clinical psychology, personality psychology, cultural psychology, environmental psychology, evolutionary psychology, etc. The individuals, after obtaining a degree in general psychology, do advanced post-graduate courses in these special branches of the subject psychology.

Social psychology as a specialized branch of the discipline psychology shows a remarkable resemblance with the subject general psychology in the manner as follows.

Similarities Between Social Psychology and General Psychology

- Social psychology and general psychology both aim to study the behavior of the individuals in all its aspects – internal and external; conscious or unconscious; and conative, cognitive and affective.
- Both aim to provide scientific study of the behavior to be studied in one or the other situations.
- The methods and techniques used for the study of the behavior are almost the same. Both make use of the methods of systematic observation and experimentation and provide emphasis on the objectivity, reliability and validity of their research findings.

However, depending on their specificity both differ in relations to some aspects like below.

Dissimilarities Between Social Psychology and General Psychology

- Social psychology is specifically social in nature. It aims to study the behavior of the individuals in social situations. The study of the behavior

in general psychology is not so specifically confined and limited. Here we can study the behavior of the people in the varied situations and circumstances of their life-personal, social and professional. In this way, where general psychology is found to have a wider scope, social psychology is limited and confined in its scope of studying behavior of people in terms of their interactions and relationships in the society (Krech et al., 1962).

- Social psychologists in their study of social behavior of the people may be found to make liberal use of the theories and findings of anthropology and sociology. The psychologists in their studies related to general psychology rarely engage in such practices.
- In general psychology, the psychologists while doing their study or investigation into behavior, try to take the individual as the unit of their study. The social psychologists, on the other hand, make the interaction among individuals and groups as the unit of studying behavior in their investigations.

To Sum Up

General psychology is a subject of study in which all the essential aspects and issues related to the entire full fleshed subject and discipline of psychology are studied in a generalized way. Its knowledge may help us to go for the proper study of the various sub-disciplines or branches of psychology including social psychology. In this way, social psychology, as a specialized branch of the discipline psychology, shows a remarkable resemblance with the subject general psychology as both in the capacity of scientific disciplines aim to study the behavior of the individuals in all its aspects. However, both differ in the matter of their scope of the study and methods of studying the behavior.

While in general psychology we can study the behavior of the people in the varied

situations and circumstances of their life – personal, social and professional, social psychology is limited and confined to the study of the behavior of people in terms of their interactions and relationships in the society. In the matter of the way of studying the behavior while social psychology on account of its closeness to sociology and anthropology may be found to make liberal use of the methodology, theories and findings of these two subjects, psychologists in their studies related to general psychology rarely engage in such practices.

Relationship of Social Psychology With Personality Psychology

Social psychology and personality psychology both represent the branches of the subject or discipline of psychology and thus aim to study the behavior and mental processes of the individuals in their specific ways. In personality psychology, we try to study the personality variables of the human behavior such as their traits, attitudes and goals representing the forces lying with the individual to make them behave in a certain specific way. In social psychology, on the other hand, we try to focus on studying the human behavior in a social context or situation (the forces lying outside the individual in his social surroundings) under which one is found to behave and demonstrate the uniqueness of his personality. In this way, both these branches of psychology designated as social psychology and personality psychology are tightly interwoven in providing psychological explanation of human behavior by unravelling the mysteries of individual and social life in some significant ways. It is why the American Psychological Association (APA) has tempted to include the research articles and essays belonging to both these branches of psychology in the same journals publishing through the titles (i) *Personality and Social Psychology* and (ii) *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*. However, despite so, these two

branches are found to exhibit dissimilarities in the manner as follows.

- Although personality psychology and social psychology both study behavior at the individual and social levels, they are found to study them from two opposite perspectives. In the case of personality psychology, it is found to focus upon intrapersonal factors for this purpose; social psychology on the other hand, mainly focuses upon interpersonal factors i.e., social interaction and relationships, etc.
- Where personality psychology is the study of the development of personality and individual traits, social psychology is the study of the social behavior reflected through the unique personality of the individuals.
- Where personality psychologists look at people as individuals rather than as members of the society, social psychologists, on the other hand, prefer to study the people as members of the society rather than the individual units.
- While the aim of personality psychology is to find out why people differ from each other in terms of their personality traits, attitudes and beliefs, etc., the aim of social psychology, on the other hand, is to study the social behavior of the individuals reflecting their common attitudes, beliefs, interactions and relationships with each other instead of their individual personalities.
- While personality psychology gives emphasis on the study of the individualities and internal functioning of the people, social psychology bears a social character by laying emphasis on the study of the individuals as they influence or get influenced by the presence of others in the society.
- Social psychology is the newly emerged and developed discipline in comparison to the personality psychology which is known to have longer historical past than the subject social psychology.

To Sum Up

About the relationship existing between social psychology and personality psychology, we can say that both are near to each other as both, in the capacity of the branches of the discipline psychology, aim to study the behavior and mental processes of the individuals. However, both differ in the sense of doing this task in their own specific ways. In personality psychology, we try to study the personality variables of the human behavior such as their traits, attitudes and goals representing the forces lying with the individual to make them behave in a certain specific way. In social psychology, on the other hand, we try to focus on studying the human behavior in social context or situation (the forces lying outside the individual in his social surroundings) under which one is found to behave and demonstrate the uniqueness of his personality. In this way, while the aim of personality psychology is to find out why people differ from each other in terms of their personality traits, attitudes and beliefs, etc., the aim of social psychology, on the other hand is to study the social behavior of the individuals reflecting their common attitudes, beliefs, interactions and relationships with each other instead of their individual personalities.

Relationship of Social Psychology With Environmental Psychology

Environmental psychology, as a branch of the discipline psychology, represents the study of what is transacted between individuals and their environment (broadly encompassing natural environments, social and cultural settings, built environments, learning environments and informational environments). For a formal definition of the term environmental psychology, we can turn to the one circulated by the *International Journal of Environmental Psychology* in the following words.

Environmental Psychology is the scientific study of the transactions and interrelationships between people and their physical surroundings (including built and natural environments, the use and abuse of nature and natural resources, and sustainability-related behavior).

As a discipline, thus, environmental psychology focuses upon the interplay between individuals and their surroundings. Its study helps us to understand how the environment around us cast its impact over our behavior and living and how as individuals our behavior and actions become instrumental in changing the environment for better or worse. However, equipped with its theory, research and practice, environmental psychology is generally aimed to have a needed interplay between individuals and their environment with a clear focus on improving and bettering their existing interrelationship.

Owning their belongingness to its parent discipline psychology, both environmental psychology and social psychology have a lot of similarities in their nature and functioning such as follows.

Similarities Between Environmental Psychology and Social Psychology

- Both are the branches and sub-disciplines of the subject and discipline psychology.
- Both represent the interdisciplinary fields that focus on the interplay between individuals and their surroundings.
- The study of both the fields employs the similar methodology emphasizing much on the use of scientific method.
- The study of both the sub-disciplines helps us to understand the interplay between us and our environment along with its outcomes. Through their study, we can know how we affect and influence our environment and are influenced and affected through it and as such can be better prepared to improve our relationship with our surroundings or environment.

Despite the resemblance and similarities cited earlier between the environmental psychology and social psychology, both differ from each other in some aspects such as follows.

Dissimilarities Between Environmental Psychology and Social Psychology

- The surroundings or environments that are being focused for studying their interplay with the individuals in both these branches of psychology are different. While in social psychology it is absolutely limited and confined to the social surroundings, in environmental psychology its scope is too wide covering natural, man-made surroundings, social and cultural environments and learning and information related environments.
- The main as well the only aim of the study and research work carried out by the environmental psychologists is to modify and improve the thinking, feelings and actions of the people for keeping their environmental surroundings as healthy as possible and take full advantage of the improved environmental conditions for their better living. On the other hand, the main aim of the study and research work carried out by social psychologists is to study the social behavior of the people and take care of their social environment for their better social living and relationships with others.

surroundings, in environmental psychology its scope is too wide covering natural, man-made surroundings, social and cultural environments as well as the learning and information related environments.

Relationship of Social Psychology With Cultural Psychology

Cultural psychology is that branch of the discipline psychology which is associated with the study of how cultures of the societies reflect and shape the psychological processes of their members. Here we study the behavior of the people and their mental processes under the context of the culture of their society. The renowned author Richard Shweder (1991) in his book *Thinking Through Cultures* has defined the term cultural psychology as “the study of the way cultural traditions and social practices regulate, express, and transform the human psyche, resulting less in psychic unity for humankind than in ethnic divergence in mind, self, and emotion.” The main tenet of cultural psychology, according to Fiske et al. (1998), is that mind and cultures are inseparable and mutually constitutive, meaning that people are shaped by their culture and their culture is also shaped by them.

Cultural psychology is found to demonstrate a lot of similarities as well dissimilarities with social psychology. Let us discuss.

Similarities Between Social Psychology and Cultural Psychology

- Both represent the branches or sub-disciplines of the subject and discipline psychology helpful in providing scientific study of one or the other aspects of human behavior.
- It can be easily seen that the cultural aspects of the behavior of the people studied in cultural psychology and social aspects of the behavior of the people studied in social psychology both belong to the same society whose culture and social aspects are hereby, respectively, working as the subject of studies.

To Sum Up

Regarding the relationship existing between social psychology and environmental psychology we can say that both in the capacity of the important branches of the subject psychology help us to understand how the environment around us cast its impact over our behavior and living and how as individuals our behavior and actions become instrumental in changing the environment for better or worse. However, both of them differ with each other in relation to the nature of the task performed. While the surroundings or environments that are being focused for studying their interplay with the individuals in social psychology are absolutely limited and confined to the social

- The methods and techniques used for studying the behavior of the people as well as institutions-cultural or social are the same.
- The pattern and norms of behavior prevalent in the society studied by the researchers of both the sub-disciplines help the individuals in their living and behaving in a proper way.

Dissimilarities Between Social Psychology and Cultural Psychology

- Culture of a society as a term is defined as the mode of living and behaving of its members perpetuating and functioning in a society from centuries onwards. In cultural psychology, we focus on studying the behavior of the people in reference to this available aspect of the culture of a society. The cultural aspect of the human behavior is, thus, the focus of study in cultural psychology. In social psychology, on the other hand, we study the social behavior of the people – their interactions and relationships existing in a society at one or the other time.
- Cultural behavior of the people is just a small part of their overall social behavior, and, hence, the scope of study in social psychology is quite wide and comprehensive in comparison to cultural psychology. As a result, where cultural psychologists try to limit their investigations in finding out how cultural practices prevalent in a society shape psychological process of the individuals or vice versa, social psychologists go a step further not only to do it for the cultural practices but also for the entire pattern and episodes of the social behavior of the members of a society.
- Cultural psychologists usually engage themselves in comparing thought patterns and behaviors within and across the cultures of the society to draw a cross-cultural image. It is found to clash with the universal perspective and pattern of the social behavior common across all of humanity studied and emphasized in the sub-discipline social psychology.

To Sum Up

About the relationship existing between social psychology and cultural psychology we can say that both are near to each other as they represent the branches of the discipline psychology and aim to study the behavior and mental processes of the individuals. The cultural aspects of the behavior of the people studied in cultural psychology and social aspects of the behavior of the people studied in social psychology both belong to the same society. However, since cultural behavior of the people is just a small part of their overall social behavior, thereby we may see that the scope of study in social psychology is quite wide and comprehensive in comparison to cultural psychology.

Relationship of Social Psychology With Evolutionary Psychology

Evolutionary psychology is that branch of the discipline psychology in which we try to study the behavior and mental processes of the people in context of evolutionary perspective. The evolutionary perspective tries to convey that many of our thoughts, feelings and actions are caused, in part, by biological mechanisms that have been shaped by thousands of generations of evolution. Accordingly, what the people inherit and adopt through their evolutionary input, thus, works in a great way to provide direction and magnitude for the development and expression of their behavior in one or the other social situations. Its knowledge and input are found to help social psychologists in studying the social behavior and psychological processes of the people through the lens of evolutionary perspective. Evolutionary psychology and social psychology thus may be seen to have a lot of similarity and resemblance in the manner as briefed next.

Similarities Between Evolutionary Psychology and Social Psychology

- Both are the branches or sub-disciplines of the subject and discipline psychology.
- The methods and techniques for carrying out experimentation, observation, content analysis, archival and field study are the same in both the branches.
- There stands a reciprocal relationship in carrying out study and understanding of one subject with the help of the principles and knowledge derived in the other. For example, for the understanding and study of a number of socio-psychological concepts and topics covering a wide range from romantic relationships, friendships and altruism to apathy, violence and prejudice, the principles of evolutionary psychology provide a deeper understandable base. Similarly, we can be helped much in studying, researching and knowing about the subject evolutionary psychology through the principles, theories and understanding of the subject social psychology.
- Evolutionary psychology much like the social psychology also has an interactionist perspective, in recognizing that thoughts, feelings and behaviors among the human beings emerge as a function of variables inside the person and the situation. Thus, an evolutionary perspective is not meant to replace traditional social psychological perspective.

Apart from the similarities and resemblance cited earlier as existing between evolutionary psychology and social psychology, there are a number of dissimilarities existing between them as briefed next.

Dissimilarities Between Evolutionary Psychology and Social Psychology

- Evolutionary psychology is more ancient and primitive than social psychology.
- While assumptions of the evolutionary psychology are rooted in the biological sciences, the basic assumptions in social psychology lie in social sciences.

- While evolutionary psychology relying on the evolutionary perspective asserts that the study of the behavior and mental processes of the individuals can be properly made through the underlying biological process shaped by a long history of evolutionary forces in ancestral environments, the social psychology considers one's individuality and social environment as the basic instrumental forces for shaping the behavior and mental processes of the individuals.
- Evolutionary psychology is much wider and comprehensive in its study as well applications than social psychology. In the form of evolutionary social psychology, it has produced a wealth of discoveries, ranging from adaptations for altruism to the dark sides of social conflict.

To Sum Up

Evolutionary psychology and social psychology both represent the branches of the discipline psychology, and there stands a reciprocal relationship between them in carrying out study and understanding of the concept and topics in one subject with the help of the principles, theories and knowledge derived in the other. However, they differ from each other particularly in the sense that where evolutionary psychology emphasizes studying the behavior and mental processes of the individuals through the underlying biological process instrumentalized by evolutionary mechanism, the social psychology considers one's individuality and social environment as the basic instrumental forces for shaping the behavior and mental processes of the individuals.

Relationship of Social Psychology With Sociology

Sociology as a discipline belonging to the social sciences may be defined as a field of study helpful in our knowing how social and cultural forces influence our

pattern of living and behaving. In its study, it tries to focus on how groups, organizations, social categories and societies are organized; how they function; and how they change with time. Social psychology (the scientific study of human social behavior and psychological processes) owing its emergence both from the disciplines sociology and psychology has much in common with its parent discipline sociology. Let us look into such similarities.

Similarities Between Social Psychology and Sociology

- The facts such as (i) a significant number of social psychologists have been and are sociologists, and (ii) very often many sociologists and socio-psychologists share the same training and publish in the same journals, (i.e., *The Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*) are certainly enough to reveal the nearness and deep association existing between these two disciplines.
- Sociology in its various forms and shapes such as micro-sociology, physiological sociology, sociological sociology, etc. is closely related to social psychology (Delamater, 2003).
- Both of them while joining hands are seen to help our complete understanding of one or the other important issues related to our social life. For example, interdisciplinary research on stereotyping and prejudice has examined dynamic roles of both societal and immediate factors, such as how particular social systems or institutional norms and beliefs affect individual's attitudes and behavior (Eagly and Wood, 2012).
- Sociology is the scientific study of human society, and social psychology is the scientific study of the individuals functioning in that society. Since the individuals and society cannot exist and subsist without each other, the sciences of making their study are bound to remain interrelated and interdependent. Their interdependence gets also firmly established when we witness that both social psychologists and sociologists tend to share an interest in studying how people behave in groups (Myers, 2005).

Apart from the aforementioned similarities and resemblance there also exists a number of differences and dissimilarities between evolutionary psychology and social psychology. We may brief them as follows.

Dissimilarities Between Social Psychology and Sociology

- Where sociology is designated as a full fleshed discipline in the realm of social sciences, social psychology as the derivative of both the disciplines sociology and psychology represents an applied branch of a scientifically studied discipline psychology.
- In the subject sociology, the unit of analysis (i.e., the focus of research and study) is the group as a whole rather than the individual people comprising the group. In contrast, in social psychology, the unit of analysis and study is the individual people comprising the group.
- Although the researchers in both the subject sociology and social psychology make use of similar research methods, they differ in terms of their preferred research methodologies. Socio-psychologists rely heavily on laboratory experiment methodology in which they try to manipulate variables such as the presence or absence of the people in order to examine its effect upon their performance level. Sociologists typically study existing social groups and institutions for knowing about their characteristics by making use of the field survey, observation, case study and archival or content analysis methods.
- The field of study and scope of the study in both the subjects differ distinctively from each other. Social psychology aims to study the behavior of people functioning in social situations, their mutual interactions, relationships and outcomes arrived through such interactions. Sociology, as the scientific study of human society, mainly focuses on the study of the social institutions, class structures, traditions and culture prevailing in the society. Therefore, sociologists in their research work are more interested in a variety of demographic, social and cultural phenomena.

To Sum Up

Social psychology owing its emergence both from the disciplines sociology and psychology has much in common with its parent discipline sociology. Sociology as a discipline belonging to the social sciences provides a scientific study of human society, and its offshoot, social psychology, is helpful in the scientific study of the individuals functioning in that society. Since the individuals and society cannot exist and subsist without each other the sciences of making their study are bound to remain interrelated and interdependent. However, they differ from each other in respect of what they study and the focal point of their study. In this respect, while social psychology aims to study the behavior of people functioning in social situations, their mutual interactions, relationships and outcomes arrived through such interactions, sociology mainly focuses on the study of the social institutions, class structures, traditions and culture prevailing in the society. Moreover, where in the subject sociology, the focus of research and study is the group as a whole rather than the individual people comprising the group, in social psychology, the unit of analysis and study is the individual people comprising the group.

Relationship of Social Psychology With Anthropology

Anthropology is the study of human societies and cultures and their development. It is known to have a broader approach to social phenomenon, concentrating on culture, with minor emphasis on the individual. It studies the patterns of cultures in various parts of the world, particularly among primitive, pre-literate and pre-urban people. In fact, thus, it presents the study of the past and present cultures, particularly in relationship to how cultural features influence human behavior. In the study of anthropology, the focus, in general, lies on shared values,

beliefs and practices of a group of people, which are passed down from one generation to the others.

Social psychology concerned with study of the behavior of the individuals in relation to what is available in the society in terms of social and cultural practices demonstrates a lot of similarities and resemblance with the discipline of anthropology. Let us see how.

Similarities Between Social Psychology and Anthropology

- Both of them have much in common in carrying out their studies in relation to the societies and cultures of the people studied. For instance, anthropologists often compare features of different societies (e.g., their customs and institutions) to understand a particular outcome (e.g., divorce rates or life expectancy). Social psychologists are also found to be interested in the study of similar outcomes.
- Both of them have a strong base for complementing each other. While the knowledge and understanding provided by the study of social psychology helps an anthropologist in understanding the root causes of human behavior in different societies and cultures, the information supplied through the anthropological studies helps the socio-psychologists in knowing about the influence of differing social and cultural environments on human behavior. In this way, where socio-psychologists have helped anthropologists in solving a number of problems related to anthropology such as those of superstitions, stereotypes, beliefs, taboos, etc., socio-psychologists are also thankful for getting help from the factual data available for their studies from the anthropologists. By studying different primitive cultures, anthropologists have shown how human behavior differs in different cultural environments.
- On a broader note, both anthropology and social psychology deal with social interactions and their effects. Here while the former makes its use in studying the cultural pattern prevailing in a society, the latter makes its use in interpreting the nature of human behavior and

personality of the individuals belonging to that society.

Despite, such similarities and resemblance visible in social psychology and anthropology, both differ on a variety of accounts discussed next.

Dissimilarities Between Social Psychology and Anthropology

- Anthropology as a distinguished field of social sciences tries to study the pattern of cultures in various society and civilizations of the world. Social psychology as a branch of psychology studies the social behavior of the people belonging to a society in *toto* involving completely their social and cultural mode of living and behaving in that society.
- Social psychology in its attempt to study the social behavior of people is set to study the interaction among the individuals, society and the culture of the society rather than any three of these alone. In contrast, anthropology focuses mainly on the study of the cultures of the societies.
- The methods and approaches adopted by the social psychologists and anthropologists in carrying out their investigations differ a lot from each other. In terms of use of methods where socio-psychologists prefer to make use of the laboratory experimental method, anthropologists usually carry out their investigation through the use of methods like naturalistic observation, and the analysis of the existing records and materials. Similarly, in terms of the use of theoretical approaches, while socio-psychologists make use of individual approach for their investigation, anthropologists are found to employ cultural approach for this purpose.
- The laws and principles discovered in social psychology for the explanation of social behavior carry a significant predictive value meaning thereby that with the help of them not only the present social behavior of the people but also the future one can be meaningfully explained. The study made in the field of anthropology, on

the other hand, tries to look into the past of the cultures and social structures of the societies while having little predictive value and suggestions at its hand for the future.

- The approach adopted by the social psychologists in their study and research is both practical and academic. The knowledge derived through their efforts in social psychology can be properly used in solving the issues of our practical life along with proving its academic worth as a subject of the study. On the other hand, the approach adopted by the anthropologists is largely academic, and it makes little contribution in solving the problems of practical life.

To Sum Up

Social psychology concerned with the study of the behavior of the individuals in relation to the social and cultural practices of their society is found to demonstrate a lot of similarities and resemblance with the discipline of anthropology – the study of human societies and cultures and their development. That is why both of them have a strong base for complementing each other. While the study of social psychology helps an anthropologist in understanding the root causes of human behavior in different societies and cultures, the information supplied through the anthropological studies helps the socio-psychologists in knowing about the influence of differing social and cultural environments on human behavior. However, they differ from each other mainly in the matter related to the what and how of their study. While social psychology is set to study the interaction among the individuals, society and the culture of the society rather than any three of these alone, anthropology focuses mainly on the study of the cultures of the societies. In terms of use of methods, while socio-psychologists make use of individual approach for their investigation, anthropologists are found to employ cultural approach for this purpose.

Relationship of Social Psychology With Economics

Economics as an important discipline and field of social science has a quite unique place in our social life. It is concerned with the study of how people allocate scarce resources for production, distribution and consumption, both individually and collectively.

Economics focuses on the actions of human beings, based on assumptions that humans act with rational behavior, seeking the most optimal level of benefit or utility. On an individual and personal level, it teaches us to spend wisely and acquire economical resources earnestly. On the wider scale, from the sociological angle, the building blocks of economics are the studies of labor and trade. Since there are many possible applications of human labor and many different ways to acquire resources, it is the task of economics to determine which methods yield the best results.

Two major types of economics are *microeconomics*, which focuses on the behavior of individual consumers and producers, and *macroeconomics*, which examines overall economies on a regional, national or international scale. A third major form of economics in the name *behavioral economics* has been also generated from the last few years with the aim of seeking an application of behavioral sciences especially psychology in the field of economics. Subsequently, it has become increasingly popular. It tries to convey that people's economic decisions are often less guided by stable preferences, rational analysis and selfish motives than by (often highly contextual) cognitive, emotional and social influences guided by the principles of social psychology. In this capacity, economics has come in a quite close relationship with the discipline of social psychology – the science of social behavior of the human beings. Let us look into the similarities and associations existing between the two.

Points of Similarities and Associations Between Social Psychology and Economics

- Economics and social psychology both belong to the field of social sciences.
- Both of them also are referred to as “behavioral” studies and intersect in “behavioral

economics”. Behavioral economics studies the effects of psychological, cognitive, emotional, cultural and social factors (the components of social psychology) on the decisions of individuals and institutions and how those decisions vary from those implied by classical economic theory.

- Economics is a science which is constantly progressing and interacting with other sciences including social psychology. Studies in the economics literature discuss how people display a particular behavior in the economic decision-making process. Social psychology is a science of social behavior of the people of the society and explains behavior of people in the economic transaction, and thus it cannot be ignored that social psychology has a profound effect on economics.
- Both social psychology and economics are found to influence and affect the studies and applications of each other in the following ways:
 - Socio-psychologists have contributed to the study of different aspects of economic organization. As result, economists are more and more making use of the socio-psychological concepts and generalizations in the study of economic problems.
 - An economist provides knowledge of property system, division of labor, occupations, industrial organization, etc. to the socio-psychologists.
 - Some matters such as labor relations, standard of living, employer-employee relations, social classes, socio-economic planning, socio-economic reforms, etc. are common to both economists and socio-psychologists.
 - The area of cooperation between social psychology and economics is widening day by day. Economists are now analyzing the social factors influencing economic growth. They are working with the socio-psychologists in their study of the problems of economic development in underdeveloped countries. Problems like poverty, beggary, unemployment, overpopulation and

unregulated industrialization have both social and economic implications.

- On the other hand, economists are more and more making use of the socio-psychological concepts and generalizations in the study of economic problems.

Despite such associations and similarities visible in the relationship of social psychology and economics, we may also witness some dissimilarities and dissimilarities between the two.

Points of Difference Between Social Psychology and Economics

- Social psychology is the offspring of the disciplines sociology and psychology. Economics as a subject and discipline of social sciences has no direct relationship neither with sociology and nor with psychology.
- The subject matter and field of study of both the subjects are too different academically as well as professionally.
- The method and techniques used in both the subjects for carrying out research work also differ particularly in the aspect where economists are more likely to test their hypotheses in large scale field studies of consequential behaviors observed in real world settings, social psychologists are found to stay tenaciously in the laboratory for testing their hypotheses.
- While social psychologists may refer to different attitudes, motivations and behaviors, (behavioral) economists adhere to concepts like utility, aversions and preferences. In contrast to social psychologists, behavioral economists sometimes ask people to attach a price to things (in the form of willingness-to-pay or willingness-to-accept) or develop utility functions.

to the field of social sciences the area of cooperation between the two is widening day by day. In this concern, while economists are now analyzing the social factors influencing economic growth, the socio-psychologists, on the other hand, are seeking cooperation from economists for seeking solution of the social problems like poverty, beggary, unemployment, overpopulation and unregulated industrialization. However, both differ from each other in so many aspects. Both of them differ too much academically as well as professionally in relation to the subject matter and field of their study. They also differ in the use of methods and techniques for carrying out research work particularly in the aspect where economists are more likely to test their hypotheses in large scale field studies of consequential behaviors observed in real world settings, social psychologists are found to stay tenaciously in the laboratory for testing their hypotheses.

Relationship of Social Psychology With Social Neuroscience

Social neuroscience is a relatively new field belonging to social and behavioral sciences. The term 'social neuroscience' can be traced to a publication entitled *Social Neuroscience Bulletin* (published quarterly between 1988 and 1994). In fact, there, this term was used in an article by John Cacioppo and Gary Berntson (1992), who are considered as the legitimate fathers of social neuroscience. Since then, it has grown rapidly. The credit for its popularization goes much to (i) the technological advances helpful in making measures of the brain and body cheaper and more powerful and (ii) to the clear recognition of the importance of neural and physiological information in the understanding of social interactions and behavioral processes of human beings.

As a mechanism, social neuroscience uses the brain and body to understand how we think and act, with a focus on how we think about and interact

To Sum Up

Regarding the relationship existing between the subjects social psychology and economics it can be said that in the capacity of belonging

with other people. More specifically, we can think of social neuroscience as an interdisciplinary field that uses a range of neuroscience measures to understand how other people influence our thoughts, feelings and behavior. As a matter of definition, thus, we can think of social neuroscience as

an interdisciplinary field devoted to understanding how biological systems implement social processes and behaviour, capitalizing on biological concepts and methods to inform and refine theories of social processes and behaviour, and using social and behavioural concepts and data to refine theories of neural organization and function.

(Cacioppo et al., 2007:100)

The overall approach in social neuroscience is to understand the psychological processes that underlie our social behavior. Since these psychological processes by being an inter-psyche phenomena cannot be directly observed, social neuroscientists rely on a combination of measurable or observable neural and physiological responses as well as actual overt behavior to conclude about psychological states and social behavior of the people.

In its functioning and application, thus, social neuroscience has a quite close relationship with behavioral sciences, particularly social psychology, and studies the same topics as studied in social psychology. Its association and similarities with social psychology may be briefed as follows.

Points of Associations and Similarities Between Social Psychology and Social Neuroscience

- Social neuroscience is the intersection of social psychology and neuroscience. We need a proper knowledge about people's psychological states for understanding their social behavior in the discipline socio-psychology. Psychological states cannot be directly observed, however the methods and techniques made available by neuroscience can help us a lot in this direction.
- Social neuroscience is clearly one of the 'hot' areas of interest in social psychology today.
- From the earlier period of the year 2003, the Attitudes and Social Cognition section of the *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, a premier journal in social psychology, had a special section on "social neuroscience". In recent years, we may see that several psychology departments have incorporated 'brain sciences' into their designations.
- Humans are fundamentally a social species whose social environment has shaped our genes, brains and bodies, and our biology (mind and body) has fundamentally shaped the social environments we live in. In this way, our biological systems studied and measured through neuroscience and social behavior studied through social psychology demonstrate a lot of interdependence and association helpful in the proper functioning of human beings.
- Social neuroscience helps us to understand the critical function of how we make sense of and interact with other people. The use of sophisticated techniques like functional magnetic resonance imaging (fMRI) and electroencephalography (EEG) helps us much in our better understanding of how different parts of the brain and body interact to produce the numerous and complex patterns of social behavior displayed by us in our social interaction. Similarly, the knowledge of psychological principles, theories and fundamentals of studying and observing human social behavior is well provided to the social neuroscientists for helping them in their study and arriving at their proper conclusions.
- Consequently, there has been a general consensus that the integration of neuroscience and social psychology holds unique promise. In this connection, Heatherton (2004), in his introduction to the special issue on social cognitive neuroscience in the *Journal of Cognitive Neuroscience*, wrote, "The neuro-scientific study of social cognition reflects a new interdisciplinary and dynamic approach that is providing crucial insights into longstanding social psychological questions" (p. 1681).

- It is therefore, a common thing now to observe the neuroscientists and social psychologists collaborating on problems of mutual interest. Accordingly, there is a growing trend of arranging for their joint training so that both may acquire necessary perfection in the theory and methodology of both the fields for the study of social behavior and processes in a better way. This true integration of perspectives promises a long and healthy marriage for the growth of both leading to offer genuinely comprehensive theories of complex social behavior.

Dissimilarities Between Social Psychology and Social Neuroscience

- Where, as a subject of study, social psychology owes its origin from its parent disciplines sociology and psychology, social neuroscience on the other hand is said to be the joint product of the discipline social psychology and neuroscience.
- Social neuroscience studies the same topics as social psychology, but it does so from a multi-level perspective that includes the study of the brain and body.
- Both the subjects differ much in the use of methods and techniques for carrying out the specific studies by their academic and research scholars. In the case of social neuroscience, scholars make use of a number of methods to investigate the confluence of neural and social processes. These methods owe their existence to behavioral techniques developed in social psychology, cognitive psychology and neuropsychology, and are associated with a variety of neurobiological techniques such as functional magnetic resonance imaging (fMRI) and electroencephalography (EEG). In the studies in social psychology, the scholars make use of specialized methods and techniques borrowed from their parent disciplines psychology and sociology for the study of the social behavior and process of the people.
- Both the subjects differ much in their scope and applications. The sole objective of studies in social neuroscience is revealing the functional

neuro-anatomy of social behavior of the people that is, telling which brain areas are involved with what type of social behavior. Social psychology, on the other hand, as the study of social behavior, processes and institutions carries quite wider meaning and applications in our social life.

To Sum Up

Social neuroscience is a subject that has come into its existence as a result of a useful synthesis of the subject matter taken both from social psychology (science of our social behavior) and neuroscience (science of the functioning of our neurological system). In its structural composition and functioning thus social neuroscience is bound to exhibit a quite close nearness to the subject social psychology. Both of these disciplines, social neuroscience and social psychology, thus, may be found to support and feed the knowledge and understanding of each other. Social neuroscience helps us to understand the critical function of how we make sense of and interact with other people. Similarly, the knowledge of psychological principles, theories and fundamentals of studying and observing human social behavior is well provided by social psychology to the social neuroscientists for helping in their study and arriving at their proper conclusions. However, while showing such closeness both of them also differ in a number of ways particularly in relation to the objectives served, scope and field of their studies, subject matter included in their studies, and the methods and techniques for carrying out the specific research studies by their research scholars, etc.

Review Questions

1. Discuss the relationship of social psychology with general psychology by throwing light on the similarities and dissimilarities present between the two.

2. What is personality psychology? How is it related to social psychology? Discuss.
3. What is environmental psychology? Discuss its relationship with social psychology.
4. "Cultural psychology and social psychology are said to maintain a close relationship in understanding and studying the behavior of the people belonging to one or the other societies." Discuss the validity of this statement in the light of the type of relationship existing between the two.
5. What is evolutionary psychology? Throw necessary light on the type of relationship existing between social psychology and evolutionary psychology.
6. Social psychology is said to owe its origin to both its parent subjects – psychology and sociology. Elucidate how and up to what extent social psychology is related to both these parent subjects.
7. What is anthropology? Discuss its relationship with the subject social psychology.
8. Explain how and to what extent, economics, a well-known subject belonging to the field of social sciences, is related to the subject social psychology belonging to the field of behavioral sciences.
9. What is social neuroscience? Throw light on its relationship with the subject social psychology.

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4.

METHODS OF RESEARCH OR INVESTIGATION IN SOCIAL PSYCHOLOGY

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- Know what is research or investigation.
- Point out the goals of social psychology research or investigation.
- Name and discuss the different methods used in social psychology research or investigation.
- Tell about the nature and use of experimental method in the studies of social psychology.
- Throw light on the nature and use of systematic or naturalistic observation method in the social psychology studies.
- Explain how survey method can be used as a method of investigation in social psychology.
- Elucidate the use of correlation method in the social psychological research studies.
- Talk about the nature and application of case study method in the social psychological research studies.
- Explain how ethnography is used as a method of investigation in social psychology.
- Discuss the mechanism of using documentary or archival analysis as a method of investigation in social psychology.
- Discuss quantitative and qualitative data analysis.
- Reflect on the ethical issues in psychological researches.

What Is Research or Investigation?

The word research or investigation in its simple meaning stands for inquiring about or knowing something new or getting more knowledge about a thing, person, phenomenon or event. The generalized day-to-day meaning of the word research may emerge before us when we find people finding answers to their queries in the situations such as follow.

1. A housewife may try to know what combinations of sugar, salt or food contents make a dish tasty and presentable.
2. A coach may try to find out the best possible way to provide coaching to his hockey team.
3. A worker may try to find out the technique of getting better output from the machine.
4. A traveler may try to find out the shortest way of his journey.

5. A teacher may try to find out the best method of teaching her students.

All the preceding individuals are trying to find out solutions to their problems. In other words, it may be said that all are engaged in the task of an inquiry or research in their own way. But, however, as far as the real meaning of the term inquiry or research is concerned, it is quite possible here that none of the preceding persons may be carrying out research in its true sense. They may seek solution to their problems or answer to their queries from some experts in their respective fields, or may acquire the desired knowledge from the reading of literature, or get it through mere chance and trial.

Let us now take the help of some authentic dictionaries and the writings of well-known authors for understanding the meaning of the term research or scientific inquiry in a proper way.

Advanced Learner's Dictionary (1952:1089):

Research is "careful investigation or inquiry especially through search for new facts in any branch of knowledge".

Merriam Webster Seventh New Collegiate Dictionary (1966:730): Research is a "careful or diligent search" or "studious inquiry or examination; especially investigation or experimentation aimed at the discovery and interpretation of facts, revision of accepted theories or laws in the light of new facts, or practical application of such new or revised theories or laws."

Young (1966:15): Research is "the systematic method of discovering new facts or verifying the old facts, their sequence, interrelationships, causal explanations and the natural laws which govern them."

Kothari (1990:20): "The term research refers to the systematic method consisting of enunciating the problem, formulating a hypothesis, collecting the facts or data, analysing the facts and reaching certain conclusions either in the form of solution(s) towards the problem concerned or in certain generalizations for some hypothetical formulations."

Best and Kahn (2006:25): "Research may be defined as the systematic and objective analysis and recording of controlled observations that may lead

to the development of generalizations, principles, or theories, resulting in prediction and possibly ultimate control of events."

Research or Scientific Investigation

A well thought scientific process involving some definite steps for arriving at something new or adding modifications to the existing stock of knowledge helpful in solving the confronted problems at one or the other times.

A close analysis of the provided definitions may reveal the following things about the meaning and nature of the term research or scientific inquiry.

- Research is always conducted with some definite purpose or objective in view. It is aimed to serve the purposes such as (i) to provide an answer to the question raised and problems felt, (ii) to seek reliable information or acquire new knowledge of a subject or its utilization for the needed practical applications.
- Research is not conducted in a haphazard way. It represents systematized efforts, studious inquiry or examination, scientific or critical investigation involving some well-planned and definite steps of a scientific method or approach for realizing its set goals or objectives.
- Research is a process, and not a product. It can be employed as a tool, means or method of manipulating the things, concepts and available data for arriving at some reliable and valid conclusions for serving the goals or objectives of research.

As a whole, thus, the characteristics and features of a good research work undertaken in any field of knowledge including social psychology may be properly summarized by categorizing them mainly into the four categories such as:

- (i) Laying down the purposes or goals of the research study.

- (ii) Applying appropriate methods for collecting information or data.
- (iii) The logical analysis of data for deriving valid conclusions.
- (iv) The observance of ethics on the part of the person conducting research.

In this chapter we will be having necessary discussion on all these four aspects of a good social psychological research or investigation.

The Fundamental Elements or Pillars of a Good Research Work

- Laying down the purposes or goals of the research study.
- Applying appropriate methods for collecting information or data.
- The logical analysis of data for deriving valid conclusions.
- The observance of ethics on the part of the person conducting research.

Goals of Social Psychology Research or Investigation

As said earlier in defining the term research, it is a quite purposeful activity that is undertaken by the individuals for serving their one or the other objectives or goals. Accordingly, the research or scientific investigation carried out in social psychology for studying the social behavior of a subject in one or the other environmental situations is aimed to serve some useful ends or goals discussed here.

1. *Description of the Behavior:* While engaging in the task of a social psychological research or inquiry one of the primary goals before the researcher is to describe the social behavior under investigation as objectively and accurately as possible. For example, if a researcher is set to the task of investigating about the bullying behavior of some children of a school he needs first to focus on knowing what their behavior actually is. He will

try to get information or collect data by observing the acts of their bullying behavior in different situations. He will note the places – such as school campus, sports ground, street or pathway, lonely places, public places, etc. – for the bullying acts committed by them alone or in group. He will also take note of the behavior of the bystanders in these situations. On the basis of these data he will then try to get acquainted with the nature and types of physical, verbal, written or online bullying acts performed by them with one or the other victims of their bullying, in such a proper extent as to enable him to describe it quite objectively and accurately as possible. It may help him to attain other objectives or goals of his research – explaining, predicting and controlling of their bullying behavior.

2. *Explanation of the Social Behavior:* The second major goal of a social psychology research or inquiry is to provide the explanation of the social behavior in question i.e., why do people do the things or behave in the way as they do in a particular social situation? In our example, the researcher collects information or data to understand the things related to the bullying behavior of some children. With its objective analysis as well as collecting further information from the concerned angles he will now focus on explaining the reasons or causes underlying their bullying behavior.
3. *Prediction of the Social Behavior:* The third major goal of a social psychology research or investigation is concerned with its strength of predicting the occurrence of a particular behavior in a given situation, under the known circumstances. The researchers in social psychology thus also focus on making use of what they have concluded in describing and explaining the behavior in question. What type of bullying behavior is exhibited in which conditions or situations towards the victims? What are its possible causes or determinants? The analysis of all these things, then, may enable them to predict the occurrence of such types of behavior in future in similar situations and circumstances within the school campus or outside.

4. *Controlling of the Social Behavior:* The other major as well quite important goal of a social psychology research or investigation is to work towards taking control of the behavior in question. When the researcher is in a position to know all about the nature of the behavior and its determinants, he may now make use of this knowledge for exercising the needed control over the said behavior by resorting to certain appropriate means and ways such as (i) to increase/promote or decrease/eliminate certain things related to the behavior, (ii) to work towards preventing the occurrence of certain things essential for exercising control over the occurrence of behavior, and (iii) to take help of curative measures in the form of providing guidance and counselling or therapies to the affected people.

In the case of our present example now needed control over the bullying behavior may be exercised by resorting to means such as (i) promoting or increasing confidence among the victims of bullying as well bystanders to face the situation in a proper way, (ii) to exercise vigil over the bullying behavior of the bullies and take suitable disciplinary action with a necessary promptness by taking into confidence the parents of the involved children, (iii) to make necessary arrangement for the guidance and counselling as well as psychotherapies for the desired changes and modifications in the behavior of the bullies, and mental health of the victims as well as bystanders.

5. *Applying the Results of the Research Findings:* The last but equally important goal of a social psychology research or investigation is to seek application of its findings in the day-to-day life activities of the people or build new theories as well as bring modifications in the existing stock of the social psychology knowledge. For example, the research work done in our present example of bullying behavior may help the teachers, parents and school authorities to take control of the bullying behavior of the bullies, help the victims in facing the situations and educating the bystanders to help or report the

matter in time, bring needed modification in the situations responsible for reinforcing the bullying behavior, etc. Moreover, it may also add in the existing know-how about the bullying behavior as it may now be available in quite modern alternative forms other than those committed in the past with more serious concern about the welfare of the victims and reputation of the schools.

Goals of Social Psychology Research or Investigation

- Description of the behavior under investigation.
- Explanation of the behavior.
- Prediction of the behavior.
- Controlling of the behavior.
- Applying the results of the research findings.

Methods Used in Social Psychology Research or Investigation

Social psychology is defined as the scientific study of social behavior involving social processes and institutions functioning in the society. It, thus, means that in social psychology we need to study the behavior of the people that is social in nature in quite systematic, reliable and valid ways. Moreover, in any method used for deriving conclusion about the phenomenon, interactions, relationships and institutions related to social behavior of the people, there is a need of collecting information or data (quantitative or qualitative) regarding that aspect of the people's social behavior along with its proper analysis for arriving at the needed conclusion. Let us think how we can avail quantitative and qualitative data/information about the social behavior of the people occurring in one or the other social situations. We can do it by getting it properly observed. In fact, thus, observation may be regarded as the only method for investigating in social psychology and truly it is. The different methods used for the purpose are nothing but the variations or alternative forms of systematic and

careful observations carried out for studying the social behavior of the people. Let us see how:

- When we are carrying out such systematic observations in a natural setting, we are said to make use of *systematic or naturalistic observation* method.
- When we make use of such careful observation in the controlled conditions in the laboratory or field setup, we are said to make use of *experimental* method.
- When we want to have a report based on the observation of a large population of the people, we may be found to make use of the *survey* method.
- When we make use of the observation technique to find out how some events related to our environment are related to the occurrence of others, we are said to make use *correlation* method.
- When we want to derive a conclusion about the social behavior and living of the people belonging to a particular culture by observing them, then and there, we are making use of *ethnography or cross-cultural* method of investigation.
- When a single unit – individual or institution – is made a target of our careful in-depth observation, we are said to make use of the *case study* method.
- When the subjects of our observation and analysis are the existing documents or archival data available for the purpose, we are said to employ *documentary or archival analysis* method.

In this way, we may make use of a number of research methods in studying the social behavior of the people, pointed out earlier, by bringing the needed variations in our observation technique and approach depending upon our research need and purpose to be solved from such observation. No one particular method out of all these is said to be perfect and sufficient for its use in all situations. Each one of them has its own value, significance as well as limitation. Let us examine the nature and application of these methods one by one for carrying out the task of investigation in social psychology. For this purpose, let us, at

present, start with the discussion of the highly used method of investigation in social psychology, known as experimental method.

Experimental Method

The experimental method, in accordance with its naming, is very much found to lay emphasis on performing experiments. The word ‘experiment’ comes from a Latin word *experimentum* meaning ‘a trial’ or ‘test’. Therefore, in experimentation we try or put to the test the material or phenomenon whose characteristics or consequences (here the social behavior of the people) which we wish to ascertain. In the sciences, while conducting such experiments in the laboratory or field we may want to learn the effect of friction on motion, the effect of sunlight on growth of plants, etc. In social psychology also, we perform such experiments in the laboratory or outside the laboratory in the social environment – physical or social settings – to study the cause-effect relationship regarding the nature of human social behavior, i.e., the effect of anxiety, drugs or stresses on human social behavior, the effect of media violence on the audience and spectator violence, etc. In performing all such experiments, we try to establish certain cause and effect relationships through objective observations of the actions performed and the subsequent changes produced under pre-arranged or rigidly controlled conditions. From these observations certain conclusions are drawn and theories or principles are formulated.

It is a widely used and most favored method of investigation employed by the social psychologists all over the globe for the study of the social behavior of the people. According to Higbee et al. (1982), social psychologists have used experimental method in about three-fourths of their research studies. Their choice has some merit as the experimental method may be said to comply with all the requirements needed for a method being called as a scientific method, namely as follows:

- It provides an opportunity to carry out the experimental work for the researchers to make the *most careful systematic observations of the*

behavior of the people in the quite controlled conditions otherwise unavailable with the use of other methods of investigation.

- It provides scope for the *prediction of the behavior* of the people by establishing a *cause and effect relationship* between two variables (the things and phenomenon that stand to vary and change in the social environment) related to the social behavior of the people.

Experimentation Method

The research method aimed at establishing the possible cause and effect relationship between the independent and dependent variables of the study through some systematic and well-planned observations carried out under controlled conditions.

Understood in this way experimentation method, in the shape of a formal definition, may be termed as a *type of research method aimed at establishing the possible cause and effect relationship between variables (changeable or variable aspects of the social world) under study through some systematic and well-planned observations carried out under controlled conditions*.

In this definition, we have mentioned a few terms like variables, controlling of experimental conditions, etc. for the employment of experimental method on the part of investigators. Let us examine them.

1. **Variables:** A variable in the experimental study in social psychology stands for any characteristic or condition (of the participants and the social environment) that is liable to be varied and thus can be attributed with different values. A researcher may encounter a number of variables that need to be manipulated, controlled or observed as per the requirement of his research study. These variables are known and classified as independent, dependent and extraneous or intervening variables.

Independent variable: The type of variable or factor in an experimental study that is deliberately manipulated and systematically varied for observing its effects on the dependent variable.

Dependent variable: The type of variable or factor in an experimental study that is supposed to get changed in tune with the introduction and manipulation of the independent variable.

Extraneous or intervening variables: Those variables (factors or conditions) in an experimental study that need to be controlled or nullified on account of their supposed interference with the results of the study.

Independent Variable: In an experimental study, the term independent variable stands for the type of variable that is very much in control of the experimenter. He deliberately manipulates and varies it for observing its effects on the dependent variable.

Dependent Variable: In an experimental study, the term dependent variable stands for the type of variable (i.e., aspect of one's social behavior) that is supposed to get affected or changed in tune with the introduction and manipulation of the independent variable.

Extraneous or Intervening Variables: In an experimental study, the term extraneous or intervening variable stands for all those variables (factors or conditions) that are of no interest to the experimenter. These are supposed to influence and interfere with the results and thus need to be controlled and neutralized (held constant) by the experimenter to clearly establish the cause-effect relationship between the independent and dependent variables of his study.

2. **Controlling Over Conditions:** In an experimental method, a quite essential thing is to exercise control over the conditions or variables. By this control we can eliminate irrelevant conditions or variables and isolate the relevant ones and

thus become able to observe the causal relationship between the independent and dependent variables by keeping all the extraneous or intervening variables/conditions almost neutralized or constant. For the purpose of exercising such needed control, an experimenter has to make the needed provisions as follows.

- **Random Assignments of Participants to Experimental Conditions:** For the utilization of this provision for nullifying the influence of the intervening variables, the experimenter has to assign the subjects/participants to varying conditions of independent variable in a random fashion. Randomization is regarded as the most convenient but powerful tool for controlling a host of extraneous variables (known or unknown) affecting the results of a study. By doing this, the experimenter is capable of providing them equal chance of being exposed to each level of the independent variable and thus ensuring the ruling out of any extraneous effect arising on account of the factors related to participants. The task of randomization may be carried out by using a lottery system, tossing of the coin or making use of the random number table.

Random Assignments of Participants to Experimental Conditions

A provision made in an experimental study to see that all participants included in the study have an equal chance of being exposed to each level of the independent variable and thus ensuring the ruling out of any extraneous effect arising on account of the factors related to participants.

- **Holding All Other Factors Other Than the Independent Variable as Constant:** The employment of this provision demands that the experimenter hold constant all the

factors, other than the independent variable, that may be suspected to influence the participants' behavior in one or the other ways.

The employment of the preceding provisions in making use of the experimental method proves quite helpful in ensuring the needed internal validity of the research findings. By the term 'internal validity' of the findings of an experimental research here we mean to make quite sure that the independent variable, and only the independent variable, influences the dependent variable (Campbell and Stanley, 1963).

Internal Validity

The term 'internal validity' of the findings of an experimental research stands for making sure that the independent variable, and only the independent variable, influences the dependent variable.

Let us now try to illustrate the task of maintaining internal validity of experimental research findings (by making out the provisions like random assignment of the participants to different levels of the independent variable and exercising control over all the extraneous variables) through a study meant for answering a research question entitled "*Does exposure to violent video increase the likelihood of children being aggressive against others in some ways?*"

In carrying out his research study for answering this question, the researcher is here needed to find out a cause-effect relationship between the independent variable (exposure to video games) and the dependent variable (the behavior resulted through such exposure) by holding constant all other factors influencing the behavior of the participants in one or the other ways. The steps taken here may be summed up as follows.

1. The participants of the study (say children of a particular section of a school class) will be

divided in the random fashion into two groups – experimental and the control. The randomization, here, may help the researcher to nullify the effects of a number of extraneous variables or factors like differences in their age, gender, socio-cultural upbringing, I.Q level, temperament as well as tendency of getting easily aggressive, etc.

2. The participants belonging to these two different groups now will be subjected to the two varying conditions or levels of the independent variable such as (i) exposure to violent video games and (ii) exposure to non-violent video games. Consequently, the children belonging to the experimental group here now will be playing the violent video games and the other belonging to the control group will be playing the non-violent video games.
3. For studying the effects of exposures related to the playing of violent video games and non-violent video games on the children of two groups, they will be under observation at the time of their regular play activities at the recess hours or on a competitive or combat game activity organized specifically for this purpose at the school ground.
4. All the needed attempts will be earnestly made to hold constant all possible intervening variables affecting the result of the study in one or the other ways. The possible intervening factors in this study may be cited as (i) the time provided for playing the games to the participants of both the groups; (ii) the facilities and convenience available for playing the video games; (iii) environmental conditions like heat, noise and other types of external disturbances affecting the playing of the video games; and (iv) observations made by the evaluators (research assistants) for reporting about the behavior of children during their regular or organized play activities.
5. The observation results compiled by the research assistants acting as evaluators will then indicate the status of aggressive or non-aggressive behavior of the children (belonging to both groups). For bringing objectivity and reliability to the observation findings, three or

four assistants may be deputed for rating the behavior of the children in play and their results will then be pooled and averaged for providing a measure for their aggressive behavior.

6. If playing violent video games causes an increase in the aggression or violence against others, then participants who played such games would be demonstrating overt aggression and violent moves towards their playing mates and thus have all possibility of ranking quite high in terms of aggressive and violence scores provided by the observers. If findings of the study indicate that this is the case, then on the basis of the work done in the present study we may conclude that exposure to violent video games increases the likelihood of being aggressive against others in some ways.

The employment of experimental method for carrying out investigation and research work in social psychology in the manner as discussed earlier may provide a quite powerful tool for serving the needed purpose. However, it cannot be termed as fully perfect and ideal for conducting all types of research work in social psychology. It has its own limitations and therefore comes under attack chiefly on account of suffering from the problems of lacking in terms of the required validity – internal and external of the research findings.

By the term ‘validity of a research finding’, we mean the faith that can be put in the findings of this study. In general, here two types of validity – internal and external – are to be looked after for deciding about the appropriateness of the use of a particular research method and its findings. Let us try to weigh the use of experimental method in terms of the possession of the required internal and external validity on its part.

In experimental method the researchers try to observe the social behavior of the people by conducting the needed experiments in a quite controlled laboratory like conditions or set-up. In the opinion of Best and Kahn (2006:171), “an experiment has internal validity to the extent that the factors that have been manipulated (individual variables) have a genuine effect on the observed consequences (dependent variables) in the experimental setting.”

Now it depends upon the quality of the needed control to be exercised for doing away with the influence of all the intervening variables (known and unknown) for studying the direct impact of an independent variable upon the dependent variable of the study. Since it is a quite uphill task to identify and control all the possible intervening variables and also to ascertain an objective and reliable measure for the influence of independent variable on the dependent variable, there remains serious doubt about the internal validity of the findings of the laboratory method. Even if the research findings of an experimental research are able to demonstrate a quite favorable result in terms of its internal validity, the difficulty regarding the maintenance of external validity may still pose a serious question about its usefulness.

By the term 'external validity' in reference to the findings of an experimental study (laboratory or field) here we mean the extent to which the results of the study are applied to a similar situation outside the experimental setup. In this connection, here we may find that findings of the experimental studies are likely to suffer badly in terms of the lack of their external validity. Simply because, here we often make use of a quite small sample of the participants and try to derive conclusions by conducting a particular type of experiment under the tightly rigid controlled conditions. Thus, it is but natural to be quite suspicious about the applicability of the research findings of experimental studies to real-life situations.

In this way, it is but natural for the researchers in social psychology to look after other methods of investigation that may be helpful in overcoming the problem of external validity with the research findings of their studies. The methods like systematic or naturalistic observation and survey may serve their purpose well in this connection. Let us try to have a look into the nature and applicability of these methods one by one.

To Sum Up

Experimental method is the most favored method of investigation employed by the social psychologists all over the globe for

the study of the social behavior of people. Here the researchers get engaged in experimental work either in the laboratory setting or in the field setting of the social environment by following all the norms of performing scientific experimentation – observation of the aspect of a social behavior under investigation in quite systematic and careful ways under the needed controlled conditions with the aim of establishing a possible cause and effect relationship between the independent and dependent variables of the study.

Independent variable is a type of variable that stands for variation (assigning different values by the experimenter) for studying its effect on the dependent variable by holding all other variables, named as intervening variables constant or nullified. This task of eliminating the effects of all the intervening variables for studying the cause and effect relationship between independent and dependent variables in the most valid (truthful) way helps much in establishing internal validity of a research finding. It can be well performed through the random assignment of the subjects of the study to varying conditions of independent variable. The task of random assignment may be well carried out by using a lottery system, tossing of the coin or making use of the random number table.

Now in terms of validity – accuracy and truthfulness of the research findings of the experimental study – we may say that it can be termed to possess the required internal validity to the extent of the proper identification and controlling of all the possible intervening variables. Regarding the external validity of the experimental studies, i.e., application of the results of the study to a similar situation outside the experimental setup, we may find that findings of the experimental studies are likely to suffer badly in terms of the lack of their external validity.

Systematic or Naturalistic Observation Method

As the name suggests, in the use of the systematic observation method for studying one or the other aspects of social behavior of the people, attempts are made to observe the target aspect of people's social behavior in a quite systematic way along with its careful recording for deriving the needed conclusion in view of the objectives of the research study. The nature of observation made in the use of the systematic observation method for investigation in social psychology thus differs a lot from our routine observation in daily life. It is quite systematic as well as objective in its processing and outcomes. Moreover, since it allows observing and recording of the occurrence of the social behavior of the people in its natural setting, it is also termed as naturalistic observation method.

In its use and application of studying the social behavior of the people, observation method is regarded as one of the most convenient and appropriate methods for investigation employed in social psychology. We can get valuable quantitative as well as qualitative information about one or the other aspects of people's social behavior by the systematic and careful observation of their behavioral activities going on in the natural way in their daily life.

Systematic or Naturalistic Observation Method

The research method in which the investigator tries to observe and record the occurrence of the behavior of the people in its natural setting in a quite systematic way for deriving the needed conclusion in view of the objectives of the research study.

Styles and Ways of Carrying Out Observation

The task of observation carried out in the use of the systematic or naturalistic observation method for the investigation in social psychology may usually take one of the forms and styles named as participant and non-participant observation. Let us examine them.

Participant Observation: In this type of observation, the observer tries to observe the behavior of a group of people by joining them as an associate or participant in any of their group activities. For example, he may join the group of children in their play activities or accompany them on tour and excursion activities to closely observe them for investigating about one or the other aspects of their social behavior. This may provide good opportunity for the observation of the behavior of the individuals. However, it suffers from a serious limitation as the presence of an observer may obstruct the natural and spontaneous flow of the behavioral activities of the participants under study.

Non-participant Observation: This type of observation tries to do away with the aforementioned defect or limitation of the participant observation. Here the observer observes the behavior of the people in such a way that they may not have any idea that their behavior in any way is being observed. For this purpose, as an observer he may take his position in such a place and in such a way that while the individuals under observation may not see him, he can clearly watch and hear, if possible, all about their behavior in action. There may be a screen or a curtain of such a nature as can help for real observation while hiding his presence. The use of some modern equipment like secret cameras, video recording, audio recording, etc. may also serve such purpose. While sitting at quite a far distance, the observer may also take the help of a telescope for a clear but secret observation. Whatever means and methods may be employed by the observer, his motive in such an observation is always to come in contact with the natural and spontaneous behavior of the subjects without making them aware of his presence.

How to Make Use of the Observation Method

The use of the observation method for the investigation in social psychology generally requires the use of the following four systematic steps.

Planning and Preparation for Observation:

The success of an observation depends much on its proper planning and pre-preparation. This initial task requires proper attention on the following aspects.

- What type of aspect, characteristic or attribute of people's social behavior is to be assessed through observation?
- How is the observation work to be carried out, and what type of techniques or resources will be used for such observation?
- What type of situation or environment is to be maintained for carrying out the observation work?
- What type of difficulties or adverse situations may occur during the observation work, and how can these be overcome for carrying out effective observation?
- How can the observation results be made more reliable, informative, objective and valid?

Observation of the Behavior: The second step is related with the actual observation work done by the observer as per planning and preparation made in the first step. As far as possible the best methods and techniques should be used here for the observation of the behavior depending upon the purpose of observation and availability of the resources and environmental situations at the time of observation. Hence, for obtaining better results, the following things should always be kept in mind.

- The subjects should not have any idea that their behavior is under observation. As far as possible, their behavior is to be observed in a quite naturalistic condition for deriving the sample of their most natural and spontaneous behavior.
- The observation work must be carried out properly in a quite effective way. The eyes have to play a key role in such an observation. If possible, one should also try to hear about the behavioral activities in action.
- It is always better to make use of a telescope for viewing the activities of individuals specially while sitting at a far-off place.

- There must be an adequate arrangement for using the modern observation equipment like cameras, video and audio recording. The use of these devices not only helps in proper observation of the behavioral activities but provides an automatic recording device for the proper analysis and interpretation of the behavior.
- It is not proper to rely on the results of a single observation of the subject's behavior for making a decision about their one or the other behavioral aspects or characteristics. For desirable objectivity, reliability and validity, such observation work must be repeated by the same observer for a desirable number of times or it should be carried out by a number of different observers at one or a number of times.
- The recording about the nature of the behavioral or personality traits should always be done side by side by the observer while making observations of his behavior. The failure to do so proves quite costly as the observer may forget or miss some or the other important things or links regarding the observed behavior. It is always better to prepare a checklist for tallying or making the things to be observed in one's behavior during the observation.

Analysis and Interpretation of the Observed Results:

In this third step, what is observed and recorded about knowing about one or the other aspects of people's social behavior during the observation of one's behavior is subjected to a close analysis for deriving the necessary interpretation about the nature and characteristics of that aspect of social behavior.

Generalization of the Results: The interpretation made and results arrived at are then used for establishing generalized opinion, facts of principles about the occurrence of the similar social behavior and existence of similar social traits among similar individuals in similar situations. It can help us to predict behavior in similar circumstances, search for the roots of a particular type of behavior and study the effects of some remedial or treatment measure in the correction of a maladaptive and undesirable social behavior.

To Sum Up

In the use of systematic or naturalistic observation method for the investigation in social psychology, the investigator tries to observe and record the occurrence of the social behavior of the people in its natural setting in a quite systematic way for deriving the needed conclusion in view of the objectives of the research study. The observation for the required purposes may be carried out in ways and styles like participant observation (participation of observer in the events of observation) and non-participant observation (observing without letting the subjects know). The success of the observation method lies in the proper planning and preparation of the observation task and then carefully observing and recording the events of the observed behavior.

Survey Method

Survey method is also quite often utilized for the investigation in social psychology, mainly to collect information about *what exists* by studying and analyzing important aspects of a pattern of a particular behavior, quality or characteristic related to an existing social group. We can study the interests, aptitudes, attitudes, habits and many other temperamental, social and personal characteristics of a group with the help of the survey method. For example, a researcher can very well study the attitudes of the young marriageable Indian boys and girls towards dowry system. For this study he has to interact with a group of youths (included in the appropriately chosen representative sample) for knowing their opinions, views, stereotypes and feelings, etc. regarding the dowry system. Similar attempts can also be made to judge opinion and attitude of the people of a particular place and region about a number of social issues such as legalized of abortion, inter-caste and inter-faith marriages, abolishing death penalty, and providing legal and

social acceptance to gay marriages. For this purpose, the needed contact with a wide variety of people of a particular group or region to arrive at a proper conclusion concerning the objectives of a socio-psychological study can only be possible through survey method. Here instead of a single individual or group, a large population of the people as a whole or its representative sample is made a subject of careful and systematic observational study. As a result, we can consider and define survey method *as a method of extensive study for the investigation in social psychology involving all the members of a population or its representative sample to derive the desired specific information about one or the other aspects of people's social life or living.*

Survey Method

The method of investigation in which the investigator tries to collect information about *what exists* by studying and analyzing important aspects of a pattern of a particular behavior or characteristic related to an existing social group involving all of its members or its representative sample.

How to Make Use of the Survey Method

The main activities regarding the employment of survey method in social psychology research may be identified as follows:

1. The selection of a representative sample.
2. Making use of survey tools such as questionnaire and interview schedule for collecting the required data from the representative sample.
3. Analyzing the collected data for drawing necessary inferences to address the research question.

In the application of survey method, sampling and administration of the survey tools are, thus in fact, the main hubs and centers of a survey study carried

out for addressing one or the other research questions. A researcher, thus, while making use of survey method should try to take necessary pains in selecting an unbiased and truly representative sample out of the targeted population of his survey study. Regarding the administration of the survey tools (questionnaire and interview schedule) on the chosen sample, it is to be kept in mind that these should be administered in such a way as to provide reliable and valid data for addressing the research questions of the study in a proper way. In general, the following modes and ways are more popular for the administration of the questionnaire and interview schedule on a representative sample:

Mail Surveys: In mail surveys, the researchers make use of the self-administered questionnaires. In practice, an appropriate questionnaire well developed by the researcher himself (or otherwise available as a standardized tool for conducting the desired survey) is sent by post to the persons belonging to the representative sample with a forwarding letter stating the significance of the survey study and request for returning the questionnaire after responding it in a proper way. A self-addressed stamped envelope is also enclosed for receiving the response from the respondents.

Group Administered Surveys: In this type of survey, a sample of respondents is brought together and asked to respond to a structural sequence of questions. This type of administration of a survey tool carries a number of advantages. Here, the researcher may give the questionnaire to those who are present and thus be fairly sure that there would be a high response rate. If the respondents are unclear about the meaning of a particular question, they can ask for clarification. Luckily enough, the researchers for this purpose may often get the already organized setting in the form of sections or classes of the schools, assembly of clubs and gatherings at the religious places.

Door to Door Surveys: A less familiar type of survey made with the help of questionnaires is the door to door survey. In this approach, a researcher goes to the respondent's house or workplace and hands over the instrument to the respondent. In some cases, the respondent is asked to mail it back or the researcher

returns to pick it up. This approach attempts to blend the advantages of the mail survey and the group survey and also provide scope for asking follow-up questions by taking the respondent in confidence.

Phone Surveys: In this type of survey, the researchers communicate with the respondents included in their study samples through available phone services – landline and smart phone. The services available on smart phones are now considered more convenient and suitable for having contact and receiving responses from respondents of survey studies. One can message, and make use of the audio-video call services available on smart phones for getting needed information/data for his research study from the sampled respondents in a quite convenient, quick and appropriate way.

Surveys Involving Personal or Face-to-Face Interview: In this type of survey, the researchers are required to collect the needed information or data directly from the respondents of their research study sample by seeking personal interviews with them collectively as members of a certain group or on an individual basis at a mutually agreed place and time. These can prove more advantageous and superior to other modes of surveys mainly on the ground that it gives more flexibility to the researcher to bring modification and alterations in the mode of questioning the respondents for bringing more completeness, reliability and validity to the task of data collection on the spot through face-to-face dialogue.

Online Surveys: In this type of survey, the researchers make use of the internet and web-based services provided by modern computer technology for collecting the desired information/data for his research study. Typically, there are three types of internet and web-based surveys (Simsek and Veiga, 2001).

1. An e-mail message with the survey embedded in the e-mail text can be sent to respondents. The respondents simply return the e-mail with the answers.
2. An e-mail can be sent with an attachment that the respondents must open, answer and then send back as an attachment.

3. Researchers can use a URL-embedded message in the text of the e-mail, so the respondent simply clicks on the hypertext link, which then evokes the web browser to present the respondent with the web-based survey.

Whatever may be the form and shape of its presentation, an internet and web-based survey, may prove a quite handy tool and device for collecting a pool of desired information or data from a vast population in no time with a negligible cost. The information collected through this mode of survey is more systematic and organized and can be easily subjected to computerized analysis for deriving valid conclusion in a research study. With its multidimensional benefits, simplicity and easy use on the part of researchers and respondents, this kind of surveying mode is turning to be quite popular day by day.

To Sum Up

Survey method is employed mainly to collect information about what exists by studying and analyzing important aspects of a pattern of a particular behavior or characteristic related to an existing social group, i.e., attitude towards dowry/population/education/birth control. Here the desired information is collected from the total population or its representative sample with the help of the devices like questionnaire and interview. In general, styles and ways adopted for the administration of the questionnaire and interview schedule on a given population or its representative sample may include the survey modes like mail surveys, group administered surveys, door to door surveys, phone surveys, surveys involving personal or face-to-face interview, and online surveys involving the use of the internet and web-based services.

Correlation Method

It is quite common on the part of researchers in social psychology to make use of the method of correlation in answering their research questions pertaining to one or

the other existing social issues, events and characteristics of the people and social institutions. The term correlation in the field of investigation and research stands for describing the type of relationship or association existing between two variables of a research study, and consequently correlation research and method in behavioral sciences including social psychology are employed to examine the relationship between two variables of a research study. In this concern, as pointed out by Cohen et al. (2000:193), *“the use of the method of correlation in social psychology researches is intended to answer three questions about two variables or two sets of data. First, ‘is there a relationship between the two variables (or sets of data)?’ If yes, then two other questions follow: ‘What is the direction of the relationship?’, and ‘what is the magnitude?’”*

Correlation Method

The method of research that helps a researcher to determine whether and to what extent variables of the research study are related to each other and thus coming in a position to predict one from the other.

How to Make Use of Correlation Method

The goal of the use of correlation method is to determine whether and to what extent variables of the research study are related to each other. If we find a satisfactory amount of correlation existing between two variables of the study it can help us in predicting that if one exists in a social situation, the other will be naturally accompanying it. For the illustration of the procedure employed for making use of correlation method, let us take a research study aimed to answer a basic question of how far the maladjustment of children at their home and school is associated with their aggressive and violent behavior in the social situations. The following steps may be followed in general for the use of the correlation method for conducting a research study in this concern.

1. First of all, the variables of the study are identified in a proper way. In this study, these are

- (i) maladjustment suffered in the school and at home on the part of children, and (ii) aggression and violent behavior demonstrated by them in social situations.
2. After then, attempts are made to have a proper measurement of these variables by making use of appropriate techniques and thus arriving at the two sets of measurement. Here in this study, a researcher may make use of a standardized adjustment inventory for finding out the maladjustment scores of the subjects included in his research sample. For getting scores on aggressiveness and violent behavior of the subjects, he may take the rating scores of the different research assistants employed for taking stock of the aggression demonstrated by the subjects at different social encounters in school, at home, playground, school canteen, etc.
 3. The attempts, then further, may be made to compute coefficient of correlation between these two sets of scores by making use of the appropriate statistical technique. The nature and amount of this computed measure will then tell us about the nature and type of association/relationship existing between the two variables including their ability to predict one on the basis of the other.
 4. Note here that the conclusions drawn through a correlation study depend solely on the value of the computed coefficient of correlation both in terms of its direction – being positive/negative – and its magnitude – the size of its numerical value. Statistically, the computed value of correlation coefficient can range from -1 to $+1$. Here in the present case, also, the numerical value (including the positive or negative sign) of the computed correlation coefficient between two sets of the measurement of the maladjustment and aggressive/violent behavior will be telling all about the nature of correlation/association existing between these two variables. If it turns sufficiently positive (possessing more positive numerical value such as 0.7 and more), then it will be concluded that maladjustment and violent behavior travel together. The children who are maladjusted in school and at home are

bound to show aggression and violence in social encounters and vice versa.

In this way, the method of correlation used for carrying out investigation in social psychology may make a researcher quite capable of establishing or denying a satisfactory relationship/association existing between the variables of that study. It also carries an appreciable predictive value. He can predict the presence/absence of one on the basis of the presence/absence of the other. For example, if a researcher in his correlation study finds that there exists a positive satisfactory correlation between the variables of his study, namely watching pornographic videos and sexual violence against women, the results of his study can be very well used for predicting the increase in sex related violence against women on account of the increase in the trend of watching pornographic videos. But here it should also be remembered that it does not mean that the watching of pornographic videos is essentially to be turned into sexual violence against women, i.e., the former is the cause and the latter is the effect. In fact, such a cause-effect relationship between the two variables of the study cannot be established through the use of correlation method and for this purpose, the researchers have to make use of the experimental method discussed earlier in this chapter.

To Sum Up

Correlation research and method in behavioral sciences including social psychology is used by the researchers to examine the nature, direction and magnitude of the relationship existing between two variables of a research study for enabling them to predict one from the other. For conducting correlation research, they are found to follow the steps like:

- The identification of the variables of the study in a proper way.
- To have a proper measurement of these two variables by making use of appropriate techniques and thus arriving at the two sets of measurement.

- To compute coefficient of correlation between these two sets of scores by making use of the appropriate statistical technique.
- To make use the computed correlation coefficient for concluding about the nature and type of association/relationship existing between the variables of the study including their ability to predict one on the basis of the other.

Case Study Method

There are situations before the researchers in social psychology when they have to conduct a type of study that may help them in describing the characteristics of an existing individual unit (i.e., an individual, group or a social system) designated as a case through its in-depth and intensive study. It is here, they have the need to make use of a specialized method of investigation, known as *case study* method.

As a matter of its formal definition, we can term case study method as a method of investigation employed for carrying out such descriptive or explanatory researches (capable of being generalized to similar cases studied under similar conditions) on the part of researchers that may prove helpful to them in a detailed and in-depth study of a case (an individual, group, institution, community, event or phenomenon) in its real-life context directed towards introducing necessary intervention and measures (if needed so) in the interest of the case studied or others.

Case Study Method

A method of research used in social and behavioral sciences to have a detailed and in-depth study of a case (an individual, group, institution, community, event or phenomenon) in its real-life context directed towards introducing necessary intervention and measures (if needed so) in the interest of the case studied or others.

In the light of our formal definition of the term 'case study method' we may mention the following characteristic features of this method.

1. Case study method involves an in-depth, holistic, detailed and longitudinal (running over a long period) study of a case (an individual, a group, institution, community, a contemporary phenomenon or a historical/social event).
2. Carried out in its natural setting and real-life context, the case study method provides a systematic way of looking at events, collecting data, analyzing information and reporting the results in a descriptive and explanatory way.
3. Case study method helps the researchers in gaining a sharpened understanding of why the particular instance/typical behavior pattern/rise and fall in the status happened as it did, and what might become important to look at more extensively in future.
4. Case study method is helpful in carrying out both descriptive and explanatory types of research work in social psychology. In its descriptive form, it may provide a detailed account of the cases studied in reference to its past, present and future prospectus. In its explanatory form, it can help in establishing a cause-effect relationship for the things observed and investigated in the composition and working of the unit studied.
5. The information or data collected in a case study research can be obtained in a variety of ways by making use of multiple sources of evidence, such as administering a questionnaire, holding interviews with the clients (cases under study) and/or their close relatives, conducting surveys and analysis of archival data.
6. As emphasized by Hitchcock and Hughes (1995:317), the case study method possesses several unique hallmarks such as:
 - It is concerned with a rich and vivid description of events relevant to the case.
 - It provides a chronological narrative of events relevant to the case.

- It blends a description of events with the analysis of them.
- It focuses on individual actors or a group of actors, and seeks to understand their perception of events.
- It highlights specific events that are relevant to the case.
- The researcher is integrally involved in the case.
- An attempt is made to portray the richness of the case in writing up the report.

In a nutshell, we may say that when a researcher in a quite straightforward way needs to obtain the description of a single unit (individual, group or institution) in-depth and detail, it is the case study method that may help him in serving his purpose well. Like other behavioral sciences, the use of this method is quite popular in the research work conducted by the social psychologists. As examples of the studies conducted in social psychology with the use of case study method, we may cite the following.

1. Case studies of the communities adopting the practices like killing the girl child after or before birth.
2. Case studies of the communities adopting the practices of honor killing of the couples indulging in inter-caste or inter-faith marriages.
3. Case studies of the prisoners or inmates of a jail.
4. Case studies of the girls adopting the profession of a call girl.
5. Case study of one or the other educational or social institution and business establishment for gathering information about its functioning, sharp rise or surprise fall.

To Sum Up

A method of research known as case study method is used by social psychology researchers in situations when they have to conduct a type of study that may help them in describing the characteristics of an existing individual unit (i.e., an individual, group or a

social system) designated as a case through its in-depth and intensive study. As examples of such studies conducted through the use of this method, we may name them as case studies of the girls adopting the profession of a call girl, or case studies of the communities adopting the practices of honor killing of the couples indulging in inter-caste or inter-faith marriages. The data collected in a case study research can be obtained from a variety of sources by making use of multiple means, such as administering questionnaires, holding interviews with the cases under study including their close relatives, conducting surveys and analysis of archival data, etc. Case study method in its application proves quite useful in getting a detailed account of the cases studied in reference to their past, present and future prospectus. It can also help well in establishing cause-effect relationships for the things observed and investigated in the composition and working of the case/unit studied.

Ethnography

The Random House Dictionary of the English language defines ethnography as “a branch of Anthropology dealing with the scientific description of individual cultures”. When researchers in social psychology intend to avail rich narratives or descriptions of one or other communities and cultures included as an object of their research studies, it is ethnography that may help them in realizing their research objectives. In its use and application ethnography as a research method has its own uniqueness. This fact may surface well before us by looking into its following definitions provided by the imminent social sciences researchers.

Maanen (1996:263): When used as a method, ethnography typically refers to fieldwork (alternatively, participant-observation) conducted by a single investigator who “lives with and lives like” those who are studied, usually for a year or more.

McNeill and Chapman (2005:59): ‘Ethnography’ literally means writing about the way of life, or culture of social groups. At its simplest, it involves the researchers inserting themselves into the natural setting of the social group being studied and participating in and observing their daily activities. Other methods, particularly informal interviews and analysis of documents such as diaries, may be used to sketch out a fuller picture.

Aronson et al. (2020:32): Ethnography is a method by which researchers attempt to understand a group or culture by observing it from inside, without imposing any pre-conceived notions they might have.

Ethnography

A method of research used by the researchers for understanding a group or culture by having first-hand contact with it without disturbing the flow of its normal course through their presence.

These definitions may help us to draw the following essentials about the nature and employment of ethnography as a method of research in social psychology.

- Ethnography as a method of research in social sciences is generally used by researchers for exploring and describing a culture, a way of living and behaving on the part of the members of a group by peeping through into the various aspects, norms and values of the group.
- Ethnography as a method of research is aimed to capture the character of naturally occurring human behavior in its social context by having first-hand contact with it. It is, therefore, conducted in a natural setting – a classroom, a school, a college or some naturally occurring assembly of individuals (i.e., tribal community, market, business establishment). There is no manipulation of variables, simulation or externally imposed structure on the situation.
- In its usual format, almost all the researches utilizing the method of ethnography may be seen to

employ three major data collection techniques: (i) in-depth open-ended interviews; (ii) direct observation; and (iii) written documents. The sole purpose of employing three different collection techniques, individually or in combination, in ethnography is to help the researcher in telling ‘the story’ in narrative form by getting access to a rich treasure of knowledge and information regarding the subjects of his research study.

Traditionally the use of ethnography as a research method was concerned with studying the cultural characteristics of primitive people or tribes. However, as it stands today, it is very much used for the study of behavior and lifestyle of the people belonging to different groups, organizations and communities of all kinds. As a result, the present-day ethnographers may be seen to study schooling, public health, rural and urban development, consumers and consumer goods, or to say any human arena.

To Sum Up

Ethnography as a method of research stands for a type of research work carried out by the researchers in the capacity of participant observers aimed to study the behavior and lifestyles of the individuals belonging to a group or culture through their first-hand contact without imposing any pre-conceived notions they might have. Such research work is, therefore, conducted in a natural setting of the studied groups or cultures without disturbing the normal course of the flow of their activities in any way. In its usual format, the method of ethnography employs three major data collection techniques – in-depth open-ended interviews, direct observation, and written documents, for telling ‘the story’ in narrative form by getting access to a rich treasure of knowledge and information regarding the behavior and lifestyle of the people belonging to the group/community/organization of his research study.

Documentary or Archival Analysis Method

Documentary or archival analysis method, as the name suggests, represents a type of method of investigation in social psychology in which a researcher is required to carry out the task of his research by analyzing the documents or archival record available to him for providing information and evidences related to his research study questions. Based on such simple meaning and concept of documentary or archival analysis research method, we can provide its operational definition as “a form of observational method in which the researcher examines the accumulated documents, or archives of a culture” (Aronson et al., 2020:33).

Documentary or Archival Analysis Method

A method of investigation in which the researchers carry out the task of their investigation by analyzing the documents or archival record available to them for providing information and evidences related to their research.

In this way, it can be easily concluded that in the use of documentary or archival analysis as a method of research, it is availability of the relevant documents and archives that matters most for the researchers in getting answers to their research questions. What are these documents or archives? Let us see.

In a generalized way, the term documents or archives in reference to its use in the documentary or archives analysis research in behavioral sciences including social psychology stands for all those things and material evidences – oral, written or visual – available at present capable of providing information/data about social behavior, social conditions, social institutions and social processes going on in the social world. As examples of such documentary and archival material we may cite the names of the following.

Books, magazines, hand written material, newspapers, diaries, autobiographies and biographies, personal letters and correspondences, speeches, pamphlets and advertisements, suicide notes, public and official records, photographs and artifacts, policy documents, population censuses, court records, congressional records, school and institutional records, cemetery records, audiotapes, video recordings, television shows and movies, social media and the modern means and ways available through internet services like smart phones, Twitter, Facebook, YouTube and web material, etc.

The written, oral and visual materials available through the aforementioned means are then subjected to proper analysis for getting the relevant quantitative and qualitative data to be used by the researchers for answering the research questions of their studies.

In its applications and usefulness, the documentary and archival analysis method is found to carry a lot of advantages and merits for the researchers in social psychology such as the following.

- Through the availability of the documents and archival records for applying this method in their research work, researchers become quite capable of accessing the things and information related to the past otherwise denied to them through other means of data gathering. In fact, a researcher can accomplish with the already existing archival records/documents what was impossible to do with gathered primary data through some other data collecting means. The reason for this is that groups, societies, tribes and movements die, stop or become ‘swallowed’ by modernization and when it has occurred, the only resource to data is the written records or other types of artifacts that are available to help the researchers in getting answers to their research questions.
- In applying this method in their research work, researchers are in a position to get the needed information/data through the already available documents/archival record. It is a welcome sign. Why should one go out into the field for gathering the primary data for his research problem

when perhaps equally good quality of data is already available to him and can be analyzed much more rapidly than the data collected from other sources. It can save a lot of energy and time of the researcher.

- Moreover, life course documents such as diaries, letters, suicidal notes and biographies allow the researchers to have access to intimate and private areas of social life which are difficult for them to normally enter, for example, the area of family life, or sexual practices, and attitude towards 'taboo' subjects such as cancer or death.
- A valuable advantage of using this method lies in the fact that here a researcher has more freedom to work with the documents and records in terms of time and location and can probe within the limits of his resources, the issues that are more difficult in conducting research with people in a living sample (Adams and Schvaneveldt, 1991:304).

To Sum Up

In the use of the documentary or archival analysis method for the research work in social psychology, the researchers are required to analyze the documents or archives available at present to them for their research work. By the term documents or archives here we mean all those things and material evidences – oral, written or visual – worth enough to provide the relevant quantitative and qualitative data to be used by the researchers for answering the research questions of their study. In its applications and usefulness, the documentary and archival analysis method is found to carry a lot of advantages and merits for the researchers in social psychology such as:

- Access to the things and information related to the past otherwise denied to them through other means of data gathering.
- Availability of the needed information through the already available documents/archival record instead of going out into the

field for gathering the primary data for his research problem.

- Access to intimate and private areas of social life of the people which are otherwise difficult for them to enter.
- More freedom to work with the documents and records in terms of time and location and more ease to probe within the limits of his resources, the issues that are more difficult in conducting research with people in a living sample.

Analysis of Data

As discussed earlier, in conducting inquiry or research in the field of social psychology, the researchers try to collect needed information or data by making use of one or the other research methods suitable to them for this purpose. The data gathered from such well-planned efforts during the research study may be quantitative or qualitative in nature.

Quantitative and Qualitative Data

Information gathered in the form of *quantitative data* describe and infer the characteristics of the things, individuals, groups, events and phenomena in their quantitative aspects through quantitative measures expressed in terms of numbers and numerals. You may know well about the nature of this quantitative data by focusing on the scores obtained by you along with your classmates on some achievement, intelligence or aptitude tests.

The qualitative data, on the other hand, stands for describing and inferring the properties and characteristics of a thing, individual, groups, events and phenomena in their qualitative aspects through qualitative measures expressed in variety of ways in a limited number of words.

In the use of naturalistic observation, open ended questions and unstructured interviews in the survey method, as well as collecting information about the individual or groups in the use of case studies and ethnographic researches, we may see that much of the data collected by the researchers are

qualitative in nature. They can exist in both verbal as well as non-verbal symbolic form, audio-video format, written as well oral expression, and any form of the reactions and interpretations made by the researcher of his observations of the people, objects and situations (Miles and Huberman, 1998).

Quantitative and Qualitative Data Analysis

It may be seen that in its original and raw form, the collected data whether quantitative or qualitative can't serve any purpose unless it is subjected to a process known as data analysis for deriving useful conclusions from the research work done by the researcher.

The analysis for deriving meaning from the quantitative data (data available in the form of numbers) is termed quantitative data analysis and that deriving meaning from the qualitative data is termed qualitative data analysis.

In carrying out analysis of their quantitative data the researchers are found to make use of a number of unique non-statistical and statistical methods and techniques broadly classified as follows.

1. Presentation of data in the form of tables, distributions and graphs.
2. Computation of the measures of central tendency – mean, median and mode – measures of variability or dispersion – range, quartile deviation and standard deviation – percentiles, percentile ranks, coefficient of correlation, etc.
3. Making use of some or the other advanced statistical methods and tests such as analysis of variance, analysis of covariance, factor analysis, “t” test, “F” test and non-parametric tests, etc. for drawing necessary inferences and conclusions of the study.

The analysis of all types of quantitative data has now become quite easy as well as sufficiently handy and accurate with the use of the services of computer technology especially in the form of the use of SPSS. The readers may collect information about its use from the resources available online or reading a text meant for this purpose.

The task of carrying out analysis of the qualitative data is quite difficult in comparison to the analysis of the quantitative data as the data here are available mostly in a non-numerical format dominated by words, language and symbolic expression. The researchers have to make use of the specialized methods and techniques for analysis depending upon the nature as well as the objectives of their study. For this purpose, the researchers in social psychology, in general, may be found to carry out the following types of data analysis at one or the other times.

- *Thematic Analysis*: In this type of qualitative data analysis, the data are analyzed with an objective to explain an emerging theme.
- *Comparative Analysis*: This type of qualitative data analysis works on the principle of comparing and contrasting the information/data collected from a variety of sources.
- *Content Analysis*: This type of qualitative data analysis is concerned with the analysis of the contents of the collected data available in various non-numerical forms.
- *Discourse Analysis*: This type of qualitative data analysis is mostly concerned with the analysis of the conversations and interactions carried out with participants of the research study.
- *Narrative Analysis*: In this type of qualitative data analysis, the researcher resorts to the analysis of narratives – a sort of story-like oral or written expositions of the subjects of the study or persons approached for collecting the required information.
- *Summary Analysis*: This type of qualitative data analysis is aimed at providing a direct summary of the collected information/data without resorting to some special technique of data analysis such as thematic, content, discourse or narrative.
- *Mechanical Analysis*: In this type of qualitative data analysis, the data are analyzed with the use of mechanical devices, such as computer technology for taking the services of useful software especially developed for qualitative data analysis.

To Sum Up

After collecting needed information or data in its quantitative and qualitative forms with the use of one or the other research methods, the researchers are needed to engage in the task of data analysis. Here the analysis for deriving meaning from the quantitative data (data available in the form of numbers) is termed quantitative data analysis and that deriving meaning from the qualitative data (data available in the form of words and other symbolic expressions) is termed qualitative data analysis.

For carrying out quantitative data analysis the researchers are found to make use of a number of unique non-statistical methods (e.g., presentation of data in the form of tables and graphs) and statistical methods (e.g., computation of the measures of central tendency, variability, percentiles, percentile ranks, coefficient of correlation, and use of advanced methods for drawing inferences).

For carrying out qualitative data analysis, the researchers have to make use of one or the other specialized methods and techniques for its analysis, depending upon the nature as well as the objectives of their study, named as thematic analysis, comparative analysis, content analysis, discourse analysis, narrative analysis, summary analysis and mechanical analysis.

Ethical Issues in Psychological Researches

It is hoped as well as expected from the researchers in all fields of knowledge to be sufficiently ethical in their research pursuit by following all the norms and values as needed on their part in this concern. Such need and expectations are more intensified in the case of the researchers carrying out investigation or research work in behavioral sciences including social psychology where the human social behavior is the focus and human beings are the subjects of the research study. In general, in this concern, the

researchers in social psychology are required to pay attention over the ethical issues like:

1. The prior consent of the individuals participating as the subjects of the study in the research.
2. The maintenance of the privacy of what has been disclosed or being transacted between them and the researcher.
3. The consideration that the subjects of the study are not put to any harm – physical or psychological – in any way.
4. Debriefing of the participants in case deception (misleading of the participants) has been employed in the study.
5. Being sufficiently objective, truthful, impartial and judicious in collecting data from the subjects in making use of one or the other research methods.
6. Being honest and truthful in data compilation, analysis and drawing conclusions of the study.
7. Sharing the results of the study with the participants of the study.

For addressing all such ethical issues researchers in social psychology are required to focus on the following things.

1. *Seeking Voluntary Participation:* They should always try to seek voluntary participation of the individuals in their study by making the purpose of their study clear and then winning their willing cooperation in this study. In no case should there be any coercion or excessive inducement for this purpose.
2. *Seeking Formal Consent About Their Role:* The participants of the study should be told about their role in the study. What type of information has to be collected from them? What type of experiment is going to be performed over them? The participants should not only be properly aware about it but they should also agree for the same by providing their formal consent.
3. *Maintaining Confidentiality and Privacy:* The participants of the study should be assured fully that what they say and do in response to their role in the study will be a matter of confidentiality.

Their privacy related to answering their private or social life will not be disclosed and they should not have any fear or hesitation on this account. The commitment made so with the participants should then be fully complied on the part of the researcher.

- 4. *Maintaining Fairness in Collecting, Compiling, Analyzing and Concluding About the Study:* The researchers should follow all the needed rules and principles for being properly ethical in respect of all these aspects or elements of the research. They should never show subjectivity and partiality in recording the things they observe, and never resort to the false cooking of the data, or interpret them in their own way for deriving their own conclusions. They should avoid the copying of the other’s research efforts and remain away from the acts of piracy.
- 5. *Debriefing the Participants at the End of the Study/Experiment:* It is the duty as well as moral responsibility of the researchers to do the task of debriefing – explaining the participants of the study, at the end of the study/experiment, its true purpose and exactly what transpired during the study/experiment and why. It is more needed in the case when the researchers in their study makes use of deception – misleading participants about the true purpose of a study or

events that would be actually happening during the experiment/study. In general, although it is always better for the researchers not to allow deception in their study, yet there are situations lying before the researchers in social psychology to put the participants to some inconvenience such as giving them electric shock, or keep them in an emergency conditions for helping them in their study, e.g., studying the helping or non-helping behaviors of the individuals.

- 6. *Sharing the Findings of the Study With the Participants:* In socio-psychological researches the researchers aim to study about one or the other attributes or behavioral functioning of the participants. It is therefore quite natural for the participants to be seriously interested in the findings of the research study for knowing about them. They are found to be eagerly waiting for the same, and researcher should never disappoint them on this account. He should definitely reappear at the scene after having the conclusions of his study with him. With his deliberate efforts of meeting participants in person or contacting them through phone or online meeting he should thank them for their cooperation in the conduct of the study and tell them about what has been resulted in his study.

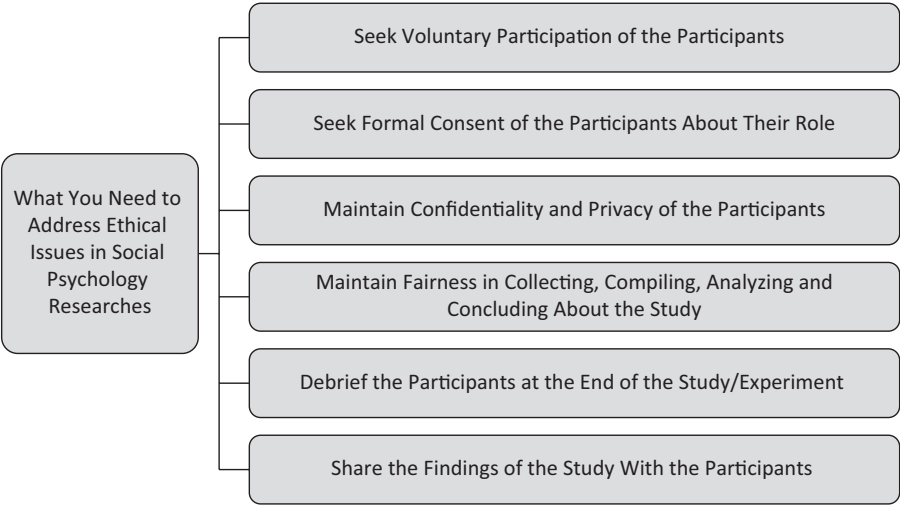


Figure 4.1 Addressing Ethical Issues in Social Psychology Researches

In this way, the researchers in social psychology should feel the necessity of taking the needed precautions and follow the rules and principles for addressing one or the other ethical issues in conducting inquiry and research for answering their research questions. The guidelines provided as well as measures adopted by the Indian government funding as well as research governing agencies such as Indian Council of Social Science Research (ICSSR) and University Grants Commission (UGC) as well as the respective Central and State Universities in this concern, may also help the researchers in this task.

At the international level, they may learn much in this direction, from the ethical guidelines issued by some of the eminent professional organizations such as the American Psychological Association for being followed by the researchers in psychology and its branches, including social psychology.

To Sum Up

It is hoped as well as expected that the researchers in psychology be sufficiently ethical in their research pursuit by following all the norms and values as needed on their part as per direction issued by their own university and the agencies such as UGC, ICSSR and professional organizations working on the national and international levels. In general, in this concern they are required to focus on the things like:

- Seeking voluntary participation of the subjects and seeking formal consent about their role.
- Assuring the participants of the study about maintaining confidentiality and privacy.
- Maintaining fairness in collecting, compiling, analyzing and concluding about the study.
- Debriefing or explaining the participants at the end about the purpose of the study and exactly what transpired during the study/experiment and why.
- Sharing the findings of the study with the participants.

Review Questions

1. What do you understand by the term research or investigation as used in the field of social psychology? Point out the goals of such research or inquiry work undertaken in social psychology.
2. Name the different methods of investigation used by the researchers for conducting research in the field of social psychology and discuss any one of them in detail.
3. What is experimental method of research? How is it utilized by the researchers in social psychology researches? Discuss.
4. What is systematic or naturalistic observation method of research? Explain in detail how is it utilized by the researchers in the social psychology researches.
5. What is the survey method of investigation? Throw light on its nature and discuss how it is utilized by social psychology researchers in their research work.
6. What is correlation method of investigation? How is it used by the researchers in the field of social psychology for conducting their research work? Explain.
7. What is case study method of research? Explain for what type of investigation it is used by the researchers in social psychology and how.
8. What is ethnography? For what type of researches is ethnography utilized as a method of research by the researchers in social psychology and how?
9. What are documents or archives? Throw light on the mechanism of using documentary or archival analysis as a method of investigation in social psychology? Tell in what ways it proves helpful to the researchers in their social psychology researches.
10. What do you understand by the terms data and data analysis? How are the tasks, related to quantitative and qualitative data analysis, carried out in social psychology research or investigation? Discuss.
11. What are the different ethical issues coming out in the way of conducting researches in the field of social psychology? How can these be addressed? Discuss.

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UNIT II

INDIVIDUAL LEVEL PROCESSES



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5.

SOCIAL COGNITION

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- Throw light on the meaning and concept of social cognition.
- Tell what happens in the process of our social cognition.
- Name and discuss the major cognitive strategies involved in our social cognition.
- Explain the roles of schemas and heuristics (mental shortcuts) in our social cognition.
- Throw light on the potential sources of errors in our social cognition.
- Discuss the relationship existing between affect and cognition.
- Elucidate how cognition gets influenced through affect.
- State how affect gets influenced through cognition.

Introduction

Social psychology, the science of social behavior, aims to provide the necessary knowledge and skills for helping us in the execution of our social behavior both at the group and individual levels as effectively as possible. However, for the execution of our social behavior while interacting with others in one or the other social situations what we essentially need is the knowledge and understanding of the things associated with the world of our social interaction at that very time. In other words, here we need to know and understand others, our own self and the environment for carrying out the process of our social interaction and relationships with others and it is that which is helped utmost through the process of our social cognition. Moreover, in knowing and understanding others' social behavior in context to one

or the other social situations, the information gathered through our sense organs, on this behalf, needs to be properly processed in the form of our social cognition involving the mechanisms like attention, memory, perception, learning, thinking and decision making, etc. Our social cognition, in fact, thus plays a quite important role in our social behavior and knowing about the associated social environment. Therefore, it becomes quite important for us to know about the essentials of the concept and process of our social cognition. Let us attempt in doing so in this chapter.

Social Cognition – Meaning and Concept

The word meaning of the term 'social cognition' is the cognition of the social. The term 'cognition' according to *Oxford Advanced American Dictionary*

available online refers to the process by which knowledge and understanding is developed in the mind. The social cognition is, thus, nothing but an act of mental processing on our part for helping us in knowing and understanding about the information available regarding social (the social environment or social behavior of others in one or the other context). For getting acquainted with the meaning and concept of the term 'social cognition' in a more useful way, let us try to concentrate over some of the following definitions provided by the eminent authors and thinkers.

Higgins (2000): Social cognition is the study of how people make sense of other people and themselves, that is, learning about what matters in the social world.

Moskowitz (2005): Social cognition is concerned with the study of the thought processes both implicit and explicit, through which humans attain understanding of self, others and their environment.

Taylor et al. (2006): Social cognition is the study of how people form inference from the social information in the environment.

Baron et al. (2008): Social cognition can be defined as a process by which we interpret, analyze, remember and use information about the social world.

Let us look at the preceding definitions one by one.

- The first definition given by Higgins considers social cognition as the field of study helping people in learning about the ways and means of getting adjusted in their social world. For this adjustment it is quite natural for them to have proper interaction and relationship with each other which further needs knowing, understanding and taking judgment about their self and others on their part. In its totality, thus, the study of social cognition helps us to know and learn what is essential for us to lead our social life in a proper way in the environment in which we live and behave.
- The second definition, given by Moskowitz, considers social cognition as a field of study that provides knowledge to the people about their

mental or thought processes that can prove helpful to them in knowing and understanding their self, others and their environment involved in their social behavior at one or the other times. These mental or thought processes, the applications of which are so essential to our social behavior, may be implicit (unconscious and automatic) and explicit (conscious and deliberate) in their nature. You may have studied them well in the course of your general psychology or cognitive psychology in the name of sensation, perception, attention, memory, thinking, reasoning and inferences drawing, etc.

- The last two definitions consider the task of social cognition, equivalent to the task of information processing, where the information related to the social world of the individuals in the form of sensory input is received as well as processed through their brain by employing the useful cognitive tools/mental or thought processes (such as attention, sensation, perception, previous experiences or learning, remembering, thinking, reasoning and inferences drawing, etc.) for resulting into an output in terms of derived conclusion for behaving in one or the other ways in one or the other social situations.

What has been conveyed and analyzed through the preceding definitions of the term social cognition may help us to derive some of the following conclusions about the meaning and concept of the term social cognition.

- Social cognition helps us to take cognizance of various social signals helpful in knowing and understanding the social world around us.
- Social cognition is the cognition in which we perceive, think about, interpret, categorize and judge our own social behavior and those of others in one or the other social situations.
- Social cognition, while getting equated with the term information processing, refers to the ways in which we try to handle and process the information about our social world (the self, others and the environment) for deriving our own

interpretation and analysis and then remember and use the result in our own ways.

- In the task of information processing of our sensory output about our social world we make use of a number of psychological/mental processes named as sensation, perception, previous experiences and learning in terms of their memory, thinking, reasoning, inferences drawing and decision making, etc. All these cognitive processes are important in social interaction, and the study of information processing in a social setting is referred to as social cognition. The output available through our social cognition (information processing) can then be successfully used for carrying out our interactions at a group or individual level.
- Social cognition, in this way, is concerned with the mental processes that subserve/promote people's understanding of their self, other individuals and the associated social environment.
- The efforts made by us in our social cognition stand for providing us the mechanistic, process-oriented explanations of the complex social phenomena involving human social interactions.

Social Cognition

The type of cognition helping the people in knowing and understanding their social world (the self, others and environment) in one or the other social situation through the application of their thought or mental processes.

The preceding discussion, for understanding the meaning and concept of the term social cognition, may now help us adopt a workable definition of this term in the words that follow.

Social cognition, as a useful topic or area related with the subject social psychology, refers to the study of the type of cognition (act of knowing and understanding) helping the people in knowing and understanding their social world (the self, others and environment) in one or the other social situation through the application of their thought or mental processes.

What Happens in the Process of Our Social Cognition?

Social cognition, as discussed earlier, stands for letting us know and understand others well for carrying out the process of our social interaction and maintenance of relationship with them in one or the other social situations. The question arises how can we know and understand others involved in our social interaction? Surely, the clues for their knowing and understanding are to be supplied by these other persons themselves in the form of what they say and do as well as how they express themselves through their non-verbal behavior involving facial expression, gestures and eye movements, etc. These clues or signals available in their social behavior at the time of our interaction with them are to be properly handled for deriving needed meaning for understanding and knowing them well in furthering the process of social interaction and it is that which is helped through the process of our social cognition. The data available in the form of verbal and non-verbal behavior are to be put under close scrutiny and analysis for deriving one or the other interpretations and conclusions about the social behavior and the personality characteristics of the people involved in the interaction. It is nothing but the task of information processing, the term used in cognitive psychology and computer science for the processing of information or available data for deriving useful conclusions in the form of final output for the needed use on the part of users. Therefore, what happens during our social cognition can be well equated with the task of information processing i.e., processing of information or data available in the form of verbal and non-verbal behavior of the persons engaged in the social behavior at one time or the other.

Our social cognition i.e., the processing of the information or input available in the form of verbal and non-verbal behavior of the persons engaged in social behavior, is carried out through the execution of a number of properly sequenced cognitive or mental processes such as attention, sensation, perception, thinking, reasoning and inference drawing, memorization or remembering for its application and use in

the ongoing or future social behavior. Let us have a look at this sequential happening.

- The work starts through the process of attention and sensation. We attend to what is conveyed by others through their verbal and non-verbal behavior with the help of our sense organs – eyes, ears, nose, touch, smell, etc. It works as input for processing what is received by us through our sense organs.
- The act of perception (meaning derived from the sensory output) is carried out by the brain on the basis of prior knowledge, experience and learning as well as current context.
- The meaning derived through the act of perception is then subjected to further analysis, interpretation, drawing inferences for arriving at decisions to respond and act in a particular way demonstrable well in our behavior at the time of interacting with others.
- In responding to the social behavior demonstrated by others in the ongoing social interaction, in such a particular way, our behavior is also influenced and guided through our perception and understanding about our self. Besides this, it also gets influenced and directed by the type of social situations and environment available at the time of the ongoing social interaction.

of cognitive or mental processes such as attention, sensation, perception, thinking, reasoning and inference drawing, and memorization, etc. carried out by us in a properly sequenced way.

Major Cognitive Strategies Involved in Our Social Cognition

The task of our social cognition involving processing of information about our social world is found to employ some useful cognitive strategies in the name of (i) schemas and (ii) heuristics. Let us examine them.

The Role of Schemas in Our Social Cognition

Schemas employed in our thought process for taking cognizance of the social world in a social situation represent those already existing cognitive or mental structures/frameworks of our mind (built through earlier experiences or exposure in the similar social situations) that come to help us in a quite ready-made fashion for the organization and interpretation of the social information available to us at present on the lines and models inherent in the built up of the one or the other relevant schema.

To Sum Up

Our social cognition helps us in knowing and understanding others well for carrying out the process of our social interaction and maintenance of relationship with them in one or the other social situations. This task of our social cognition is carried out through a phenomenon of information processing – the processing of the input (information available in the form of verbal and non-verbal behavior of the persons engaged in social behavior). In the reception of this input and its subsequent processing for deriving necessary meaning, we are helped by a number

Schemas

The already existing mental frameworks built through earlier experiences in the similar social situations helpful to us in a quite ready-made fashion at present in the similar social situations for the organization and interpretation of the available social information.

Let us illustrate the use of schemas in facing the new situations, related to your social behavior, narrated as follows.

- You visit the place of one of your acquaintances and find that a cake is being cut.

- You try to talk to a person in the party, but he continues to look around somewhere and does not attend to your conversation.
- You meet a person, gent or lady, first time, dressed and behaving in a particular way and now need to have interaction with him/her.

In all such cases, you certainly do not take long to arrive at the conclusion about the things going on in that very social situation. In the first case, you may conclude that there is a birthday or marriage day celebration party. In the second, you immediately take note of getting ignored as the person you are speaking to is not interested in you and needs to avoid you. In the third case, you try to conclude about the expectations from his/her role by concluding about one or other things concerning his/her personality and profession etc.

What makes you reach such a fast conclusion or interpretation of the observed event, behavior of a person, or personality traits visible in them? It seems that there is something already lying in you to help you in processing the input provided by your sense organs in that very social situation in a quite rapid, automatic or mechanical way in the attempt of your information processing or social cognition task. Definitely, here it is so. You are being helped by the particular types of cognitive or mental tools or structures available for your social cognition (information processing) task being performed by you in dealing with the faced situation. It is that which is named as schemas (specific mental frameworks or structures). These schemas of ours are built around one or the other specific themes/concepts associated with our social world involving self, others and the environment. This buildup is resulted through our previous experiences gained in the similarly faced social situations. Their buildup is also affected through a number of other factors such as social norms, traditions, superstitions, stereotypes, attitudes and prejudices, etc. prevailing during the processing of their establishment. In their so built-up form, schemas of ours may be found to play the roles as follows.

- Our schemas guide or dictate often the path of our social cognition, (organization and processing of information) well in one or the other social situations in a quite set, organized and structured form along with a rapid speed. If we look at the instances of our social encounters, it is this help of the buildup of schemas in our mind that eased the task of our social cognition and deriving necessary inferences for our subsequent social behavior in the form of identification of a particular type of celebration by witnessing cutting of the cake, and taking notice of the indifferent attitude and inattentiveness of our friend.
- Our schemas (mental frameworks) built up around specific themes contain information relevant to specific situations or events, which once established, help us interpret these situations and what's happening in them (Baron and Byrne, 2001:77).
- Our schemas in the form of mental framework or structures provide us opportunity to seek a comparison between the features or characteristics of the newly faced situation or stimulus with the abstract mental representation of the same preserved in the form of schemas in our memory.
- Our schemas on account of their possession of the quite useful information relevant to self, people with their characteristics and roles, and specific events related to specific social situations help us in predicting or expecting the similar outcomes or happening of the events in the similar situations and thus making us quite prepared for reacting and responding on our part as per the need of the situation.

Types of Schemas

Schemas in the form of a set mental framework for processing particular types of information related to our social world (associated with the social situations involving events, people and their roles) may be broadly classified into five major types, namely person schemas, self-schemas, event schemas, role schemas and group schemas. Let us examine them.

Person Schemas: These schemas are built up as a result of our past experiences – direct or indirect – in our life with other persons. On the basis of the

inferences drawn through the observation of their personality characteristics and activities (whether in the actual life encounters or at silver screen, cyber and print pages) we have some distinctive mental visualization for categorizing them as the persons belonging to different professions/occupations (i.e., teachers, lawyers, doctors, shopkeepers, laborers, etc.) and personality types (i.e., introvert, extrovert, psychopath, philanthropists, selfish and money minded, socially deviant, etc.). While interacting with the people in social situations, the mental frameworks in the form of personal schemas are found to guide or dictate the path of our social cognition in reacting and responding to them in proportion to the anticipation or expectation of certain types of behavior matching their personality and profession. In this way, when you see people showing discourtesy, losing temper, dishonoring the social norms, or demonstrating altruism in their behavior, the person schemas existing in your mind at once come into operation to suggest why they are behaving in this manner.

Self-Schemas: Instead of helping in the social cognition (organizing and processing of the information) of other persons engaged with us in our social interaction like person schemas, self-schemas prove helpful in knowing and understanding the self for the ongoing task of social interaction and relationship building with others or getting adjusted well in the available social environment in tune with the self-image (i.e., expectations from our own self). The type of self-confidence, self-esteem and self-efficacy visible in the social behavior of individuals at the time of their social interaction is what is resulted through their self-evaluation helped by the type of self-schemas possessed by them.

Event Schemas: Event schemas represent the mental frameworks or structures erected in our mind through the generalization reached about the nature and sequence of one or the other types of events occurring in the form of our real and virtual life experiences or social encounters. The memory of these events lives in our mind as a lively script written on a writing surface. What will precede and follow in a particular social situation, it remains quite clear to

us with the courtesy of the possession of one or the other event schemas knitted with this social situation and accordingly we remain mentally prepared to behave as per demands of the sequence of the occurring social event. As illustration of the event schemas in relation to different segments of our society we may name event schemas for birthdays, weddings, marriage anniversaries, honeymoons, community dinners and even funerals, etc.

Role Schemas: In this category we include the schemas associated with the social roles played by the people in their different walks of social life. The different roles in connection with the fulfilment of one or the other types of social responsibilities or engaging in one or the other types of professions or bread earning occupations are to be played by the people in their social life. We may name and categorize them as (i) professional or occupational role schemas such as the role schemas related to a teacher, bank manager, insurance agent, professional singer, actor or artist; (ii) social responsibility role schemas such as role schemas assigned to parents, children, members of a particular community, a caste or religion. Each and every such role played by the individuals possesses its uniqueness and that is why schemas associated with a specific role contain a lot of information about how individuals, falling in that very role schema, act and behave in their social interaction and what personality characteristics generally they have and accordingly, they prove quite helpful in our social cognition and behaving accordingly in one or the other social situation.

Group Schemas: In accordance with their naming, group schemas are the schemas associated with the composition, working and behaving of the members of a social group or category comprised of a particular community, specific region, gender, caste or religion. Most often these group schemas reflect the stereotypes prevalent in the society and that's why many of the group schemas held by us may contain the information such as women are weak and need protection at all times at the hands of their male counterparts; women are more fearful and religious minded; the people belonging to such and such regions, caste or religion look and behave like this or that. These schemas also like all other previously

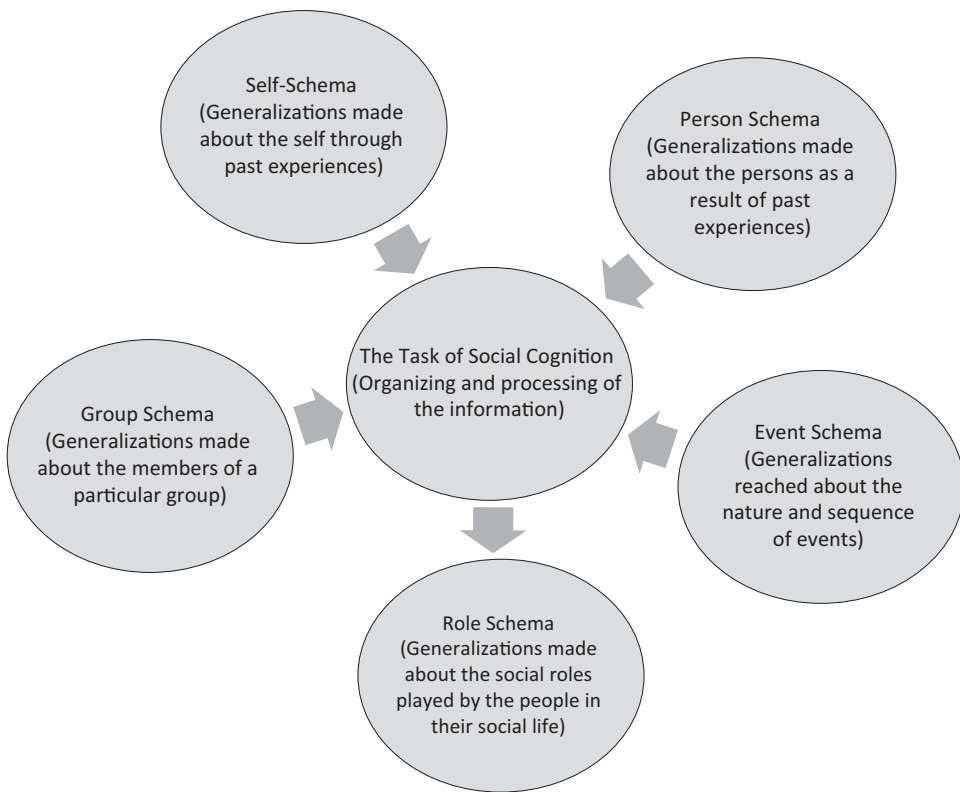


Figure 5.1 Major Types of Schema Guiding Our Social Cognition

mentioned schemas provide a workable base for our social cognition and guide our social behavior in a particular direction.

How does the employment of Schemas as a cognitive strategy influence or affect our social cognition?

The question here may arise, that, in what way does the employment of schemas as a cognitive strategy influence or affect the task of our social cognition (processing of the information related to our social world) in one or the other social situations? In this concern, our schemas (mental frameworks) existing in our mind in their various types are found to provide a quite valuable prompt service in helping a number of cognitive processes associated with our social cognition. In fact, cognizance of what is going on in a particular social situation gets initiated right from getting hold of the associated information in a proper way and it, in turn, needs the caring for

the cognitive processes like attending, encoding and retrieval of the related information. Let us think in this direction.

1. **Assisting in the Attention Paying Process:** One has to be quite selective and focused in his attention while attending to one or the other information related to the field of his social cognition at a particular social situation. The various types of schemas available in the form of mental frameworks, now, here appear to assist us in this venture. As an effective mechanism or cognitive strategy, schemas help us in remaining quite selective and focused on the specific aspects or things concerning our social environment. In our social interaction, when we come across a person, we try to match his personality traits and actions with the schemas available with us. If our schemas tell that he is a teacher,

then we get focused in attending carefully to the expectations we may have from him as a teacher, leaving all other things unconcerned with teacher like actions and behaviors. In a similar way, we are likely to concentrate over the next thing to happen in the chain of one or the other events belonging to our social world (i.e., marriage ceremony, restaurant food eating, etc.) while witnessing the cognition of a particular social event.

Here we see that the stimulus that is coherent/consistent with schemas is more easily noticed than the stimulus that is not fitting with the schemas we hold (e.g., during a cricket match, we quickly notice happenings on the cricket ground as compared to the noise in the stadium). Quite interesting, however, incoherency or inconsistency found in the observable behavior and schemas held may get even more attention in a number of cases (e.g., the person adjudged as a doctor may be seen to act as an insurance agent or show magic tricks). No matter, thus, whether there exists consistency or inconsistency in the matching of the behavior expected through the schemas held by you and behavior demonstrated, the employment of schemas stands useful as an attention paying mechanism in our social cognition.

2. **Assisting in Encoding of the Attended Information:** The information once got through careful attention, needs to be stored in our memory for its proper processing and use. It is done through a process known as encoding and this task of encoding is again very much helped through the assistance of our one or the other types of schemas. Much like what happens in the case of attending to a piece of information, here also the information quite consistent or fit in the frameworks of our existing schemas is more likely to be saved in the long-term memory than the one that is less relevant. (The students of a mathematics class may attend to and remember the things concerning the subject mathematics taught by the mathematics teacher than the moral or discipline related things told by him.) In contrast, you may also remember some

instances which do not at all fit in your schemas. For example, if you enter a railway coach at the time of heavy rush with almost no chance of getting even a standing place but get a seat to sit in, you will not forget the instance, because it was contradictory to your expectations.

3. **Assisting in the Retrieval of the Encoded Information:** Retrieval refers to the processes of recalling the information stored in memory and using it. Like attention paying and encoding, retrieval of information is also well linked to the schemas held by us for helping our social cognition. Moreover, the role performed by the consistency or inconsistency of information with the existing schemas is also similar to that played in the case of paying attention to and storing the attended information, where in many cases we may find that information that is consistent with our schemas is better retrieved by us. Quite contradictory, in other cases, it may also be observed that the information inconsistent with the schemas is more easily stored as well as retrieved by us at the time of its use.

In this way, our schemas are found to cast their valuable impact over the three important processes of the attention, encoding and retrieval of the important information linked with the work of our social cognition at the time of our interaction with the people or social environment.

To Sum Up

We often make use of an important cognitive strategy named as schemas in the task of our social cognition. The term 'schemas' here stands for the types of mental framework possessed by us about the people, things or events built up through our past experiences about them in the similar situation. They are found helpful to us at present in the task of our social cognition in the similar situations.

Schemas in the form of a set mental framework for processing particular type of

information, relating with the social situations may be broadly classified into five major types, namely person schemas, self-schemas, event schemas, role schemas and group schemas built up as a result of our past experiences with other persons, self, social events, social roles and social groups.

In respect of the role played by schemas in our social cognition, we may definitely say that all of our schemas existing in their various types and forms provide a quite valuable prompt service in helping a number of cognitive processes such as attending, encoding and retrieval of the related information each of which is found to play a quite key role in the task of our social cognition.

heuristic can be used as a means and mode of making use of one's cognitive skills for drawing the needed inferences and conclusions from the available information input. In their nature and application, thus, heuristics may be known as the rules of thumb or mental shortcuts that help us in reducing our mental efforts in relation to making complex decisions and drawing inferences on our part at the time of need in a quite speedy and efficient way.

Heuristics

The rules of thumb or mental shortcuts that help us in reducing our mental efforts in relation to taking complex decisions and drawing inferences on our part at the time of need in a quite speedy and efficient way.

The Role of Heuristics (Mental Shortcuts) in Our Social Cognition

The task of social cognition in the execution of social behavior on our part in one or the other social situations requires the processing of information (input) available to us in a quite proper and fruitful way. Such processing requires a lot of hard work as well as the quite wise use of the cognitive skills owned by us. It is a serious challenge because there is always a limit in the use of our cognitive skills, and the scope of getting bombarded with a fund of information coming to us from a number of stimuli is limitless. No doubt, we are helped on this front by the role played by our schemas through their mechanism of encoding and retrieval of the selective information, but it is not sufficient. We certainly require some more efficient mechanisms to increase or stretch our cognitive skills for meeting out the situation of information overload as well as quickening and simplifying the employment of these cognitive skills by reducing the mental efforts performed on this account. The use of heuristics may serve this purpose. Let us see what these heuristics are.

The word heuristic owes its origin from a Greek word '*heurisko*' meaning 'to discover'. As a cognitive strategy in the field of social cognition thus the term

A lot of research work was done in the field of the use of heuristics in this concern at the hands of American scholars Amos Tversky and Daniel Kahneman in the 1970s and early 1980s. While pointing out the contribution of one or the other types of heuristics in one's quick and efficient decision making, they also have mentioned the fallacy or errors surfaced in the use of these mental shortcuts at the hands of the users in one or the other situation. We are here carrying out the necessary discussion on this account by broadly categorizing the heuristics used in our social cognition as (i) representativeness heuristic, (ii) availability heuristic, (iii) anchoring and adjustment heuristic and (iv) simulation heuristic.

Let us discuss all these heuristics one by one.

Representativeness Heuristics

As discussed earlier, we possess a number of schemas (mental frameworks) associated with the personality traits, roles, social events and groups of the people belonging to our social world. These schemas, while placing before us the mental portraits of the typical personality traits and actions of the people and sequencing happening in the social events, may work as a good description for

the classification of people and events in specific categories. When we are faced with the task of social cognition of the people behaving and events occurring in our present environment, the schemas held in our cognitive structure may work as a good representative or yard stick for drawing inferences or prediction about their social behavior or the occurring of events. For example, when we witness the events of a particular social ceremony, we try to match them with the schemas of the similar social event already held in our cognitive structure. Similarly, when we observe a person looking like and behaving as a particular type or category of person (e.g., lawyer, dancer, introvert, extrovert, etc.), the person and role schemas work as a good guide for the anticipation of social behavior of the concerned person. In this way, when behavioral characteristic of a person or likelihood of an event is judged on the basis of the extent that it represents the essential features of the concerned schemas held by us, the heuristic strategy applied in this situation is named as representativeness heuristics. Its application provides us an immediate shortcut means for the cognition of the nature and expected behavior of the persons in our social interaction simply by matching their appearance and behavior with the personality characteristics and behavior of the people of the same types or categories existing in our schemas (mental frameworks). In short, thus, the use of the representative heuristics on our part at any juncture of our social interaction helps us in deciding if a particular person or event belonging to our social world is an example of a particular person, role, event or group schemas held in our cognitive structure.

Representative Heuristics

A type of heuristics used in our social cognition for taking judgment about a particular person, role, event or group in the light of the resemblance with the related schemas existing in our mental framework towards them.

The question here may arise, are such judgments or inferences drawn through the use of representativeness heuristics accurate? As we know these inferences and conclusions are the results of a quite reasonable matching between the observed characteristics and behavior of the people in our present social interaction with their schemas held in our cognitive structure. Once categorized and counted as the representative of a set schema they cannot be expected to behave and act otherwise. We may, thus, here claim that to a large extent in majority of the cases the judgments are accurate. However, it is not to be guaranteed so in all cases. There are occasions, when judgments based on representativeness heuristics are wrong. A person adjudged as fashionable and extroverted on the basis of his present observation may be truly quite introverted and simple in his living. A lady thought to be a professional dancer on the basis of her performance in a classical dance venture may be found to be working and behaving as a professor of mathematics in her social life. In this way, there may be so many exceptions that may prove that the representativeness heuristic, although useful, can lead to serious errors in at least some instances. In addition, reliance on this heuristic can trap us to fall in other problems such as (i) to overlook other types of information that may potentially be very useful, and (ii) to get engaged in harmful practices based on gender biases, caste, religion, region and language based discriminatory behaviors in the society.

Availability Heuristics

The availability heuristic refers to a strategy in which we try to make use of what is easily available or comes first in the mind for judging and concluding about the information linked to our social world. If we are asked to conclude about the possibility of young people getting a heart attack, one is sure to take help from the cases of acquaintances, readily available in one's mind for the purpose. Interestingly, those who have lower instances in their mind will conclude fewer chances in comparison to those who have more cases of heart attack in their readily available memory stock. The similar thing may also occur if we are asked to comment over the divorce

rate or corruption prevailing in government offices. Most probably here we will try to rate these social phenomena on the basis of what is easily available to us in the form of our memory or experiences for the happenings to our friends, relatives or known acquaintances including ourselves. Taking clues from such instances Barrett (2017:92) has defined the term availability heuristic as “mental shortcuts in which people judge the frequency or likelihood of an event based on how easily relevant examples come to mind”. The socio-psychologists Tversky and Kahneman (1982) conducted an experimental study in support of this heuristic. Let us examine it.

In their study, Kahneman and Tversky asked the subjects of the study to judge whether the letter ‘K’ would appear more frequently at first place or third place in all English language words. The majority among the subjects answered first place. This simply happened because it is easier for us to think of such words, and therefore, they are readily available to us in our memory. We can think of many more words that begin with letter ‘K’ than that have letter ‘K’ in the third position. With the results of their experimental study then they tried to establish the role of availability heuristics as the strategy of making judgments or deriving conclusions in a social situation on the basis of how easily the specific information relevant to the situation can be brought to mind.

Availability Heuristics

The type of heuristics used in our social cognition in which we try to make use of what is easily available or comes first in the mind for judging and concluding about the information linked to our social world.

However, as happens with representativeness heuristic, availability heuristic may also lead to errors in decisions and judgments. Based on the readily available information in their memory that one of their acquaintances, a chain smoker as well as drinker, lived a quite long life of more than 90 years,

a person may be found to assert that neither smoking nor drinking is injurious to health. We can here easily notice how erroneous their conclusion is that is based on a single exceptional case readily available in their memory.

Anchoring and Adjustment Heuristic

Anchoring heuristic is a heuristic strategy used for judging and interpreting any ambiguous information by reducing its ambiguity with the help of anchoring. Anchoring, as emphasized by Wyer (1976), here, stands for the tendency to be biased towards the starting value (or anchor) in making quantification judgments. In the course of judging any ambiguous information or assessing the probability of an event, people start with an implicitly suggested reference point (anchor) and make adjustments to it to reach their estimate. Since the application of this strategy calls for the use of the two separate mechanisms anchoring and adjustment, the strategy is named as anchoring and adjustment heuristic. As a whole here in the application of this strategy we begin with a first approximation (anchor) and then make adjustments to that approximation based on additional information. For illustrating the mechanisms of this strategy, Tversky and Kahneman (1974) conducted a study. Let us examine it.

In this study Tversky and Kahneman asked the subjects to guess the percentage of African nations which are members of the United Nations. For helping them in their guess work, there was a mechanical arrangement in the form of a moving wheel of fortune. This wheel of fortune had numbers on it from 0 to 100 and was rigged to stop either at 10 or 65. Every time when wheel was spun and got stopped with a guessing number 10 or 65, the subjects of the study were asked to base their guess work on the lucky number available (either 10 or 65) to them for this purpose. In this way, the subjects of this study were automatically divided into two separate groups – one using 10 as an anchor (reference point) and the other using 65 as the reference point for its guessing. After the stopping of the wheel, specifically the question put to each of them one by one was: *You have a displayed number 10/65 before you. Do you think the*

percentage of the African countries who are the members of United Nations is higher or lower than this displayed number?

At the end of the study, it was seen that the subjects who had number 10 displayed on their wheel reported that 25% of African countries were members of the United Nations and the group who had number 65 displayed on the wheel reported that 45% of the African countries were the members of United Nations. The results of the study thus clearly revealed the effect of anchoring mechanism on the behavioral responses of the subjects. The subjects gave answers by making adjustment around the anchors available to them and thus the subjects under high anchor condition judged the percentage of African nations much higher than those who were in low anchor condition.

Anchoring and Adjustment Heuristics

The type of heuristics used in our social cognition in which we make use of a mechanism known as anchoring and adjustment – using some approximation (number, value or description) for our initial judgment and then having a needed adjustment for our final decision.

A similar pattern of behavior is found to follow in the use of anchoring and adjustment heuristic in our day-to-day life matters. In the bargaining market whenever we want to sell or buy something, we always go for adjusting our bargain around the anchor (initial price quoted by us or the person in bargain). Here in the deal, a price is initially quoted by the seller or buyer and then attempts are made to settle the deal around that price (the anchor).

In this way, in general our deals and bargains in the market are found to be affected to a great extent by the mechanism of anchoring and adjustment (using some value as an initial point and then adjust the final judgment).

Simulation Heuristics

Simulation is a kind of assumption or re-creation of a particular appearance or form. Its adoption as a heuristic strategy for the social cognition enables the

people to draw inferences in any encountered social situation through the creation of some hypothetical scenarios in their mind. According to Sears et al. (1991), the use of simulation heuristic represents a tendency to think on our part that the events or situations that can be easily simulated mentally or imagined, are more likely to occur.

Simulation Heuristics

A type of heuristics used in our social cognition that enables us to draw inferences in any encountered social situation through the creation of some hypothetical scenarios in our mind.

In general, we can make use of simulation heuristic in the social cognition related to various tasks, including prediction, causality and affective responses. In the cognition or thinking about a social situation, thus, here attempts are made to imagine or recreate the hypothetical scenarios in the mind.

To Sum Up

Another important cognitive strategy used on our part in our social cognition is known by the term heuristics. As a strategy here we can understand it as the rules of thumb or mental shortcuts that help us in reducing our mental efforts in relation to taking complex decisions and drawing inferences on our part at the time of need in a quite speedy and efficient way.

In this concern, the heuristics used in our social cognition may be broadly categorized as (i) representativeness heuristic (helpful in taking judgment in our social cognition in the light of the resemblance with the related schemas existing in our mental framework), (ii) availability heuristic (making use of what is easily available for taking judgment in our social cognition for judging and concluding

about the information linked to our social world), (iii) anchoring and adjustment heuristic (initially using some approximation followed by a needed adjustment for the final decision) and (iv) simulation heuristic (taking judgment about our social cognition through the creation of some hypothetical scenarios in mind).

The Potential Sources of Errors in Our Social Cognition

While taking cognizance of the things related to our social world with the application of our cognitive abilities and trying to remain almost correct and reasonable (as claimed by us in general) from our side we are likely to make errors in drawing conclusions and making judgments in our social cognition. Why does it happen? What are the potential sources or reasons for the surfacing of the errors in our social cognition? The researchers and thinkers in social psychology with the help of their studies and research work have arrived at some of the potential sources and reasons as discussed next.

1. Negative Bias

It is the human tendency that we are attracted and pay more attention and cognition to things which are negative in nature. We may be found, in general, to be driven more towards noticing and responding to the angry, fearful and painful expressions (verbal or non-verbal) of the persons in interaction in comparison to the neutral and happy ones. Similarly, among the news appearing in the daily newspapers the news related to negative social behavior such as rape, murder, robbery, cybercrimes, etc. catch our attention and are read more than the other types of positive and socially useful information available in them. It can lead us to conclude that there is no positivity/good behavior, humanity and socially desirable behavior left in our society. Here, our thought process gets quite derailed instead of remaining relatively objective and unbiased. This tendency of

ours to be increasingly sensitive to negative information or negative stimuli of our social environment in comparison to the positive ones is referred to as the negative bias playing its part in the task of our social cognition.

It is a well-recognized fact that one has a greater chance of committing errors in deriving conclusion from the available information if one's judgment gets biased for one or the other reasons. Focusing attention and giving more weight to the negative features in the cognition of things related to the social world at the cost of neglecting or sidelining the positivity lying in them, may lead to serious errors in the derivation of inferences and making judgment in the task of related social cognition. Under the influence of such negative bias playing its role in our judgment making, we may make mistake of setting aside a number of positive features available in the personality and social behavior of an individual in our interaction with him by simply giving more attention and weight to a minor thing negative in his/her personality characteristics, appearance, dressing, table manners or social etiquettes.

2. The Optimistic or Positivist Bias

The optimistic and positivist bias refers to the tendency to remain an optimist and expect the overall outcomes as positive. The presence of this bias in the people works just opposite to the negative bias held by them in their information processing task. However, like negative bias it also brings error and fallacy in the task of judgment making on the part of individuals in their social cognition. Its harmful effects can be felt in many of their actions and behaviors related to their social life. In this concern, Shepherd et al. (1996) through their research work have pointed out two common aspects or types of the optimistic or positivist bias in the names of over-confidence barrier and planning fallacy. Let us examine them.

In its demonstration on our part, the over-confidence barrier refers to the tendency to be more confident about the accuracy of our judgments related to our social cognition than what is justified in a particular situation. Acting and behaving under the spirit of this bias leads us to errors in our social

cognition. Here, the excessiveness in over confidence may make us not take care of the necessary precautions and think about the possible obstacles and dangers in the path of our accomplishment resulting in making us err in our proper judgments.

Another form of optimistic/positivist bias is demonstrable in the shape of planning fallacy. In the adoption of this bias in our social cognition, we are found to be unrealistically optimistic about the planning made by us in relation to the performance of our task particularly in our estimations of time to do the task. As a matter of definition, the bias related to planning fallacy refers to the tendency to be unrealistically optimistic about how long a given task will take for its final completion. Here we are led, mistakably, to believe that we can do more work in a given period of time than actually or realistically is possible and it is what makes us err in our judgments.

3. Counterfactual Thinking

In terms of its word meaning, counterfactual literally means 'contrary to the facts'. In its practice and application, thus, the term counterfactual thinking stands for the tendency shown or practice followed on our part to imagine alternative versions or other outcomes of the things that actually occurred in the past or are occurring in the present in our social situations.

In making use of this practice, we are often seen in the grip of a line of thought such as "It has happened in this way on account of doing and performing in this particular way. What would have been there if it had been done in some other way?"

Counterfactual Thinking

The tendency on our part to imagine alternative versions or other outcomes of the things actually occurring in our social situations. There are two types of counterfactual thinking. One is upward counterfactual thinking (evaluating a social situation better than actual), and the other is downward counterfactual thinking (evaluating a social situation worse than actual).

As a result, when you come to know that one of your students has missed his merit by so narrow margin, you may begin to think that it could not have been if he had listened to your advice of paying a little more attention to the study of social sciences. Similarly, the act of counterfactual thinking may be said to be in function on your part after missing an international flight and thinking in the ways like what would it have been if you got started a little earlier or picked up another route. With these instances, however, it should not be understood that our thinking in some counterfactual way is limited to the happenings of the past or negative events. We may be found to be busy in our counterfactual thinking when we are in the grip of positive happenings with ourselves or others in our social company. He has survived the attack of some fatal disease, had it not been so, what would have been happening to his family? I had somehow got my train to join my newly sought job, what would be happening, if I wouldn't have started at that time? In this way, the range and field of our counterfactual thinking is quite wide and it influences our social cognition in a variety of ways by providing simulation of alternatives to past or present factual events or circumstances.

In general, the thought process in our counterfactual thinking is found to drift in two different directions – one positive and upward and the other negative and downward. Let us illustrate it with some examples.

Example 1: You have missed the gold medal in your sport event by a quite narrow margin. You may think: (i) I have been quite unfortunate, and I could have done better or (ii) I have been in a position to bring silver to my country, and I will be winning gold in the next round.

Example 2: You are informed about the death of one your relatives in a particular hospital. You may think: (i) It has been a mistake, had it been some other good hospital, his life could have been saved or (ii) attempts were made to provide medical assistance in time, but nothing could be done against the wishes of God.

The counterfactuals thinking, exemplified through the former, listed as (i), statements in both these examples, is technically named as downward

counterfactual thinking. It comes into picture when our thought process results in evaluating or judging a social situation worse than actual.

On the other hand, the counterfactuals thinking, exemplified through the latter, listed as (ii), statements in both these examples, is technically named as upward counterfactual thinking. It comes into picture when our thought process results in evaluating or judging a social situation better than actual.

Our counterfactual thinking in all the situations of our social cognitions is found to provide a strong bias to our thought process in arriving at a conclusion. For example, if you have been fined and your vehicle has been impounded on account of serious violation of traffic rules. Your thought process now may run in different directions such as you may think that (i) I could bribe the official, (ii) Why didn't I make use of my higher contacts, (ii) It was a serious mistake on my part, with the check in time, I have been saved to face an unimaginable accident. Although the process of such counterfactual thinking (alternative happening) on our part almost goes in a quite automatic fashion, our proper reasoning and willing attempts may turn the direction of our thought process on a positive beneficial side such as teaching us a lesson not to repeat our mistake of breaking the traffic rules in the future.

4. Thought Suppression

The act of suppression of thoughts may be understood as an active effort on our part to block or manage one or the other thoughts of ours from entering into our consciousness. It is often found that on account of one or the other reasons some people want to get away from thinking about some or the other things or events associated with their social world. Since the mere memory of or thinking about these things or events results in a lot of inconvenience and mental disturbance to them, they attempt to avoid them through the mechanism of thought suppression. In view of Wegner (1992) the mechanism of thought suppression is carried out by us in two stages named as monitoring and operating. At the monitoring stage of our thought suppression, the identification of an unwanted disturbing thought is

carried out by us in an automatic way. After then, at the operating stage effortful deliberate attempts are made by us to get rid of the disturbing thoughts by finding something else to think about.

A number of fears, phobias and anxiety producing reactions fixed in the minds of the individuals may force them to remain away from the social interaction and cognition of the things and situations associated with these reactions. No doubt, our resorting to the mechanism of thought suppression may help us for the time being in remaining mentally healthy by keeping us away from the disturbing and unpleasant thoughts. However, it neither provides us a proper prevention for the impairment of our mental health on account of these thoughts, nor saves us from becoming a victim of errors in our social cognition. Suppression of anything, as you know, may take us away from that thing for a temporary period, but the thing remains there in our mind and has all possibility of coming out with a force in future. Moreover, in resorting to thought suppression, we have to drift away from the natural flow of our thought process by trying to think about something else. We do not pay attention to a thing or do not get engaged in its cognition simply because we don't like it or it pinches us. It certainly creates problems in our awareness of a number of things or events the thinking of which undergoes suppression on our part. Our feelings and behaviors can't remain normal and natural at this stage and it is definitely going to adversely affect or bring error in the task of our social cognition.

5. The Phenomenon of Magical Thinking

Socio-psychologists (Zusne and Jones, 1889; Rozin and Nemeroff, 1990; Keinan, 1994) through their observations and studies have pointed out a phenomenon named magical thinking responsible for bringing serious error in our social cognition. Here, we find a type of thinking involving assumption that does not hold under rational scrutiny, but still individuals are compelled to believe in them; it has been termed as magical thinking.

For understanding the nature and implications of such type of thinking, let us acknowledge it

through an example very often cited by authors writing on social psychology.

You are offered an eatable such as a chocolate that has a peculiar shape of an insect, cockroach or lizard. Would you like to eat it? Most probably you would not. But why when as a rational being you properly know that its resemblance like such has nothing to do with its taste and quality? It is simply because here your thought process is very much influenced by the type of thinking named as magical thinking.

The influence of such magical thinking is also visible when we are found to act and behave under the grip of one or the other superstitious beliefs (i.e., a cat crossing your path, a fear of number of 13) and stereotypes (i.e., women are inferior to men in terms of performing intellectual and managerial tasks). Although as a progressive individual having faith in scientific values, we do not at all support such beliefs and stereotypes, yet, can we say with utmost honesty that our thought process and behavior are not at all affected by such superstitions and stereotypes. Certainly, to some extent, it affects our thought process creating the possibilities of bringing errors in our social cognition.

6. Dominance of Intuitive Thoughts Over the Rational

For our understanding the social world, we have two modes or approaches at our disposal – one is to make use of deliberate rational thinking (governed through basic rules of logic) and the other is to go with our intuition or gut-level feelings. It is no secret that the former mode of thinking leads us to arrive at the properly processed and systematically analyzed inferences and conclusions about our social world. However, as a matter of ease and convenience we are found in general to be going with our intuition or gut-level feelings for taking cognizance of the social world including understanding others and their behaviors. Here it is important to mention that as a rational being, we certainly are well acquainted with the fact that a systematic well-planned logical approach is the only viable approach for deriving valid conclusions in our social cognition. But why then are we inclined to make use of the shortcuts or easy paths governed by our intuitive or gut-level

feelings? For its illustration, let us imagine a situation described by Kirkpatrick and Epstein (1992) in the following words.

You are shown two bowls containing red jelly beans and white jelly beans. One holds a single red bean and nine white ones; the other holds 10 red beans and 90 white ones. Further, imagine that you will win money each time you select (blindfolded) a red bean. From which bowl would you prefer to draw? Rationally, it makes no difference: the chances of winning are exactly 10% in both cases. But, if you are like most people, you'd prefer the bowl with one hundred beans. In fact, in several studies, more than two thirds of the participants given this choice preferred the bowl with the large number of jelly beans; and even more surprisingly they were willing to pay money to guarantee this choice.

We in our social life face so many situations like this and are seen to make the similar choice of preferring the large bowl of jelly beans on account of our going with intuition or gut-level feelings (believing that there are more chances to win) instead of being rational (judging that odds of winning are the same in both cases). In this way, wherever we sacrifice rationality for picking up an easy path led by our intuition or gut-level thinking, we invite the chances of committing errors in our social cognition.

7. Being Too Rational or Too Much of a Thinker

There should be no controversy in accepting that we can know our social world best by adopting a rational or logical approach in our thinking for its study and cognizance. But as you know there is always a limit for the use and operation of a thing resulting in the desired outcomes. Excess of anything is bad, and it equally applies to our being rational in our social cognition. Excessive reliance on rational thinking or becoming too rational in one's thought process may derail and complicate the journey of information processing needed for immediate understanding and behaving in our social world. There are situations where simple common sense, our experience in the similar situations, use of one or the other schemas (mental frameworks) and heuristics, or scaffolding, etc. may serve our purpose well with a greater ease,

convenience and satisfaction for arriving at a proper decision in our social cognition and interaction with others. However, observation of too much sensitivity for being rational and logical in one's thinking may result in great confusion and frustration on the part of the individuals involved in such a social interaction at one or the other time.

To Sum Up

It is not at all unusual for us to make errors in drawing conclusions and making judgments in our social cognition. The potential sources and reasons responsible for these errors have been identified by the researchers as:

- *Negative bias* (the tendency to get attracted and pay more attention and cognition to things which are negative in nature).
- *Optimistic or positive bias* (the tendency to remain optimistic and expect the overall outcomes to be positive).
- *Counterfactual thinking* (the tendency to imagine alternative versions or other outcomes of the things actually present in the social situations).
- *Thought suppression* (an active effort on our part to block one or the other thoughts of ours from entering into our consciousness).
- *The phenomenon of magical thinking* (a type of thinking involving an assumption that does not hold under rational scrutiny, but still we are compelled to believe in them).
- *Dominance of intuitive thoughts over the rational* (making use of the shortcuts or easy paths governed by our intuitive or gut-level feelings instead of rational thinking governed through basic rules of logic).
- *Being too rational or too much of a thinker* (too much involvement in thinking with the observation of too much sensitivity for being rational and logical).

Relationship Between Affect and Cognition

Our social behavior is composed of three interconnected and interdependent aspects or components of our behavior – cognitive, affective and conative. What we think (our cognition), feel (our affective behavior) and do (our motor responses) in one or the other social situation in its compact form, thus, constitute our behavior in that situation. In this way, while the cognitive aspect of our behavior is concerned with the task of cognition carried out through the cognitive processes (such as sensation, perception, thinking, reasoning, memorization, decision making, etc.) the affective aspect of our behavior i.e., what we are feeling at a particular time period is reflected through our mood (happy or sad) and expression of emotions (positive or negative). There exists a strong bond in the form of reciprocal relationship between the cognitive (thinking) and affective (feeling) aspects of our behavior each influencing and affecting the other in one or the other ways during our social interaction. Let us examine their relationship and interdependence.

How Cognition Is Influenced Through Affect

The task of our social cognition passes through a number of cognitive processes such as paying attention to a stimulus, its sensation, perception, memorization, and use of thinking, reasoning, creative imagination and inference drawing on our part. All these associated cognitive processes are found to be greatly influenced through the positive and negative states of our affective behavior that are governed through the positive and negative feelings or emotions experienced by us at one or the other time and appear before us and others in the form of our pleasant (happy) and unpleasant (sad) moods.

The state of our mood – pleasant or unpleasant – influences in a considerable way our cognition related to the social world. You may yourself feel and experience this magic of mood in your day-to-day behavior. When you are in pleasant and cheerful mood everything around you seems to be quite good and better for you than usual. The scene is altogether altered when you are in an unpleasant and sad mood;

then the whole world looks quite deserted, full of sorrow and grief. Since our mood is found to influence almost everything concerning our cognition attention, sensation, perception, memory, thinking, reasoning and conclusion drawing, therefore what we perceive, think and infer about the things related to our social world at a particular moment depend too much on the nature of our mood existing at that very time.

In fact, how we will react and behave in a particular social situation depends much on the states of our mood. The boss is not in a good mood, papa is disturbed/angry; let us wait for their normal and pleasant mood. These are the common sayings about the impact of our mood on our social behavior. Let us examine further such impact of the states of our mood upon some of the important processes related to our social cognition.

Mood and Memory: What we store in our memory and its timely retrieval is very much affected through the states of our mood. The normal and pleasant mood works as a strong motivator, and fertile ground for the germination and flowering of the desirable fruits in the form of proper gaining of the desired information, its storage in our memory and then its proper retrieval at the time of need. The

reverse happens at the state of our unpleasant and disturbing mood. In studying the impact of mood on memory on an extensive scale, researchers have concluded about the two important effects or impacts in the name of (i) mood dependent memory and (ii) mood congruent memory.

In terms of the possession of a mood dependent memory, we are found to retrieve a piece of information or learning material in a better way in the mood in which it was received or learned. For example, if we store in our memory something in a positive mood, then we are more likely to retrieve it in our positive mood.

In terms of the possession of a mood congruent memory, we are found to retrieve a piece of information or learning material in a better way depending upon its congruency (consistency) with the present mood. If at present you are in a positive mood then the positive information will be retrieved in a better way from the storage of your memory, but in case you happen to be in negative mood, then it will be the negative information that can be retrieved better on your part. As a conclusion, thus, here your mood serves as a filter allowing the proper retrieval of positive or negative information, depending upon its congruency (consistency) with your present mood.

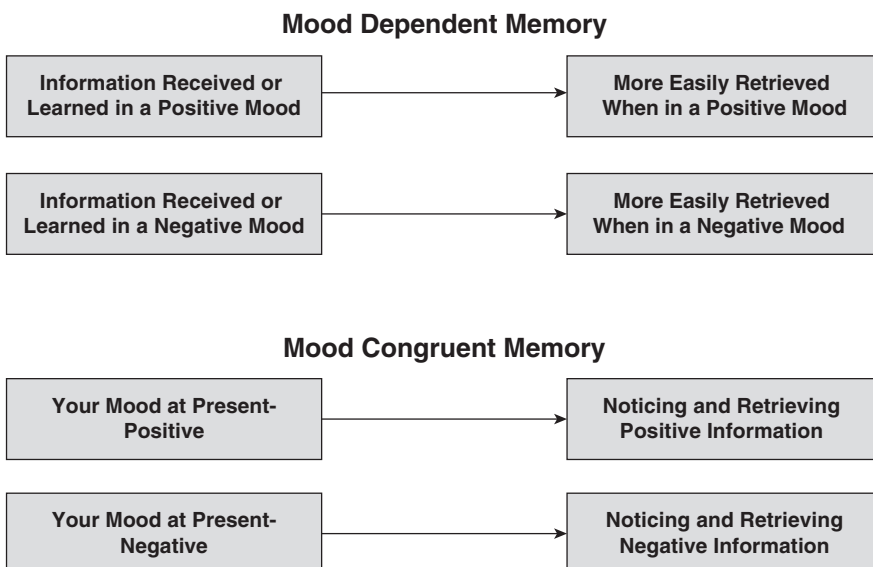


Figure 5.2 The Impact of Positive and Negative Moods on Memory

Mood and Higher Order of Thinking: The positive mood is helpful in creating such conducive motivating and pushing environment that may allow or encourage people to get engaged in the proper processing of the social information with the use of higher order thinking and creative abilities. What we term as flying in imagination, building castle in the air or creating new unparalleled innovative associations are mostly the product of the positivity of one's mood. Trying for the best possible shortcuts/heuristics and properly framed schemas for the use in one's social cognition also depends upon the positivity or negativity of one's mood.

Mood and Judgment: The states of our mood also cast their positive and negative impact upon our judgmental abilities in the social situations. There is a popular saying about the mood of examiners/paper checkers playing its role in assigning marks: "The delta marked on your answer book may be the outcome of a paper checker who had a fresh quarrelling with his wife." There is no exaggeration in such saying, as the spoiling of the mood may disturb the equilibrium of the people for using their cognitive abilities in a proper way for arriving at valid conclusions and judging a situation in a proper way. On the other hand, in a positive mood, People get free hand and positive environment to make use of their cognitive abilities for having more transparency and accuracy in their judgments.

Mood and Attribution: There is a quite positive correlation between the states of our mood and our assigning of motives to others' behavior. In a negative mood we usually try to seek deficiency and negativity in others' behavior and the things lying in the social environment for our failures and losses. However, in the case of having positive mood we tend to attribute positive motives to others' behavior in comparison to what we do in our negative mood.

Apart from talking about the role of our moods in affecting our social cognition, it is also quite imperative here to take into account the role of our feelings and emotions in affecting and influencing the processes involved in our social cognition.

Our emotions represent the agitated states of our mind and body. The core of an emotion is an intensive feeling and in the expression of emotions –

positive or negative – the intensity of our feelings is found to affect and influence almost all the processes associated with our social cognition in a quite adverse way. In the intensive current of our emotions – positive or negative – we can't remain focused on our targeted stimulus, can't receive information from our social world in a proper form, and can't think and reason in its natural way for arriving at the valid and justified conclusion for our social cognition. Just imagine the state when you are in the grip of one or the other negative emotions such as anger or fear. In this state of your mind, it is not at all unusual for you to misjudge and misinterpret what is said, gestured and acted on the part of the people in your conversation or interaction. Not only in the grip of the negative emotions but also under the current of positive emotions such as love and lust, we are forced to act and behave blindly with no assistance from our power of thinking and reasoning. The sayings like "love is blind" justify the closure of the doors of proper cognition on our part for taking appropriate decision on the basis of the employment of our cognitive abilities in a proper way.

How Affect Is Influenced Through Cognition

In a quite reciprocal way, where we find that our affective behavior reflected through our moods, feelings and emotions influences our cognition, cognition in its turn can prove itself a potent force in influencing our affective behavior (moods, feelings and emotions) in a considerable way. Let us see how.

Nothing is good and bad; it is our thinking or cognition that it makes it so. This popular saying carries a wide implication in acquainting us with the effect and impact of our thinking or cognition on our moods, feelings and emotions. We get attracted, feel happy and pleasure, appreciate it on one or the other grounds, and fall in love with it, only after going through its cognition in some ways. We become sad or happy, feel angry, get feared, develop envy and jealousy in our social behavior only after being helped through one or the other processes associated with our social cognition. When people in our interaction convey something through their

verbal and non-verbal behavior, we neither feel nor express any emotions in response to their utterances before we make meanings about it through our cognition machinery. Even when people say something provocative, insulting and threatening, in their language (unknown to us), we do not show any symptom of feeling displeasure or getting angry or feared. It may also happen with the people who are mentally retarded. They do not react and respond with any corresponding feelings of pleasure or displeasure to any negative comments or happenings to them simply because they have no proper cognition about these on account of their low intellectual potential. The children who have not developed cognition about fear from the snake or other harmful insects may not be found to show fear or anxiety reactions, but a simple sight of a barking dog, jumping monkey or creeping cockroach may make them tremble and choke on account of their frightful memories. In this way, a thing lying or event happening in people's social environment can't produce any feeling or emotions good or bad unless it is turned so for them through their cognition in one or the other ways.

So far, we have acquainted you with the impact or influence of cognition over the aspects of your affective behavior (moods, feelings and emotions) in a quite generalized way as experienced by you through your day-to-day observations or living. Let us now try to substantiate it through some more convincing ideas, and understanding reached in social psychology on the part of researchers and psychologists.

1. The cognitive arousal theory propounded by the psychologists Schachter and Singer (1962) may help us in a proper way to understand how our feelings and emotions are influenced through our cognition. This theory proposes a two-stage model for understanding the mechanism of our emotional experiences. At stage one of our emotive experience, we undergo through a particular type of physical arousal i.e., trembling, crying for help or running as a reaction or response to a fear producing stimulus or happening. The initial stage, thus, is quite general in nature, associated only with a certain type of physiological arousal. It is the second stage that is meant for
2. looking out for cues to attribute that arousal (i.e., what we were feeling at the time of such physiological arousal). Depending on these available cues we then try to label and name the emotion experienced by us in this social encounter. It should be quite apparent to us now that the whole process of identifying the cues and attribution is purely cognitive in nature, helping us to claim that cognition plays a quite significant role in our affective experiences.
3. The other source of supporting the claim that our affective behavior is influenced considerably through cognition is available in the mechanism of the activation of schemas containing a strong affective component. According to this view, if a schema (cognitive framework) of ours contains some strongly affective information (i.e., strong feeling of liking or disliking, positive or negative attitude, stereotypes and prejudices of some or the other nature against an individual or groups of people), then their activation or interplay may work as a powerful factor in producing specific types of positive or negative feelings or emotions among us towards these people or groups while interacting and behaving with them in social situations. For example, if we have a type of schema portraying a person as quite negative in view of his personality characteristics, actions, or sometimes for belonging to a religion or caste resented or disliked by us, in this situation, activation of this schema is likely to exert powerful effects upon our affective behavior (moods, feelings and emotions).

over their anger and aggression. If ever they fall victim to the evils of their emotive feelings such as anger, anxiety, fear, excessive attachment and lust, etc. their intellect helps them to come out from the mess. Where the misinterpretation of one's laughter or an innocent verbal comment may play a major role in fueling your anger, the saying of the word sorry, or clearing the misunderstanding, on the other hand, may make the things quite normal.

4. The concept of emotional intelligence and its role in understanding and managing emotions has further provided sufficient ground for understanding the role of cognition in influencing as well regulating the things related to our affective behavior. We have now well-established research as well as commonly experienced evidences to show how the use of our cognitive abilities may help us in knowing and managing the emotions of the self and others for getting needed success in our social interaction.
5. We may also witness the role of cognition in influencing the affective behavior of the individuals when they are seen to make use of their intelligence in diverting their attention and focus on the things, events and persons other than those that are presently proving as a potent factor for getting them angry, feared, depressed or infatuated. Similarly, we may see the people making a desirable shift in their achievement motivation, level of aspiration, expectancies, that are presently working towards making them suffer from the negative moods, feelings and emotions. Redirection or re-channelization of their emotional energy towards some more constructive fronts or channels may only be possible through the proper use of their cognitive abilities.

In this way, it is quite imperative and appropriate on our part to say that our cognitive and affective behaviors maintain a quite intimate and close inter-relationship between them. Where on one hand, our affective behavior (moods, feelings and emotions) cast a quite strong influence and impact on

our cognition, our cognition also in turn affects our moods, feelings and emotions in a considerable way.

To Sum Up

There exists a strong bond in the form of a reciprocal relationship between the cognitive aspect and affective aspects of our behavior each influencing and affecting the other in one or the other ways during our social interaction. Where, on one hand, our affective behavior in the form of our moods, feelings and emotions cast a quite strong influence and affect on our cognition, our cognition, in the form of our thinking, reasoning, imagination and inference drawing, also in turn affects our moods, feelings and emotions in a considerable way.

Review Questions

1. What is social cognition? Discuss its meaning and concept in detail.
2. Define the term social cognition and tell actually what happens in the process of social cognition.
3. What are the major cognitive strategies involved in our social cognition? Discuss them in detail.
4. What are schemas? What are their major types? What roles are played by them as a cognitive strategy in our social cognition? Explain.
5. Throw light on the nature and roles of the following types of schemas in our social cognition: (i) Person schemas, (ii) self-schemas, (iii) event schemas, (iv) role schemas and (v) group schemas.
6. What are heuristics? What role is played by them as a cognitive strategy in our social cognition? Explain.
7. Throw light on the nature and roles of the following heuristics in our social cognition: (i) Representativeness heuristic, (ii) availability heuristic, (iii) anchoring and adjustment heuristic and (iv) simulation heuristic.

8. Throw light on the experimental studies performed by the socio-psychologists Tversky and Kahneman for explaining the roles of (i) availability heuristic and (ii) anchor and adjustment heuristic in our social cognition.
9. What are the main potential sources of errors in our social cognition? Discuss in detail.
10. Throw light on the following potential sources of errors in our social cognition: (i) Negative bias, (ii) being optimistic or positive, (iii) counterfactual thinking, (iv) thought suppression, (v) the phenomenon of magical thinking, (vi) dominance of intuitive thoughts over the rational and (vii) being too rational or too much of a thinker.
11. How do affect and cognition influence each other? Discuss in detail.

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6.

SOCIAL PERCEPTION

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- Define and explain the term social perception.
- Throw light on the role of non-verbal communication in social perception.
- Explain the role of attribution in social perception.
- Name and discuss the various theories of attribution.
- Throw light on the applications of attribution theory in our social perception.
- Name and discuss various types of attribution biases.
- Discuss the meaning of the term impression formation.
- Explain how the task of impression formation is carried out.
- Tell about the meaning of the term impression management.
- Throw light on the methods and techniques used for impression management.

Introduction

As social animals, we can't live and exist without our social world and social life. In our social living we have to interact and deal with others belonging to our social environment in one way or the other. This interaction and dealing with others can't be turned into reality unless we know who they are and what may be expected from them during the social interaction. The information gathering about a thing or phenomenon is the first step for knowing about the thing. It equally applies to our knowing about others' personality characteristics and social behavior. We need the relevant information on this account and it is available to us at the initial stage of our social interaction in the form of

a psychological process known as sensation. What one is transmitting through his non-verbal and verbal communication and what is received by our sensory organs through the mechanism of sensation, then needs to be provided some meaning and interpretation on our part, and here it is what that is done by the mechanism of a psychological process known as perception. *Perception in its simple way, thus, means sensation attached to meaning*, and it is our brain-our cognitive network that helps in carrying out perceptions of the people and their behavior during interaction with them in our social world. Since this type of perception about the people and their social behavior (known as social perception) carries a wide significance to us for carrying

out the needed social interaction with them for our social living, we need to know more about it in terms of its meaning, nature, determinants, processes and applications, etc. Let us do it in the present chapter.

Social Perception – Meaning and Definitions

In its word meaning the term social perception stands for the perception of the social (i.e., social world and social behavior of the people). As a dictionary meaning, The STANDS4 Network (an online resource for definitions and translations) has defined it as follows: “Social perception is that part of perception that allows people to understand the other people in their social world. . . . Social perception allows individuals to make judgments and impressions about other people.”

The other thinkers and authors in the field of social psychology have also tried to define the term social perception in their own ways. Let us look at them.

1. **Secord and Beckman (1974):** Social perception refers to the manner in which impressions, opinions or feelings about other persons are formed.
2. **Feldman (1985):** In person (social) perception, which is different from object perception, the perceiver focuses on specific traits to form an overall impression of others.
3. **Baron et al. (2008):** Social perception refers to the processes through which a person seeks to know and understand other persons.
4. **Aronson et al. (2010):** Social perception refers to the ability to make accurate interpretations and inferences about other people from their general physical appearance, verbal and non-verbal patterns of communication.
5. **McCleery and Green (2014):** Social perception refers to identifying and utilizing social cues to make judgments about social roles, rules, relationships, context or the characteristics (e.g., trustworthiness) of others.

Social Perception

A type of perception in which we try to know and understand others and build an overall impression and attitude towards them for our social interaction on the basis of drawing inferences and making judgments from the relevant clues available to us for this purpose.

A close analysis of the definitions provided may help us in drawing the following conclusions about the meaning and characteristic features of the term social perception.

- The task or process of social perception is quite different from object perception. Here we perceive persons (other than us) and their behavior instead of objects or physical events.
- In the process of our social perception, we try to provide meaning to what information is received by us about the personality characteristics and social behavior of others through one or the other clues such as their outward physical appearance, clothing and dress, verbal and non-verbal behaviors, etc.
- Social perception is a perception that mainly helps us form attitudes and opinions and arrive at an overall impression about the personality characteristics and social behavior of others by drawing inferences and conclusions from the clues available for this purpose about them.
- In our social perception as perceiver, we perceive-interpret the information about others in a quite subjective way i.e., focusing on specific traits or aspects of social behavior.
- Actually, during the process of social perception we observe other people and decide what they are like and how we will respond to them.

In view of what has been discussed about the meaning and characteristics of our social perception, we may try to adopt a working definition of the term social perception in the following way.

Social perception is a type of perception in which we try to know and understand others and build an overall impression and attitude towards them for our social interaction on the basis of drawing inferences and making judgments from the relevant clues available to us for this purpose.

The understanding reached on the meaning and concept of the term social cognition in the preceding form now persuades us to think further on the issues that follow.

1. What type of input in the form of clues or information regarding other people's personality traits or social behavior is available to us for carrying out the process of our social perception and through what means and manners?
2. Why do people behave in a certain way as visible to us at the time of our interaction with them in a social situation?
3. What is the overall outcome or output of the task or process of our social perception?

Let us try to think in this direction.

- At the time of our present social interaction or responding to the people in a desired social way, we need to find out what others are thinking and feeling at that time. How the relevant information can be available to us on this account. It is only through verbal and non-verbal communications possible with them at that time. However, in general, it also becomes quite difficult on our part to believe in their verbal clues because people are always in the habit of concealing or even misleading others about their current psychological states – thoughts, beliefs, moods, feelings, emotions, etc. Thus, it is only the information available in the non-verbal form (such as their physical appearance, dress, facial expressions, gestures, eye movements, physical movements and actions, etc.) that can serve the required purpose of providing needed input for carrying out the task of social perception on our part. It is why we are going to discuss in detail the role of non-verbal communication in furnishing a lot of information for our social perception.

- The people at the time of our social interaction with them are found to behave (think, feel and act) in certain ways. In our attempt to derive necessary meaning from their observable behaviors and communication, it becomes quite imperative on our part to reason why they are behaving in such ways. Our efforts in this direction expect from us to attribute one or the other reasons for the same. The phenomenon of attribution thus carries a lot of value in the task of our social perception. We will be discussing it in detail in this chapter.
- The process related to our social perception is aimed to help us in knowing and understanding the people in our social interaction. In its outcome it results in forming an overall impression by us about the personality and social behavior of the concerned people. How these impressions are formed and get managed on our part for carrying out the desired social interaction in one or the other social situation to know about this is, thus, a quite essential thing for all of us. In the present chapter we will also be discussing this aspect of our social perception in detail.

Let us begin our discussion by taking into account the role of non-verbal communication.

The Role of Non-Verbal Communication

Most of the important input (amount of information) we get for knowing and understanding people and their social behavior comes from the non-verbal communication taking place with them in one or the other social situation. The term non-verbal communication in its simple words may be defined as the way in which we are found to communicate or express our thoughts and feelings intentionally or unintentionally, in almost every social setting, without making use of words. These non-verbal communications or expressions of the people play a quite substantial role in providing necessary input or clues for deriving needed interpretation and judgment about the inner feelings and thoughts of the people. This non-verbal expression or behavior may be displayed by us through a variety of channels or means such as

our body build and physical appearance, dress and clothing, facial expression, language of the eye, body language (gesture, posture and bodily movements), touching, etc. Let us examine all these forms of our non-verbal expression.

Body Build and Physical Appearance: We, many times, try to conclude about the personality characteristics and social behavior of the persons through the body build and physical appearance of the people. Through their body build, color of the skin and hair, etc. they appear to be belonging to this or that country, race, religious groups, caste or region of a particular country. Sometimes, we may also identify them as rural or urban, or engaged in one or the other professions. After categorizing them in this manner, then, the task of drawing inferences and making judgments about their personality characteristics and social behavior is carried out by us in the light of the different types of schemas (cognitive framework) existing in our mind about the people (male and female) belonging to such races, countries, religious groups, caste or region of the country. In this way, non-verbal information or clues available to us through the body build and physical appearance of the people work a valuable input for our social perception – making impressions about them and then accordingly preparing ourselves for the social interaction with them.

Clothing and Dress: Like body build and physical appearance, the clothes on the body, the dressing sense, fashion and designs adopted, etc. by the people may also work as an important link for associating them with a certain religious groups, ethnicity, profession, race, culture, country and region of the country. It may also lead to identify them as old fashioned or modern, rural or urban, open or close for love and friendship, etc. The information or clues available to us through such identification of the people are then matched with the schemas (mental frameworks) of the personality traits and social behavior available in our mind for such type of people (men and women). It can help us in making one or the other type of impressions regarding their personality and social behavior. In this way, one's clothing and dressing styles may provide an important non-verbal source for furnishing important clues and information for

the task of social perception carried out by us in one or the other social situation.

Facial Expression: In general, face and facial expressions may be said to be a true index of one's thinking and feelings going on in one's mind and heart at that very time. In such a capacity, thus, our facial expression is capable of conveying all about our thinking and feeling behavior in a quite non-verbal way to others in conversation or interaction with us. The states of our moods – sad or happy, pleasant or unpleasant, joyful or anxious – may be clearly read by others through their keen observation of our facial expressions. It must also be seen that much of what is conveyed to others though our facial expression is almost similar and universal all around the globe with a little variation in the different cultures. It is why we can easily conclude that at a particular time one is feeling angry, fearful, jealous, astonished, or showing love, sympathy or hatred, etc. or thinking something negative or positive about us and others. In this way, one's facial expression in its non-verbal communication form may furnish a lot of clues and information to us for concluding about the mental and emotional states of others for preparing us well in carrying out our social interaction with them at that time.

Language of the Eye: Language of the eye in its unique non-verbal form is capable of providing a lot of information or important clues about what is going on in the mind and heart of the person concerned at the present moment. The thoughts and feelings of the people can be easily conveyed to the others through the eye contacts and gazing of eyes in one or the other ways on their part in one or the other social situation. Language of the eye is considered to be quite common and universal at least with no exception among the inhabitants of a particular region or followers of a particular culture or civilization. In our society, the various idioms and phrases showing movements and actions of our eyes such as 'AnkheBichhana', 'AnkheDikhana' etc. provide a quite valid testimonial of the role of eye language in conveying a lot of information about the thinking and emotive behavior of the concerned person. The different ways or modes of eye contact and eye gazing in the form of looking, staring and blinking, thus, here

may be found to express our thoughts and feelings to others in different fashion. For example, when one is found to turn his eyes, we may conclude that he is not interested in our friendship or conversation or wants to avoid us. On the other hand, a high level of gazing and direct eye contact from another person is considered as a sign of positive feelings, friendliness or liking. Similarly, one can communicate well his emotions of fear, jealousy, anger, envy, hatred, greediness, temptations, lust, love, affection, apathy or sympathy, etc. through the language of the eye. In this way, the language of the eye, in its pure non-verbal form, may supply a lot of information or clues for the task of our social perception – understanding others and their social behavior.

Body Language (Gestures, Postures and Bodily Movements): Our body has an impressive non-verbal language for communicating our feelings, thoughts and actions to others in the form of a variety of gestures, postures and specific bodily movements. A classical dancer, while performing on the stage, may provide a substantial testimony for the effectiveness of such communication by displaying a variety of gestures, postures and bodily movements for conveying what she wants to convey or tell to her audience. It is why as a spectator we are capable of concluding that now she is offering prayers, getting annoyed, or feeling nervous, tense, shy, fear, jealousy, envy, anxiety, love or affection.

The different components or constituents of our body language – gestures, postures and bodily movements – provide specific clues or information regarding the thinking and affective behavior of ours to others in a quite proper way. You may be quite familiar with some of the widely used gestures in our day-to-day conversation or communication such as gestures for saying good bye, stop, go away, yes, no, come, sit down, stand up, small, large or expansive, warning and victory, etc.

Postures of the body, in their different shapes, sizes and forms also reveal and convey the thoughts and feelings of the people to others. Depression or elevation, nervousness or confidence, anxiety, grief, and sadness or happiness and pleasure, liking and disliking, willingness or unwillingness for doing something, etc. can be found successfully revealed

and displayed to others through the postures one is adopting at one or the other time.

Similarly, our bodily movements, in their various forms used for performing a number of activities such as rubbing, clapping, shaking and raising of hands, whistling from mouth, touching of the other's feet, clinching of the fist, stroking of the chest in particular ways, dragging of the feet, nodding of the head and moving of the neck in a particular way, and walking swiftly or gently, etc. may also be found to convey our thoughts and feelings in a variety of ways.

In this way, our body through its peculiar gestures, postures and movements conveys to others about our thoughts and feelings, we are experiencing at one time or the other in the form of fears and phobias, anxiety, sadness, sorrow, grief, anger, happiness, love, hate, jealousy, envy, friendliness, love, affection, sympathy and empathy, etc. We can thus have a lot of input and information about the thoughts and feelings of others for carrying out the task of our social perception with a proper interpretation of the language spoken by their body.

This interpretation of others' body language, however, needs some essential precautions on our part. We should be properly aware of the truth that body language, in spite of being judged as somewhat universal and common, has a perfect cultural and social base. As a result, every culture or society has its own body language that gets developed and learnt the same way as the spoken verbal language. That's why we should be quite cautious while making use of or interpreting one or the other type of body language on our part for our social cognition and interaction with others. Let us cite a few instances for this purpose.

- In Tibet, tribal people exchange greetings by producing/displaying their tongues. Don't dare to do this in India. It will be communicated as insulting and teasing the receivers.
- In India, here we may use our stretched open palm for conveying the stop signal. However, doing such in Greece will be an outright insult to the receivers.
- In western culture the people may welcome or greet through kissing, whereas kissing in public

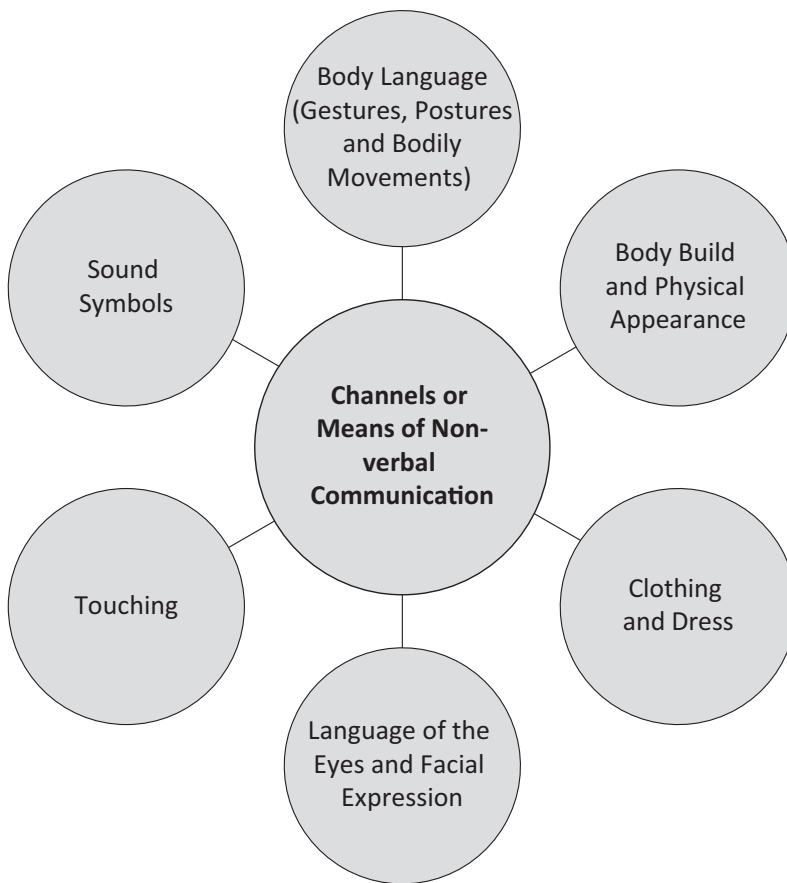


Figure 6.1 Different Channels or Means of Non-Verbal Communication

is not liked in India. We usually welcome or greet through joining both our hands, touching feet or shaking hands, etc.

Touching: Touching (making body contacts with others), also, is an important source of our non-verbal communication. The clues provided in the form of a sensation of a touch and its subsequent interpretation may help us in knowing and understanding the people and their social behavior. The task of the interpretation of touches on our part as a receiver of the sensation of touch depends on a variety of factors involved in the process of touching in one or the other social situations. We can name these factors as follows:

1. The type of person who did the touching (an elderly person, a member of the same age or a child, a friend, a stranger, same sex or opposite sex member, etc.).
2. The physical nature of the touch (such as rough or gentle, thrust or pushing, brief or prolonged, the part of the body touched, etc.).
3. The affective nature of the touch (such as affectionate, caregiving, power and control, aggressive, ritualistic, good and bad, etc.).

These factors are found to play their respective roles in our interpretation of a touch provided by somebody as appropriate or inappropriate. Besides these three types of factors, the context or the social setting in which this episode of touching takes place also counts much for considering a touch proper or improper. For example, a touch provided by a doctor in the setup of a clinic or hospital is almost always

considered appropriate or desirable on the part of us in our capacity of the patients and it produces positive feelings among us. However, the touch provided by a male doctor to somebody especially to the female members in some other social setup may not be perceived as good and appropriate. Similarly, there are occasions when the touch received even at the hands or contacts with one's relatives or friends may be considered inappropriate on the part of the receivers resulting in producing quite negative feelings and poor impression about them. In the cases of children, therefore, we have to teach them to differentiate between good and bad touch for protecting themselves from the evil of sexual abuse.

In our social interaction and contacts, the touching practices adopted usually by us consist of our handshaking, embracing, touching the feet of the elders, etc. The manners in which these practices are carried out and the type of sensation associated with these practices provide a quite wide scope for interpreting them in different ways. These touches may lead us to read about the thinking and affective behavior of the person who is providing touch to you in the name of handshaking, embracing and feet touching. You may feel warmth and positivity in them or may consider them as mere formality, indifference, apathy or even vicious in their nature and effect. In this way, touch as an important non-verbal communication mode may prove a quite valuable source for furnishing a lot of clues and information for being used in our social perception – knowing and judging the person and their social behavior.

Sound Symbols: In our conversation or interaction with people we often make use of certain sound symbols and vocal cues (non-verbal in nature) along with the verbal dialogues carried out with them for this purpose. We may name them as 'hunh-hunh', 'yaa', 'unu hunh', 'uanh', etc. During our conversation when the listener responds in between by uttering the sound 'hunh-hunh' or 'yaa' we may consider that he is showing agreements with our line of thinking and feeling. The uttering of the sound 'unu hunh' or 'uanh' on the people's part on the other hand signifies their disagreement and disinterest for the same. Their lines of agreement or disagreement with our thoughts and feelings may become more distinctive

and prominent when they also nod their head and neck in a particular way along with the utterance of the positive sounds (i.e., 'hunh-hunh' or 'yaa') or negative sounds ('unu-hunh' or 'uanh').

In addition, the sound symbols and vocal cues used in our conversation with others may also provide substantial clues for judging the thinking and emotional behavior of others in some other ways. For example, when one is making a pleasing sound through whistling or humming, we may know that he is in a pleasant and happy mood and when one utters 'hunh' with angry expression, he is said to be in an angry or aggressive mood. However, the interpretation of the sound symbols can only be made in context to the tone, volume and the situation prevailing at the time of the utterances of these sounds, i.e., whistling may be made to tense, attract and make indecent remarks to somebody.

In this way, various modes of non-verbal communication as just discussed may be found to work as a quite potent and useful source for providing a lot of clues and informational input to us in carrying out the task of our social perception – knowing and understanding the people and their social behavior – enabling us to carry on the process of social interaction in one or the other social situation. This help provided on the part of non-verbal communication becomes more significant when there are minimal or lesser chances of verbal communications among the parties involved in social interaction.

To Sum Up

Social perception is a perception that mainly helps us form attitudes and opinions and arrive at an overall impression about the personality characteristics and social behavior of others by drawing inferences and conclusions from the clues available for this purpose about them. The clues in this connection are available from their verbal and non-verbal behaviors while having our interaction with them in one or the other social situations. In this connection, we may see that the clues

available from people's non-verbal behavior carry more weight in comparison to their verbal behavior simply for the reason that, in the verbal behavior there is a greater possibility of concealing or even misleading others on their part about their current psychological states – thoughts, beliefs, moods, feelings, emotions, etc. Thus, it is only the information available in the non-verbal form such as their body build and physical appearance, clothing and dress, facial expressions, language of the eye, body language in the form of gestures, postures and bodily movements, sound symbols and vocal cues, and touching, etc. that can serve the required purpose of providing needed input for carrying out the task of social perception on our part.

Role of Attribution: Understanding Why People Behave in the Way They Do

Meaning and Definition of the Term Attribution:

Attribution in its word meaning stands for an act or process of attributing something. In *Cambridge English Dictionary*, available online, the term attribution in its generalized way has been defined as “the act of saying or thinking that something is the result or work of a particular person or thing”. When we say that Taj Mahal is the result of the efforts of Mughal Emperor Shahjahan, ‘Ram Charit Manas’ is the creation of Tulsidas, or this railway accident is the outcome of the carelessness of the engine driver or signal man, we are making attribution, identifying the person or thing responsible for the creation or happening of a thing or event. However, in the field of social psychology when we are studying the phenomenon of social perception (act of knowing and understanding the personality traits and social behavior of others), the use of the term attribution is strictly confined to attribute reasons or causes for one or the other types of behavior demonstrated by them in a particular social situation. The definitions of the term attribution provided by the authors and researchers in the field of social psychology, thus,

may be seen to focus on answering the question why people behave in this or that way in their social life. As a sample, here, we are producing a few of them.

Delamater and Myers (2009): The term attribution refers to the process through which the observer infers the causes of another’s behavior.

Baron and Byrne (2001): Attribution refers to our efforts to understand the causes behind others’ behavior and, on some occasions, the causes behind our behaviors, too.

These two definitions are hereby clearly pointing out the objective or goal of the task of attribution carried out on our part in any process of our social interaction. We have a natural curiosity of establishing a cause and effect relationship in the happening of an event or observed phenomenon. Accordingly, when anybody is found to behave in a particular way or demonstrate a particular type of social behavior, we begin to assign attribution i.e., think about the possible causes or reasons underlying this behavior. Let us try to make it clear through examples.

Attribution

Our attempts to assign possible causes or reasons behind the type of behavior demonstrated by others as well as ourselves in one or the other social situations.

Imagine yourself sitting in an arm chair and all of a sudden, a child, while screaming, thrusts herself into your arms. It is natural for your thought process now to be engaged in the task of attribution – assigning one or the other reasons – for the behavior of the child such as (i) she is feared on some account, (ii) somebody is chasing her during the child play, (iii) she is just kidding, (iv) she is missing you for the long time or (v) she is demonstrating love and feelings of attachment towards you.

It is only after the close scrutiny of all these possibilities that you try to respond in the most suitable way for carrying out your social obligation and interaction in this situation.

Now next imagine about another episode. You are a steno in a corporate office. One day, when you report yourself for some dictation in the office of the boss, he calls you to come near for one or the other excuses and begins to flirt with you. It surprises you and makes you engage in the process of attribution – searching the possible causes for his flirting behavior. You are, then, found to react and respond depending upon the nature of attribution you link with his behavior. In response, if you show here your resentment or compromise in some particular way, then, the same also depends upon paying consideration over the attribution you link with your behavior in this situation such as: it is not at all proper to tolerate such unjustified unsocial behavior or it is a good opportunity to get a promotion or increasing nearness with the boss. In this way, attribution you link with the behavior of others and responding on your part may decide the nature of the interaction further carried out by you in one or the other social situation.

Theories of Attribution

What guides or dictates us in carrying out the attribution task? How is the process of attribution, in general, carried out by us in our day-to-day social interaction and social perception? The questions like these may be answered on the basis of the different theories of attributions put forward by the renowned socio-psychologists and thinkers from time to time. Let us try to discuss some of these important theories.

Heider's Naïve Psychology Attribution Theory

Fritz Heider (1896–1988) is the first in the history of social psychology who realized the need of bringing a theory for explaining why people behave in the way, as they do. He is popularly referred to as the father of attributional theories by being the first person who is credited to provide the needed conceptual foundation for the framing or development of subsequent theories of attribution in the later years by one or the other socio-psychologists. More specifically, his theory is known for emphasizing certain fundamental

themes and ideas for the causal explanation of the human behavior such as follows:

- Not only professionals such as psychologists but all human beings in the capacity of naïve psychologists are involved in understanding the behavior of themselves and others. Here they also try to assign causation to this behavior and on its basis make predictions about the occurrence of such behavior in future.
- As a naïve psychologist, people, in general, believe that there exists a perfect cause and effect relationship in what happens in this social world regarding the occurring of the events or behaving of the people in a particular way.
- In attributing causes for the one or the other types of behavior of others, as a naïve psychologist, the people in general, are found to adopt a quite simple approach. They either hold responsible the person himself for his behavior or search for the causation of this behavior in his environment i.e., holding other persons or the situations prevailing in one's environment responsible for making him to behave in that way (Heider, 1958).

Heider's Naïve Psychology Attribution Theory

A theory of attribution providing a workable account of the manner and ways in which we, as an ordinary or common people (termed as naïve psychologist), explain the causes of the events concerning the social behavior of the individuals by holding the individuals themselves or the things lying in their environment responsible for the display of such behavior.

Along with the propagation of the preceding ideas, the attribution theory put forward by Fritz Heider is best known for classifying the factors responsible for a particular type of behavior of people in one or the other social situations into two major categories as explained here.

1. **Internal causes or attributions:** Internal causes as the name suggests are internal in nature. They lie within the individual rather than outside in the environment. Thus, while attributing internal causes for the behavior of the individuals we look for the things lying within the individuals such as their personality characteristics, health condition – physical and mental – nature of the mood, feelings and emotions felt, and abilities, capacities, motivations, aspirations, competencies, etc. possessed on their part. Our attributions like *“He is angry and fighting with others because he is bad tempered and quarrelsome”* belong to the category of internal attributions.
2. **External causes or attributions:** External causes as the name suggests are external in nature. They lie outside the individuals in their environment rather than within the individuals themselves. These causes are also referred to as situational implying that occurrence of the behavior in an individual has been resulted through the creation of a situation or happening of something bad or negative in the environment of an individual. In this regard, our attributions like *“He is angry and fighting with others because they have uttered abuses against him and his family”* belong to the category of external attributions.

In this way, Heider through his theory of attribution tried to provide a workable account of the manner and ways in which we as an ordinary or common people (termed as naïve psychologist) explain the causes of the events concerning the social behavior of the individuals by holding the individuals themselves or the things lying in their environment responsible for the display of such behavior.

Jones and Davis's Correspondent Inference Theory

The correspondent inference theory of attribution put forward by Jones and Davis (1965), well in tune with its naming, tries to explain how people infer that a person's behavior corresponds to one or the other dispositions such as his or her personality

traits, intention, interest, attitude, temperament, etc. It should be noted here that this theory emphasizes internal factors (things lying within the individual) over external factors (lying in the environment or social situations) for attributing causes or explanations for the social behavior of the people because for this task, the former proves more stable and controllable in comparison to the latter. Further, in this sequence among the internal factors, it has preferred to lean over the personality traits that are supposed to be relatively stable and enduring and thus have better claim for being used as a valid predictor of the behavior of the individuals.

Thus, in search of attributing one or the other causes for a particular type of social behavior of a person, this theory advocates to seek correspondence or matching between the behavior demonstrated and the personality traits possessed by the individual. Now the question arises, what type of information do we need to process for assessing or inferring the correspondence or matching between one's behavior and personality makeup?

In this concern, while Jones and McGills (1976) have pointed out to make use of five types of information named as free choice, non-common effects, social desirability, hedonic relevance and personalism, other authors like Baron and Byrne (2001) and Crisp and Turner (2010) have focused only on the first three for this purpose. Let us examine these three types of information and their processing.

1. In our social perception of others, the information categorized as *free choice* refers to those behaviors for the performing of which one is quite free in his choice. The performing of these behaviors is not induced or forced on the people; these are willingly and purposefully executed by them and thus the linking of these behaviors with some of their personality traits may be fully justified. These are the behaviors that prove a quite potent information source for inferring the correspondence between one's behavior and personality traits. On the other hand, the behaviors that are performed by the individuals under compulsion (such as a traveler pushing people out of the way in his haste, or a guardian and

relative of a patient becoming aggressive with the medical staff for not attending the patient under emergency) for which they have no alternatives or choices before them, can't be undertaken as an outcome or creation of the relatively enduring and stable traits of their personality. It is therefore quite essential for us not to make use of the type of behaviors known as forced choice behaviors for inferring the correspondence or matching between one's behavior and personality makeup. For such type of behavior, the situations or circumstances under which one is behaving are much more responsible than the individual himself.

2. The type of information categorized as non-common effects refers to those behaviors of ours which are accompanied with the consequences or outcomes that are uncommon and unique. As a general rule, the actions and behaviors that are exceptional and unique may be found to reflect in a quite vocal way the uniqueness of a person resulting from the uniqueness of his personality. The information got through such behaviors is, thus, more suitable and forceful for inferring a strong relationship between one's behavior and his internal disposition/personality makeup. How sincerely a young graduate is touching the feet of his elders, his actions and feelings reflected in his behavior may tell the story of the uniqueness of his behavior for being used as the important information capable of being linked to his internal disposition or personality characteristics.
3. The third type of information to be used for inferring the correspondence between one's behavior and his internal dispositions is concerned with the nature of the social desirability of one's social behavior. In this connection, Jones and Davis in their theory of attribution have opined that the actions or behavior of the people that are low in social desirability are more easily noticed and have a better chance of being linked with their internal dispositions in comparison to the actions that are high in social desirability. In our social life we have to comply with one or the other types of social norms, rules

and regulations, turning our behavior as socially desirable. However, any act or action which runs somewhat contrary to the social norms is termed as socially undesirable and it is more easily noticed by others for being linked with their personality characteristics or internal dispositions. For example, a young girl or boy who takes the decision of marrying in other caste or religion, the information like this related to their social behavior is quite easily noticed and has a preferably better chance of being used for inferring a correspondence between the behavior and the personality dispositions of the people.

To Sum Up

Jones and Davis's Correspondence Inference Theory, in its search of attributing one or the other causes for a particular type of social behavior of a person, advocates a need to seek correspondence or matching between the behavior demonstrated and the personality traits possessed by the individual. The type of information we need to process for such matching task may be broadly categorized as:

- Free choice (the behaviors of the individuals for the performing of which they are quite free in their choice).
- Non-common effects (behaviors of individuals which are accompanied with the consequences that are uncommon and unique).
- The noticeable behavior of the people i.e., the behavior low in social desirability.

Kelley's Theory of Causal Attribution

When an individual is found to behave in a certain way before us, in general, we are found to attribute some or the other cause or explanation of his or her behavior in our own ways. In doing so, we as a naïve psychologist or thinker (as opined and guided by the father of attribution theories Fritz Heider) try to attribute the cause of the other's behavior either in

the internal factors (within the individual himself) or in the situational factors (behavior of others and the things going in the environment). In this concern, the famous thinker and socio-psychologist Harold Kelley while agreeing with Heider, forwarded his own views in 1967 by propagating a theory of attribution named as Kelley's theory of casual attribution. According to Kelley, here in attributing causes on our part to the behavior of others there may arise two types of different situations named as (i) single-instance observation and (ii) multiple-instance observation of the people's behavior. Kelley has suggested in his theory to make use of different types of approaches or models for the attribution of causes to other's behavior in the name of "causal schemata model" and "covariation model". Let us examine the use of these two models in the different situations related to single-instance or multiple-instance observations of the behavior of others.

Single-Instance Observation and Use of Causal Schemata Model

Often, as an observer we witness people quite incidentally or occasionally behaving in some particular ways in one or the other situations of our social encounter. We have no past history of the person, and also have an unlikely possibility of witnessing the behavior being repeated before us in the future, and thus we have to establish a cause and effect relationship in such cases, then and there, simply on the basis of a single-instance observation. As examples of such single-instance cases, let us view our experiences like:

- On our visiting tour, a stranger standing nearby us on the railway platform suddenly falls down.
- While waiting for the local bus, we see a young lady beating a boy with her footwear.

What makes the man fall down, and why has this lady treated the boy in this manner? For answering such what's and why's of our single-instance observations, Kelley in his theory of attribution has suggested to make use of his *causal schemata model*.

While recommending the use of this model, he emphasizes that in the cases of single-instance

observation we immediately try to attribute causes to others' behavior simply on the basis of the stock of a particular type of schemas referred to as 'causal schemata' held by us in our cognitive structure or framework. According to him the term 'causal schemata' stands for a general conception the person has about how certain kinds of causes interact to produce a specific kind of effect (Kelley, 1972).

Accordingly, by using this model, for the search of the causes lying behind the falling down of the person or aggressiveness of the young lady, we immediately try to make use of the concerned causal schema lying with us. As a result, we are set to wonder, in general, what can make the person fall down or activate the lady to behave in this way. As the possible attribution, we may infer that (i) the person may be too tired/has a heart problem/has consumed excessive alcohol/or has just slipped down; (ii) the lady is reacting too much for an accidental touch of the boy/she has answered well the ill intention of the boy.

The hunt for the establishment of a cause and effect relationship in the cases of single-instance observation, thus, does not end with the listing of the possible causes; it needs further processing for arriving at the appropriate conclusion. Kelley, for this purpose, has suggested the use of the following two types of principles.

1. *Discounting Principle*: It asks to assign reduced weight to a particular cause of behavior if there are other plausible causes that might have produced it.
2. *Augmentation Principle*: It says that we should assign greater weight to a particular cause of behavior if there are other causes present that normally would produce the opposite outcome.

Multiple-Instance Observation and Use of Covariation Model

In the cases where it is possible to have more than one observation of the behavior of the people, we have better opportunity for the establishment of cause and effect relationship through the adoption of an approach much on the same lines as adopted by scientists for establishing their scientific facts. Kelley

in his theory of attribution has mentioned the use of covariation model for this purpose. Let us examine it.

While introducing his model of covariation for the attributional purpose, Kelley (1967) says that in order to attribute cause for the behavior of others in a properly scientific way, it becomes quite essential for the people to work in a rational, logical fashion, like detectives instead of drawing hasty and quick inferences based on their general understanding, stereotypes and beliefs. They have to place before them all the clues and information available in one situation for the required attribution and then get it verified through the information or clues available in the similar situations. The attribution or cause assigned for the occurrence of a behavior in one situation should also remain in operation in the similar other situations. The attribution should covary or co-occur for causing that behavior. In this way, the term covariation used in Kelley's model denotes a tendency to seek an association between certain cause and certain effect with reference to different situations (Sears et al., 1991). In other words, covariation according to Kelley occurs when a cause which we attribute to explain an effect, is present when the effect is present, and absent when the effect is absent.

As we know, all the theories of attribution answering the basic question “why do people behave in the way as they do” stand on a basic premise: attributing the cause to internal factors (the people themselves) or external factors (the situations or environment).

Let us have a consideration over such attribution by taking an example. Imagine that one of your classmates Rekha, while having rehearsal of a cultural show, suddenly gets angry at the trainer and then slaps him. Why did she act in this way? Was it an outcome of some internal factors such as the inherent suspicious and hot temperament of Rekha or resulted from the external or situational factors such as something wrong the trainer did or said? How should you decide which one of these two – internal or external attributions – is appropriate?

For providing substantial clues or information capable of supporting a decision in such a situation, Kelley, in his model of attribution, has mentioned making use of the following three types of clues or information.

1. **Consensus information:** The information is characterized as consensus information to the extent to which other people behave the same way towards the same stimulus or event as the actor (the person for the behavior of which we are attributing a cause). Here in the case of our present example, we will try to have a thorough review of the stock of information lying with us for ensuring its quality of providing consensus.
2. **Distinctive information:** The information is characterized as distinctive information to the extent to which one particular actor is found to behave in the same way to different stimuli or events. In other words, it is concerned with whether or not the behavior occurs in other, similar situations.
3. **Consistency information:** The information is characterized as consistency information to the extent to which the person in question behaves in the same way in other situations. In other words, it is concerned with a consideration of whether or not the behavior occurs repeatedly.

Consensus Information

The type of information conveying the extent to which other people behave the same way towards the same stimulus or event as the person under evaluation.

Distinctive Information

The type of information conveying the extent to which the person under evaluation is found to behave in the same way to different stimuli or events.

Consistency Information

The type of information conveying the extent to which the person under evaluation behaves in the same way in other situations.

For making use of these three types of information for assigning some cause – internal or external –

to the behavior of others, Kelley in his attribution theory has suggested to proceed as follows.

1. Assign to attribute people's behavior to an internal cause when you have information characterized as low consensus and low distinctiveness but high consistency. (Here the person himself is responsible for his behavior.)
2. Assign to attribute people's behavior to an external cause when you have information characterized as high in all the three dimensions – consensus, distinctiveness and consistency. (Here the cause of the behavior of the person lies in the behavior of others or the situation.)
3. Consider the people's behavior an outcome of the combination of internal and external factors under the conditions in which consensus is low, but distinctiveness and consistency are high. (Here cause lies in the special situation created through the interaction of the person with his environment.)

We can represent the attribution pattern suggested by Kelley through the table as follows.

When we are in no position to attribute the cause of behavior exclusively to the internal and external factors, we begin to infer from the other available sources of information lying in the environment or

situations in which particular behavior has taken place. Therefore, in the present case we will be analyzing the relevant information available in the environment for the search of some situational factors: (i) Rekha might have misunderstood the action or behavior of the trainer; (ii) there was something happening on the stage suddenly that had been responsible in creating misunderstanding; or (iii) Rekha was in a bad mood and angry on some other account etc.

In this way, Kelley through his model of attribution has tried to provide a powerful tool for attributing internal or external cause to people's behavior by drawing inferences from the various types of information available to us in this regard. In terms of its application, while keeping many things on its credit side, it is criticized on the grounds such as:

- This model is totally based on the principle of covariation. However, covariation can't be taken as equivalent to causation.
- Making covariation judgments requires multiple observations. Often this information is not available to us in a number of social situations.
- It has problems in terms of its application. (i) People do not always have the relevant information they need on all three dimensions. (ii) They may not pay equal attention to the information

Table 6.1 Attribution of Internal or External Causes in Kelley's Covariation Model

Type of Information and Its Degree	Examples	Attribution
Low Consensus	No other students ever behaved with trainer in the way as Rekha has behaved. (Consensus for blaming the trainer – external cause – is quite low.)	<i>Internal attribution</i> (Rekha herself is responsible for her behaving in this way.)
Low Distinctiveness	Rekha has been seen losing her temper and demonstrating her suspicious nature while interacting with other male students or people. (Behavior of Rekha has a quite low distinctiveness for putting blame on the trainer.)	
High Consistency	Rekha has behaved in the same way at different occasions. (Consistency for blaming Rekha – internal factor – is quite high.)	
High Consensus	Several other students of this college/other than this college have been found to behave with the trainer in the past in the same way. (Consensus for blaming the trainer – external factor – is quite high.)	<i>External attribution</i> (The trainer has caused Rekha to behave in such a way.)
High Distinctiveness	By temperament Rekha is O.K. We have not seen her lose her temper and get angered on ordinary matters. (Distinctiveness for blaming the trainer – external factor – is quite high.)	
High Consistency	The trainer has been found to receive such treatment from the female trainees at the previous occasions.	

available to them and thus likely may focus on one aspect (consensus, distinctiveness or consistency) of the information rather than the others. (iii) Also, people, in general, are not good at assessing and using covariation formation in a predicted manner (Tabachnik, 1984).

- In the end, we should always keep in mind that attributes are only inferences. The initial causes of behavior of others may never be known; what we are doing is guessing.

To Sum Up

Kelley's theory of causal attribution recommends to making use of two types of models known as "causal schemata model" and "covariation model" for attributing internal and external causes for the behavior of others in one or the other social situations.

Here, the use of "causal schemata model" is recommended in the cases when there is no possibility of the behavior being repeated and we have to establish a cause and effect, then and there, simply on the basis of a single-instance observation. In the use of this model, we immediately try to attribute causes to others' behavior simply on the basis of the stock of a particular type of schemas referred to as "causal schemata" – a general conception we have about how certain kinds of causes interact to produce a specific kind of effect.

On the other hand, in the cases of the possibility of the behavior being observed in multiple conditions, the use of covariation model is recommended. The term covariation used in Kelley's model denoted a tendency to seek an association between a certain cause and a certain effect with reference to different situations. Therefore, while attributing cause for the behavior of others in a properly scientific way, according to covariation model, we have to place before us various types of clues or information (i.e., consensus information, distinctive information and consistency information) available in one situation for the required attribution and then get it verified through all such varying types of information or clues available in the similar situations.

Shaver's Attribution Theory

The socio-psychologist K.G. Shaver is credited with introducing an attribution theory known as Shaver's attribution theory. Shaver (1975) in the development of his theory has borrowed the needed ideas and approaches for attributing causes to others' behavior from the previously discussed attribution theories developed by Heider, Jones and Davis as well as Kelley. His theory considered a hybrid theory because it portrays a synthesized picture of the ideas belonging to the previously developed three main theories.

Shaver has tried to formulate his theory on the three basic assumptions about human nature. These are:

1. The behavior does not occur at random or by chance. It is organized and therefore is predictable.
2. We have the desire to understand, to explain and predict the behavior of others. If this prediction is done correctly it helps us to have effective interaction with others.
3. By observing the behavior of others we try to collect credible information about the underlying causes of their exhibited behavior especially about character and personality traits.

With these assumptions in his mind, Shaver tried to develop a working model of attribution, i.e., assigning causes for the behavior of others. His model provides the three sequential steps for carrying out the needed attribution process for this purpose. These are:

Step 1: First, be sure that the person has really committed the behavior. (For example, in relation to the aggressive behavior of Rekha, we have to become sure that she has really committed such behavior.)

Step 2: After then, attempts should be made to find out whether the committed behavior was intentional (whether Rekha intentionally behaved with trainer in such an aggressive way).

Step 3: At this final stage, attempts should be made to find out whether the behavior committed was coerced or forced on the person (whether Rekha behaved with trainer in such a way under coercion or compulsion for doing so).

How to Conclude the Attribution (Cause of Committing a Particular Behavior on the Part of the Person)

1. If the findings regarding step 1 and step 2 are in affirmative i.e., the person really has behaved so and it was intentional (Rekha got angry and slapped the trainer quite intentionally) but these are in negation at step 3 i.e., there was no coercion or compulsion (Rekha was not under any compulsion or coercion to behave aggressively), then conclude for attributing internal cause or personality disposition for the committed behavior (Rekha behaved so because she is temperamentally quite aggressive and suspicious by nature).
2. If the findings regarding all the steps 1, 2 and 3 are in affirmative i.e., the person has really behaved so with intention but however was forced to do so (Rekha got angry and slapped the trainer quite intentionally but was forced to do so) then conclude for attributing external cause i.e., attribution to environment or situation for the committed behavior (Rekha behaved so because she was forced to act in this way on account of the undesirable behavior of the trainer).

- If the findings regarding step 1 and step 2 are in affirmative but these are in negation at step 3 then attribute internal cause or personality disposition for the committed behavior,
- But, if the findings regarding all the steps 1, 2 and 3 are in affirmative, then attribute external cause i.e., environment or situation for the committed behavior.

Weiner's Attribution Theory

The socio-psychologist Bernard Weiner is credited with propagating an attribution theory that is specially meant to explain the behavior of people associated with their achievement (success or failure) in one or the other field. That is why Weiner's attribution theory often is referred to as "achievement attribution or success and failure attribution theory". In providing a practical shape for his views and thoughts related to his theory of attribution, Weiner developed a functioning model known as Weiner's attribution model. The main things inherent in this model (Weiner, 1974, 1980, 1986) may be summarized as follows:

To Sum Up

Shaver's attribution theory tries to provide a working model of attribution, i.e., assigning causes for the behavior of others by executing some specific functions in two phases.

In its earlier phase, it talks about going on our part for the purpose through three sequential steps such as:

- Becoming sure that person has really committed the behavior,
- Attempting to find out whether the committed behavior was intentional, and
- Whether or not the committed behavior was coerced or forced on the person.

In its second phase, it tries to chalk out the process of deriving a necessary conclusion about the attribution by saying that:

1. The achievement (success and failure) of the people in any field of their social life may be attributed or explained in terms of the four basis causes/factors said to be responsible for such achievement of theirs. We may classify and name these factors as (i) ability, (ii) effort, (iii) task difficulty and (iv) luck.
2. While asked to attribute a cause for the success or failure of a person in a particular task, we try to blame one of these four factors i.e., his ability to do the task, his efforts for performing the task, the difficulty level of the task or mere chance or luck causing his success or failure in the task.
3. In perceiving the success or failure of others, how should we proceed to attribute one or the other factors out of these four responsible for a

particular type of achievement behavior related to the success or failure of a person in the assigned task? The answer lies in categorizing and weighing each of them on the three dimensions provided in the model in the name of internal-external, stable-unstable and controllable-uncontrollable dimensions in the manner as explained next.

- (i) **Categorizing as Internal-External:** Out of these four factors the former two – ability of performing the task and efforts for performing the task – actually lie with the person performing the task and thus may be safely classified as internal disposition. The latter two factors – task difficulty and luck – lie outside the individual in his environment and thus are likely to be labeled as external or situational.
- (ii) **Deciding the Stability and Controllability of the Internal Causes (Ability and Efforts):** Among the *internal causes* associated with the ability and efforts made for the success or failure in a task we generally include (a) individual's personality traits and temperament which may be termed as relatively permanent and stable, and therefore remain quite manageable and controllable in their disposition and (b) his physical and mental health, mood, motives, interests and attitudes, etc. which remain relatively unstable as well as unmanageable.
- (iii) **Deciding the Stability and Controllability of the External Causes (Task Difficulty and Luck):** The task and its difficulty level are characterized with a quite reasonable stability. A paper set for the examinee, a project assigned for being completed in an assigned time all have equal difficulty for the examinees or members of the group. The task difficulty thus possesses a quite stable nature. However, how it is felt on the part of the examinees or group members depends on their ability and will to exercise efforts

and accordingly it is uncontrollable in its execution. On the other hand, for the luck or the chance factor we may see that it has the unique characteristic of being unstable as well as uncontrollable.

4. Since ability and efforts as an internal attribution are found to possess more consistency and manageability, we as an observer and evaluator of the achievement (success or failure) behavior of others, in general, tend to value or attribute, most of the time, internal factors – ability and efforts of the people responsible for their successes as well as failures. The task of perception and attribution should also go in similar fashion for the people to evaluate their own successes or failures. However, here many of us are found to attribute internal factors (ability and efforts) to our successes and external factors (task difficulty and luck) to our failures. The question here may arise why do we adopt such mode of attribution for our successes and failures? Let us see how.

It is an accepted fact that after success we have a better feeling about ourselves and others rather than failure. We feel proud for our successes and victories, but failures or defeats bring shame and give us a guilty conscious. It is why, where we want to give all credit for our successes to our personal assets i.e., abilities and efforts (internal factors) for helping us to enhance our self-confidence and self-esteem, and we blame the things lying outside us in our environment and social situations, i.e., task difficulty and luck (external or situational factors) for saving us from the agony of shame and criticism at the hands of others and helping us to protect our ego self from damage. Accordingly, for saving him from the agony of his failure, a workman may be found to find faults with his tools, a student with the difficulty level of the test or revengeful attitude of the examiner, and a cricketer with the bat or unfavorable conditions of the playground, etc.

Table 6.2 Weiner’s Attribution Model: Displaying the Task of Attribution on Success and Failure Falling in Each of the Three Dimensions

	<i>Internal</i>		<i>External</i>	
	<i>Stable</i>	<i>Unstable</i>	<i>Stable</i>	<i>Unstable</i>
Controllable	Personality Traits/ Temperament Typical Effort	Unusual Effort	Help from Parents, Friends, and Teachers	Help from Unknown
Uncontrollable	Ability	Physical and Mental Health, Mood, Interest	Task Difficulty	Luck/Chance

To Sum Up

Weiner’s attribution theory for the purpose of attribution – assigning cause for others’ behavior – proposes a working model known as Weiner’s attribution model. For the purpose of attributing causes for the success or failure of the people in a task, it talks about crediting or blaming one of the four factors, namely people’s ability to do the task, their efforts for performing the task, the difficulty level of the task or mere chance/luck for causing their success or failure in the task. In deciding which one of these four factors is responsible for the success or failure in the assigned task, it further talks about categorizing and weighing each of them on the three dimensions provided in the model in the name of internal-external, stable-unstable and controllable-uncontrollable.

information/evidences, or apply shortcuts for drawing inferences and making judgments about them. As a result, we may be found to fall prey to various types of errors and biases referred to as attribution errors or biases affecting the quality and trustworthiness of our attribution in a quite negative way. In general, some of these major attributional errors or biases appearing in our social perception may be named and discussed as follows.

1. Fundamental Attribution Bias or Corresponding Attribution Bias

In making such error or getting biased in our explanation of the behavior of others, we make a fundamental mistake of overvaluing the role of internal factors (the things lying within the individual) and undervaluing the role of external factors (the things lying in the environment or associated with the situations). In other words, we tend to perceive others as acting as they do because they are “that kind of person”, rather than because of the many external factors that may have affected their behavior (Baron and Byrne, 2001:57). This error or bias is also known as corresponding attribution bias because it reflects the tendency to explain the cause of others’ behavior as stemming from or corresponding to the dispositions (internal factors) even when the observer is provided with clear evidences for situational causes (Jones, 1979).

The occurrence of this error or bias in our perception may be said to be an outcome of the inherent tendency or deep-rooted bias in human beings to interpret the events and behavior of others as the consequences of the purposeful actions

Attribution Biases

In our social perception, when we try to attribute causes for the behavior of others, we are advised to follow a quite systematic and organized procedure for remaining as methodical and objective as possible. The theories of attribution as discussed earlier guide us well in this direction with their own ways. However, in practice when we engage in the task of attribution i.e., holding things and events responsible for the behavior of others, our thought process, at several times, turns faulty. We begin to evaluate the people and their behavior on the basis of incomplete

of the concerned person or agent. Under the influence of such bias, we usually tend to underestimate the importance of inanimate, situational factors over animate, human factors and accordingly, try to name the personal factors (i.e., one's temperament, moods, motives, traits, attitudes, interests and intension, etc.) responsible for the actions and behavior of the person concerned by setting aside all types of environmental or situational factors playing their role in influencing and affecting the behavior of the person in that very situation.

Why do people fall prey to the fundamental or corresponding bias in their perception or attribution to the behavior of others? The explanations on this account have been given by a number of socio-psychologists and authors in their own ways. For example, Gilbert and Malone (1995) have pointed out the following four main reasons on this account.

1. When people make attribution of others' behavior, they assume that what a person does or says is consistent with his attitudes, beliefs and intentions.
2. While making attribution, people do not take sufficient account of situational constraints.
3. The link between the person and behavior is over-emphasized because people have a tendency to make spontaneous trait attribution.
4. Spontaneous attributions are treated at face value and are not adjusted sufficiently against situational causes when further deliberations are made.

2. Actor-Observer Bias

In committing this type of error or bias, people fall victim to a typical phenomenon known as *actor/observer differences*. Under the influence of this phenomenon, people involved in an action as *actors* view things differently from people behaving as *observers*. Their behaviors become subjective depending upon the role of actor or observer played on their part in one or the other situation. As a result, when we observe others to behave aggressively in one situation, we attribute the cause of their aggressive behavior to their internal dispositions, but when we get

angry with others, we say that we have been forced to behave in this way due to the other's behavior or some other external factors. Similarly, as Baron and Byrne (2001:58) comment:

When we see another person trip and fall, we tend to attribute this event to his or her clumsiness. If we trip, in contrast, we are more likely to attribute this event to situational causes: ice on the sidewalk or slippery shoes.

Why do people fall prey to this kind of actor-observer bias in the perception of their own as well as others' actions? The explanation on this account have been given by a number of socio-psychologists and authors in the way as follows.

1. By nature we, generally, remain quite subjective for proving ourselves justified in terms of our actions performed at one or the other time.
2. We are quite aware of many situational factors affecting our own actions, but are less aware of such factors when we turn our attention to the action of other persons. Thus, we tend to perceive our own behavior as arising largely from situational causes, but that of others as deriving mainly from their traits or dispositions (Baron and Byrne, 2001:58).

3. The Self-Serving Attribution Bias

Self-serving attributions, true to their naming, are those attributions that are used by people for serving the purpose of their own self i.e., keeping them always positive and self-assured about their behavioral performances in one or the other situations in their life. In doing so, they may be adjudged as biased or inclined heavily for serving the interest of their ego self. Thus, while making use of this attribution, people are found:

1. To take credit for the acts that result in positive outcomes and successes for them by attributing internal causes (such as their personality traits, temperament, attitudes, interest, motivation, ability and sincere efforts, etc.) for the execution of these acts.

2. To blame the external or situational factors (such as action or behavior of others, unfavorable situations or circumstances, the cumbersome and difficult nature of the task or unfavorable luck coming in their way etc.) for the acts that bring unfavorable outcomes or failures to them.

In a nutshell, thus, self-serving attribution bias is a tendency to attribute one's own success to internal causes and one's failures to external causes. A student may be observed to demonstrate such bias when he takes pride in declaring that he has topped the class in the subject mathematics and attributes his success to the pains he has taken for concentrating on the study and practice work in the subject, but for his not faring well in the subject English, he may be found to blame one or the other external factors such as his health, some disturbance in the family, unavailability of proper coaching, etc.

One thing that needs mentioning here is that the self-serving attributions may also be found to work at the group level much in the same way as being found working at the individual level. The schools as a whole, the teaching faculty of a particular section, the members of a playing team including the coach and manager all feel pride and attribute the success or winning of the team to internal factors like the unity of the team, excellent performance, attention given on the practice and preparation of the team, availability of good leadership to the team, etc., but the scene is totally altered in the case of facing a defeat at the hands of an opponent team when onus for causing the negative outcomes is put entirely on the external factors. Not only the team members and team officials but also we as supporters may be found to blame the weather conditions, unfavorable ground conditions and a number of other external causes including bad luck for the defeat of our state or national team.

To answer what makes the individuals commit such self-serving attribution bias we may respond by saying that:

- It helps them to maintain their self-esteem, looking good in the eyes of others, and protect their ego self from getting hurt.
- It helps them maintain their self-confidence and be hopeful for doing better in the future. The things were not in their favor, and especially their luck was bad this time – the attribution of this sort may help them much in remaining in a good mood despite the debacles.
- It helps them to get adjusted to their self and their social environment by fulfilling a natural and inherent tendency of the human being to process the social information in a typical set way i.e., attributing positive outcome to internal causes, but negative ones to external causes (Ross, 1977).

With all such excuses and advantages pointed out about the application of the self-serving attributions on the part of the people, we must not forget that their use also carries quite negative outcomes to its users especially in connection with the maintenance of appropriate interpersonal relations.

To Sum Up

Quite often, when we engage in the task of attribution, we begin to evaluate the people and their behavior on the basis of incomplete information/evidences, or apply shortcuts for drawing inferences and making judgments about them. It may result in one or the other types of errors and biases referred to as attribution error or biases in our social perception. We may broadly classify them as:

- *Fundamental Attribution Bias or Corresponding Attribution Bias* (the type of bias creeping on account of our tendency to overvalue the role of internal factors and undervalue the role of external factors.
- *Actor-Observer Bias* (the type of bias in which people involved in an action as actors view things differently from people behaving as observers).
- *The Self-Serving Attribution Bias* (the type of bias creeping on account of our tendency to pay much interest in serving the interest of our ego self).

Applications of Attribution Theory in Our Social Life

An attribution theory, whatever the form it keeps and views it propagates, tries to explain why people act or behave in the way they do. It tells us how we perceive and explain the actions and behavior of the self and others. All the attribution theories we have discussed in this chapter try to answer this question in their own ways. We may derive useful knowledge and skills for helping us in understanding the underlying causes for one or the other types of behavior demonstrated on the part of the people, including ourselves, at one or the other time in the different fields and spheres of their social life. Since human beings have a quite broad range of spheres and fields of their social life, the application of the theory and mechanism of attribution is also quite broadly ranged. There is hardly any sphere or field of our social life where we are deprived of such use and application. As an instance, we may quite distinctly and appreciably note the use and application of attribution theory in the fields of mental health, education, sports, business and social life in the ways discussed ahead.

1. Attributions and Mental Health

The status of our mental health depends to a great extent on the perception we have about ourselves and the attributions we make for explaining our actions and behaviors. How we do and why we think and act in that particular way, its perception and attribution may take us to enjoy a particular level of positive and negative mental health. For example, take the case of the people suffering from frustration and depression. These people often show a self-defeating and self-condemning pattern of attributions, which is the opposite of the self-serving attribution style discussed by us earlier in this chapter. They attribute negative outcomes to stable and enduring internal causes (i.e., their own traits, lack of efforts and ability) and positive outcomes to the unstable and temporary external causes (i.e., a mere chance or good luck and special favor and assistance from others). In this way, they may be seen to pick up a quite unique attribution style characterized by a tendency to make

internal-stable attributions or blame their own traits or lack of ability for the negative outcomes (e.g., I can never do the things in a proper way in my life). These are the most damaging and punishing of all possible attributions. Their possession and demonstration on the part of people cause serious problems and bring quite negative consequences for them in the form of (i) undermining their self-esteem and self-confidence, (ii) feeling embarrassed and low in the eyes of their self and others and (iii) making them to have a quite dismal outlook about their future performances. In this way, what we term as a depression or frustration on the part of the individuals may be largely seen as the outcome or consequence of the unrealistic and damaging style of attribution adopted by the people concerned for their own acts and behaviors performed in one or the other social situations. The help rendered by the attribution theory in understanding the role played by the improper self-ruining attribution style adopted by the depressive and frustrated individuals has proved quite valuable in adopting a quite suitable therapy for their treatment. In this therapy, attempts are made to bring needed changes in the defective attributional styles of these persons for helping them to take personal credit for their positive outcomes and stop blaming themselves unnecessarily for the negative outcomes. In this concern, research findings have satisfactorily revealed that reversing attribution for positive outcomes from external to internal and for negative outcomes, from internal to external has been found to help the depressed and frustrated a lot in coming out from their problems (Forsterling, 1988).

2. Attributions and Achievements

The nature and quality of the achievements attained on the part of the individuals in the different walks of their social life (e.g., education, sports, business, etc.) very much depend on the type of attribution style adopted by them for the perception of the actions and behavior of themselves and others. One can learn from the use of the positive and negative attribution styles that it is not proper to assign always all credit for the success and good performance to

the internal factors and associate the failures and bad outcomes to the external factors. In such case the individuals – students, sport persons, and business professionals – cannot learn appropriate lessons from their poor performances and failures and thus can't concentrate on improving and bettering their abilities and skills as well putting needed intention and efforts for achieving the set targets. The athletes who are in the habit of blaming the external factors – weather, ground condition, instruments and bad umpiring, etc. – for their setbacks while not paying any consideration to their own shortcomings can't go much ahead in the field of their choice. Similar is the case with the students, research workers and business professionals. All have to maintain a proper balance in the adoption of the attributional style for the conduct and evaluation of their own acts and behaviors for achieving the set level of their targets.

There is another way, in which, the knowledge and skills related to the adoption of attribution styles may prove helpful to the students, sport personnel and business professional. It is concerned with providing needed guidance, therapy and pushup at the time of need. For instance, take the case of backward children and underachievers in the field of education. The diagnosis of their problem may reveal that it is mostly resulted through the improper attribution style adopted by them for their tasks of learning and evaluating their learning performance and behavior. When we train or guide them for adopting a well-balanced attribution style by providing due attention over them, the academic performance of the backward children and underachievers, as the research studies done in this concern reveal and show, makes a considerable improvement. (Dweck, 1975).

3. Attributions and Social Problems

The rise in the cases of our so many social problems such as sexual assaults and crimes against women, prejudices and discrimination against one or the other social groups, etc. may also be adjudged as the product of improper attribution styles adopted by the concerned persons. For example, take the case of rape victims. When there is a rape of one or the other young girl or lady, the people, in general, in our society

(males and females both) attribute it to the internal factors by commenting as: "She herself is responsible for it. Why did she venture to travel alone or move outside in the night? What was she doing in the bar or remote place at these odd hours? Why did she put up such dress? She must have allured or made it easy for them, etc." In this way, with the knowledge gained from the attribution theories, we may here conclude that in such cases of rape victims, the blame is often attributed to victims themselves as much as, or more than, to offenders. It is nothing but a serious error or bias involved in the attribution of a valid cause or explanation on our part for the undesirable criminal act or behavior coming in to our notice through the press or media channels. Our acquaintance of such error or bias can help us to bring desirable change in our attribution style on this account.

The same thing equally applies to the evils of prejudices and discriminations prevailing in the society against one or the other social groups. While feeling prejudiced or showing discrimination towards the particular groups of the society, we may justify and provide explanation for our behavior in our unique ways. Their belongingness to a particular religion, caste or creed, speaking of the different language or belongingness to other region, sex or age group may work as a quite potential factor for us to justify our negative attitudes, beliefs and thinking towards them. Note, here, we are attributing internal factors (the things lying within the people in the form of their religion, caste, sex, language, etc.) for our prejudices and discriminatory role towards them and are completely ignoring the real cause or explanation possible in this case i.e., thoughts and feelings prevailing in our own community or social group against them. The remedy for cutting short the impact of these evils lies in bringing suitable alterations in our perception and attribution style on this account.

4. Attributions and Social Relations

Our social relationships with others in our personal, social and professional life rest much on the nature and quality of the mutual goodwill, cooperation and collaboration maintained by us in our social

interaction and partnership. The attribution styles adopted by us, for evaluating the personality characteristics and behavior of others and self, in such interaction and relationship play a quite crucial role. When we attribute internal causes (such as the good nature, sacrifices, sincerity and the efforts of our friend for keeping our friendship quite intact, the abilities and contributions of our partner in the successful execution of the business affairs, sport successes and family matters) and attribute external factors (such as the unfavorable social situations, their own mistakes or short comings or the chance or luck factor) for any setback or failure, then it brings the desired positive consequences in making the mutual collaboration and relationship quite intact and cordial for the good of both the partners. However, when the attribution style goes wrong by taking the shape of a self-serving attribution – taking all credit for the success and positive happenings and put blame on the partner for the failure and negative outcomes – then the consequences with regard to the maintenance of proper relationship take a quite contrary shape. Here our social interrelationship falls victim to a serious attribution error or bias named as self-serving bias. We have already discussed it in this chapter. It proves quite damaging to the maintenance of proper interrelationships as one's suffering from self-serving bias makes him to perceive negative on his own part as reasonable and excusable, but identical actions on the part of others as irrational and inexcusable (Baron and Byrne, 2001).

Our acquaintance with the damaging consequences of the adoption of improper attribution style for the perception of the social behavior of others including our self in the manner as discussed earlier may provide a necessary base for devising suitable means and measures for the maintenance of proper interrelationships among us. The research work carried out in this concern has been able to demonstrate that in our dealings – personal, social or professional – when we try to adopt a quite well-balanced attribution style involving both the internal and external factors responsible for one or the other type of actions and behaviors on the part of people involved, it leads us to have quite congenial and satisfying interrelationships among the persons involved in such interaction.

To Sum Up

Regarding the significance and applications of attribution theories we may say that all of them help us in the different fields and spheres of our social life at one or the other times, in their own ways.

In the field of the maintenance of mental health, the help rendered by the attribution theories in understanding the role played by the improper self-ruining attribution style adopted by the depressive and frustrated individuals has proved quite valuable in adopting a quite suitable therapy for their treatment.

Similarly, the knowledge arrived through the applications of attribution theories may help the individuals in improving the nature and quality of their achievements in the different walks of their social life (e.g., education, sports, business, etc.) by maintaining a proper balance in the adoption of the attributional style for the conduct and evaluation of their own acts for achieving the set level of their targets.

In the task of dealing with the rise of the social problems such as sexual assaults and crimes against women, prejudices and discrimination against one or the other social groups, etc. we may be properly helped by an understanding reached through the applications of attribution theories that the remedy for cutting short of the impact of these evils lies in bringing suitable alterations in our perception and attribution style on this account.

Besides this the knowledge derived through attribution theories may help us much in the maintenance of proper social relationship with others with the learning of a lesson that we should try to avoid the occurrence of the self-serving bias by adopting a quite well-balanced attribution style involving both the internal and external factors responsible for one or the other type of actions and behaviors of others.

Impression Formation and Management

The term impression possesses a quite unique significance in the field of our social perception – knowing and judging others. In our social conversations, it is quite common to hear the comments such as: “I have a quite poor impression about that person”; “I don’t want to give a chance to my boss for making bad impression about me”; “Keep in mind that your selection to this post depends on the type of impression you leave on the members of the interview board”; “What impression will others make about you from your such careless dressing and pointless talking?” etc. With such comments, it seems that by the term impression we mean a sort of imprint (an overall idea or picture in the form of good or bad feelings) left on our mind and heart about the personality traits and behavior of others resulted through their short- or long-term contact with us. Here it should be noted that when on one hand, we try to leave our impression on the mind and heart of others for making a value judgment about us, we also act an evaluator for taking value judgment about others through the type of impression they have left on us. Now the question arises how do we form impressions about others? What goes into the task of such impression formation? Let us think about this.

Impression Formation – Meaning

The term impression formation is used for the processes involved in the formation of impression about others. In terms of its defining, it may be known as a process through which we combine diverse information about other persons into a united impression of them.

It begins in the form of the first impression (the initial impression) one makes on others. What we term as love at first sight, distaste and disliking at the first opportunity of getting in touch of a thing or person, may be said to be the good examples of the phenomenon of such first impression. You may yourself know well how quick and easy it seems in its formation. A simple sight of a thing, the hearing of a few words from others, getting in touch and contact for a while, and the observation of a person’s act, appearance and behavior for a quite brief time

may make us capable of forming a holistic image in the form of our first impression about a person. And wonder, the inking or imprinting made on our mind and heart in the form of these first impressions is quite lasting and enduring in its effect and application – justifying fully the saying that “first impression is the last impression”. It is why it is always advised to be quite careful on the first day of the office, first date with the lover, interviews, viva and other situations in which we will meet others for the first time. Large number of research studies have shown that first impression does seem to exert a lasting effect on both social thought and social behavior (Anderson, 1981; Wyer et al., 1994).

How the Task of Impression Formation Is Carried Out

Whatever simplicity and ease may be reflected in making first impression about others, in practice, however, it needs the adoption of an elaborate cognitive process for its execution. What is available to us for knowing and understanding the person in a particular social situation or social encounter (i.e., his appearance, dress, way of talking, walking, expressing his opinion and behaving one or the other ways, etc.) is organized into a gestalt whole on our part for making a unified impression of the person concerned. Actually, it is this process of organizing diverse information into a unified and gestalt impression of the other person that is referred to as impression formation (Delamater and Myers, 2009).

Impression Formation

The process of organizing diverse information to make a unified and overall impression of the other person.

How the available information is used for making the unified and gestalt impressions of others in our first social encounter with them, the explanation about this came at the first time in the year 1946 from the famous socio-psychologist, Solomon Asch. For this purpose, he is known to make use of

a configuration model (perception of information about the person in the gestalt form) developed by him on the basis of a few experimental studies conducted by him in this concern. In his studies he also focused on highlighting the role of our central and peripheral traits for making a gestalt impression of others. Let us have a look into these studies and their findings.

In one of his studies Asch gave the subjects of his experiment (two groups of undergraduate students) identical lists of seven traits providing information about a stranger in the ways as given here:

First Group: Intelligent – skillful – industrious – **warm** – determined – practical – cautious.

Second Group: Intelligent – skillful – industrious – **cold** – determined – practical – cautious.

(Note that these lists differ only with respect to two words: warm and cold.)

- In terms of performing their task in this experiment, subjects belonging to both groups were asked to indicate their impression of the stranger in the form of a short description by checking the traits on their respective list that they felt fit with their impression of this person.
- The short descriptions of the subjects of both the groups then got scrutinized. There was a huge difference between their descriptions – indicator of their overall impression of the stranger.
- Where the subjects belonging to first group (having the list of traits with the word **warm** in middle) typically described the stranger as generous, happy, good natured, successful, popular and humorous, the subjects belonging to the second group (having the list of traits with the word **cold** in middle) quite contrarily described him as unsociable, unhappy and self-centered.
- The question arose: What made the subjects of the two groups differ so much in the evaluation of the stranger when the lists of the traits (information about the stranger) was almost identical except differing with respect to one out of the seven traits i.e., replacement of the word **warm** with the **cold** in the second list?
- In this concern, while drawing his own conclusions, Asch (1946) argued that if his subjects would have formed impressions of the stranger merely by adding together individual traits, the impression formed by them would not be differing very much. Actually, they adopted a quite known path of drawing conclusions from the available information about the stranger. They organized all pieces of available information (in the form of the list of seven personality traits) into a synthesized whole for helping them to have an overall impression of the person concerned.
- Moreover, here in deriving a holistic overall impression of the stranger from the available seven traits, the mechanism and contribution of the central and peripheral traits played a quite significant role. In the lists provide to them, while the words appearing as “warm” and “cold” were representing the central traits of the stranger’s personality, all the rest stood for the peripheral traits. As we know, a trait that is central carries more weight in the description of one’s personality and thus plays a quite central role on the formation of our impression about the person, leaving one’s peripheral traits into shadow. Thus, the responses of the subjects in both the groups differed too much simply because they were focusing mainly around the central traits – warm and cold – of the stranger.
- For obtaining additional support for his derived conclusions about the role of central traits in shaping the subjects’ all over impression about the stranger, Asch substituted the words **polite** and **blunt** for **warm** and **cold** and asked them again to put their impressions of the stranger into words. The evaluation of the responses of the subjects now revealed that the effects on subjects’ impressions of the stranger were far weaker at this time in comparison to the former with the use of **warm** and **cold**. It happened possibly for the reason that **polite** and **blunt** did not work as the strong and effective central words for casting a strong impact on their first impressions about the stranger as **warm** and **cold** did.

- On the basis of his experimental studies Asch, tried to conclude that:
 - Information about the personality traits of a person helps us in deriving an impression about him. However, forming impressions of others involves more than simply adding together individual traits.
 - For making impressions on the basis of these personality traits we try to organize them into an organized whole i.e., attempting to form an impression of the entire person or drawing a composite picture in which all the traits may fit together in a quite consistent and proper way.
 - In allowing traits to play their role in making an overall impression about a person, we have to give much importance to the central traits as they cast a stronger impact on our impressions than peripheral traits.

In addition to the view expressed by Asch for explaining the process of first impression formation on the basis of his configuration model i.e., organizing the knowledge about the traits and characteristics of people into an organized whole, several other viewpoints, theories, approaches and models have also been in vogue as a result of some or the other researches in the field of social cognition. Let us examine them.

Implicit Personality Theories for Explaining the Process of Impression Formation

Implicit personality theories refer to our beliefs regarding what traits or characteristics tend to go together for the formation of impression about others. These beliefs of ours are said to be closely integrated with a certain type of schemas (mental maps) existing in our mind through our long- drawn experiences (direct or indirect) suggesting that when a person possesses some traits, they are likely to possess other likewise traits also. As a result, when someone describes a person as “helpful” and “kind” we would also perceive him to be sincere. Similarly, if our friend describes a stranger as “practical” and

“intelligent” person, we would also assume him to be ambitious. In the study conducted by Asch (1946), we have seen how the subjects of the study had a clear-cut schema conveying them what type of traits are supposed to travel along with having a warm or cold temperament. This phenomenon is commonly observed in our day-to-day social life.

For example, in our Indian culture, we have a belief that “what is beautiful is good” – that people who are attractive also possess other positive traits, such as good social skills and interest in enjoying good times and good things in life. Besides this, a large number of research studies, especially those related to birth order and personality such as conducted by Herrera et al. (2003), reveal that our beliefs about what traits or characteristics go together play a very significant role in shaping our impressions of others. As a result, we are more often found to form impressions of others that reflect our implicit beliefs more than their actual traits in such impression formation.

Cognitive Approach for Explaining the Process of Impression Formation

The cognitive approach for explaining the process of impression formation emphasizes that impression formation is not carried out in a cognitive vacuum but for serving this purpose, it essentially utilizes the basic knowledge of social cognition i.e., the ways in which we notice, store, remember and integrate social information.

According to cognitive view, our basic ideas regarding how impressions are formed and changed are influenced mainly by two factors: (i) exemplars – concrete examples of behavior – and (ii) mental abstractions – mental summaries that are abstracted from repeated observations of others’ behaviors. Let us examine the role of these two factors in our impression formation.

Exemplars: It refers to concrete examples of behavior others have performed in the past and we have actually encountered while having interaction with them. This behavior of theirs, while centered round a cardinal personality trait such as honesty, aggressiveness, kindness, punctuality, fearlessness or

timidity, etc., may be found to be quite consistent for forming our impression about them. Accordingly, while making our impression about them we recall examples of their behavior and base our judgment on such exemplars.

For example, we recall that during our first conversation with a certain woman, she interrupted us repeatedly, made nasty comments about other people and failed to hold open a door for someone whose arms were loaded with packages. The result: As we recall these pieces of information, we include the trait “inconsiderate” in our first impression of this person (Baron and Byrne, 2001:65).

In this way, we may conclude that our first impressions of others are formed mainly in the light of the exemplars – concrete examples of behaviors indicative of their personality traits. After then, the task of our impression formation is further carried out to its destination with the use of the mechanism of abstractions. Let us now examine the role of these abstractions.

Abstractions: The concept used in the field of social cognition in the name of abstractions for helping us in making impressions about others refers to mental summaries that are abstracted from repeated observations of others’ behavior. When we see a person behaving in a particular way as showing the trait of “inconsideration”, on the part of a woman in our example, and the same behavior is observed by being shown by the other people – men and women – at one or the other time in our social encounters, then, it helps us to develop a sort of mental abstraction – a cognitive framework or picture about the behavior and actions of the person imbued with the trait of “inconsideration”. The similar abstractions – mental pictures of the behaviors of the people – may also be available with us on the basis of past experiences or former encounters with them on one or the other social situations, in respect of the other traits of their personality such as unfriendliness, unsociability, hard-working, punctuality, honesty, kindness, etc. All these types of abstractions stored in the form of different mental frameworks may be now timely recalled and integrated with the available information about the person, for making an overall impression about him.

The preceding viewpoint conveying that the two cognitive mechanisms – exemplars and abstractions – play a quite significant role in impression formation has been endorsed by a large number of research evidence (Klein and Loftus, 1993; Klein et al., 1992). In this concern, it is to be clearly noted that in the beginning, the task of the formation of initial impressions about the people is mainly helped by the mechanism of exemplars (concrete examples of the behaviors of these people). But afterwards, when we have more social encounters and experiences with people, our impressions shift towards consisting mainly of abstractions – mental summaries of their behavior on many occasions.

To Sum Up

The term impression formation is used for the processes involved in the formation of impressions about others on the basis of available information about them. It begins in the form of the first impression one makes on others. Such first impressions formed by the individual about others are said to be quite lasting and enduring in their effects and applications. The explanation for how available information about others is used for the formation of first impressions about them in our first social encounter came for the first time from the famous socio-psychologist Solomon Asch through the use of the *configuration model* (perception of information about the person in the gestalt form) developed by him on the basis of a few experimental studies conducted by him in the year 1946. On the basis of his studies, he tried to conclude that the task of the formation of first impressions about strangers at the time of our first encounter with them is performed by us by organizing all pieces of information regarding their personality traits (central and peripheral) into a synthesized whole.

Implicit personality theories point towards our beliefs regarding what traits or characteristics tend to go together for

the formation of impressions about others. These beliefs of ours are said to be closely integrated with a certain type of schema (mental map) existing in our mind through our long-drawn experiences (direct or indirect) suggesting that when a person possesses some traits (i.e., helpful, kind), they are likely to possess other likewise traits (sincere, honest) also.

Cognitive approach for explaining the process of impression formation emphasizes that the task of impression formation is carried out through the utilization of the basic knowledge of social cognition i.e., the ways in which we notice, store, remember and integrate social information. In the opinion of the cognitive approach, thus, the task of impression formation on our part about others is influenced mainly by two factors: (i) exemplars – concrete examples of behavior – and (ii) mental abstractions – mental summaries that are abstracted from repeated observations of others’ behaviors.

Models of Impression Formation

Besides the theoretical viewpoints emphasized and theories put forward for explaining the formation of impressions about others, researchers and thinkers in the field of social perception have developed a variety of models. In this concern, we have already talked about a model developed by Asch (1946) in the name of *configuration model* aimed to configure or combine a lot of diverse information about others into unified impressions about them. Besides this model, researchers have figured out other models such as additive, average and weighted average models for the purpose. Much like the configuration models, these models also depend on a key assumption – it is the overall positive or negative evaluation of the person that makes us form one or the other type of impression about the person.

Let us try to examine these three types of models.

Additive Model of Impression Formation

Additive model of impression formation emphasizes assigning the addition of all the trait evaluations that we carry out about a particular person. For carrying out the trait evaluation task, we may use the help of measuring tools like semantic differential scale or any suitable rating scale designed for the purpose of impression measurement such as given here:

Unsociable	Sociable
Lazy	Hardworking
Non-sincere	Sincere
Serious	Jovial
Dishonest	Honest

In this scale, we can evaluate a person by placing a mark on any of the seven places provided on the scale and assigning the numeric value ranging from 1 to 7.

Now suppose by using the measurement scale, a particular candidate, in connection with our task of forming an impression about him, receives the scores for the traits in the manner such as follows.

Sociable (+5), Hardworking (+3), Sincere (+4), Jovial (+3) and Honest (+3)

Now as per the additive rule his score in terms of his overall impression will be +18. We can compare his scores with the scores obtained by other candidates appearing in the interview for their relative grading or selection for the job.

Averaging Model of Impression Formation

According to Anderson (1981), in the process of predicting the overall impression about the person, the meaning of the traits on certain dimensions may be averaged for the better outcomes.

The statement concerning the adopted averaging rule for this purpose runs as follows:

“The overall evaluation can be predicted by dividing the sum of the trait evaluations by the number of traits used in forming the overall evaluation.”
(Hansen, 1984:28)

In this way, if we make use of the previous example given in the case of the additive rule, then here the overall impression of the candidate as per averaging rule may be computed by the use of a formula stated as:

Overall impression of the individual = Sum of the traits evaluation (as computed with additive model) / Number of traits used in forming the overall evaluation

By using this formula we will thus find that our overall impression of the candidate as per averaging rule is: $18/5 = 3.6$

This average value may now be used for getting it compared with the average impression scores of the other candidates computed in the similar way.

Now, if any new information related to some other personality trait such as tolerance or attractive is additionally available at the later stage, then its impact will depend on deciding whether the rating score of this new information is more or less than the overall averaged impression score.

Weighted Averaging Model of Impression Formation

In addition of providing a due recognition to the use of additive and averaging models for making the overall impression of an individual, the researchers in social psychology have preferred the use of a third model named as weighted averaging model. It makes use of the weighted averaging rule, a somewhat complex cognitive method derived through adding two components to the already existing averaging rule named as (i) trait weights – assigning weightage to the traits and (ii) first or past impressions. Expressing his views about the use of this model, Anderson (1981) has referred to it as an attempt on our part to combine available information about others into a *weighted average* in which each piece of information about another person is weighted in terms of its relative importance. In the formation of impressions about others with the use of this model, thus, we need to assign more weight to some and less to others out of the various types of information available about them in one or the

other situations. Now the question may arise: What are the different factors that influence the task of assigning relative weightage to the different piece of information? In this connection, researchers like Rosenbaum and Lewin (1969), Coovert and Reeder (1990), Mellers et al. (1992) have identified the following factors responsible for influencing the task of such relative weighting on the part of the perceivers.

- *The Sources of Input:* The sources from where information is coming occupy a great significance in the formation of impression. We as perceivers always provide heavy weightage to the information which we trust and admire in comparison to the information coming from the sources we distrust or suspect.
- *Positive and Negative Nature of Information:* In using information for the impression formation, the information is identified as positive or negative. In general, the negative information is provided more attention and weightage for making impressions about others than the positive ones. It happens so because the information loaded with negativity is more attractive, attention drawing and distinctive than the positive ones.
- *Unusual or Extreme Behavior:* Among the available information for the task of impression formation, the information describing or characterizing behaviors or traits of the persons as unusual or extreme in nature are usually provided more attention and weightage on the part of the perceivers.
- *Primacy Effect:* The past information (particularly the first) matters a lot. Therefore, information received first is given heavier weightage than information received later.

During the process of impression formation on our part about others we try to analyze the stock of information available and tend to give it more or less weightage about them for this purpose. Here the aforementioned factors guide us on our path in doing so.

The total procedure involving the use of weighted averaging model for making an overall impression on the basis of the information available

about him (such as displayed traits and behavior) with the use of a measurement scale such as semantic rating scale may run as follows (we may take the previous example given in the case of additive and averaging models).

- How social, sincere, hardworking, jovial and honest one is, you may tell your impression in this regard now by assigning more or less weightage on the seven-point scale for each of these personality traits. These scores constitute the weighted scores with regard to the different traits examined and evaluated by you for making an overall impression about the person.
- Now add all of these weighted scores and divide them with the number of traits being evaluated (e.g. five in the present example).
- The output resulted now will represent the score for our overall impression about the person concerned. We may make use of this score for having comparison with others with regard to our impression about them after evaluating them also in the same way.

To Sum Up

Besides theories, researchers have also developed certain specific models for explaining our impression formation about others. Asch's configuration model in this concern discusses the process of the formation of a first impression. The other significant models used for explaining overall impression formation are additive model, averaging model and weighted averaging model.

In the use of the **additive model** for explaining the task of impression formation we first go on for the task of evaluating one or the other personality traits of the person concerned with the help of the measuring tools like semantic differential scale or any suitable rating scale designed for the purpose of impression measurement and then try to add all the trait evaluations for making an overall impression about the person.

In its attempt at bettering the prediction of our impression outcomes, the **averaging model** proposes the averaging of the evaluation measures of the traits used for making an impression about the person and for serving the required purpose, puts up before us the formula:

Overall impression of the individual = Sum of the traits evaluation (as computed with additive model) / Number of traits used in forming the overall evaluation

The **weighted averaging model** makes use of the weighted averaging rule, instead of a simple averaging rule used in the averaging model. For making impressions about the individuals, here we first try to weigh each piece of information (the present as well as the first or past impression available about them) in terms of its relative importance and then proceed for the averaging of the so evaluated measure to arrive at the overall impression about the concerned person.

Impression Management

It is a natural tendency among the human beings to want to look good in the eyes of others. In this concern, we always remain in search of ways and means of presenting ourselves before others in such a way as to leave a quite good impression of ours on their mind and heart. It is this art of self-presentation that is referred to as impression management in the field of social perception. As a matter of definition, thus, we can define the term impression management as the efforts made and methods applied by us for presenting ourselves in a way to create a favorable impression of ours on others.

Impression Management

Our efforts to have a good impression on others, i.e., to make others see us as we like to be seen.

Methods and Techniques Used for Impression Management

In general, the methods and techniques employed on the part of the people for creating good impression on others may be broadly categorized as (i) self-enhancement techniques and (ii) other-enhancement techniques. Let us examine these two types of techniques helpful for the individuals in their impression management.

Self-Enhancement Techniques

Impression management techniques classified as self-enhancement techniques may be defined as the efforts and provisions made on our part to boost our own self-image. In making use of these techniques people, in general, are found to adopt the following two modes.

1. They may make one or the other type of efforts for improving their personal appearance by resorting to the means like:
 - Bringing change or alteration in their dress (clothing and footwear).
 - Caring for their personal grooming with the use of the cosmetics, changing hair styles, coloring of hair and bodies, using perfumes, etc.
 - Making use of various props such as bearing of eye glasses, contact lenses, jewelry and ornaments, and hair wigs, etc.
 - Making use of alcohol, smoking cigarettes, using drugs and visiting night clubs, etc.
 - Making use of the attention providing non-verbal cues such as gestures, body movements, facial expressions, etc.
2. They may make use of a vocal self-enhancement or self-promotion tactic in the form of self-praise i.e., telling about their achievements and the goodness at their own by resorting to the means such as:
 - Narrating how they have overcome the difficulties coming in their path at one or the other time.
 - Telling how they have faced the challenges which are not so common.

Other-Enhancement Techniques

Other-enhancement i.e., enhancing the self of others, falls just opposite to the work done for enhancing the self on the part of the people. Here they are supposed to make efforts on their part to enhance the self-esteem of the target person and make him/her feel good in their presence. Some of the techniques used for enhancing the other's self-esteem utilized on the part of individuals, in general, may be accounted as follows:

- Resorting to the tactic of flattery i.e., showering praise over or appreciating the target person even if they do not deserve it.
- In the course of having conversation or working with the target person expressing agreement with their views and plans of action.
- In the course of social interaction showing a high degree of interest in them.
- Making efforts for doing one or the other small favors for them.
- Asking them for their advice and feedback.
- Presenting themselves before the target person in the manner to realize them as if they always feel good as well as favored in the presence of them.
- Trying to express liking for the target person through verbal and non-verbal communication.

Regarding the **importance and significance of the task of impression management**, a large body of research evidences (e.g. Schlenker (1980), Wayne and Kacmar (1991), Wayne and Linden (1995), Paulhus et al. (1995) etc.) suggests that efforts to engage in impression management on the part of individuals at one or the other occasions of their social encounter, when done judiciously with care, may prove highly useful and beneficial for them in achieving their desired goals. In the daily life as well as in professional and business related areas we may ourselves clearly

witness the result achieved and gains made with the use of the self- and other-enhancement techniques of impression management. One can achieve and gain much in terms of their work done, results achieved in interviews, choosing life partner, getting promotion in the service, striking a business deal, and seeking adjustment in one's social and personal life, etc.

However, it does not mean that the tactics employed for impression management in the form of self- or other-enhancements always bring positive and favorable results to the doers. The story may be altogether different proving too costly to the individuals who engage in the enhancement or promotion of their self or other's self in quite excessive and undesirable ways. As example, these unpleasant outcomes may be cited as follows.

- Unwise and excessive use of beauty products and self-decorative material; engaging in the practice such as skin piercing, excessive coloring and painting of the body, etc. may turn into health hazards in the form of one or the other skin and allergic problems.
- Resorting to smoking, alcohol and drugs consumption, and night club adventures may bring quite unpleasant social and physical outcomes for the persons using them as self-image enhancers.
- Self-appreciation in the form of boasting about one's own achievements, adventures and goodness for raising one's self in the eyes of others may get misfired as others are quite intelligent to see what is fitted for you and your capabilities. The difference between your sayings and actions may be easily noticed resulting in their loss of trust and faith in you. Thus, instead of proving helpful, your tactic now may work contrarily to degrade you in the eyes of others.
- The means used for enhancing or promotion of the self-esteem and ego of others, also if used unwisely in a disproportionate manner may bring quite negative results. In case you are supporting a person even knowing well that he is wrong for the sake of his self-enhancement, then certainly what you are doing is nothing but an attempt to push him in a deep trench. By doing such things with the people, you yourself

lose your own reputation and degrade yourself in your own and others' eyes.

Seeing in this way, we may properly infer that the task of impression management is a quite skilled and carefully organized venture. It needs the application of the quite well thought and planned techniques and tactics of impression management being researched as well as experienced at the hands of the wise thinkers. The application of these so valued techniques and tactics, however, further needs a quite judicious and proportionate use of them so that the efforts for enhancing the ego of the self or the ego of others may seek a proper balance with the overall interests and welfare of the self and others.

To Sum Up

As a matter of definition, we can define the term impression management as the efforts made and methods applied by us for presenting ourselves in a way to creating a favorable impression of ours on others.

The task of impression management is a quite skilled and carefully organized venture. It needs the application of the quite well thought and planned methods and techniques of impression management. These methods and techniques used by us for the task of impression management may be broadly categorized as (i) self-enhancement techniques and (ii) other-enhancement techniques. While in the former category we may include all the efforts and provisions made on our part to boost our own self-image, the other-enhancement techniques are meant for enhancing the self of others and thus may include all such efforts and provisions made on our part to enhance the self-image of others.

In the use of these both types of techniques, we should however be quite careful in making a quite judicious and proportionate use of them so that the efforts for enhancing the ego of the self or the ego of others may seek a proper balance with the overall interests and welfare of the self and others.

Review Questions

1. What is social perception? Discuss in detail.
2. While defining the term social perception, throw light on its meaning and nature.
3. "Our non-verbal communication is said to play a quite significant role in helping us in our social cognition." In the light of this statement, discuss in detail the role of non-communication in our social perception.
4. What is attribution? How does it help us in our understanding, why people behave in the way, they do?
5. What are the various attribution theories? Name and discuss any one of them in detail.
6. What is Heider's naïve psychology attribution theory? Describe and discuss it in detail.
7. What is Kelley's theory of causal attribution? Describe and discuss it in detail.
8. What is Jones and Davis's correspondence inference theory? Describe and discuss it in detail.
9. What is Shaver's attribution model used for explaining attribution? Describe and discuss it in detail.
10. What is Weiner's attribution theory? Describe and discuss it in detail.
11. What do you understand by the term attribution biases? Discuss in detail the various types or forms of attribution biases generally emerging in our social perception.
12. Throw light on the nature and impact of the following types of biases in our social perception:
 - (i) Fundamental attribution bias or corresponding attribution bias.
 - (ii) Actor-observer bias.
 - (iii) Self-serving attribution bias.
13. Discuss in detail the applications and significance of attribution theory in various fields or spheres of our life.
14. What is impression formation? Explain how task of impression formation is carried out.
15. Throw light on the nature and application of the following:
 - (i) Implicit personality theories for explaining the process of impression formation.
 - (ii) Cognitive approach for explaining the process of impression formation.
16. Name and discuss the important theoretical models used for explaining the task of impression formation.
17. Throw light on the nature and use of the following types of impression formation models:
 - (i) Additive model, (ii) average model and (iii) weighted average model.
18. What is impression management? Name and discuss the various methods and techniques used for impression management.

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7.

SELF-PERCEPTION

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- Throw light on the meaning and concept of self.
- Tell about the meaning of self-awareness and discuss how it gets developed.
- Provide the meaning of the term self-concept and throw light on its development among individuals.
- Discuss the factors affecting the development of self-concept.
- Name the various theories of self-concept management and maintenance and describe and discuss them in detail.
- Provide the meaning of the term self-esteem and throw light on its development among individuals.
- Discuss the characteristics of persons having high and low self-esteem.
- Name and discuss the various forms or kinds of self-esteem.
- Explain how one's self-esteem is measured.
- Provide the meaning of the term self-efficacy and throw light on the ways and means for the development of self-efficacy.
- Elucidate the nature and characteristics of self-efficacy.
- Tell about the role of self-efficacy in the progress and well-being of the persons.
- Provide the meaning of the term self-regulation and throw light on its development among individuals.
- Discuss the characteristics of self-regulated individuals.

Introduction

For having proper interaction and relationships with others in one's society and community, one is needed not only to have a proper knowledge about the mechanism of social perception for knowing and understanding others in relation to the available

social environment, but should also have essential insight into the phenomenon of self-perception – knowing and understanding his or her self in a proper way. The knowledge and understanding of the self in this regard is found to involve a number of the associated attributes and aspects such as

self-awareness, self-concept, self-esteem, self-efficacy and self-regulation, etc. Let us try to examine them one by one in some essential details. But first let us concentrate over knowing the meaning of the term 'self' itself.

What Is Self? – Its Meaning and Concept

Self in its common sense understanding as well as dictionary meaning is known as the distinct identity and individuality of a person. In their attempts to throw light on its meaning and concept, various thinkers and authors have tried to define it in various ways. Let us take some of these definitions into our consideration.

Ausubel (1952:13): Self is defined as the combination of one's physical appearance, personal memories and sensory images.

Yinger (1971:158): The term self may be defined as the mental images of who I am or what I want to be.

Taylor et al. (2006:131): Self is the collection of beliefs we hold about ourselves. The contents of these beliefs are called self-concept.

Crisp and Turner (2014:135): The self is a fundamental part of every human, a symbolic construct which reflects an awareness of our own identity.

Self

A symbolic construct in the form of mental images and collection of our beliefs about ourselves to get us aware of our own identity.

Analysis of the preceding definitions may help us in drawing a conclusion about the meaning and nature of the term self in the way as follows.

Self is not a reality – anything possessed by us in its concrete form – but a symbolic construct. It stands in the form of mental images and collection of our beliefs about ourselves that helps us (i) in getting the answers of some of the basic questions such as who am I and for what I stand, and (ii) in enabling to recall and remember our past, assessing our present and projecting our future.

Self-Awareness – Meaning and Development

The term self-awareness in its word meaning stands for the awareness of one's self. Therefore, for deriving its meaning, we should try to be clear about the terms 'self' and 'awareness'.

- In this concern we have just discussed about what we mean by the term self. One's 'self' in the light of what has been pointed out above may stand for anything and everything which helps a person in knowing and understanding him or her in his/her uniqueness besides getting distinguished from others. In the form of a hypothetical construct, the self of a person may be essentially known as the outcome or product of one's own introspection or reflexive action.
- On the other hand, awareness as a term stands for a psychological state of an individual in which he or she is found to be conscious of their traits, feelings and behavior. It represents the capacity and ability of a person to identify, recognize or taking cognition on his part of one or the other things lying all around him including his self with the application of one or the other tools (helpful in his task of cognizance and recognition) including his own introspection.

Self-Awareness

One's ability to recognize oneself as an individual quite separate from the environment and other individuals and a capacity for introspecting one's self.

After understanding the meaning of the terms self and awareness, we can now define the term self-awareness as (i) the ability to recognize oneself as an independent social entity i.e., an individual quite separate from the environment and other individuals and (ii) a capacity for introspecting one's self.

Regarding the types and kinds of self-awareness, socio-psychologists have named two types of

self-awareness such as (i) private self-awareness and (ii) public self-awareness.

Private self-awareness is a type of awareness that is concerned with the people's awareness of their private and personal aspects of the self. In the course of the development of self-awareness among individuals, this type of awareness is first aroused. "People become privately self-aware when they see their face in a mirror, or experience physiological arousal which may lead them to reflect on their emotional state, for example whether they are happy, excited or angry" (Crisp and Turner, 2014:137).

Private Self-Awareness

A type of self-awareness concerning our awareness about our private and personal aspects of the self.

In the course of the development of self-awareness among people, public self-awareness is visible among individuals after the initiation of the first type of self-awareness – private self-awareness. Public self-awareness as a term stands for a type of awareness that is concerned with the people's awareness of their public or social aspects of the self. "People are publicly self-aware when they are being watched by others, for example giving a presentation, talking in a seminar, being photographed or being filmed. Public self-awareness is associated with evaluation apprehension" (Crisp and Turner, 2014:138).

Public Self-Awareness

A type of self-awareness concerning our awareness about our public or social aspect of the self.

Development of Self-Awareness

In connection with its presence and development among individuals, it can be properly said that it is not innate and inherited. No child at birth is found

to be equipped with the ability or capacity known as self-awareness. It gets developed among children much like the other traits or characteristics of his behavior after getting needed environmental exposure and acquiring the necessary cognitive capacity for separating his identity from other people or objects lying in his environment. Commenting on this aspect Feldman (2016:174) writes:

We are not born with the knowledge that we exist independently from others and the larger world. Very young infants do not have a sense of themselves as individuals; they do not recognize themselves in photos or mirrors. The roots of self-awareness, knowledge of oneself, begin to grow at around the age of 12 months.

Thus, starting in infants with the recognition of their faces and body in mirrors, pictures and photos, voices from the audio-video recording, the sense of self-awareness goes on developing in children as they go on advancing in their ages and stages of development. During their developmental years this ability or capacity of recognizing and identifying one's self reaches its top in the period of adolescence. Now they are very much seen to get engaged in seeking the answers of questions related to the identity of their self, such as: Who am I? From where have I come? For what am I here? With the development of higher cognitive abilities to think, reason, analyze and conceptualize, they are now also in the process of seeking and understanding the available philosophical explanation about knowing and understanding one's self. Is it my body or physical appearance which is called my 'self', or should it be my voice, smell, brain or my thoughts and views that are to be identified as my 'self', or is it the composition of all such as body, mind and spirit that makes the sense of 'self' for me? The thinking and searching for answers of such questions now may be helping developing children in making attempts for getting acquainted with their self.

Apart from this continuous process of evolving and developing self-awareness among developing children, one thing is quite clear that whatever the developmental level may be, the development of self-awareness i.e., awareness about one's self among

a developing infant, provides sufficient ground and opens all the channels for the proper development of his self in its higher forms such as the emergence and development of his self-concept, instilling him with a sense of self-esteem or self-regard, and self-efficacy, and enabling him to demonstrate self-regulation in his behavior.

Self-Concept and Its Development

Meaning of the Term Self-Concept

Humans are not only found to form and possess specific concepts about the objects, persons or events related to their environment but also are characterized with the possession of specific concept about the 'self'. The concepts formed and possessed by the individuals about their 'self' are termed as self-concepts. A self-concept formed by an individual may thus represent a mental image, notion or generalized idea formed by him through his own experiences, learning or training about his self. The self-concept possessed by us in fact, thus, is the mirror of our 'self'. It reflects or mirrors all what we think in totality about our 'self'. In the words of famous psychologist H.J. Eysenck (1947), "the totality of attitudes and qualities may thus be referred to one's self-concept".

The concept of the self is, thus, found to reflect one's own ideas and picture drawn about his total self – revealing to us many of the things such as (i) what we think about our self, (ii) what we are in fact in our eyes, (iii) what are our strengths and weaknesses, (iv) what are our abilities and incapacities, (v) how we are expected to behave in a particular situation, (vi) how we can stand against odds, and (vii) how can we win cooperation, love and confidence of others, etc.

Thinking on this line, Baumeister (1998) tried to define the term self-concept as "the total organized body of information that any given person has about him or herself". Self-concept of an individual, thus, in all its ways of understanding and defining is nothing but a generalized idea or image formed by him about his self. It helps him to assign the required worth and value for his 'self' in his own eyes (the reflection of his own about himself) irrespective of what is judged and said about others. As a conclusion, thus, the *self-concept of individuals may be defined as*

a generalized idea, notion or mental picture drawn by them about their self through their prior experience or learning enabling them to distinguish themselves from other individuals or objects, and to have a proper estimate about their strengths and capacities.

Self-Concept

A generalized idea or image formed by the individuals about their self, helping them in assigning the required worth and value to their 'self' in their own eyes.

Development of Self-Concept Among Individuals

The self-concept or any other concept possessed by an individual is not a matter of one's heredity. It is acquired like other traits, characteristics of one's personality or behavior through experience and learning. What the individuals get after their birth in the form of direct and indirect experiences from their interaction with the physical, social and cultural environment and how they are reared and receive their education, all cast a powerful impact over the formation of their concept about their self.

The process of self-concept formation starts in the baby infants with their attempts to get their voice and face distinguished and recognized as different from their mother and other persons around them. After standing against the mirror now they are able to rub off any substance poured, powder spread over their face, nose, etc. and respond well to the questions identifying their body parts. They can recognize them in their family photo and turn their head after being called by the. It is the stage of the development of their awareness about their 'self'.

The next phase of the development of their self-concept is concerned with the development of ideas or notions of the benefits they may derive through the type and nature of their weeping, smiling and behaving in one way or the other. They also may have an idea what is there in them that is liked by others and in what way. The task of formation or

development of the concept about self is thus concerned with the task of the formation of an image or drawing of a picture by the individuals themselves, their totality of behavior, personality characteristics, strengths and weaknesses, power and limitations, etc. in a composite way. In doing so, they may be seen to form two types of self-images, one termed as physical self-image and the other as psychological self-image.

Physical self-images are concerned with images formed by the children in their individual capacity about their body structure, color, shape, weight and height, strength and stamina, physical and motor abilities, intelligence and cognitive functioning, etc. The formation of such an image helps them in taking evaluative judgments about their physical appearance, strengths, and stamina, physical and mental capacities, and anticipating the reaction of others in reference to the possession of these physical attributes by them.

The psychological self-images are concerned with the psychological-self i.e., thinking and feelings. The realm of these is covered thorough the concepts related to the thoughts, emotion, attitudes, interests, aspirations and feelings of the children in their individual capacity and how they see them in relation to the possession of such concepts. Where the task of developing physical self-image is related with the satisfaction of physiological needs and experiences associated with them, the development of psychological self-images is concerned with the experiences associated with the satisfaction of socio-psychological needs. Since the satisfaction of physiological needs comes well before the satisfaction of psychological needs the individuals may be seen to acquire physical self-image quite earlier than the acquisition of psychological self-image on their part. However, as individual beings cross the period of adolescence both physical and psychological images get immersed into each other resulting in a unifying and integrated picture of one's self-concept. It also has been seen that where in childhood concrete self-concepts get developed in a substantial form rather than the abstract ones, adolescence witnesses the development of abstract self-concepts in an increasing way.

There is one more striking feature regarding the development of self-concept among individuals in the early years of their childhood. The opinions and judgments of their parents, members of the family, peers and teachers play a more dominant role than their own opinions in helping them to form concepts about their self. A child identifies and knows himself in the way and manner as identified and told by others. He is naughty, he is cowardly; he does not fear anybody; he is too adamant; he does not listen to anybody; that girl is black, unholy or unfortunate. Such types of comments addressed to children persuade them to pick up the same feelings and conceptions about them. They try to pass value judgment about them and mirror them accordingly as judged and declared by others.

However, as they advance towards maturity, the scope and field of their experiences of learning, cognition and understanding also increase in a substantial manner. Now they become capable of engaging in the task of developing self-concept in an independent way. They no longer mirror themselves in the way as viewed and judged by others. The past experiences as well as their present interaction with the persons and environment guide the process of formation of their self-concept. However, the gains of maturity on their part do not guarantee the formation of proper and desirable concept about their self. They may not be able to form the correct concept about their self, meaning thereby that they may evaluate themselves in a quite low way or estimate themselves too highly in terms of their actual abilities and capacities. Development of such faulty and improper concepts leads them towards mal-adjustment, failure and frustrations. Here it becomes essential to take steps for helping the individuals to protect them from the ill impacts of the developed faulty concepts by helping them to know the reality about their self.

To Sum Up

The task of self-concept development among individuals is carried out right from their babyhood in a sequence of certain specific stages.

The initial stage, in this sequence, is the stage of the development of their awareness about their 'self'. It is characterized with their attempts to get their voice and face distinguished and recognized as different from other persons around them, responding well to the questions identifying their body parts, recognizing them in their family photo. The next phase of the development of their self-concept is concerned with the task of the formation of an image or drawing of a picture by them about their self. In doing so, they may be seen to form two types of self-images, one termed as physical self-image (concerning the possession of one or the other physical attributes) and the other as psychological self-image (concerning their one or the other psychological attributes).

However, as individuals cross the period of adolescence and attain maturity, both physical and psychological images get immersed into each other resulting in a unifying and integrated picture of one's self-concept. At this final stage, development of both types of self-concepts – concrete as well as abstract – may be witnessed among the developing individuals. Moreover, now they become capable of engaging in the task of developing self-concept in an independent way rather than mirroring their self in the way as viewed and judged by others.

Factors Affecting Development of Self-Concept

The concept about the self is quite personal and unique for an individual being. Its development in the individual being, as discussed earlier, is the function of his interaction with his environment and gaining of experiences (direct or indirect). The various factors related to the people's self and their environment are said to affect and influence their self-concepts. Let us examine them.

1. **Perception of the Self:** One's self-concept, to a quite great extent, is said to be the product and outcome of his perception about his self. It sets the direction and goal for the development of the self-concept among individuals. Since it is personal, it remains subjective and not objective in nature. One's self-perception may thus have all possibilities of getting biased and misleading resulting in the formation of a faulty concept about one's self.
2. **Perception of Others:** Besides how one perceives his self, the perception of others about the concerned individual also plays a quite significant role in the formation and development of self-concepts among the developing individuals. When children are referred to as quite naughty, irresponsible, unbelievable, or well mannered, sincere and honest in their dealing, the development of self-concept among them accordingly picks up negative and positive direction.
3. **Role of Environmental Experiences or Exposure:** What one gets from his environment and environmental exposure at one or the other time in the course of his development affects and influences his development in a quite significant way. Since there is too much diversity in the environment or experiences available to the developing children, the formation of the self-concept among them also shows significant variations and diversities. Accordingly, children may be found to view themselves differently in the way as colored or designed by the diversities present in their environmental experiences. We may name and know these diversities from a number of angles such as social, cultural, community, religion, caste, gender, location, language, socio-economic status and literacy of parents, etc., each of which has a strong potential for affecting and influencing the nature of self-concept among the developing children. Let us try to adjudge their relative or diverse role in this respect.
 - (i) **Socio-cultural Impact:** The type of society, social exposure and cultural interaction available to the children in their developmental age is very much responsible for shaping the formation of their

self-concept in a particular way. We may witness the differences observed in the development of self-concept among the children brought up in one or the other types of socio-cultural environments. For example, the socio-cultural environment available to the children studying in the famed expensive residential public schools may thus be seen to work for the development of a particular type of self-concept among children characterized with egoistic attitude, dominating and ruling nature, superiority complex and high achievement motivation opposed to the confining in the self, inferiority feelings and low achievement motivation colored self-concept developed in the children of government and economy schools.

- (ii) **Community or Society Variation:** The community and society in which children live and develop possess a strong potential for coloring the development of self-concept among children. Rural and urban community, orthodox and progressive community, civilized and uncivilized community, criminal and non-criminal community, illiterate and educated community, thus, may be found to nurture a quite diverse type of self-concepts among their developing children. The image of a community as the habitat or abode of the pocket pickers, smugglers or criminals may impress upon its developing children to get imbibed with the self-concept of such undesirable behavior or bad character. They may begin to think or accept them in such a bad role.
- (iii) **Religion Impact:** Religion or faith observed by the family, parents or the children themselves may also be found to play a quite decisive role in the development of a particular type of self-concept among the developing children. The followers of religions like Buddha and Jainism advocating adoption of non-violence in one's thoughts and actions

may be found to develop a non-violent, non-aggressive and peace loving attitude and self-concept among its children in contrast to the reactionary, aggressive and violent natured self-concept developed among the children following the religions advocating killing of the animals and human beings in the name of offering sacrifice, and making others to follow their religion with the use of force or negative means. As one of the glaring examples of the impact of religion on the formation of self-concept we may at present witness that where all over the globe some followers of the Islam religion have been found to engage in terrorist acts, there the youths following Islam have begun to develop such self-concept among them.

- (iv) **Caste Factor:** The caste factor i.e., sense of belongingness to a particular caste may cast a quite stronger impact over shaping the self-concept of the developing children in a particular form. Where the sense of being a Brahmin may develop a particular type of dominating and superiority complex ridden self-concept among the children belonging to the Brahman caste, the children belonging to the lower castes and scheduled tribes may get infected with a type of concept colored with inferiority feelings, low achievement motive and poor self-expectations. Similarly, the sense of belongingness to a business community/caste may be found to be helpful in the development of a self-concept colored with adventurism, risk taking behavior and laborious attitude for establishing their own businesses among the children belonging to vaish or other business community castes, and the children belonging to warrior communities like Jats, Gujjars, Yadavs and Rajputs are found to develop a self-concept characterizing the brave and heroic behavior among them.

- (v) **Gender Influence:** Belongingness to a particular gender – male, female or neutral – may be found to develop a particular type of self-concept characterized with masculine, feminine or transgender type nature, attitude and temperament among developing children. Consequently, boys try to get imbibed with the behavioral traits characterized as masculine and girls begin to accept those fit and appropriate for playing the feminine role. Neutral gender children similarly develop the self-concept involving the acceptance of neutral gender role for their interaction and behavior in life. In a traditional society of ours, for example, among the boys and girls the things may go on like: I am a boy and so I should not fear going or staying alone, I am not supposed to do household kitchen activities, the thinking and feelings like these reflect the type of self-concept developed among the boys. Contrarily the feelings like I am a girl and should not participate in the games and activities like boxing, wrestling, horse riding, rock climbing, remaining outside in the late hours but rather try to become expert in house managing and kitchen activities, reflect the things germinating in the self-concepts developed among girls.
- (vi) **Location Factor:** The nature of the habitat and places where the children reside may also be found to play a decisive role in the development of a particular type of self-confidence among developing children. The truth in this regard may be properly visualized by comparing the self-concepts developed among the children belonging to localities such as urban and rural, posh and slum, green and industrial, thinly and thickly populated areas, etc. Similarly, belongingness to a particular region, state or geographical location such as north and south states, hilly and plain areas, being known as Haryanvi, Punjabi, Rajasthani, Gujarati or Keralite may direct the developing children imbibing the diverse self-concepts conceptualized for their respective residential location or habitat.
- (vii) **Language Factor:** The skill of carrying on communication with others and its use for the learning and self-study may exercise a great role in the development of one's self-concept. One may feel handicapped or get benefitted to the extent of one's proficiency in understanding and using a particular language for his development and progress. The related awareness of this efficiency or deficiency may cater to form a particular image for his self. A migrated child may experience a certain type of social and emotional isolation in the company of peers using the local language in their communication and interaction. The children from the Hindi medium schools may similarly experience a lot of inconvenience in seeking admission to a higher class in an English medium school. Here the language barrier may be found responsible for instilling a sense of inferiority complex for getting adjusted to the new environment. It may become a life-long event for many of us who experience difficulty in using English for communication with others especially in oral form. The efficiency of communicating in a day-to-day or learning media language, thus, may work as a quite influencing factor in the development of positive as well as negative self-image among children.
- (viii) **Socio-economic Status Impact:** It is quite usual for developing children to feel elevated or low on account of their raised or low socio-economic status. The higher, middle or lower socio-economic status of their family and parents become a great deciding factor for them to evaluate and place their self before their peers and others in interaction. Privileges enjoyed by the higher socio-economic group children may automatically add to a raised self-confidence

and self-esteem and care-free attitude and similar things shaping their self-concepts in a quite favorable way. On the other hand, children belonging to the poverty ridden families or lower socio-economic status may remain quite occupied and anxious for the satisfaction of their day-to-day basic needs or fulfillment of the demands of the school and peer-group relationship. These things may drift them to form a negative self-image. However, in cases where they emerge victorious in terms of excelling others belonging to higher socio-economic status they may be seen to win over their self, resulting into a quite appropriate positive concept about their self.

- (ix) **Literacy of Parents:** The literacy or illiteracy, and the lower or higher educational level of the parent – mother and father – may add a lot in the formation of positive or negative, higher or lower self-concept among developing children. It works in two ways. In one way, the educational level of the parents either helps or obstructs their learning and development on account of the level of know-how or ignorance of their parents. On the other side, they may feel elevated or low before their peers, teachers and others on account of the higher or discouraging educational level of their parents. The children of illiterate parents may feel discouraged or find themselves at the disadvantageous position and thus may form a poor self-image in comparison to the peers who are at the advantageous side on account of the raised educational level of their parents. It may appear in a more raised conscious level, when their parents happen to visit their school and participate in the teacher-parent meetings and functions of the school. In this way, what they feel for themselves and whether they develop desirable or discouraging images for their self depends a lot on the literacy level of their parents.

To Sum Up

The factors influencing and affecting the self-concept of the individuals may be broadly grouped into two categories – factors related to the people's self and factors related to their environment.

In the category of the factors related to their self we may include the factors like: their own perception about themselves and the perception of others about them. On the other hand, in the category of environmental factors we may include the factors like: socio-cultural impact, community or society variation, religion impact, the caste factor, gender influence, location factor, language factor, socio-economic status impact and literacy of parents.

Theories of Self-Concept Management and Maintenance

How do we keep on and manage our self-concepts? The explanations on this account come from a number of theories known as theories of self-concept management and maintenance. There are six such different theories developed by the socio-psychologists and thinkers that are mainly used for this purpose. For their proper distinction, understanding and use, these six theories may be divided into three groups each consisting of two different theories in the ways as laid down next.

1. **Theories of Self-Comparison:** These theories allow people to compare their self with the perceptions of how their self should be. While having a particular type of self-concept, where they know who actually they are, side by side, they also have an idea of how they would like to be. The theories named as control theory of self-regulation, and self-discrepancy theory, are included in this group.
2. **Theories of Individual Comparison:** The theories of individual comparison try to emphasize

that people learn about their self (who actually they are) by comparing themselves with other individuals, rather than their ideal self as happens with the earlier discussed theories of self-comparison. The theories known as social comparison theory and self-evaluation maintenance theory are included in this group.

3. **Theories of Group Comparison:** In contrast to theories of self-comparison and individual comparison, the target of comparison in the theories of group comparison to the people for learning about their self (who they actually are) is the group to which they belong (such as male, female, artists, teacher, businessmen, etc.) rather than their ideal self or other individuals. The theories known as social identity theory and self-categorization theory, are included in this group.

In this way, it may be clearly seen here by us that the formation of the three groups of theories of self-concept maintenance is based merely on the comparison target chosen for learning about the self (who actually we are). All of the six theories of self-concept put up in these three groups try to throw light on the management and maintenance of self-concept in their own unique ways. Let us examine it one by one.

Control Theory of Self-Regulation

Control theory of self-regulation in its capacity of belonging to the group of theories of self-comparison, lays emphasis on comparing our *self* with the perception of how our *self* should be. In the task of such comparison, the possession of self-awareness on our part (in both types of mode – private self-awareness and public self-awareness) plays a key role for exercising control over our behavior in its capacity of assessing whether or not we are meeting our goals in one or the other social situations. By travelling across a particular cognitive feedback loop (consisting of the four subsequent phases) as recommended by Carver and Scheier (1981, 1988), we may be able to self-regulate our behavior for meeting the expected goals in this pursuit in the manner as given here.

1. *Test Phase:* During this first phase of self-regulation exercise, individuals try to compare the self against one of the two standards – private or public – depending upon the type of self-awareness (private or public) possessed by the individuals. Accordingly, where people who are privately self-aware try to compare themselves against a private standard (the values and norms they respect), the people who are publicly self-aware try to compare themselves against a public standard (the values and norms held by their friends, family members and community people). If people pass the test i.e., feeling that they have met the private or public standard set by them, they directly enter into the fourth phase named as exist phase by crossing over the second and third phases of the cognitive feedback loop. However, when they fail in their mission i.e., feeling that they do not meet the required standard, they have to perform the actions needed to be performed at the next phase named as operative phase.
2. *Operative Phase:* The people who feel that they do not meet the relevant standard – private or public – set by them for themselves in tune with the type of self-awareness – private or public – possessed by them at one or the other social situation are needed to enter this second phase of the cognitive feedback loop. Here they are required to remain operative for bringing needed change in their behavior in order to meet the standard that has been denied to them at the initial test phase.
3. *Test Phase:* For deciding whether or not the individuals have been successful in bringing needed behavioral changes for meeting the relevant private or public standard, they have to enter this third phase for getting them tested again. In the process of their re-testing here the individuals are required to engage in the task of self-reflection, retesting themselves in the form of comparing their self with the norms and values held by their self or others. The results of this retesting decide for them to enter or not to enter the last phase named as exist phase. If they fall short in clearing the set standard – self or public – they have to

pass through the vicious circle comprising of the attempts to bring changes in behavior for meeting the set standard, evaluate themselves for the success in their mission and so on until they feel that their behavior ultimately now matches the standard.

4. *Exist Phase*: The individuals may have their safe entry into this phase after they feel fully satisfied with the attainment of their desired goal – matching of their self-concept related behavior with the set standard. From here now, they are free to exist outside the feedback loop – the vicious circle of operate and test.

Equipped with a feedback loop, the control theory of self-regulation, in this way, may prove quite helpful in making us understand how we can improve the self by exercising needed control through a combination of our self-awareness and self-regulation.

Self-Discrepancy Theory

Self-discrepancy theory of self-concept management owes its origin to the work of Higgins (1987). In its capacity of belonging to the group of theories of self-comparison, like self-regulation theory it also focuses on comparing our *self* with the relevant standard (perception of how our *self* should be). However, in making such comparison, self-discrepancy theory focuses on awareness of the people about the discrepancies (demonstrated by them through their emotional responses) existing between their actual and ideal identity. Proposing his theory, Higgins (1987) argued that people possess three types of self-schema, namely actual self, ideal self and ought self. Here, our *actual self* stands for the self-schema representing what we actually are at present (what we think about ourselves, with regard to our bodily characteristics, mental abilities, capacity and capabilities of doing one or the other things etc.). Our *ideal self*, on the other hand, works as an ideal set by us for becoming as such in the future (what type of characteristic traits and qualities, habits, temperaments, etc. we would like to imbibe). Our *ought self*, in contrast, reflects what in fact we ought to be in relation to what is

expected from us in performing our duties and responsibilities.

In his theory, Higgins further emphasized that in general, people are motivated to ensure that their actual self matches their ideal self as well as the ought self. In cases where it does not match, discrepancies emerge resulting in one or the other types of discomfort for them. For example, if a student having a high aptitude for the study of engineering courses wants to become a lawyer, but his parents want him to become a doctor, his actual self (what he actually is at present with respect to his capabilities) is having a significant discrepancy with his ideal self (what he thinks ideal for him for becoming so in his future) and his ought self (what he should be per expectations of his parents). Such discrepancies while giving birth to some serious types of conflicting desires bring a lot of psychological discomfort for the concerned individuals in the manner as cited next.

- If the discrepancy is actual-ideal discrepancy (discrepancy between one's actual and ideal self) then it is found to give birth to dejection related psychological states such as disappointments, unhappiness, depressions and frustrations among the concerned individuals simply for the reason that ideals are hard to achieve, their present abilities do not match with what they aspire.
- On the other hand, if the discrepancy is actual-ought discrepancy (discrepancy between one's actual and ought self) then it will give birth to highly aroused emotional states such as anger, aggression, fear and nervousness, etc. among the concerned individuals simply for the reason that others are expecting quite differently from them what they actually are.

The self-discrepancy theory, in this way, tries to emphasize that it is one or the other type of discrepancy existing between their actual and ideal or ought self that motivates the people to make changes in their behavior for reducing these discrepancies helpful in managing or maintaining their concept about them accordingly.

Social Comparison Theory

Social comparison theory of self-concept management owes its origin to the work of Festinger (1954). Social comparison theory, in its capacity of belonging to the group of individual comparison, lays emphasis on comparing ourselves with other individuals around us. While providing its views on the maintenance and management of one's concept about the self, the theory emphasizes that people are found to assess their strengths and abilities by comparing these with the strengths and abilities of others around them. Getting better marks in school subjects than their classmates, making more runs or taking more wickets in the cricket tournament in comparison to other players, help individuals not only test or assess their abilities and capacities but also work towards enhancing their ego self in a quite positive way. Here as quoted in the preceding two cases comparing the self-achievements in academic and sport field, individuals are found comparing the self with the others who are somewhat similar. However, there are occasions where their social comparison – comparison with others – takes the form of upward and downward comparisons. In making use of upward comparison, people are found to compare themselves with someone who in their opinion is better than them. It helps them in providing enough motivation for improving and doing better in life, but it may also prove risky by making them feel inferior or worthless in comparison to others. Downward comparison, although not capable of providing proper match for competing and motivation for excellence, is helpful in making them to remain in the race, feel satisfied with what they are and maintain their ego self with the least risk of getting it damaged. However, the appropriate way is to adopt a middle path by maintaining a proper balance between upward and downward comparisons as done in the model adopted in another social comparison theory known as self-evaluation maintenance theory discussed next.

Self-Evaluation Maintenance Theory

Tesser (1988), the propagator of the self-evaluation maintenance theory, expressed his opinions about the management and maintenance of the

self-concepts of individuals through the help of a model known as self-evaluation maintenance model. As you know, we have the least possibility of getting our self-esteem endangered on account of the failures of others. However, the successes of others, certainly, have implications for our own self-esteem. We react and respond to the success of others in certain ways and try to adopt different ways and means for the protection of our ego and maintenance of our self-esteem as per the need of the situation. How all it happens has been explained by Tesser (1988) in his self-evaluation maintenance model in the manner given as follows.

1. We respond to the success of someone else and derive our self-esteem from his/her accomplishments in one of two ways – social reflection and social comparison.
2. In this concern, we are most likely to engage in the acts of *social reflection* in the following situations.
 - (i) A situation in which we find that the domain on which the individuals are successful is irrelevant to us in the sense that their success does not threaten our self-concept in any way. However, here we may be found to celebrate their success, feel proud for their achievements and provide a certain sort of boost to our self-esteem. For example, as parents, teachers or coaches we celebrate the achievements of our children, students and trainees and also feel proud for their achievements. Similarly, we celebrate and feel proud for the achievements of any particular player, athlete, student, researcher or artist belonging to our village, town, district, state or country with no consideration whether or not we belong to the domain or area of their achievements. In both these examples we feel happy and get boosting for our self-esteem simply for the reason that achievements gained on their part, directly or indirectly, adds to our abilities and popularity rather than challenging them.

- (ii) A situation in which we find ourselves quite certain about our abilities regarding our performance and success in a particular domain in which the individuals are successful. Here also, we feel least or no danger to our self-esteem. Commenting over this aspect Crisp and Turner (2014:146) write:

If we are confident that we are also very successful, the success of someone else should pose no threat to us. Instead, their success should actually add to our perception of success. If, for example, you are certain that that you are excellent at psychology, the success of another student is unlikely to concern you. Instead, knowing that someone else is also very good should lead you to reflect on the fact that you are on a top psychology course where the students tend to be excellent, enhancing rather than threatening your self-concept.

3. We are likely to engage in the acts of *social comparison* in the situations when the domain in which someone else is successful is relevant to us in the sense that his or her success threatens or endangers our own self-esteem. For example, you are quite competent and successful as a fast bowler and aspire to be selected in the Indian Cricket team going to South Africa for playing international matches. However, there is one more player in your eyes who has done quite well in the Ranji Trophy and other national level competitions. Certainly, here the success story of this player lies on a dimension that draws you to have a comparison (an upward comparison) between his and your abilities. In this situation, if you are also uncertain about your abilities about getting selected at the hands of the selection team, this will certainly go to affect your self-esteem in a quite negative way. What can help you in this situation to seek ways and means for maintaining your self-esteem in a desired positive way? The self-evaluation maintenance model, here, may help you in this regard by suggesting the use of the following four strategies:

- (i) *Exaggerating the Ability of the Successful Target:* In making use of this strategy, you can attempt to maintain your self-esteem by saying that the fast bowler with whom you are competing is certainly far-far better than you. In fact, he is genius and matchless. Certainly, there can be no comparison between super human beings and the normal ones.
- (ii) *Changing the Target of the Comparison:* In making use of this strategy, people are found to switch the target of the comparison. Instead of going for the upward comparison – comparing them with someone having higher abilities – they may now opt for downward comparison – comparing them with the people having lower abilities and less success. In the present example, you may respond by saying that, let us not talk about him (the genius one), I am quite better than the rest of the players who are appearing for the selection.
- (iii) *Distancing From the Successful Target:* In making use of this strategy, people are found to engage in the practice of maintaining physical and emotional distance with the successful target. They themselves leave the field by saying that there is nothing common between him and you. He is 6 feet and 8 inches in height where you are 5 feet 8 inches; many of the selectors belong to the state or region for which he plays, etc.
- (iv) *Devaluing the Dimension of Comparison:* In making use of this strategy, people are found to engage in the practice of reducing the value of the dimension of comparison. For saving our esteem from injury, we do not compete with the individual in the field in which he is successful or undoubtedly more capable from us, we search for his weakness in other fields, particularly those in which we are more comfortable. Likewise, in the present example, you may say, “He has earned so much efficiency and popularity as a fast bowler, so what, see his social and personal life, I am better than him.”

Social Identity Theory

Social identity theory of self-concept management belongs to the group of theories categorized as theories of group comparison. Accordingly, here the target of comparison is a group instead of a single individual or our own ideal self. This theory owes its origin from the research work carried out by Henri Tajfel (1979).

Let us see what the theory conveys about the maintenance and management of one's concept about the self.

- We humans are social beings. Accordingly, the identity of our own *self* stands divided into its two aspects – personal identity and social identity. The former one helps us to know ourselves in relation to our personal self, i.e., what we are as a person, what type of traits and characteristics are unique to us, etc. The latter one helps in identifying us as a member of one or the other social groups such as our family, village, state, country, groups based on religious faiths, caste, ethnicity, etc. Tejfel (1979) and Tejfel and Turner (1986), in this concern, proposed that the groups which people belonged to were an important source of pride and self-esteem. Groups give us a sense of social identity: a sense of belonging to the social world. However, we may be the members of different social groups at a time. As a single individual, thus, every one of us may be found to hold many identities. Accordingly, what identity or identities we should take into consideration while defining our self-concept may be a thing of serious consideration for us.
- While providing an answer to this question, the propagators of social identity theory assert that our sense of self at one or the other time depends upon which one of our many personal or social identities is more salient (we are most aware of) for contributing towards our own self-concept/self-esteem at a given time, and this awareness in turn is going to depend on the context or the situation prevailing at that time. Commenting on this aspect Crisp and Turner (2014:149) write:

Which identity is salient at any given time depends on the context. Imagine, for example, that you are chatting to a close friend on your

college campus. At this point in time, it is your personal identity that is likely to be salient, as you talk about your personal experiences with another individual. Imagine now that you arrive at the college soccer pitch to watch a match between your college and a rival college. Because you are here to support your college team, your social identity as a member of that college will now be salient.

Self-Categorization Theory

A theory belonging to the group of group comparison theories was brought out by socio-psychologists in the name of self-categorization theory for throwing light on the maintenance and management of self-concept. Turner et al. (1987) have termed it as an extension of social identity theory. The main views underlying this theory may be summarized as follows.

- Based on a normal cognitive functioning, people have a natural tendency to categorize the things for getting these clearly distinguished from each other based on their similarities and dissimilarities. As a result, people are found to have a clear distinction between their personal and social identities and their impact on their self-esteem in one or the other social situations.
- In the situation when one's social identity takes the lead of enhancing his self-esteem on the basis of the successes and accomplishments of the social groups to which he identifies himself in a particular social situation, his personal identity gets merged into his social identity. His self-esteem in this situation is directed and guided totally through his social identity. A player takes pride of the success of his team irrespective of his unsatisfactory performance in the match.
- At a time, an individual may be a member of a number of social groups. He belongs to his family, but he also belongs to his village, district, state and country. In this situation, his social identity also gets differentiated and categorized in the manner such as identification with family, village, district, state and nation, etc. These

different social identities now play their respective roles at one or the other times affecting his self-esteem in their own ways as per demand of the situation. For example, when you are watching an inter-state competition say in the game of hockey, then your self-esteem will necessarily be closely attached to the successes and winning of the Haryana team to which you associate by being the resident of Haryana. However, the story will be different when there are state, district, village level tournaments, as in these situations, your self-esteem will necessarily be associated with your social identities concerning your district, village and family.

- While categorized and put up in a particular group, people see the group to which they belong (the in-group) as being too different from the others (the out-group), and members of the same group as being more similar than they are. Their loyalties are fully assigned to the groups they belong. They think, feel and act in the manner as the group as a whole does and accordingly celebrate or feel unhappy at the success and failure of the group affecting their self-esteem in the same way.
- Moreover, people who define each other in terms of the same social category share an inclusive self that shapes their self-interest and emotions. They feel the experiences of others because what happens to others is also happening to their self if they see themselves as members of the same inclusive self-category. We can't hear anything adverse to our country while living in another country without trying to take a joint stand as the collective self. The things happening in India can affect the self-esteem of the NRI living and serving in foreign countries in a quite positive and negative way.

To Sum Up

Socio-psychologists and thinkers have developed six main theories known as theories of self-concept management and maintenance for explaining the task of managing our self-concept.

In this concern, control theory of self-regulation lays emphasis on comparing our *self* with the perception of how our *self* should be. In the task of such comparison, the possession of self-awareness on our part (in its both types or mode – private self-awareness and public self-awareness) – plays a key role for exercising control over our behavior in its capacity of assessing whether or not we are meeting our goals in one or the other social situations.

Self-discrepancy theory also, like self-regulation theory, focuses on comparing our *self* with the relevant standard (perception of how our *self* should be). However, in making such comparison, self-discrepancy theory focuses on awareness of the people about the discrepancies (demonstrated by them through their emotional responses) existing between their actual self (what they think they are), ideal self (what they think they should be) and ought self (what is expected from them by others).

Social comparison theory lays emphasis on comparing ourselves with other individuals around us. For doing this, we are found to assess our strengths and abilities by comparing these with the strengths and abilities of others around us, i.e., getting better marks in school subjects than other classmates. It helps individuals not only test or assess their abilities and capacities but also works towards enhancing their ego self in a quite positive way.

Self-evaluation maintenance theory makes use of the self-evaluation maintenance model for explaining management and maintenance of the self-concepts of individuals. The model in its use emphasizes that we react and respond to the success of others in one of two ways – social reflection and social comparison – for the purpose of protecting our ego and maintenance of our self-esteem as per need of the situation. We resort to social reflection in the cases where we feel proud for the success of others and celebrating their success

there on our part for providing a certain sort of boost to our self-esteem. In the situations where others' success threatens or endangers our own self-esteem we, while having social comparison as a yard stick, try to protect our ego and maintenance of our self-esteem by resorting to means like exaggerating the ability of the successful person, distancing from the successful person or devaluing the dimension of comparison.

Social identity theory of self-concept management focuses on comparing one's ideal self with a group instead of a single individual. In its proposition, the theory conveys that groups to which we belong are an important source of pride and self-esteem. Our belongingness to a group gives us a sense of social identity. However, we may be the members of different social groups at a time and thus every one of us may be found to hold many social identities. Our sense of self at one or the other time depends upon which one of our many social identities is more salient (we are most aware of) for contributing towards our own self-concept/self-esteem at that time in the prevailing situation.

Self-categorization theory, as an extension of social identity theory, also focuses on the people's social identity contributing towards their sense of self in one or the other situations. While categorized and put up in a particular group, their loyalties are fully assigned to the groups they belong. They think, feel and act in the manner as the group as a whole does and accordingly celebrate or feel unhappy at the success and failure of the group affecting their self-esteem in the same way.

developed self-esteem signifies their liking and paying due regard to their self. Differentiating between these two terms, Feldman (2016:414) writes:

Knowing who you are and liking who you are two different things. Although children, particularly reaching adolescence become increasingly accurate in understanding who they are (their self-concept), this knowledge does not guarantee that they like themselves (their self-esteem) any better. In fact, their increasing accuracy in understanding themselves permits them to see themselves fully – warts and all. It's what they do with these perceptions that leads them to develop a sense of their self-esteem.

In this way, while the term self-concept as we have known and discussed in this chapter stands for what we think about the self, self-esteem denotes the liking shown and value, worth, regard or respect we give to our 'self' in the light of its positive or negative evaluation. In literature, therefore, the term self-esteem is often used as synonyms or near synonyms of the terms self-worth, self-regard, self-respect and self-integrity.

Whatever meaning we attach to the term self-esteem, in its roots, basically, it stands for the value judgment passed by the individuals themselves about their worth and capability in terms of facing problems and difficulties, feeling happy and adjusted and getting successes in their personal, academic, social and professional life. What is their attitude towards their self, how do they value and respect their self, what do they think about their abilities and capabilities, how much do they feel satisfied or dissatisfied with their functioning, how much respect, love and affection, regard and respect do they receive from others? All such things singly or in combination work towards defining people's self-esteem.

Much has been explored about the term self-esteem by scholars. Humanistic psychologists like Karl Rogers and Abraham Maslow have termed self-esteem as one of the higher order basic needs for the attainment of which every one of us struggles and gets a feeling of inner satisfaction and happiness only after knowing and valuing one's self. One's self-esteem, besides helping one to pay respect or regard

Self-Esteem and Its Development

What Is Self-Esteem?

Self-concept and self-esteem both are connected with our self. In their meaning and development both of them differ in a quite considerable way. In a most generalized sense where one's self-concept helps the people in knowing what they are, the

to one's self, is also properly linked with one's sense of confidence in one's worth and capability. Reflecting on such nature and form of the term self-esteem, Branden (1987) has provided an understanding of the term self-esteem in the following words:

Self-esteem is the sum of self-confidence (a feeling of personal capacity) and self-respect (a feeling of personal worth). It exists as a consequence of the implicit judgment that every person has of their ability to face life's challenges, to understand and solve problems, and their right to achieve happiness, and be given respect.

Thus, as conveyed in the preceding assertion, self-esteem may be found to represent an ability, disposition or trait of our personality that helps us first in making an overall evaluative judgment about our self (incorporating both positive and negative aspects) and then assists us in maintaining a healthy positive attitude towards 'self' for valuing and respecting ourselves.

Self-Esteem

A unique ability possessed by individuals enabling them to respect and appreciate their self by accepting and owning it as a whole with its both positive as well as negative aspects.

Looking in this way, *self-esteem may be thought as a unique ability possessed by individuals enabling them to respect and appreciate their self by accepting and owning it as a whole with its both positive as well as negative aspects.*

The Characteristics of Persons Having High Self-Esteem

1. An individual equipped with an appropriate amount of self-esteem may be found to feel good about his self and its capabilities despite a number of weaknesses, limitations and negative attributes of his personality and behavioral functioning. In fact, the person having high

self-esteem may be said to have a blind love for his self. A true lover loves, admires and accepts his beloved with all her positive and negative aspects. The person having self-esteem also in the similar way admires and pays regard to his self by accepting it in its existing form – a mixture of positive and negative attributes. He has an overall good “impression” and attitude marked with the feeling of “All is well” towards his self. It results in making him feel better and developing a sense of utter satisfaction, love and respect for the self.

2. The people with high self-esteem have no complaint and never blame or curse their self for their inadequacies and failures. Instead of cursing their self and blaming others for their failures and hardships they begin to think of doing away with their limitations and shortcomings by working on them in a desirable way.
3. With a healthy self-esteem, they feel that they have positive characteristics and skills they can offer to other people, and they also feel they are worthy of being loved, admired and accepted by others. Persons with healthy self-esteem are more likely to be happy, to make and keep positive relationships and friends circle, and to persevere in working through difficult situations that occur in relationships.
4. Self-esteem serves a motivational function by making it more or less likely that people will take care of themselves and explore their full potential. People with high self-esteem are therefore found to demonstrate a natural inclination and favorable motivation for taking care of themselves and to persistently strive towards the fulfillment of personal goals and aspirations.
5. Persons with high self-esteem are more likely to see challenging situations as opportunities to try something new, even if they're not completely successful. They prove themselves as capable problem solvers. When challenges arise, they can work toward finding solutions and voice discontent without belittling themselves or others. For example, rather than saying, “I'm an idiot,” a child with healthy self-esteem says, “I don't understand this.”

6. They remain away from the feelings and thinking of frustration and depression by giving themselves positive suggestions and engaging in appropriate self-talk and thus remain always surrounded with hopes and optimisms even in the time of difficulties and troubles.
7. Since they value and pay regards to the self, they always try to remain away from the acts and activities that can bring them down in the eyes of others and particularly their own "self".

The Characteristics of Persons Having Low Self-Esteem

1. Persons having low self-esteem are the persons who have little or no confidence in their abilities and capabilities. They are always worried over their weaknesses and limitations instead of having appreciation for their goodness and capabilities.
2. Instead of believing and having faith in the self-evaluation, they are more guided by the negative observations, comments and criticism of their abilities by others. They, thus, are naturally bent upon developing an unhealthy and negative attitude towards their self.
3. On account of devaluing their own self, development of negative attitude towards their capabilities and lack of self-confidence they are accustomed either to feel ashamed, embarrassed, guilty, sad or angry with their self or fall in the trap of frustration, depression, anxiety and stress resulting in the impairment of their mental health and failures in terms of getting adjusted and succeeding in life.
4. Persons with low self-esteem feel hesitant to try new things and may speak negatively about themselves: "I'm stupid," "I'll never learn how to do this," "What's the point of doing this or that?" "I am the person who is not liked by anybody."
5. People with lower self-esteem don't tend to regard themselves as worthy of happy outcomes or capable of achieving the targets and as a result are found to possess a quite low level of achievement motivation. They may have the same kinds of goals as people with higher self-esteem, but on account of their lack of motivation, they tend to let important things slide and to be less persistent in pursuing their goals.
6. They may exhibit a low tolerance for frustration, giving up easily or waiting for somebody else to take over. They tend to be overly self-critical and habitual to condemn and blame their self for anything happening worse or any unfavorable outcomes of the efforts.
7. Persons with low self-esteem see temporary setbacks as permanent, intolerable conditions and a heap of troubles from all round the corners. They are, thus, in the habit of getting into the clutches of utter despair and pessimism by laying down their arms without fighting.

To Sum Up

Persons having high self-esteem are found to possess certain unique characteristics such as: Possessing a sense of utter satisfaction, love and respect for the self; possessing no complaint and never blaming or cursing their self for their inadequacies and failures; more likely to remain happy and to make and keep positive relationships and friends circle; highly motivated in exploring their full potential for achieving their personal goals and aspirations; proving themselves as problem solvers in challenging situations; remaining always surrounded with hopes and optimisms even in the time of difficulties; and remaining away from the acts that can bring them down in the eyes of their own self and others.

On the other hand, persons having low self-esteem are characterized as: Possessing little or no confidence in their abilities and capabilities; developing an unhealthy and negative attitude towards their self; feeling hesitant to try new things; falling victim to frustration, depression and poor mental health; possessing a quite low level of achievement motivation; being overly self-critical and habitual to condemn and blame their self; and being pessimist and habitually laying down their arms without fighting.

Forms and Kinds of Self-Esteem

The term self-esteem may be found functioning or being used in the following three ways and forms in our social life.

1. Trait Self-Esteem (or Global Self-esteem): In this form and kind, people's self-esteem gets reflected through one or the other personality trait (such as self-confidence, sense of worth, endurance, capability, etc.) that represents the way they usually feel about themselves. It is known as trait self-esteem or global self-esteem, as it is relatively enduring across time and situations. Personality traits, in general, are said to be relatively enduring, stable as well as global and thereby, one's self-esteem in the form of trait self-esteem is also found to be comparatively constant, stable and global. It is universal and does not get changed over a period of time. The people who are found to have a lower self-esteem (characterized by lack of self-confidence in their worth) in their childhood are likely to have similar self-esteem even later in their life. Measures like the Rosenberg Self-Esteem scale are used for measuring the trait self-esteem of people.

Trait Self-Esteem

A type or form of self-esteem that gets reflected through one or the other personality trait and represents the way we usually feel about ourselves. On account of its being relatively enduring across time and situations, it is also known as global self-esteem.

2. State Self-Esteem (or Feelings of Self-Worth): In this form and kind, people's self-esteem gets reflected through the state of their feelings of self-worth experienced by them in one or the other situations. Feeling proud or pleased with themselves or humiliated and ashamed of themselves are examples of what is meant by feelings of self-worth experienced on their part. Such experiences as we know are situation specific. In one situation, like being selected for a post or getting the desired

promotion one's self-esteem may be sky high, but the same may be punctured in situations when he gets shunted from the job or faces failure in his or her love affair. On account of resting on the state of feeling worthy or not worthy this type of self-esteem is termed as state self-esteem. Being situation specific it is not constant like the trait self-esteem but is liable to change depending upon the sense of self-worthiness felt on the part of the concerned individual at one or the other time. There are ups and downs in the person's self-esteem depending upon the worthiness or unworthiness felt by them in the different situations. Measures like the Beeper self-reports are used for measuring the state self-esteem of people.

State Self-Esteem

A type or form of self-esteem that gets reflected through the state of our feelings of self-worth (e.g. feeling proud or humiliated) experienced by us in one or the other situations.

3. Domain Specific Self-Esteem (Self-Evaluative Self-Esteem): In this form and type, one's self-esteem is found to be domain specific, i.e., related or associated with one or the other domains of one's life, such as academic, artistic, games and sports, politics, business, personal and social, etc. For example, an individual who has apprehension about his academic abilities may be said to be attributed with a low academic self-esteem. However, along with it, if he thinks that he is quite good at sports he may now be termed to possess a high athletic self-esteem. In this way, one's domain specific self-esteem stands for the way he evaluates his various abilities and attributes for lowering and raising his self-esteem. When a salesman tries to self-evaluate his own abilities and capacities for convincing himself that he is very good in selling the products in a proper way, he is said to be termed as possessing high self-esteem in the domains of products selling. On account of being the product of one's self-evaluation, the domain specific self-esteem is also referred to as self-evaluative self-esteem. Accordingly, its measurement is also performed with

the help of measuring devices that help in the self-evaluation of self-esteem related to one or the other domains of people’s lives. The self-reporting or self-rating scales or measuring instruments are used for this purpose. In this concern, it should also be noted that many scales that assess self-esteem include subscales that measure self-evaluations in multiple domains on account of the very reason that people have different levels of self-esteem in different areas and we are interested to have a proper measure of their self-esteem in its totality.

Domain Specific Self-Esteem

A type or form of self-esteem associated with one or the other domains of our life such as academic, business, personal and social, etc.

Measurement of Self-Esteem

Usually, three types of methods and approaches are utilized for measuring people’s self-esteem. These are: (i) self-reporting or self-rating method, (ii) reporting or rating by others and (iii) projective method.

Let us examine these three methods.

A. Measures or Devices Using Self-Reporting or Self-Rating Method

Self-evaluation is said to be the best evaluation, since nobody can tell better about the person and his *self*, than the person himself. We can divide and describe these self-reporting measures into the following three categories according to the nature of the purposes served by them in the manner as follows.

- 1. *The measures helpful in the assessment of the self-esteem present in the form and kinds of trait self-esteem or global self-esteem*

Most often, in these measures or evaluation devices the respondents are asked to agree or disagree or provide their rating to the statements appearing in the scale or inventory constructed by the measuring

instrument developers. These measures are more commonly available even in their well standardized format for the assessment of people’s self-esteem. As examples of such self-esteem assessment tools, we may name the tools like Rosenberg Self-Esteem scale (RSE) and Coopersmith Self-Esteem Inventory (SEI). For illustration purpose, here we are presenting a brief discussion of the SEI.

Coopersmith Self-Esteem Inventory (SEI):

This scale was developed by S. Coopersmith in 1967. It consists of 50 items and aims to measure attitudes towards the self. Its items require the respondents to report feelings about the self directly and are typically scored using a dichotomous scale (“Like me” vs. “Unlike me”). Thus, a SEI score can range from 0 to 50 with higher scores reflecting higher self-esteem.

What is in the items can be judged through the following sample items.

- Item No. 47: My family understands me.
Like me Unlike me
- Item No. 48: I always tell the truth.
Like me Unlike me

Scoring: The correct responses providing 1 score, each have been marked as follows:

- Like me: Items 2, 4, 5, 10, 11, 14, 18, 19, 21, 23, 24, 28, 29, 32, 36, 45, 47, 55, 57
- Unlike me: Items 3, 7, 8, 9, 12, 15, 16, 17, 22, 25, 26, 30, 31, 33, 35, 37, 38, 39, 40, 42, 43, 44, 46, 49, 50, 51, 52, 53, 54, 56, 58

- 2. *The measures helpful in the assessment of the self-esteem present in the form and kinds of state self-esteem*

Here we have to make use of such measuring device that can help us to take measures of one’s self-esteem from time to time. In this concern, the measure known as *Beeper self-reports* may be termed as the most relevant and appropriate technique for providing self-report repeated measures for the assessment of the state self-esteem of the individuals by documenting changes in their self-esteem over the course of time. In making use of the *Beeper self-reports*

technique, the individuals/respondents are equipped with wrist beepers, pagers or smart phones programmed to beep at random times throughout the day or at the interval of days or months, etc. as per some fixed schedules. When the signal sounds the individual has to record (in the note book or on the device) answers a set of well framed structured format questions such as: Where are you? What are you doing? Who are you with? What is your mood? Etc. The answers received from the respondents are helpful for documenting changes in their self-esteem over a week, month or a year.

In this concern, Savin-Williams and Jaquish (1981) have mentioned the use of Beeper self-reports technique in assessing the self-esteem among the samples of adolescent students by obtaining situational snapshots of their self-esteem over a course of time. Here the evaluator has used a structured format of words. The individual adolescent, here, is required to indicate from a list of adjectives, or beep sheet, the words that describe his or her self – feelings at the moment he or she is beeped, or signaled to respond.

Instructions: How would you describe yourself at the moment beeped? Circle as many words below as are appropriate.

<i>Inhibited</i>	<i>Happy</i>	<i>Skilled</i>	<i>Left behind</i>
Clear	Relaxed	Productive	Exposed
Consistent	Free	Unloved	Fussy
Tense	Sluggish	Useless	Loved
Confident	Lonely	Growing	Bored
Unprepared	Powerful	Overwhelmed	On time
Belonging	Empty	Affectional	Unsure
Weak	Ashamed	Depressed	In control
Safe	Proved	Needed	Conforming
Spontaneous	Secure	Frustrated	Manipulated

Other feelings about yourself:

Inference drawing: The self-esteem of an individual is derived via subtracting the number of low self-esteem words that are selected from the number of high self-esteem words, then dividing this quantity by the total number of words selected (possible range = -1.00 to 1.00).

3. *The measures helpful in the assessment of the self-esteem present in its overall form*

In this category we may include the measures that can help us in assessing the self-esteem of people in its overall forms and kinds – trait, state and domain specific discussed earlier in this chapter. The most mentionable assessment measures, in this concern, are available in the form of structured or unstructured interviews. The sample items of a structured interview schedule for the assessment of people's self-esteem are presented next:

1. How often do you feel really good? Can you describe it?
2. Do you like yourself? How much? Why?
3. In what situations do you feel best about yourself?; worst?
4. Is it easy for people to win arguments with you?
5. Do you feel like an important person in the school?
6. Overall, do you like the way other people treat you?

All the self-report measures and instruments classified into the three categories rest on an untenable assumption that individuals are able to, and willing to, honestly state their feelings. Savin-Williams and Jaquish (1981:333) in this concern have asserted, "Results from self-report measures might be unduly influenced by the individual's awareness, unconscious defenses, current emotional state, need for social acceptance, or to meet social desirability standards."

B. Measures or Devices Based on Reporting or Rating by Others

In this category of measures or devices employed for assessing self-esteem of people, we include those measures and devices that are based on others' evaluation rather than self-evaluation. In their distinction from the self-reporting measures, whereas self-report instruments purport to measure the experienced self, ratings by others purport to measure the presented self, that is, the self that is displayed in social interaction and is therefore observable (Savin-Williams and Jaquish, 1981). The others who know the individual

well in terms of their intimacy and interaction with him may well serve the role of a good evaluator of the various traits and aspects associated with the self-esteem of the concerned individual. In the category of others, thus we may include their peers, friends, parents and other family members, teachers and professional colleagues, employers, etc.

More often, for helping these others for evaluating the people they know well, two types of measuring instruments (i) rating scales and (ii) behavioral checklists may be used by the evaluators or researchers. Well standardized rating scales and behavioral checklists are available for this purpose. Let us illustrate their use.

- In making use of a well standardized rating scale peers are required to rate each other by selecting a number from 1 to 5 (1 = low self-esteem and 5 = high self-esteem). A peer-based score then may be obtained for each participant by computing the mean of all ratings given to that individual by his or her peers.
- In making use of a well standardized behavioral checklist, the observers (parents, family members, peers/colleagues) may be asked to provide their opinion about the things related to the negative and positive aspects of the self-esteem of the subjects under evaluation. The checklist consists of 20 items out of which 10 (referred to as positive) are meant to measure high self-esteem, and the other 10 (referred to as negative) measure low self-esteem. The sample items of both positive and negative nature pointing towards high- and low self-esteem of the subjects are given next.

<i>Positive Item (Sampled out of 10)</i>	<i>Negative Item (Sampled out of 10)</i>
Sits with others during social activities	Puts down others by teasing, name calling or gossiping
Maintains eye contact during conversation	Gives excuses for failures
Expresses opinions	Speaks too loudly, abruptly or in dogmatic tone
Works cooperatively in a group	Inappropriate touching or avoid physical contact

Scoring and Interpretation: Each checklist produces a self-esteem score by subtracting the number of low self-esteem items from the number of high self-esteem items, then dividing by 10. The resultant proportion scores (range = -1.00 to 1.00) for each checklist for each individual subject may then be summed and the mean of those proportion scores provides the behavioral self-esteem score for that individual.

C. Measure or Devices Using Projective Techniques

The methods and measures discussed in the form of reporting or rating by self or the others have their own weaknesses and limitations. Biases involved in seeking evaluation of the self-esteem by the individual themselves are quite obvious. One cannot produce reality about his self or own experiences in a truthful or objective manner. There is a lot of subjectivity in reporting about the self on the part of individuals affecting the results of the measurement in an adverse way. The reporting or rating of others for the evaluation of the self-esteem of the individuals is based on what is presented by the individuals to the observers for their observations. The individuals may conceal in order to present them good in one or the other ways affecting the results of the evaluation in a quite adverse way. In this situation, the use of projective techniques may provide a good alternative. Here what lies in one's unconscious is revealed through the use of the well-structured and standardized projective material for saying much about the self-esteem of the individual. We have enough availability of such projective material in the standardized popular tests including the Rorschach Ink Blot Test, Thematic Apperception Test (TAT), Children Apperception Test (CAT), Word Association Tests and Sentence Completion Tests, etc.

The major problem, as emphasized earlier with the self and others reporting, lies in the fact that individual under evaluation wants to say or present him or her as socially desirable, but here in the projective techniques the threat of social desirability is almost ruled out. For example, let us take the modified version (Henry and Sims, 1970) of Murray's (1938) Thematic Apperception Test (TAT). While measuring

self-esteem with this test we can present the pictures of one or the other characters doing one or the other things in their social life. Let us further assume that we are making use of the two pictures from this modified version of TAT, one showing a teenage boy and the other a teenage girl looking into a mirror. The subjects – boys and girls – then, may be given these two pictures one at a time for responding in terms of writing a story – presenting the past, present and future related to the events happening with the hero/heroine of the story.

The analysis of the contents of these stories may reveal that what the subjects say through their stories is nothing but their own feelings expressed through the contents of these stories. In these stories, the subjects unconsciously identify them with the person in the picture and thus what they say is quite enough for taking judgment about their self-esteem.

To Sum Up

The measures and device utilized for measuring self-esteem of people may involve three types of measures based on self-reporting or self-rating, reporting or rating by others, and projective techniques.

Measures or devices using self-reporting or self-rating method may involve the measures helpful in the assessment of the self-esteem present in the form and kinds of:

- Trait self-esteem or global self-esteem such as Rosenberg Self-Esteem scale (RSE) and Coopersmith Self-Esteem Inventory (SEI).
- State self-esteem such as Beeper self-reports.
- Its overall form available in the form of structured or unstructured interviews.

Measures or devices based on reporting or rating by others call for the evaluation of our self at the hand of others with the help of two types of measuring instruments – rating scales and behavioral checklists.

Measures or devices using projective techniques are termed more appropriate in comparison to the evaluation made by the self and others which are considered quite subjective and biased in reporting about one's self-esteem. Examples of such projective techniques are the Rorschach Ink Blot Test, Thematic Apperception Test (TAT), Children Apperception Test (CAT), Word Association Tests and Sentence Completion Tests, etc.

Development of Self-Esteem Among Individuals

Nobody is born with the concept of the self and traits of self-esteem. Both are invariably the product of environmental exposure and organized experiences called learning. The type of experiences (good or bad, positive or negative, pleasant or unpleasant) one gathers from his environment work for the formation of positive or negative attitudes towards the self. It is the formation of such positive and negative attitude that may result in creating a sense of liking and respect or disliking and disrespect towards the self. However, the best period of habit formation and imbibing of the proper traits is the developmental period. Here also it is quite beneficial to start quite earlier so that the child may pick up the right things at the right time. It is therefore essential that earnest attempts should be made by the parents, members of the family, teachers and elders to provide the child a rich congenial environment right from his early developmental period for the development of his self-esteem in an appropriate way. In doing so they may be advised to take care of a number of things mentioned as follows.

1. **Presenting Proper Role Models:** Parents, elders and teachers helping the children in building their self-esteem should try to present them as an ideal figure or model for imbibing a sense of respect to the self and others. They can support children's developing self-esteem through their actions as well as their words. In particular, the parents and teachers can model the behaviors they want their children and students to learn by

acting those behaviors out in front of children. One important behavior they can teach in this manner is how to talk about, express and cope with powerful feelings such as embarrassment, sadness, frustration and anger, etc.

2. **Be Careful What You Say or Utter to the Child:** Words carry much weight. They have the power to cast most desirable or damaging impact on the minds and hearts of the children. Therefore, nothing should be uttered by us that can prove a fertile ground for lowering the self-esteem of the children. "Nothing good can be expected from the dull and duffer like you"; "You are not fit for this assignment" – such outbursts on our part can damage the self-confidence of the children and make them feel worthless and incapable of doing one or the other things. Instead of uttering such improper words, we should always use praiseworthy and encouraging language for appreciating their good work and motivating them to do away their mistakes and overcome their limitations.
3. **Try to Identify and Rectify Inaccurate Perceptions and Beliefs:** The children having low self-esteem are found to be nurturing one or the other types of inaccurate perceptions and beliefs about one or the other aspects concerning the self (i.e., perfection, attractiveness, ability, intelligence, sociability and capacity of doing one or the other things). For example, a child who does very well in school but struggles with mathematics may say, "I can't do math. I'm a bad student." Not only is this a false generalization, it's also a belief that can set a child towards failure. We the elders should try to identify such misconceptions and beliefs being nurtured in the minds of the children. They should, then, be helped in getting rid of such false perceptions and beliefs about themselves that are leading them to feel small, inferior and inadequate. They should be told that no one is perfect in this world. All of us are the creations of the Almighty and as such we all are unique in ourselves. There is no reason to be felt small or inadequate. We should accept ourselves with all of our goodness and limitations and try to make the best use of

our limitations with our good behavior, dedication and hard work.

4. **Encourage Positive Suggestions and Appropriate Self-Talk:** Auto-suggestions and self-talk have a lot of power in influencing the thinking and feeling of children in a positive or adverse way. If one is feeding the ideas through a continuous flow of auto-suggestions and self-talk that he is good for nothing, then nothing will desist him drifting towards such limitations and failures. But if we alter the direction of this flow by making the child use his power of auto-suggestions and self-talk in a positive way, then surely he will be filled up with necessary confidence in his abilities and capacities. I am capable; I can do it; I am improving and going higher and higher; nobody can stop me to realize my dream – the pumping of such motivational ideas certainly will bring the desired result in raising the level of his confidence and status of his self-esteem.
5. **Creating a Positive Atmosphere at Home and School:** Environmental influences have a strong impact on the shaping of one's behavior. Therefore earnest attempts should be made to create a positive and favorable environment at home and school for helping children get imbibed with adequate self-esteem. Children who don't get the needed love and affection at home and proper treatment at the hands of their teachers, or feel unsafe or are abused at home or school are at greatest risk for developing poor self-esteem. Parents and teachers should always have an open channel for communicating with the children and should try to understand and accept them with their all goodness and limitations and help them in becoming capable of solving their difficulties and leading life on their own with a proper level of self-esteem.
6. **Taking Care of the Peer-Group Influence:** The peer-group relationships and interactions should be so planned and looked after as the developing children should get no adverse or negative experience resulting in the diminishing of their regard to the self. They should not be made to feel inferior and think themselves as worthless or incapable in comparison to their classmates or neighborhood peers.

7. **Encouraging Children to Take on Challenges:** Children feel confident and proud and develop a sense of adequate self-esteem when they are given proper opportunities to take up challenges for solving difficult problems and complicated puzzles, doing hard tasks and sharing heavy responsibilities. Therefore attempts should be made by teachers and parents to provide suitable opportunities to take up challenges with regard to social tasks and curricular assignments.
8. **Encourage Children's Self-Assessment:** It is customary for people to pass value judgment on the ability, appearance, physique, intelligence, sociability, emotionality and a host of other behavioral tendencies and personality traits. Children's self-esteem is very much affected by such evaluation and comments made by others. However, if they have the habit of knowing about their capacities and abilities through self-assessment, then they can pick up the reality about their strengths and limitations in a most desirable way. The conclusions reached about their self with their own self-assessment helps them in proper self-awareness and acceptance of the self in its true color adding to a proper increase in the level of their self-esteem. Parents and teachers should therefore earnestly try to encourage and train the child in going through the self-assessment of their abilities and capabilities.
9. **Finding Professional Help:** As a last resort, when needed most, teachers and parents should not hesitate to take help from the professionals (therapists and counselors) in identifying the needed coping strategies to help in dealing with the problems of the children suffering from low self-esteem.

role models of the self-esteem behavior and biographies, and (ii) behaving and treating them in an appropriate way suitable for inculcating among them the trait of self-esteem and characteristics of persons having high self-esteem.

Self-Efficacy and Its Development

What Is Self-Efficacy?

Why are some individuals eager to learn and willing to tackle new challenges when others seem uninterested or unmotivated in the similar situations? Why do some individuals demonstrate high levels of confidence in their abilities in the learning of one or the other material, while others seem unsure of themselves? Psychologists may answer such questions by saying that the interested and willing ones are endowed with a unique ability known as self-efficacy while the uninterested and unwilling ones may fall short of such necessary ability. But what is then this unique ability known as self-efficacy?

Self-efficacy in its simple meaning stands for a state or quality of efficacy demonstrated on the part of an individual. In dictionaries (Merriam-Webster, Oxford, etc.), the term efficacy is defined as (i) the power or capacity to produce a desired result or effect, or (ii) effectiveness.

Consequently, we can understand by the term self-efficacy of an individual, his effectiveness or the confidence demonstrated by him in his capacity to produce a desired result or effect (i.e., doing and performing a task, achieving a target).

The famous psychologist Albert Bandura has also tried to endorse the similar meaning by defining the term self-efficacy in the following manner:

1. Self-efficacy refers to an individual's belief in his or her capacity to execute behaviors necessary to produce specific performance attainments (Bandura, 1986).
2. Perceived self-efficacy is defined as people's beliefs about their capabilities to produce designated levels of performance that exercise influence over events that affect their lives (Bandura, 1994).

To Sum Up

Regarding the *development of self-esteem*, it can be well said that nobody is born with the concept of the self and traits of self-esteem. Both are invariably the product of environmental exposure and organized experiences called learning. For this purpose, the growing children may be helped through presenting (i)

Self-Efficacy

The effectiveness or the confidence demonstrated by us in our capacity to perform a particular activity or attain a desired thing or objective.

The term self-efficacy in this way stands for the confidence shown by an individual in his ability or capacity to perform a particular activity or attain a desired thing or objective. It shows or refers to “one’s beliefs about one’s ability to perform behaviors that should lead to expected outcomes” (Weiten et al., 2012:198). In short, one’s self-efficacy conveys us his/her effectiveness in respect of facing a particular situation as judged by the individual him or herself.

Nature and Characteristics of Self-Efficacy

The following characteristics may help us more in understanding and grasping the meaning and concept of the term self-efficacy in a better way.

1. Self-efficacy is a person’s judgment about being able to perform a particular activity. It is an individual’s “I can” or “I cannot” belief.
2. Self-efficacy beliefs determine how people feel, think, motivate themselves and behave.
3. Unlike self-esteem, which reflects how one feels about his worth or value, self-efficacy reflects how confident one is about performing one or the other tasks.
4. High self-efficacy in one area may not coincide with high self-efficacy in another area. Just as high confidence in playing cricket may not be matched with high confidence in playing tennis; high self-efficacy in mathematics may not necessarily accompany high self-efficacy in English.
5. Self-efficacy is specific to the task being attempted. However, having high self-efficacy does not necessarily mean that one believes she will be successful. While self-efficacy indicates how strongly one believes she has the skills to

do well, she may believe other factors may keep her off from succeeding.

6. A growing body of research however reveals that there is a positive, significant relationship between one’s self-efficacy belief and his/her performance in the related task (i.e., student’s performance in an academic task).
7. It also has been found that while individuals with low self-efficacy toward a task are more likely to avoid it, those with high self-efficacy are not only more likely to attempt the task, but they also will work harder and persist longer in the face of difficulties.
8. Self-efficacy is also found to exert considerable influence in the following matters: (i) What activities people select, (ii) how much effort they put forth, (iii) how persistent they are in the face of difficulties and (iv) the difficulty of the goals they set.

Role of Self-Efficacy in the Progress and Well-Being of Persons

A strong sense of efficacy enhances human accomplishment and personal well-being in many ways as discussed here.

1. **Helping in Appropriate Goal Setting:** A desired success in terms of attaining desired progress and development in all the personality dimensions and pursuits of life can be successfully achieved if one has the ability of setting appropriate goals for his striving. Personal goal setting is influenced by self-appraisal of capabilities. Self-efficacy helps an individual to have a proper appraisal of his capability of doing a task and achieving the target. It helps him to meet the challenges and set the proper goals for his learning and striving in one or the other situations of his life. The stronger the perceived self-efficacy, the higher the goal challenges people set for themselves and the firmer is their commitment to strive for achieving the targeted objectives.
2. **Helping in Seeking Proper Motivation:** The motivation is found to work as wonder in

providing desired success for an individual in his goal directed behavior. Self-beliefs of efficacy play a key role in the self-regulation of motivation. Most human motivation is cognitively generated. People motivate themselves and guide their actions anticipatorily by the exercise of forethought. They form beliefs about what they can do and achieve. It is why the people loaded with a high degree of self-efficacy are found to be imbued with a high sense of intrinsic motivation. It helps them absorb themselves fully in the tasks and activities related to their wholesome development and targets designed to realize valued futures.

3. **Helping in Setting Proper Level of Aspiration:** It is essential for an individual in striving towards his desired development and progress to establish a proper level of his aspiration much in tune with his own abilities and capacities. The setting of a higher or lower level of aspiration much above and below his capacities may result in unnecessary frustration and despair on one's part. However a good sense of self-efficacy helps the individuals to set a proper level of their aspirations and thus get desired success in proceeding well on the path of their proper progress and well-being.
4. **Helping in Equipping With a Sense of Necessary Self-Confidence:** Our self-efficacy is our confidence shown in our ability or capacity of performing an act or attaining a specific target. Equipped with a proper sense of self-efficacy, thus people may be naturally found to demonstrate a necessary level of self-confidence in the ability or capacity of striving towards the attainment of their goal or performing a task of their choice. The demonstration of such self-confidence thus may help individuals in seeking maximum towards their progress and well-being.
5. **Helping in Pursuing Goals in an Appropriate Way:** The individuals endowed with a high degree of efficacy are found to have a positive outlook about their efforts in achieving the set targets. They are found to approach difficult tasks as challenges to be mastered rather than as threats to be avoided. They heighten and sustain their efforts in the face of failure. They quickly recover their sense of efficacy after failures or setbacks. They attribute failure to insufficient effort or deficient knowledge and skills which are acquirable. They approach threatening situations with assurance that they can exercise control over them. Such an efficacious outlook produces wonderful impact on their wholesome development and personal accomplishments.
6. **Helping in Making Right Choices for Proper Progress and Well-Being:** The power of self-efficacy belief helps individuals to make right choices in the course of their progress and well-being. The higher the level of people's perceived self-efficacy the wiser they prove themselves in pursuing the most suitable course for their progress and well-being in perfect tune of their inherent talents and capacities.
7. **Helping in Seeking Proper Adjustment With the Self and Environment:** People remain adjusted with their self and environment until their basic needs (biological and socio-psychological) remain satisfied or are in the way of getting satisfied. The persons endowed with a good sense of self-efficacy are fully aware of their ability or capacity of doing a task or attaining a specific target. They are aware of the extent to which their needs may be gratified and thus may not expect or strive for attaining much beyond their perceived capacities and abilities. This habit helps the individuals much in remaining adjusted with their self and environment which in turn may prove a big helping hand in their proper learning and development.
8. **Helping in Attaining Wholesome Health and Well-Being:** Equipping with a good sense of self-efficacy helps the individual in the attainment of wholesome health and well-being in respect to its physical, mental, social, emotional and moral dimensions. In the support of this assertion the following things may be especially mentioned:
 - The stress and anxiety caused in any way leads to the impairment of physical and

mental health of an individual being. People's beliefs in their coping capabilities affect how much stress and depression they experience in threatening or difficult situations. Self-efficacy loaded individuals who believe they can exercise control over threats do not conjure up disturbing thought patterns and thus do not fall victim of anxiety, stress, depression and impairment in their level of physical and mental functioning.

- Perceived self-efficacy affects every phase of personal change. The stronger the perceived self-regulatory efficacy the more successful people are in developing healthy habits and imbibing desirable virtues helpful in their proper social, emotional and moral development.

To Sum Up

The term self-efficacy stands for the confidence shown by individuals in their ability or capacity to perform a particular activity or attain a desired thing or objective. It conveys us the effectiveness of an individual in respect of facing a particular situation as judged by the individual himself. Unlike self-esteem, which reflects how people feel about their worth or value, self-efficacy reflects how confident one is about performing one or the other tasks. A strong sense of self-efficacy possessed by individuals may be found to help them in setting and pursuing appropriate goals by maintaining the proper level of their motivation and aspiration; getting equipped with a sense of necessary self-confidence; and making right choices for seeking their adjustment with the self and environment; and attaining wholesome health and well-being.

The Ways and Means for the Development of Self-Efficacy

The self-efficacy possessed by individuals is an acquired phenomenon. It is learned as a consequence of one's experiences and interactions occurring in

one's socio-cultural environment. The following measures may prove quite beneficial in helping individuals get imbibed with the power of self-efficacy.

1. **Orientation About the Concept and Significance of Self-Efficacy:** The individuals should be provided due orientation about the nature and significance of the behavior loaded with self-efficacy. Help of the well framed documentaries, audio-video presentations, availability of appropriate literature highlighting incidence of the success achieved in life through the power of self-efficacy may be taken for acquainting individuals with the concept and significance of the power of self-efficacy.
2. **Producing Models of Exemplary Behavior:** A behavior is learned well through its observation and imitation on the part of learners. Therefore, attempts should be made to produce models of exemplary self-efficacy behavior before the individuals. For this purpose, they may be provided opportunities for getting exposure and interaction with the persons of repute and living examples of self-efficacy.
3. **Providing Opportunities for Demonstrating Self-Efficacy:** The skill of using self-efficacy power can be acquired by the people well only when they avail the opportunities of getting engaged in the self-efficacy behavior through their own experience. Therefore, they should be provided reasonable freedom and opportunities for taking challenges of doing and performing the acts and attaining the learning and developmental objectives well in tune with their inherent capacities and abilities.
4. **Reinforcing the Self-Efficacy Behavior of the Individuals:** A behavior is learned well when it gets reinforced in an appropriate way. Therefore, attempts should be made to provide due reinforcement to the self-efficacy behavior demonstrated on the part of individuals in one or the other situations by resorting to methods like proper praise and appreciation, appropriate incentives, grading and making them feel satisfied and proud with their achievement.

To Sum Up

The development of self-efficacy behavior among individuals is a learned and acquired phenomenon that takes place as a consequence of their experiences and interactions occurring in their socio-cultural environment. For helping them in this direction, it can be useful for adopting the measures like: providing orientation about the concept and significance of self-efficacy; producing models of exemplary behavior; providing opportunities for demonstrating self-efficacy; and reinforcing their self-efficacy behavior.

Self-Regulation and Its Development

What Is Self-Regulation?

In its word meaning the term self-regulation stands for regulating or controlling our 'self' by ourselves in terms of our functioning and performing one or the other types of behavioral acts and thus giving birth to a special type of behavior known as self-regulated behavior helpful in our adjustment, development and progress in a proper way. In this way, the self-regulated behavior of the individuals is said to be described as a type of behavior that is regulated or controlled by the individual themselves. For knowing more about the meaning and concept of self-regulated behavior let us take the help of a few available definitions of the term 'self-regulating behavior' such as follows.

Self-Regulation

The process of regulating and exercising restraint or control over one's behavior for functioning and performing well in one or the other situations.

Ormrod (2009): Self-regulated behavior describes a process of taking control of and evaluating one's own behavior for the good and welfare of the self and others.

Paris and Paris (2001): Self-regulated behavior emphasizes autonomy and control by the individual who monitors, directs and regulates actions toward goals of information acquisition, expanding expertise and self-improvement.

In the light of these definitions of the term self-regulated behavior, we can conclude about the meaning and nature of the term self-regulation and self-regulated behavior in the following way.

- Self-regulation stands for the characteristics of one's ability or capacity to regulate and exercise restraint or control over his behavior (conative, cognitive and affective) through one's own initiative and attempts.
- Self-regulation or self-regulated behavior is not thrust upon the individuals from outside. It is a willful act undertaken by the individual themselves for serving their own interests and goals.
- Self-regulation and self-regulated behavior as a whole is initiated, undertaken and executed to its desired end with the full intention, motivation, attention and involvement of the individual.
- In self-regulated behavior, the behavior gets fully regulated and controlled by the individuals themselves from the beginning till end in terms of the objectives set, strategies planned and methods used for their functioning in one or the other situation.

The Characteristics of Self-Regulated Individuals

The habit and practice of resorting to self-regulation in performing or engaging in one or the other types of behavioral activities on the part of individuals pays a rich dividend in terms of their adequate adjustment, effective work performance and overall developmental outcomes. The behavioral characteristics of self-regulated individuals in this concern may be briefed as follows.

1. Self-regulated individuals have their own mechanism in exercising control over their functioning and behaving rather than being dictated and

controlled through some external agency. They know well what can go well with them in terms of doing and behaving and, thus, automatically try to remain on the track of their proper functioning and behaving.

2. The working and functioning on the part of individuals in the course of their self-regulated behavior remains under their ownership and control. They need not wait or depend upon the direction, warning, managing and disciplining of their behavioral acts on the part of others and it helps them in a quite valuable way to remain goal oriented and regulated in their functioning and behaving.
3. The individuals, here, take all types of responsibilities and burdens of carrying out the task of behaving and functioning and, thus, what gets to be done or performed in a particular situation becomes their own task valued by them in all ways. It pays in a big way to help them in behaving and performing in a given situation with a quite responsible and effective way.
4. Self-regulated behavior is characterized with the full involvement of the concerned individuals in its execution. The self-regulated individuals are found to take genuine interest and demonstrate a lot of intrinsic motivation towards their functioning and behaving in a particular situation. It helps them to remain focused on their behavior despite facing odds and difficulties in their path.
5. Self-regulated individuals are found to possess a strong sense of self-efficacy. They know their strengths and limitations in respect of doing or performing one or the other tasks, solving one or the other problems, reacting and responding to a situation, interacting and behaving with others, etc. and, thus, remain in command of the things to be done and behavior to be demonstrated on their part. It helps them to benefit through their performance and demonstrate behavior well in a quite fruitful way.
6. Self-regulated individuals are found to exercise proper control over the process of their functioning. They can take on the task of performing according to their own pace, convenience, time and efforts. They are free to go on functioning independently with their own efforts or may choose to take guidance and help from others in the way and amount as and when needed so by them. They manage the behavioral situations and environment in the way as needed by them in getting success in their behavior performance. Such regulation and control exercised by them in their behavior and functioning makes them a good person resulting in their desired development and progress.
7. Self-regulated individuals are found to make use of the process and mechanism of self-assessment or evaluation for getting needed feedback about the appropriateness of their functioning and behaving. On its basis, they may be seen to introduce necessary changes in their performance or behavioral goals, work strategies, motivational spirit and environmental surroundings helping them to exercise needed control over the process and product of their functioning and behaving.
8. Self-regulated individuals are equipped with a number of useful traits and habits that add to the effectiveness of their behavioral acts such as:
 - They are keen to know and investigate into the nature of things.
 - They do not need constant pushing, but are found to take initiative for knowing the things with their own attempts.
 - They ask questions and make inquiry from the relevant sources for acquiring necessary knowledge and skills.
 - They are self-confident, self-reliant and self-dependent in regulating and managing their affairs regarding the use of their abilities and capacities for their effecting functioning and behaving.
 - They know the art of exercising proper control over their motor, cognitive and emotional behavior. While functioning and behaving in a particular situation, they try to manage their capabilities and resources in an effective way.
 - They try to adopt their own course and regulate the process of their functioning in their own ways by setting their own

behavioral goals, seeking their intrinsic motivation, choosing a particular work strategy, getting focused on their functioning and behaving, and reinforcing or modifying their efforts on the basis of self-assessment for attaining the desired outcomes of their functioning and behaving.

Development of Self-Regulation and Self-Regulated Behavior Among Individuals

The ability or capacity to exercise control over one's functioning and behaving is not at all an inherited phenomenon but gets developed and acquired by the developing individuals much like the acquisition of other characteristics of one's behavior and personality traits. It is why no child at the time of his or her birth is found to demonstrate needed ability to regulate his or her behavioral functioning at his or her own. It does not happen or to say can't happen unless the developing infants and children acquire a reasonable level of their cognitive capacities for guiding and exercising control over their functioning and behaving in one or the other ways. At the initial stage of their development, they have no alternative but to remain completely dependent upon their parents and caregivers for their needed functioning and behaving. They receive feeding and caring for their adjustment, living and development at the hands of their parents and caregivers and learn and imbibe many habits and acts such as walking, climbing, speaking, jumping, etc. in the close company and under the directions of their elders. In their developmental years ahead also the parents, elders and teachers try to dictate their developmental path by regulating, controlling and managing their functioning and behaving in accordance with their own liking and disliking, wishes and goals set by them for their children. However, as experience reveals the parents, elders and teachers also wish and attempt for making their children relatively independent and self-reliant in regulating and managing their behavioral acts at their own. Their efforts in this direction may be well witnessed in helping the infants in demonstrating self-regulated behavior in terms of taking meals, dressing, taking bath, toilet functioning, combing,

tying shoe laces, playing their games, etc. As infants grow in age, they try to seek independence in exercising their different roles in their various types of functioning and behaving in their day-to-day life and working at their homes, community surroundings and schools. They can be very much helped in this task by parents, caregivers, elders and teachers in the varieties of ways by adopting the habit and practice of self-regulation in their functioning and behaving. The following measures may help the parents, caregivers, elders and teachers well in this direction.

1. They should try to switch over from the practices of authority or dictating behaviors of the children (such as issuing directives and instructions, dictating and deciding their learning paths and ways of behaving, helping and assisting them always in their functioning as well as spoon feeding them in their learning attempts) to the role of an effective guide and facilitator for helping them in the demonstration of the ability of self-regulation and self-control in their functioning and behaving.
2. The children should be properly oriented with the practice of self-regulated functioning and behaving along with its inherent usefulness. For this purpose, attempts should be made to provide opportunities in exposing them to a good literature available in library or show them documentary films and audio-video presentations highlighting the incidence and significance of self-regulation and self-regulated behavior.
3. The children should be provided the opportunities for modeling their functioning and behaving on the pattern of self-regulated behavior. The parents, family members, elders, capable peers and teachers themselves may work as models before the younger children to learn and imbibe essentials about self-regulated behavior.
4. Suitable exposure in the form of formal or informal learning or training experiences should be provided to the developing children for catching hold of the idea and practice of regulation and regulated behavior in their conative, cognitive and affective functioning. Why and how they have to exercise needed restraint and control

over their physical and physiological habits, motor acts and physical activities, cognitive functioning and emotional expression should be invariably known to them. They should be trained and taught to use their cognitive abilities for regulating their behavior and functioning. Especially in relation to the expression of emotions, they should essentially know the way of expressing their emotions in a right way at the right time in a right proportion and intensity.

5. The children should be provided the needed freedom for regulating their behavior and its outcomes by setting their own behavioral goals, seeking their own measures of intrinsic or extrinsic motivation, choosing suitable working strategies and applying their own method of self-assessment for exercising desirable control over their functioning and behaving.
6. Children should not be allowed to develop distaste, apathy or frustration with the adoption of self-regulation in their functioning and behavior by holding help and assistance from the elders for the sake of developing independence and self-regulation but be helped at the time of their need in a proper amount in the proper way by keeping alive the spirit of self-regulation and self-regulated behavior side by side.
7. Well intended attempts should also be made to reinforce the self-regulated behavior of the children by providing them encouraging feedback. We need to appreciate and acknowledge their hard work, initiatives and enthusiasm in one of the acts of their self-regulated functioning and behaving for helping them well in the pursuit of their proper development and progress.

To Sum Up

The term *self-regulation* stands for regulating or controlling one's self by the individuals themselves in terms of their functioning and performing one or the other types of behavioral acts and thus giving birth to a special type of behavior known as self-regulated behavior helpful in their adjustment, development and

progress in a proper way. However, the ability or capacity to exercise control over one's functioning and behaving is not at all an inherited phenomenon but gets developed and acquired by the children much like the acquisition of other characteristics of one's behavior and personality traits. It also needs a reasonable level of mental maturity on the part of children for the self-regulation of their behavior. In the task of getting equipped with such behavior, the children may also be helped by the parents, teachers and elders with the measures like: playing the role of guide and facilitator in place of dictating and controlling everything about them; providing orientation about the self-regulated behavior; working as model and producing exemplary behavior opportunities before them; providing exposure in the form of formal or informal learning or training experiences for catching hold of the idea and practice of regulation and regulated behavior; giving needed freedom to them for regulating their behavior and its outcomes; and reinforcing their self-regulated behavior by providing them encouraging feedback.

Review Questions

1. What is 'self'? Discuss in detail its meaning and concept.
2. What is self-awareness? Discuss its meaning and nature and throw light on its development.
3. While defining the term self-concept, throw light on its meaning and development among individuals.
4. What is self-concept? Name and discuss various factors contributing towards its development.
5. Name the various theories of managing and maintaining self-concept and discuss any two of them in detail.
6. Discuss in brief any three theories of self-concept management and maintenance among the following: (i) Control theory of self-regulation, (ii) self-discrepancy theory, (iii) social comparison theory, (iv) self-evaluation maintenance

theory, (v) social identity theory and (vi) self-categorization theory.

7. What do you understand by the term self-esteem? Throw light on its development among individuals.
8. What is self-esteem? Name and discuss its various forms or kinds.
9. Discuss the characteristics of persons having high and low self-esteem.
10. Explain in detail how one's self-esteem is measured with the help of available measures.
11. What is self-efficacy? Throw light on its meaning, characteristic features and ways and means for its development.
12. Discuss in detail the role of self-efficacy in the progress and well-being of individuals.
13. What is self-regulation and self-regulated behavior? Tell about its characteristic features and throw light on its development among individuals.

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8.

ATTITUDES – CONCEPT, FORMATION AND MEASUREMENT

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- Define the term attitude and throw light on its meaning and nature.
- Discuss the characteristic features of attitudes.
- Talk about the components of attitudes.
- Explain various functions of attitudes.
- Throw light on the formation of attitudes with a necessary detail of how they get developed and maintained in individuals.
- Elucidate the role of social comparison in attitude formation.
- Name and discuss the factors influencing the formation or development of attitudes.
- Establish a link between attitudes and behavior.
- State what persuasion is and how it helps in bringing change in attitudes.
- Discuss the mechanism of cognitive dissonance associated with our attitudes.
- Throw light on the nature and functions of Heider's balance theory and Festinger's cognitive dissonance theory.
- Discuss the means and ways of dealing with the state of dissonance.
- Tell about the resistance to persuasion.
- Discuss how attitudes can be measured.

Introduction

Social psychology is concerned with the task of equipping individuals for behaving well in social situations. Their behavior termed as social is composed of many important attributes. One of these important attributes is attitude. One's behavior, therefore, to a great extent depends upon one's attitude towards the things – ideas, persons or objects – in

one's environment. Their entire personality makeup and working is very much affected and influenced by the type of attitudes imbibed by them in their social behavior. What are these attitudes; how are these formed and developed; how do they affect and influence one's behavior; are these fixed or liable to be changed somehow; how are these measured? Let us find answers for all these questions in this chapter.

What Are Attitudes?

Social psychologists, thinkers and authors have variously defined the term attitude in the following ways.

Travers (1973:337): An attitude is a readiness to respond in such a way that behavior is given a certain direction.

Whittaker (1970:591): An attitude is a predisposition or readiness to respond in a pre-determined manner to relevant stimuli.

GordonAllport (1935): Attitudes refer to a mental and neural set of readiness, organized through experience exerting a directing or dynamic influence upon the individual's response to all objects and situations with which it is related to (Sears et al., 1991:137).

MecKeachie and Doyle (1966:560): We define an attitude as an organization of concepts, beliefs, habits and motives associated with a particular object.

Crisp and Turner (2014:57): An attitude is a set of beliefs that we hold in relation to an attitude object, where an attitude object is a person, thing, event or issue.

Faizo and Roskos-Ewoldsen (1994): Attitudes are associations between attitude objects (virtually any aspect of the social world) and evaluations of those objects (Baron and Byrne, 2001:112).

Eagly and Chaiken (1993:1): An attitude is a psychological tendency that is expressed by evaluating a particular entity with some degree of favor or disfavor.

Barrett (2017:231): Attitude in simple terms can be described as how one thinks or feels about a thing, person, place or even event. It can also be described as an evaluation of the attitude object and can be positive, negative, mixed or neutral.

Sorenson (1977:349): An attitude is a particular feeling about something. It, therefore, involves a tendency to behave in a certain way in situations which involve that something, whether person, idea or object. It is partially rational and partially emotional and is acquired, not inherent, in an individual.

Kretch et al. (1962:138): An attitude is defined as an enduring system of three components centering about a single object: the beliefs about the object – the cognitive component; the affect connected with

object – the feeling component; and the disposition to take action with respect to the object – the action tendency component.

The analysis of these definitions may help us to get acquainted with the meaning and nature of the term attitude in the manner as discussed next.

1. *An attitude is a predisposition, readiness or tendency of ours to behave in a particular and definite way to a particular situation.* This predisposition, readiness or tendency to behave in a predetermined way is mental and neural in nature meaning thereby one is mentally and neurologically quite well prepared to respond to a particular type of stimuli in a particular way. In this way, one's attitude decides one's response to a particular stimulus. For example, in responding to all stimuli related with the congress party one has a predisposition or tendency to act in a certain way if one has developed an attitude towards that party.
2. *Our attitudes are clearly attached or associated with attitude objects.* By the term attitude objects here we mean anything related to our social world such as persons, places, organizations, things, ideas and issues, etc. As a result, one may possess a number of attitudes at a time for responding and reacting to one or the other stimuli (attitude objects) in one or the other social situations.
3. *Attitudes are the product of one's learning and experiences much like the other psychological characteristics and traits of one's personality.* In all their forms and shapes they are, thus, an acquired phenomenon and not the inherited ones. For example, people's attitude towards their religion is an acquired tendency or disposition. They are not born with enthusiasm or apathy towards a particular religion. They have developed a sort of attachment or favorable feeling towards their religion due to their own experiences since their early childhood.
4. *Our attitudes towards one or the other attitude objects partly stand on rational and partly on emotional footing.* People's attitude towards their religion, motherland, eating pizza or ancestral

house is partly rational and partly emotional. Accordingly, they may be able to give very good reasons for advocating and appreciating their religion, but their basis is partly beneath conscious reasoning.

5. *Our attitudes represent our evaluations of the attitude objects. It can be positive, negative, mixed or neutral.* If we keep a positive and favorable attitude towards an object, we will be attracted towards it, admire and try to achieve it. On the other hand, if we have a negative and unfavorable attitude, we will try to avoid it and even feel hostile towards it. For example, people having a positive attitude towards democracy will respond positively to democratic practices and institutions and negatively to authoritarian procedures. Their behavior will speak about their attitude. In the case of having a mixed attitude towards an object, people will be seen to admire and blame it equally on one or the other points. Consequently, they will like to have the company of the person at times but side by side to remain away from them at some other occasions. The neutrality of the attitude shown towards an attitude object may be clearly perceived in their behavior of not taking any interest in the person or thing or remaining quite silent or taking a neutral stand in expressing opinion about an issue.
6. In its composition, *our attitude about a particular object (person, thing, organization, idea or issue) consists of our concepts, beliefs, habits and motives associated with that object.* In this concern, our concepts and beliefs associated with an attitude are often referred to as the cognitive component of our attitude, the habit as the action component and the motives as the affective component.
7. *Any attitude of ours centered round a particular object has three components – cognitive, affective and conative or behavioral.* In other words, all what one thinks, feels and the way one reacts, expresses one's attitude towards an object. For example, the formation of favorable or unfavorable attitude towards a political party is the result of one's thinking and feeling towards that

party and it would be exhibited overtly by them through the acts like heated discussion with associates or strangers, casting a vote in favor of the party candidate or doing active party work during the election campaign.

Judging in this way, attitudes are to a great extent responsible for a particular behavior of a person towards an object, idea or a person. But by this, it should not be concluded that one's behavior is an absolute function of one's attitude. Behavior by all means is a function of both characteristics of the behaving person and the situations in which he behaves. Hence a person may hold a strong attitude and yet under certain circumstances, may behave in quite contradiction to those attitudes. In this way, one's behavior towards an object related to a particular attitude cannot be properly predicted through that attitude but it can be safely said that it makes the individual respond in a particular way to a particular stimulus.

Attitude

An acquired tendency propelling an individual to behave in a certain way towards a specific object or a class of objects subject to the conditions prevailing in the environment.

Concluding in this way, *we may understand by the term attitude as a determining acquired tendency which prepares a person to behave in a certain way towards a specific object or a class of objects subject to the conditions prevailing in the environment.*

Characteristic Features of Attitudes

We defined attitudes as predispositions or determining tendencies to respond in a specified manner. Now the question arises: Should all the predispositions like habits, interests, traits and physiological motives be classified as attitudes? The answer is no. For a clear distinction, an attitude should meet the following six criteria:

- **Attitudes Have a Subject-Object Relationship:** Attitudes always involve the relation of an individual with specific objects, persons, groups, institutions and values or norms related to his environment.
- **Attitudes Are Learned or Acquired:** Attitudes, as pointed out earlier, are learned and acquired dispositions. They are not innate and inherent in an individual. Consequently, they may be differentiated from physiological motives. Hunger, for example, is an unlearned physiological motive, while preference for a particular food, an acquired tendency, is classified as an attitude. Again, while almost any suitable member of the opposite sex may satisfy a man's sexual need, when the need becomes attached to a particular person, the attachment (acquired) becomes an attitude.
- **Attitudes Are Reactively Enduring States of Readiness:** Attitudes represent the state of readiness to respond to a certain stimulus. Physiological motives also do the same. But in their case like hunger and sexual tension, the states of readiness disappear for a period when they are gratified. Attitudes, on the other hand, are relatively enduring states of readiness. Consequently, a wife may hold affective attraction to her husband even after the sexual tension has been resolved.
- **Attitudes Have Motivational-Affective Characteristics:** Attitudes have definite motivational characteristics. Other dispositions like the habit of writing with one's right hand do not have any motivational or affective quality; but attitudes towards one's family, nation, religion or other sacred and hallowed institutions have definite motivational affective characteristics.
- **Attitudes Are as Numerous and Varied as the Stimuli to Which They Respond:** We may have a number of attitudes depending upon the number of stimuli to which we respond. Attitude is an implicit response. Therefore, it stands to be varied with the number and variety of the responses which the individual makes. The change in environment and the situations

further bring variety in the expression of these attitudes. Therefore, it is correct to say that attitudes are as numerous as the object towards which they are directed and the situations in which they are expressed.

- **Attitudes Range From Strongly Positive to Strongly Negative:** Attitudes involve direction as well as magnitude. When people show some tendency to approach an object, they are said to have positive attitude towards it but when they show a tendency to avoid the object, their attitude is described as negative. These positive or negative attitudes may involve intense feelings and vary from large negative values to increasingly positive.

To Sum Up

Our attitudes are those predispositions or determining tendencies that propel us to respond to one or the other objects related to our environment in a specified manner. In order to make them distinguishable from other dispositions like interests, traits and motives, our attitudes are said to be carrying some specific features like (i) they have a subject-object relationship for reacting to the environmental objects in a specific way, (ii) they are learned or acquired, (iii) they represent a relatively enduring state of our readiness to respond to a certain stimulus, (iv) they are attributed with definite motivational affective characteristics, (v) they are as numerous and varied as the stimuli to which they respond, and (vi) they range from strongly positive to strongly negative.

The Components of Attitudes

What we think, feel and the way we react expresses our attitude towards an object. Accordingly, our attitude towards attitude objects (persons, things, ideas and issues, etc.) is composed of its three components – cognitive, affective and conative or behavioral. Let us examine them.

The Cognitive Component of Attitudes

Our thinking and thought processes associated with the attitude object represent the cognitive component of our attitude towards that particular attitude object. Our thought processes, in this connection, may include all sorts of cognition such as facts, knowledge and understanding, ideas and opinions, assumptions and beliefs regarding that object irrespective of their nature – true/untrue, simple/complex or favorable/unfavorable, etc. Regarding the presence of cognitive components in one's attitude we may argue in the manner as follows.

- In a number of cases, our attitudes might be based primarily upon a consideration of the positive and negative attributes about the attitude objects. For example, when we go for purchasing a washing machine for our domestic use, we pay a lot of attention to the factors associated with the appropriateness of the washing machine such as the popularity of the brand and model, effectiveness of washing provided by it, consumption of water and electricity, price and guarantee period, risk of its damage and repair requirements, availability of after sale services, etc. In this example, we may also see that we already have or acquire on the spot (after our survey of the market) a certain type of attitude towards a particular model and brand of the washing machines on the basis of the cognizance taken about their positive and negative characteristics. In this way, what we call the cognitive element of an attitude, is concerned with the use of the available information or opportunity for the needed cognition on our part for forming an opinion, whether favorable or unfavorable, about the attitude object.
- Our thought processes and cognitive exercises play a quite important role as well as cast a quite sizable impact on the formation and functions of our attitudes concerning our social life. One's attitude towards smoking has a quite stronger cognitive component visible in arguments highlighting the health hazard of smoking. Similarly,

the presence of a quite influential cognitive component in people's attitudes (favorable or un-favorable) about the legalization of abortion or same sex marriages may be witnessed quite properly in the cognitively drawn arguments in favor of their opinion.

- We know that most of our attitudes – positive or negative – are formed out of our beliefs (particular type of considerations) centered round the particular attitude objects. What we believe in is the result of a quite thoughtful consideration or cognitive exercise performed on our part for the formation of such a belief. The involvement of cognition in the formation of our beliefs provides a good testimony that attitudes are derived from more elementary cognitions about the attitude object.
- The favorable or unfavorable opinion formed about an attitude object gets stored in our memory for its timely revival in the future. Memorization and recall, as we know, are the cognitive processes and their bonding in such a way with our attitudes provides a valid testimony about the presence of a cognitive component in our attitude. The negative attitude regarding alcohol consumption formed on account of experiencing or witnessing its negative and damaging consequences gets stored in one's memory for becoming a quite enduring component of one's negative attitude towards alcohol consumption.

The Affective Component of Attitude

While the cognitive component of an attitude is associated with our thinking and cognitive processes, the affective component of this attitude is concerned with what one experiences in terms of his emotions and feelings attached to that very attitude object. What we term as an affective component of our expressed attitude towards an attitude object is judged and known through the intensity of our feeling and emotions associated with that attitude object.

Regarding the presence of affective components in one's attitude we may argue in the manner as follows.

- Where the cognitive part of one's attitude plays its role and functions in the background in a passive way, the affective component in terms of its outlet in emotions and feelings remains vocal and expressive in nature. One can read the intensity of feelings and emotions while observing and judging the type of attitude shown by an individual towards a particular attitude object.
- Affective responses influence attitudes in a number of ways. A primary way in which feelings affect attitudes is due to affective reactions that are aroused in the individual after exposure to the attitude object. For instance, many people indicate that lizards/spiders/cockroaches make them feel scared. These negative affective responses are likely to produce a negative attitude towards lizards/spiders/cockroaches. On the other hand, some special kinds of fragrance, voices of birds, meeting with some special groups of people and celebrations of some occasions may arouse positive affective responses (i.e., pleasant feelings, attraction, happiness, etc.) producing positive and favorable attitudes towards these attitude objects.
- The intensity of emotions and feeling associated with positive or negative attitudes towards the various stimuli (attitude objects) may vary a lot in the individuals depending on their own personality characteristics and experiences associated with the development and expression of these attitudes. Accordingly, where people may be found to have strong favorable feelings and positive emotions about environmental protection, they may possess causal or quite weak emotional feelings or reactions for the freedom of speech or road safety.

The Behavioral Component of Attitudes

What we think and feel about an attitude object and what we imbibe as the components of that attitude are translated into action through the behavioral component of this attitude.

Regarding the presence of behavioral components in one's attitude we may argue in the manner as follows.

- The behavioral component of people's attitude towards an attitude object (person, place, thing, idea or issue) is visible to us through their actions and behaviors. The favorable and positive attitude about an attitude object supported through its cognitive and affective components is reflected through the positive actions and behavior demonstrated by them in their social behavior. The reverse is also true for the unfavorable and negative attitude possessed by the individuals towards an attitude object.
- The behavioral component of attitudes refers to the actions performed and behavior demonstrated with respect to an attitude object. For instance, people who have favorable and positive attitude towards same sex marriage or gay rights may be found to demonstrate the likewise actions and behaviors in support of their attitude in the manner such as: (i) presenting their arguments before others in conversation, panel discussions, or through print and online media, (ii) holding demonstrations and hanging banners, and (iii) highlighting and honoring the same sex marriages or attempts made for providing equal rights to the gay community in one or the other field of the social life. Similarly, in the individuals who have a negative attitude towards the members of other races or religions, the presence of the behavioral component related to this attitude will be reflected through the actions and behaviors such as (i) demonstrating their negativity towards them through their comments, and opinions expressed about them in the conversation with their own community; (ii) showing disrespect, apathy and unsociability while interacting with them; (iii) writing and expressing negative views about them in print and online media; (iv) maintaining a quite sizable distance from them in the social interaction and social behavior; and (v) indulging in insulting and aggressive activities against them.

To Sum Up

Our attitude towards an attitude object (persons, things, ideas and issues, etc.) is composed of its three components – cognitive, affective and conative or behavioral.

The *cognitive component* of our attitude towards an object is represented through our thinking and thought processes involving all sorts of cognition such as facts, knowledge and understanding, ideas and opinions, assumptions and beliefs regarding that object. The *affective component* of our attitude towards an object is concerned with what we experience in terms of our emotions and feelings attached to that very attitude object. It is judged and known through the intensity of our feeling and emotions associated with that attitude object. The *behavioral component* of our attitude towards an object refers to the actions performed and behavior demonstrated by us in reacting and responding to that object. Actually, what we think and feel about an attitude object and is imbibed by us as the components of that attitude are translated into action through the behavioral component of this attitude.

Functions of Attitudes

Why do we hold one or the other types of attitudes in the demonstration of our behavior in the social world? What functions are served by our attitudes to us or in what way can they prove helpful or valuable for us? The thinkers, researchers and authors in the field of social psychology have worked out for answering these queries related to the holding of a host of attitudes on our part towards one or the other attitude objectives. As a result, they have tried to name and discuss the needs and functions of the attitudes held by the individuals under the following four heads (Katz, 1960; Crisp and Turner, 2014).

1. Utilitarian Function

Our attitudes favorable or unfavorable developed towards one or the other attitude object may be

found to serve a variety of utilitarian functions helpful in our proper personal, social and professional adjustment leading to an overall welfare and better living to us. Actually, as the research evidences show, attitudes can help people to approach things that are beneficial for them and avoid things that are harmful to them (Maio et al., 2004).

Let us first address the role of favorable or positive attitudes in this connection. The favorable or positive attitudes possessed by individuals towards a number of good things, people, places and issues such as healthy diet, cleanliness, environmental protection, conformity to group/social norms and ethical standards, spouse, parents and elders, etc. are found to perform a quite positive role in making them adequately adjusted and overall better in their life. Not only this, these so adjusted and better living people are also found to imbibe a number of unfavorable or negative attitudes towards a number of improper or bad things such as smoking, gambling, drugs consumption, disrespecting elders, and social or group norms, etc. In this way, a number of positive as well as negative attitudes developed by us for one or the other attitude objects may serve their utility functions for us in a number of ways and these functions lie in us in the form of specific attitudes that maximize rewards and minimize punishments obtained from attitude objects.

Moreover, on account of their helping in our adjustment in a number of ways these are also said to perform adjustment functions for us. In addition, our positive and negative attitudes may also function for getting them utilized to fulfill our needs – personal and social – as well as realizing the set goals of our life. For working as instruments for serving our needs and realizing our life missions, our attitudes may also be found to serve the instrumental functions for us.

2. Knowledge Functions

Our attitudes are found to serve the knowledge function in the sense that each and every attitude (whether positive or negative) possessed by us is found to be imbibed with a unique ability to organize information about attitude objects. Accordingly, our

attitudes help us much in our knowledge gathering process. They help us in making sense of the world, quite rapidly and with enough ease, which in general is quite complex in its nature. Our attitudes about the attitude objects are organized in the shape of some well-defined schemas or cognitive frameworks and accordingly, when we are required to process the available information about a particular attitude object, the attitude formed about that object works as an energy-saving device for helping us much in making attitude-relevant judgments faster and easier to perform. For example, the attitudes formed about honesty, truthfulness, bravery, etc. may help in quick judgments about the persons attributed with these attributes. The negative or unfavorable attitudes formed about the criminals, gamblers and alcohol consumers may help in organizing and processing available information about the people attributed with these negative habits in a quite rapid and easy way. Moreover, influenced by the type of the attitudes formed along with its greater and lesser intensity about one or the other attitude objects, the people are found to know and understand these objects accordingly in the same stronger or weaker ways. Consistent with this hypothesis, research has shown that highly strong and accessible attitudes increase the ease with which people make attitude-relevant judgments. It helps them to get them away from some confusion or ambiguity arising about knowing and understanding reached about the target attitude objects (Kruglanski, 1989). Accordingly, people devote more attention to convincing arguments that match the function of their attitude than to convincing arguments that do not match the function of their attitude (Petty and Wegener, 1998).

3. Ego-Defensive Function

The ego-defensive function performed by attitudes helps people to defend or protect their ego self against any possible internal damage. There are occasions in their life when they fall victim to their internal conflicts and pressures. They need to resort to some mechanism for saving them from the resulting threatening situation. In this connection, their attitudes may serve the purpose well. Individuals who

are quite incompetent in playing a game or showing their worth in an academic area may develop an intense dislike or negative attitude for the game or the academic area and thus may protect their ego self from getting damaged from the unpleasant situations arising on account of their poor performances in these activities. Similarly, while getting threatened with the success of a co-workers in the industry or fellow students in a class, one may develop an unfavorable and critical attitude towards them for protecting one's ego from damage. In some other situations, people are also found to develop a certain type of attitude for defending their ego self when they do not want to face or acknowledge the unpleasant truths about themselves. While not able to resist the temptation of taking bribes or having extra marital relations, one may be found to demonstrate in public the behavior loaded with a quite negative and unfavorable attitude towards corruption and adultery and thus maintaining one's ego self before others.

4. Value-Expressive Function

Our attitudes towards abortion are based on the value we place on an individual's freedom of choice and the sanctity of human life. Similar is the case with a number of certain other attitudes, such as our attitudes towards women empowerment, rape victims, child abuse, environmental pollution, corruption in the society and a host of other social issues. In this way, there is certainly a quite important relationship existing between our attitudes and the values and ideals held by us in our personal and social life.

Accordingly, our attitudes may also serve a quite important function of helping us in the expression of certain values considered as big and important in our eyes. For example, people who have a positive attitude towards health consciousness and environment protection may be inspired and moved to adopt the habit of using a bicycle for going to work and keeping their surrounding clean and pollution free and in turn it helps them in the preservation and expression of their values and ideals towards health maintenance and environmental protection.

Such value expressive attitudes, while playing the role of a motivator and opportunity providers

to the individuals for the expression of their values and ideals, may also automatically add in the task of enhancing the self-esteem of the concerned individuals. The persons having strong views about religious and moral values will naturally have immense satisfaction to the extent of maintaining their self-image by getting engaged in all those activities that provide expression to these values. On account of playing such an additional role, the value-expressive function is also termed as self-esteem function.

To Sum Up

Our attitudes serve quite useful functions for us in our life in a variety of ways broadly categorized as (i) utilitarian function helpful in our proper personal, social and professional adjustment leading to an overall welfare and better living to us; (ii) knowledge function helping us much in our knowledge gathering process; (iii) ego-defensive function helping us to defend or protect our ego self against any possible internal damage; and (iv) value-expressive function helping us in the expression of certain values considered as big and important in our eyes.

Formation of Attitudes – How Attitudes Get Developed and Maintained

How attitudes are formed has been a question for investigation for psychologists in a quite intensive way. For all what is possessed by the individuals as human beings, we, in general, make one's heredity and environment responsible for it. In this concern, along with the acceptance of a quite bigger role of environmental factors, there have been attempts from time to time on the part of researchers and psychologists for the search of the biological base in the formation of attitudes among human beings. The serious ones in this concern have been carried out mostly through experimental studies conducted on pairs of identical twins reared apart or together (Keller et al., 1992; Hershberger et al., 1994). The results obtained and conclusions arrived through

these studies, however, have been quite inconclusive in the sense of establishing any reliable and valid association between one's genes and development of attitudes. The position held up to the present in this connection clearly states that one's attitudes are not inherited, they are learned and acquired through his or her conscious efforts much like the other personality characteristics and attributes. Let us see how these are learned.

How Do We Learn or Acquire Attitudes?

Experience – direct or indirect – is said to be the greatest teacher in making us learn one or the other things in our life. It equally applies for the learning and acquiring of attitudes on our part. The favorable or unfavorable attitudes developed for eating or not eating particular types of food stuff, bearing or not bearing particular types of dress material or the use of cosmetics, etc. on the part of individuals are mostly the result of the generalization of their experiences occurring in their past. Not only the direct but the indirect experiences occurring in one's life, through the reading of literature, listening from others, watching from electronic devices also after getting generalized, take the shape of the deeply rooted positive or negative attitudes towards one or the other attitude objects. How does the process of imbibing one or the other attitudes through one or the other experiences go on in one's life? It can be explained through the explanations provided by a number of learning theories developed by psychologists for this purpose. Let us have a brief look at the role played by some of these learning theories in the task of attitude formation and development among individuals.

- *The Theory of Classical Conditioning:* A number of our interests, attitudes, habits, liking and disliking, fears and phobias are said to be the product of our conditioning that occurred in our past through the available social experiences. For example, let us take into consideration the formation of the attitude towards the idols of the God. A child in his early childhood sees his mother pay respect to the idols of the Gods by joining her hands and performing

other formalities of worshiping every time she pays visit to a temple. While accompanying his mother the child initially has little or no mentionable reaction in the form of regard and respect to the idols of the Gods. However, after witnessing repeated pairing of his mother's paying regard to the idols of Gods, he himself begins to respond in the same way – showing respect and worshiping the idols of the Gods irrespective of the presence or absence of his mother.

- *Theory of Operant or Instrumental Conditioning:* In accordance to the principles of operant conditioning, we learn through the consequences of our own actions. The positive or negative attitudes towards an attitude object, according to instrumental conditioning, thus are formed as well as maintained by the type of rewards or punishment we get in consequences of our responding or reacting to the object. A child who is appreciated and praised for taking part in a particular sport or cultural activity may be found to develop a quite favorable attitude towards that sport or cultural activity. On the other hand, the individuals who have a quite bad experience at the time of their first puff of a cigarette, or first day of their alcohol intake might learn to remain away from the consumption of these stuffs and also develop an aversion or negative attitude towards smoking and alcohol consumption.
- *Theory of Social or Observational Learning:* Most of our social learning including the formation and maintenance of our positive and negative attitudes, according to the social or observational learning theory propounded by Albert Bandura, takes place by observing and imitating the behaviors of others especially the elders and our role models. Our attitudes towards one or the other things good or bad in our life are the outcomes of what we observe in their behaviors in our real life or on the silver screen. As consequences of such observational learning, individuals are found to have positive and favorable attitudes towards standing firm for the rights of women and legalizing of abortion, and negative attitudes towards drugs consumption, child abuse and rampant corruption in society.

To Sum Up

Regarding the development or formation of our attitudes, it is to be remembered that these are not inherited, but are learned and acquired through our conscious efforts. We imbibe our attitudes – positive and negative – through the generalization of experiences – indirect as well as direct – occurring in our past. The act of such imbibing of our attitudes through one or the other experiences can be described through the explanations provided by a number of learning theories such as classical conditioning, operant conditioning, and social or observational learning.

The *theory of classical conditioning* in this concern tries to tell us the way we imbibe a number of positive and negative attitudes as a result of our conditioning that occurred in our past through the available social experiences. According to the *theory of operant or instrumental conditioning*, our positive or negative attitudes towards an attitude object are formed as well as maintained by the type of rewards or punishment we get as consequences of our responding or reacting to the object.

The *theory of social or observational learning*, while putting its views in this regard, asserts that most of our social learning including the formation and maintenance of our positive and negative attitudes takes place by observing and imitating the behaviors of others especially the elders and our role models.

The Role of Social Comparison in Attitude Formation

In addition to the role played by one or the other learning theories discussed earlier in the formation and development of attitudes, another mechanism termed as social comparison has also been found to play a quite substantial role in this direction. As a mechanism, social comparison may be defined as a process through which we compare ourselves to others in order to determine whether our view of

social reality is or is not correct (Baron and Byrne, 2001:117). As a human being for becoming more social and showing more nearness to the general opinion held by the members of our society, we try to compare our own opinions and attitudes held by us for one or the other attitude objects with those of others, especially who are valued by us more on this account. The outcomes of this comparison, then, provide us a scope for (i) retaining and strengthening our opinions about the attitude objects, (ii) bringing the needed adjustment or modifications in them, or (iii) replacing them as a whole by showing complete agreement/conformity with others.

Social Comparison

A process through which we compare our own opinions and attitudes held by us for one or the other attitude objects with those of others, especially who are valued by us more on this account.

Factors Influencing the Formation or Development of Attitudes

Attitude is unquestionably an acquired disposition and therefore conditioned by learning or acquisition of experiences. Heredity does not play any role in the formation or development of attitudes. Environmental force helps an individual to form and develop various attitudes. An attitude at any stage is essentially a product of the interaction of one's self with one's environment. Therefore, the factors influencing the formation and development of attitudes can be divided into two sections as follows:

1. Factors within the individual himself.
2. Factors within the individual's environment.

Factors Within the Individual

All individuals do not respond similarly to the same situations. The effect of environmental stimuli in acquiring some predispositions is very much

conditioned by the growth and development pattern of an individual being. Let us try to emphasize these developmental factors.

1. **Physical Growth and Development.** In the development of attitude, physical growth and development plays a significant role. Poor physical health, low vitality and undeveloped somatic structure are responsible for poor emotional and social adjustment and poor social adjustment inevitably exercises an important effect on the formation of attitudes in many different directions. A crippled and undersized girl of 15 years is unlikely to form the same attitudes as those formed by another girl of 15 who is tall, well-proportioned and charming for her age. Even the color of the skin, weight of the body or bio-chemical changes in the body tissues and fluids, for example, sex hormones, have a vital effect on the development of attitudes through its connection with social adjustment.
2. **Intellectual Development.** Development of attitudes is conditioned by the growth of intelligence. The components of intelligence like memory, understanding, thinking and reasoning play a significant part in attitude formation as they help in gaining perceptual experience. Due to his limited intellectual capacities, a young child is incapable of forming attitudes about remote or complex abstract things. His attitudes are always of the particular kinds that are related to his own immediate problems and experiences. With the growth of intellectual capacities, an intelligent adult is capable of having more abstract and generalized attitudes.
3. **Emotional Development.** Emotional development also affects the formation of attitudes. Emotions play a dominant role in overt or covert behavior manifestation and behavior is related to attitudes. As the child develops with age and growth the capacity for varied emotional experiences and attitudes is gradually developed. Emotional maturity helps in social adjustment and in seeking social approval. In turn it makes an individual develop numerous attitudes through his direct or indirect experiences.

4. **Social Development.** Attitudes are rarely individual affairs. Social interaction and group processes are the keys to attitude formation at any stage of human development. Children having poor social adjustment are more likely to have antisocial attitudes and are less likely to be influenced by groups while forming attitudes. Children with healthy social adjustment easily pick up social attitudes from their respective groups.
5. **Ethical and Moral Development.** People develop certain ideals, values and concept of the self in which they take pride. For enhancing their feelings of self-esteem, they try to develop those attitudes that suit their values and ideals. A student who values historical events or objects will have a favorable attitude towards the subject of history. The people who think that God is one will not have unfavorable attitude towards the persons belonging to the religion other than their own.

Factors Within the Individual's Environment

Besides the individual variations shown by their various personality characteristics on account of the pattern of their growth and development, attitudes are largely borrowed from the groups within one's environment to which one owes one's stronger allegiance. It has now been firmly established that environmental forces, in the shape of the social groups, institutions and community, cast a strong influence on shaping the beliefs and attitudes of an individual. Let us try to understand a few important environment factors.

1. **Home and Family:** In attitude formation, home and family environment plays a leading role. The children by identifying themselves with their parents and other members of the family pick up their attitudes. The family more or less defines for the children the expected roles which they must play in various situations and thus initiates the formation of specific attitudes. A healthy family environment and positive attitudes of the parents and other family members bring desirable impact

on children in picking up desirable attitudes while negative parental attitudes, for example of hostility and rejection, lead them to imbibe ascendant and aggressive attitudes. Similarly, many anti-social attitudes are said to be the product of the faulty upbringing and uncongenial environment at home and in the family.

2. **Social Environment:** While the family and home environment play its role in the formation of early attitude, contact with the people in the neighborhood, school, community and society and mores and traditions of the community, to which one belongs, cast strong influence in reshaping early attitudes and acquisitions of many more new attitudes. As the children grow older and have wider social contacts, they are influenced by many social institutions and groups and as a result they try to pick up attitudes of the groups for whom they have stronger allegiance or that suit their own nature and motives in the manner as summarized next.

- In schools, factors like teachers and their behavior, classmates or school mates and their behavior, the teaching methods, curriculum, general tone and discipline of the institution all contribute towards attitude formation.
- The religious groups, social clubs or constitution where one learns or earns has a definite set of emotional and intellectual environment as a result of which members of the group pick up characteristic attitudes of the group and, in this way, social groups play a leading role in attitude formation.
- Mass media in the form of newspapers, radio and television, moving pictures, propaganda literature and advertisement also play a key role in shaping and reshaping the attitudes. Individuals tend to identify themselves with the views expressed through these agencies. Thereby heroes and heroines on screens and in TV programs, attractive figures shown in the advertisements and slogans of a popular leader prove potent sources for the formation of attitudes.

To Sum Up

The factors influencing the formation and development of our attitudes can be divided into two distinctive categories, namely factors lying within our self and factors lying within our environment.

In the former category, we may include one or the other developmental factors such as physical growth and development, intellectual development, emotional development, social development and ethical and moral development. In the latter category, the environmental factors related to the prevailing environment in one's home and family, and the factors lying outside home and family in one's social environment such as: neighborhood, school, community and society, the religious groups, social club and institutions, mass media, and mores and traditions of the community to which one belongs, etc. are found to occupy their unique place.

The Link Between Attitudes and Behavior

From the very early times when Allport (1924) defined attitude "as tendencies to behave in certain ways in social situations", there has been a strong trend in believing that attitudes do influence behavior and to a great extent also work as an important determinant of one's behavior. How one will behave in social situations, thus, might be well predicted through the cognizance of the type of attitudes held by him. If we know the type of attitudes people hold, it seems quite logical for us to predict when they are going to help others or be prejudiced and aggressive; when they are going to engage in healthy behavior, and will eat or prefer to buy some products but not the others. Accordingly, the person having a strong positive attitude towards environmental protection will be found to say and do all what is desirable for the protection of environment in one way or the other. Research findings, in this concern, also show enough possibility of predicting people's behavior from their attitudes. However, it is just one side of the

story. The questions here may well arise: Is it essential to have such a link between attitudes and behavior? Do attitudes always predict behavior or is the shape of one's behavior always determined by the type of attitudes he holds? If not, then when and how, one or the other types of influence is exerted by the attitudes on one's behavior? Based on their works, researchers and social psychologists have tried to conclude these issues as follows:

A. There Is Every Possibility of a Gap Between Attitudes and Behavior

It is not at all always essential for one's behavior to fall on the lines and directions provided by the attitudes possessed by him in this concern. The link between attitudes and behavior is not very solid as it otherwise appears or is supposed to be. In fact, it is relatively weak and depends on so many situational and personal factors. There are situations and possibilities where we may find a sizable gap between attitude and behavior. Therefore, it is not proper nor reliable to predict one's behavior on the basis of one's attitudes. The first such attempt in making such conclusions about the link between attitudes and behavior was made by an American social psychologist, Richard T. LaPiere (1934). He studied the relation of attitude and behavior by travelling with young Chinese couples. During the time of carrying out his study there was widespread prejudice against Asians. The objective of his study was to understand the nature of this negative attitude and its impact on the behavior. In the first phase of his study, he stopped along with the Chinese couples in 184 restaurants, 66 hotels and one motel during his traveling for more than two years all over USA. All over they were treated with courtesy and consideration showing no sign of discrimination against the Chinese couple except with the exception of one who refused serving the couple. In the second phase of his study, carried out after six months, he sent a questionnaire to the same hotels/restaurants/motel including questions related to whether they would be willing to serve Chinese couples in their establishment. Out of the responses received 92% were found to say that they would not serve the Chinese couples and the remaining 8%

replied that they are uncertain. With the results of his study, LaPiere, then, concluded that there is often a sizable gap between attitudes and behavior. Accordingly, we can't use attitudes to predict one's behavior.

B. There Are Reasons for the Gap Left Between Attitudes and Behavior

Why can't attitudes be used for predicting behavior? Why does there remain a sizable gap between attitudes and behavior? Why is there so much inconsistency between what the people say and what they actually do? Let us try to understand it. In this concern the first and foremost thing to pay consideration is to see that there lies a lot of difference between one's covert (implicit and unconscious) and overt (explicit and conscious) behaviors. Implicit and unconscious behavior is the real portrait of one's self. We can't expect inconsistency between one's attitudes and his behavior at the unconscious or implicit state. However, it is not unusual to witness a sizable gap between his attitudes and overt behavior on account of the making use of his cognitive abilities in the form of *reasoned thoughts*.

People try to apply their reasoned thoughts in performing actions in their conscious states of functioning at one or the other occasions. Here, they follow the principle "look before you leap". In this connection, while applying his theory of planned behavior, Ajzen and Fishbein (1980) emphasize that the people think about the implications of their actions before behaving in a certain way instead of behaving as per direction of their attitudes. Accordingly, we may witness the people behave in the manner as illustrated next.

- We may see individuals join the study of a discipline, engaging in one or the other types of activities, or adopting one or the other types of profession/occupation for earning their livelihood for which they are known to have a quite unfavorable attitude and negative opinion.
- There are occasions when people prefer to dispose the waste in the way of their convenience, or engage in the pollution spreading behavior quite contrary to the opinions or attitudes

held by them for the pollution free clean environment.

- People are found to behave quite contrary to their opinions and beliefs held under the influence or pressure exerted on them by the norms and decisions of the groups or community to which they belong. They behave as others behave for being in agreement or conformity with the majority opinion by setting aside their firmly held positive or negative opinions and attitudes on one or the other issues under consideration in a particular social situation.
- There are people who make use of the attitudes for serving the need of their ulterior motives or inner nature. Their actions are quite contrary to their sayings. An individual known for possessing strong unfavorable attitude towards corruption, in fact, may be the one who is an expert in giving and taking the bribes. Another person may express his intense feelings against extra-marital relationships in public only to shield the extra-marital activities in which he is otherwise engaged.

C. There Are Conditions in Which Attitudes Strongly Influence Our Overt Behavior

In spite of a remaining sizable gap between our attitudes and overt behavior in one or the other social situations due to one or the other reasons discussed earlier, there are enough research evidences available for the existence of a close link between people's attitudes and overt behavior strong enough to predict behavior on the basis of their attitudes. Researchers and social psychologists (e.g., Jamieson and Zanna, 1989; Aijen and Fishbein, 1980; Faizo and Roskos-Ewoldsen, 1994; Kraus, 1995; DeBonno and Synder, 1995) etc.), in this concern, have pointed out certain conditions or factors helpful in establishing a close link between attitudes and behavior. Let us examine them.

1. **Situational Factors:** The nature of the expression of our overt behavior on one or the other issues depends both on the nature of attitudes maintained by us on an issue and the situations

prevailing at the time of our behaving. The chances of having a close link between our attitude and behavior, therefore, are greatest at the periods where there is close similarity between the demand of the situation and nature of our attitudes. That is why in the rallies or drives launched against abortion, pollution, crimes against women, etc. the majority of the people will be of those who will have a quite strong unfavorable attitude towards these social evils.

2. **Attitudinal Factors:** The factors or things associated with the nature of the attitudes, themselves, are said to play a quite important role in the existence of a close link between attitudes and behavior. Some of these factors may be referred to as (i) specificity of the attitude, (ii) origin of the attitude, (iii) strength of the attitude and (iv) accessibility of the attitude. Let us examine them.

- (i) *Specificity of the Attitude:* Our attitudes and behavior demonstrate a close link between them if they are found to function at the same level of specificity. For predicting behavior in a good way, therefore, an attitude needs to be focused on a specific attitude object or area rather than the generalized ones. That is why, in a generalized way, when we say that Ramesh has a quite favorable attitude towards sports, it does not guarantee to predict that he would be good at playing all types of games – hockey, cricket, football, etc. He may prove good in one and quite poor in the others. The predictable power of an attitude depends on its specificity – to be quite specific and limited in its application to a specified sport area in the present example such as the game of cricket and there also on one's batting or bowling capacity. In this way, it can be properly said that specificity of attitude plays a quite important role in establishing the attitude-behavior link.

- (ii) *Origin of the Attitude:* The origin or the way in which an attitude has been formed plays a quite important role in deciding the nature of the attitude-behavior link.

Research evidences in this concern have revealed that the attitudes formed on the basis of direct experiences usually exercise greater impact on one's behavior than those formed indirectly through indirect experiences – particularly through hearsay – and as a result, are more capable of maintaining a close attitude-behavior link.

- (iii) *Strength of the Attitude:* How much power or strength an attitude carries with it becomes a great deciding factor for the maintenance of a close attitude-behavior link. As a generalized rule, the greater the strength of an attitude more is its capacity to predict the associated behavior. The strength or power of an attitude is judged through the value or importance given by the individual to its attitude in terms of serving one or the other purposes in the personal and social capacity.
- (iv) *Accessibility of the Attitude:* In our behaving in social situations, what is more accessible – comes into our mind easily – becomes a ready-made part of our responding to one or the other stimuli. It is also true for attitudes. The attitudes (beliefs and feelings towards one or the other attitude objects) that are easily remembered and got available for use when needed are found to possess more strength and power for maintaining the attitude-behavior link.

3. **Non-attitudinal Factors:** Besides the attitudinal factors (things within or associated with the attitude itself), pointed out earlier, certain non-attitudinal factors such as habits, affect (feelings and emotions), reflexes, etc. are also found to exercise sizable influence over human behavior (Pittman and Heller, 1984). On the occasions when people are found to react and respond under the influence of their intense feelings and emotions, perpetuated habits of reacting and responding in a set way or through a quite prompt reflex like actions without finding time to respond thoughtfully, their behavior falls in line with the direction and guidance available through the previously formed attitudes

towards these objects or issues. Accordingly, in these situations we may find greater possibilities of a proper link between one's attitude and his behavior.

4. **Individuality of the Person:** Individuality of people also plays a quite substantial role in establishing the attitude-behavior link. There are individuals who have the guts for standing firm to their beliefs and opinions in all circumstances. Their attitudes towards the attitude objects remain unchanged. For example, if their attitude demands from them to remain away from taking and giving bribes, they behave accordingly with no scope of a gap between their attitude and behavior. On the other hand, there are persons who are found to possess a type of attitude known as ambivalent attitude (neither positive nor negative) towards the attitude objects. The ambivalent attitude is found to be a quite weaker predictor of behavior. It is here that we have a quite weaker attitude-behavior link. Besides this, there are persons who are found to react and respond to the attitude objects according to the needs of situation or serving their own interests with least consideration of the type of attitudes possessed by them towards them. Having least respect to environmental protection, thus, they may be found to prove them a quite vocal supporter of the environmental protection. In such situations, also we may witness a quite weaker link between attitude and behavior.

by an American social psychologist, Richard T. LaPiere (1934). However, the most plausible explanation for the gap left between attitudes and behavior in this concern came from Ajzen and Fishbein (1980) by stating that we think about the implications of our actions before behaving in a certain way instead of behaving as per direction of our attitudes.

On the other hand, in spite of such a sizable gap remaining between our attitudes and overt behavior due to one or the other reasons we can't deny the presence of a close link between our attitude and behavior in a number of situations when these are found to fulfill certain conditions like (i) close similarity between the demand of the situation and nature of our attitudes; (ii) the nature of an attitude in itself in terms of its specificity, origin, strength and accessibility exercising sizable influence over our behavior; and (iii) non-attitudinal factors such as habits, feelings, emotions and reflexes, etc. exercising sizable influence over our behavior. In addition, individuality of the people also plays a quite substantial role in establishing the attitude-behavior link. There are individuals who have the guts for standing firm to their beliefs and opinions and thus their attitudes remain unchanged in all circumstances towards the attitude objects.

To Sum Up

About the link between attitudes and behavior, it is a general trend to believe that attitudes do influence behavior and to a great extent also work as an important determinant of our behavior. However, it is not always essential to find such a solid link between our attitudes and behavior. There are situations and possibilities where we may find a sizable gap between attitude and behavior. The first such attempt in making such conclusions about the gap between attitudes and behavior was made

Persuasion: Changing of Attitudes

Attitudes are by no means fixed and unchanging pre-dispositions. They can change. The task of changing one's attitude is referred to as *persuasion* in social psychology. Here we try to persuade or influence the individual for bringing changes of one or the other kind in the attitudes held by him towards the attitude objects. These changes in people's attitude may be found to be occurring in their two forms or shapes. In its one form, they take place in the already existing direction, that is, from unfavorable to still more unfavorable or from favorable to still more favorable. The changes taking place in the attitudes are called

congruent changes. In its other form, when they take place in the opposite direction, that is, from unfavorable to favorable or vice versa, these are called incongruent changes.

Persuasion

The task or process of changing one's attitude in the desired way.

The process of persuasion, whether resulting in congruent or incongruent changes in people's attitude, is found to involve sending or receiving of the appropriate type of messages/information to persuade them for the needed changes. The whole world of propaganda and advertisement revolves round conveying such messages to the users of the commodities that can have maximum appeal or leave a good impression on them to have a favorable opinion for buying these products. Parents and teachers are also found to convey useful messages or information to the children for persuading them to bring required changes in their attitudes for their needed social and personality development. As a whole, thus, for attitude change persuasive communication plays a vital role. It can be through dialogue, written ideas, television, film or videos. The task of persuasion, carried out through one or the other media at one or the other occasion, may be found to involve the presence of the following four elements.

- The persuader (communicator of the message or appeal).
- The content of the message or appeal.
- The means and mode of communicating the message or appeal.
- The target of the persuasion (the receiver of the message or appeal).

Needless to say, the success of the persuasion process for carrying out desired changes in one's attitude depends wholly on the desirability and competency of the four elements – summarized in a single phrase “*who says what to whom and with what effect*”. Let us see how they need to function.

A. The Persuader (Who Says or Persuades)

The success of any attempt for persuading people to imbibe the needed attitudinal change rests too much on the desirability, and competency of the persuader who communicates with the audience for this purpose. The truth of this saying can be witnessed well when we evaluate the effectiveness of one or the other advertisement or propaganda carrying out on the television or other modern electronic devices. The appearances of the well-known cine personalities, artists, popular leaders and politicians, and social workers carry a strong message/appeal to the audience for turning their opinion in the favor of what is conveyed to them by the communicator. In this connection, researchers and social psychologists have mentioned the presence of the following personality characteristics among the good and effective persuaders.

- Reliability and credibility of the persuaders/communicators in the eyes of the audience.
- Attractiveness and likableness of the persuaders on the part of the audience.
- A likeness and similarity of the persuader with the audience in the sense that he is considered by the audience as one of them.
- Power and status enjoyed by the persuader in the social world.
- The skill, efficiency and expertise possessed on the part of the persuaders in the field.

B. The Content of the Message or Appeal (What Is Said or Communicated by the Persuaders)

Along with the effectiveness of the persuader as a person, what is said or communicated by the persuaders in their communication or appeal to the audience also carries an equal or to say more weight in molding and changing their attitude. The content of the advertisement and propaganda makes the people know and understand why is it beneficial to buy a particular product or follow a particular scheme or program launched by the government and social agencies or vote for a particular political party in the election. The more powerful and effective the

content of the message communicated by the persuader will be the more powerful and effective it would be proving in terms of persuading the audience for the desired attitudinal change. The power and effectiveness of the content of the message many times lie in their capacity of generating strong emotions among the audience in favor of bringing that attitudinal change or providing useful suggestions convincing them that it is beneficial for them to introduce changes in their attitude.

C. The Means and Modes of Communicating the Message or Appeal (How, When and in What Form It Is Said or Communicated)

In the communication of messages or making appeals for the attitudinal changes by the persuaders, it carries a lot of weight to pay proper consideration to the associated factors such as the when and how of the communicated material. It is the best time or opportunity to reach the audience when they are in the mood of or need of listening to the persuaders/communicators for one or the other piece of advice/suggestions in bringing needed attitudinal changes. People listen to the health advisors for attending to cleanliness and healthy food habits when they are suffering or have danger of being infected from diseases. Recently at the time of battling with the global covid-19 disease in 2020–2021, each and every information, guidance or advisory provided to the masses in terms of observing environmental cleanliness, social distancing, hands washing and face mask bearing was attentively captured on their part. Similarly, the status of one's mood also works as a great factor in receiving a message from the persuaders. Efficient salesmen try to care for the moods, intentions and interests of the customers to make them have a favorable attitude towards their offers.

The form, style, mode and method chosen for the communication also matters much. The manner in which you speak (fast or slow), attend to the responses and reactions of the listeners, and take pain in clearing their doubt, matters a lot for winning their confidence and establishing a proper channel for communicating the content of your sayings. The choice for the use of communication media

also counts much in this concern. Although the use of multimedia may serve a quite useful purpose, the decision for making use of one or the other communication channel or media should be taken quite cautiously depending on the needs of the situation and characteristics of the audience.

D. The Target of the Persuasion (the Receiver of the Message or Appeal)

The most important in any channel of communication or persuasion appeal is the audience (person or group), the attitude of whom we want to change in the capacity of the persuader. Attitudinal change in its all forms and capacity involves the needed change in one's behavior and this change in behavior, as we know may be brought through a process of learning, i.e., acquiring one or the other types of experiences – direct or indirect – on the part of the individual. However, whatever good and fine content material and mode or method may be adopted for making one to learn, the success in making one learn the new ways of behaving may not be at all obtained unless one is willing to learn. In this way, the audience, the attitude of whom we want to change, should be ready – physically and psychologically – for accepting the suggestions and appeal made by the persuader/communicator.

To Sum Up

There are situations in which we have to bring desired change in one's attitude. The task or process of bringing such changes in one's attitude is referred to as *persuasion* in social psychology.

The process of persuasion, whether resulting in the already existing direction (i.e., from unfavorable to still more unfavorable or from favorable to still more favorable) or opposite direction (i.e., from unfavorable to favorable or vice versa), is found to involve sending or receiving of the appropriate type of messages/information for persuading the people

for the needed change. As a whole, thus, for attitude change persuasive communication plays a vital role. It can be through dialogue, written ideas, television, film or videos.

The task of persuasion, carried out through one or the other media at one or the other occasion, may be found to involve the presence of the four elements, known as: the persuader (communicator of the message or appeal), the content of the message or appeal, the means and mode of communicating the message or appeal, and the target of the persuasion (the receiver of the message or appeal). Each one of these elements is expected to play its desired role for the effectiveness of a persuasion task carried out in one or the other social situation.

Dealing With Cognitive Dissonance Associated With Our Attitudes

The term cognitive dissonance stands for taking cognizance of an unpleasant internal state on the part of individuals that results when there arises dissonance (serious internal inconsistency) between (i) two or more of their attitudes or (ii) the attitude held by them and its expression in behavior. It is not unusual to witness the presence of such cognitive dissonance among the behavior of individuals quite often in our day-to-day life illustrated as follows.

Cognitive Dissonance

Cognizance of dissonance – inconsistency between two or more of the attitudes of the people or between their attitudes and the behavior.

- The presence of cognitive dissonance is clearly visible in the behavior of a person who is found to possess a strong liking and favorable attitude toward his Muslim friend but on the other hand showing a quite negative and unfavorable attitude towards his culture and religion.

- It is also visible in the behavior of a person who is found to possess a strong liking and favorable attitude toward his Haryanvi colleague but on the other hand shows a quite negative and unfavorable attitude towards his Haryanvi culture and language.
- It also comes into light when a person imbibed with a quite favorable attitude towards environmental protection may be found to engage in the activities associated with cutting of trees or littering in public.
- It is also visible in the behavior of a person when he is found to eat carelessly the unhealthy food while advocating and possessing an aversive and negative attitude towards such unhealthy practice.
- Rakhi as a consumer/buyer of tea may feel uncomfortable when her favorable cine star appears in an advertisement advocating for the purchase of a brand she does not like at all.
- Rekha who loves her parents much may feel uncomfortable when her parents insist she marry a boy of their choice and oppose her for marrying a boy of her liking and choice.

How can one deal with situations like these in resolving the dissonance or inconsistencies arising between attitudes held or between attitude and in its behavioral expression? The socio-psychologists have tried to provide the answer through the development of theories known as cognitive dissonance theories. Two of these important theories known as Heider's balance theory and Festinger's cognitive dissonance theory are discussed here in this chapter.

Heider's Balance Theory

This theory has been brought out by the American Socio-psychologist Fritz Heider. This theory is aimed at sorting out the ways and means for helping individuals feeling uncomfortable or imbalanced when they are faced with inconsistencies arising in taking cognizance of the people and/or issues that are linked by some form of relationship. Heider (1946, 1958) produced his views in this regard through a triangular model known as P-O-X model. Here P stands for the person or individual facing inconsistency or discomfort in a relationship, O for the other person

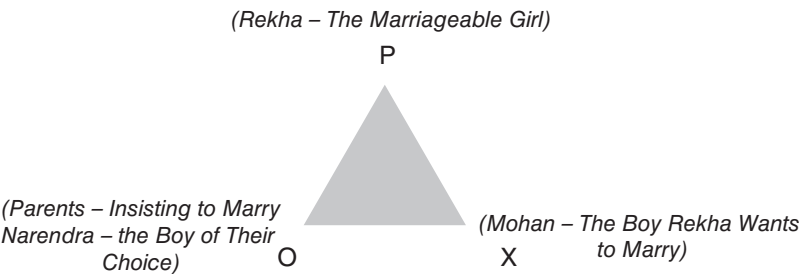


Figure 8.1 Heider's Triangular Model of Cognitive Dissonance

involved in the situation and X for another entity – a person or an object. In reference to the example where Rekha who likes and wants to marry Mohan is opposed and insisted by her loving parents to marry a boy of their choice who is not liked by her at all. The triangular model provided by Heider's theory may be represented as shown in figure 8.1.

In general, two types of relationship – unit and sentimental – are found to exist between the three elements P, O and X of this model.

In maintaining a unit relationship, the elements of the model are attached with each other on account of their belonging to the same unit – family, school, religious faith, language speaking, etc. On the other hand, in the maintenance of a sentimental relationship elements of the model are attached sentimentally by experiencing intense feelings towards each other, e.g., relation between husband and wife, attitude towards one's country, religion or mother tongue. However, at the time of their functioning, the elements of these models express their unit and sentimental relationships in a quite synthesized way with the demonstration of their sizable liking and disliking (or positive and negative attitudes) towards each other.

Symbolically, the positive and negative relationships or attitudes existing between the elements are represented through the algebraic positive (+) and negative (–) signs.

In the triangular model, the relationship existing between the three elements, namely: P, O and X may be both positive (represented through the + signs) and negative (represented through the – signs). Here, all the possible combinations resulted through the interactions of positive and negative relationships (positive and negative attitudes existing between the three

elements) giving birth to the balanced state (one's stable cognitive state of making him feel comfortable) or unbalanced state (one's unstable cognitive state of making him feel uncomfortable) may be symbolically expressed in its algebraic language as follows.

- (Multiplication of the three signs) + + + = +
(Balanced State)
- (Multiplication of the three signs) – + – = +
(Balanced State)
- (Multiplication of the three signs) – – + = +
(Balanced State)
- (Multiplication of the three signs) + + – = –
(Imbalanced State)
- (Multiplication of the three signs) – + + = –
(Imbalanced State)
- (Multiplication of the three signs) – – – = –
(Imbalanced State)

In this way, during the interaction between three elements of the model the possibilities of having balanced or imbalanced states may be listed as follows.

1. We have the possibility of maintaining balance if all three relations are positive or two relations are negative and one positive.
2. There will be imbalance if all three relations are negative or if two relations are positive and one negative.

Let us make clear all possibilities of the creation of balanced or imbalanced states – consistencies and inconsistencies – in relation to arriving at some decision in the light of the example under consideration. (See Table 8.1.)

Table 8.1 Balanced and Imbalanced Cognitive States Reached in Heider's Model

<i>Situation and Outcome (in Symbolic Forms)</i>	<i>Situation in Its Real Form</i>	<i>Outcome in Real Form</i>
+ + + = +	(i) Rekha likes and has a positive attitude towards her parents. (ii) She likes Mohan and wants to marry him. (iii) The parents like and have a favorable attitude towards her marriage with Mohan.	<i>Balanced State</i> All is O.K. in the relationship triangle. There is no inconsistency. Rekha feels quite comfortable.
- + - = +	(i) Rekha dislikes and has a negative attitude towards her parents. (ii) She likes Mohan and wants to marry him. (iii) The parents don't show liking and favorable attitude towards her marriage with Mohan. They are proposing some other boy.	<i>Balanced State</i> Due to their constraint relation, parents are not in a position to persuade Rekha to marry someone other than Mohan. She has full opportunity to take her decision to marry Mohan.
- - + = +	(i) The parents don't show liking and favorable attitude towards her marriage with Mohan. They are proposing some other boy. (ii) Rekha has stopped liking Mohan by learning about something bad about him and have a negative attitude towards him. (iii) Rekha likes and has positive attitude towards her parents.	<i>Balanced State</i> By developing a negative attitude and giving up her idea of marrying Mohan, Rekha is well in a position to go with the wishes of her parents loved and liked by her very much.
+ + - = -	(i) Rekha likes and has a positive attitude towards her parents. (ii) She likes Mohan and wants to marry him. (iii) The parents don't show liking and favorable attitude towards her marriage with Mohan. They are proposing some other boy.	<i>Imbalanced State</i> Rekha will be facing a state of confusion and tension. She has to make a choice either for going with or acting against her loving parents.
- + + = -	(i) Rekha dislikes and has a negative attitude towards her parents. (ii) Rekha likes Mohan and wants to marry him. (iii) The parents like and have a favorable attitude towards her marriage with Mohan.	<i>Imbalanced State</i> Rekha while feeling good and obliged to her parents with their agreeing to her marriage with Mohan may be in a state of tension for feeling guilty of not having her parents to celebrate her marriage with the boy of her liking. The tension can be resolved on her part by making an attitudinal change towards her parents.
- - - = -	(i) Rekha dislikes and has a negative attitude towards her parents. (ii) The parents don't show liking and favorable attitude towards her marriage with Mohan. They are proposing some other boy. (iii) Rekha has stopped liking Mohan by learning about something bad about him and has a negative attitude towards him.	<i>Imbalanced State</i> Rekha is now not in favor of marrying Mohan. It is consistent with the wishes of her parents. On the other hand, it is quite hard for her agreeing to marry the boy of their choice as she does not like him at all. She will thus be experiencing the state of dissonance and feel psychologically tense and disturbed. The best alternative for coming out of this threatening situation for her lies in mending fences with her parents by (i) marrying the boy of their choice or (ii) making them agree to her marrying the boy of her choice in the future.

In this way, according to the views held in Heider's theory, people, in general, try to maintain consistency and stability in their relationships with people and objects. However, there are occasions when there arises one or the other inconsistencies in the relationship behaviors or attitudes held by them towards other people or objects in the system of their social behavior at one or the other time. It creates a state of instability or imbalance resulting in a lot of discomfort and tension in their minds. For resolving this issue, they have to bring needed changes in their system of beliefs and opinions about the people and objects. Once the needed attitudinal changes are introduced by the person by taking cognizance of such inconsistencies, the structure gets balanced or acquires needed stability for functioning again well in the interest of the individual and social relationships.

To Sum Up

Heider's balance theory, brought out by the American socio-psychologist Fritz Heider, opines that people, in general, try to maintain consistency and stability in their relationships with people and objects. However, there are occasions when there arises one or the other inconsistencies in the relationship behaviors or attitudes held by them towards other people or objects. It creates a state of instability or imbalance resulting in a lot of discomfort and tension in their minds. Its resolution requires from them the needed attitudinal changes in their behavior, system of beliefs and opinions about the people and objects. After introducing such changes by the person the structure gets balanced or acquires needed stability for functioning again well in the interest of the individual and social relationships.

Festinger's Cognitive Dissonance Theory

Known by his own name, this theory of cognitive dissonance was proposed by the American socio-psychologist Leon Festinger in the year 1957. In the view of Festinger, there is dissonance in one's

cognition resulting in a state of tension providing a lot of psychological discomfort to him in one or the other social situations. The term dissonance has been defined by Festinger as a negative drive state, which is produced when a person falls prey to two psychologically inconsistent cognitions at the same time quite capable of making him feel tense and uncomfortable. Throwing light on the term cognitive dissonance, Festinger (1957) writes:

Cognitive dissonance can be seen as an antecedent condition which leads to activity oriented toward dissonance reduction just as hunger leads toward activity oriented toward hunger-reduction.

An individual may be seen to fall prey to the phenomenon of cognitive dissonance when there is a sizable discrepancy between what he believes and does. In technical language, one is to face cognitive dissonance especially when there is a quite mentionable inconsistency between his attitudes and the behavioral actions performed on his part. After that, the cognition of such dissonance on his part is found to create a psychological pressure on him to adopt ways and means for dealing with the induced dissonance.

Let us illustrate the phenomenon of cognitive dissonance experienced by the individuals through the examples associated with the day-to-day happenings to them in their real life.

- An individual who is an environmentalist and has a positive and favorable attitude towards environmental protection may be found to face cognitive dissonance after taking cognition that his recently purchased car consumes much petrol by giving less mileage. Here he is caught between the contradiction or inconsistency arising between the attitude held for the environmental protection and his compulsion of using a car that is spreading environmental pollution by consuming more petrol. The contradiction between what he needs to do and what he is doing at present creates dissonance between his belief and behavior making him psychologically tense and uncomfortable.

- A person having unfavorable and negative attitude towards alcohol consumption may be found to face cognitive dissonance when he has to consume alcohol for providing company to the people with whom he has to get engaged in one or the other business deals. Here there is a conflict and fighting between two contradictory cognitions: (i) "Alcohol consumption is injurious to health" (negative belief or attitude held towards alcohol consumption) and (ii) "I am consuming alcohol" (the behavior being performed). It creates the state of dissonance (an unpleasant psychological state of feeling tense and uncomfortable).

What Creates Dissonance?

As emphasized in the preceding two examples, we may conclude about the possible reasons for the creation of the state of dissonance among the minds of the individuals in the manner as follows:

Whenever for one or the other reasons one has to do (publicly) something, he (privately) really doesn't want to do on account of the beliefs and attitude maintained in this concern, a state of dissonance is created between his cognition (I don't want to do this) and his behavior (I am doing it).

After reaching the state of dissonance, according to Festinger (1957, 1964), people will be motivated to try to come out from this state of dissonance (full of psychological tension and discomfort) by resorting to one or the other means including bringing change in their already held attitudes. For demonstrating conditions under which one's cognitive dissonance will change his attitudes, Festinger and Carlsmith (1959) conducted a useful study described as follows.

In this experiment, experimenters asked a group of college students to get engaged for an hour in the series of two boring tasks: (i) emptying and refilling a tray with spools and (ii) repeatedly turning 48 wooden pegs on a board. After then, the experimenters requested these participants to help them in the second phase of their

experiment to be carried out with the new participants who will be also doing the same boring tasks like them for an hour. Since at present they are not in a position to avail the services of some assistant, as a helper they have to tell these new participants before their getting engaged in the boring tasks, that the tasks indeed were quite interesting, exciting and full of fun, in other words lie to them.

For the required purpose, experimenters then divided these college students into three groups: Experimental Group-I, Experimental Group-II and the control group. The experimental groups were used for the execution of the experiment – telling a lie. The control group was put to rest. (The participants of the control group thus did nothing more than doing the boring tasks at the first phase of the study.) For carrying out their lie task the participants of Groups I and II were given \$1 or \$20 respectively to tell the next person (actually a female accomplice of the experimenter) that the tasks were enjoyable and to remain on call in the future. After that all the participants (belonging to Experimental Groups I and II and the control group) were then asked to evaluate the tasks by an interviewer. Results indicated that those paid \$1 rated the tasks as more enjoyable than did those paid \$20 or those who merely performed the tasks and were not asked to lie.

Comments on the Results of the Study

Let us think over the behaviors demonstrated on the part of the participants as the end result of the study belonging to the control group, Experimental Group-I and Experimental Group-II.

Control Group: The participants of this group did not participate in the second session for telling a lie like the participants belonging to both the experimental groups. They merely engaged in the performance of the boring tasks for an hour during the first session of the study. It was thus quite natural and justified on their part to rate both the tasks as dull and boring. Here they did not face any dissonance as their judgmental behavior matched with their belief and attitude held by them towards the type of tasks given to them in this study.

Experimental Group-II: The participants of this group were paid \$20 each to lie by saying that the tasks were quite interesting and enjoyable. This was in quite contradiction to the opinion held and attitude maintained for the tasks executed by them in the first session of the study. It would have resulted in creating a lot of dissonance – the state of mental tension and discomfort. However, the payment of \$20 made them feel obliged and in fact a duty on their part to do as asked. They told a lie. It did not cause any dissonance and thus did not necessitate change in their previously held belief or attitude towards the boring tasks. The payment of \$20 made the behavior of lying justified in the eyes of the participant of Group II with no dissonance of any sort in their mind. With no feeling of dissonance on their part thus they did not feel the need to change their attitude and thereby reported that the tasks were boring.

Experimental Group-I: The participants of this group were also paid cash to lie like the participants of Group-II. They were thus supposed to act and feel like them. However, the things went otherwise. They experienced dissonance as a consequence of the inconsistency existing between their belief (tasks were boring) and action (telling a lie that they were fun). Why did they not respond like the participants of Group-II? They were paid a quite lesser incentive of \$1 in comparison to the \$20 paid to the participants of Group-II. Thus, where the participants of Group-II perceived the incentive paid to them as quite justifiable for making them tell a lie, the payment of \$1 as incentive was not perceived by the participant of Group-I as sufficient and justifiable for behaving contrary to their held belief or attitude towards the boring task. It resulted in the creation of the state of dissonance among them. The dissonance experienced then motivated them to take some measure for the reduction of this dissonance. Finding the change in attitude is the only alternative available for them in this situation, they reported that the tasks were interesting and enjoyable (the only way to justify their lying behavior and seek harmony).

On the basis of this study, Festinger and Carlsmith (1959) tried to conclude that:

- In the situations when people have a reason or justification for behaving in a certain way contrary to their held belief or attitude, they can explain their action well and thus prevent falling victim of the state of dissonance and their attitude can remain unchanged.
- While people are forced to behave in a way contrary to their attitudes, they need to be satisfied by making them convinced for doing so through one or the other means including incentives. However, the magnitude of this incentive should be in an appropriate proportion to help them in seeking justification of engaging in the behavior contrary to their beliefs or attitudes.

To Sum Up

Festinger's cognitive dissonance theory, proposed by the American socio-psychologist Leon Festinger opines that we face a psychological phenomenon named dissonance when there is a quite mentionable inconsistency between our attitudes and the behavioral actions performed on our part. The cognition of such dissonance on our part is found to create a psychological pressure on us to adopt ways and means for dealing with the induced dissonance such as (i) to get engaged in the activities helpful in eliminating the faced dissonance by reducing the importance of the conflicting beliefs/attitudes, or bringing required attitudinal change in our behavior; or (ii) to provide justification for behaving in a certain way contrary to our held belief or attitude in case we are forced or remain satisfied in behaving as such in one or the other situations.

Means and Ways of Dealing With the State of Dissonance

There is a big necessity to take measures for dealing with the psychologically uncomfortable state of dissonance reached on the part of individuals while behaving in one or the other social situation.

Dissonance is produced chiefly on account of the inconsistencies or contradictions arising between what one believes (expressed through the attitudes held) and what one does (the behavior performed). This dissonance needs to be cared for then and there as it is liable to produce a lot of mental tension and psychological discomfort to the affected individuals. The root of the treatment of an evil or problem lies in its causation. Since dissonance is reached on account of the inconsistency or disharmony between the attitude and behavior, the remedy should essentially lie in bringing the needed adjustment or changes in either of them for making consistency or consonance to each other.

However, generally the attitudes held towards an attitude object is quite fixed and rigid in its nature as it has been a result of long driven experiences and learned beliefs. Hence, the measures related to attitudinal change are taken always as a last resort for handling the issue of cognitive dissonance. On the other side, our behavior is also associated with our habits – somewhat conditioned and rigid in nature. Moreover, behaving contrary to the expected lines may also prove harmful and loss giving in many situations. Therefore, while seeking measures to deal with dissonance arising in a social situation, alternatives other than making changes in the behavior or attitudes are first tried on the part of the affected individuals. In this way, the measures taken for restoring harmony in the dissonance state may be classified into three categories, namely (i) to introduce change in the existing beliefs or attitudes, (ii) to introduce change in behavior and (iii) adopting alternative possible means. Let us examine them.

1. **To Introduce Change in the Existing Beliefs or Attitudes:** The disharmony or inconsistency arising between people's attitude and behavior can be properly ruled out by bringing alterations in the attitude held by them towards the attitude object. For this purpose, one can give up wholly the attitude held or soften it in some ways so that it does not come in the way of one's behavior. The individuals who are feeling psychological upset for taking alcohol in the party on account of their negative attitude towards

alcohol consumption may try to come out from this problem by giving up this negative attitude in its totality or may soften it to some extent so that they do not feel guilty for taking it in the attending parties. Similarly, other individuals may be found to give up their negative attitude towards a particular minority community for dealing with their customers belonging to that community or working as colleagues in the same office.

2. **To Introduce Change in One's Behavior:** To reduce or rule out the discrepancy or inconsistency between one's behavior and attitude, the other best way is to introduce the necessary changes in one's behavior for getting it fitted into one's acquired beliefs or attitude. For this purpose, they may completely give up their customary behavior on this account or somehow accommodate it with the held attitude. For illustration, the individuals in our example may be found to give up completely their habit of alcohol consumption, or make it limited for being practiced under the valuable circumstances in dealing with some prized or unavoidable occasions.
3. **Adopting Alternative Possible Means:** However, both these preceding modes of dissonance reduction frequently present problems for people, as it is often difficult for people to introduce change in their well-defined and well-learned beliefs, opinions and behavioral responses (e.g., attitude towards religious minorities, or giving up the habit of alcohol consumption/smoking). As an alternative then they are found to make use of certain other means or measures in the form of excuses and possible alternatives for getting relief in their mental discomfort caused through the dissonance. In view of Festinger (1957, 1964), these may involve:
 - (i) **Elimination of the Dissonant Cognition:** Here the affected individuals try to get rid of the particular cognition (the information and knowledge) which is responsible for creating a certain type of positive or negative attitude towards the attitude

objects, i.e., alcohol consumption is injurious to health. Thus, in making use of this measure, the alcohol consumer may reduce the dissonance by changing their cognition about the effect of alcohol consuming on health and believe that it does not have a harmful effect on health. Similarly, the people who are feeling guilty of spreading pollution on account of the less mileage of their car may begin to think that there is no correlation between the petrol consumption of the car and spread of pollution.

(ii) **Addition of the Consonant Cognitions:**

Here the affected individuals try to add such information and knowledge in their cognition that can help them to believe and think that their attitudes and behavior are in consonance (parallel and matching each other). Thus, in making use of this measure, the alcohol consumers might look for positive effects of alcohol consumption and believe that it reduces tension, keeps them away from a number of viral and infectious diseases and adds to their digestion. Similarly, the people who are feeling guilty of spreading pollution on account of the less mileage of their car may begin to think that actually the engine of their car is so modeled that its petrol consumption does not add to pollution.

(iii) **Reducing the Importance of the Dissonant Cognition:**

In making use of this measure, the affected individuals try to reduce or underweight the significance or value attached to the beliefs or attitudes held by them towards the attitude objects. Accordingly, the alcohol consumers while making use of this measure may begin to believe that the risk to health from alcohol consumption is negligible compared with the danger of automobile accidents. Similarly, the people who are feeling guilty of spreading pollution on account of the less mileage of their car may begin to believe that the risk of spreading of any environmental pollution through the petrol consumption of

their car is quite negligible as compared to the pollution made by other so many vehicles on the road as well as from the factories and many other things spreading pollution in the surroundings.

(iv) **Increasing the Importance of Consonant Cognitions:**

On one hand, while attempting to reduce the importance of things responsible for creating the state of dissonance, the affected individuals, on the other hand, may also attempt to provide weightage to the thoughts and beliefs that lead towards the consonance – harmony between the held attitude and performed behavior. Accordingly, the alcohol consumer while making use of this measure may begin to argue that you don't know how good I feel when I consume alcohol. It gives me the pleasure of the haven. Its consumption is injurious to health, so what, if it leads to shorten one's life, even such short life filled with the taste of the liquor and sensual pleasure is far better than a long life devoid of such pleasures.

Similarly, the persons who are feeling guilty of spreading pollution on account of the less mileage of their car may begin to think about the number of gains resulted through the lesser use of their car for their day-to-day use. They may take the help of public transport or resort to cycling for their going to office or marketing, etc. for helping them in their body fitness and health maintenance program.

To Sum Up

For dealing with dissonance – state of inconsistency or disharmony between our attitude and behavior – it is natural to seek remedy in the measures helpful in bringing the needed adjustment or changes in either of them. However, there are situations where we feel some difficulty in bringing alterations in our attitudes on account of their being quite fixed and rigid in nature and also there is a big possibility of

facing harm and loss on account of our behaving contrary to the expected lines. Therefore, while seeking measures to deal with dissonance arising in a social situation, alternatives other than making changes in the behavior or attitudes are first tried on the part of the affected individuals.

Consequently, as a whole, we may adopt three types of measures for dealing with dissonance, namely measures helpful in introducing change in our attitudes, measures to introduce change in our behavior and measures adopting alternative means other than bringing change in attitude or behavior such as (i) getting rid of the particular cognition – the information and knowledge responsible for creating dissonance, (ii) adding information and knowledge in cognition helping one to believe and think that his attitudes and behavior are in consonance, (iii) reducing or under-weighting the significance attached to the attitudes held towards the attitude objects, and (iv) providing importance to the thoughts and beliefs that lead towards the consonance between the held attitude and performed behavior.

Resistance to Persuasion

Persuasion, as you know, when done with good intention aims to bring changes in the attitudes or behaviors of the individuals for directing their thoughts and actions to travel on the proper path for their own good and social welfare. However, doing so on the part of persuaders is not as easy as it otherwise appears. There may be a lot of resistance on the part of the individuals to accept the persuasive messages. The persuaders have to work hard for the same.

On the other side, such type of resistance shown by individuals in the acceptance of persuasive messages is somewhat essential for them to safe guard their opinions, beliefs, attitudes and hard-earned learning and behaving modes. It is their resistance to persuasion that works as a deterring force for not allowing their beliefs and attitudes to become

a subject of constant change. The conditions and factors that have been found to work for creating resistance to persuasion in one or the other social situations may be named and discussed as follows.

1. **Reactance:** It refers to a tendency of the human beings to react against any attempt made by someone for persuading them to bring changes in their attitudes. They take the persuasion message as the deliberate effort aimed to snatch their personal freedom by getting the things done according to the wishes of the persuaders. In the demonstration of the phenomenon of such reactance, thus, many times people are found to express their resentment against the persuaders by doing just opposite to that what has been asked and advised to them in the persuasive messages. In the case of their persuasion with greater emphasis, force and strength on the part of the persuaders, the individuals may turn into a perfect rebellion not only to reject and go against the persuasive message but also do contrary to their own standing on the involved issue in case it may help them to go against the wishes of the persuader. Commenting over the nature and effect of the phenomenon of reactance, Baron and Byrne (2001:137) write:

The existence of reactance is one principal reason why hard-sell attempts at persuasion often fail. When individuals perceive such appeals as direct threats to their personal freedom (or their image of being an independent person), they are strongly motivated to resist. And such resistance, in turn, virtually assures that many would-be persuaders are doomed to fail.

2. **Forewarning:** The term forewarning stands here for the prior knowledge or information possessed on the part of the individuals that they are going to be influenced or persuaded by someone for agreeing to what is conveyed to them on an issue by setting aside their own opinion or belief in this concern. In this way, well before being approached by the persuaders through their persuasive message, the individuals have a prior knowledge of its intent – knowledge that someone is trying to change

their opinion or attitude about the existing issue. For example, at the election time the well-informed conscious voters are quite aware of what might be conveyed or done by the political parties for bringing changes in their beliefs and attitudes. Naturally, such prior knowledge about the intent of the persuaders must make them quite ready and prepared before-hand to stand by their beliefs and attitudes more firmly in comparison to the state in which they would have been caught unaware. And it happens in the real sense. The individuals will have opportunity as well as time for getting engaged in the collection of well-framed arguments or other defenses against the persuasive messages and, thus, become more rigid in their previously held beliefs and attitudes for showing a heavy resistance to the concerned persuasion attempts.

3. **Selective Avoidance:** In making use of this technique for resisting the persuasion attempts of others, the individuals are found to direct their attention away from information/persuasive messages that challenge their existing beliefs and attitudes. Accordingly, while viewing television, people may be seen avoiding the pressing of the TV remote for one or the other channels that are well-known for telecasting the news and views criticizing the activities and policies of a political party, particularly some of its leaders for whom they have a quite favorable and positive attitude. Similarly, people may be found to avoid reading of the newspapers and magazine articles and looking on the messages on their smart devices that stand contrary to their opinions and attitudes on one or the other issues. Such avoidance proves quite helpful and effective to them for increasing their resistance to persuasive messages of their disliking.
4. **Providing Counterarguments Actively:** The technique of selective avoidance used for the resistance of unwanted persuasive messages provides us a silent and passive mode for showing our opposition and resistance to the persuasive messages. In addition, or without resorting to the avoidance of the persuasive messages, people can be sufficiently vocal for expressing

their opposition and resistance to the persuasive messages. In making use of such an active vocal mode for the expression of their resistance, they can actively plan and organize a set of well-thought arguments that are capable of exercising two-fold functions: (i) opposing and criticizing what is conveyed through the persuasive appeals and messages and (ii) supporting the views held or things to be done in accordance of their beliefs and attitudes. Accordingly, while making use of the technique of providing counterarguments actively, the individuals are seen to actively defend their existing attitudes by providing counterarguments against the views that are contrary to these attitudes (Eagly et al., 1999).

To Sum Up

The task of persuasion carried out by persuaders for communicating their persuasive message may face a lot of resistance on the part of the individuals. The various conditions and factors that work behind such resistance may be referred to as:

- *Reactance* (our tendency to react against any attempt made by someone for persuading us to bring changes in our attitudes).
- *Forewarning* (having information that we are getting persuaded by someone for agreeing with the persuasive message contrary to our attitude and belief).
- *Selective Avoidance* (attempt on the part of the individuals to direct their attention away from persuasive messages that challenge their existing beliefs and attitudes).
- *Providing Counter Arguments* (actively defending the existing attitudes on the part of individuals by providing counterarguments against the views that are contrary to these attitudes).

The Measurement of Attitudes

Our attitudes are hypothetical constructs. We have defined them as our implicit responses or predispositions to objects, persons, ideas, values or situations in the social surroundings. Thereby, they are essentially covert tendencies and represent the inner mechanisms of the individual not directly observable by us. If we want to measure them, there must be some means to draw them out or make them manifested in the form of overt behaviors. This can be done in the following two ways: (i) Direct Method (measuring the verbal report of the attitude) and (ii) Indirect Method (interpretation of the attitude from the indirect responses of the individuals).

Let us discuss now both of these methods.

Direct Method for the Measurement of Attitude

In this method, opinions of the individuals about a particular subject in the form of a verbal report are collected and then on its basis, their attitude towards the subject is estimated. Generally, the following devices are used for the purpose.

- 1. Asking individuals directly how they feel about a subject (the use of questionnaires and interview techniques).
- 2. Asking individuals to mark those statements from a list with which they are in agreement (the use of devices such as checklists and rating scales).
- 3. Asking individuals to indicate their degree of agreement or disagreement with a series of statements dealing with the same subject (the use of the especially constructed attitude scales).

The last mentioned devices known as attitude scales are most widely used for the measurement of attitudes. Generally, the Thurstone attitude scale, Likert attitude scale, Guttman attitude scale and Bogardus social distance scale are popular in this context. Let us examine them.

Thurstone's Attitude Scale

It is also known as an equal-appearing intervals scale. This scale was developed by Thurstone, L.L. in 1929. In constructing such a scale, a large number of statements representing a variety of opinions on a subject are collected. These statements are then given to a number of judges who are asked to sort the statements into two categories – say from “very favorable” to “very unfavorable”. Whenever the judges disagree significantly over an item, it is rejected. The finished scale then consists of the remaining statements or items that represent clearly defined opinions on the subject. Each of these final statements is then assigned a scale value based on the median scale position given by the judges. If half the judges, for example, had assigned a particular statement to position 4 or lower and half had assigned it to position 5 or higher, the scale value assigned to the statement could be 4.5. Some of the statements from the Thurston's scale for measuring attitude toward the church with the scale value of each statement are shown here:

Items	Scale Value
I believe the church is the greatest institution in America today.	0.2
I believe church membership is almost essential to living life at its best.	1.5
I believe in what the church teaches, but with mental reservations.	4.5
I believe in religion, but I seldom go to church.	5.4
I do not receive any benefit from attending church service but I think it helps some people.	5.7
I think the church is a parasite on society.	1.0

In administering the scale, individuals are asked to check all the statements with which they agree. For each individual, then a scale position is computed as the average of the scale values of all the items one has checked.

Likert Attitude Scale

This scale is more popular than Thurstone's scale. It employs a larger number of items than Thurston's

scale and discards the methods of scaling by several judges. This scale was developed by Rensis Likert as a part of his doctoral thesis in 1930s (Likert, 1932). In constructing such a scale, a number of statements or items concerning a particular subject are collected. These items, each of which clearly represents either a favorable or unfavorable attitude, are then tested for internal consistency, i.e., to see that all the statements or items are actually concerned with the same subject. The tested items constitute attitude scale. The individual is asked to indicate the degree of his agreement or disagreement with each item on a five-point scale. Thus, for assessing attitude towards internationalism, the sample items such as follows are presented.

Encircle one of the symbols preceding each of the following statements. A, stands for “Agree”, S.A. stands for “Strongly Agree”, D for “Disagree”, S.D. for “Strongly Disagree” and I for “Undecided.”

Response	Items
S.A., A, I, D, S.D.	We should be willing to fight for our country whether it is in the right or in the wrong.
S.A., A, I, D, S.D.	Our country should never declare war again under any circumstances.

For scoring the items, a value of 5 may be given to the responses indicating strong agreement, 4 for simple agreement, 3 for undecided, 2 for simple disagreement and 1 for strong disagreement. Thus, each individual can be assigned a single quantitative score for the measurement of his attitude.

Guttman Scale

Named after its developer, this scale was developed by Louis Guttman (1950) for measuring the attitudes of individuals towards the attitude objects. However, on account of a lot of hardships faced in its construction as well as use, it is rarely used by researchers and other users for the measurement of attitudes of the individuals in one or the other social situations. To take stock of the nature of the instruction issued and items included in a Guttman scale, let us try to illustrate it through an example.

Example 1: A Guttman scale measuring attitude towards the legalization of abortion might take the following form (Thorndike and Thorndike, 2010:368–369):

Please indicate what you think about legalization of abortion by putting right (+) or (-) mark in the box to identify the statement that quite closely matches your opinion.

1. Abortion should be available to any woman who wishes it.
2. Abortion should be legal if a doctor recommends it.
3. Abortion should be legal whenever the pregnancy is the result of rape or incest.
4. Abortion should be legal whenever the health or well-being of the mother is endangered.
5. Abortion should be legal when the life of the mother is endangered.

Bogardus Social Distance Scale

Named after its developer, this scale was developed by Emory Bogardus in 1924. It is one of the oldest and still in use psychological attitude scales. It is widely known as the social distance scale on account of its being developed by Bogardus as a scale of measuring varying degrees of closeness in people towards other members of diverse social, ethnic or racial groups (Bogardus, 1925). In this way, social distance scales such as the Bogardus social distance scale are helpful in measuring social distance of one group from the other. These scales differ from the scales of attitude measurement (like the Thurstone, Likert and Guttman type) in the sense that they do not represent the exceptional attitude of a single member or any group towards other groups or its members but they represent the attitude or feeling of a group as a whole towards other groups or their members.

Like the formerly discussed Likert, Thurstone and Guttman scales, the Bogardus scale is also unidimensional. It can thus measure the type of attitude, prejudiced opinions or the lack of it towards only one community or group at one point in time.

In its application, the Bogardus scale asks people the extent to which they would be accepting of each

group (a score of 1.00 for a group is taken to indicate no social distance.)

- As close kinship by marriage (score 1.00).
- As my close personal friends (2.00).
- As neighbors on the same street (3.00).
- As co-workers in the same occupation (4.00).
- As citizens in my country (5.00).
- As non-citizen visitors in my country (6.00).
- Would exclude from entry into my country (7.00).

A close analysis of these seven categories reveals that in social distance scales statements are constructed to measure the varying degrees of social intimacy or distance. The respondents have a wide choice ranging from a fairly close degree of relationship with the other group or their members to an extremely remote relationship or none at all. The analysis of the responses of the respondents, then, helps to provide a good estimate of the type of positive or negative attitude or feelings possessed on their part about the social group in question.

In India, too, attempts have been made to devise social distance scales for measuring social distance between different groups. B. Kuppaswamy in 1951 devised a scale in which he asked his respondents (students in Madras) to indicate as to what extent would they admit Brahmins, Christians, Harijans, higher caste non-Brahmins, Muslims, Parsis and Sikhs to the following social relationships:

1. To kinship by marriage.
2. To take food in your own dining room.
3. As an intimate personal friend.
4. As a guest in your house.
5. As your neighbor.
6. As an acquaintance.

Indirect Method for the Measurement of Attitudes

The process of inferring attitude directly from the verbal report or expressed opinion has many limitations. One may conceal one's real attitudes and may not really know what one feels and may be unable to

know one's attitude about a situation in the abstract. Even overt behavior is not always a true indication of one's attitude. When politicians cuddle babies, their behavior may not be a true expression of their attitude towards children.

To avoid this problem, it has been tried to make use of the measurement methods that are indirect or disguised in nature. In these methods the subjects are given opportunities to structure their own responses without letting them know the real purpose of the task. The projective techniques used for the assessment of personality are good examples of these Indirect Methods. As examples of these projective techniques utilized for this purpose, we may include the techniques like Rorschach Ink Blot Test, Thematic Apperception Test (TAT), Children Apperception Test (CAT), Word Association Tests, Sentence Completion Tests, Play Way Techniques, etc. The essence of these techniques is that the subjects express their covert tendencies while responding to unstructured stimuli. An intelligent interpretation of their responses may show their attitude towards a particular object or issue.

Now the question arises as to which of these two techniques – direct or indirect – should be used for measuring attitudes. Both of these are very good instruments and have their own values and limitations. Perhaps in our opinion, the best method or procedure adopted for the measurement of attitudes is the one that combines the verbal report and the interpretive techniques. It will surely help us in getting an extensive and intensive measurement of attitudes covering their covert tendency and overt manifestation.

To Sum Up

For the measurement of people's attitude towards an attitude object, two types of measures classified as Direct or Indirect methods may be employed.

In making use of the Direct Method for the measurement of attitudes, opinions of the individuals about a particular subject in the form of a verbal report are collected and then

on its basis, their attitude towards the subject is estimated. The devices we make use for this purpose may be questionnaires and interview techniques, checklists and rating scales, and constructed attitude scales such as the Thurstone attitude scale, Likert attitude scale, Guttman attitude scale, Bogardus social distance scale and Kuppaswamy social distance scale.

In the use of the Indirect Method for the measurement of attitudes, attempts are made to infer attitudes of the people with the help of projective techniques such as the Rorschach Ink Blot Test, Thematic Apperception Test (TAT), Children Apperception Test (CAT), Word Association Tests, Sentence Completion Tests, Play Way Techniques, etc.

Review Questions

1. What do you understand by the term attitude? Provide its meaning and discuss its concept in detail.
2. What are attitudes? Discuss their characteristic features.
3. Define the term attitude and throw light on its various components.
4. What functions may be served by our attitudes? Explain in detail.
5. Throw light on the formation of attitudes with a necessary detail of how they get developed and maintained among individuals.
6. Define the term social comparison and explain its role in our attitude formation.
7. Name and discuss the factors influencing the formation or development of attitudes.
8. In which way and to what extent are our attitudes linked with our behavior? Discuss in detail.
9. What do you understand by the task of persuasion? Name and discuss the various elements involved in carrying out this task.
10. What is cognitive dissonance? In what way does it become problematic to the suffering individuals? Discuss.

11. What are the cognitive dissonance theories? Name and discuss any one of them in detail.
12. What is Heider's balance theory? How is it helpful in resolving the dissonance experienced by an individual in one or the other social situations?
13. What is Festinger's cognitive dissonance theory? Throw light on its role in dealing with the state of dissonance.
14. What is dissonance? Discuss in detail the means and ways of dealing with the state of dissonance.
15. What do you understand by the term resistance to persuasion? Name and discuss the various conditions and factors that work for creating resistance to persuasion in one or the other social situations.
16. What are attitudes? Discuss the various ways and means utilized for measuring people's attitudes.
17. Throw light on the use of any two of the following attitude scales in measuring people's attitudes: (i) Thurstone attitude scale, (ii) Likert attitude scale, (iii) Guttman attitude scale and (iv) Bogardus social distance scale.

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9.

STEREOTYPING, PREJUDICE AND DISCRIMINATION

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- Talk about the meaning and concept of stereotyping.
- Throw light on the types or forms of stereotyping behavior.
- Elucidate the relationship of stereotypes with prejudices and discrimination.
- Explain from where stereotypes emerge.
- Discuss the impact of stereotyping on the progress and well-being of individuals and societies.
- Tell about the meaning and nature of prejudices.
- Throw light on the sources of prejudices.
- Discuss the evil impact of prejudices on interpersonal relationships.
- Talk about the meaning and nature of discrimination.
- Discuss the consequences or impact of discrimination.
- Throw light on the various techniques used for countering the ill effects of stereotyping, prejudices and discrimination.

Introduction

We live in a diverse society, where we may find that people differ from each other in so many aspects – physical, mental, emotional, social and behavioral in a variety of ways. For the understanding of such diversity among individuals and their groups from a sociological angle we try to classify and categorize them in some social classes and categories on certain social differentiations such as religion, caste, color, creed, gender, socio-economic status, marital position, profession and means of livelihood, language

spoken, locality and nationality, etc. With our experiences – direct and indirect – about the individuals belonging to these social groups we have developed certain types of specific attitudes towards these social groups or categories reflected usually through some particular type of thinking, feeling and acting behaviors on our part known by the terms stereotyping, prejudices and discriminations in the world of social psychology. In the pages to follow, here, we will be focusing on knowing about the essentials of the nature and application of these important concepts.

Stereotyping

Meaning and Concept

As its etymological derivation, the term stereotype has been derived from a combination of two Greek words – ‘stereos’ (meaning as firm or solid) and ‘typos’ (meaning impression or opinion). In its literal sense, thus, the term stereotype stands for a type of plate that works as a mold. We can prepare or manufacture many articles of an identical nature with the help of a mold. In the similar way the persons, places and objects of a particular category may appear identical to us by getting colored through stereotypes. The stereotypes in this way may be termed as a sort of some ideational or emotional patterns or molds set up in our mind that may give birth to our over generalized beliefs and concepts about the persons, places and objects, etc. such as: Hilly people are hardworking; the bald are rich and prosperous; women can’t keep things secret; African-Americans are violence-prone; the people wearing spectacles are studious; green fruits are always sour and red are sweet.

As a matter of definition, the terms stereotype and stereotyping have been variedly defined in the available dictionaries and writings of scholars. Let us try to have a glimpse of these definitions.

The American Heritage New Dictionary of Cultural Literacy (2005): It defines the term stereotype in the following two ways:

1. A too-simple and therefore distorted image of a group, such as “Football players are stupid” or “The English are cold and unfriendly people.”
2. A generalization usually exaggerated or oversimplified and often offensive, that is used to describe or distinguish a group.

Webster’s Seventh New Collegiate Dictionary (1970:860): Stereotype is “a standardized mental picture held in common by members of a group and representing an over simplified opinion, affective attitude or uncritical judgment as of a person, a race, an issue, or an event”.

McGarty et al. (2002): In social psychology, a stereotype is a thought that can be adopted about

specific types of individuals or certain ways of doing things.

Judd and Park (1993): The thoughts and beliefs maintained about people or issues. These thoughts or beliefs may or may not accurately reflect reality.

Sears et al. (1991): Stereotypes are beliefs about the typical characteristics of group members.

Kimble Young (1953): Stereotype is best defined as a false classificatory concept to which as a rule, strong emotional feeling, tone of like or dislike, approval or disapproval is attached.

Secord and Backman (1974): Stereotyping is an exaggerated form of typification that has three characteristics, namely,

1. People identify a category of person according to certain attributes.
2. People agree in attributing sets of traits or characteristics to the category of persons.
3. People attribute the characteristics to any person belonging to that category.

Fisher (1982): Stereotypes involve gross generalizations that are acquired through misinformation and that ignore individual differences and are resistant to change even in the light of new evidences.

Lee et al. (2013): Stereotypes do consist of conventional aspects such as attributing characteristics to different social groups.

Aronson et al. (2014): Stereotypes can be defined as a generalization about a group of people, in which certain traits are assigned to virtually all members of the group, regardless of actual variation among the members.

Stereotyping

Our thoughts and beliefs in the form of over simplified generalizations about a group of people, objects or issues.

The definitions given earlier may help us in drawing the following conclusions about the meaning and nature of the term stereotyping:

- Stereotyping reflects the oversimplified attitudes and feelings of people in general towards specific types of individuals, groups and communities.
- It is the result of incomplete or distorted information accepted as fact without questions or putting into verification and critical judgment.
- Stereotypes are best known for influencing our perception and social judgments we have about the other group; they influence how much we like or dislike a person or a given group.
- Most of the time stereotypes are found to make us feel superior in some way to the person or group stereotyped.
- Stereotyping is responsible for breeding an antagonistic attitude, ill feelings and prejudices against the persons who are subjected to stereotyping.
- It is not necessary for the stereotypes or stereotyping to be always negative in its nature resulting into negative consequences. Sometimes, we may have positive over generalizations or stereotypes like: Hilly people are hardworking; Asians are good students and employees; black men are good at basketball, etc.
- Under the negative influence of stereotyping, the victims (individuals or groups) may be found to suffer from (i) the prejudices, isolation, discrimination or marginalization on a group/community level and (ii) anxiety of failure, inferiority complex and lack of confidence in terms of their adjustment and progress at the personal level.
- Stereotypes ignore the uniqueness of individuals by painting all members of a social category or group with the same brush. However, as we know, each individual is unique, and, therefore, it should not be assumed that the actual traits, characteristics or behaviors of the person being stereotyped will concur with those that are suggested by the stereotype (Luthans, 2010).
- It is true that most of the time stereotyping leads to inaccurate perceptions and inappropriate behavior towards people. But it does not mean, however, that all stereotypes are incorrect. Many of them may be filled up with a lot of truthfulness/possess a kernel of truth (Whitley and Kite, 2006).

- Stereotypes are also difficult to contradict once they are formed, mainly because as stereotypes are used, they determine the type of information that is remembered by us. And information that is not consistent with the stereotype is not remembered (Taylor, 1984).

Types or Forms of Stereotyping Behavior

A stereotype is simply a widely held belief that an individual is a member of a certain group based on its characteristics. Due to the process of over generalization within social perception, stereotyping leads to a great deal of inaccuracy in social perception. Sex, race, age, sexual orientation, religion and physical ability are various categories which exist in stereotyping.

Let us discuss common types of stereotypes existing in our society

A. Sexual or Gender Stereotypes

- Girls like to remain dependent, protected and looked after more than the boys.
- Parents hold an opinion that their daughters need nurturing of passivity and dependency and their sons to be aggressive and independent.
- Females are more conforming and more concerned about displaying socially desirable behavior than males are.
- “Boys don’t cry” and “Girls don’t fight”.
- Females are most fit for doing household jobs and males for the outdoor work.
- Females are talkative and are not fit for serious and responsible assignments.
- Girls are not supposed to study mathematics, sciences, computer, commerce and technical subjects. They are suitable for the study of humanity and languages.
- In work-outputs females are quite inferior and often lag behind their male counterparts.
- The girls are not supposed to take part in games and play activities involving adventure, muscle power and stamina like

wrestling, boxing, shooting, paragliding and trooping, rock climbing, weight lifting, etc.

- Girls always surpass boys in the demonstration of communication and social skills, musical and dancing abilities, aesthetic sense and artistic abilities.

B. *Social Class or Racial Stereotypes*

- People belonging to lower castes possess inferior cognitive, social and emotional intelligence than those belonging to higher castes.
- People belonging to low social class and communities and blacks (in relation to western countries) are better in athletic games particularly in boxing, wrestling and the activities requiring toughness, physical stamina and adventurism.
- People from urban backgrounds and urban culture are superior in intelligence but lag behind the rural children in the performances in sports.
- Children belonging to lower castes, low social class, rural backgrounds and backward areas lag behind in their studies, create problems in the class and school, and have more chances of becoming delinquents.

C. *Poverty Related Stereotypes*

- The people belonging to poor families have a quite low level of aspiration and achievement motivation.
- The poverty ridden individuals easily fall victim to problematic and delinquent behavior.
- The poverty ridden people usually suffer from maladjustment, as well as problems related to poor physical and mental health.
- The poverty ridden children are poor in their school attendance, find little time and face difficulties in doing their home assignments and project activities.

person, are firmly attached with the other concepts like prejudices and discrimination. Stereotypes are regarded as the most cognitive component and often occur without conscious awareness, whereas prejudice is the affective component of stereotyping and discrimination is the behavioral component of prejudicial reactions. Thus, in this tripartite view of inter-group attitudes,

- (i) Stereotypes reflect expectations and beliefs about the characteristics of members of groups perceived as different from one's own (cognitive behavior exhibited by the person having stereotype).
- (ii) Prejudice represents the emotional response exhibited by the person possessing the stereotype (affected behavior exhibited by the person having stereotype).
- (iii) Discrimination or marginalization refers to actions (conative behavior exhibited by the person having stereotype).

In this way, a stereotype is first responsible for generating the prejudiced feelings and emotions against the group members and then acting in a prejudiced way showing a lot of discrimination and marginalization. As a result,

- A teacher who is under the influence of the gender stereotype, "girls are talkative, and non-serious" and the related prejudiced feelings will always be found automatically appointing boys as "group leader" and girls as "secretary" for the project or association activities.
- The members of a selection committee under the influence of gender, religion or caste stereotyping may be found to have prejudiced feelings and discriminatory attitudes in selecting the candidates for the various posts by setting aside the merit and suitability criterion for the purpose.

Relationship of Stereotypes With Prejudices and Discrimination

Stereotypes, although having their separate identity and existence as the firm beliefs and attitudes of a

From Where Do Stereotypes Emerge?

From where do the one or the other stereotypes emerge? Let us think over the possible sources of their emergence.

Stereotypes, the fixed opinions and beliefs about the persons, objects, places and issues, are the psychological attributes much like many of our psychological traits. These are not inherited and inborn. We learn and acquire them through one or the other ways explained ahead.

1. *Perception of the Social Objects*

Our perception in the world where we live in consists of two types of objects – natural and social. In our perception of natural objects or physical surroundings we see things as they are, while in perception of social objects we see things as we are (according to the color of the spectacles we wear or things we want to see in them) or we are told about these things well in advance before we actually see them. In this way, our perception of the social issues is quite subjective. It is dominated by the preconceived notions told by others or otherwise prevalent in the society for a long time in the form and shape of stereotyping.

2. *Indirect Learning*

Experience is said to be a good teacher. It may be acquired through indirect as well as direct mode. The learning gained or acquired through indirect experiences here is known as indirect learning and it may prove a quite potent source for the acquisition of one or the other stereotypes among individuals. Under the influence of such indirect learning, individuals may form stereotypes and specifically assign attributes to certain groups that they may have indirectly learned from influential agents such as parents, teachers and peer groups (Timberlake and Estes, 2007). From their earlier childhood, people are subjected to such indirect experiences available to them at their homes, neighborhood, schools, play grounds and community gatherings (Bar-Tal, 1996). They may be told or listen to their elders and peers about the notions and beliefs related to a number of stereotypes spread in the society. For example, they may be informed that the people of some specific community or religion are bad and notorious and such perception of these people in the form of specific beliefs may be carried out by them throughout

their life span. In one study reported by (Whitley and Kite, 2006), results indicated that many of the Jewish children in Israel had negative stereotypic beliefs of Arabs and associated them with characteristics such as being violent and aggressive. Many of the children also mentioned that their parents (either their mother or father) described Arabs in a negative manner and also warned them to stay away from Arabs. These images that Jewish children developed in childhood have every possibility of spilling over to and being retained in adulthood as a negative stereotyping towards the Arabs in general.

3. *Direct Learning*

Learning in its most appropriate form is best acquired through the experiences directly gained through one's own active involvement in such venture of experience gaining. According to the social learning theory, proposed by the social psychologist Albert Bandura (1973), individuals learn or acquire one or the other things related to their social behavior through direct experience acquired by them through the observation and imitation of the behavior of their elders and those who they admire and follow. Whenever they see a character of their liking or even otherwise in the real life or at the screen to demonstrate the feelings of prejudice and discriminatory behavior towards the members of a particular social group on account of one or the other types of stereotyped thinking attached to it, they are naturally inclined to imitate it in their own behavior. The reinforcement received on this account, further, sets the direction of it being fixed in their minds. As a result, they are likely to uphold those beliefs and behavior for which they or others (in their real life or on screen) are rewarded and put an end to those beliefs and behaviors that will lead to them or others being punished (Whitley and Kite, 2006).

4. *Conformity With Social Norms or Groups*

Another reason for the acquisition of stereotypes is inherent in the need of the people to conform and follow the norms and socio-cultural traditions of the group and society they belong. It is quite essential

for them to have their proper equations and adjustment with the people belonging to their day-to-day social life. If the group or community to which they belong or the place or society they work is adopting some stereotypes in their living and working, then it becomes customary for them to imbibe these in their behavior. In this way the development of stereotyped thinking and the subsequent feelings of prejudices and discriminatory behavior all take lead from such necessity of conforming to the rules, norms or pattern of the group or society by following a simple rule or tendency: "If the members of my group or people of my community dislike them, then so should I."

5. *Social Categorization: We vs. – They, Phenomena*

The psychology of groups and group dynamics emphasize that people in their social behavior, in general, try to divide the social world around them into two distinct social categories – We and They (in- and out-groups). We as members of the *in-group* perceive the members of our group in a quite positive and favorable way, while *they* (the others) as the members of the *out-group* are perceived by us relatively in a quite negative and unfavorable way. It happens on account of a well-known psychology of individuals to consider them and their group or community better than others' group or community simply for raising their self-esteem (keeping their image good in their eyes). We as a member of the *in-group* thus always remain in a competition of showing us and our group superior and for this purpose try to down grade others and the *out-groups* (to which these other people belong) by creating and fueling the negative thinking and beliefs about them and their groups. And it is all that which results in the emergence of one or the other types of negatively attributed stereotypes against them and their social group or category.

6. *Out-Group Homogeneity Effect*

As a matter of our social perception and ease of dealing with our social environment we divide the people belonging to our social environment into certain categories or social groups on the basis of

certain criterion such as race, religion, caste, gender, occupation, socio-economic status and age. Once these social groups are formed, beliefs or perceptions (in the form of one or the other stereotypes) usually pile up in the social world about the characteristics, attributes or behaviors of members belonging to that particular group or category (Whitley and Kite, 2006). In the course of our dealing with the members of the out-group (people belonging to other caste, religion, gender, race, religion, etc.), a phenomenon known as "out-group homogeneity effect" is found to govern our perception and cognition of them and their behavior. It refers to a tendency to perceive individuals belonging to the groups other than one's own as all alike reflected often through the statements like, "These people are all alike – if you have met one you have met all." In our social dealing with one or the other members of the out-groups, then our thinking is engineered well through the beliefs and perception formed about the social group they belong. In this way, most often, a particular individual or group of individuals becomes the victim of stereotyping associated with their social group or category because the perceiver (the one doing the stereotyping) is only familiar with the overall category or group to which the person belongs (Luthans, 2010).

7. *Seeking Justification for Inequalities and Discrimination*

Quite often, stereotypes are created and perpetuated for justifying and rationalizing the underlying inequalities and discrimination shown towards the selected social groups or classes. As examples of the stereotypes formed and flourished on this account, we may include the stereotypes associated with women, scheduled castes, religious minorities and other economically backward communities in India and black people in Europe and USA.

Accordingly, the men in our country may be found to make use of the stereotypes prevalent about women folk for exploiting and marginalizing them in day-to-day social behavior and the occupational field. The stereotypes prevalent about blacks are also used as a big excuse for denying opportunities and

promotion to many of them in one or the other social fields and business areas.

8. *Role of Mass Media*

The negative role played by the agencies of mass media (like movies, television, newspapers, communication on computers and other smart devices, etc.) may work as a quite potent source for the promotion and perpetuation of the evils of stereotyping in the society in the manner as described next.

- No one can match the mass media in exposing individuals to the numerous kinds of stereotypes (along with their associated evils) prevalent in the world societies with respect to race, gender, caste, creed, color, gender, age and a host of so many other attributes. Exposure to such evils may make them know, learn and practice these in their behavior.
- One's caste, race, gender or social class is superior or inferior, good or bad – the considerations and beliefs like such may be easily germinated and perpetuated with the magnificent influencing power of the media. Accordingly, we may be seen to work for the perpetuation of those stereotypes that add to our self-esteem and make others to fall in our eyes.
- When one is exposed to the fact through media reporting and exhibit that a certain type of stereotyping exists in the different regions of a country or globally in other countries, he may form the opinion in favor of the preservation and continuity of that stereotyping about that particular social group of class. The mass media equipped with smart devices and web links quickly spread this negative message to the masses and its repetition on the media gets it reinforced and deep rooted in the minds and behavior of the persons exposed to the media at a global level. The followers of particular religions are terrorists – this stereotype and the related marginalization of them on this account on a global basis may be taken as a glaring example of the role and contribution of media in the promotion and perpetuation of stereotyping and its evil effects.

Impact of Stereotyping on the Progress and Well-Being of Individuals and Societies

Stereotyping is a big problem for a society or nation as it creates great hurdles in their smooth and peaceful functioning as well as needed development and progress of its citizens. Let us see how it affects the development and well-being of individuals and societies.

1. Stereotyping related to gender, race, social class and poverty, etc. breeds prejudices among individuals against the other people and groups. It can develop into hatred, enmity, rivalries among the peers and students of the same class and school, the employees of a workplace and inhabitants of a locality. It can thus prove a big danger and obstacle in the cooperative and collaborative environment needed for the peaceful coexistence, living and working at a particular place or global area.
2. Stereotyping puts labels about how a person should act or live according to their sex, race, personality and other facts. This could affect the social interaction, activities and working of the individuals who perhaps like different things or do different activities, but feel ashamed of doing so because of domain related stereotypes (e.g., women are bad drivers; they are not good for an office job; they are not meant for hard labor, adventurous sports and risky pursuits). Consequently, women may avoid driving of a vehicle, may stay for household work and remain away from the work areas meant for men according to the stereotypes prevalent in the society. In this way, stereotyping may be seen to put hurdles in the path and progress of the many deserving women who do not dare and come forward for doing one or the other things in spite of their abilities and capacities for performing and progressing in them well.
3. Stereotypes create a lot of misconception and ill beliefs regarding what people are and how they live and behave as the members of their social, cultural, religious groups in the different regions or countries of the world. This misconception

and exaggerated beliefs may create distances in the minds and hearts of the individuals living and working at the same place and locality. It can prove a big nuisance for a multi-cultural and democratic society or nation.

4. Stereotyping of any nature may result into the discrimination and marginalization of the victims. Individuals in their living and working may face discrimination and marginalization on account of the stereotypes related to gender, caste, creed, color, social class and poverty at their homes, neighborhood, educational institutions, workplaces and community. It affects their adjustment, education, development and progress in a quite adverse and negative way.
5. The sufferings caused through a combined effect of prejudices, discrimination and denial of opportunities arising out of the stereotypes may provide a great harm to the victimized individuals in the form of psychological set back. It may affect their physical and mental health and also affects their performance in living and work performance. It has been noted that people get hurt and act more aggressively after they've faced prejudice and discrimination in a given situation. They are more likely to exhibit a lack of self-control and may feel difficulty in making good, rational decisions as a fallout of stereotyping.
6. Stereotyping may also be found quite harmful to the individuals in terms of affecting their performance and outcomes in an adverse way. In this concern, it is quite interesting to note that both negative as well as positive stereotypes (e.g., the members of some groups will perform more poorly or more appropriately than others) are found to carry the equally adverse effects on the achievements and performances of the individuals in the testing and work performance situations. The reason that performance suffers under stereotype threat is still a matter of some debate. Research has shown that factors such as anxiety, physiological arousal and reduced cognitive capacity can all occur under stereotype threat, and each factor might contribute to lowered performance. For example, a girl student may be found to be a victim of decreased performance in the tests and work situations related to mathematics, natural sciences and computer engineering with a psychological fear generated through the negative stereotyping against females. But at the same time her male class mate who is also appearing in that mechanical comprehension/mathematical or scientific ability test may also be found to perform poorly as a consequence of facing a lot of text anxiety simply for saving the reputation of his group by earning better scores than the female counterparts (justifying the positive stereotyping in favor of the males).
7. Stereotypes may also create problems among individuals in many other ways. As an accepted way of believing and behaving in the society they live, these stereotypes have taken a quite ideal shape in the minds and hearts of the people. They can't think beyond them. As a consequence, they are suffering from a number of negative effects in many areas not only in academics but also in sports, co-curricular areas, personality development and their overall progress and well-being. Accordingly, the industrial establishments or workplaces may have a mentionable gap in income and opportunities between men and women in our country and whites and blacks in USA. We can't imagine how the false images and ego built up by these stereotypes and discrimination or marginalization suffered by the individuals on their account is making the people of the world suffer in terms of their achievements, adjustment, development and progress.

To Sum Up

Our stereotyping formed about a group of people, community, race, certain kinds of objects and issues represents our rigid attitude, firm belief and thinking towards them. Most of the time, these prove as a false representative of the reality on account of our oversimplified

and misjudged interpretation reached about the stereotyping objects.

In general, a number of stereotypes may be seen to be prevalent in almost all the societies and communities all over the globe. These stereotypes may be broadly classified as sexual or gender stereotypes, social class or racial stereotypes, and poverty related stereotypes, etc.

Regarding the relationship of stereotypes existing with the prejudices and discrimination it may be properly witnessed that where our stereotypes are considered the cognitive component of our attitudes towards the social groups or issues, prejudices and discrimination represent their affective and behavioral component respectively. Consequently, a stereotype is first responsible for generating the prejudiced feelings and emotions against the group members and then acting in a prejudiced way showing a lot of discrimination towards them.

Regarding the sources of emergence of our stereotypes it is to be seen that these are not inherited and inborn. We learn and acquire them through one or the other ways such as (i) perception of the social objects, (ii) indirect learning (learning through indirect experiences, (iii) direct learning (learning through the direct experiences), (iv) conformity with social norms or groups, (v) social categorization (We vs. They, phenomena), (vi) out-group homogeneity effect, (vii) seeking justification for inequalities and discrimination, and (viii) role of mass media.

Regarding the impact of stereotypes it can be seen that stereotypes are a big problem for a society or nation as they are found to create great hurdles in their smooth and peaceful functioning as well as needed development and progress of its citizens. In the case of the individuals, they are found to hamper their welfare and development in an adverse way.

Prejudices

In our social perception and behavioral sequence of stereotyping, prejudice and discrimination, a prejudice evolves from or follows a stereotype. In their mutual relationship and dependence on each other, where stereotypes as a cognitive component are associated with our thinking about the object or people, and prejudices as the affective component with our feelings and emotions towards these objects or people, discriminations then as the behavioral component find their expressions in the prejudicial reactions of the stereotypes stored in our minds. Our thinking makes us to feel and behave with a person and react to a social situation in a particular way. The stereotype we have formed about the social group or class to which a person belongs, works as a base or root for germinating and perpetuating prejudice against him or her. Negative stereotyping, thus, may be found to lead us in negatively prejudiced feelings. In this way, based on our stereotypes if we start forming hostile or negative opinions of others or when we begin to dislike someone belonging to an out-group for no good reason before even getting to know him, it is termed as prejudice. Let us look more into the meaning, nature and impact of prejudices in our social life.

Meaning and Nature of Prejudices

Etymologically, the word *prejudice* has been derived from the Latin word *praejudicium* meaning before judgment or pre-judgment in the English language (Taylor, 1984). In this sense, the term prejudice may mean arriving at a judgment without hearing or going through the proceeding of a case, making one's own opinion without listening and attending others, reaching a conclusion without getting acquainted with the facts, etc. In our day-to-day life, we can illustrate the term prejudice along with its situational meanings through the following instances.

- (i) One may be prejudiced against beautiful women for arriving at a pre-judgment that they do not prove a good marital partner.

- (ii) On the basis of prejudice, one may form an opinion that the girls performing on the stage as actresses or singers are loose characters.
- (iii) One as an individual or a group of people belonging to the upper caste may hold prejudices against the people belonging to scheduled castes by considering them as untouchable, unintelligent or unbelievable.
- (iv) The urban people may be prejudiced against the village people by arguing that they are uncivilized, uncultured and unintelligent.
- (v) One may show prejudice in declaring that the girls belonging to rural and tribal areas are good in playing and athletic activities.

In this way, people may get prejudiced in one way or the other favorably or unfavorably by having a pre-established judgment or opinion about the preferences for educated vs. uneducated, working women vs. house wives, upper castes vs. lower castes, members of one's village and province vs. others, black color vs. fair color, fatty vs. thin body structure, etc. However, once, they get prejudiced in favor or against an object, individual or a group, the whole of their behavior pattern gets molded and colored in the spirit of the set prejudices. They now think, feel and act in the way as guided and directed through their established prejudices.

To know more about the meaning, nature and characteristics of prejudices, let us now consider the views expressed by some well-known authors and social psychologists in this concern.

Krech and Crutchfield (1948): Prejudice is an unfavorable attitude toward an object which tends to be highly stereotyped, emotionally charged and not easily changed by contrary information.

Asch (1952): Prejudice is a negative attitude toward a socially defined group and toward any person perceived to be a member of that group.

Allport (1954): A prejudice is an antipathy based on faulty and inflexible generalization directed towards a group as a whole or towards an individual because he is a member of that group. It may be felt or expressed.

Secord and Backman (1974): Prejudice is an attitude that predisposes a person to think, perceive,

feel and act in a favorable or unfavorable way towards a group or its individual members.

Feldman (1985): The term prejudice may be defined as positive or negative evaluations or judgments of members of a particular group.

Baron and Byrne (2001): Prejudice is an attitude (usually negative) towards the members of some group, based solely on their membership in that group.

Crisp and Turner (2010): Prejudice can be defined as a negative attitude or feeling held towards members of an out-group.

Aronson et al. (2014): Prejudice is defined as a hostile or negative attitude towards people in a distinguishable group, based solely on their membership in that group.

If we have proper analysis of all the preceding definitions of the term prejudice, it may lead us to conclude about its meaning, nature and characteristics in the following ways.

- Prejudices are based on as well as affected by a lot of stereotyping tendencies and rigidity inherent in the people's behaviors.
- A prejudice represents a special type of biased attitude formed about objects, individuals or groups. Its cognitive component is the stereotype; the affective component is a feeling of liking or disliking; the behavioral component is the various types of discriminatory actions.
- Prejudices tend to arouse intensive emotional current in the individual compelling or drifting him along the current of the prejudiced thinking.
- Prejudices are quite strong enough to control and direct the interaction and social behavior of the people with other individuals or groups without giving them any time or opportunity for thinking and making decisions. Here the mode of behaving or reacting to a situation is already set in the mind of the individuals on the basis of a biased attitude held against the person or the group to which they belong.
- The prejudiced behavior is not based upon the reactions or responses at the present situation but is specifically dependent upon the

pre-conceived notions and attitude formed towards the persons or the groups to which they belong. For example, if the boss of a company is prejudiced against a particular caste or religion he will try to behave quite negatively towards every employee of that caste or religion irrespective of their good performance and talents.

- The prejudices may involve both positive and negative attitudes and, in this way, prejudiced behavior may provide undue favor to somebody along with harming others in the same situation. The teachers or administrators who have a strong prejudice in favor and against the people of their own caste and others may show such favoritism while dealing with their students or subordinates.
- Prejudices with the involvement of a totally biased and partisan attitude may prove a potent cause for the deterioration and impairment in the interpersonal relationships. It may give birth to the feelings of segregation, casteism, regionalism, communalism and class conflicts. The negatively affected individuals may be found to be drifting towards aggressiveness, antisocial behavior, delinquency and crimes.
- Prejudices are not inborn or inherited. These represent the learned or acquired behavior resulted through one's interaction with one's social environment.

Prejudices

Our prejudgment, opinion and attitudes formed on the false premises persuading and compelling us to think, feel and act with the individuals and social groups in a quite biased or partial ways.

Taking clues from the aforementioned characteristics of prejudices we may be tempted to define the term prejudices as follows.

The term prejudices stands for all our prejudgment, opinion and attitudes formed on the false premises persuading and compelling us to think, feel and act

with the individuals and social groups in a quite biased or partial way.

Sources of Prejudices

Prejudices are learned and acquired behavior patterns. The factors and sources responsible for their birth in individuals may be classified and discussed as follows.

1. **The Process of Socialization:** Individuals at the time of their birth are free from any type of prejudices and ill feeling towards others. It goes well for quite a long time in their early childhood. However, as they come into contact with the stereotypes and prejudices prevalent in their social surroundings, their mind gets vitiated and influenced one way or the other. They may, thus, catch the infection of behaving in a biased manner from the prejudices prevalent in the present socio-cultural environment. The parents, family members, neighborhood, peer groups, school and the impact of other societal factors may, thus, teach the growing individuals lessons of factionalism, casteism, regionalism, linguistic separation and so many other things related to the learned behavior of so many prejudices. Their own experiences related with suffering from prejudices shown towards them may add fuel to their already agitated and partitioned minds. As a result, they may begin to demonstrate the prejudiced behavior by showering favor or disfavor to individuals and groups leading to the impairment of interpersonal relationships.
2. **Personality Structure and Characteristics:** We know that many of us who are physically and psychologically weak may easily fall prey to a number of diseases in comparison to those who possess the strength for fighting with the diseases spreading viruses and conditions. Thinking on the same lines, various research studies have concluded that the persons possessing weak and defective personality makeup and behavioral traits are most susceptible to the

acquisition of prejudices. A few such traits and characteristics are as follows.

- Superstitious, intolerant and impatient behavior.
- Admiration for power and toughness.
- Too much obedience and loyalty.
- Emotional instability.
- Feeling of insecurity, anxiety and frustration.
- Too much aggressiveness and hostility.
- Lonely and unsocial.
- Rigid adherence to conventional values.
- Intolerance of ambiguity, indiscipline and disorganization, etc.

3. **Intergroup Rivalries and Conflicts:** Prejudices are more often the results of intergroup rivalries and conflicts. It is quite natural for an individual as a member of some social group to be loyal and possessing feelings towards it. On the other hand, it is also quite natural for him to treat the out-groups and their activities as a matter of competition and rivalry. As a result, everybody in the group wants to gain, achieve and snatch the things or benefits only to himself and his group. This may result in showing undue favor to the members of one's own social group, caste, religion, province and region on one hand and disfavor and denial of facilities/opportunities to the others. It may lead to the growth of separatist tendencies and birth of slogans like Assam is for Assamies; hills are for the hill people etc. The people belonging to minorities then try to develop a sense of fear and insecurity forcing them to develop negative attitudes and prejudices against the majority community and people. They may also think all about them as good and positive resulting in the formation of positive attitude and prejudices in favor of their own community and members. In this way intergroup rivalries and conflicts may be held responsible for giving birth to the likewise prejudices for and against their own group and others.

The Evil Impact of Prejudices on Interpersonal Relationships

The prejudices, the learned pattern of specific favorable or unfavorable attitudes and behavior towards the individuals, groups or community as a whole prove the germinating seed for a number of unhealthy group rivalries, tensions, conflicts and so many other ills and disharmonies in our society. Infected with prejudices, we tend to work against the interest of one or the other members of the groups belonging to other religions, political parties, castes or regions, resulting in the chains of overreactions towards them. In such an atmosphere of mutual distrust, panic and anxiety, how can we expect the continuity of cordial and harmonious interpersonal relationships among the affected individuals or groups? Prejudices are bound to create biases in the form of positive and negative attitudes and this in turn may germinate the seed of doubt, fear, panic reactions and distrust segregating one individual, group and community from the other. It may color our vision and obstruct the whole process of logical and rational thinking. We then view the situations and persons through the eyes and ears provided by the built up prejudices, and as a result the interpersonal relationships get deteriorated and spoiled. A distressful personal experience then may further give the valid grounds for furthering the amount of tensions, conflicts and torn up relations – leading to the group and class infighting as well as regional and global world war.

To Sum Up

The term prejudices stands for all our pre-judgment, opinion and attitudes formed on the false premises persuading and compelling us to think, feel and act with the individuals and social groups in a quite biased or partial ways. Our prejudices are learned and acquired by us much like our other personality traits and behavior patterns. The factors and sources responsible for their birth in the individuals

may be: (i) catching up the infection of behaving in a biased manner from the prejudices prevalent in their socio-cultural environment, (ii) possession of weak and negative personality makeup and behavioral traits, and (iii) intergroup rivalries and conflicts. Regarding the ill impact of prejudices it can be well observed that our prejudices are responsible for creating an atmosphere of mutual distrust, panic and anxiety, which in turn casts a quite damaging effect on our interpersonal relationships and spreads evils and disharmonies in the society.

Discrimination

Meaning and Nature of Discrimination

In this chapter we have discussed that there exists a chain-like interrelationship among stereotypes, prejudice and discrimination. Where the stereotypes are regarded as the cognitive component of the special type of attitude termed as prejudice possessed by us about the members of a social group or the group as a whole, the expression of the feelings and emotions attached with our prejudice takes place in the form and shape of discriminating behavior shown towards the target of our prejudice. In this way, what we think (through stereotypes) and feel (through the prejudice formed) finds its expression in a quite biased and partial behavior known as the discriminatory behavior shown by us towards the members of a social group or the group as a whole.

Discrimination

Behavioral manifestation of the prejudices possessed by us about members of a social group or the group as a whole.

Discrimination, thus, may be safely termed as prejudice in action or the behavioral manifestation of prejudice. It stands for the negative and harmful

reactions and behavioral acts directed towards the persons or groups who are the targets of our prejudice. In the execution of such discrimination, we usually treat the members of a social group or the group as a whole in a quite unfavorable, discriminatory and marginalized way exemplified as follows.

- The boss of a company may be seen to demonstrate discriminatory behavior against the candidates of a particular community/religion/gender/state/country for whom he or she has the fixed form of stereotyping and prejudices by not selecting them for certain employment positions even when they are meritorious and deserving.
- A female child belonging to the same family may fall victim of indiscrimination on account of her gender at the hands of her parents and family members. She may get less attention, love and affection, incentives and encouragement, opportunity of education, development and progress in comparison to her male siblings or cousins.
- Disabled children may feel discriminated and marginalized when they are not allowed to make use of the educational facilities available in their neighborhood. They are debarred from taking part in the social functions of the family and community.
- The people belonging to a socially untouchable, scheduled caste or tribe may face the hardships of discriminatory behavior demonstrated by the members of upper castes in various forms such as denial of water from a well (the only source of drinking water in the village), or the right of worship by not getting entry in the temples.
- The rural community may experience the blunt of acute discrimination by getting deprived of many such facilities that are easily available to the urban people. Similarly a minority community may get victimized at the hands of majority and consequently may feel quite uncomfortable and unsafe even in their living and enjoying civic rights (e.g., Kashmiri Hindu population in the disturbed Kashmir regions).

- Many of the districts or regions of a particular state or nation may also suffer from acute discrimination and marginalization by being denied opportunities and facilities available to other citizens on account of the negative attitude and prejudiced feelings shown by the ruling party or government. The people of Bangladesh remained victims of acute discrimination and exploitation in the hands of the mighty Pakistan, then rulers who showered undue favor to the progress of the western Pakistan at the cost of the present Bangladesh.

The Consequences or Impacts of Discrimination

The discriminatory behavior shown towards individuals or social groups at one or the other times by the majority community or people, who hold power for making and marring their future carries a quite notable damaging impact and negative consequences for the development, progress and welfare of these so affected victims. Depending on the nature of stereotypes held and prejudiced attitude formed about them (in the individual capacity or as a group or community as a whole) they may be denied opportunities for participating fully in the economic, social and political life of the society in which they live. They often become victims of acute apathy, hate and discrimination carried out towards them on one or the other discriminatory grounds such as gender, race, caste, color, creed, sect, religion, language, locality or nationality, etc. The ills of the discriminatory behavior shown towards the individuals may be found to show profound impact on their development and welfare right from their early childhood and schooling in the manner as described here.

1. *Discrimination Suffered at Home and in Family:* It is quite possible for children to suffer from a lot of discrimination at the hands of their own parents, step mother and father, caretaker and family members in a number of ways. The apathy and antagonistic attitude of the family members towards the female child, widow child, or children losing their mother/father or both,

disabled, etc. in our society is well known. In such discriminatory and deprived physical and socio-psychological environment of the family the children fail to get needed love and affection, attention and care, rearing and nourishing supplements, healthy interactions and timely guidance, incentives and reinforcement for their good behavior and progress. As a result, there arises a big gap in the physical and socio-psychological needs and their satisfaction. It leads them nowhere other than the path of painful maladjustment and failure in terms of achieving age related milestones of their wholesome development and progress.

2. *Discrimination Suffered in the Schools and Educational Institutions:* The environment available to the growing individuals in the schools and educational institutions where they get their schooling and higher education may be quite defective, improper and discriminatory. Accordingly, they may be found to face the blunt of acute discrimination and marginalization in the school on one or the other grounds like belonging to a particular gender, caste, color, creed, religion, social status, region, language group and nationality, suffering from one or the other types of disabilities and incapacities, or may face the wrath of the personal disliking, negative attitude, jealousy and envy developed towards them on the part of their teachers and authorities. As a consequence, they may be excluded and prevented from taking part in the regular activities of the school/educational institute, ridiculed or treated badly in front of others, face injustice in evaluating their performance and achievements and thus get harmed psychologically and educationally in a way as to put a lot of barriers in their adequate adjustment, development and progress. Such discriminated and marginalized children, then, with no fault of them may be seen to be drifting towards backwardness, failure, unemployment, truancy, delinquency, drug addiction, and other types of antisocial and morally deviant behaviors.
3. *Discrimination Faced in Community Living at the Hands of Society:* Members of the majority

community and the environment also try to display a lot of marginalization and discrimination towards the developing individuals by not allowing them to take part in the activities, festivals, rituals, worships and functions organized in the community venues from time to time. The discrimination and prohibition may be on any ground (such as being a women/girl, widow, disabled, lower caste or untouchable, poor, villager, following other sects, faiths or religion, black color or disliked nationality), but in all its way it casts a quite negative and damaging influence on the adjustment, and progress of the developing individuals by snatching the valuable opportunities of social interaction, community and social learning and outward self-expression.

4. *Discrimination Faced in the Employment Market or Professions:* It is no secret that people have to face a lot of discrimination in seeking job opportunities in the employment market both in the private and public sectors on account of the stereotypes and prejudices held about them as an individual or members of a certain specific social group or category. One may be denied selection on a particular post, his or her promotion may be withheld or he/she may have to face a lot of hurdles in going with his/her occupation or profession well on account of his or her belongingness to a particular gender, race, caste, religion, locality or nation. Such cruel jokes played with them through the well-planned discriminatory behavior on the part of the prejudiced employers, bosses, customers and others for depriving them of all what they actually deserve in their professional life, occupation and business career may prove quite costly to these discrimination victims in terms of their physical, psychological, social and economic well-being.
5. *Ill Consequences of Discriminating a Group or Community as a Whole:* It is also quite common in the world societies and regions to show a lot of discriminatory behavior to a particular community or social group on one or the other grounds such as caste, religion, color, race, gender, etc. Frequent clashes in our country and abroad are between the followers of different

sects or religions (e.g., Hindu-Muslims riots in India, Sunni-Shias conflicts in the Muslim dominated regions and countries etc.). Caste wars resulting in the atrocities on Dalits in our country and racial conflicts occurring in Europe and the USA are the clear testimony of the role of stereotypes, prejudices and discrimination played by one social group against the other.

To Sum Up

What we think (through stereotypes) and feel (through the prejudices formed) finds its expression in a quite biased and partial behavior known as the discriminatory behaviors shown by us towards the members of a social group or the group as a whole. While engaging in such discriminatory behaviors, we usually treat the members of a social group or the group as a whole in a quite unfavorable and discriminatory way. In its consequences, the discriminatory behavior shown towards the individuals or social groups carries a quite notable damaging impact and negative consequences for the development, progress and welfare of these so affected victims. They may be denied opportunities for participating fully in the economic, social and political life of the society in which they live. They often become victims of acute apathy, hate and discrimination carried out towards them on one or the other discriminatory grounds such as gender, race, caste, color, creed, sect, religion, language, locality or nationality, etc.

Techniques for Countering the Ill Effects of Stereotyping, Prejudices and Discrimination

Stereotyping, prejudice and discrimination all, as we have seen, are quite notorious in playing a quite negative role for bringing damaging consequences for the development and well-being of the victimized individuals and affected social groups. The question

here may arise, are there any ways and means that can be applied for countering their evil impact and damaging consequences? The socio-psychologists and thinkers on this aspect have suggested making use of one or the other techniques and ways as discussed next.

1. **Providing Opportunities for Direct Interaction or Contact With the Out-Groups:**

In most situations, we are spending time and working with the members of the in-group and accordingly have enough time to know and understand the individuals comprising this group. However, it does not happen in the case of our dealings with the members of the out-group. The lack of contacts with the individual members of the out-group compel us to form opinions and behave with them in the light of stereotypes developed and prejudiced attitudes formed about them on the part of our own group. Such negativity in our thinking, feeling and behaving with the members of out-groups can be checked and restrained in a satisfactory way if efforts are made for having direct interaction and contact with the members of the out-groups. The instances for having such needed opportunities for direct interaction and contacts with the members of the out-groups can be cited as follows.

- Forming coordination and action committees for reducing tension, apprehension and conflict during the uprise of conflicts and clashes between the religious, racial and caste ridden groups.
- Encouraging organization of different types of cooperative activities and non-competitive cultural shows and literary programs, friendly matches and group projects involving different communities and social groups of a region at the community centers and other public places for providing needed opportunities to understand each other to reduce unhealthy rivalry and prejudices against each other.
- Holding of workshops, seminars and assemblies in the educational institutions, bodies of professional and business organizations, social

institutions and community gatherings providing opportunities to the members of multiple cultures, religions, castes and localities for having direct contacts and interaction with each other.

- Providing opportunity to the district level best players for coming together to constitute a state level team for the participation in the national tournament.

The availing of such aforementioned opportunities of contact between the prejudiced and the target people or groups has been found to help much in restraining the spread of negativity resulted through stereotyping, prejudices and discrimination. Commenting over this aspect, Baron and Byrne (2001:217) write:

Direct intergroup contact can be an effective tool for combating cross-group prejudice. When people get to know one another, it seems, many of the anxieties, stereotypes, and false perceptions that have previously kept them apart can melt in the face of new information and warmth of new friendships.

- ### 2. **Re-categorization: Redrawing the Boundary Between 'Us and Them':** Remember the days when you were the students of a college affiliated to certain university. You might have witnessed the zonal as well inter-zonal youth festivals held every year by the concerned university. In the zonal festival, the teams from the colleges belonging to the specific zone compete with each other and the top position holders in the various cultural and literary items from this zonal tournament gets opportunity to participate in the inter-zonal tournament held after some days.

It was quite natural for you to view your college team as 'us' (in-group) and the teams of other colleges as 'them' (out-group). You along with your college students cheered your team and aspired for its win over the rivals. It was also quite natural for the rival teams getting one or the other types of rifts, annoyance and prejudices against each other. However, at the time of witnessing the inter-zonal tournament, you were

there to cheer the same rival teams belonging to your zone that were the main targets of your hooting and prejudices. Why? For the simple reason that now they were accepted by you as us (in-group). Your whole sympathy and cheering then lied with them.

In this way, as soon as the people or groups treated as 'they' (out-groups) are accepted as 'we' (in-group) by us, our disliking, hate and prejudice toward them disappears at once. Reminding people that they are part of a large group – for instance, that they are all Tamils, Indians, Americans or even human beings – can help much in achieving this kind of re-categorization which may prove a potent weapon against the narrow mindedness and prejudiced feelings about the out-groups.

3. Undermining and Restricting the Role of Stereotyping: Stereotypes prevalent about the members of one or the other social groups are very much responsible for the formation of prejudiced attitudes and discriminating behavior towards them. Under the influence of stereotypes such as women are not good managers, a woman executive may be denied promotion otherwise well-deserved on her part. For saying halt to such negative consequences of the stereotypes, there must be an earnest attempt for undermining and restricting their role in our day-to-day and professional behaving. Let us see how it can be done.

It is almost an established fact that most often the acts of our prejudiced and discriminatory behavior towards the people belonging to specific social groups are based on the assumption and unfounded belief that all people belonging to that groups are all alike – they share the same characteristics. These misconceptions need essentially to get weakened by resorting to one or the other suitable techniques such as follows.

- People should be encouraged to think about others as individuals not simply as members of social groups. Here, thus, they need to think carefully about others by paying due attention to their own unique individual traits and

characteristics instead of assuming that these people and their characteristics will be the same as stereotyped about the group to which they belong. In this way, people should be encouraged and advised to take an objective judgment about knowing and judging other people instead of getting driven by the current of the misconceived stereotypes.

- Attempts should also be made to organize useful affirmative action programs and activities in schools and colleges, community gatherings and social setups that may provide proper platforms for downgrading/undermining the stereotypes prevalent in the society.
 - Stereotypes are very much associated with one's thinking directed through one's own cognition. If a suitable cognitive intervention is erected in the minds of the people against the stereotypes, then it can help much in restricting their impact. If one repeatedly says "no" to the existing stereotypes about the specific social group it may help in combating prejudices against the individuals belonging to that group.
- 4. Formation of Super-Ordinate Goals:** To provide a challenge for the realization of a particular type of goal known as super-ordinate goals may also prove a good technique for reducing prejudices and conflicts among the members of the rival groups. We may know the subordinate goals as the goals which can be observed through the cooperative efforts of the groups involved in a particular social situation. The realization of these goals, in this way, demands or in a way compels and persuades the members of different groups to come closer for the purpose. The socio-psychologist Sherif (1966) was the first to emphasize the significance of the setting of super-ordinate goals for reducing tension and conflicts among the members of the out-groups. For deriving his conclusions in this connection, he conducted a series of experiments with the groups of children of the different schools attending a summer camp during vacation at some place in the USA. During their stay, certain types of conflicts and clashes arose

among these groups of children. For dealing with the situation, he invented an idea of creating some emergencies before these conflicts ridden groups in the shape of stage managing the disruption of water supply and breakdown of the camp lorry. It compelled the groups of the conflict ridden children to come closer, be friendly and work jointly for dealing with the emergency resulting in the reduction of their intergroup conflicts and prejudices in a quite mentionable amount.

5. **Becoming the Good Role Models for the Growing Children:** What we have with us in the form of acquiring and imbibing good and bad things, it comes to us right from our childhood through social learning by observing and imitating behavior of our elders and other role models. It is equally true for our acquiring and imbibing of stereotyping, prejudices and discrimination against the out-groups. The reverse can also happen well if parents at home and teachers in school, and role model available in the society provide a good example of acceptance, tolerance and large mindedness (instead of rejection, intolerance and narrow mindedness) along with the feelings of due respect for the opinions, culture and status of out-groups. If tried honestly, this step may play wonder in checking the growth and curbing the evil influence of stereotyping, prejudices and discrimination prevalent in our society against the members of the out-groups.

6. **Role of Mass Media:** Despite its negative role as emphasized earlier, media can play a substantial role in getting rid of the evils of stereotyping, prejudices and discrimination in our society in the ways and means summarized here:

- Instead of reporting, viewing and glorifying the things concerning stereotyping, prejudice and discrimination, it can adopt a positive approach for addressing these issues in a constructive way. In adopting this role, basically the media should try to say and exhibit all of them as the evils and vices that thus need to be sidelined or

abolished. It should provide the news and stories, write-ups and experiences videos, serials and films that can contradict the notions and beliefs prevalent in our society in the form of gender, race, caste, religion and social class based stereotypes, prejudices and discriminations.

- Media through its various platforms may try to portray the negative outcomes and devastating effects of prejudices and discriminatory behavior shown towards the individuals and the specific social groups. The sufferings and difficulties felt on the part of targeted individuals or groups on this account should be brought into the notice of the media users and viewers in such a way as to make them realize the necessity of stopping the evil practices of prejudices and discrimination.
- Media should try to portray the positive image altogether contradicting the traditionally held stereotyped negative images of the individuals and groups. For example, it should report that girls are doing wonders in excelling in various areas and sphere of human life disproving and rejecting various stereotypes. Similarly, the other types of stereotypes, prejudices and discriminations related to caste, races, religion, poverty and social class should also be properly addressed at the hands of media reporting and showing. It should report well how a particular individual or group is excelling or contributing towards the welfare of the society, nation and humanity irrespective of the negative stereotype held by the public about it. How a person, belonging to a particular religion, caste, race or extremist section, has saved the lives of others by aborting a terrorist act and how it is unfair on our part to brand all the people belonging to a particular community race or caste as the villains, bad guys or terrorists. The things and events like these should be properly highlighted and glorified by the media through its untiring efforts.

To Sum Up

Stereotypes, prejudices and discrimination all are quite notorious in casting their damaging impacts over for the development and well-being of the victimized individuals and affected social groups. It needs to be checked by adopting appropriate techniques and means such as: providing opportunities for direct interaction or contact with the out-groups – the target of our stereotyping, prejudices and discrimination; re-categorization; redrawing the boundary between 'us and them'; undermining and restricting the role of stereotyping; formation of super-ordinate goals needing the cooperation of all in the society for their realization; becoming good role models for the growing children; and desirable role of mass media.

Review Questions

1. What do you understand by the term stereotyping? Throw light on its meaning, concept and its various forms or types.
2. Discuss the relationship of stereotypes with prejudices and discrimination.
3. What are stereotypes? From where do they emerge?
4. Define the term stereotyping and discuss the impact of stereotyping on the progress and well-being of individuals and societies.
5. What are prejudices? Throw light on their meaning, nature and sources.
6. Discuss in detail the evil impact of prejudices on interpersonal relationships and the well-being of society.
7. What do you understand by the term discrimination? Discuss its consequences or impact over the development and welfare of the victims.
8. What are the various techniques that may be employed for countering the ill effects of stereotyping, prejudices and discrimination? Discuss them in detail.

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UNIT III

INTERPERSONAL AND SOCIAL PROCESSES



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10.

SOCIAL INFLUENCE

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- Explain what social influence is.
- Tell about the forms and ways of social influence.
- Elucidate the concept and meaning of conformity.
- Discuss the types or forms of conformity.
- Discuss the sources of conformity – why and when we choose to conform.
- Throw light on the factors affecting conformity.
- Throw light on Sherif's classical experiments on private conformity and Asch's classical experiments on public conformity.
- Elucidate the concept and meaning of compliance.
- Throw light on the various principles or factors governing one's compliance.
- Discuss the various techniques of compliance – making people comply.
- Elucidate the concept and meaning of obedience.
- Tell about the various forms of obedience.
- Throw light on Stanley Milgram's study on obedience.
- Discuss the various factors affecting obedience.
- Describe the mechanism of exercising restraint or control over the destructive obedience.

What Is Social Influence?

In its word meaning, the term social influence means the type of influence that is social in nature. It, thus, stands for an influence exercised on the part of an individual/group to make the desired change in the behavior of others. Under the impact of social influence, people tend to behave differently other than what they would have if left entirely to them. Sociologists and

socio-psychologists both consider this phenomenon of social influence quite essential and significant for the adjustment of the individuals in their social setup and also running of the social setup itself in a desired way. For understanding the meaning and concept of the term social influence let us now think over some of its well-known definitions provided by the scholars and thinkers in this field.

Baron and Byrne (2001:318): Social influence may be defined as “efforts by one or more individuals to change the attitudes, beliefs, perceptions, or behaviors of one or more others”.

Avermaet (2004:404): Social influence is the change in the judgments, opinions and attitude of an individual as a result of being exposed to the views of others.

Crisp and Turner (2014:85): Social influence is an umbrella term. It refers to any effect that another person or group has on your attitudes and behaviors.

Barrett (2017:190): Social influence is an internal or external change in a person caused by the real or imagined pressure from others.

The analysis of the preceding definitions may reveal the following things about the meaning and nature of the term social influence.

- Having, basically, a social nature and feeling the need to remain attached to their social group/society the individuals are prone to yield under social influence – introduce changes in the ways of their thinking, feeling and behaving as asked and desired by others who are considered recognizable and valuable by them for this purpose.
- Social influence has a great potential to bring changes in the behavior of a person or group of persons. These changes are internal (introduced in their ways of thinking and feeling) as well as external (reflected in their acts and actions performed by them in their social encounters).
- As a result of these changes, the affected individuals try to behave somewhat in a quite different way demonstrable in their changed beliefs, opinions, attitudes, perception of the things and ideas, ways of doing and performing in real life including interaction and responding to others.
- These changes are brought out in their behavior through the pressures (direct as well as indirect) exerted on them by other people or groups of people in the form of providing direction, setting norms and ideals, emphasizing majority

opinion, providing incentives or motivation of some sort or imposing their authority of one or the other kind.

- It is not essential for an influencing exerting agency to remain present in person; the norms, rules and regulations, traditions and modes of living and behaving established by the society or authority in a social and work situation may work by themselves as pressure exerting agents in influencing the thinking and feeling of the people for behaving in a set or desired form. Here, in this change in behavior of the people through social impression, their anticipation of some negative consequences for not conforming to the group or individual (termed as symbolic social influence) may prove quite enough as equivalent to the direct presence or instructions from others.

Social Influence

A type of influence, essentially social in nature, exerted on an individual or group by another individual/group for bringing changes in the social behavior of the former.

On the basis of what is conveyed through the preceding definitions about the meaning and nature of the term social influence we may understand it as *a type of influence essentially social in nature that is exerted on an individual or group directly or indirectly by another individual/group for bringing changes in the behavior of the former in the areas like opinions, perceptions, beliefs, attitudes, doing work and performing skills, and ways of interacting and behaving with others in one or the other social situations.*

The Forms and Ways of Social Influence

Under the phenomenon or mechanism of social influence, the efforts made by an individual or group of individuals/society are found to influence the social behavior of the influenced or affected individuals/group for behaving on their part in one or the other ways as mentioned next.

1. **Conformity:** They yield to majority opinion and bring changes in their attitude and behavior for having conformity i.e., going along with the group or established norms of the society.
2. **Compliance:** They comply with the request or suggestion made directly by others for behaving in a particular manner.
3. **Obedience:** They behave as asked and ordered by others.

How do these three forms of social influence directed behaviors differ from each other, and when, how and why do these behaviors show their upsurge in one's social life? Let us think about all this in the pages ahead one by one.

Conformity

Concept and Meaning

There might have been so many things in our social life that we have not liked to do but did simply for going along with the majority opinion or set norms or ways of behaving prevalent in the society. Accordingly, one may get engaged in a stereotyping and prejudiced behavior towards a minority neighbor for going along with the majority of neighbors of his residential locality despite his broad mindedness on this account. The other may engage in a violence ridden strike against the school authorities simply for conforming to the majority decision of his school mates despite his unwillingness and known standing against such acts as a matter of principle.

The socially influenced such behavior committed by individuals is termed as conformity in the language of sociology and social psychology. For making its meaning and nature clear, the thinkers and authors have tried to define it in the following ways.

1. **Kiesler and Kiesler (1969):** Conformity refers to the convergence of the person's thinking, feeling and behavior towards a group norm.
2. **Baron and Byrne (2001):** Conformity may be referred to as a type of social influence in which individuals change their attitude and

behavior in order to adhere to existing social norms.

3. **Cialdini and Goldstein (2004):** Conformity is the tendency to change one's beliefs or behaviors so that they may match the behavior of others.
4. **Baron and Byron (2006):** Conformity can be described as pressures to go along with other people around you, to behave in the same manner as other persons in one's group or society.
5. **Coon and Mitterer (2007):** Conformity may be simply defined as bringing one's own behavior into agreement with the social norms or to the behavior of others.
6. **Crisp and Turner (2014):** Conformity is used to describe attitudes or behavior change in response to an implied, rather than explicit, social norm.

Conformity

A form or mode of social impression putting pressure on the individuals to bring changes in their behavior in tune with the existing social norms.

In this way, as emphasized in one or the other ways in the above cited definitions, the term conformity stands for a form or mode of social impression putting pressure on the individuals to bring changes in their thinking, feeling and doing behavior enabling it to get matched with the existing social norms or behavior of the majority in the group or society.

Types or Forms of Conformity

In general, people may be found to demonstrate two types of conformity in their social behavior known as (i) private conformity and (ii) public conformity.

1. *Private conformity*, in the opinion of Insko et al. (1983), is said to occur, when the individuals are truly persuaded that the group is right and when they willingly and privately accept the norms of the group as their own beliefs. In this way,

private conformity is quite private in the sense that here we may witness the private acceptance of the social norms on the part of an individual. This phenomenon was extensively studied by Sherif (1935). Let us examine it.

Sherif's Classical Experiments on Private Conformity

Muzafer Sherif, a Turkish Socio-psychologist, carried out an experiment in 1935 for studying the phenomenon of conformity. This experiment was carried out in two phases. There were three participants in the study. In the first phase of his experiment, Sherif asked each of the three participants one by one to pay attention to a dot (single point) of light while sitting alone in a totally dark room. This dot lied on a wall in a quite stationary condition (with no movement) at a distance of 15 feet from the place of participants. However, on account of a phenomenon of optical illusion known as *auto-kinetic effect* it got observed by the participants moving in a jagged circle. It occurred on account of a lack of reference point for its observation in the complete darkness of the room. The task of each participant in the first phase of the study was to make 100 judgments as to how far the dot of light was moving in inches. At the conclusion of the first phase of the study when participants individually made their estimates, it was seen that there existed a quite significant variation in the estimates of the length of the movement of the dot on their part.

In the second phase of this experiment conducted after a few days, these three participants were again engaged in doing the same task but with a difference. This time they did not participate as individuals but as the members of the three-person group. Here they could enjoy the hearing of one another's estimates of the movement of the dot. This development naturally affected their individual beliefs/estimates and soon their responses began to converge to the point of providing a single unanimous response i.e., establishing a group norm for the estimation of the length of the light.

The findings of the experiment helped Sherif conclude that individuals, formerly placed in an

individual situation and having judgment of a thing in their own ways, tend to arrive at a common judgment after being placed in a group situation and accept this common judgment as a group norm. Later on, as an extension of his experiment, Sherif, repeated the experiment with the individuals in an individual situation all alone and found them responding in terms of the established norms instead of providing their own estimates of the length of the light. They, thus, in fact behaved under the influence of private conformity by accepting the group estimate (group norm) as their own estimate (own norm).

Private Conformity

The type of conformity in which individuals willingly and privately accept the norms of the group as their own beliefs.

2. *Public conformity* true to its naming is a public show of one's conformity. In this type of conformity, the people are found to work under pressure. They go along with majority opinion and publicly behave as demanded by the majority or social norms while privately considering that the group or social norm is not right. In such conformity, thus, there is nothing like personal or private acceptance of a certain viewpoint or a way of doing something on the part of the concerned individuals. Arch's classical experiments on conformity may be said to be good examples of such conformity. Let us examine them.

Public Conformity

The type of conformity in which individuals while working under pressure publicly behave in tune with the majority opinion or social norms.

Asch's Classical Experiments on Public Conformity

There arise numerous occasions in the people's social life when they are found to go with the opinion of

others especially the majority in believing and doing what they say in spite of having a contrary view about it. It reminds us of a folk story where four miscreants planned to befool a merchant selling a cow baby. They appeared before him one by one to tell that the animal he was selling was a goat baby and not the cow baby and finally got him agreed to sell it in the price of a goat baby. Here we may see that the merchant acted under the pressure of the social influence demonstrating conformity with the majority opinion regarding the animal identity in spite of having a contrary view/belief about it. The American socio-psychologist Solomon Asch (1951) is credited with conducting the quite useful experimental studies in studying the nature and impact of the phenomenon of such type of conformity. In his study carried out with a group of eight male college students, the experimental setting and working took its shape in the manner as laid down next.

- One among the eight participants was selected as the real or main participant for studying the phenomenon of conformity. The remaining participants worked as the confederates/helpers of the researcher in the conduct of this study. However, they were there in the experiment for doing the same task as assigned to the main participant with no knowledge to him about their presence as confederates of the researcher.
- All of these eight participants were told at the start of the experiment that they were participating in an experiment on visual judgment.
- In terms of their seating arrangement the real or main participant was provided the space and turn for participating in the experiment only after all the seven participants (the confederate of the researcher) had done their job.
- During the experiment, participants were presented first with a standard line drawn on a white card. After then a second white card was presented before them consisting of three comparison lines marked as A, B and C as given in the figure 10.1.
- The participants' task in the experiment was to tell in the presence of all the other participants loudly which one of three comparison lines had the same length as the standard line. The real or main participant had to do it after all the other seven participants (acting as confederates) had done their job in this concern.
- The task in this experiment was quite simple. There existed a line (the middle one B in the figure 10.1) among the three comparison lines equal in length to the standard line with no ambiguity of any kind in its recognition as such. However, the manipulation in this experiment was done on four accounts: (i) The judgment was made public, as every participant had to announce it in a loud (quite hearable) voice well before all the other participants; (ii) the real or main participant was given the last place, so he had to announce his judgment after hearing the judgments of others; (iii) the researchers had instructed the other participants acting as the confederates/helpers to provide the incorrect response – picking up

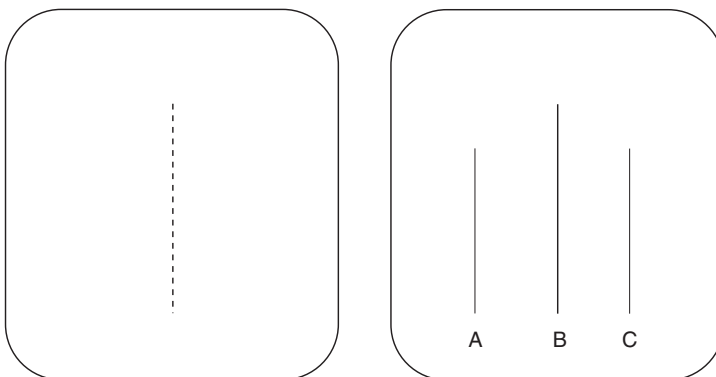


Figure 10.1 Three Comparison Lines in Asch Experiment

the same incorrect line saying the third one C in the figure 10.1; and (iv) for providing a check on suspicion on the part of the real or main participant, where six out of the seven confederates were instructed to pick the same incorrect line and say the third one (C), one participant had to pick line A for his incorrect response.

- At the conclusion of the experiment, it was noted that the real or main participant also provided the same incorrect answer – line C as given earlier by the majority of the confederate participants of the study. Obviously, the conformity – agreeing with the opinion and beliefs of the others – here emerged in the behavior of the real participant by getting influenced through the majority opinion of others.
- For deriving further conclusion on the type of conformity visible in the behavior of the real participant, Asch in another experiment asked the participants to report their answer on a paper, instead of saying it in a loud voice in front of the others. The rate of conformity was significantly dropped, distinguishing clearly between public conformity and private conformity.

Through his experiments Asch, thus, tried to conclude that the individuals (just as the real or main participant of his study) show a good amount of conformity in their behavior under pressure (influenced and affected by the majority opinion of the group). In public, or in the presence of others, there is a quite less possibility of going against the majority opinion, and it forces them to conform, even though in a real sense they might have been disagreeing with it in their heart (like the real or main participant of Asch's study who was victim of public conformity even when he stood disagreed with it in his heart).

Sources for Conformity – Why and When Do We Choose to Conform?

The question arises why do people engage in a conforming behavior at one or the other social situations? Why and when do they decide to go along with others or try to follow the group norms? The socio-psychologists and researchers have tried to

answers these questions by associating people's conformity to two different types of social influences—informational social influence and normative social influence. Let us examine them.

Informational Social Influence Guided Conformity

There are situations in our life that are quite new or ambiguous for us. They may create a lot of difficulty for us in deciding how to behave in the situation. Imagine the situations when we are required to take decisions regarding how to behave while visiting a particular temple, church or mosque, playing of the national anthem of a country, attending a marriage ceremony of a particular community, making use of the knife and fork at the dining table for the first time, using specific skills for performing a typical task (such as estimating the length of the dot light in Sherif's experiment on conformity) etc. No doubt it may prove quite challenging for many of us at one or the other times. However, let us see what we generally do at this time. We simply choose to behave as others are behaving and for this purpose try to collect adequate information using one or the other means such as seeking guidance from the knowledgeable, educating ourselves with the help of the internet and smart phone devices or simply copying the behavior of the majority in the group. In this way, at many occasions, we try to turn to other people and information providing sources for guiding our own behavior to get it merged with the behavior of others in the group. Such type of conformity (known as informational conformity) on our part, thus, is brought out with the type of social influence, known as informational social influence. It is based on our tendency to depend upon others as a source of information for responding to an ambiguous or entirely new situation related to our social life.

Informational Social Influence

A mode of social influence reflecting our tendency to depend upon others as a source of information to guide our behavior in an ambiguous or new situation.

Commenting on the nature of the type of social influence associated with such informational conformity Aronson et al. (2014:240) write:

Informational social influence may be understood as the influence of other people that leads us to conform because we see them as a source of information to guide our behavior; we conform because we believe that others' interpretation of an ambiguous situation is more correct than ours and will help us choose an appropriate course of action.

In this way, we in general in most of the ambiguous, new and complicated situations in our social life resort to informational conformity (based on the mechanism of informational social impression) and run with others chiefly because here we (i) are uncertain about what the correct behavior is, and (ii) have a strong desire to the extent of feeling anxious for being correct or right in our performance for honoring our self-esteem and fit in the group. As example here we may quote the type of conformity exhibited on the part of the participants in the light dot experiment performed by the socio-psychologist Muzafer Sherif.

Here the person who engages in the conformity behavior has no confusion about his conformity response. There is no outside pressure on him to conform as visible in the case of normative conformity (discussed ahead). He willingly accepts to conform by believing that the majority is correct and he has picked up the right information from them to behave in a right way. This sort of conformity is also known as private conformity (personally accepted and privately conformed on the part of the individual). We have already thrown light on this aspect earlier in this chapter.

Normative Social Influence Guided Conformity

Normative conformity is based on or guided by the normative social impression. Here one is persuaded or forced to behave as others behave on account of almost a compulsion to follow the majority decision or group norm with a least care of its willing

acceptance on the part of the individual. This type of conformity is also known as a public conformity (discussed by us earlier in this chapter). As illustration of this type of conformity we can quote here the type of conformity demonstrated by the real or main participant in the experiment performed by Solomon Asch. The source of such type of conformity, as explained by socio-psychologists is normative influence. Aronson et al. (2014:246) have defined the term normative social influence as the influence of other people that leads us to conform in order to be liked and accepted by them; this type of conformity results in public compliance with the group's beliefs and behaviors but not necessarily in private acceptance of those beliefs and behaviors.

Normative Social Influence

A mode of social influence in which we behave under pressure in tune with the majority opinion or norms of the group or our desire to be liked and accepted by others.

The views expressed in the preceding cited definition may help us to understand the following facts about the nature and form of the normative conformity.

- In normative conformity, people behave in full accordance with the group or social norms.
- The main reason for their choosing to conform – going along with others or the social norms – is their desire to be liked or accepted by others in their group or society. Accordingly, the children may be found to conform for pleasing and seeking approval and liking of their parents, teachers and other elders of their society and the working professionals for pleasing their boss by abiding to the norms of working in the establishment.
- The other reason for group or normative conformity on the part of children or grownup people may be cited as avoidance of rejection, exclusion, punishment and ridiculing of them

for not going with the majority or not following the norms and rules set down by the group for behaving in one or the other social situations.

Factors Affecting Conformity

Social influence as we have discussed in this chapter has a great potential and in fact is responsible to a large extent for making people conform to others' opinions, beliefs and attitudes in one or the other social situations. The socio-psychologists and researchers have identified a number of factors that either increase or decrease the level of social influence in a given social situation, and in this way, directly or indirectly, contribute towards the conformity of the people to the views of others in the group. We may name and discuss some of these significant factors as follows.

1. **Cohesiveness:** Cohesiveness of a group refers to the type of unity, togetherness and degree of attraction visible in the attitude and behavior of the members of the group towards each other, the group as a whole and its goals and norms. The research studies in social psychology have revealed the significance and importance of cohesiveness in bringing conformity of the individual members towards the group goals and norms. In principle, the more cohesive is the group (i.e., the more interdependent its members are, and the more attraction they feel for their group and its goals) the more likely they are to conform.
2. **Group Size:** Size of the group also matters much in deciding the fate of the conformity on the part of group members. In general, the bigger the groups in size the greater are the chances of witnessing conformity on the part of group members simply for the reason that in a large group we may expect a quite big number for exercising social influence or group pressure on the individual members to go along with the majority and abide by the group norms. The presence of even three members in the group may work well for making an individual conform and go along with majority even if he has a reverse opinion on this account. We have already witnessed the happening of this phenomenon while discussing the Asch experiment on comparison of lines. The research findings have further revealed a quite interesting fact in this concern by claiming that conformity increases with group size up to about three members, but then seems to level off. Throwing light on this aspect, Crisp and Turner (2014:94) write:

As groups grow in size, there is a corresponding increase in the level of conformity observed, but there is a leveling off once the group size reaches three people. In an extension to his classical study, Asch (1952) found that when the group size got progressively bigger than three, then conformity remained stable at about 35%. The idea here is that when there are just two people, any disagreement between participants could be regarded as an interpersonal issue. With three, however, there are enough people present for the individual participant to feel that that they are outnumbered, and they will begin to feel pressure to conform to avoid possible social exclusion.
3. **Group Unanimity:** The presence or absence of unanimity among the members of the group also plays a quite leading role in deciding the nature of the fate of conformity. As a general rule, greater is the unanimity among the members of the group in relation to some issue or compliance of social norms more are the chances of witnessing increase in the amount of conformity. In fact, unanimity in the group is always found to work as a great pressurizing force on the individual members to conform. However, when there is some voice of dissent the conformity gets decreased in the same proportion. Even a single dissent exercised on a part of an individual member (irrespective of his status, knowledge and skill, etc.) may provide sufficient strength and confidence to other members to think about their conforming or not conforming to the majority decision or group norms.

4. **Self-Esteem and -Confidence of the Individuals:** The level of self-confidence and self-esteem of the people also works as a significant factor for their conformity in one or the other social situations. It has been generally found that the people possessing high self-esteem and more self-confidence are less likely to conform than those lacking in the possession of these traits. Where one's self-confidence and self-esteem provide them sufficient strength and open mind to express their own views, and doing something other than the majority, the lack of self-confidence and self-esteem leaves a little scope for the individuals to differ and non-conform.
5. **Status of the Individual:** What is true for self-esteem and self-confidence is also equally applicable for the status of an individual in the group or society to conform or not conform to the majority opinion or group norm. The lower the social position or status of a person in the group, more are the chances of showing conformity behavior on his part. Reverse is also true. The people with high social status or position in the group are more likely to show a lesser degree of conformity as they have power and scope for going against the majority and social norms.
6. **Nature of the Social Norms:** The nature of the conformity on the part of individual members also depends much on the nature of the social norms prescribed for their behavior in one or the other social situations. In reference to the maintenance of social behavior, socio-psychologists have mentioned two types of norms, namely descriptive norms and injunctive norms. Descriptive norms, true to their naming, describe what people in general do in a particular social situation such as putting waste or used material in the containers meant for this purpose at the public places. On the other hand, injunctive norms clearly specify what is desirable/approved behavior or undesirable/unapproved behavior in one or the other social situations, i.e., one should not litter at the public places. Both types of these norms add

to influence the conformity in people's behavior but with a difference. The injunctive norms carry a much stronger appeal accompanied with a hidden warning for conforming to the socially desirable behavior and hence prove more effective than the descriptive norms in inducing conformity in the behavior of people.

Principles or Factors Governing One's Conformity

- Cohesiveness.
- Group size.
- Group unanimity.
- Self-esteem and confidence of the individuals.
- Status of the individual.
- Nature of the social norms.
- Cultural and age factors.
- The need for individuation.
- Situational factors such as public vs. private response, and nature of the task and level of competence.

7. **Cultural and Age Factors:** Cultural effect as well as age factors are also found to exercise their roles in affecting and influencing the level of conformity of the people. Regarding the cultural effect, it is observed that the conformity of the people varies in accordance to the nature and impact of culture they belong. In general, cultures that are collectivist in nature exhibit a higher degree of conformity than the individualistic cultures. Accordingly, the people belonging to rural, backward and tribal cultures are found to be more prone to conformity than the urban and western culture influenced people and communities in India.

Regarding the impact of age factor on conformity it has been found that the individuals younger in age especially the children are more prone to conformity than the people older in age due to lack of experience and status. In fact, there is a quite direct relation between one's age and level of conformity. Older the age, lesser is

the likelihood to conform easily to the opinions and beliefs of others.

8. **The Need for Individuation:** There are individuals who have a quite strong urge or inherent desire to maintain their individual identity for expressing their own opinion, holding their own belief and behaving their own way by choosing not to go with others. They resist the majority decision even when they find themselves all alone in the group or community for taking a different stand. In this way, the level of conformity may be seen to get decreased or increased on account of the presence or absence of such individuation demonstrated on the part of the members of the group. Sometimes, these individuals are really the talented ones who know more and possess ability to provide quite unique and useful ideas for the group and thus may be found to resist the majority decision for pressing their own for the benefit of the group or society. The other times, they may be found to be going against the majority and behaving in a different manner only for the sake of bringing them into the limelight and becoming popular for having courage to go against majority and social norms.

9. **Situational Factors:** In addition to the preceding more prominent and common factors involved in influencing and affecting the increase and decrease in the level of conformity on the part of people there are certain other specific and situational factors found effective for the purpose. These may be briefly stated as follows:

- (i) **Public vs. Private Response:** In the situations when group members are required to provide their judgment or express their views publicly in front of others, they have a quite great pressure on them to conform – going with the majority of group norms. On the contrary, when they are supposed to engage in expressing their views or opinions privately, for example casting their vote through secret ballot, they feel free to express

their personal opinion or exercise their own individual judgments with no outside group pressure. In this way, situations when members of the group are supposed to provide their responses publicly or privately cast a great impact over the nature of their conformity behavior in one or the other social situations.

- (ii) **Nature of the Task and Level of Competence:** Nature of the tasks and competency possessed on the part of the members in the group for performing these tasks also adds to the increase and decrease in the conformity level of the individuals. In the situations, when the tasks or behaviors to be performed on the part of individuals are vague or difficult, then it makes or forces them to conform to the views and suggestions of others or go with majority. However, when the tasks are simpler and easy to handle the people may feel competent to go it alone and in such a case the need to conform is found to be greatly decreased. In this way, the nature of the task or behavior to be performed can work as one of the potent factors in influencing and affecting the nature of conformity in one or the other social situations.

To Sum Up

The term conformity stands for a form or mode of social influence putting pressure on the individuals to bring changes in their behavior in tune with the existing social norms or behavior of the majority in the group or our desire to be liked and accepted by others.

In general, people may be found to demonstrate two types of conformity in their social behavior known as private conformity (privately accepting the norms of the group as one's own beliefs) and public conformity (publicly behave as demanded by the majority or social norms). While the phenomenon of private conformity was extensively studied

by Sherif through his classical experiment in 1935, the phenomenon of public conformity was studied by Solomon Asch through his classical experiment in 1951.

People engage in private conformity or public conformity on account of two different types of social influences – informational social influence (tendency to depend upon others as a source of information for responding to an ambiguous or new situation) and normative social influence (compulsion of behaving as others or following the majority decision or group norm).

There are certain factors that are known to either increase or decrease the level of social influence responsible for making the people conform. These factors affecting conformity may be known as cohesiveness, group size, group unanimity, self-esteem and confidence of the individuals, status of the individual, nature of the social norms, cultural and age factors, the need for individuation and a variety of situational factors such as public vs. private response, and nature of the task and level of competence.

who have the guts to get others to comply – to make others submit to their request or proposal for serving their unique purposes). In simple words, thus, the term compliance may be termed as a socially impressed behavior demonstrated on the part of the individual or group of individuals for complying or submitting to the request or proposal made to them by others who need to be profited by it in some ways. For knowing and understanding more about its meaning and nature let us take the help of a few important definitions given on the part of the socio-psychologists and authors.

American Psychological Association (2007):

In psychology, compliance refers to changing one's behavior due to the request or direction of another person.

Taylor et al. (2006): Compliance is defined as doing what we are asked to do, even though we might prefer not to.

Breckler et al. (2006): Compliance refers to a change in behavior that is requested by another person or group; the individual acted in some way because others asked him or her to do so (but it was possible to refuse or decline).

Hewstone et al. (1996): Compliance involves change in overt (public) behavior after exposure to other people's opinions.

Compliance

Concept and Meaning

The other important socially influenced behavior in our social world is compliance. In Merriam Webster Dictionary the term compliance has been defined as “the act or process of complying with a desire, demand or proposal” (*Webster Seventh Collegiate Dictionary*, 1970:170). In demonstrating a complying behavior the individual or group of individuals is found to comply or submit to the request or proposal made to them by someone who is interested in getting it done so. It is why the famous American socio-psychologist Robert Cialdini (2006) has termed the people like salespeople, advertisers, insurance agents, political lobbyists, fund raisers, etc. as *compliance professionals* (the individuals

Compliance

A form of social influence aimed to bring changes in people's overt behavior to comply with the request or proposal made to them by others.

The analysis of the definitions just cited may help us in deriving the following conclusions about the meaning, nature and characteristics of the term compliance as follows.

1. Compliance refers to a response – specifically, a submission – made on the part of an individual or group of individuals in reaction to a request or proposal put forward by someone else.

2. In compliance social influence (direct or indirect pressure) is exerted on the part of someone for introducing changes in the behavior of others for making them behave as per his desire or motives.
3. We consider a behavior is a compliance behavior when an individual changes his or her behavior in response to an explicit or implicit request made by another person.
4. Compliance is often referred to as an active form of social influence in the sense that it is usually initiated by a person or establishment quite intentionally for meeting its own purposes.
5. Compliance is also conceptualized as an external form of social influence in the sense that it focuses mainly on a change in overt behavior. Although compliance may sometimes also cause changes in people's internal beliefs and/or feelings, such internal changes are not the primary goal of compliance, nor are they necessarily required for the request to be successful.
6. In the compliance related behavior people resort to one or the other tactics for inducing others to say yes to their request or proposal. On the other side, in their response, the induced or socially influenced people are seen to demonstrate changes in their overt or external behavior whether or not they internally agree to do so or not.

Featured with the aforementioned characteristics, the following behaviors may be well exemplified as the socially influenced compliance behavior of the people in one or the other social situations.

- You respond to the request made by an old lady to help in picking up her dropped stick.
- The children may be found to cry and engage in tantrums for agreeing their parents and elders to their justified or unjustified demands.
- You may act and respond in the way as asked by your friends or acquaintances for doing favor to them.
- The customers may be found to buy one or the other things when a salesman with his art makes a pitch and then asks them to make the purchase.

- You see an advertisement appealing in its own way for purchasing a product, and you make up your mind for its purchase by ordering it online.
- We all stand at the tune of our national anthem at the time of its playing anywhere at the public place or community gathering.

Principles or Factors Governing One's Compliance

The socio-psychologists like the famous American scholar Robert Cialdini (1994, 2006), working and experimenting in the field of social impression, have mentioned the following basic principles/factors that usually govern the compliance behavior of the people.

1. **Friendship or Liking:** Degree of trust or faith imposed on someone may safely draw others to say yes for one's request or proposal. It is why the individuals are more willing to comply with requests from their near ones, relatives, friends or others in comparison to the requests coming from strangers or the people not trusted and liked by them. Accordingly, we show a lot of compliance to the proposals put up by the insurance agents, shopkeepers and others in our one or the other types of deals and transactions who are trusted and liked by us most.
2. **Commitment or Consistency:** Commitment made by us on one or the other accounts with someone on one or the other issue or deal works as a good internalized pressure for honoring it on our behalf. Accordingly, when we settle a price for the purchase of a piece of land or any other commodity, it becomes obligatory on our part to maintain the continuity of our 'yes' for the commitment once made in this connection. Similarly, whenever people show their commitment to one or the other social cause or make public their views on one or the other policy matter, there remains a lot of consistency in their behavior. In this way, the commitment made or 'yes' said by somebody for the request or proposal of others has a greater possibility of its honoring/complying well till the time it

remains consistent with the earlier commitment. However, any new proposal or request which is inconsistent with the earlier commitment definitely may face uncertainty in its compliance.

3. **Scarcity:** The need decides the value of a thing. How useful and essential it is to say “yes” or comply with the request or proposal of others on one’s part decides the fate of its being honored or denied on one’s part. When there is shortage or scarcity of a particular commodity, in the market, the purchasers are more inclined to agree with what is proposed by the sellers, even if it seems to be somewhat unreasonable to them otherwise. The people who feel scarcity of the resources or opportunities may be found to say “yes” for the hard-pressed proposals and service rules and comply with a lot of things to be asked by their employers in their service tenure.
4. **Reciprocity:** What we do to others as good or bad gets returned to us usually in the same proportion on one or the other ways. Reciprocity in fact, thus, is the rule of nature and it equally applies to our social relations and interactions. Accordingly, in general, people may be found to comply more with a request or proposal from someone who has done some favor to them in the past or is obliging them at present in comparison to those who do not fall in the list of favoring them in such a way.

Principles or Factors Governing One’s Compliance

- Friendship or liking.
- Commitment or consistency.
- Scarcity.
- Reciprocity.
- Social validation.
- Authority.

repetition on our part. When we see others comply with a certain type of request or proposals made to them on this account with a satisfactory return, we have almost no hesitation in going on their way in the compliance of the similar requests or proposals. In such case, the fear of getting it wrong and uncertainty about our decision seems to be vanished in a greater degree and we willingly agree to get along with others for the compliance of the request or proposals of others. The social validation we get by seeing others benefit through the compliance of a request or business proposal motivates or in a way persuades us to engage in such complying behaviors on our part.

6. **Authority:** From early childhood we may be seen to comply with what is asked or desired by our parents, elders and teachers, the well-known authorities holding such a position of influencing and guiding our behavior to a compliance path. It goes for us in the similar way, after getting maturity on our part. All of us, in general, are found to comply more in a greater degree with what is asked or desired by the people who hold some recognized legitimate authority than people who do not hold such position.

Techniques of Compliance – Making People Comply

Making people comply with the request or proposal made to them is really a great art. It involves a lot of labor and skilled performance on their part as we witness through what is done by a number of compliance professionals such as salesmen, insurance and property agents, counselors and coaches, etc. or many of us in the capacity of parents, teachers and administrators. In practice, the task of making others say “yes” for the request or proposal made to them needs the employment of a number of specific tactics and strategies based on the principles and factors of compliance discussed ahead. Let us examine them one by one.

5. **Social Validation:** The social validation of a behavioral act increases the possibility of its

A. Tactics Based on Friendship or Liking- Ingratiation

These techniques of increasing compliance call for making efforts to get others to trust in us by coming closer and liking us in one or the other aspects. We must have an appropriate impression on them as a good, reliable and attractive person for the purpose of the needed ingratiation i.e., getting them agreed to our requests or proposals. Some of the mentionable techniques used on one's part in this concern may be the following:

- Improving one's appearance, making one's look more attractive and pleasing to others.
- Emitting positive non-verbal cues in the form of desirable gestures, smiling face, a high level of eye contact, etc.
- Using soft, pleasing and understandable language in one's communication.
- Associating oneself with positive events, places, objects or people the target person likes most.
- Flattering and praising the target person in one way or the other.
- Trying to project one as appreciable and high in the eyes of the target persons by resorting to self-promotion.
- Listening carefully to the target people, agreeing with them on one or the other issues and showing interest in them.
- Identifying with the target people by calling attention to small and slightly surprising similarities between them and us.
- Providing the target people some small gifts or doing favors to them from time to time.

Ingratiation

A way of making people comply with our request or proposal through our good impression on them by increasing their liking for us.

For the success of the aforementioned impression enhancing techniques used for promoting conformity, the research findings have yielded

satisfactory results by indicating that all of these tactics can be successful, at least to a degree, in increasing others' liking for us.

B. Tactics Based on Commitment or Consistency

The techniques based on the principle of commitment or consistency for deriving good results in the promotion of conformity on the part of the target people may be discussed in the manner as follows.

1. **Foot-in-the-Door Technique:** In case you want to get beyond a door, it may begin by putting first a portion of your body in the way. If you succeed, it may help you to have more success in getting entry to the room. Much in the same way, in using the foot-in-the-door technique for gaining compliance in one or the other social situations from others, a beginning is made by an individual for placing a small request and when this is granted, it is further escalated to the point of achieving what is aimed. For example, in a working situation, your coworker may ask if you will fill in for him for a day. After you say yes, he may then further submit if you could just continue to fill in for the rest of the week. The trick here goes well in most of the cases for a simple reason that once the target person complies with the small request, it becomes a little hard for him to say no to its extension. Surely, he would not like to disfigure his good image by showing inconsistency to his initial response and accordingly the desired success in availing conformity/yes to a proposal or request from the desired target can be properly availed on our part.

Foot-in-the-Door Technique

A technique used for getting people to comply with our request by first getting them agreed to our small request, and then extend its dimension to the point of achieving what is aimed.

The technique is well applied by shopkeepers to sell their products to customers. For this purpose, they initially request them to have a taste of their product. After having its compliance, they further request them to buy some amount of their product in the quantity of their choice. More often, it gets compliance on the part of the customers as they feel obliged to some extent by tasting their product and want to maintain their image.

2. **Law-Ball Technique:** In making use of this technique, for getting agreed people to accept a proposal or deal, the target customers are first lured by offering a relatively lower price along with some additional discount for the purchase of a product. However, once the customers accept the offer, they get it changed in one or the other ways for leaning the deal more favorably to their side. You may have experienced it while purchasing something from the shopping malls, or booking a car or flat. Throwing light on the use of this compliance technique, Baron and Byrne (2001:335) write:

In this technique, a very good deal is offered to a customer. After the customer accepts, however, something happens that it makes necessary for the salesperson to change the deal and make it less advantageous for the customer – for example, an “error” in price calculations is found, or the sales manager rejects the deal. The totally rational reaction for customers, of course, is to walk away. Yet often they agree to the changes and accept the less desirable arrangement.

Law-Ball Technique

A technique used for making people comply with our proposal or deal first by luring them by quoting a lower price or offering a sizable discount and then making them agree to pay more by giving one or the other reasons.

Besides the marketing and business deal, we may very well witness the use of this compliance technique in our day-to-day life and social dealings. Initially, the people may be offered to pay a lesser amount for becoming a member of a social club or getting honored for their donation to a social cause by a big celebrity, but after saying yes and completing the necessary formalities, they may be informed about some or the other changes such as the fees have been recently raised or some local authority will be honoring them on this occasion. In all such cases, however, the results are more commonly found in the favor of the success of this technique, perhaps for the reason that once an individual has made an initial public commitment to a course of action, he or she is reluctant to withdraw, even when the ground rules are changed (Burger and Cornelius, 2003).

3. **Bait-and-Switch Tactic:** In making use of this compliance technique on the part of business men and shopkeepers, the target persons are lured or fished into the net by advertising a relatively lower price and big discount on one or the other items. Accordingly, people enter the shop by making up their mind for the purchase. However, there are now some planned tricks that are played on the part of shop owners such as (i) they say that the advertised ones have been sold, (ii) they present before them the items of a very low quality in the name of discounted items or (iii) as an alternative, they show them the relatively costlier item by emphasizing its quality. The trick or strategy used serves its purpose – the customers, who had already made up their mind and taken the trouble in visiting the shop, now have hardly any alternative other than buying a more expensive item that is available.

C. Tactics Based on Reciprocity

The techniques based on the principle of reciprocity for deriving good results in the promotion of

conformity on the part of the target people may be discussed in the manner as follows.

1. **The Door-in-the-Face Technique:** This technique of gaining compliance on the part of a requester or proposer runs contrary to the “foot-in-the-door technique” discussed earlier. Here, instead of beginning with a small request and then presenting a larger one, people seeking compliance are found to initiate or start with a quite heavy request or demand and then, after this is rejected, convert it to a lighter or smaller one – the one actually in their plan – for being accepted. The dealers and sellers often are found to make use of this tactic for pushing up the price desired on their part to get accepted by the target customers. It may also happen with us while selling our plot of house. We place a quite heavy price much above the market rate with a clear vision of being rejected by most of the purchasers. After then, we get engaged in the negotiation with a clear aim of lowering our quoted price to a level on which we actually desire to sell it.

The Door-in-the-Face Technique

A technique used for getting compliance of our request by first initiating with a quite heavy demand and then after its probable rejection, converting it to a lighter one.

2. **The Foot-in-the-Mouth Technique:** Nobody would like to harm or bite his own foot even when it happens to be in his or her mouth. The recognition of the foot as their own makes them to behave in a friendly way. Similarly, people generally prefer to oblige their friends, relatives and acquaintances by getting agreed to their request or proposal. It is such recognition on the part of a request maker that helps him first to seek or establish good relationships with the target persons and then put his request before them for the compliance (much like putting his foot in their mouths)

with a reasonable certainty that it will not be refused (bitten by them). This type of compliance behavior thus works quite straightly on the principle of reciprocity. The existence of a good relationship is reciprocated in a proper way i.e., the presence of mutual trust between the requester and responders. Accordingly, friends usually help friends and acquaintances accede to each other's request when they need so and it is this relationship which is well exploited in the use of the foot-in-the-mouth technique for gaining compliance of others on the part of the request makers or proposal submitters. In this connection, the statements like we are all students; women; residents of the same province; followers of the same faith or religion; the people of the same caste, province, country; or say human beings may be well used by the request makers for getting people agreed to say yes to their proposal of one or the other kind.

Foot-in-the-Mouth Technique

A technique used for getting compliance to our request by initiating some type of relationship with the target people aimed to increase their feelings of obligation to comply.

3. **That's-Not-All Technique:** This is another useful technique based on the principle of reciprocity – do some extra favor and get a quick favor in return. The shopkeepers, insurance agents, property dealers and even the public school-owners, may be found to make use of this technique quite often for luring the target persons to comply with their proposals. Let us illustrate next how this technique gets employed in practice.

Imagine you're purchasing some deals. You were in the market for purchasing a laptop of a particular brand. The shopkeeper showed you the quoted price of the company for this purpose. You asked him for

some discount. As a result of negotiation, he finally offered you a low price. But it was not the end – that wasn't all. While you were making up your mind, a small incentive was also offered to you for sweetening the deal in the form of free antivirus software for a year with the hope that this would help him close the deal. And it really worked. You agreed perhaps for feeling obliged through the extra concession and reciprocated it by accepting the deal.

D. Tactics Based on Scarcity: Tactics based on the principle of scarcity are also found to play a quite important role in promoting the needed compliance behavior on the part of targeted individuals. These may chiefly include the following.

1. **Playing Hard to Get:** In making use of this scarcity principle-based technique, efforts are made to promote the compliance behavior of the target persons by suggesting or in fact making them believe that the object they are aiming to get is scarce, rare and hard to obtain. As examples of the use of this technique we may consider the following.

- In a jewelry shop, while selecting a diamond set of a specific design, the shopkeeper may offer that a particular set selected by you is already reserved for a customer and it takes a long time as well as labor for preparing such sets. When you insist on its purchase, he puts up a high price for its sale which you most likely will accept, with a realization that it is not in any way improper for getting such valuable and rare piece in this price.
- In appearing for an interview of an executive post in an establishment you may try to assure the selection team that you are one of the most suitable candidates for the job and get them to know that you already have good offers from some companies. It helps in projecting you as a valuable and hard to get candidate for the said post resulting in the compliance on the part of the selectors what you intend.

2. **Deadline Technique:** Unlike the playing-hard-to-get technique creating scarcity of an object or person, the deadline technique shows scarcity of the time for getting the target person to say “yes” by just announcing a deadline (the time of closing a deal). In this way, the deadline technique of promoting compliance to a desired behavior represents a technique in which target persons are told that they have only limited time to take advantage of some offer or deal. Many of the shopkeepers and property dealers may be found to make use of this technique in the promotion of their sale. They provide a deadline for the concession available on their product/flat by advertising a specific time limit for this purpose. Here they also clearly specify that after this deadline, the said item will be available at its original price. Here it is but natural that everybody would be in a hurry to avail the concessional items in a low price instead of paying more for them after the expiry of the time limit. It is also here to be seen that no shopkeeper can afford to sell the items without getting its due profit on them. Therefore, in most of the cases the sale is not real and neither is the time limit as announced by them in their advertisements. However, the trick used for promoting the sale works a lot. It may attract so many customers and lure them to rush for the purchase of the items within the time limits even when they have no urgent need or liking for its purchase then and there.

E. Other Miscellaneous Tactics for Gaining Compliance

In addition to the earlier mentioned compliance techniques based on one or the other compliance principles, there also is a specific category of compliance techniques that is based on the intermixing of a variety of compliance principles. Let us examine a few important techniques belonging to this category.

1. **Complaining Technique:** We, in our day-to-day life and work situations may be found to complain about one or the other things which

we do not want to happen. It is most often concerned with some sort of discontent, dissatisfaction, resentment or regret felt for the behavior of others including the self in the manner as exemplified here.

- “I should not speak in such a tone and way to my parents.”
- “You should not litter in this way in the public place.”
- “As a responsible authority, why are you not caring for the cleaning of the water tanks supplying water in our colony?”
- “It is not fair to eat the same vegetables you like, why don’t you care for my choice?”
- “Mummy, really you don’t love me anymore, is it right?”

Really it is one’s complaining about the behavior of somebody (including the self) that may make him feel the need of bringing desirable changes in his behavior. It is thus a unique way of making use of the phenomenon of social impression on one’s part for getting the desired compliance from the target people. Researchers have reported quite encouraging results for the use of this technique to promote compliance behavior among the people.

2. **Putting Others in a Good Mood:** Another effective technique in this category is concerned with our efforts to get the target people to remain in a good mood. Mood certainly decides the action. Keeping the target people in a good mood is that which is well desired for creating a quite congenial environment and the needed motivational conditions to place one’s request or proposal for its acceptance well on their part. Many of the business establishments, shopping complexes, property dealers’ offices, automobile showrooms and travel agencies always plan for keeping their customers in a good mood for gaining desired outcomes in their favor. They provide the needed facilities and amenities for the pleasing welcome of their customers, including taking all precautions for the desired good behavior and attitudes

shown towards them. It certainly brings favorable result. The good mood of the target persons helps much in getting a “yes” from them for the requests or proposals made. Not only in business dealings, but also in our day-to-day social life, we can very much witness the magic of putting target persons in good moods. Even children try to have a close watch on the moods of their parents for putting their demands to get these accepted in a proper way.

To Sum Up

The term compliance stands for a socially impressed behavior demonstrated on the part of the individual or group of individuals for complying or submitting to the request or proposal made to them by others who need to be profited by it in some ways.

The various principles or factors governing one’s compliance may be known as:

- Friendship or liking (making a good impression by increasing our liking on the part of persons to comply with our request).
- Commitment or consistency (utilizing the commitment made by the target persons earlier in relation to asked request or proposal).
- Scarcity (realization of the shortage or scarcity of the thing offered for deal).
- Reciprocity (give and take phenomenon for complying with some body’s request).
- Social validation (seeing others comply with the request).
- Authority (the position and status of the persons making us comply with their request).

We may make use of a number of techniques for making people comply with our requests or proposals. In general, we may classify and name these techniques as techniques based on:

- The phenomenon of ingratiation (winning friendship or liking of the target persons).
- The principle of commitment or consistency such as foot-in-the-door technique, low-ball technique and bait-and-switch technique.
- The principle of reciprocity such as the door-in-the-face technique, the foot-in-the-mouth technique and that's-not-all technique.
- Scarcity such as playing hard to get, and deadline technique.
- Other miscellaneous tactics for gaining compliance such as complaining technique, and putting others in a good mood.

Obedience

Concept and Meaning

The third important socially influenced behavior, falling after the previously discussed behaviors – conformity and compliance – is obedience. In terms of its formal definition, it refers to a type of socially influenced behavior in which people are found to obey or submit to the orders or commands from others for doing what is demanded from them without questioning the authority who issues these orders. In this way, we may find, this type of socially influenced behavior differing from the conformity and compliance in some of the following ways.

- In obedience, one person orders one or more persons to do something and they obey by doing it in the way as demanded from them. Obedience, in this way, is an active form of social influence in the sense that it is directly initiated by an authority figure or whosoever is in the commanding position.
- Here change in behavior of the target person is brought out by a direct order or command from an authority figure. There is nothing like persuasion or getting him agreed for doing what is desired by the authority figure.

- The obedience behavior is typically external in the sense that obeying the orders requires the target persons to demonstrate it through the observable external behavior. What they think or feel in obeying such orders is a matter of least concern for the authority figure.

Obedience

A form or type of socially influenced behavior in which people are found to obey or submit to the orders from others for doing what is demanded from them without questioning the authority who issues these orders.

- In practice, in our day-to-day life or social interaction, we may notice that in making people behave in a certain way, we usually prefer in most of the situations, conformity or compliance than the obedience as an instrument of social influence. As far as possible, even the persons who possess authority and power for ordering others to obey, generally, prefer to exert it through the soft means like request or persuasion rather than the stiff direct orders. In spite of it, it is not uncommon or surprising to find that obedience to the commands of the authority is also very much frequent in our social and professional world. Business executives sometimes issue orders to their subordinates; military officers shout commands that they expect to be followed without questions; and parents, police officers and sports coaches, to name a few, seek to influence others in the same manner (Baron and Byrne, 2001:343).

Forms of Obedience

Like conformity and compliance, obedience behavior can also take different forms depending on the nature of the order or command providing authority as well as the one who is obeying this command.

- Obedience on the part of children to their parents, family members, teachers and elders.

- Obedience on the part of employees and workers from their employers and masters.
- Obedience on the part of police and military personnel to their seniors in ranks.
- Obedience on the part of followers of a faith or religion to its beliefs, rituals and doctrine.
- Obedience on the part of the members of a community or citizens of a country to the prescribed norms and laws.
- Obedience on the part of the members of a gang to their leader.
- Obedience on the part of the ignorant and unknowledgeable to the experts and knowledgeable.
- Obedience on the part of human beings to God or nature as the supreme power.
- Obedience on the part of individuals to the self-imposed restrictions helpful to their existence, survival and well-being.

Milgram's Study on Obedience

A series of quite useful social psychology experiments for studying phenomena of obedience were conducted by Yale University psychologist Stanley Milgram (1963, 1965). In one of his experiments, he tried to measure the willingness of study participants to obey an authority figure who instructed them to perform acts that conflicted with their personal conscience. The experimental setting, procedure and outcomes of his experiment may be briefly summarized as follows.

- In his experimental study there were three types of individuals designated as experimenter (the researcher himself), the participants of the study (on which experimenter performed the experiment) and the confederates (the experimenter's own people). For the role of subjects or participants he selected 40 male volunteers (20–50 years old) from a wide variety of backgrounds with the help of advertisements.
- At the beginning of the experiment, experimenter informed the participants that they were taking part in an investigation into the effects of punishment on learning. They have

to play the role of teachers and their job in this experiment is to make the other volunteers like them play the role of teacher. In terms of experimental setting, the experimenter and the participant of the study both were required to sit in the same room (referred to as control room) with the experimenter sitting behind the participant for issuing instructions to him from time to time. The confederate volunteer (acting as learner) was required to sit in the adjoining room (referred to as shock room) for making him non-visible to the participant (playing the role of a teacher).

- Experimenter in the gathering of the all the participant volunteers (acting as teachers and learners) explained that the teacher's job would be to sit in the control room along with the experimenter and to read a list of word pairs to the learner. After the teacher read the list once, it would be the learner's job to remember which words went together. For instance, if the word pair was *red-carpet*, the teacher would say the word *red* on the testing trials and the learner would have to indicate which of four possible words (*bird, hairs, wall* or *carpet*) was the correct answer by pressing one of four buttons in front of him. In case the learner makes a mistake in recalling the correct word, he would be liable for the punishment in the form of receiving an electric shock. For inflicting punishment to the learners, teachers were required to begin with the smallest possible shock (15 volts) but with each mistake the shock was to be increased by one level (an additional 15 volts) extended to 450 volts.
- Once the learner (who was, of course, actually an experimental confederate) was alone in the shock room, he unstrapped himself from the shock machine so actually he was not feeling shocks for the wrong responses. Moreover, for responding on their part the learners were equipped with a tape recorder possessing a pre-recorded series of responses of the learner that the teacher could hear through the wall of the room for every step taken by him in his testing and shock providing task.

- The teacher heard the learner say, “Ugh!” after the first few shocks. The teacher was told to go on increasing the shock level each time the learner made a mistake. With the increase of the level of shock, the responses of the learner also got intensified indicating the grief and pains they were feeling at their end. For example, exclaiming at 150 volts, “Please, get me out from here, my heart is bothering me now.” At 180 volts, the learner shouted that he could no longer stand the pain. As the shock reached about 270 volts, the learner’s protests became more vehement, and after 300 volts the learner declared that he was not going to answer any more questions. From 330 volts, onwards, just silence was there from the side of the learner. The experimenter responded to participant’s questions at this point, if they asked any, with a scripted response indicating that they should continue reading the questions and applying increasing shock even when the learner did not respond.
- At this point and even before that the participants playing the role of teachers indicated their desire to stop the experiment and check on the condition of the learner. However, most of them continued after being assured they would not be held responsible for what they were asked to do. If at any time a particular participant/teacher indicated his desire to halt the experiment, he was verbally encouraged to continue. If the participant still wished to stop after all the verbal prods, the experiment ended in the case of that particular pair of the teacher and learner. Otherwise, it was only called to end after the participant/teacher had given the maximum 450-volt shock three times in a row to the paired learner.
- Milgram was interested in his study to find out the overall impact of the instructions issued or orders passed by an authority on the obedience behavior of the target persons – how far they may go blindly to obey the authority and what works in influencing their behavior to such an extent. Prior to the study, 40 psychiatrists that Milgram consulted told him that fewer than 1% of subjects would administer what they thought

were dangerous shocks to the learner. However, the results of the experiment were quite contrary. Under the presence of the experimenter (the authority figure) and his insistence to continue to increase the shock level, 65% of the participants continued giving the shock to the learner all the way up to the 450 volts maximum, even though that shock was marked as “extremely dangerous” and there had been no response heard from the participant for several trials (more than enough to create suspense about their being alive).

- Through such findings of his study, Milgram tried to conclude that people may be found to obey the orders of an authority figure blindly, if they willingly or otherwise accept the authority of the person issuing them instructions or orders; if the authority figures remain present before them for watching their behavior and issuing orders; and if the authority figures make them assured that they will not be held responsible for any damaging outcomes of their obedience behavior.

Factors Affecting Obedience

Obedience behavior takes its expression in its many forms and varieties in our day-to-day life, social and working situations mentioned earlier in this chapter. It may be both constructive as well as destructive in its nature and consequence. The obedience shown by youngsters in obeying their parents and teachers may help them in learning good and desirable behavior for their development and progress. Similarly, the obedience of the norms and regulations or rules and laws formed by law abiding authorities and communities helps much in establishing law and order and maintaining harmony among the people. However, all obedience is not so much constructive in its nature. It can prove sufficiently harmful and destructive to the well-being of humans and society in one or the other ways as revealed through the findings of the experiments conducted by Milgram. Now here questions may arise about why people get engaged in one or the other type of such constructive or destructive obedience behavior. In general,

based on our social experience on this account as well as conclusions reached on the part of Milgram in his experimental studies, we may briefly summarize the factors affecting obedience in the manner as given here:

1. *Proximity to the Authority Figure:* Proximity indicates physical and psychological closeness of the authority to the target persons. When people begin to trust and feel emotionally attached to an authority figure, they do whatever is asked from them for doing. Besides this, physical proximity in the form of the presence of the ordergiving authority on the scene, his close watch for the compliance of the orders and frequent warnings or reminders about disobedience of any sort, play a quite decisive role in eliciting obedient response on the part of target persons. Milgram's continuous presence in the same room, his close watch on the obeying responses of the participants and reminding them from time to time to follow the instructions worked much in the continuance of their obedience behavior too long.
2. *Position and Status of the Authority Figure:* Obedience behavior of the target persons is very much associated or connected with the status and position of the order issuing authority. The higher the position and status of the authority, the more pressure it puts on the individuals for obeying its orders. In government services, army and industrial establishments, you may easily witness the role of hierarchical ranks or positions of the commanding authorities for influencing and affecting the obedience behavior of their juniors and general public. There are so many visible symbols, signs or marks associated with the status of an authority figure, they may remind us about their status, position, ranking and powers held on their part for enforcing their authority on us. Their name plates, special uniforms, insignia, titles, badges or medals worn by them may constantly remind us about the status of their commanding authority and thus directly or indirectly force us to comply with their orders.
3. *Lack of Skills and Expertise:* Obedience behavior of the target person is very much influenced by the degree and level of skills and expertise they possess for doing a task or interacting in a social situation. The individuals who possess neither the ability nor the expertise to perform a skill work and take appropriate decisions are bound to look at others for leading and commanding them in these situations.
4. *Personality of the Target Persons:* The nature and fate of the obedience behavior also depend on the personality of the persons obeying the commanding authority. Some people are specifically known for possessing a submissive nature – always saying “yes” and submitting to the orders of an authority figure. Accordingly, the obedience is reflected more in the response behavior of these persons in comparison to those who are quite little bit non-submissive in their nature.
5. *Nature of the Upbringing and Belongingness to a Culture:* The obedience also depends to a larger extent on the upbringing of the persons. The children brought up in an authoritarian setup

Factors Affecting Obedience

- Proximity or nearness to the authority figure.
- Position and status of the authority figure.
- Lack of skills and expertise possessed by the target persons.
- Personality of the target persons.
- Nature of their upbringing and belongingness to a culture.
- Avoidance of negative consequence of disobeying.
- Time available for obeying the orders.
- Entrapment (gradual escalation of the level of obedience behavior).
- Deindividuation (defending their self by blaming others for their undesirable obedience behavior).

expected to obey without raising any questions, are turned the subjugated persons in their adult life in comparison to those provided reasonable freedom to question the imposed restrictions. Similarly, the cultural setup and norms of the society also influence and affect the obedience behavior of its members. It can be well seen as well get compared by witnessing the role of culture and social norms on the children and adults belonging to Indian culture.

6. *Avoidance of Negative Consequence of Disobeying*: In most of the cases there is a lot of danger in disobeying the orders and instructions in terms of facing one or the other types of negative consequences. Most of the people do not want to be rude and offend the authority and, therefore, think it better to submit without questioning the appropriateness of the instructions or orders of the authority figures.
7. *Time Available for Obeying the Orders*: There are occasions where there is hardly any time left for judging the appropriateness and consequences of the orders issued by the commanding authority in that situation. For example, at the time of riots and community clashes or punishing a thief and criminal caught by the group of people the things move very quickly, leaving almost no scope for reflection on the part of the individuals to say “no” to the instructions or orders issued by someone who takes the lead in exercising authority in this situation.
8. *Entrapment (Gradual Escalation of the Level of Obedience Behavior)*: Obedience behavior of the target persons can be escalated to a high degree by adopting the foot-in-door technique. People, here, are asked to obey first the easy commands, and then are compelled to obey more and more difficult commands. In a way, thus, they are entrapped to obey all types of desirable or undesirable orders by once entering into the trapping net of a clever authority figure. Milgram used this technique in inducing the destructive obedience among the teacher participants of his study.
9. *Deindividuation*: It is no surprise to see that all of us in general try to take credit for some good

things done on our part and to put blames on others for our mistakes and undesirable behavior. It equally applies to our obedience behavior. Here also people may be seen to defend their self by blaming others for their undesirable or destructive obedience behavior such as being demonstrated by the participants (teacher’s role players) of Milgram’s study in punishing the learners much against their own conscience. The simple explanation given by the people for their destructive obedience in such cases lies in their innocent statement that they were obeying the orders of an authority figure. In a number of gruesome torturing and fake encounters made on the part of police personnel, they view and project the destructive obedience on their part as instrument for carrying out others’ wishes, and thus no longer seeing themselves as responsible for their actions. In view of this fact, it is not surprising that many of us tend to engage in destructive obedience against our own individuality and conscience by assigning responsibility for such undesirable behavior to the authority rather than themselves.

Exercising Restraint or Control Over the Destructive Obedience

Destructive or blind obedience and subjugation to an authority figure proves quite dangerous and destructive to the well-being of the individual or group of individuals who fall victim of such undesirable obedience. It definitely needs to be controlled or restrained by taking measures for reducing our tendency of blindly obeying the orders or command of others without looking into its consequences. In general, the following strategies may be recommended for this purpose.

1. **Individuation**: The use of this strategy demands to make the individual entrapped or engaged in destructive obedience behavior realize that one is himself responsible for what he does with others irrespective of who orders him for doing it and whatever assurance is given to him for feeling safe on this account. There

are instances where the police officials engaging in the encounter of the political rival at the orders of the political authorities had to bear consequences through the inquiries set up and judicial judgments appeared against them at the later stage. No one stood for protecting them for their destructive obedience in these cases. Similarly, it should be quite clear to the people who commit heinous crimes and offences under the influence of destructive obedience they will have to bear the brunt when they are caught and held responsible for their acts with a least consideration that somebody was there to order them to do all this. For this purpose, the individuals, in general, from their early childhood should be exposed to these bitter truths for helping them to realize that one is fully responsible for the harm produced by following the improper commands and not the authority.

2. **Exposure to the Disobedience Models:** Observational learning and modeling is considered a quite effective technique for learning or relearning of one or the other things related to our social life. It can be appropriately used for making the people realize and learn that beyond some point, unquestioning submission to destructive commands is inappropriate. How to resist the pressure of the commanding authority and tactfully or bravely demonstrate a destructive disobedience behavior (refusing to obey the destructive commands) can, thus, be properly emphasized through exposing individuals to the actions of disobedient models.
3. **Appropriate Upbringing of Children:** The developmental age period is the best period of an individual's development and growth. The traits of the personality helpful for the individuals to resist pressure of destructive obedience get inculcated among the growing children through the proper bringing up and handling of them by their parents, elders and teachers. The democratic and appropriately expressive environment available to them helps much in the development of desirable personality traits for enabling them to resist the pressure of destructive obedience. In facing such situations, then and there

we may find them questioning the expertise and motives of the commanding authority figures and taking their own decision of what should be obeyed or what not.

4. **Reinforcing the Destructive Disobedience Behavior:** The individuals who demonstrate courage to disobey the commands and orders of mass destruction and improper inhuman treatment and similar other improper and inappropriate ones should be praised, rewarded and provided recognition in public. It will help not only to boost their morale but also prove an example for others to stand against the destructive commands.

To Sum Up

The term obedience behavior refers to a type of socially influenced behavior in which people are found to obey or submit to the orders or commands from others for doing what is demanded from them without questioning the authority who issues these orders.

Much like conformity and compliance, obedience behavior can also take different forms depending on the nature of the order or command providing authority as well as the one who is obeying this command. It has been usefully studied through a series of quite social psychology experiments conducted by Yale University psychologist Stanley Milgram during the period of 1963–1965.

The obedience behavior of people is influenced and controlled by a number of factors such as proximity to the authority figure (physical and psychological closeness of the authority to the target persons); position and status of the authority figure; lack of skills and expertise possessed by the target persons; personality of the target persons; nature of their upbringing and belongingness to a culture; avoidance of negative consequence of disobeying; time available for obeying the

orders; entrapment (gradual escalation of the level of obedience behavior); and de-individualization (defending their self by blaming others for their undesirable or destructive obedience behavior).

Destructive or blind obedience and subjugation to an authority figure proves quite dangerous and destructive to the well-being of the individual or group of individuals who fall victim of such undesirable obedience. It definitely needs to be controlled or resisted by following the strategies like individuation (realizing that one is himself responsible for what he does); exposure to the disobedience models; appropriate upbringing of the children; and reinforcing the destructive disobedience behavior.

Review Questions

- What is social influence? Throw light on its meaning and concept in detail.
- Define the term social influence and discuss its different forms and ways (such as conformity, compliance and obedience) in brief.
- What is conformity? Throw light on its meaning and concept as one of the modes and forms of our socially influenced behaviors.
- Define the term conformity and discuss its various types and forms.
- What do you understand by the term conformity? Throw light on its sources or the reasons of our getting engaged in a conforming behavior.
- Discuss the Sherif's classical experiments on private conformity and Asch's classical experiments on public conformity.
- What is a conforming behavior? Why and when do we choose to conform? Discuss.
- While throwing light on the concept of conformity, name and discuss the role of various factors affecting conformity.
- What is compliance? Throw light on its meaning and concept as a socially influenced behavior in detail.
- Discuss in detail the role of the various principles or factors governing one's compliance.
- Discuss in detail the various techniques of compliance – making people comply.
- What is obedience? Throw light on its meaning and concept as one of our socially influenced behaviors.
- Discuss the various forms or types of obedience.
- What is obedience behavior? How was the phenomenon of obedience studied by Stanley Milgram through his experiments? Discuss.
- Name and discuss the various factors affecting people's obedience behavior.
- What is destructive obedience? How can it be restrained or controlled? Discuss.

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11.

SOCIAL EXCHANGE PROCESS

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- Explain what social exchange is.
- Discuss a theory helpful in explaining the phenomenon of social exchange.
- Throw light on the meaning and concept of the social exchange processes.
- Tell about the significance of social exchange processes in our social life.
- Name the various forms or types of social exchange processes.
- Throw light on the concept and meaning of the term cooperation.
- Name and discuss the various forms or types of cooperation.
- Elucidate the needs and significance of cooperation in our social life.
- Explain the concept and meaning of the term competition.
- Throw light on the characteristic features of the process of competition.
- Name and discuss the various forms or types of competition.
- Discuss the role and functions of competition in our social life.
- Explain the concept and meaning of the term conflict.
- Elucidate the characteristic features of the conflict process.
- Name and discuss the various causes of conflict.
- Name and discuss the various forms or types of conflicts.
- Throw light on the role and functions of conflicts in our social life.
- Discuss the different techniques used for the resolution of conflict.

Introduction

Human beings are termed as social animals. They live and lead their lives in their community or society. For their living and leading life in the community/society, it is quite essential for them to have interaction with each other. This interaction between the individuals living in a community or society takes

place in the forms or shapes such as: (i) interaction between individuals, (ii) interaction of individuals with a group of individuals and (iii) interaction between groups of individuals. The question may arise here how do individuals interact? What ways or modes are adopted on their part for their interpersonal and social interaction?

The most common and quite essential way or mode in this connection utilized by us for our interaction with others may be known as communication (verbal as well as non-verbal). We may exchange or share with each other our opinions, beliefs, attitudes, feelings and emotions, liking and disliking, interests, needs, motivations, etc. through the language we speak or non-verbal expression we mutually understand. The other important and essential mode employed on our part for our interaction with others is getting engaged with them in one or the other activities – social and professional – carried out with our action organs (such as playing, singing, dancing, working on the projects, household or professional jobs, etc.).

Whatever mode or method may be adopted by us in our interaction with others, it makes us get engaged in one or the other type of social behavior governed through a mechanism known as social exchange in the field of social psychology. What is this social exchange? Let us try to examine its meaning and theories governing such social exchange.

What Is Social Exchange?

The term exchange in relation to our social behavior is used for the type of our social interaction with others that is carried out purely on the principle of “give and take”. We say and do something to others, they respond to it by saying or doing something to us, likewise in return, the process of such give and take (social exchange), then, may be continued or discontinued depending on the will of the parties interacting with each other. The question here may arise what is given and taken on the parts of the interacting individuals engaged in this type of social exchange. It can be in terms of the exchange of:

- The material goods (money, food stuff, clothes or any sort of physical objects and commodities considered good on the part of giver or taker) and non-material goods (feelings and emotions, symbols of respect/disrespect and approval/non-approval).
- The tangible activities (the activities carried out in their physical and real forms – day-to-day

living, social and work situations related activities) and intangible activities (i.e., carrying out conversations in the form of verbal and non-verbal communication).

Social Exchange

Our social interaction with others carried out purely on the principle of “give and take”.

The Social Exchange Theory

While, the phenomenon of social exchange is very much discussed and used in economics and psychology, the roots of its development very much lie in the work and studies in sociology. It is why the attempts for developing a theory to explain the phenomenon of social exchange and its application in our social life and business are known to be initiated by the researchers and thinkers in sociology. What is known as social exchange theory, thus, was first developed by the American sociologist George Homans, who wrote about it in a 1958 essay titled “Social Behavior as Exchange”. Later, sociologists Peter Blau and Richard Emerson further developed the theory. Let us try to know the basic essentials and features of this theory.

- In its essence we may term social exchange theory propounded by Homans as a broad social psychological perspective that attempts to explain how human social relationships are formed, maintained and terminated.
- The theory emphasizes that initiative in the direction of forming social relationships is well taken though our interaction with others in our social life and work situations. In such interactions, individuals are found to get engaged in exchanging one or the other things – material or non-material, tangible or intangible with others. In this connection, Homans wrote, “Social behavior (termed as social exchange) is an exchange of goods, material goods but also non-material ones, such as the symbols of approval or prestige” (Homans, 1958:606), and later in his

writings, social behavior is seen “as an exchange of activity, tangible or intangible, and more or less rewarding or costly, between at least two persons” (Homans, 1961:13). At the intangible level, carrying on a conversation with someone costs you time and energy but can be offset by the rewards gained such as confirmation of your value and development of a relationship.

- The exchange process is a two-sided process going on between two parties involving two actions – one is to give and the other is to get something in return. In this way, in social exchange, there is a lot of mutual dependence on one another. The parties engaged in social exchange rely and depend on each other for the satisfaction of each other’s need by giving and taking something from each other.
- The mutual dependence over each other accompanied with a process of give and take running between them results in making them engaged in one or the other types of social behavior. In this way, the social behavior shown and relationship formed between the individuals or groups is the result of this social exchange process. Actually, our engaging in ongoing social exchanges can create a pattern of trust that facilitates the development of close relationships. When both partners are meeting each other’s personal goals, they create a bond of a balanced, reciprocal and interdependent relationship. In case of its lacking, the things may be found derailing towards the negative outcomes.
- In the task of social exchange going on between the two parties (under social interaction) one party is found to give something of value (incurring cost) for getting something needed in return (reward).
- Rewards can consist of anything material and non-material or tangible and intangible that an individual considers valuable. For instance, getting an increase in salary or promotion, recognition and a sense of security while serving in an establishment or getting fun, friendship, companionship and social support in social relationships. Costs include anything that an

individual spends or invests from his side such as amount of money, time, effort or prestige.

- In their social interaction (leading to form social relations) people generally seek to maximize rewards and minimize cost in their exchange of one or the other things between them.
- According to this theory the continuity of the process of social interaction and formation of a social relationship depends on the personal gains achieved on the part of the interacting parties. If there is some dissatisfaction from both or either of them, the interest for having continuity in this relationship is diminished and the relationship gets terminated. In fact, all individuals living and working in one or the other social situations always try to measure their social interactions and relationships with others against personal gains that they achieve, and the outcomes in the form of gain or loss decide the fate of their present and future relationships.
- Social exchange theory suggests that we essentially subtract the cost incurred from the reward amount for determining how much a relationship is worth. Positive or worthy relationships are those in which the rewards outweigh the costs while negative or unworthy relationships occur when the costs are greater than the rewards.
- The basic formula for deciding the worth or predicting the continuity of a social behavior or relationship in one or the other social situation runs as:

Social behavior or relationship (profitable to continue) = Rewards of interaction – Costs of interaction.

- In any relationship, people weigh the net loss and gains resulted through their incurring costs and achieving rewards. When relationships become unprofitable and risky for them, they decide to end it altogether. As a result, you may decide to give up the company of a casual friend who never, ever opens his wallet when it comes time to settle up a bill for the amount collectively spent by both of you. Similarly, one tries to weigh profits and loss for deciding whether

or not it is worth him sticking around at a company he works for.

- According to social exchange theory, people are found consciously incurring a cost with an expectation of receiving a reward (either intrinsic as love or extrinsic as help with chores) and this reward should produce either profit or at least equity for the continuity of the relationship in a social venture.
- According to Blau (1964:89) there are two main functions served by the process of social exchange going on in our social world. These are: *“to establish bonds of friendship, and to establish super-ordination over others”*. A bond of friendship is established between two individuals when there is some sort of interdependence lying between them in their social interaction and it is accompanied by a satisfactory level of mutual give and take in their social exchange. A situation of having super-ordination in social exchange arises when there is a notable difference between the status and powers of the interacting individuals. Here, one of the parties is dependent on the other which is what prompts the social exchange; that is, a person's personal goal (e.g., getting help on a task for which he is unqualified) can only be met through interaction with another person.

In this way, social exchange theory while based on the framework and principles of economics of investment and return (cost and reward) tries to explain the dynamics of human interactions and relationships from a quite practical and pragmatic angle. The fate of our social interaction, formation of relationships and their maintenance depends on the satisfaction we feel through the net profit (in terms of physical, social and psychological gains) earned out of our investment (in terms of money, time and efforts) vs. rewards or benefits expected in this situation. Where the mutual satisfaction on the part of interacting parties adds to the formation and continuity of formed relationship in an increased way, the dissatisfaction brings deterioration and saying good bye to relationship.

To Sum Up

The term exchange in relation to our social behavior is used for the type of our social interaction with others that is carried out purely on the principle of “give and take” of the material as well non-material things.

The social exchange theory developed by the American sociologist George Homans in 1958 attempts to explain how human social relationships are formed, maintained and terminated. According to this theory initiative for the formation of social relationships, characterized with mutual exchange – giving and taking something from each other – are well taken though our interaction with others. The continuity or discontinuity of such social relationship, however, depends upon the satisfaction or dissatisfaction we feel through the net profit (in terms of physical, social and psychological gains) earned out of our investment (in terms of money, time and efforts) vs. rewards or benefits expected in this situation.

Social Exchange Processes and Their Significance in Our Social Life

The efforts made by us through our social interaction and social exchanges with others set the stage of our engaging in a cycle of social processes for the accomplishment of our goals set for behaving and working in one or the other social situations. Let us try to get acquainted with the nature and role of these social processes in our social life.

Social Exchange Processes – Meaning and Concept

In its word meaning, the term social exchange process or social process stands for the process that is very much social in its nature and functioning. It refers to a social behavior involving a number of activities associated with people's social interaction and social exchange in one or the other social

situations. In the term process itself, an idea of continuity already exists. Accordingly, actually when social interaction or exchange between individuals in social situations becomes continuous and repeated many times and leads to some result, then, it becomes a social process or social exchange process. For understanding the meaning and nature of the term social process or social exchange process, let us take the help of a few important definitions provided in this concern by some eminent thinkers and authors.

Gillin and Gillin (1942): By social processes we mean those ways of interaction which we can observe when individuals and groups meet and establish a system of relationships or what happens when changes disturb already existing modes of life.

Ginsberg (1956): Social processes mean the various modes of interaction between individuals or groups including cooperation and conflict, social differentiation and integration, development, arrest and decay.

Green A.W. (1956): Social processes are merely the characteristic ways in which interaction occurs.

J.H. Fichter (1957): The social process is more than the link between two statuses or roles.

MacIver and Page (1949): Social process is the manner in which the relations of the members of a group, once brought together, acquire a certain distinctive character.

Horton and Hunt (1964): The term social process refers to the repetitive forms of behavior which are commonly found in social life.

Leslie et al. (1980): The repetitive forms of social interaction are called social processes.

An analysis of the preceding definitions may help us to examine the following features and characteristics of social processes or social exchange processes.

- A social process may consist of a number of social interactions and social exchanges of the interacting individuals.
- When the activities related to the social interactions and exchanges of the individuals get repeated, their continuity in certain dimensions

takes the form or shape of a social process. For example, the meeting of a boy and girl on some occasion at some place is termed as social interaction and their saying “hallo” or “hay” is social exchange. However, if such interactions and exchanges between them get repeated and turn into a love affair or marriage, then the whole of their social behavior will be termed as a social process.

- The social interactions and exchanges occurring between individuals and groups after taking a particular shape or distinguished characteristic such as cooperating and competing with each other are covered by the term social processes.
- The presence of the individuals or groups in their individual respective roles or status (e.g., teacher and students in a classroom or two boxers practicing at the boxing site) does not qualify it for being termed a social process. When teacher and students get engaged in a process of steady interaction and social exchange and boxers engage in boxing after challenging each other, they may be termed as going through the respective tasks of social processes.
- Social processes involve various modes of interaction between individuals or groups resulting in positive or negative outcomes such as cooperation and conflicts.
- Social processes help in making the social interaction and exchange between individuals turn into a bond of social relationship as well as an instrument for the social change.

Social Exchange or Social Process

The unique and special ways of social interaction and exchange characterized with their reoccurrence and continuity in the social behavior of the interacting individuals and groups leading them to tie in a bond of social relationship and also working for them as an instrument of social change.

The understanding reached about the meaning and characteristics of the term social processes in the form of the preceding discussion may help us to define it as

those unique and special ways of social interaction and exchange, characterized with their reoccurrence and continuity in the social behavior of the interacting individuals and groups, which may help them to tie in a bond of social relationship and also works for them as an instrument of social change.

Forms or Types of Social Exchange or Social Processes

In the field of sociology and social psychology, the social exchange processes have been broadly classified into two types: (a) associative or conjunctive process and (b) dissociative or disjunctive process.

Associative or Conjunctive Process: These processes are also called the integrative social processes. These are found quite essential for the integration and progress of the community or society. The major types of associative or conjunctive processes are (i) cooperation, (ii) accommodation and (iii) assimilation.

Dissociative or Disjunctive Processes: These social processes are also called disintegrative processes. They work for disintegration and, thus, hinder the growth and development of a community or society. However, in some amount, their presence may contribute directly or indirectly in bringing changes in the social structures and thus saving the society from stagnation and idleness. The most pronounced social processes included in this category are competition, rivalry and conflicts.

In the present chapter here from the list of the earlier cited associative and dissociative social processes we will be focusing on the discussion of the three commonly used social processes known as cooperation, competition and conflict.

ways of social interaction and exchange, characterized with their reoccurrence and continuity in the social behavior of the interacting individuals and groups, which may help them to tie in a bond of social relationship and also works for them as an instrument of social change.

In the field of sociology and social psychology, the social exchange processes have been broadly classified into two types known as associative or conjunctive process (such as cooperation, accommodation and assimilation), very much essential for the integration and progress of the community or society, and dissociative or disjunctive process (such as competition, rivalry and conflicts), known much for their disintegrative tendency of hindering the growth and development of a community or society.

Cooperation

Concept and Meaning

The term 'cooperation' has been derived from two Latin words – 'co' meaning 'together' and 'operary' meaning 'to work'. Hence, cooperation means working together for the achievement of a common goal or goals. In this way, when two or more persons work together to gain common goal, it is called cooperation. There is hardly any field or sector of the human life and society where individuals are not found to demonstrate togetherness and cooperation in their peaceful living, harmoniously adjusting to each other's need and jointly working for the achievement of common goals. Family members cooperate in running the household matters, students share their time and efforts for completing a project, players and teams work jointly for achieving their common targets, and similarly, the workers in production, professionals in business, public officials in police, army and other public services outputs work day and night in an endless variety of beneficial activities in a jointly united way to make possible for all of us an integrated and worth living social life.

To Sum Up

The term social exchange processes or social processes stands for those unique and special

Actually, as we may find, cooperation may be termed as one of the fundamental processes of our social life. It is a form of social process in which two or more individuals or groups work together jointly to achieve common goals for the benefits of all participants. For understanding more about the concept and nature of the term cooperation, let us take the help of some definitions of this term cited by some prominent authors and researchers.

Fairchild (1944): Cooperation is the process by which the individuals or groups combine their effort in a more or less organized way for the attainment of common objective.

A.W.Green (1956): The term cooperation may be defined as the continuous and common endeavor of two or more persons to perform a task or to reach a goal that is commonly cherished.

Merrill and Eldredge (1957): Cooperation is a form of social interaction wherein two or more persons work together to gain a common end.

John Cuber (1959): The term cooperation may be defined as the interaction oriented towards the achievement of a goal.

Leslie et al. (1980): Cooperation involves individuals or groups working together to achieve their individual or collective goals.

Cooperation

A social process or behavior characterized with some specific type of social interaction in which two or more individuals or groups are found to work together to achieve a certain common end or goal.

Analysis of the preceding definitions may lead us to conclude about the meaning and nature of the term cooperation in the following way.

- Cooperation involves two elements: (i) common end or goal and (ii) organized effort. When different persons or groups have the same goals and also realize that individually at their own, they cannot achieve these goals, they work jointly for the fulfillment of these goals.

- Cooperation is an associative process of social interaction which takes place between two or more individuals or groups.
- Cooperation is a conscious process in which individuals or groups have to work consciously and willingly to attain what they aim to achieve in a particular social situation.
- Cooperation is a personal process in which individuals and groups personally meet and work together for a common objective.
- Cooperation is a continuous and common endeavor of two or more persons involving the elements of proper interaction and continuity throughout its beginning till end.
- Cooperation is a universal process in the sense that it is found in all groups, communities, societies and nations.
- Common ends/goals in one or the other social situations can be better achieved by cooperative efforts of the people and it is necessary for the progress of individuals as well as society.
- Cooperation also results from necessity. It is not possible to run many of our tasks, projects, businesses and even household affairs with the proper cooperation of others.

In this way, it is evident from the preceding discussion that *we may term cooperation as one of the forms or types of social processes or behaviors characterized with some specific type of social interaction in which two or more individuals or groups are found to combine their motivations and efforts to achieve certain common ends and purposes.*

Forms or Types of Cooperation

The phenomenon of cooperation may take its various shapes and forms in our world of social life. The various authors and research scholars have provided different classifications for categorizing the types and forms of cooperation. Let us have a look into them one by one.

A. Classification Provided by MacIver and Page

MacIver and Page (1949) have divided cooperation into two main types, namely (i) direct cooperation and (ii) indirect cooperation.

Direct Cooperation: The process of cooperation in which individuals and groups are found to cooperate directly with each other, for performing a single or similar task aimed to serve the common purpose is called direct cooperation. In this mode of cooperation, we may witness the presence of a quite direct relationship existing among individuals and the groups for doing things of their liking and interest on a quite voluntary basis. It permits the people to do like things together because the nature of work itself calls for the participation of individuals or groups in a format of collective togetherness situation. The social processes like playing together, worshipping together, working on a school project together and harvesting the crops together may be cited as some important examples of direct cooperation.

Indirect Cooperation: The process of cooperation in which people are found to do things individually but in doing so indirectly contribute to the achievement of common goal is called indirect cooperation. In this way, here the goal is one or common for all the participants, but they perform specialized functions suiting to their abilities and capacities for its attainment. In its visible form, this mode of cooperation works on the principles of division of labor and specialization possessed for performing one or the other types of functions. So in modern technological age, indirect cooperation may be found to play a quite significant role in fulfilling the need of doing things as per specializations required for performing the various tasks. The type of cooperation visible on the part of the workers and employees of a factory or industry in producing a particular commodity out of the raw material, and building of the flats for a society on the part of a contractor with the help of a variety of workers and technicians may be cited good examples of the term indirect cooperation.

B. Classification Provided by A.W. Green

A.W. Green (1956) has classified cooperation into three main categories: (i) primary cooperation, (ii) secondary cooperation and (iii) tertiary cooperation. Let us examine them.

Primary Cooperation: This type of cooperation, as its name suggests, is more prominently visible in the primary social groups such as the family. In this form of cooperation, each member of the group works for serving the interests of the other group members with little care of serving the interests of their own. Here, each member of the group is conscious of the welfare of all the members of the group and to work for each other's welfare not only gives them a sense of personal satisfaction but also paves the way of indirect realization of their personal needs and interests.

Secondary Cooperation: Secondary cooperation, true to its naming, is found in secondary groups or social institutions like employees of the government services, workers of the industry, members of the trade union and visitors of a temple, etc. In these groups the individuals cooperate with each other by placing their self-interest as a prime consideration while leaving the attainment of some common target at the secondary place. The characteristic features of the modern society – believing in the philosophy of pragmatism and running along with the slogan “self is great” – are very much followed by the cooperation providers in this type of secondary cooperation. Cooperation, here, is neither voluntary nor is it unlimited and self-less as found in primary groups. Everybody is here cooperating with each other for certain compulsions and fulfilling his or her own needs and expectations.

Tertiary Cooperation: This type of cooperation is the characteristic feature of the tertiary groups. These groups are formed and demonstrate their presence under certain compelling circumstances. The members of these groups demonstrate a high degree of cooperation for serving their immediate common interest at a particular time and occasion such as unity and cooperation shown by the passengers of a railway coach for resisting the entry of the new passengers and seat sharing. The attitude of individuals or groups cooperating with each other on this occasion are quite occasional, highly selfish and opportunistic in its nature. We may witness such cooperation on the part of the different political, social and religious groups for maintaining their status, power or existence. As example, here we may

cite the cooperation demonstrated on the part of two or more political parties with different ideologies for unseating a ruling party in the state or center.

C. Classification Provided by Ogburn and Nimkoff

Ogburn and Nimkoff (1940) have divided cooperation into three main types discussed as follows:

General Cooperation: When some individuals or groups are found to cooperate for achieving a common purpose or goal, in general, in one or the other social situations the cooperation rendered by them in this format is termed as general cooperation. Cooperation provided by the community people living in different sectors or wards of a town for making a cultural program of the town a success may be cited as a good example of such cooperation.

Friendly Cooperation: This type of cooperation rendered by the individuals or groups is characterized with the involvement of some type of friendly input in their jointly working and contributing in one or the other types of social situations for the attainment of a common goal. In such type of cooperation, all get a friendly environment for serving their interests and it usually results for them in attaining mutual satisfaction and happiness as a whole. The cooperation seen among individuals or

a group of individuals for celebrating a community event or festival may be cited as a good example of such cooperation.

Helping Cooperation: In the society or community where we live and work, there may arise situations when individuals are found to work jointly in the activities or tasks meant for helping others at the time of their need on the humanitarian ground; the type of cooperation rendered by them on these occasions is named as helping cooperation. The cooperation shown at the time of providing flood relief, and other disaster management tasks performed at the time of social and natural calamities and accidents may be cited as good examples of this type of cooperation.

Needs and Significance of Cooperation

Why do people need to cooperate with each other in one or the other social situations at one or the other time? What role is played by cooperation in the life of the individuals and progress of the society? The following things can be said in response to these queries.

1. Helping in the Satisfaction of Individuals'

Needs and Goals: Cooperation as one of the important means of social exchange process helps individuals living in a community or society to meet each other's physiological and socio-psychological needs. We can fulfill our so many basic and fundamental needs such as food, clothing, shelter, sex and other day-to-day comfort giving needs through a process of give and take or mutual exchange associated with the phenomenon of cooperation. The same also applies with the satisfaction of our psychological needs (e.g., to love and to be loved, giving and getting recognition, showing sympathy and getting sympathy from others, etc.) through the mechanism of cooperation. In addition to the satisfaction of our basic needs, cooperation also does wonders in helping us in the realization of our life goals, motivations and aspirations by taking and giving help to each other at the time of need at one or the other time. Take any sector

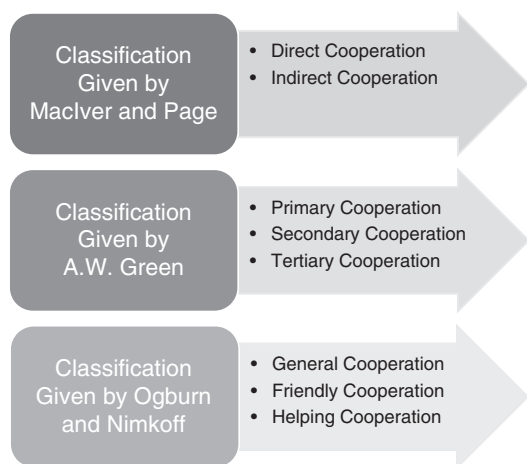


Figure 11.1 Types or Forms of Cooperation

or field of your social life and think a while, would it be possible for you single handedly to reach your destination or respective goals without the active cooperation of other members in society?

2. **Helpful in the Existence and Survival of Human Beings:** We all owe our existence in this world through the courtesy of the cooperation mechanism. It is the cooperation between male and female in the society that has made possible the continuity of the human race through the reproduction and upbringing of the children. Cooperation is the most elementary form of social process without which society cannot function or even exist. The security and protection that is available for us for our living and working have been made possible through the cooperative efforts of all of us paving the way for the establishment of the system of governance and formation of laws, rules and regulations for this purpose. At the time of any crisis – natural or man-made – it is not unusual for us to stand united and work jointly for coming out of the problem. Similarly, a unique type of cooperation is visible from all the corners of a country among its citizens having too much diversity in their opinions and behavior for providing their contribution for the defense of the country and survival of their own.

Tasks Helped by Cooperation

- Satisfying our needs and goals.
- The existence and survival of human beings.
- Making the human being social.
- Maintenance of the social fabric.
- Development and progress of the society.

3. **Helping in Making the Human Being Social and Maintenance of the Social Fabric:** It is the spirit of cooperation that makes human beings social by crossing over their narrow self-interests. They begin to think about the collective gains and happiness for all. How to get on the path

of the individual progress while maintaining the needed social structure and fabric of the society can be well learned and practiced on their part with the help of the spirit of cooperation demonstrated by them in their working and behaving.

4. **Helping in the Development and Progress of Society:** Cooperation in the form of an integrative and associative phenomenon always works for the constructive, creative and developmental activities and goals. It is why a variety of individual and social development and progress may be seen to be engineered and monitored through the cooperative efforts of the people of a community or nation. The saying, “united we stand and divided we fall” tells us how cooperation contributes in a big way towards our progress and development and non-cooperation results in stagnation and downfall. Today what we see as tremendous progress and development in the field of science and technology, agriculture and industry, transport and communication, space science and missions, would not have been possible without active cooperation. In fact, all the progress that mankind has made in the various fields from time to time is credited well to the cooperating spirit of people from all over the globe.

To Sum Up

The term cooperation stands for one of the forms or types of social exchange processes characterized with some specific type of social interaction in which two or more individuals or groups are found to combine their motivations and efforts to achieve certain common ends and purposes.

The phenomenon of cooperation may take its various shapes and forms in our world of social life categorized or classified in various ways such as (i) direct cooperation and indirect cooperation; (ii) primary cooperation, secondary cooperation and tertiary cooperation;

and (iii) general cooperation, friendly cooperation and helping cooperation.

Cooperation is found to play a quite significant role in our social life by helping us in the satisfaction of individuals' needs and goals; in the existence and survival of human beings; in making the human being social and maintenance of the social fabric; and in the development and progress of society.

Competition

Concept and Meaning

Much like cooperation, competition is that form of social exchange process that is considered quite essential for providing needed motivation and hitting target for striving and achieving excellence and success on the part of the involved parties. However here, there are no such united efforts for achieving a common target as visible in cooperation. All individuals/groups taking part in a competitive event or racing for a prized or scarce thing, struggle in their own ways for achieving it somehow with a least consideration of the interests of others. It is why competition is placed in the dissociative or disintegration category of the social processes. For knowing more about its meaning and nature, let us take the help of some well-known definitions of the term competition given by prominent authors and researchers.

Fairchild (1944): Competition is the struggle for the use or possession of limited goods.

Park and Burgess (1921): Competition is the impersonalized struggle among resembling creatures for goods and services which are scarce or limited in quantity.

Horton and Hunt (1964): Competition is the process of seeking to monopolize a "reward toy" surpassing all rivals.

Sutherland et al. (1966): Competition is an impersonal, unconscious and continuous struggle between individuals or groups for satisfaction which, because of their limited supply, all may not have.

Biesanz and Biesanz (1969): Competition is the striving of two or more persons for the same goal which is limited so that all cannot share it.

E.S. Bogardus (1979): Competition is a contest to obtain something which does not exist in quantity sufficient to meet the demand.

Leslie et al. (1980): Competition is the individual and group striving for goals that only one can win.

Competition

A social process in which people are found to strive or struggle with others for achieving the targeted goal by surpassing all rivals.

On the basis of what has been conveyed by the aforementioned definitions *we can understand competition as a type of impersonal, universal, continuous and unconscious social process in which people are found to strive or struggle with others for achieving the desired scarce things or the targeted goal by surpassing all rivals.*

The Characteristic Features of the Process of Competition

The process of competition in its unique form and type of the social processes is known to be attributed with some of the specific characteristic features detailed next.

1. *Competition Springs up Due to the Scarcity or Limitation of Things:* In most cases people or groups of people get engaged in the process of competition due to the scarcity or limitation of the things they want to achieve for the satisfaction of their physiological or socio-psychological needs. As a generalized rule, people compete with each other in a most pronounced form whenever there is an insufficient supply of anything that they desire most. It is insufficient in the sense that demand outturns supply and all cannot have as much of it as they wish. Many times, there is only one prized item, position or

status that two or more persons want to achieve. In this case, there is a tough competition for its attainment that can be possible to only one out of the several.

2. *Competition Is Both Dissociative and Associative in Its Nature and Consequences:* In comparison to other social processes like cooperation and conflict, competition lies in between these two in terms of its nature and consequences in the sense that it has a capability of proving dissociative as well as associative. It is associative or integrative in the sense that no other social process can match it in terms of providing the needed motivation to the individuals or groups for working wholeheartedly for achieving the set target in a competitive event. How the candidates work and struggle for obtaining the desired rank or position, the motivation of doing all this is brought out through the competition organized for this purpose. It remains constructive till the competitors struggle for excelling each other without obstructing or harming the efforts of others, however, once the norms set for the competition are broken, it turns into unruly conflicts and clashes making it highly dissociative and disintegrative in its nature and consequences.
3. *Competition Is Universal:* Competition may be termed as the most universal social processes in the sense that it is found in all societies, whether civilized or uncivilized, rural or urban, traditional or modern in all periods of history and among all classes of people all over the globe. It happens on account of a simple reason that there is no end of the wishes and needs of the individuals living on this earth, but the material or psychological resources available for their satisfaction is quite scarce and limited. There, thus, arises a universal struggle for existence and survival in the form of competing with each other for attaining what all need or wish to achieve.
4. *Competition Is Impersonal:* Take any competitive event in its true form. In this event, individuals may be found to take part in competing with each other for getting something they desire in terms of some object, reward, position or status. They struggle and strive for achieving or attaining a common objective. In this way, here, clearly, the competitors do not compete with each other on a personal level. The attention of all the competitors is fixed on the goal or the reward they aim at. Moreover, at a number of times at different occasions in different fields of life, the competitors while competing with each other do not know one another at all. These are the reasons for calling and considering the competition act as an impersonal affair.
5. *Competition Is an Unconscious Activity:* Competition takes place on the unconscious level in the sense that competitors in most of the cases hardly know each other. Take the case of any competition – competitive examination or test/interview organized for securing the highest marks in the final-examination or getting selected for a course of job – the competitors here may be found to be reasonably conscious of what they are doing, what they want to achieve and how they should struggle for achieving their target but on the other hand, they are not at all conscious of the presence of other competitors. They bother doing their efforts with a least consideration of who their competitors are and what will they do. Hence competition is said to take place mostly on an unconscious level.
6. *It Is Continuous Process:* In a general way, people compete with each other for the satisfaction of their needs or fulfilling their wishes. The sphere and dimensions of these needs and wants always remain in the chain of their continuity. One need or desire in terms of getting wealth, name, glory, power and status when satisfied may give birth to another need or desire for competing with others. It is why the process of competition never comes to an end. It goes continuously throughout one's life span.
7. *Competition Is Always Governed by Norms:* Take the case of any competing event in the fields or spheres of our life. It is always organized and governed through the set rules and norms. All the competitors are required to follow these rules

and norms. In the examination hall, all examinees have to follow the norms of appearing in the examination and surrender their answer sheets to the invigilators at the fixed time. Similarly, at the sport complex, all the players and teams while competing with each other have to abide by the rules and norms of the respective games being played there at that time. In any way, if the rules and norms are violated, it results in conflicts and clashes between the players and teams.

Types and Forms of Competition

Competition, as a universal and continuous social process, is found in all fields and spheres of our social life. In our day-to-day life and social as well as working situations we come across many types or forms of competitions. Like cooperation, the researchers and sociologists have also tried to classify and categorize them in certain forms or types as discussed next.

A. Classifications Provided by Mercer and Wanderer

American sociologists Mercer and Wanderer (1970) have divided competitions going on in the social world into the following four main types.

1. *Pure and Limited Competition:* The competitions visible in our social world can be classified into two distinct types named as pure and limited. Pure competition is an all-out open competition that is carried out among the participant competitors with no string of cultural restrictions. However, in its practical sense, no competition exists in such pure wild form. It is said to be more abstraction than reality. On the opposite side, there stands a type of competition termed as limited competition. In this type of competition, competitors are engaged in competing with each other with some essential limitations or restrictions imposed on them for their competing. Actually, this form of competition between the individuals or groups demands some sort of cooperation on the part of the competitors in the shape of their abiding
2. *Personal and Impersonal Competition:* In one of its forms the competitions may be divided into two main types known as personal and impersonal competition. Personal competition is the competition in which one or the other types of personal elements are involved in competing with others. Here competitors know each other and take the competition at their personal level by making the achievement of a prized objective (such as getting 1st position in the class, having competition with one or two players for getting selected in the nationals) as a matter of their own personal gain or loss and even the question of their life and death. Such type of competition, in its excess, may turn into harmful personal rivalries, conflicts and clashes if not checked in a proper way. Contrary to personal competition, impersonal competition is not a personal battle. Here nothing is personal on the part of the competitors. They have least concern or conscious about the personal identity of the competitors. Their whole attention is to try their best for obtaining the common object by competing with others whosoever they may be by following the set norms of the competition.
3. *Absolute and Relative Competition:* The competitions occurring in our social world may also be classified as absolute and relative competitions. Absolute competition is the competition in which individuals and groups compete for a thing which is scarce or the only one available to achieve. The competition for the purchase of a property or building is absolute in

the sense there is only one competitor who will be successful in getting it through the open auction. Similarly, in the competition for the vacancy advertised to the post of four clerks in an establishment, only four competitors will get the chance, and others will be absolutely denied this opportunity. Here the outcome of the competition is one sided and total, only the successful competitors get the scarce things or positions. On the other hand, in the relative competition, the result of the competition is not one sided, it may get shared among a number of competitors. Take the case of Miss World or Miss Universe competition. Here the awards are shared among the different competitors in the capacity of crown winner, 1st runner up, 2nd runner up and other subsequent winners relatively on the basis of merit scores earned by them in the contest. In the entrance tests and examinations also, the 1st, 2nd, 3rd and other merit positions are earned on the basis of relative scores earned by them in that test or examination.

4. *Creative and Non-creative Competition*: Some competitions are termed as the creative competition in comparison to others termed as non-creative. The difference between these two lies in the capability or non-capability of producing some creative or new positive output on the part of individuals or groups in the attainment of the objective in their competition with each other. For instance, according to Mercer and Wanderer (1970), when traders compete with each other for attracting customers, they can inadvertently expand the market. In attracting customers, new products are produced with high qualities as well as of high aesthetic value. In this way, the competition becomes truly creative and productive of desired social values.

B. Classification Provided by Max Weber

The famous German sociologist Max Weber (1991) has divided competitions into two broad categories known as regulated and non-regulated competition. Let us examine them.

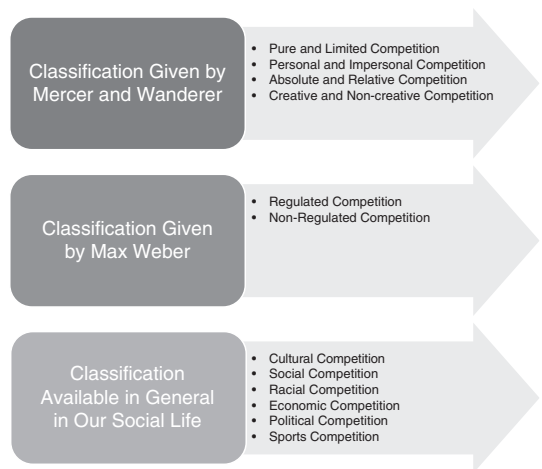


Figure 11.2 Types or Forms of Competition

Regulated competition is the competition which is essentially regulated in its organization and functioning. Here all the competitors are found to compete with each other for the attainment of a common goal or object by following some rules or norms prescribed or mutually agreed for this purpose. On account of being conducted through the set rules and norms, a regulated competition held between the competitors goes on quite smoothly allowing all the competitors struggling for the attainment of a common target. *Unregulated competition*, on the other hand, is that competition which true to its naming is held and competed on the part of competitors with no set rules or norms for the purpose. The object is common, and the competitors are free to choose their ways and methods (with no strings or restrictions imposed on them) of competing with others for its achievement on their part. In its natural and usual way, such unregulated competitions go on in their own ways resulting often in bitter clashes and conflicts in our communities and societies, institutions and work situations.

C. Classifications Available in General in the Various Fields and Spheres of Our Social Life

In addition to the ways of classification mentioned earlier we may also categorize or divide the

competition in various types or forms such as cultural, social, racial, economic, political and sports competition associated with one or the other field and spheres of our social life. Let us examine them.

1. *Cultural Competition:* Cultural competition is the competition existing among two or more cultures for establishing their superiority over each other. It has been the way of living life on the part of the followers of different cultures and religions in the different parts of the globe at different times of the human history. In our country, there has been quite a strong wave of competition between the Aryan and Non-Aryan cultures (e.g., Dravian, Mongolian, Mughal, Christian) from time to time resulting in a typical form of cultural diversity in our present society. It has also resulted in conflicts and clashes particularly in relation to the following of different faiths and religions.
2. *Social Competition:* The individuals and groups in a particular community and society are found to compete with each other for striving and struggling for attaining some or the other social goals such as high social status, popularity or name and fame in their community or society. It has been present in the societies all over the globe from the quite earlier ancient times. In its changed structure, it has been the most characteristic feature of our modern society. At every moment and periods of our life we always remain conscious of our social prestige and status and thus remain busy for its attainment or maintenance by getting into competition with others by refining our talent, capacities and abilities for the purpose.
3. *Racial Competition:* Much like cultural competition, racial competition is the type of competition found among different races of the world for establishing their supremacy over others. The competition between blacks and whites in the USA and South Africa is a good example of such racial competition. In Germany, once its ruler Hitler made use of the sentiments of such racial competition by declaring that the German race has been made to rule all over the races of the world.
4. *Economic Competition:* In this type of competition individuals and groups compete for gaining economic supremacy over each other. It is visible in the economic field and carried out through efforts made on the part of individuals or groups for the attainment of material goods and facilities for good living or raising their social status on the local and broader level. Competition for getting a job, competing for promotion and rise of salary, competition for the expansion of business and marketing of a product by the producer of some material goods are examples of such economic competition. However, we know that there is no end of one's wishes to acquire wealth and other material facilities and consequently the competition in the economic field also knows no limits. The individuals and business establishments, thus, may be seen to engage in such a blind race of economic competition that eventually turns in establishing monopoly of a few at the local, national or international levels with the exploitation of others who cannot stand much before them in such competition.
5. *Political Competition:* This type of competition is associated with the political ambitions of the individuals or groups for establishing their supremacy in the political field. For this purpose, individuals try to join different political parties, assign or associate them with certain political ideology, work and campaign for the expansion and victory of their political party in the elections for obtaining political power and establish the superiority of their own and their party over others. The countries play politics, bind themselves in certain types of agreements and treaties such as NATO, for forming a united front to compete politically with the rival nations for gaining supremacy.
6. *Sports Competition:* Such type of competition is visible in the field of games and sports (organized or unorganized) between the participants – individuals and teams at the local, regional, national and international levels. The scope and field of such competition is quite wide and

diversified as it covers all types of physical activities, games and sports played by human beings all over the globe.

Role and Functions of Competition

Competition, as said earlier in this chapter, is a social process that may be characterized as integrative as well as disintegrative in its nature and consequences. Accordingly, it can play both positive as well as negative roles in exercising its functions in our social life. Let us try to discuss them.

Positive Role and Functions of Competition

The positive role and functions of competition in our social life can be summarized as follows.

1. *Helping Individuals in Meeting Their Needs and Desires:* In our social world, there are things which are quite scarce but are more needed on the part of the people for the satisfaction of their physiological and socio-psychological needs and wants. Demand is scaling the supply in many areas. Accordingly, it is quite natural to have a shortage of employment or positions in one or the other private or public sectors. The competition opportunities available for the individuals in this regard make them hopeful for the fulfillment of their wishes in a properly fair way by doing their best in struggling and striving for the purpose. Many of the individuals, thus, are very much helped by the phenomenon of competition in the realization of their needs and wants. Moreover, by utilizing competition as a mode and means, we may protect the individuals from direct conflicts and clashes for achieving the scarce things and thus may secure a solution to the problem of limited supply and unlimited demand of goods in a peaceful way.
2. *Allotment of Right Individual to Proper Place in a Right Way:* Individuals differ from each other in relation to the possession of abilities and capacities of performing the task related to one or the other social and professional areas. With the help of means and measures employed for providing opportunities to compete for places and positions in the respective social or professional fields it becomes quite easy to place the right person judiciously to the proper places. Competition helps in distinguishing and determining who can do better in the respective fields and who can do justice for being selected for a particular job, status or position in society. Thus, properly fitting the round pegs in the round holes and square pegs in the square holes is possible with the help of the phenomenon of competition.
3. *Proving a Good Source of Motivation to Go Ahead in Life:* You have the ability and strength to do a job or do the needed hard work for earning wealth or status in a particular area; the pushing needed and opportunities provided for this purpose can be properly possible in a society where there lies a democratic system in which to compete and excel in the desired fields. Actually, competition opportunities always prove a constant source of motivation to the peoples of all cadre and social status to excel or to obtain recognition or to win an award in one or the other social and professional areas. The practice of organizing contests and awarding prizes and scholarships to those who occupy the few top position on the merit is specially meant not only for providing the needed reinforcement to them but also to work as a good motivational source for others to come forward for striving to excellence.
4. *Helpful in the Development and Progress of Society:* The phenomenon of competition, has a great potential to throw a challenge for the individuals, societies and nations to increase their strengths and capabilities for keeping them in the race of economic, social, industrial, scientific and technological progress at the regional and international level. The progress and development visible on this account all around the globe owes much of its glory to the practice of competition. The type of advances and progress going on in space science,

artificial intelligence and robot technology in different countries at present may be cited as a good example of the outcome of the phenomenon of competition. Moreover, in a generalized way, in our common day-to-day life, social sectors and work areas, competition has helped us in allotting the right persons to the different assignments. It has naturally resulted in making use of the best human resources and talents available for the purpose of the required progress and development of the society and nation. The continuation of competition after entering the field further pushes the talented and capable people to remain conscious of providing their best in their respective work domains, thus making the wheel of progress and development of the society moving on with the required speed.

Negative Role and Functions of Competition

Competition has its both positive as well as negative sides for affecting the welfare of the individual and the society. We can expect good positive outcomes discussed earlier through the courtesy of the competition phenomenon. However, all of such advantages and benefits derived for competition can only be possible if the process of competition remains within its limits and is carried out in all its fairness and positive spirit. However, when derailed, it can drift heavily on the negative side giving birth to a number of negative outcomes briefed here.

1. *Resulting in the Sheer Wastage and Stagnation of Resources:* Unfair and unreasonable use of competition may result in a high degree of wastage and stagnation of the resources in the society. In a joint family we may see that the family members buy the things they don't need and consume more in competition to other members causing a great deal of wastage of the material and economic resources. Similarly, in competing with others people are found to spend more on their pomp and show resulting in a lot of economic wastage. In addition, an unreasonable competition among individuals or groups

may also result in stagnation, as no one is ready to cooperate with others and leave one's wrong course of actions.

2. *Causing Great Inequalities and Injustice in Society:* Unlimited and unrestricted competition in society may provide too much power and supremacy to a few ones at the cost of others. They may monopolize the resources while leaving others to remain dependent on them for the satisfaction of their needs and aspirations. In the blind race of unfair competition, the powerful and status holders become more and more wealthier and powerful leaving others quite behind in this race to the extent of getting them starved or deprived of their basic needs. In fact, most of what is visible in our society and world community in the form of too much inequality and injustice may be termed as the outcome of the unrestricted cut throat competitions of one or the other kinds prevalent among them.
3. *Creating Psychological and Emotional Problems:* Unhealthy and unfair competition is responsible for creating one or the other types of psychological and emotional problems to the participant individuals or groups. Due to some or the other bitterness creeping during the competition, competitors may develop unfriendly and unfavorable attitudes towards one another. The failure and the experience of losing face in the public may make them fearful, anxious and frustrated. In some cases, it may lead to neurosis and competition phobia. On the other hand, it may also have a possibility of turning some competitors into rebellious and rule breaking personalities. They pick up the habit of not following any rules and norms while competing with others in the social life or business field causing serious harms to the integrated fabric of the society.
4. *Competition May Lead to Conflicts and Clashes:* The unfairness, partiality and rules breaking in competition may develop a quite unhealthy bitterness among the competitors. It may result in drawing a deep gulf of a wide variety of differences between them. They begin to suspect

and doubt every step of their competitors and thus always remain in the state of conflict and clashes with one another. They begin to employ quite under handed methods for harming each other. Business rivals, for example, may try to ruin and destroy the business of each other and professionals may think about down grading the image of their competitor colleagues before the seniors or public in general. In the big picture, the conflicts and clashes among competitors many times may take the shape of group fighting, communal clashes and spoiling of relationships between nations in international scenarios.

Therefore, we must try to learn the lesson from the bitterness and harm caused by the unfairness and unhealthy competition. Where on one hand, competitions should always be encouraged for harnessing the various individual and social advantages available from it, it should be kept under proper control by following the needed rules and norms and concentrating fully on the attainment of a target on our part by increasing our competency rather than planning for creating obstacles in the path of the other competitors.

To Sum Up

Competition is that form of social exchange process in which people are found to strive or struggle with others for achieving the desired scarce things or the targeted goal by surpassing their rivals.

Competition is attributed with some specific characteristic features such as: springing up due to the scarcity or limitation of the things; proving dissociative and associative in its nature and consequences; demonstrating its universality, impersonality, unconsciousness and continuity in its functioning; and governed always by norms.

In its attempt to classify and categorize competitions, American sociologists Mercer and Wanderer have divided competitions into the

four main types: pure and limited competition; personal and impersonal competition; absolute and relative competition; and creative and non-creative competition. On the other hand, the German sociologist Max Weber has divided competitions into two broad categories known as regulated and non-regulated competition. In addition to it, attempts have also been made to classify competitions in the categories like cultural, social, racial, economic, political and sports competition.

Competition can play both positive as well as negative roles in exercising its functions in our social life. Here, in terms of playing its positive roles, competitions may be found to exercise the functions like: helping the individuals in meeting their needs and desires, allotment of right individual to proper place in a right way, proving a good source of motivation to go ahead in life, and helpful in the development and progress of the society.

Regarding its negative roles competition can be found to exercise the functions such as: resulting in the sheer wastage and stagnation of resources, causing great inequalities and injustice in the society, creating psychological and emotional problems, and leading to conflicts and clashes.

Conflict

Concept and Meaning

When cooperation turns into non-cooperation, obstructing others rather than helping them in their tasks and competition turn into apprehension in the minds and bitterness in the hearts of the competitors for one another, then the social process and social interaction between the individuals and groups is said to take the form and shape of a socio-psychological phenomenon named as conflict. In all its forms and shapes the social process or behavior known as conflict is essentially a dissociative or disintegrative social process in the sense that it always leads

to disintegration proving harmful to the individuals and groups in conflict. For understanding about the meaning and nature of the term conflict in a more appropriate way, let us take the help of some well-known definitions given by the eminent sociologists and authors on this account.

Park and Burgess (1921): Conflict evokes the deepest emotions and strongest passions and enlists the greatest concentration of attention and of effort.

MacIver (1931): Conflict is an activity in which men contend against one another for any objective.

Gillin and Gillin (1948): Conflict is the social process in which individuals or groups seek their ends by directly challenging the antagonist by violence or threat of violence.

K. Davis (1949): Conflict is a codified form of struggle.

Lewis Coser (1956): A struggle over values and claims to status, power and resources in which the aims of the opponent are to neutralize, injure or eliminate their rivals.

A.W.Green (1956): Conflict is the deliberate attempt to oppose, resist or coerce the will of another or others.

J.H. Fichter (1957): Conflict is the social process in which individual or groups seek their ends by directly challenging the antagonist by violence or threat of violence.

Horton and Hunt (1964): Conflict may be defined as a process of seeking to monopolize rewards by eliminating or weakening the competitors.

Kenneth Thomas (1992): Conflict is a process that begins when one of the parties in interaction perceives that another has frustrated or is about to frustrate one of his needs or concerns.

On the basis of what has been conveyed by the aforementioned definitions *we can understand conflict as a type of social process in which individuals or groups, after feeling that others are heavily coming in their way, consciously and deliberately resort to some emotionally charged negative activity such as violence or direct attempt to harm or weaken the opponents with a sole motive of achieving their desired ends in any way.*

The Characteristic Features of the Conflict Process

Socio-psychologists and researchers have tried to conclude the following things about the characteristic features of the process of conflict.

1. *It is a Universal Process:* Conflict, much like cooperation and competition, is an ever-present process. It exists at all places and all times in all sectors of our social life throughout the globe. In the interaction and social exchanges between individuals and groups, there arise situations and circumstances before them to have clashes in their interests at one or the other points and particularly while contesting and contending for some scarce things or common objective. These situations and circumstances are also universal; they may occur in the life of the individuals or groups all over the globe at all times. Conflicts in our societies have, therefore, been present from the time immemorial and will exist in all times to come.
2. *Unlike Competition, Conflict Is Specifically Personal:* When competitions are held under specified rules and norms, they allow all the competitors to struggle for the realization of the common objective according to their own ability and capacity. However, when these become personalized, centering only on one's personal interests with no care of norms and others' welfare, these are turned into conflicts. Here, instead of putting the attention and energy into the realization of the goal, they are shifted to harm or even eliminate the opposite party from the scene of the competition. Since the conflicting

Conflict

A type of social exchange process or behavior in which people, after feeling pressure from their opponents, deliberately resort to some emotionally charged negative behavior for inflicting harm or weakening the opponents with a sole motive of achieving their desired ends in any way.

parties personally know each other, the process becomes quite personal and as a result, both the parties, locked in conflict, get engaged in harming each other instead of concentrating on the realization of their goal or objective.

3. *It Is a Conscious and Deliberate Act:* In getting engaged in the social behavior known as conflict the involved parties are quite conscious of their conflicting behavior. Here one individual or group makes a deliberate attempt for opposing and resisting the will or causing harm and injury to another. While in conflict, attention of each is fixed on the rival quite consciously for teaching him a lesson rather than minding their own business of attaining the goal. In this way, every conflict on the social scene represents a quite conscious and deliberate attempt on the part of the involved parties to harm or cause loss to another in some or the other ways.
4. *Unlike Cooperation and Competition, It Is an Intermittent Process:* Unlike cooperation and competition processes, the process of conflict lacks continuity. It is occasional and intermittent. Two parties cooperating and competing well with each other may be found to get indulged in conflicting behavior all of a sudden. Most often, the conflict between parties also subsides as quickly as it erupted. If the conflict becomes continuous, no society can sustain itself. Therefore, its intermittent nature also proves a boon to the individuals and the society as a whole.
5. *It Is a Highly Emotional and Violence Ridden Act:* The highly surcharged atmosphere loaded with a number of negative emotions of intensive speed is a quite known birth place of the conflicts arising in the interaction and competitions among human beings. Quite suddenly, minor and ordinary looking conflicts are found to take the shape of quite violent behavior on the part of the involved parties. Such uprising of violence in the behavior of involved parties not only proves quite detrimental to the interests of both the parties but also proves quite harmful to the growth and well-being of the society.
6. *It Is Loaded With a Lot of Disintegrative or Dissociative Functions:* As a process, conflict in its

nature and consequences may be termed as a highly disintegrative and dissociative process. In it functioning it is the anti-thesis of cooperation. Here instead of providing assistance to others for achieving their ends, all sorts of hindrance or obstacles are placed on their path by resorting to violent means. Conflict as a disintegrative process persuades the competitors to make use of all sorts of fair and foul means at their disposal including elimination or weakening of their rival competitors in the pursuit of the common goal. Here competitors may be found to engage in a deliberate attempt to oppose, resist or coerce the will of their opponents as well intentionally harm them through a lot of violence shown towards them.

8. *On Its Positive Side, It Can Work as an Instrument of Social Change and Reconstruction:* Besides a lot of things lying on the debit side of the process of conflicts, including causing loss and harm to the interests and welfare of the competitors and society as a whole, there are some things that may be quoted to fall on its credit side. The mentionable ones are (i) stiffening the morale and promoting the cohesion and solidarity of the group; (ii) raising the status and position of the dominant individual or group; (iii) bringing change in the ideology, value systems and social structure; and (iv) persuading the members of the society to think about the ways and means for reducing conflicts and clashes between the competitors.

Causes of Conflict

Conflict is a quite conscious and deliberate process. It may happen at any time in all societies and social sectors around the globe. Although it is a universal process, its causes vary from individual to individual, group to group and from time to time. Accordingly, it is regarded to be caused on account of the interaction of a number of biological and socio-psychological causes or factors as discussed next.

Biological Causes

In the category of biological causes, we may consider the following factors responsible for the eruption of

conflicts among individuals and groups working in society.

1. *Inborn and Innate Aggressive Tendency:* According to some thinkers like Freud and other physiological psychologists, some people are born with aggressive and hostile tendencies making them engage in conflicts in their later social behavior.
2. *The Need to Struggle for Existence and Survival:* There are limitations and scarcity of the material objects and physical facilities in our social world in comparison to the needs and wants of the people for their attainment. When demands outplay supply, it is but natural for the needy ones to get into struggles and conflicts with other aspirants. They think it quite essential for their survival and existence.
3. *Individual Differences:* No two individuals are exactly alike. They differ from each other not only in relation to their somatic structure and physiological conditions but also with respect to their attitudes, aspirations, ideologies, values and interest. Such differences in individuals may create a wide gulf between their ways of thinking, feeling and doing one or the other things causing a lot of maladjustment and possibilities of confrontation and clashes with one another.

Socio-psychological Causes

In the category of socio-psychological causes responsible for creating conflicts among individuals and groups we may include the following factors or attributes.

1. *Socio-cultural Differences:* One of the major causes for the eruption of conflicts among individuals and groups in our society is linked with a lot of differences lying between the social living and cultural traditions of the people. Our communities and societies all over the world remain disintegrated and strained in their relationships at their bitterest on account of belonging to different castes

or ethnic groups, following different religions and believing in one or the other faiths or philosophies of life. The separation tendencies and conflicts may also be clearly visible among the people and groups on account of the boundary lines drawn between them on the basis of urban-rural division, public and private establishments, local vs. immigrants, speaking of language, etc.

2. *Social Changes:* In our societies nothing is permanent. It remains changing with the change in time. Individuals and society as a whole need to adapt themselves to these rapid changes in order to keep pace with them for individual and social progress. When some individuals or a particular segment of the society does not change along with ongoing changes in the society, it may create a serious cultural lag leading to mutual confrontation between those who welcome or resist these changes. The conflicts visible in the ideology of the old and new generation is a good example of the role of social changes in the creation of conflict.
3. *Wide Gap in Demand and Supply:* When there is an unreasonable gap between the demand and supply of certain commodities at one or the other times in society, then everybody wants to compete for or obtain the scarce things by hook and crook. The desire or competition for obtaining undersupplied or scarce things in society, after taking quite a bit more fierce form, is found to be converted into conflicts between the competitors.
4. *Economic Disparity:* The distribution of economy in a reasonable way among individuals and groups is essential for their proper and harmonious living in the society. There erupts a lot of tension and conflict in the societies where there becomes too much disparity between the economic earnings, and socio-economic status of the individuals or groups living in those societies. It may take the form of a class struggle between poor and rich or haves and have-nots of those belonging to these societies.

5. *Clashes of Mutual Interests:* A very big cause of the mutual rivalries and conflicts between the individuals and groups in society is the clashes of their mutual interests. The hoarders always want to monopolize the purchase and sale of the commodities in the market and it can make them engage in conflicts with the producers and consumers of these commodities. Similarly, we can observe the conflicts and clashes between the labor class and the owners of the factories as both parties are locked in the struggle of serving their own interests.

Types or Forms of Conflicts

Conflicts between the individuals and groups in the society at one or the other time in one or the other social situations may take a variety of forms and shapes. Sociologists and authors have tried to classify them in their own ways in different types. Let us have a glimpse at them.

A. Classification Provided by MacIver and Page

MacIver and Page (1949) have distinguished two fundamental types of conflict named as direct and indirect conflict discussed as follows.

Direct Conflict: In this mode, the conflict is direct and face to face. Here it is free for all and accordingly all fair and foul means are adopted by the competitors to attain the goal even to the extent of intentionally harming and injuring or eliminating each other. Direct conflict may be further bifurcated into (i) less violent and (ii) more violent.

Direct conflict in its less violent form is less harmful. Any sort of litigation and propagandistic activities may be cited as examples of such less violent conflict. The other form of direct conflict (e.g., war, riots, etc.) involving more violence is quite dangerous and harmful not only to the involved parties but to society as a whole.

Indirect Conflict: In this mode of conflict, confrontation or conflict is indirect. Here the concerned individuals or groups involved in the conflict do not

directly impede the efforts of one another for seeking a common end but nevertheless intentionally engage in doing the same through indirect means. Accordingly, in indirect conflict efforts are made by individuals or groups to frustrate the efforts of their opponents in an indirect manner. In villages, two parties indulge in filing police complaints and fighting court cases against each other till their lands are sold.

B. Classification Provided by George Simmel

According to the German sociologist George Simmel (1955) there are four major forms of conflict named as war, feud, litigation and conflict of impersonal ideals. Let us examine them.

War: War is a type of direct conflict. When all the efforts to resolve the conflict between two countries fail, war finally breaks out as the last resort for resolving the conflict between them.

Feud: Feud is also a type of direct conflict. Like war, its scope and dimension is not too wide; it is limited to some factions of the individuals of a society. That is why it is also termed as a factional strife. It takes place among the members of the society turning it as an intra-group affair rather than the inter-group.

Litigation: Litigation is a form of conflict which is judicial in nature. It is found to occur when both or one of the parties involved in some type of conflict or dispute over one or the other things resort to legal means in the court of law for finding a solution. To initiate a litigation, in a court of law on the part of two parties, taking possession of a piece of land may be cited as an example of such type of conflict.

Conflict of Impersonal Ideals: It is a conflict of an impersonal nature when it is carried on by the individuals or groups not for achieving personal gains but for some ideals or values. Here the parties involved in the conflict try to justify their actions for maintaining some values or ideals. While fighting elections, when different political parties try to show that how the ideals of their parties are better than others, it may become a point of conflict and clashes among them.

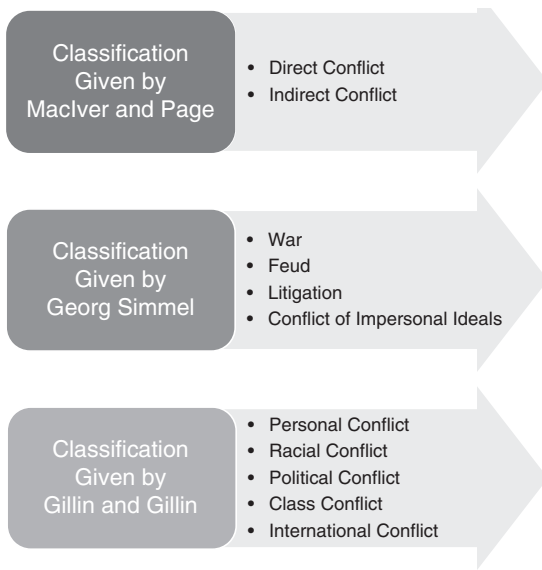


Figure 11.3 Types or Forms of Conflicts

C. Classification Provided by Gillin and Gillin

In classifying conflicts, sociologists Gillin and Gillin (1948) have mentioned five types of conflict – personal, racial, class, political and international. Let us examine them.

Personal Conflict: Personal conflict is a conflict of personal nature that takes place on the personal level between two persons within the same group. Here each person involved in the conflict tries to achieve a common goal for serving his own interest by adopting any method fair or foul for this purpose. The conflict among the family members for obtaining greater share in an ancestral property and the intended candidates for obtaining a particular job may be cited as good examples of such personal conflicts.

Racial Conflict: Racial conflict occurs between the different races of the world. They may erupt any time in any intensity on account of one or the other reasons. The one of the common reasons behind these racial conflicts is to call the other races inferior and establish one's supremacy over them. The black-white conflict in many parts of the world may be cited as a good example of this type of conflict.

Political Conflict: Political conflicts occur between the individuals and parties contesting in the political field for winning election, establishing their ideologies or gaining status and power. A fierce conflict in the form a political battle may be witnessed in Indian democracy often when attempts are made by the opposition to destabilize a ruling party by feeding the game of defection.

Class Conflict: The class conflict is a conflict between two classes or categories of the society made on the basis of economic status (i.e., poor and rich), residential status (i.e., rural and urban), employment status (i.e., employers and employees), educational status (educated and illiterate) and ruling conditions (e.g., the exploiters and the exploited). It is a universal phenomenon present at all the times all over the world. The different segments of the society differentiated and categorized in different classes remain in the state of conflict on account of the clashes of the mutual interests and ideologies.

International Conflict: International conflict is the conflict going on between two or more countries on the international level. The clashes of the interests and desire for establishing supremacy may be cited as two main reasons behind these conflicts. The intention to spread one's ideology (i.e., capitalism, Marxism and fascism), religion or faith; capturing the trade market or natural resources; or grabbing others' land, etc. may be other reasons for initiating conflict on the part of one nation with others.

Role and Functions of Conflict

Being included in the disintegrative and dissociative category of social exchange processes, it is quite natural for conflicts to be designated as evil and damaging to the well-being of the conflicting parties as well as to the society as a whole. However, like competitions, the conflicts between individuals and groups also perform a variety of positive functions. Let us think over their positive as well negative roles or functions ahead.

Positive Role and Functions: The positive role played or functions served by the conflicts may be discussed as follows.

1. *Redefining the Values and Norms*: Quite often there is a clash of values and norms lying behind the conflicts among individuals and groups in the society. There is a generation gap that may bring the young generation in conflict with their elders. However, each party after having some initial clash usually comes to a stage of redefining the value and norms to be observed in the future in their social interaction and exchange. Similarly, we may see conflict of values and interests in the working places between masters and workers, employees and employers or even teachers and the taught in the educational institutions which may end in the establishment of new values and norms for working and smoothing relations among them in a proper way.
2. *Restructuring the Social System*: It is in conflict where the people or groups find opportunity to express their opinion and come forward for bringing change in the existing social system. The differences of opinion in their sharp presence pave the way for the urgent discussion and settlement of the pending issues and it helps in the creation of something new needed for the required progress and development of the society. In fact, as Cooley (1902) observes, "Conflict of some sort is the life of society and progress emerges from a struggle in which each individual, class or institution seeks to realize its own ideals of good." A new building emerges on the debris of the old, and a new social system gets its shape by the demolition of the old through the conflicting struggles. The credit, thus, for restructuring the society goes to conflict as it prevents the ossification of the social system by exerting pressure for innovation and creativity.
3. *Promoting the Unity and Cohesion of the Group*: Where the conflict between the out-groups brings too much disintegration, dissociation and devastation to each other, it surprisingly proves a great boon for promoting the unity, solidarity and fellowship within the group. When there is a common danger for the members of a group from the other group under confrontation, then the task of accepting this challenge becomes a common task for each member of the group.

Accordingly, each confrontation situation of this nature raises the morale of the in-group for providing a united front to the out-groups. It may be clearly witnessed when conflict with an enemy country makes the whole nation to respond with a great cohesion and solidarity on its part. "Inter-group conflict", to quote Ogburn and Nimkoff (1940), "is a potent factor in promoting inter-group cooperation."

4. *Enhancing Intimacy in Relations*: Conflict has a magic effect in bringing peace and cementing the sore relations. In conflict both the parties enjoy the full opportunity to express their bitterness in words and deeds. It helps in relieving them from the emotional stress and inducing an environment of peace for the development of mutual understanding of each other. Accordingly, in a number of cases, conflicts may be found to act as a cementing force for the establishment of intimate and friendly relations among the individuals and groups that were involved in a harmful conflict until a short time ago. For example, the outcome of the conflict between lovers, relatives, friends and married couples leads to the establishment of relations which happen to be more sweetening and intimate after confrontation than before.

Negative Role and Functions

The negative role played and adverse functions served by conflicts may be summarized as follows.

1. *Conflict Results in Damage, Destruction and Annihilation*: Conflict in its all forms – mild and heavier – costs dearly to the involved parties. They have to suffer from one or the other type of losses and damages by confronting each other in a bitter struggle for attaining a common goal. Moreover, quite often as Young and Mack (1959) write "at its most rudimentary level, conflicts result in the elimination or annihilation of the opponent". You yourself imagine now how dangerous and harmful the more intensive form of conflict may prove to the well-being of

the individuals and society. The bloody clashes resulted through the conflicts or war going on between the countries may bring incalculable damage and immeasurable suffering to the people and the society. In this way, conflicts in all their forms are responsible for causing damage and loss to the involved parties in a number of ways.

2. *Conflict Disrupts the Unity and Cohesiveness of the Group:* Conflict is regarded as the number one enemy of cooperation, unity and cohesiveness among the members of a group or society. Where there is conflict and clashes among the members of social group, there, we can't imagine the presence of any cooperation and togetherness for achieving a common goal. Actually, in such a conflicting environment, the attention and energy of the group members get concentrated and directed wholly to harm and weaken the opponents rather than to care for attaining the common group goal. Similarly, conflicts among the different groups or sectors of society also cause a great harm and damage to the unity, cohesiveness and solidarity of the society or nation as a whole. The disintegration and differentiation created in the society or nation then through such conflicts may prove a great obstacle in their progress and development besides weakening its defense against the knowing and unknowing dangers.
3. *Conflict Causes a Lot of Psychological Disturbance and Moral Loss to the Involved Individuals:* The conflict, in its dissociative and disintegrative nature, proves quite costly to the conflicting individuals in the sense that it causes them uncalculated psychological harm. They give up their mental peace and may fall victim of revengeful attitude, suspicion, guilt, fear, apprehension, depression, etc. resulting in a heavy loss of their mental health and psyche condition. Moreover, in the conflicting situation all feel unsafe and alone for taking the appropriate decision and facing one or the other problems. It also affects their morale and struggling stamina for obtaining what

is essentially needed or aspired at one or the other time. Puzzled and confused on account of the conflict-ridden circumstances, they may be forced or tempted to follow the immoral path and break the code of conduct and social norms for winning over their opponent or getting ahead or serving their interests.

Techniques Used for the Resolution of the Conflict

Conflicts, despite how necessary they may appear for the reorganization and restructuring of the social systems, actually prove quite unhealthy and damaging for the well-being of the individuals and the society. These should be resolved as early as possible. Sociologists and psychologists have tried to suggest the following techniques for the resolution of the conflict arising between two parties.

1. *Introduction of Humor:* Humor is a great medicine and a sure shot for extinguishing the fire ignited through an emotionally charged environment of conflict. It can also prove a great medicine for relieving the involved parties from the tension and stress created through the struggle and clashes experienced in the conflict. Therefore, some attempts should always be initiated by someone present on the scene for the introduction of humor for diverting attention of the conflicting parties to something other than reacting and responding to the verbal and motor duel.
2. *Introducing Variety and Change in the Existing Situation:* Conflicts, many times, are the consequential product of momentary or situational based reactions and responses of the involved parties. If somehow a change is brought out in the existing situation, then conflicting parties may be helped in leaving the vicious conflicting scene. When two parties have a duel over an issue, then the change of topic may save them from the aggravation of the conflict.
3. *Resorting to Social Distance or Avoidance:* For the management of conflict arising between

two parties, it remains quite beneficial on their part to suspend for the time being their interaction and social exchange, maintain necessary social distance and avoid the conversation and actions, particularly associated with the thorny issues loaded with the possibility of mutual conflicts. The initiative for taking such a step may come from any one of the two parties or both may simultaneously go for it. One of the individuals out of the two in conflict may take a decision to withdraw from the conflicting scene and it may help in putting a brake in their mutual conflict.

4. *Adopting the Means of Negotiation and Compromise:* In conflict resolution, the adoption of the strategy of seeking negotiation or compromise between the involved parties is considered the most viable, useful and applicable strategy. It calls for sitting at the table and seeking a compromise by searching for a midway and coming to a win-win position for the parties involved in a conflict. For seeking such compromise, one of the parties may come forward to take necessary initiative for breaking the ice with the party in conflict and start useful dialogue with it for coming to a position of compromise. However, in some situations a third party or person may prove quite useful in playing the role of a negotiator. Let us think over how he should play his role.

- (i) He should first try to know and understand the true nature of the conflict between the two parties in its full aspect and consequences by giving a patient hearing to both. After hearing both separately at their respective places, he should, then, propose and persuade them to seek negotiation with each other.
- (ii) He should then take their views of what they actually want to seek from such negotiation. They may be asked to prepare a list or set an agenda for the things to be needed on their part priority-wise through this negotiation.
- (iii) He should then try to convince and take them in confidence for providing their

willing cooperation for the success of the negotiation. They should be made to realize that in negotiation one should show a reasonable flexibility for giving something to attain other things present in his list.

- (iv) He should then take initiative for breaking the ice between the parties in conflict by appropriately planning and organizing their meeting at a suitable place accidentally or purposely. The lists from both the parties containing what they want through negotiation should then be made the subject of negotiation between them. The task may then be further carried out as follows.

- The top priority should be given to the things in their lists which can be negotiated quite easily. Usually, such items are centered round the differences in their thinking and perspective. These conflicts exist mainly in the minds of the people. They should be helped here to resolve such conflicts by putting themselves into the other's shoes so that they can understand each other's point of view and narrow down the list of their differences in their negotiation agenda.
- After then attempts should be made to allow the involved parties to identify and openly discuss differences in perceptions. Here the negotiator should be careful not to allow the discussion to become an opportunity to place blame on each other but to make them understand the other side's emotions and interests.
- Both parties should now be asked to fix their attention on the remaining ones left unresolved out of the two lists and attempt further to engage in negotiation on a give and take basis for the mutual satisfaction of one another.
- For the difficult ones, if left still unresolved, lottery or draw system may be adopted or attempts may be made for getting them agreed that for the first half of the period one party will be enjoying a certain benefit and for the second half the other in turn.
- Once all is negotiated, it should take a formal form of written agreement.

To Sum Up

As a term conflict may be understood as a type of social process in which individuals or groups, after feeling that others are heavily coming in their way, consciously and deliberately resort to some emotionally charged negative activity such as violence or a direct attempt to harm or weaken the opponents with a sole motive of achieving their desired ends in any way.

Regarding the characteristic features of the process of conflict we may say that it is a universal, specifically personal and intermittent process, and is termed as a highly emotional and violence ridden act loaded with a lot of disintegrative or dissociative functions. On its positive side, however, it can work as an instrument of social change and reconstruction.

Regarding the causes or factors responsible for creating conflict we may safely conclude that it is caused on account of the interaction of a number of biological and socio-psychological causes or factors.

Conflicts between the individuals and groups in the society at one or the other time in one or the other social situations may take a variety of forms and shapes classified in the ways such as (i) direct and indirect conflict; (ii) war, feud, litigation and conflict of impersonal ideals; and (iii) personal, racial, class, political and international conflicts.

Regarding the role of conflicts, we may say that they can play both positive and negative functions in our social life. In this concern, the positive functions served by conflicts may be: redefining the values and norms; restructuring the social system; promoting the unity and cohesion of the group; and enhancing intimacy in relations. The negative functions served by them on the other hand may be described as: bringing damage, destruction and annihilation; disrupting the unity and cohesiveness of the

group; and causing a lot of psychological disturbance and moral loss to the involved individuals. Conflict arising between two parties needs to be resolved as early as possible by making use of one or the other useful techniques such as: introduction of humor, introduction of variety and change in the existing situation, resorting to social distance or avoidance, and adopting suitable means of negotiation and compromise.

Review Questions

1. What is social exchange? Throw light on its meaning and concept in a proper way.
2. While defining the term social exchange, discuss a theory helpful in its proper explanation.
3. Discuss in detail the meaning, concept and significance of the social exchange processes in our social life.
4. While telling about the meaning of the term social exchange processes, name and discuss their various forms or types.
5. What is cooperation? Throw light on the concept, meaning and various forms or types of the term cooperation.
6. Discuss in detail the needs and significance of cooperation in our social life.
7. What is competition? Throw light on its concept, meaning and characteristic features as a form or type of social exchange.
8. Discuss in detail the role and functions of competition in our social life.
9. What are conflicts? Explain their concept and meaning in a proper way and point out the characteristic features of the conflict process.
10. Discuss in detail the various causes and factors responsible for the creation of conflicts.
11. Name and discuss in detail the various forms or types of conflicts and throw light on their role and functions in our social life.
12. Discuss in detail the different techniques used for the resolution of the conflicts arising between two parties in one or the other social situations.

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12.

INTERPERSONAL ATTRACTIONS AND RELATIONSHIPS

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- Discuss the meaning and nature of the term interpersonal attraction.
- Name and discuss the various theories of interpersonal attraction.
- Develop an understanding about the various interpersonal theories such as evolutionary theory of attraction, linear theory or reinforcement model, exchange theory of attraction, equity theory of attraction and balance theory of attraction.
- Name and discuss the various determinants of interpersonal attraction and relationship.
- Throw light on the various types of interpersonal relationships such as early family relationships, close friendships, and romantic relationships and love.
- Know and discuss various types or forms of love relationships such as passionate love, compassionate love, and romantic love and marriage relationship.

Introduction

You visit a garden and look at the different variety of flowers growing there. Your attention is focused to a particular type of flowers regardless of whether you are familiar or unfamiliar with the name or variety of these flowers. Your attraction for these flowers is just natural and intrinsic. By nature, inherently we begin to show intense liking or disliking to the things around us. In the same sequence it is also not uncommon for us in our social interaction to feel a strong sensation of liking and disliking termed as attraction and repulsion towards the familiar or unfamiliar persons at one or the other time. The feelings of such intense liking or attraction may

then gradually develop into intense love and intact social relationships such as being bosom friend or life partner. There are a number of internal as well as external factors lying in ourselves and in our environment for making us attracted and bonded with others. It is these feeling of attractions and bond of love and affiliation that help in the establishment and continuance of family and community relationships for our survival and happy living. In this chapter we would like to focus our discussion on these two different aspects of interpersonal interaction of human beings, namely (i) interpersonal attraction and (ii) interpersonal relationships. Let us first have the discussion on interpersonal attraction.

Interpersonal Attraction

Meaning and Nature

The term interpersonal attraction in its word meaning stands for the attraction by individuals for each other that is experienced during social interaction. It is a sort of mutual liking and desire to be in company as well as having proper interaction with each other. In the words of Crisp and Turner (2014:287), “interpersonal attraction describes the desire to approach another individual to seek them out for interaction”. In the subject physics you must have learned about the phenomena of attraction and repulsion exhibited on the part of magnetized objects. In our social interaction also the same tendency of getting attracted or repelled is exhibited on the part of individuals during their interaction with others.

Actually, in their perception when people like somebody being in conversation or interaction in some ways, they feel attracted towards him or her. In such cases of liking, they are found to possess a quite positive attitude towards the liked one. On the other hand, their disliking certainly poses a negative attitude toward the disliked. In this way, by the term attraction or repulsion towards somebody in our social interaction we certainly mean the possession of positive or negative attitudes towards that person. Attraction like the phenomenon of liking may be expressed along a scale or dimensions ranging from strongly felt attraction to strongly felt repulsion or disliking. That is why by the term interpersonal attraction we may mean “a person’s evaluation of or the person’s attitude about some other person on a dimension ranging from strong liking to strong disliking” (Baron et al., 2006). In any sense, thus, where our attraction towards a person draws us nearer and nearer to that person with a feeling of positive attitude and strong liking for him or her, the feelings of disliking and repulsion on the other hand make us remain away from that person. Attraction, thus, may be seen to provide us a beginning for the establishment of close relationships with others in our social interaction.

Interpersonal Attraction

Our desire for drawing nearer and being in company and interaction with one or the other people accompanied with a feeling of positive attitude and strong liking for them.

What we term as love at first sight is the result of a strong sense of liking or attraction felt for the people at the very perception or interaction with them. Now the question may arise, in our social interaction what is that which makes us get attracted towards one or the other person? Sociologists and socio-psychologists have tried to answer this question through some theories propagated by them for this purpose. Let us try to get acquainted with them.

Theories of Interpersonal Attraction

Theories of interpersonal attraction attempt to specify the conditions and suggest the reasons for explaining the mechanism of interpersonal attraction. Out of a number of theories available for this purpose here in this text we would be discussing a few important ones named (i) evolutionary theory, (ii) learning theory or reinforcement model, (iii) exchange theory, (iv) equity theory and (v) balance theory. Let us examine them one by one.

Evolutionary Theory of Attraction

Evolutionary biologists and social psychologists while borrowing the basic theorizing ideas from Charles Darwin have tried to provide a physiological, biological and genetic heritage-based explanation of the phenomenon of attraction. What is inherited from the immediate parents by the offspring in terms of their physical features and fitness may become a focal point for the like or dislike of people from the viewpoint of the perceivers and interactors. According to evolutionary psychologists the physical appearance, body size and fitness of people plays a dominant role in making them attractive in the eyes of others. People often use the appearance and behavior of others

to make a variety of judgments about them including the act of getting attracted or not towards them. These decisions regarding making opinions and forming attitudes towards them are made quickly and unconsciously and are fairly resistant to change. The biological habit of being attracted towards members of opposite sex and making a mate selection depending upon the physical appearance, fitness and mating compatibility is not limited to the animal world but it also remains fairly common with the humans.

Evolutionary Theory of Attraction

A theory of attraction providing a physiological, biological and genetic heritage-based explanation for the phenomenon of attraction and thus laying heavy emphasis on clearly observable features of human bodies inherited by the offspring from the immediate parents rather than emphasizing the internal factors such as kindness or trustworthiness for arriving at the judgments related to attractiveness of people.

In fact, evolutionary psychologists place heavy emphasis on clearly observable features of human bodies rather than emphasizing the internal factors such as kindness or trustworthiness. According to them although a number of features of the body relate to attractiveness, the things that draw immediate attention for influencing judgments of attractiveness may be cited as the color of the skin, facial beauty, size of the chest and arms (in males) and neck, breast and waist-to-hip ratio (in females). Evolutionary theory affirms its biological explanation to attractiveness by pleading that biological nature and evolutionary perspective of taking cognition of the things in the environment does not change with the passage of the time and it is why some standards of attractiveness are consistent across time and cultures.

Learning Theory or Reinforcement Model

The learning theory or reinforcement model addressing interpersonal attraction is based on two

important notions of psychology – the one that attraction, as a positive attitude or favorable liking towards somebody, is a learned phenomenon and the other that this learning is guided through the principle of reinforcement. It implies that behaviors that are followed by desirable consequences (rewards or pleasant experiences) tend to be repeated. When applied to interpersonal attractions, the principle suggests that individuals are drawn to relationships that are rewarding and avoid those that are not. Socio-psychologists like Bernice Lott and Albert Lott (1974) and Donn Byrne and Gerald Clore (1970) are very much associated with the reinforcement model of attraction. It can take two different forms – one based on the reinforcement explained through operant conditioning and the other in the form of reinforcement-affect through classical conditioning.

Learning Theory or Reinforcement Model of Attraction

A theory of attraction emphasizing that interpersonal attraction, as a positive attitude towards somebody, is a learned phenomenon that is guided through the principle of reinforcement, i.e., individuals are drawn to relationships that are rewarding and avoid those that are not.

In its simple form the reinforcement model of interpersonal attraction guided through the principle of operant conditioning is found to convey that we like or get attracted to the people who reinforce us i.e., prove rewarding, satisfying or pleasure giving in our interactions with them. We come into contact or interact with somebody in some ways and it gets some sort of satisfaction, reward or pleasing effect to us in one way or the other; it is quite natural for us, then, to repeat our interaction and increase the circumference of our contact with the person concerned. For example, in their first contact, a young boy looks at a young girl and gets a good response in return; it reinforces his approaching behavior towards the girl for spending more time with her. The more comfortable

and rewarding they feel in each other's company, the more attraction towards each other they are likely to experience as a consequence.

In its other form reinforcement model named as reinforcement-affect model is found to be guided through the principle of classical conditioning. In its very essence, the reinforcement-affect model tries to convey that in addition to liking the person who is making us feel rewarded or pleased (reinforced) with his or her response or company, we also like people or the environmental circumstances existing at the time, when we are reinforced in such a favorable way on account of their being associated with the positive reinforcement and viewed positively. In their love affair the young boy and girl may be found not only to show a great attraction and liking for each other, but it is also natural for them to show liking or positive feelings towards the accomplice (the small children, friend or a pet) or the place of their meeting. In the honeymoon trips, the young couples do not only keep remembering their pleasant experiences but also show a peculiar type of attraction and attachment to the places of their stay and visits. The reverse is also true. Hence, as a rule, the neutral stimulus (the accomplice or the place of stay in the examples) that is associated with reward (pleasant experiences) elicits positive feelings and liking, and what is associated with punishment (unpleasant experiences) leads to negative feelings and disliking.

Exchange Theory of Attraction

Socio-psychologists Homans (1951), John Thibaut and Harold Kelley (1959), Blau (1964), and U.G. Foia and E.B. Foia (1974) are very much associated with the propagation of the exchange theory of attraction. According to the exchange theory of attraction, there goes a certain kind of exchange – give and take – between two people in developing initially a liking or attraction for each other and then continuing it in the form of an intimate relationship. In this exchange both parties think about the gain or loss occurring in its pure economical terms and then decide to engage in interpersonal attraction – mutual liking – and develop a relationship if it seems profitable or

advantageous to them in their perception of the situation. Gain and loss in the social exchange process going in the interaction between two individuals are named as reward (benefit) and cost (investment) in this theory of social exchange. The output or return from the social exchange here is computed through the formula:

$$\text{Outcome} = \text{Rewards (Benefits)} - \text{Costs (Investments)}$$

This outcome now comes under proper evaluation at the hands of the person concerned with the considerations such as (i) are the rewards/benefits in proportion to the cost as per expectations, (ii) is it worthwhile to provide company and to be in relationship in view of the outcomes, and (iii) are there other alternatives available for replacing this relationship in a more profitable or satisfying way, etc.?

Exchange Theory of Attraction

A theory of attraction emphasizing that there goes a certain kind of exchange – give and take – between two people in developing initially a liking or attraction for each other and then continuing it in the form of intimate relationship if it seems profitable to them in their perception of the situation.

In this way, the key concepts involved in the exchange theory of attraction, for explaining the continuity or discontinuity of interpersonal attraction and relationship between two individuals, may be named as benefit (reward), cost (investment), outcome (return) and overall evaluation of the outcome (comparison).

Benefits or rewards expected in interpersonal relationships may be intrinsically rewarding such as liking each other, feeling good in the company, falling in love and getting emotional support and warmth, or they may be extrinsic such as getting objects or products, receiving monetary benefit, getting services of one or the other nature, satisfaction of the need of social approval, self-esteem and raising

of the status, getting needed information, advice or guidance, etc.

Costs incurred or investments made in interpersonal attraction and relationship involve the things that work as punishing rather than rewarding the involved individuals. They may involve the things such as time and money spent, fatigue, anxiety, fear of embarrassment, social disapproval, rejection or ridicule, forgoing of a reward, post, status and respect, etc.

Outcomes in the form of getting more benefits than the cost incurred or at least in a satisfying proportionate way, encourage both parties to get closer in their interpersonal attraction and continue in their relationships. The reverse in the form of feeling dissatisfied with the outcomes makes them feel repulsion and break in the relationship.

In this way, the social exchange theory tries to suggest that how individuals feel, positively or negatively, about their coming closer to each other and developing relationships depends absolutely on their perception of outcomes resulted through the cost incurred (investments made) and benefits or rewards received as well as the personal satisfaction felt by them on this account. In general, individuals are expected to value their relationship in a quite positive way, if the scale of balance shifts in their favor i.e., earning more benefits/rewards in proportion to the cost incurred in the maintenance of personal attraction and continuance of relationship. However, there occur situations when even after suffering considerable loss (getting quite less reward/benefit in proportion to the cost incurred) in the relationship or not getting satisfied with the outcome, the people prefer to stay in relationship. It may happen in the cases such as: (i) when they hope and believe that the situation will improve and the relationship is going to pay them quite favorably in future or (ii) there is no alternative available at present for tying up with others or alternatives available are worse than the present relationship. That's why people may be seen to dragging on the unwanted and dissatisfied marriage relationships too far instead of seeking immediate breakup and divorce.

Equity Theory of Attraction

A slight variation of exchange theory, equity theory is based on the principle of equity in relationships. While in view of the theory of exchange discussed earlier, it is possible to have continuity of relationship in the cases where the balance sheet conveying gain or loss through the benefits earned and costs incurred in a social relationship may be slightly or heavily tilted in favor of either of the parties, such possibility is almost denied in the equity theory. Socio-psychologists like Adams (1965), and Walster et al. (1978) are very much associated with the propagation of the ideas related to this theory.

Equity Theory of Attraction

A theory of attraction, known to be based on the principle of equity in relationships, emphasizing that the interpersonal attraction and continuity in a relationship is possible only when both parties try to maintain equity in serving the interests of each other.

According to this theory the interpersonal attraction and continuity in a relationship is possible only when both parties try to care for being fair to the outcomes attained by the opposite party besides its own on an equality basis. In this way, the theory suggests that in the interpersonal attraction and continuity of the relationship one party has to maintain a balance between the outcomes (resulted through rewards-cost) experienced on its part and those experienced on the part of the other party in the relationship. Such equitable relationships, maintaining a proper balance between the gains of both the parties, are the happiest and the most stable, while inequitable relationships result in one party being over benefited and the other under benefited. In such an inequitable relationship there is a tension and unhappiness resulting either in mending the ways from both the sides to seek equity or end in breakup.

In this way, according to equity theory interpersonal attraction and relationship gets promoted

in the case where each person in the relationship believes that his or her own ratio of costs to benefits is fair (or equitable). On the other hand, a relationship remains at risk when one party in the relationship thinks that the time, effort and other resources being invested are O.K., while the other party does not feel that way.

Balance Theory of Attraction

Based on the phenomenon of cognitive consistency, balance theory of attraction owes its origin to socio-psychologist F. Heider who propagated it in the year 1958. In his theory, Heider proposed that in order to understand interpersonal attraction, it is necessary to focus on the individual's perception of a relationship. The people become attracted towards each other and develop friendship when they find consistency between feelings of attraction towards others, and their personal beliefs, attitudes and values match each other. Actually, their attraction and development of relationship with each other depends upon their striving for maintaining a balance between the way they feel for each other and the action they take for forming a relationship.

In his theory, Heider further argued that in interpersonal attraction and relationship there arise situations when the persons involved face inconsistencies or imbalances in their relationship leading to tension and negativity in their relation; here they can achieve normality in their relationship by achieving balance or consistency in their behavior or mutual socio-interaction.

Balance Theory of Attraction

A theory of attraction, known to be based on the phenomenon of cognitive consistency, emphasizing that people become attracted towards each other and develop relationship only when they find consistency between feelings of attraction towards others, and remain capable of maintaining a balance between what they mutually believe, like or value.

In highlighting his views for explaining the phenomenon of interpersonal attraction and relationship existing between two individuals Heider (1958) took the help of a triadic formation. In this triadic formation he mentioned two types of relationships (unit relation and sentimental relation) existing between three entities, namely a person (P), another person (O) and any other event, person, place or concept (X).

Here a unit relation existing between the two individuals (P and O) is related to belongingness. It involves the perception that both of them belong or do not belong together. Sentimental relation existing between them is related to the evaluation of liking/disliking for each other. Such liking/disliking for each other is linked to the things associated with the factor X.

In case when two individuals like each other, they are said to possess a positive sentimental relationship and if they do not like each other, they are said to possess a negative sentimental relationship.

In this way, according to Heider, in having positive interpersonal attraction (liking), there needs to exist a balance between both types of relationships – unit and sentimental. On the other hand, if there is an imbalance, then individuals feel uncomfortable. To deal properly in this situation, they may now try to restore the balance by changing either their sentiment towards the other, or by changing the unit relationship.

Let us now try to illustrate the triadic formation for explaining the phenomenon of interpersonal attraction and relationship between two persons by an example.

Let us assume that there is a unit relationship (belongingness) existing between two friends, say Mohan (P) and Ravi (O). They may also be found to be sentimentally attached (liking) to each other. In such case, thus, we may find a needed balance existing between two types of relationships (unit and sentimental) making Mohan and Ravi feel comfortable in their relationship. Now assume the entry of the third entity of the triadic formation named (X) – the other person, object, place, moral value, belief, opinion or philosophy. If Mohan believes in the ideology of a particular party, the balance in their

interpersonal relation (friendship) will exist in case Ravi also believes in that ideology. The relationship will be in jeopardy if one shows liking and the other shows disliking for that ideology. For restoring the balance, one of them has to compromise or both should agree that they will not make it a sentimental issue for harming their relationship. In case they fail in restoring the balance, in such a way, it may lead to the breakage in their friendship.

The same may also happen with a married couple who are found to share a lot of interpersonal attraction and liking for each other as a result of an appropriate balance existing between their two types of relationships – unit and sentimental. In keeping such balance, they may also be found to share a common liking for a number of things – objects, persons, places and ideology, etc. However, now there arises a situation when one party does not like at all the other party's liking or actions. The balance is disturbed and it may bring bitterness in their relationship to the stage of seeking divorce. A husband may not like the frequent interference of her mother-in-law in their family matters or the wife may not like to stay with her in-laws. In such situation, there arises a compulsion of restoring the balance by sinking the differences through the initiative taken from the either side or be prepared for separation.

To Sum Up

Theories of interpersonal attraction attempt to specify the conditions and suggest the reasons for explaining the mechanism of interpersonal attraction.

In this connection, *evolutionary theory of attraction* provides a physiological, biological and genetic heritage-based explanation for the phenomenon of attraction. Consequently, evolutionary psychologists place heavy emphasis on clearly observable features of human bodies inherited by the offspring from the immediate parents such as the color of the skin, facial beauty, size of the chest and arms (in males) and neck, breast and waist-to-hip ratio (in females) rather than emphasizing the

internal factors such as kindness or trustworthiness for arriving at the judgments related to attractiveness.

Learning theory or reinforcement model addressing interpersonal attraction is based on two important notions of psychology – the one that attraction as a positive attitude towards somebody is a learned phenomenon and the other that this learning is guided through the principle of reinforcement. When applied to interpersonal attractions, the principle suggests that individuals are drawn to relationships that are rewarding and avoid those that are not.

According to *exchange theory of attraction* there goes a certain kind of exchange – give and take – between two people in developing initially a liking or attraction for each other and then continuing it in the form of intimate relationship. In this exchange both parties think about the gain or loss occurring in its pure economical terms and then make the decision to engage in interpersonal attraction – mutual liking and developing relationship – if it seems profitable to them in their perception of the situation.

The *equity theory of attraction*, true to its naming, is based on the principle of equity in relationships. Consequently, according to this theory the interpersonal attraction and continuity in relationship is possible only when both parties try to care for being fair to the outcomes attained by the opposite party besides its own on an equality basis.

Based on the phenomenon of cognitive consistency, *balance theory of attraction* emphasizes that people become attracted towards each other and develop friendship when they find consistency between feelings of attraction towards others, and their personal beliefs, attitudes and values match each other. Actually, their attraction and development of relationship with each other depends upon their striving for maintaining a balance between the way they feel for each other and the action they take for forming a relationship.

Determinants of Interpersonal Attraction and Relationship

What makes people engage in the process of interpersonal attraction (developing liking for each other) and then building relationships? In this process of interpersonal attraction and relationship we may usually mark the presence of three types of factors or determinants such as internal, external and interactive.

By the term *internal factors* here we mean the factors that are associated with the internal mechanism or very nature of the persons involved in the process of interpersonal attraction (the one who attracts and the other who gets attracted). The important ones included in this category of internal factors are: (i) need to affiliate experienced on the part of persons and (ii) the feeling and emotional states of the persons.

The term *external factors* here stands for the factors that are associated with the external mechanism such as (i) proximity or physical closeness between two individuals and (ii) the observable features and characteristics of the persons such as their physical attractiveness, physique, warmth, competence, the dressing styles, mannerism, social etiquette and behavior, etc.

The third one, *interactive factors*, here stands for the factors coming into operation as a result of some ongoing communication and social interaction between two persons such as (i) similarity to the self with respect to a lot of things such as attitudes, opinions and beliefs, food and clothing choices, habits,

temperament and values, etc. and (ii) mutual or reciprocal liking or disliking

Let us now discuss some of the important factors or determinants falling in the aforementioned three categories – internal, external and interactive.

1. The Need to Affiliate

We as humans have the basic need and internal demand to become the part of a group, and getting affiliated or accepted by someone. Need for affiliation, thus, actually works as a quite potent motive for our seeking interpersonal attraction and relationships. However, individual differences of wide degree and nature lie among individuals with respect to their expression as well as striving for the satisfaction of the need to affiliate. Some are quite social in nature and may be seen to express their desire to seek affiliation and get attached to others. It may be seen to work as an active source of interpersonal attraction and relationship. Others may not be so social but possess an implicit need for affiliation interested in a quite limited social interaction. In this way, it may be properly visualized that the intensity and nature of the affiliation need present among the interacting individuals is found to be a quite potent factor in influencing and guiding the process of interpersonal attraction and relationships among individuals. The more need to affiliate a person possesses, in one or the other situations, the more efforts he or she will do (or more approachable he or she will be) to seek affiliation, interaction and relationship with others.

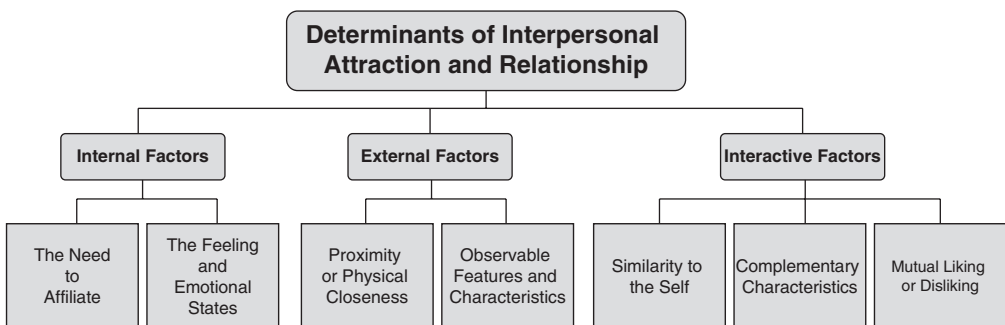


Figure 12.1 Determinants of Interpersonal Attraction and Relationship

2. The Feeling and Emotional States

The affective component of one's behavior in the form of his feelings and emotional states casts a quite sizable impact upon the process of interpersonal attraction and relationships. These affective states of one's behavior have been found to demonstrate two basic characteristics in the form of their intensity (strengths of the feeling and emotions) and direction (being positive or negative in character). What we term as a mood is the creation of the affective state (feelings and emotions) in which one is found to function in a particular social situation. Good and bad mood often or to say at all times decides how the involved persons will be reflecting themselves for interpersonal attraction and relationship. A person in a pleasant mood is more attractive and approachable for social interaction and building relationship. The reverse is equally true. When one feels good in his feelings and emotions towards a person, he gets more attracted towards him or her. In the reverse case reverse happens. It is why the positive state of feelings and emotions of the people is found to lead them to the positive evaluation of other people (developing liking for them) and negative leads them to negative evaluation of other persons (developing disliking for them). For example, when we are emotionally in a positive state (a good, happy mood) we usually evaluate a person positively, even though he is a stranger, and negatively evaluate a friend in a negative state. In this way, actually, our mood, the positive and negative states of our feelings and emotions as well as our evaluation of people good and bad likewise all work in a joint collaboration for influencing or casting a strong impact on our attempts in drawing closer or distancing far from the people involved with us at one or the other times in varying social situations.

3. The Impact of Proximity or Physical Closeness

Proximity or physical closeness between two people is included in the category of external determinants or factors casting a quite sizable impact on their interpersonal attraction and relationship. As examples of such proximity or physical closeness existing between individuals we may cite the example

of students sitting beside each other, the workmen working in the factory together, hostlers sharing rooms and players of a team taking part in the competition, etc. In each of these physical closeness situations of interpersonal interaction we may see that there is every possibility of drawing closer and developing good relationship.

Proximity is also supposed to have an effect on friendship formation. Heider (1958) states that "individuals may become friendly with one another, because they spend a lot of time together". Studies have supported this idea and have found that time spent in interaction leads individuals to like each other (Aderman, 1969; Berscheid et al., 1968).

The question may arise, why does proximity or physical closeness enjoy the possibility of developing interpersonal interaction and bringing closeness in the relations of the individuals? The research work done in this concern reveals the following facts (Festinger et al., 1950; Smith and Mackie, 1995; Moreland and Beach, 1992).

- Proximity or physical closeness helps in providing due opportunity to the individuals to interact well with those who are quite physically close to them in their living, behaving and working.
- The ease earned in interacting frequently made possible by the phenomenon of proximity makes the persons concerned to know and understand more and more about each other and thus paving the way for coming closer and developing intimacy.
- Proximity is quite capable in bringing repeated exposure effect for the development of interpersonal interaction and closer relationship. It is why students sitting beside each other and getting repeated exposure of each other's company may be found making positive evaluations of each other. It helps in removing any hesitation, suspicion and uncertainty about each other and brings them closer for developing interpersonal attraction and close relationship.

4. Observable Features and Characteristics

What we observe in the individuals coming into our contact for the first time as a stranger or unknown

in terms of certain physical features, competencies, living styles, social qualities and mannerism, etc. are found to exert a quite mentionable impact over the process of interpersonal attraction and relationship going on between them. We can summarize their roles in this connection as follows.

- **Physical Attractiveness and Appearance:**

What is at once visible among the strangers and unknown persons to us for their evaluation is their physical attractiveness and outward appearance. What makes us experience a feeling of intensive liking, coming closer and having interaction with some individuals at our first meeting certainly has a proper connection with their observable outward appearance. There definitely may be something in their physique and physical appearance which has a strong attraction appeal. It draws and attracts us in the same way as a powerful magnet does in attracting the magnetized objects. In its applied sense, physical attractiveness and outward appearance stands for a phenomenon that ranges from being evaluated as extremely good and attractive to the extremely bad and unattractive. In a generalized way, people are found to provide an important consideration to one's physical appearance designating him or her quite a handsome, beautiful, charming and attractive person for getting attracted to and showing their intensive liking for him or her in their behavior. However, what makes the people attractive or unattractive in one's eyes is purely a subjective phenomenon depending upon a combination of cultural consideration and personal preferences.

- **Competency:** The competent person in one or the other field including day-to-day living activities may be found to act as a source of attraction and liking for us in a number of social situations. In general, the skills they possess, the competencies they exhibit are very much appreciated and valued on the part of the people. The attraction for the cine celebrities, artists, dancers, musicians, scientists and technicians exhibited on the part of people is very much on account of

the matchless competencies possessed by them and practiced in their professional life. However, the attractions shown and liking exhibited for the people by us on the basis of competencies held by these competent persons is again a subjective phenomenon. We don't get attracted to the competent persons indiscriminately. We value others and get attracted towards them depending upon our evaluation that they may prove quite helpful and beneficial for us in our own functioning.

- **Social Qualities:** In addition to the physical attractiveness and appearance working as a potent factor for drawing persons closer to each other, the social qualities and characteristics reflecting in the social behavior of the people also prove a great source of attraction and liking for others. The persons are liked or disliked on the basis of desirable or undesirable social traits and characteristics possessed by them. For example, the people who are perceived by us as warm, kind hearted, sober, helping and sincere are also seen as attractive and good on our part for building a relationship. On the other hand, the cold hearted ones of complaining nature and critical are usually not liked and thus found to become the object of non-attraction on our part.
- **Living Style and Mannerism:** The living style and mannerism of the people may also work as an important source for interpersonal attraction and relationship. What types of interests and hobbies, attitudes and values one has, how one dresses and cares for the fitness of his or her body, what one eats and drinks and his or her table manners, how one speaks, gestures, and responds in communication, at what length one can be trusted for caring for the person in relationship are a few of the numerous things that are put under evaluation for getting attracted and falling into a relationship with somebody. The more positive results one gets in this direction, the more probability then occurs for him or her to become serious about the interpersonal attraction and relationship with the person concerned.

5. Similarity to the Self

A well-known saying that the birds of the same feather flock together fits well to an accepted fact in the realm of interpersonal attraction and relationship where we clearly observe that people get attracted and like to be with persons who are more similar to them. Similarity between them here may stand for their being similar in respect of their attitudes, interests, personality characteristics, beliefs, values and many more things. In the field of social psychology, the tendency to respond positively to indications that another person is similar to them and negatively to indications that another person is dissimilar from them has been referred to as *similarity-dissimilarity effect*. Going ahead, the similarity effect in this connection helps to evaluate the similar persons in a quite positive way leading us to get attracted and have a relationship with them. Actually, there exists a direct relation between similarity and degree of attraction between two people. Greater the similarity between two persons, more is the probability of their getting attracted and having a relationship with each other. The reverse is also true. The dissimilarity effect making one to evaluate the dissimilar persons in a quite negative way leads him to get away from or dislike the concerned persons.

6. Complementary Characteristics

Besides seeking similarity to the self for coming closer or getting attracted to others, it may also be seen that we often draw near or get attracted to those who are found to possess the characteristics (physical or behavioral) that complement, rather than mirror, our own. Commenting over the meaning and nature of this feature as one of the important factors in interpersonal attraction and relationship Crisp and Turner (2014:295) write:

We find others attractive, when they hold a trait that we value, but do not possess ourselves. It is important to note that this is distinct from the idea that ‘opposite attract’ – that we are sometimes attracted to dissimilar others. Instead, an attraction to complementary characteristics

reflects the fact that we like people who have traits that we do not have, but would like to.

Socio-psychologist researchers like Buss (1989) and Townsend and Levy (1990) have tried to verify the importance of the factor “complementary characteristics” by asserting through their findings that for relationship, men prefer women who are pretty and younger in age irrespective of their socioeconomic status (the thing they lack) whereas women generally prefer men older and experienced enjoying a quite high status in society (the thing they aspire but do not possess).

7. Mutual Liking or Disliking

The maintenance of reciprocity in relationship in the form of simultaneous liking or disliking of each other may prove a quite reckoning factor in getting the people tied in the bond of interpersonal attraction/repulsion and mutual liking/disliking. In the foot step of like begets like, the people who like each other are found to evaluate each other in a quite positive way and such positivity of their attitudes may bring them quite closer to each other. On the opposite side, the mutual disliking may develop into negative attitudes towards each other leading people to part ways or even hate each other. Actually, the exchange of communication silently or vocally on the part of both the parties that they like or dislike each other has a great potential to arouse positive and negative emotional feelings for each other. It is these feelings or aroused emotions (positive or negative) that turn into interpersonal attraction and repulsion between them for paving the way to the mutual close relationship or indifference/hating.

To Sum Up

The things proving as determinants of people's interpersonal attraction and relationships in one or the other social situations may be stated in the ways as:

- The *need to get affiliated or accepted* by others is responsible to a great extent for

driving the interacting individuals to make more efforts for seeking affiliation, interaction and relationship with others.

- The affective component of interacting individuals in the form of their *feelings and emotional states* (expressed through mood) casts a quite sizable impact upon the process of interpersonal attraction and relationships.
- *Proximity or physical closeness* between two people casts a quite sizable impact on their interpersonal attraction and relationship.
- *Observable features and characteristics* of the individuals coming into our contact for the first time as a stranger or unknown in terms of certain physical features, competencies, living styles, social qualities and mannerism, etc. are found to exert a quite mentionable impact over the process of interpersonal attraction and relationship going on between them.
- *Similarity* between the interacting individuals in respect of one or the other things such as their attitudes, interests, personality characteristics, beliefs and values, etc. exercises sizable impact over the mutual attraction and relationship between them.
- People often draw near or get attracted to those who are found to possess the *complementary traits* – the traits they value, but do not possess.
- *Mutual liking* of each other proves a quite reckoning factor in getting the people tied in the bond of interpersonal attraction and relationship.

Interpersonal Relationships

In social interaction the story of building relationships with others begins with feelings of liking, attraction and attachment towards them. What we identify as close or intimate relationships are

developed among individuals gradually as they grow and mature, engage in interactive experiences, develop liking and attraction as well as learn to share love, faith and respect for each other. We can name these relationships as early family relationships, close friendships, romantic love and marriage relationships. Let us discuss these in coming pages.

Early Family Relationships

What is said in terms of the building of intimate interpersonal relationships, the initiation on this account comes from within the boundary walls of a family and it is the mother or caretaker that becomes a focal point for the development of the valuable affiliation, attachment and interpersonal relationship with the newborn baby. Gradually other members of the family, including siblings, come into contact with the growing baby and his or her circle of interpersonal affiliation, attachment and relationship gets widened. In this way, in fact it is the home and family that works as the first place for teaching the growing children the initial lessons of social interaction, attachment and interpersonal close relationship. Whatever the children get in terms of the type of care, attachment, love and affection from their mother and other family members in the earlier age cast a sizable impact upon their attachment behavior, interpersonal attraction and relationship with others in the later periods of their growth and development. Let us have a look at the nature of the types of interpersonal relationships emerging among children as a result of social interaction within the home and family.

The interpersonal social interactions of the growing babies with their mother, caregivers, family members and siblings are said to create two types of attitudes – attitude towards self (named as self-esteem) and attitude towards others (named as interpersonal trust). They are found to develop positive and negative self-concepts about themselves depending on the positive and negative reactions of their mother and family members in terms of considering them important, valued and loved on one hand and unimportant and unloved on the other. The second attitude named as interpersonal trust developed among them is the creation of the type

of positivity and negativity shown towards them by their mother and family members in considering them trustworthy, dependable and reliable in their conduct and behavior. The upsurge of these attitudes in the form of low or high intensity as well as positivity and negativity of their nature among the growing children results in the picking up of some particular attachment and interpersonal behavior styles. Researchers in this connection through their findings have identified a secure interpersonal style (named as secure attachment style) and three other styles upsurging on account of their feeling insecure. Let us examine them.

Secure Attachment Style: This style is developed among the infants and children who feel secure in the company of their mother/caretakers, siblings and other family members for the satisfaction of their physical and socio-psychological needs. The grown-up children as well as adults showing this type of attachment style in their interpersonal behavior and relationships are found to be imbued with the characteristics like: (i) high in both self-esteem and interpersonal trust; (ii) high in self-confidence, empathy and achievement motivation; (iii) good at personal and social relationships; (iv) reasonably adaptable to their day-to-day functioning and professional responsibilities; (v) more secure and comfortable in their relationships with the life partners; and (vi) less fearful of the coming dangers and failures in life.

Insecure-Avoidant Attachment Style: As a reactionary measure for feeling insecure, here the infants or developing children may be seen to adopt an avoidance or apathetic attitude towards their mother, siblings and other family members. It accompanies them well in their adult life. The individuals adopting this style are found to be imbued with the characteristics like: (i) low on both self-esteem and interpersonal trust; (ii) low in self-confidence, empathy and achievement motivation; (iii) poor at interpersonal relationships; (iv) showing a lot of apathy, avoidance, withdrawal and aloofness in their social behavior; (v) showing inconsistency of behavior, lack of decisive ability, suspicion, anxiety and nervousness in their functioning; (vi) avoiders of close and intimate relationship on account of remaining suspicious about others; and (v) difficult marriage relationship.

Insecure-Resistance Attachment Style: In their early age, as a reactionary measure for feeling insecure the infants and children here try to pick up the rebellion and resistive attitude towards their mother, siblings and family members. It may, then, travel with them when they grow in their age as adults. As a grown-up the individuals adopting this attachment and interpersonal relationship style are found to be imbued with the characteristics like: (i) negative attitude towards the self, accompanied with high interpersonal trust; (ii) low self-confidence, and high dependence on others; (iii) victim of cheating and failure in love relationships on account of excessive trust in others; (iv) showing a lot of aggressive, hostile, resentment and revengeful attitude and behavior in their life; (v) unable to maintain satisfactory relationships with peers and other people in their social and professional interaction; and (vi) ready to get in interpersonal relationships with others but not sure of its proper continuance including the married life.

Insecure-Disorganized and Disoriented Attachment Style: This attachment style is the outcome of the utmost insecurity felt by the children in their upbringing. The infants exhibiting this style are characterized as to show a confused, clueless behavior lying between attachment and non-attachment such as displaying fear of familiar caregivers instead of getting comfortable in their company. It is often linked with parental, sibling and family member's abuse or neglect and is connected with unmanageable fear. Throwing light on its etiology and disorganized nature, Levine and Munsch (2018:390) write:

Think about how this pattern would develop. The very person to whom the baby would normally turn when afraid is the same who is causing the fear. The babies don't know what to do or where to turn. They cannot organize their behavior because they do not have a predictable environment. They never know what to expect or what is expected of them.

Assumed to be formed in infancy and childhood, this style continues in the adult life. The adults adopting this attachment and interpersonal relationship style

are found to be imbibed with the characteristics like: (i) high self-esteem and low interpersonal trust; (ii) avoider of genuine close relationship; (iii) believing that they deserve a close relationship but are frustrated because of the mistrust towards others; (iv) failure in making intimate friendship and successful life partnership; and (v) demonstrating a lot of signs and symptoms of a disturbed and disorganized personality, antisocial and abnormal behavior.

To Sum Up

In the earlier age, the interpersonal social interactions of the growing babies with their mother, caregivers, family members and siblings are said to create two types of attitudes – attitude towards self (known as self-esteem) and attitude towards others (known as interpersonal trust).

The upsurge of these attitudes in the form of low or high intensity as well as positivity and negativity of their nature among the growing children results in the picking up of some particular attachment and interpersonal behavior styles such as (i) secure attachment style, (ii) insecure-avoidant attachment style, (iii) insecure-resistance attachment style and (iv) insecure-disorganized and disoriented attachment style.

Assumed to be formed in infancy and childhood, these styles continue in the adult life. The adults adopting one or the other attachment and interpersonal relationship style are found to be imbibed with certain types of unique personality traits, behavioral habits and adjustment patterns. In fact, whatever the children get in terms of the type of care, attachment, love and affection from their mother and other family members in the earlier age casts a sizable impact upon their attachment behavior, interpersonal attraction and relationship with others in the later periods of their growth and development.

Close Friendships

Home and family, as we have said earlier, is the first place in our life where the initial lessons of affiliation, attraction, attachment and close interpersonal relationships are learned by the growing infants and children. The bond of interpersonal relationship is quite strong between the family members. It is clearly visible through a high level of intimacy and closeness existing among them. For the growing children right from their infantile age the valuable opportunity for establishing bonds of mutual relationship apart from their family members arise in having friendship with the children of their own age. The basis of having friendship at this stage lies purely in the fulfillment of their desire to share and participate in mutually enjoying activities. As they grow in age and enter childhood, the basis of making friendship is more widened. It now may include the similarity of interests, abilities, age, race, socio-economic status, attitudes and behavior. However, there lies a difference between the friendship of the child and the adolescents or grown-ups. In childhood children come closer and tie in friendship for sharing some common interests particularly the exchange of commodities, participation in mutually enjoying activities and providing company to each other. The intimacy and closeness of relationship reflected in the friendship of adolescence and mature adults is rarely visible in the friendships of infants and children. It needs a little more intellectual, emotional and social development on their part for getting tied in the bond of close friendship and intimate interpersonal relationship. The rapid all-round growth and development occurring in adolescence and its follow-up in adulthood provides them all what is needed from them on this account.

What we call a close friendship of the adolescents and mature adults may be defined as an intimate interpersonal relationship where the individuals called friends spend a great deal of time together; interact in variety of situations; are self-disclosing; demonstrate mutual trust; provide physical, economical and emotional support at the time of the need; and generally relax and feel comfortable in the company of each other. We may also notice

very clearly that as a mature individual we may have friendship with a number of persons at a time but whom we consider as our closer and intimate friends are in fact a quite few ones, more often only one or two in our life.

Why and how the people become friends has been explained by socio-psychologists (Altman and Taylor, 1973; Laurenceau et al., 1998) through a mechanism known as reciprocal self-disclosure in which the individuals are found to disclose or reveal the things mutually on the reciprocal basis about their self to the intended friend for coming closer and developing intimacy with each other. Throwing light on this aspect Crisp and Turner (2014:307) write:

A developing friendship is guided by a norm of self-disclosure reciprocity. Individuals match one another's level of disclosure, only revealing information of greater intimacy when the other person does so. This allows a relationship to develop at a comfortable pace, avoiding rejection as a result of too small a disclosure, or personal invasion and threat as a result of too large or too sudden a disclosure. Once the relationship has reached a high level of intimacy, the level of self-disclosure levels off and is replaced by an exchange of support and understanding.

Socio-psychologists (Dindia and Allen, 1992; Duck and Wright, 1993; Crisp and Turner, 2014) have also demonstrated the role of gender difference in the field of friendship formation and its further continuance by highlighting the following things.

- Women friendships tend to be more intimate and emotionally involved in comparison to men's friendship.
- Women are more self-expressive and self-disclosing than the men in their friendships to either sex.
- It has been observed that men get closer to women and establish intimate relationship with them with a set thinking in their mind that, eventually, their relationship will result in sexual interactions, if not then males eventually end the relationship. In contrast females expect

their male friends to provide safety and security (physically, economically and socially) to them and eventually, end the relationship if they find that it is not happening.

- Regarding the nature of physical contact maintained or desired in friendship it has been found that men in general engage in less physical contact with same sex friends than do women. Homosexual friendship is thus more seen in the case of women than the men.

To Sum Up

For the growing children right from their infantile age the valuable opportunity for establishing bond of mutual relationship apart from their family members arises in having friendship with the children of their own age.

However, there lies a difference between the friendship of the child and the adolescents or grown-ups. The intimacy and closeness of relationship reflected in the friendship of adolescence and mature adults is rarely visible in the friendships of infants and children. Such type of their close friendship may be defined as an intimate interpersonal relationship where the individuals called friends spend a great deal of time together; interact in a variety of situations; are self-disclosing; demonstrate mutual trust; provide physical, economical and emotional support at the time of the need; and generally relax and feel comfortable in the company of each other.

We may also notice very clearly that as a mature individual we may have friendship with a number of persons at a time but whom we consider as our closer and intimate friends are in fact a quite few ones, more often only one or two in our life.

Romantic Relationships and Love

In the sequence of interpersonal relationships existing between two individuals, romantic relationships

and love fall a step next to the stage of close and intimate friendships existing between them. Such relationships existing between adolescents and mature adults know no boundary of age, caste, race, region, religion, language, socio-economic status or even sex. The sayings *love is blind and romance has no limitations* are reflected well in the loving and romantic relationships existing between we human beings.

Romance and romantic relationships have been a fascinating subject for discussion and presentation before the literary figures and artists all over the world in their creations and compositions. These types of relationships, while having similarity with the closeness and intimacy of friendly relationship in respect of degree of personal attraction, affiliation and attachment towards each other, differ from it in the following ways.

- There is a presence of certain aspects more in degree and quality in the romantic relationship such as sexual attraction, spending time together, similarity of attitudes and values and the belief that both of them share something special (Baccman et al., 1999).
- Partners in a romantic relationship are found to set higher standards for each other than for friends with respect to social status, physical attractiveness, warmth and intelligence (Sprecher and Regan, 2002).
- The presence of the element of sexuality is the main characteristic feature of a romantic relationship between two individuals ranging from holding hands, embracing, kissing to engaging in sexual intercourse.
- Besides sexuality, regular dating and spending time with each other is another characteristic feature of the romantic relationships.
- Each partner in a romantic relationship wants to believe that his or her partner is a perfect partner and also wants totally positive feedback from the partner (Katz and Beach, 2000).
- Each partner in a romantic relationship possesses his or her own ideals and he or she tries to validate the partner on these ideals. If the partner is perceived closer to one's ideal the

relationship is considered good and long lasting (Campbell et al., 2001).

Romantic relationships provide a genuine opportunity to the engaged partners in falling into loving relationship. Love as a term is considered to be lying on a quite higher footing than the mere simple or intense liking. It involves a lot of interpersonal attraction; affiliation; desire for interpersonal interaction; and acts of mutual give and take, trust and sacrifice on the part of the individuals engaged in a love affair. Rubin (1973) defined the term love as a sort of romantic relationship between two individuals attributed with three important elements named as caring, attachment and intimacy shown towards each other in their interpersonal interaction relatively in a higher proportion in comparison to that available in closer friendship.

In understanding the nature and implication of interpersonal love, socio-psychologists have tried to classify it in a number of ways. However, a classification which is more common and practicable categorizes human love as passionate and compassionate love. Let us examine both types of love.

Passionate Love

True to its naming, passionate love involves the element of passion (a strong feeling and current of an intense emotion) in its expression. Occurring usually during the early stages of a romantic relationship between two individuals, it has been defined by authors and socio-psychologists in the following ways:

Hatfield and Walster (1978): Passionate love may be defined as a state of intense physiological arousal and intense desire for union with another.

Baron and Byrne (2001): Passionate love represents an intense and often unrealistic emotional reaction to a potential romantic partner.

Crisp and Turner (2014): Passionate love is a state of intense longing for another person that is experienced during the early stage of romantic relationship. This is typically thought to involve very intense emotions, constantly thinking about the

lover, and wanting to spend as much time as possible with him/her, even to the exclusion of other friends.

Passionate Love

A type of love visible during the early stage or onset of romantic relationship and characterized with an overwhelming emotional state of arousal accompanied with a feeling of intense attraction and a state of intense longing for union with a loving partner.

On the basis of what has been conveyed about the passionate love in the earlier cited definitions, and some more findings of the sociologists about it, we may summarize its characteristic features as follows:

- This type of love usually occurs during the early stage or onset of romantic relationship.
- More often passionate love can arise suddenly without warning – literally, love at first angle (Averill and Boothroyd, 1977).
- In addition to being strongly attracted to the other person, people in passionate love try to maintain close physical proximity and remain always in a state of intense longing for union with the loving partner.
- People in this state of love tend to experience quite deep feelings and intense emotions for each other.
- They need to be near the potential loving partner, and experience extreme distress when separated.
- They are found to be thinking constantly about their loving target. Not only are these thoughts persistent, but these can also intrude at almost any time during the day or night.
- Passionate love depends primarily on specific observable cues provided by the potential loving partner, as well as on what one believes and expects about love (Baron and Byrne, 2001:290).
- Passionate love is characterized often with the unrealistic emotional reaction to the potential loving partner. It usually begins with as an instant, overwhelming and all-consuming positive reaction that recognizes no boundary.
- People in passionate love intend to be quite open for each other. Consequently, they want to know everything about their partner. They also want their partner to know everything about them.
- People in passionate love are found to believe that their loving partner can do no wrong. Further, they may also believe that their relationship is a perfect match and their loving partner is matchless.

Forms or Kinds of Passionate Love

Passionate love between two individuals may be reflected in its two varieties or forms known as requited love and unrequited love.

Requited love is a two-sided process witnessing the flow of the love traffic from both sides with equal intensity and force. Here the loving partners are found to share intense feelings of mutual attraction and longing for union with one another. *Unrequited love*, on the other hand, is a totally one-sided affair. Here only one individual is found to pass through an intensive current of passionate love and longing for union with the target love partner. In consequence thus, where requited love helps the two individuals in coming quite closer, forming the needing union and making romantic relationship with each other, the unrequited love pushes one in the state of despair, anxiety and loneliness.

Components of Passionate Love

Regarding the nature and structural composition of passionate love, Hatfield and Sprecher (1986) have pointed about its three distinctive components – cognitive (knowing), emotional (feeling) and behavioral (doing). Equipped with the cognitive component of passionate love, the individuals are preoccupied with the ideas and thinking about their loving partners, and a desire to know or be known by them. The emotional component of the passionate love works towards arousing the individuals physiologically

and emotionally, and creating sexual attraction and intense desire and craving for remaining together, and having opportunity for loving and getting love in return. The behavioral component of the passionate love is the component in action and accordingly helps the loving partners to serve the interests of each other including maintenance of physical closeness, intimacy and satisfaction of their need to love and be loved.

Compassionate Love

Another important type or form of human love, other than the passionate love, is designated as the compassionate or companionate love. As told earlier, it is the passionate love that is the very characteristic and identifying mark of the type of love witnessed at the earlier stages of our romantic relationship. It is marked by too much emotional intensity, thrill, excitement and a quite rosy picture of one another experienced on the part of loving partners. However, this stage of romantic relationship is not enduring, it is short lived. It either ends up in the breaking of romantic relationship or gets replaced by a relatively enduring romantic stage colored with the compassionate love. In fact, when we talk about a long-term romantic relationship, we are sure to observe that passionate love typically simmers down to compassionate love within a few years of its commencement. As a term compassionate love has been defined by the well-known authors and socio-psychologists in the manner as follows.

Berscheid and Walster (1978): Compassionate love is a more practical type of love and is a crucial aspect of a satisfying and lasting relationship. Such love emphasizes trust, caring and tolerance for a partner's mistakes and flaws.

Hatfield (1988): Compassionate love is the affection we feel for those with whom our lives are deeply intertwined.

Caspi and Herbener (1990): Compassionate love represents a very close friendship in which two persons are attracted, have a great deal in common, care about one another's well-being, and express mutual liking and respect.

Baron and Byrne (2001): Companionate/compassionate love is the love based on friendship, mutual attraction, common interests, mutual respect, and concern for one another's happiness and welfare.

Crisp and Turner (2014): If a relationship lasts beyond the passionate love stage, it is replaced by a less passionate but more enduring love defined by the term companionate (compassionate) love.

Compassionate Love

Referred also as companionate love compassionate love is characterized by a type of love that is not accompanied with passion or physiological arousal and that which is found to last long with a bond of close friendship, mutual trust, liking, respect and caring about one another's well-being.

The definitions cited earlier coupled with a number of research findings may help us in getting acquainted with the characteristic features of the term compassionate love in contrast to passionate love in the manner as given here.

- In our romantic relationships, the stage representing compassionate love steps in when the stage of passionate love – the stage of love initiation and romantic relation formation – has been crossed over.
- In comparison to passionate love (quick to fade) the stage of compassionate love is long-lasting but less passionate than passionate love.
- Compassionate love is found to be dominated by the feelings of intimacy, trust, commitment and affection. In comparison, where passionate love is marked by its intensity, compassionate love is characterized by its level of intimacy.
- Regarding commitment to each other, the people engaged in compassionate love are found to exhibit a more long-lasting and enduring commitment than the passionate lovers.
- Mutual sharing of feelings and concerns is a hallmark of compassionate love. Consequently,

it is quite natural for the individuals engaged in compassionate love to share every aspect of themselves with each other.

- Compassionate lovers, in comparison to passionate lovers, are found to be intensely and deeply involved in the care and well-being of each other. Moreover, they are found to be more open and knowing well about each other.
- Regarding having trust, the compassionate lovers are found to exhibit more trust and faith towards each other in comparison to the passionate lovers.
- Companionate lovers may be not found to exhibit wild passion, excitement or obsessive thoughts that are seen in passionate lovers. However, in place of these characteristics they are well seen to exhibit the necessary feelings of tenderness, a strong bond, friendship and enjoyment of the other's company.
- With the passage of time and growing in age, the compassionate lovers are found still to feel passionate about one another, but the intensity of passionate love making typically gets diminished with the passage of the time.
- With fewer exception, the compassionate lovers are found to remain in love with full dedication to each other even at the time of adversity, bad times and disagreement to each other on one or the other grounds.

Romantic Love and Marriage Relationship

There is a strong bond of relationship that exists between romantic love and married life. But what should follow or be followed one after the other is an issue that is definitely based on the norms followed in a particular culture. In the western culture and modern societies marriage relationships are formed after getting engaged in love affair and establishing romantic relationships. Making love and engaging in romantic intimacy before marriage is prohibited and decried in most of the eastern cultures. In Indian societies also the trend has been to have arranged marriages rather than allowing the customs of love making, dating, living in relationship and seeking sexual intimacy before

tying the knot. However, with the influence and effect of western culture and especially through the impact of movies and use of smart devices the practice of having love affairs and romantic relationship before marriage has begun to take its roots in the Indian society also, particularly in the sections that feel proud in being called modern and open.

Whatever trend may be followed in a society for allowing or not allowing love and romantic relationship including sex activities before getting married, it is but natural to get them practiced during the marriage relationship on the part of the married couples in all the societies worldwide.

What makes the two individuals come closer and get married? In making their own initiative for this purpose in the case of love marriages or leaving this matter to their parents or well-wisher in the case of arranged marriages, the following factors may be found to play their respective role.

- Similarity in respect of a number of attributes like interests, liking and disliking, attitudes, values, abilities and capacities, etc.
- The degree of attractiveness, physical features, color of the skin, physical and mental health including height and weight.
- Caste, religion, belongingness to a particular region or country, language spoken, etc.
- Socio-economic status, availability of material resources and power enjoyed in the society.

In general, whenever two parties try to seek deal for getting married, they try to avail as much they are able to get for them from the other side. However, perfect matching or what one aspires in relation to fulfill his or her requirement or desire about the marriage partner never becomes totally possible in seeking match for the marriage relationship. One has to make compromise or strive further (by dating or engaging in matrimonial alliance attempts) but, at the end, has to settle for less than perfect mate.

After getting married, a happy marriage relationship existing between the couple is known to be consisting of so many positive things like interpersonal attraction, mutual liking and attachment, friendship, love and romance, trust and commitment, sharing

and consideration, good communication including listening, sexual satisfaction, constructive management of arguments or disagreements and willingness to compromise in the case of differences of opinions or conflicts. However, all is not so simple in our marriage relationships. There arise situations when the things begin to turn on the negative side exhibiting wide fissures in the marital relationship giving birth to so many expected or unexpected marital problems casting deep effect on the continuance of marriage relationship.

In the marriage relationship love and romance play a quite significant role from its earlier beginning to the end of married life. Both types of love – passionate and compassionate – remain visible among the life partners for this purpose. The honeymoon phase and subsequent following years of the married life are excessively dominated by the passionate love. Interpersonal attraction, spending time in the company of each other, doing romance and erotic love and craving for the sexual satisfaction is the hallmark of the marriage relationship existing at this time, ignoring all the negative or adverse things about each other. After the expiry of the passionate love, romance and sex dominated phase of the early married life, there may arise now two situations or outcomes in the events of married life. One may be a happy combination of passionate and compassionate love that may help the couple to live and lead a happy well-adjusted married life by making them to understand each other in a better way and getting adjusted to each other's needs and requirements. The other outcomes may be visible in the form of difficult marriage relationship giving birth to a number of marital problems to the extent of separation and divorce. This is the time when the problem ridden couples need guidance and counseling from a capable professional for taking their marital life on the right track. However, much depends upon them – their willingness and initiatives for mending the fence. The gulf and distance created in the marriage relationship can be better managed by making renewed attempts for coming closer to each other in the ways as laid down here.

- They should try to spend time together in the manner and ways possible for them in their busy personal and professional life. During this time,

they should refrain from doing anything bitter that can bring them in endless argument. Here the opportunity should be explored for coming closer and talk to know what is hurting and what is expected now from each other for seeking honorable compromise in the mutual interest.

- The attempts for maintaining physical closeness in the ways and manner such as making eye contact, smiling, holding hands, kissing, hugging, massaging one another and simply sitting close together, may also work wonders in providing opportunity for opening up the grievances and mending fence.
- It is the mishandling of feelings or emotions that creates a gulf and distance in the relationships of the couples. Hence, well intended attempts for developing emotional closeness should be earnestly made by both the partners. They should try to become an attentive listener instead of remaining all vocal for putting up their side. After listening carefully to the partner about his or her feelings, thoughts, beliefs, values, hopes, worries, fears, dreams and ambitions, the other should try to open his or her self to his or her utter sincerity and honesty. The emotional closeness developed in this way may help them in getting solution of their differences.
- In many of the situations, the basic cause of bitterness as well as precipitating factor in spoiling the family relationship lies in the dissatisfaction or embarrassment resulted in the sex relations. Therefore, it is quite important for both the partners for remaining happy and satisfied in their sexual relationship. They should not give any opportunity for arising any suspicion or misunderstanding in their sex relationship. If it arises, somehow in the mind of a partner, no time should be wasted in its sorting out amicably. The differences arising in relation to the frequency, timing and mode of sexual activity should also be sorted out with a cool mind and mutual agreement. In any case, establishing sex relationship should not be made an instrument of getting the other partner agreed to one's viewpoint or showing one's resentment over one thing or the other. In case there is any difficulty

in remaining normal or feeling inconvenience and uncomfortable in sexual relationship, the proper advice and counseling should be secured from the appropriate professionals.

To Sum Up

In the sequence of interpersonal relationships existing between two individuals, romantic relationships and love fall a step next to the stage of close and intimate friendships. Such relationships existing between adolescents and mature adults know no boundary of age, caste, race, region, religion, language, socio-economic status or even sex.

Love as a term may be defined as a sort of romantic relationship between two individuals attributed with three important elements known as caring, attachment and intimacy shown towards each other in their interpersonal interaction relatively in a higher proportion in comparison to that available in closer friendship. In understanding its nature and implication we often classify it as passionate and compassionate love.

True to its naming, passionate love involves the element of passion (a strong feeling and current of an intense emotion) in its expression. Occurring usually during the early stages of a romantic relationship between two individuals it is characterized with the features like:

- Arising suddenly without warning – literally, love at first sight.
- Remaining strongly attracted to the other person, trying to maintain close physical proximity and remaining always in a state of intense longing for union with the loving partner.
- Marked by too much emotional intensity, thrill, excitement and a quite rosy picture of one another experienced on the part of loving partners.
- Reflected in its two varieties or forms known as requited love (two-sided love) and unrequited love (a one-sided affair).

- Possessing three behavioral components: cognitive (knowing), emotional (feeling) and behavioral (doing).

Compassionate love follows the stage of passionate love and is well enduring in its durability and sustainability. In comparison, where passionate love is marked by its intensity, compassionate love is characterized by its level of intimacy, trust, mutual sharing of feelings and concern as well as commitment to each other.

There is a strong bond of relationship that exists between romantic love and married life. The successful functioning of a married life depends much on the mutually satisfying romantic relationship existing between the married partners. Both types of love – passionate and compassionate – remain visible among the life partners for this purpose. The honeymoon phase and subsequent following years of the married life are excessively dominated by the passionate love. After the expiry of the passionate love, romance and sex dominated phase of the early married life, there may arise now two situations or outcomes in the events of married life. One may be a happy combination of passionate and compassionate love that may help the couples to live and lead a happy, well-adjusted married life. The other outcomes may be visible in the form of difficult marriage relationship giving birth to a number of marital problems to the extent of separation and divorce needing appropriate remedial measures in the form of making their own efforts and also seeking guidance and counseling from a capable professional for taking their marital life on the right track.

Review Questions

1. What is interpersonal attraction? Throw light on its meaning and nature.
2. What are the various theories of interpersonal attraction? Discuss any one of them in detail.

3. Discuss in brief the following theories of interpersonal attraction: (i) evolutionary theory of attraction, (ii) linear theory or reinforcement model, (iii) exchange theory of attraction, (iv) equity theory of attraction and (v) balance theory of attraction.
4. What are the various determinants of interpersonal attraction and relationship? Discuss them in brief.
5. Discuss the various types of interpersonal relationships known by the names such as: (i) early family relationships, (ii) close friendships and (iii) romantic relationships and love.
6. What is love? Know and discuss various types or forms of love relationships in the form of (i) passionate love, (ii) compassionate love and (iii) romantic love and marriage relationship.
7. Differentiate and discuss passionate and companionate or compassionate love, and tell how these are found to function in the marriage relationships between the life partners.

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13.

ALTRUISM AND PRO-SOCIAL BEHAVIOR

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- Discuss the meaning and nature of pro-social behavior.
- Define the term pro-social behavior.
- Talk about the meaning and nature of altruism and altruistic behavior.
- Differentiate and distinguish among the terms helping behavior, pro-social behavior and altruistic behavior.
- Tell about the concept “bystanders intervention in an emergency”.
- Discuss the perspective or theories explaining pro-social behavior.
- Throw light on the theories explaining pro-social behavior named as (i) empathy-altruism theory, (ii) negative state relief theory, (iii) empathic theory, (iv) competitive altruism theory and (v) kin selection theory.
- State the personality variables associated with pro-social behavior of the helpers.
- Elucidate the characteristics of those being helped.
- Tell about how one should feel to receive help.
- Name and discuss the various determinants of pro-social behavior.

Introduction

Every one of us must have witnessed one or the other scenes in life when some type of urgent help is needed by one or the other individuals at the time of some incidences, accidents or catastrophe like getting trapped in a heavy flood, deadly fire, damaging earthquake, tsunami, hurricane, road and rail accident, or fierce punching and life harming activities at the hands of bad elements. In addition to these

incidences, there may be occasions when help is needed on the part of the sick and disabled, older people and poor, orphans and homeless, hungry and needy at one or the other time from those who can afford to provide it. You must also have seen that not all of us present at the scene or being appealed for the help show the required courtesy of helping the needy. Many of us at that time remain the mere spectators or bystanders and only a few ones come forward to provide genuine help. Those who come forward are,

thus, here found to stand by a social cause, capable of truly portraying themselves as social beings for helping the needy at the time of their need. The behavior of these noble people is termed as helping behavior in a common sense. However, in the field of social psychology, it is designated by the term pro-social behavior. This behavior of human being takes a more refined and self-less shape when it is performed by someone with no intention of earning name or fame or getting any personal benefit. It has been named by the socio-psychologists as altruistic behavior and the motivation under which they perform this behavior as altruism. In this chapter, we will be focusing our attention on the description of pro-social behavior in its various aspects such as defining the term pro-social behavior, distinguishing it from altruistic behavior, the bystanders' apathy, altruistic personality, perspectives and approaches explaining pro-social behavior, and determinants of pro-social behavior of the individuals in their social life etc.

Pro-Social Behavior

As told earlier, there are people who stand by the sufferers and needy at the time of their distress and need, at their own on a voluntary basis. Such behavior of helping others at the time of their need is termed as helping behavior. It may range from simple act of picking the dropped stick of a disabled/aged, providing food to a hungry person, giving donations to a charitable trust, providing legal help to the needy poor or risking one's own life in saving a victim of flood, fire or any nature/man created disaster or painful incidence. We name all such types of helping behavior of the human beings as pro-social behavior in the field of social psychology as they serve the social cause of serving humanity by providing the required help to the needy in human society. It is a simple self-explanatory explanation of the term pro-social behavior. For understanding more about it, let us look into some formal definitions provided by social psychologists.

Staub (1978): Pro-social behavior is defined as behavior that benefits another person or has positive social consequences.

Eisenberg and Miller (1987:92): Pro-social behavior is the "social glue" that enables people of

different ages to live together peacefully and productively. Specifically, pro-social behavior has been defined as voluntary, intentional behavior that results in benefits for another person.

Eisenberg and Mussen (1989:3): Pro-social behavior refers to voluntary actions that are intended to benefit another individual or group of individuals.

Sears et al. (1991:367): Pro-social behavior is defined as any act that helps or is designed to help others, regardless of the helper's motives.

Batson (1998): Pro-social behavior is a much broader category. It is defined as any helpful action that benefits other people without necessarily providing any direct benefit to the helper and it may even involve risk for the helper.

Crisp and Turner (2014:250): Pro-social behavior in the form of helping behavior refers to acts where people voluntarily and intentionally behave in a way that they believe will benefit others, although at the same time the behavior may benefit them as well.

Barrett (2017): Pro-social behavior as a concept includes varied behaviors including volunteering,

Pro-Social Behavior

A form of helping behavior being performed intentionally on a voluntary basis regardless of the helper motives – selfish or self-less – resulting in benefits to another individual or group of individuals.

cooperation, conformity with social norms and even being polite.

The definitions cited earlier may help in revealing the following characteristic features of the term pro-social behavior.

- Pro-social behavior is a specific form of helping behavior that is intended to benefit others.
- Individuals in their personal capacity or as members of the group are helped through the pro-social behavior of the helpers.
- Besides proving beneficial to the individuals or group of individuals at the time of their need, it aims to bring harmony, peace, as well as welfare and progress of the society.

- The people as helpers get engaged in the pro-social behavior at their own intentionally and purposefully for benefitting others.
- The voluntary and intentional nature of the pro-social behavior gets it separated from other behaviors incidental or forced that may result in benefitting others.
- Pro-social behavior in the form of a helping behavior is a quite broad category or concept involving or including features like:
 - Pro-social behavior helps others regardless of the helper motives – selfish or self-less.
 - It may or may not provide any direct or indirect benefit to the helper.
 - It may or may not involve risk for the helper.
 - It is a quite broader concept in the sense that a number of varied activities/behaviors termed as serious or low cost as well as serious and high cost may be performed by people for benefitting others (Bierhoff, 2001).
 - A quite varied number of acts or behaviors may be performed by the people as a part of their pro-social behavior in the form of assisting, cooperating, encouraging, comforting, sharing, listening and attending others in a decent way.
 - The most distinguishing feature of the pro-social behavior is its capacity to benefit others in the domain of social welfare and progress irrespective of the helper's motive – self or self-less.
 - The behaviors known as altruistic behaviors – providing voluntary help to others with no selfish motive or expectation of reward in any form – are a sub-part or constituent of the broader term pro-social behavior.

Altruism and Altruistic Behavior

Altruistic behavior, as a part or category of pro-social behavior is based on altruism. Altruism as a term has been variously defined by the socio-psychologists in the manner given next.

Batson and Coke (1981): Altruism is motivated by a desire to help someone else rather than yourself.

Sears et al. (1991:367): Altruism can be defined as an act performed voluntarily to help someone else when there is no expectation of receiving a reward in any form.

Schroeder et al. (1995): Altruism means an unselfish concern for the benefit and welfare of others. In other words, altruism means performing an act voluntarily to help someone else when there is no expectation of reward in any form, except the feeling of having done a good and positive deed.

Hodgetts et al. (2010): Altruism as a term was introduced by Auguste Comte in 1851, to explain the effects of moral acts of individuals directed towards helping other individuals.

Crisp and Turner (2014:249): Altruism is a more specific form of helping behavior referring to an act of pro-social behavior which benefits others but is not expected to have any personal benefits.

Altruism or Altruistic Behavior

A type of pro-social behavior that falls in the line of morality driven behavior in its true sense on account of its being performed for benefitting others with no expectation of any personal gain and even at some cost to oneself.

The definitions cited earlier may help in revealing the following characteristic features of the term altruism and altruistic behavior.

- Altruistic behavior based on altruism is a comparatively smaller concept under pro-social behavior (Bierhoff, 2001).
- Altruism assumes there is no expectation of personal benefit to the person doing the helping.
- Altruistic behavior does not include behaviors that are incidental or behaviors that are a result of some selfish motive.
- The most distinguishing feature of altruistic behavior lies in its self-less motive. Here one helps or behaves for providing benefit to others with no intention of getting benefit to the self in any way.

- Altruistic behavior and altruism fall in the line of morality driven behavior in its true sense. Here people act and behave for the benefit and welfare of others as preached in all the great religions of the world.
- Although *altruistic behavior* falls in the category of pro-social behavior intended to benefit others, it differs from it more particularly in the sense that it is absolutely governed through an altruistic motive-providing benefit to others with no expectation of any personal gain and even at some cost to oneself. A good example of altruistic behavior is to give an anonymous donation to a person, group or institution without any resulting recognition, economic or political gain. Similarly, the act of an unknown bystander to save the life of a person attempting suicide by jumping in the river even at the risk of his own life with no intention of earning any benefit from his heroic deed also falls in the category of altruistic behavior.

Distinguishing Among the Terms Helping Behavior, Pro-Social Behavior and Altruistic Behavior

Helping behavior is the behavior that is intended to help or provide benefit to others in meeting out their needs or requirements. This help may be provided to one or the other individuals for serving their interests by the help giving people in case they intend to do so. Its dimension or direction may be pro-social or antisocial in its nature and consequences. Therefore, in the definition of helping behavior we are likely to include both the behaviors – having positive as well as negative social consequences, helping or obstructing the welfare and progress of the society. The assistance provided to the bad elements for engaging in the antisocial activities as well as helping the drug controllers in providing information about the drug peddlers may thus be equally entitled to be named as helping behavior in their own sense. Moreover, the tasks performed for fulfilling his or her obligations such as rearing or bringing up of their own children by parents, may thus also be included in the category of helping behavior. In this way, the term helping

behavior is a quite broader term. It includes all types of acts and behaviors involving duty performing, pro-social or antisocial helping acts and behaviors. The altruistic behavior – a special type or form of pro-social behavior – also falls within the umbrella term helping behavior.

Pro-social behavior is a type of helping behavior that is entirely pro-social in nature. Here help is provided to others with a full consideration that it will result in the welfare and progress of the society. In its occurrence and application, pro-social behavior involves helping and benefitting others irrespective of the nature of motives of the helper – self or self-less. In this way, pro-social behavior can be distinguished in its nature and scope from helping behavior, that is considered as a broader concept, and altruism (altruistic behavior), which is comparatively smaller concept under pro-social behavior (Bierhoff, 2001). All types of helping behavior, social in dimension, with the motive of serving the self or self-less interests of the helpers, are thus included in the category of pro-social behavior.

Altruistic behavior is a quite small concept in the field of helping behaviors in comparison to pro-social behavior with regards to its dimension as well implication. It differs from pro-social behavior in relation to the things laid down next.

- Both differ in relation to the motivation of the helper for benefitting others. While in pro-social behaviors, the helper may engage in the task of helping others with a number of motives – selfish and self-less – the altruistic behavior is carried out only on the part of a helper with a self-less motive (no intention of getting any benefit or reward of any kind).
- While all types of altruistic behaviors are termed as pro-social behavior, the reverse is not true. Many pro-social acts are not altruistic as they may not be carried out with a selfless motive. Directly or indirectly, they may be found to serve the interests of the helper in the manner as follows.
 - (i) Some pro-social acts are carried out for the satisfaction of ego or raising their socio-economic/political status, e.g., providing a

donation for feeling good or raising one's self in the eyes of others.

- (ii) Many times, exhibition of heroism may also guide the pro-social acts of the individuals. They may be found to involve themselves in courageous risk-taking behavior for becoming a hero in the eyes of others.
- (iii) Pro-social behavior may also be carried out for serving the future plan, e.g., working without salary for serving the ulterior motive to make the resume stronger or providing free legal advice to the needy for gaining popularity in the profession.

In this way, where the term helping behavior stands for an umbrella term for representing all types of helping behavior incorporating pro-social and altruistic behaviors in its domain, the term pro-social behavior is less wide in its scope in comparison to helping behavior but much wider and comprehensive than the altruistic behavior (limited only to the altruistic tasks of the helpers).

To Sum Up

The terms helping behavior, pro-social behavior and altruistic behavior distinguish from each other in respect of the broadness or comprehensiveness of their scope.

The term helping behavior is a much broader and comprehensive term in comparison to pro-social and altruistic behaviors. In the definition of helping behavior, we are likely to include both the types of behaviors – having positive as well as negative social consequences, helping or obstructing the welfare and progress of the society. Further, the term helping behavior is known to be an umbrella term for representing all types of helping behavior incorporating pro-social and altruistic behaviors in its domain.

Next comes the term of pro-social behavior. It is a type of helping behavior that is entirely pro-social in nature. All types of helping behavior, social in dimension, with the motive

of serving the self or self-less interests of the helpers, are thus included in the category of pro-social behavior. It is less wide in its scope and comprehensiveness in comparison to helping behavior but much wider and comprehensive than the altruistic behavior which is found to be limited only to the altruistic tasks of the helpers carried out only on their part with a self-less motive (no intention of getting any benefit or reward of any kind).

Bystanders Intervention in an Emergency

By the term bystanders in an emergency here we mean the persons who remain present at the scene of an emergency arising on account of the bad happenings such as a road or rail accident, drowning of person in the river or sea water, beating of a person or sexual harassment of a girl by some bad elements, or snatching of a golden chain of a lady by the chain snatcher, etc. at one or the other time. Out of these bystanders it has been observed that there are only a few or sometimes only a single person who opt for helping the needy in the emergency, as the majority among them play the role of non-helping bystanders. The question here arises, what makes such differences in the behaviors of the bystanders? What makes someone to engage in the help giving pro-social behavior and others simply stand around and do nothing? In their attempt to answer this question, the socio-psychologists Latané and Darley (1970) through their experimental work have proposed that likelihood of the bystanders in engaging in a pro-social behavior in an emergency situation is determined by a series of decisions that must be made quickly on their part for figuring out what if anything is going on and what they should do about it. These decisions, needing sequential steps for the timely intervention on the part of bystanders, may be identified and discussed as follows.

1. **Noticing or Failing to Notice the Critical Incident:** The task of bystander intervention – helping or not helping the victim – in an emergency situation begins with their noticing or failing

to notice the emergency incident. How can we expect from someone from the bystanders to come to help the victim/needy in the emergency condition unless he or she is in cognition of the incident? The mere presence of a person does not guarantee his awareness about the critical incident. One may be thinking about something and concentrating on something else and thus, may be unable to notice what unusual is happening at the spot. Consequently, one may not view what has happened with an accident ridden individual or hear the call of a sufferer at the hands of bad elements. In this situation, the story of receiving any help from his side automatically ends without any beginning in this concern. On the other hand, the people who are in a position to take due notice of the critical incident may be found to take their first step in moving towards providing help to the needy on the voluntary basis.

2. **Interpreting the Situation as an Emergency Requiring Help:** It represents the second stage of preparing the bystanders to engage in pro-social behavior. Here two situations may arise. In one situation, the bystanders after taking due notice of the perceived critical situation, and examining the situation in the light of their previous experiences and collecting relevant supplementary information on this ground may interpret the situation as an emergency for providing relief or assistance to the sufferer or victim and thus taking them a step ahead in their pro-social behavior. On the other hand, in another situation, even after taking due notice of the perceived critical situation, they may not be in a position to accept it as an emergency to act. It may be due to their lack of experience, inability to obtain complete information or its incorrect interpretation on their part. If it happens with them, then there is all possibility of their inclusion in the list of non-helping bystanders.
3. **Making a decision of assuming responsibility for providing help:** The third stage of providing or not providing help to the needy in an emergency is related to the decision taken by the

bystander/bystanders for owning responsibility on this account. In case people remain indifferent and do not come forward at this stage for owning their moral responsibility to help the person in crisis, they automatically become the non-helper bystanders. However, there may be some reasons of their indifferent attitude or apathy. In the case of more than one bystander there arises a question of who should lead. Why should I and not somebody else own responsibility of providing help? In this situation, generally, the bystanders look at others as to how they are reacting and if others do not react, they may not feel worthwhile to react. They consider safe to follow majority. On the other side, if he or she is a lone bystander or the only competent one among those present such as the trained nurse/medical personnel for providing needed care to the injured victim or the emergency patient, he or she is more likely to own moral responsibility of helping the sufferer. Whatever the case may be, it is quite essential for somebody among the bystanders to come forward and take personal responsibility of helping the needy in an emergency. Then and then only the required task of providing timely help to the needy can be assumed to be proceeding on the right track.

4. **Possession of the Necessary Knowledge and Skills for Helping:** One passing through the above mentioned three stages successfully might not be equipped with the necessary knowledge and skills for providing the required help to the needy in an emergency. Such bystanders are forced to remain a non-helping bystander. For example, you are there where a person is getting drowned in the river, however, except raising alarm (it's all even when you decide about for doing so as well as being competent in doing so in the proper manner) you can do nothing unless you are a good swimmer and possess necessary skills and competency for carrying out such a rescue operation. However, in some cases, the persons are found to risk their life even when they are a quite average swimmer. But, generally, the bystanders while engaging in such pro-social behavior take such a decision

after thinking well about their competency for the purpose.

5. **Making Final Decision to Help:** This is the last but a quite crucial and essential step and stage for giving shape to the reality of rendering help to the needy in an emergency. The successful passing out of the existing bystanders, through all the earlier mentioned four decision making stages of providing help to the needy in an emergency, can't bring any fruitful purpose unless they take a final decision at this stage for rendering help to the sufferer on their part in their own way according to their capacity. For this purpose, they may actively engage in providing help to the person in crisis even at the risk of their own life; may appeal and involve other bystanders for joining them in the help giving process; and may call and inform the other special agencies such as fire brigade, police personnel, local administration, ambulance agencies or social institutions providing help in an emergency. However, while taking the final decision of helping the victim, the bystander is supposed to engage in weighing the positive vs. negative consequences of helping act (Fritzsche et al., 2000). In this connection, Dovidio et al. (1991) with the help of their research work have established that in the situations where there is a greater possibility of getting rewards in comparison to potential costs to both the helper and the victim, the chances are greater for getting help on the part of the victim. However, reverse is also true. The final decision taken on the part of the bystanders is more often inhibited by potential negative consequences of the behavior emerging on the scene in greater degree in comparison to the positive outcome for the helper. Commenting on this aspect, McGuire (1994) writes:

Helping may be inhibited by fears about negative consequences. If you try to help a person who slipped on the ice, you may fall down yourself. If you help a person who is coughing and groaning on the sidewalk, you may get your cloths dirty or catch a

disease. And most serious of all, remember the man who helped an accident victim and then was mistakenly shot to death by the victim's son. Altogether, unless one is especially motivated to provide help, helping may not occur because the potential costs simply appear too great.

The fear of the possibility of negative consequences, thus, may force the bystanders to take a final decision of not helping the needy in an emergency in their own interest. It is why, in our country anywhere, if any accident victim asks for help, the first thing that a bystander has in mind is what will be the consequences? Will he be questioned and harassed by the policeman for helping a person after the accident? The persons bearing altruistic personality or taking risk in life for a good cause may only be found to demonstrate pro-social behavior in such conditions.

The stage and steps discussed earlier involving the decision of one or the other nature in terms of helping or not helping the victim in an emergency thus have to be crossed over by the bystanders in their respective sequence. The failure to arrive at a desirable decision contributing towards helping behavior at one or the other stage may bring them in the category of non-helping, indifferent or apathetic bystanders.

To Sum Up

The term bystanders stands for the persons who remain present at the scene of an emergency arising on account of the bad happenings or accidents. Out of these bystanders it has been observed that there are only a few ones who opt for helping the needy in the emergency, the majority among them play the role of non-helping bystanders.

The likelihood of the bystanders in engaging or not engaging in a pro-social behavior is determined by a series of decisions that must be made quickly on their part. These decisions needing sequential steps for the timely intervention on their part may be identified as:

noticing or failing to notice the critical incident; interpreting the situation as an emergency requiring help; weighing the pros and cons of intervening in this situation; possessing the necessary knowledge and skills for doing help; making the decision of assuming responsibility for providing help; and making the final decision to help.

The Perspectives or Theories Explaining the Pro-Social Behavior

Why do certain people engage in the pro-social behavior? To provide necessary explanation, socio-psychologists have arrived at some well-known perspectives or theories. Let us here try to discuss some of the important ones in their necessary details.

Empathy-Altruism Theory

The credit of bringing this theory goes to a group of socio-psychologists comprising of Batson, Duncan, Ackerman, Buckley and Birch (1981). According to this theory, people engage in pro-social behavior on account of the emotional arousal resulted through the empathy felt for the victim in distress. Empathy as a term refers to putting oneself in the other's shoes i.e., understanding the situation from the other's perspective. The generation of such emotional arousal, on account of the empathy felt, drives an individual for getting engaged in the altruistic pro-social behavior (i.e., to help the victim with a least consideration of serving any self-motive). The stronger is the feeling of empathy generated through the plight of the sufferer, the more intensive emotional arousal it will produce for forcing the potential helper to help the victim for ending his plight.

Empathy-Altruism Theory

A pro-social behavior theory emphasizing that people engage in pro-social behavior on account of the emotional arousal resulted through the empathy felt for the victim in distress.

In this connection, Batson and Batson et al. (1995) tried to conclude through their research work that at least some pro-social acts are motivated only by the desire to help someone in need which is aroused through the empathy felt for the victim in plight. If such motivation is strong, the helper is willing to engage even in dangerous and life-threatening activity.

Negative State Relief Theory

The credit of bringing this theory goes to Cialdini et al. (1981). According to it, we help the victim in distress because our doing so provides us a sense of relief or uprights our spoiled mood by reducing our own negative feelings aroused for one or the other reasons. These negative feelings or the unpleasant state of our mood may result through the observation of the plight or suffering of the victim i.e., the bleeding body of an accident victim or the plight of a helpless person being brutally assaulted by a group of bad elements. However, these negative feelings are not necessarily aroused by observing the plight or suffering of the victim. One may be passing through a bad mood or the unpleasant state of his mind on account of some one or the other personal or social reasons. The opportunity to come forward for helping a needy in an emergency gives the persons what they needed for getting out of their unpleasant state of mind or mood. They engage in a pro-social act as a way to improve or set right their own negative mood. In this way, according to negative state relief theory, people help the victim in order to improve their mood by reducing negative emotions through offering help (Dietrich and Berkowitz, 1997).

Negative State Relief Theory

A pro-social behavior theory emphasizing that we help the victim in distress because our doing so provides us a sense of relief or uprights our spoiled mood by reducing our own negative feelings aroused for one or the other reasons.

Empathic Joy Theory

This theory owes its origin through the experimental efforts made by Smith et al. (1989). This theory suggests that empathy alone cannot make the helpers respond and help a victim; it should be accompanied by an inherent joy or a purpose that is well visualized by them to get served as a result of their helping the victim. In other words, according to this theory help giving people engage in a pro-social act not because of empathy but because they want to accomplish something and doing so is rewarding for them. Thinking in this way, it becomes quite apparent that if people help the victim in an emergency, only for empathy, then they would not be concerned about the feedback of its effect.

Empathic Joy Theory

A pro-social behavior theory emphasizing that empathy alone cannot make the helpers respond and help a victim; it should be accompanied by an inherent joy or a purpose that is well visualized by them to get served as a result of their helping the victim.

To test this hypothesis Smith, Keating and Stotland, the propagators of the theory of empathetic joy, conducted an experimental study. In this experiment, the undergraduates as the research participants had to watch a video about a young female student saying that she might drop out of college because she felt isolated and distressed. According to the opinion of the research participants, she was described as similar to one group and dissimilar to another group. The researchers took them as high and low empathy participants. After watching the videotape, the participants (having high sympathy and low sympathy with the sufferer) were randomly divided into two groups and were asked to give helpful advice. The participants of one group were told that they would be given a feedback of effectiveness of their advice, and the participants of the other group were told that they would not come to know what the suffering female student decided to do in response to their

helpful advice. Results showed that empathy alone was not enough for eliciting the needed pro-social behavior among the potential helpers among the participants. They were found to demonstrate pro-social behavior (ready to provide helpful advice) only if there was a higher empathy accompanied by the feedback about the impact of their advice.

Competitive Altruism Theory

The role of competitive altruism in arousing pro-social behavior among individuals has been demonstrated repeatedly in studies such as performed by the socio-psychologists like Hardy and Van Vugt (2006), and Flynn et al. (2006) with humans. For instance, it is found in these studies that individuals are more generous when their behavior is visible to others and altruistic individuals receive more social status and are selectively provided a great honor in the society in the shape of being treated as a group leader, honorable chairmen of a trust, a big hero or even honored by naming the roads and building after them. The findings of their studies have resulted in the emergence of a perspective or theory named as competitive altruism theory for explaining the pro-social behavior of the potential helpers.

Competitive Altruism Theory

A pro-social behavior theory emphasizing that people compete with others in a bid to demonstrate themselves as more and more altruistic as well as foresee the possibility of the enhancement of their status and reputation in the society and also in the eyes of the person being helped.

According to this perspective people help others because in doing so they foresee the possibility of the enhancement of their status and reputation in the society as well as in the eyes of the person being helped. In doing this, the individuals are often motivated to help others by weighing the possibility of benefits arrived against the cost incurred in this

venture. Surely the reward gained in terms of raising their value and status in the eyes of the society or the helped ones is bound to be much greater always than the cost involved in providing help by them. After all, what does one need after accumulating wealth, attaining power or possessing capacity to help one in the emergency? It is nothing but the desire for getting accepted by others as a generous and altruistic personality. It is this craving that motivates them for engaging in pro-social acts like giving a donation to a charitable trust, saving a female sufferer from the clutches of the offenders and helping an accident victim. They become a hero – the person of liking and admiration by others – and it is what ultimately motivates the individuals to get engaged in pro-social acts of one or the other nature at one or the other time.

Kin Selection Theory

The credit of bringing this theory into the limelight goes to the research work carried out by sociopsychologists Burnstein et al. (1994). According to this theory people generally do not provide help to anybody anywhere indiscriminately. For engaging in the pro-social behavior, they certainly seem to be quite choosy and help only those who are somewhat known to them and in this respect also particularly prefer their kith and kin who are biologically related to them. Neyer and Lang (2003) have also confirmed the assertion of this perspective through their research work by concluding that in general, we are more likely help others to whom we are biologically related (share our genes) in comparison to those people to whom we are not related.

Kin Selection Theory

A pro-social behavior explaining theory emphasizing that people instead of providing help to anybody anywhere indiscriminately, remain quite choosy and help only those who are somewhat known to them and particularly their kith and kin who are biologically related to them.

Why are we inclined much in protecting our kith and kin by providing them the necessary help at the time of emergency even at the risk of our own life? In explanation, the believers in this theory try to say that actually by helping our kith and kin in an emergency, we tend to oblige ourselves more than somebody else. From the evolutionary perspective, the main goal of all the organisms is passing their genes to the next generation and thus, establishing them a significant contributor towards the survival and existence of their own species. The next thing that is required most for the survival and existence of one's own kinds is concerned with the help rendered to them at the time of the emergency endangering their survival and welfare. The pro-social behavior of the people noticed at the time of preferring their kith and kin for rendering help at the time of emergency, is thus nothing but the attempts of fulfilling the obligation of the maintenance of the cycle of species of one's own kinds on this earth.

Burnstein, Crandall and Kitayama conducted a series of studies in 1994 for proving the assertion of this theory. These studies showed that participants of the study preferred to help their close relatives over others in an emergency situation. Participants also preferred to help younger relatives rather than the older. Why did they do so? In its explanation, the researchers tried to suggest that it happened because the participants had in their mind that the younger generation needs to be saved first because they had more chances of passing on their genes to the next generation for a longer time.

This theory has come into criticism by claiming that it is not always true that in the pro-social behavior people always help their biological similar. Many a times we help the persons who are quite unknown having no relationship of a genetic nature or friendship of any nature. Why we do so can be explained through the principle of reciprocal altruism. It states that usually people help others who are unrelated to them because the task of helping is usually reciprocal. It does not only benefit the person being helped but also benefit the helper in one or the other ways such as providing inner happiness and satisfaction, increasing their status and glory, providing them some or the other material benefit for their contribution.

To Sum Up

Socio-psychologists have provided some theories to give necessary explanation for the pro-social behavior of the people, named as empathy-altruism theory, negative state relief theory, empathic theory, competitive altruism theory and kin selection theory.

According to *empathy-altruism theory*, brought out by Batson et al. (1981), people engage in pro-social behavior on account of the emotional arousal resulted through the empathy (understanding the situation from the other's perspective) felt for the victim in distress.

According to *negative state relief theory*, brought out by Cialdini et al. (1981), we help the victim in distress because our doing so provides us a sense of relief or uprights our spoiled mood by reducing our own negative feelings aroused for one or the other reasons.

According to *empathic joy theory*, brought out by Smith et al. (1989), empathy alone cannot make a helper respond and help a victim; it should be accompanied by an inherent joy or a purpose that is well visualized by him to get served as a result of his helping the victim. In other words, according to this theory a helper engages in a pro-social act not because of empathy but because he wants to accomplish something and doing so is rewarding for him.

According to *competitive altruism theory*, brought out by Hardy and Van Vugt (2006); and Flynn et al. (2006), people help others because in doing so they foresee the possibility of the enhancement of their status and reputation in society as well as in the eyes of the person being helped. In competing with others in this case, they try to demonstrate themselves as more and more altruistic.

According to *kin selection theory*, brought out by Burnstein et al. (1994), people generally do not provide help to anybody anywhere indiscriminately. For engaging in the pro-social behavior, they certainly seem to be quite choosy and help only those who are somewhat known

to them and in this respect also particularly prefer their kith and kin who are biologically related to them.

Personality Variables Associated With Pro-Social Behavior of the Helpers

Helped through the viewpoints expressed in the already discussed theories for providing explanation to the pro-social behavior of the helping individuals, socio-psychologists have tried to sort out what type of personality variables are the hindrance or helpful in the promotion of pro-social behavior among individuals. The personality variables owned by the personality types such as aggressive personality, narcissistic, neurotic, delinquent and Machiavellianism are reflected in their selfish, unsympathetic, uncontrollable, distrustful, cynical, egocentric and manipulative behavior. People ranking high on these characteristics are less likely to show pro-social behavior (McHoskey, 1999). On the other hand, the quality of putting others first, showing concern for their problems and distress, readiness to help them in need, courage and patience to bear the cost of helping others, and sacrificing own privileges for the cause of the needy are some of the usual characteristics found in the personality of the helping people. In the language of social psychology, the true helpers are characterized with a unique type of pro-social personality known as altruistic personality. The main features visible in an altruistic personality as pointed out by Bierhoff et al. (1991) may be summarized as follows.

1. **Highly Empathetic:** Altruistic people are found to be highly empathetic in their behavior towards others, especially the victims in distress. Studies have indicated a positive correlation between dispositional empathy and pro-social behavior (Bierhoff, 2001).
2. **Strong Believer in the Just World:** An altruistic personality is well characterized with a positive tendency of believing in the just, fair and predictable world. They think and believe that there's a justice in this world, and what you do

with the others is liable to return to you in the same way – good or bad.

3. **Owning Social Responsibility:** The people showing pro-social altruistic behavior are found to demonstrate a quite responsible behavior by owning responsibility of helping the needy in distress. They consider it as their moral duty and believe that each person is responsible for doing her or his best to help the needy in distress.
4. **Possessing Internal Locus of Control:** The altruistic people are characterized with the possession of an internal locus of control. This is the belief that one can behave in such a way as to maximize good outcomes and minimize bad ones – that the individual can make a difference and is not helplessly at the mercy of luck, fate and other uncomfortable forces (Baron and Byrne, 2001:369).
5. **Absence of Ego-Centeredness:** The altruistic people are not ego-centric. Ego-centric people are self-centered, self-observed and competitive. Their self is always great and dear to them, and such people are not supposed to engage in the pro-social behavior. Thus, more often ego-centric people are found to play the role of an apathetic bystander or utilizing the opportunity of helping others in crisis for serving their ulterior motives such as snatching the ornaments and other belongings of the accident victims as an excuse of helping them. In contrast, the altruistic people play their helping role in a true form by remaining away from the evils of ego- and self-centeredness.

The Characteristics of Those Being Helped

The pro-social behavior demonstrated on the part of the helpers in one or the other emergency tends to provide help and assistance to the needy in time. However, it should also be noted that one is not found to show pro-social behavior towards each and every one indiscriminately with no consideration of their state of need and personality characteristics in one or the other particular situation. In general, the following characteristics may be found to decide

whether or not they will receive help from the potential helpers.

1. *Responsible or Not Responsible for the Problem:* Those who receive help from the potential helpers are the persons that are usually adjudged as innocent – not at all responsible for the creation of the problems that they are suffering from. On the other hand, the persons who are very much responsible for creating their own problems and difficulties often get neglected on the part of the potential helpers. All this is for a simple reason, where, the help seekers like a habitual drinker lying on the road or a person falling in debt after losing all his money for his bad habit of gambling are often denied assistance even from the generous helpers, while, the poor person helpless in bearing the expenses of the marriage of his daughter or a person who lost his ticket and purse due to pick pocketing is very often helped through the potential helpers.
2. *Sense of Appeal for Help:* The people who get help from the potential helpers are usually found to possess a favorable sense of appeal on one or the other grounds such as (i) similarity to the potential helper in terms of belongingness to the same region, state or country, caste, sect or religion, social class and status, nature of work and profession, etc.; (ii) good looking and attractiveness; and (iii) belongingness to one's own family, group and community, race and ethnicity, etc.
3. *His Perception as a Deserving One for Getting Priority in Help:* The people perceived as the deserving ones are more helped by the potential helpers in comparison to those who do not seem so. Here the nature and degree of legitimacy do play a crucial role. Accordingly, a woman beggar unable to cover her body gets preferred for the donation of clothes, in comparison to the male counterparts. Actually, the non-deservingness of the people seeking help may arise the feelings of discontent, apathy and anger among the potential helpers. Accordingly, in the case of the people being perceived in distress due to the situation created through their own intentional mistakes and antisocial habits, it is not unusual

to see them falling as a victim of anger and discontent rather than of concern and care at the hands of the potential helpers.

How Should One Feel to Receive Help?

In hearing this, we may at once raise voice against the absurdity of this very question. What can be expected from a help receiving person other than usual i.e., being thankful to the help giver for his act of giving assistance at the time of need? In a usual practice, when someone happens to provide us help at the time of our need, the common expectation from us is to feel obliged and express our gratitude to the helper. However, the same is not universal and may not happen in every instance. Here, it is also not at all unusual to witness the people receiving help experience discomfort and even feel resentful towards a person who is providing help to them. As example, we may quote some or the other elderly adults needing help from others on account of their old age or some specific physical impairment but after receiving help feel depressed on account of such help and even express their resentment towards their helpers who have made them so due to their ceaseless assistance. Similarly, the attempts for helping somebody in times of their economic difficulties may sometimes be resented on the part of victims by taking it as an attempt of getting them humiliated specially in the case when the help is coming from the people of their own status and category. Now the question may arise, what should be the reasons or causes inherent in such resentful and non-obliging behavior of the people who have been helped by the good persons in their difficulties and needs?

The more important and prevalent cause, in this concern, is essentially linked with the self-esteem of the human beings. People here feel a sense of rupturing of their self-esteem on account of being helped or getting offer for the help particularly from the person similar in education, status, age and many other characteristics (Depaulo et al., 1981). In all its way, thus the people feel hurt on account of the lowering of their self-esteem and as a reactionary measure develop the feeling of disliking and resentment towards the helper. The truth regarding such role of

the self-esteem and the after effect has been under scrutiny on the part of socio-psychology researchers from time to time. Some of their findings in this regard are briefed as follows.

- It has been found that when a member of a stigmatized group (e.g., black) gets the unasked help from a member of a non-stigmatized group then it is perceived as a patronizing insult (Schneider, 1976).
- In general, when people are helped by someone just equal and similar to them, they feel insulted most probably for the reason that receiving such type of help may raise question about their competitiveness and expose their unworthiness well before their equal and similar. That is why where, helping from non-sibling or non-similar person is seen more positively, the help from younger sibling or other similar person (age, income, profession, etc.) is taken in an unpleasant way (Searcy and Eisenberg, 1992).
- For the persons who respond to their being helped in a resentful negative way there is one positive aspect that accompanies, and it is that the person is motivated for self-help in future (Fisher et al., 1982). Such motivation may prove a great boon to them as it can help them to work hard for reducing their dependency on others. For example, feeling not good for receiving financial help from close relatives may motivate one to work hard and avoid such hardships in the future.

To Sum Up

The true helpers are found to be characterized with a unique type of pro-social personality known as altruistic personality. The main features visible in an altruistic personality may be identified as: highly empathetic, strong believer in the just world, owning social responsibility, possessing internal locus of control and absence of ego-centeredness.

Regarding the characteristics of those being helped by the pro-social or altruistic persons at the time of emergency we may see them

to be attributed by the characteristic features like: adjudged as not at all responsible for the creation of the problems that they are suffering from; possessing a favorable sense of appeal for seeking help from others and demonstrating characteristics of being perceived as a deserving one for getting priority in help.

Regarding how one feels in receiving help from others at the time of need, it may be seen that people may demonstrate a mixed type of positive and negative responses. While in majority of cases they feel obliged and respond by expressing thanks, there are possibilities where the people receiving help experience discomfort and even feel resentful towards a person who is providing help to them. In all such cases, it happens because they feel hurt on account of the lowering of their self-esteem and as a reactionary measure develop the feeling of disliking and resentment towards the helper.

Determinants of Pro-Social Behavior

The determinants or factors influencing the pro-social behavior of the individuals may be broadly categorized as (i) internal or personal factors and (ii) external or situational factors. Let us try to examine the role of these factors in affecting and influencing the pro-social behavior of the potential helpers.

Internal or Personal Factors

The factors falling in this category are said to be internal in the sense that they are found to lie within the person supposed to be a helping hand to someone in difficulty. We may include the following factors in this category.

1. **Genetic Predisposition:** Some people are more genetically predisposed to demonstrate pro-social behavior than others. Although there exists no evidence of a gene that determines pro-social behavior, among humans there are

genetically based capacities to communicate one's emotional state and to form social bonds. These inherited aspects of social behavior make it likely that we will help one another when the need arises (Buck and Ginsburg, 1991). In this way, the amount or degree to which people are inherently sociable, they may be found to demonstrate pro-social behavior in their social interaction.

2. **Physical Health:** We should be physically healthy for getting us to feel better in terms of our physical well-being. If we are not physically healthy and well, we are not expected to think and care about others in their need. In this condition, our whole attention and efforts are naturally directed towards our own care. It is why a quite positive correlation exists between people's better or at least normal physical health and their pro-social behavior.
3. **Competency:** Competency of a person is directly linked to the behavioral performance of an individual. The same is also true for the occurrence of a pro-social behavior in a particular emergency or help needing situation. Here people are found to demonstrate their pro-social behavior to the degree or extent to which they are skilled or competent for doing so. Accordingly, in an emergency situation, if one or the other bystanders feel that they are competent to deal with a problem they are more likely to engage in pro-social behavior. For example, in an emergency needing first aid to the heart patients or the persons needing treatment after getting their rescue from drowning in the river the potential helpers have to be reasonably acquainted with the know-how of such first aid. The more the people are competent in doing so, the more they will put themselves in the position of providing help in such a situation. In this way, the competency possessed on the part of bystanders draws them towards the needed pro-social behavior in the ratio of the competency required from them in helping the victims in an emergency.
4. **Mental and Emotional State:** The thinking and feeling components of one's behavior govern the

total action-oriented behavior of the individual. What we think and feel, thus, certainly decides our course of action in one or the other behavioral situation including helping others in need in the manner briefed here.

- Where in the state of good and even normal mental health one enjoys the needed capacity to devote one's efforts for helping others, the poor mental health and disturbed state of one's mind prove a great obstacle in doing so on one's part.
- One's emotions good or bad exercise a great impact in deciding the shape – in magnitude and direction – of one's behavior. We can't expect a thing – good and normal like pro-social behavior – from the individuals at the time of their being in the current of uncontrolled flow of negative emotions like fear, anger, hate, jealousy, guilt, sorrow, grief, etc.
- In our day-to-day life, the mental and emotional states of ours in their positive and negative nature are found to take the shape of good and bad mood. It is these good and bad mood conditions of the individuals that are stated to play a quite decisive role in determining their helping or non-helping behaviors in the social situations in the manner as explained next.
- Regarding the impact of positive mood over pro-social behavior, there is a general assumption suggesting that we are more likely to help if we are in a good mood as compared with when we are in a bad mood. Research suggest that people are more willing to help others when they are in a good mood, maybe when they are enjoying some nice outings, or when they have watched some comedy film (Cunningham, 1979). However, further research done in this area suggests that there is no such direct positive correlation between our moods and the pro-social behavior. There may be situations where the bystanders, who are in

the positive mood, may not be willing to help the needy because that may interfere with their good mood and they do not want to spoil their mood by performing helping actions that are difficult and unpleasant. Commenting on this aspect, Isen (1984) writes:

A person who is very happy has a sense of power, including the power to say no to a request for help and then to walk away. Whenever being helpful means that one's good mood will possibly be spoiled, positive emotions actually result in less helpfulness.

- Regarding the impact of negative mood on pro-social behavior it is also generally believed that when people are in a bad mood, they are less likely to help others. But if their helping acts generate positive feeling, people in the bad mood, as already explained by the negative state relief model of pro-social behavior, are more likely to help as compared with people in a neutral or positive mood (Cialdini et al., 1981).
5. **Personality Traits or Characteristics:** There exist individual differences in individuals with regard to the intention and capacity of demonstrating helping behavior towards the needy. The researchers in social psychology in this regard have concluded that the helping may be caused as a result of the presence of some unique personality traits already pointed out in this chapter in the form of (i) empathy, (ii) strong belief in the just world, (iii) social responsibility, (iv) an internal locus of control and (v) absence of ego-centrism.

Besides these, researchers have also pointed out the role of certain other personality traits or characteristics in the demonstration of pro-social behavior of the individuals discussed as follows.

- *Interpersonal Trust:* People who possess a high degree of interpersonal trust engage in more pro-social behavior than the people who have

a low degree of interpersonal trust, and therefore, mistrust others (Cadenhead and Richman, 1996).

- *Self-Efficacy*: The people equipped with a strong sense of self-efficacy (belief that one's actions are likely to be successful) are found to be more pro-social than those who have a low degree of self-efficacy. Actually, as claimed by Colby and Damon (1995), like empathy, self-efficacy is also related to small and short-term forms of help as well as long-term forms of help.
- *Selfish or Unselfish Nature*: The believers in pro-social behavior are large hearted. They do not come to help others for serving their one or the other interests or purposes. On the contrary, the

people whose main motive is self-interest are not concerned with others' welfare. They do not have a genuine urge for serving humanity.

- *Moral Integrity*: The people possessing an integrated moral personality (believing in truly ethical, moral and human values by remaining away from moral hypocrisy) are found to demonstrate more helping behavior in comparison to those who seriously lack in the possession of this virtue. They are not moral hypocrites – wanting to appear moral while avoiding the cost of being moral. In their saying and doing, these people are always concerned about doing good to others and even at the greater sacrifice of their interest and comfort try to help the needy in an emergency.

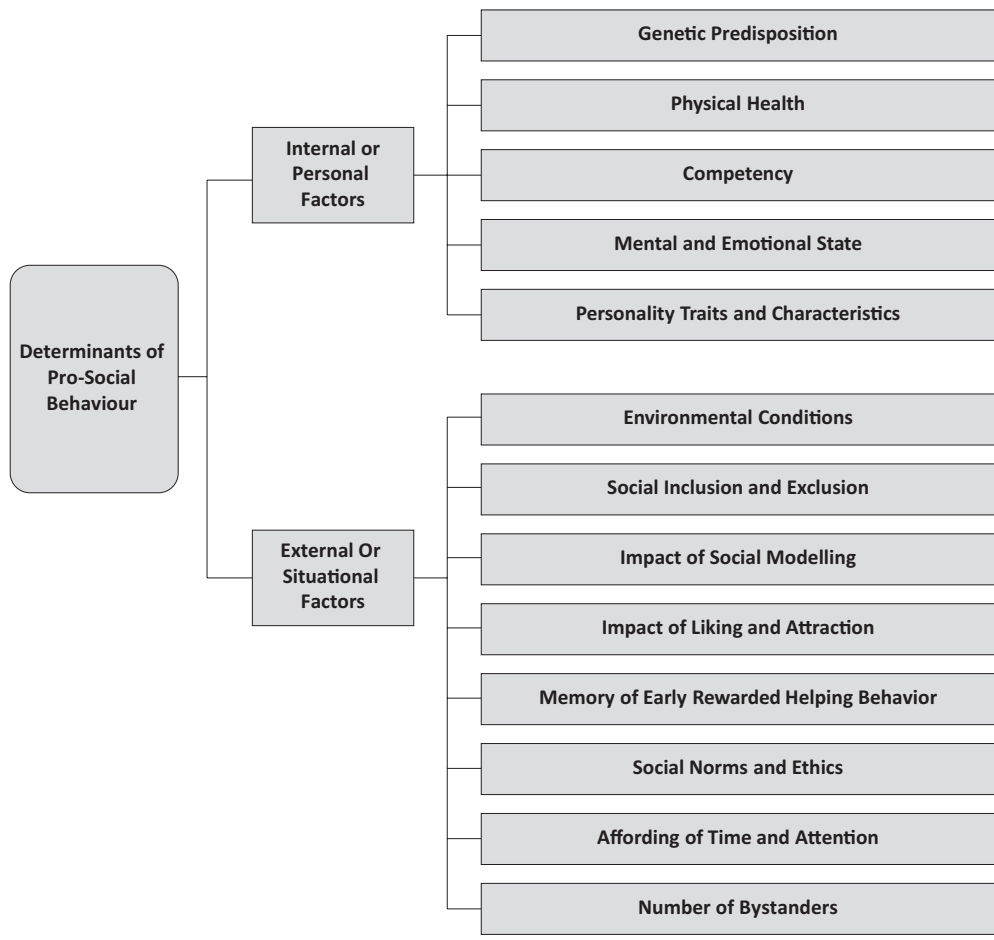


Figure 13.1 Determinants of Pro-Social Behavior

External or Situational Factors

The factors falling in this category are said to be external or situational in the sense that they are found to lie outside the person in one's environment or situations created from time to time giving birth to a need of helping others in difficulty. We may include the following factors in this category.

1. *Environmental Conditions:* Environmental conditions prevalent at the time of helping the needy contribute significantly in influencing the pro-social behavior of the helpers. In this concern, we may particularly name weather conditions prevailing at the time of help given to the needy. There seems to be a quite positive correlation between the favorable weather conditions and readiness for rendering help to the needy. Here reverse also stands quite true as the unfavorable weather conditions like temperature extremities, climatic adversities and roughness of weather on one or the other grounds make one uncomfortable and circumstances inconvenient for rendering help to the help seekers in need. In order to study the impact of the weather conditions on the helping behavior, Ahmed (1979) through his research finding reported that when the weather was sunny rather than rainy, people provided more help to a stranded motorist.

In addition to weather conditions, the other things related to our environment – physical and social such as life in small town vs. city; slums and lower income colonies vs. posh colonies; low income group families vs. higher status families – provide more opportunities and favorable conditions for developing closeness and mutually helping attitude among the inhabitants. Moreover, strangers are also more likely to be helped in small and less prosperous communities than the larger and much prosperous (Levine et al., 1994).

2. *Social Inclusion and Exclusion:* Social inclusion and exclusion of the individuals is also found to influence their helping and non-helping behavior. The research evidences such as experiments

conducted by Twenge et al. (2007) have concluded that while the people feeling included in the mainstream of the society feel safe, secure and confident in helping others in need, the socially excluded, on the other hand, suffer from the feelings of insecurity and lack of confidence. They are busy with their own feelings of rejection and abandonment and they have less emotion left for experiencing concern for others. As a result, thus, social exclusion has lasting effects and prevents people from building the social relationships and helping attitude.

3. *Impact of Social Modeling:* The initiative taken by somebody in the demonstration of pro-social behavior for some noble cause may work for the others as a model behavior. It is the observation of this model behavior that may be found to work as a great motivator to the observers for getting them engaged in the pro-social behavior as per need of the situation. When one devotee takes lead in donating an amount for the construction of the temple hall, others present in the gathering gradually try to announce their own donation amount. The impact of modeling on the promotion of pro-social behavior can be more clearly exemplified through the bystander's behavior at the time of some emergency or accident. The whole crowd of the bystanders at the accident scene may be seen watching all what is happening with no initiative for intervention from their side. As soon as some initiative for rendering help is taken from somebody, it models their apathetic behavior into a helping behavior. In this concern, Bryan and Test (1967) with the help of their research work have tried to conclude that in many situations, the presence of a helpful bystander provides a strong social model and the result is an increase in helping behavior among the other bystanders.

Besides this, socio-psychologists like Sprafkin et al. (1975) and Forge and Phemister (1987) through their experimental findings have also established that media – television, movie, on-line communication on the computer and smart phone devices – may also work as a great opportunity provider for

modeling the pro-social behavior of the individuals. How help is required and given with generosity on the part of heroes and heroines, at the time of need, may be found to work as a quite stimulating factor for modeling the pro-social behavior of the spectators in the required direction.

4. *Impact of Liking and Attraction:* It has been established on the basis of experimental evidence that our liking and attraction for somebody works as a great stimulating factor in helping them in need. Actually, in this case, as observed by Clark et al. (1987), the more we like and get attracted to a person, the stronger our tendency to provide needed assistance will be.

In our day-to-day interaction and social life, it is not uncommon for us to face situations when we show our preferences and liking for one or the other individuals, and get attracted towards them on one or the other varying grounds. These are the individuals who are more likely to get our attention and care in terms of providing help to them in need.

In relation to the reasons or grounds for our liking and attraction towards one or the other individuals we may say that it may happen on account of some similarity visible between us and them such as speaking the same language, belonging to the same region, province, country or parts of the globe. We may know and like somebody on the basis of their work and contributions, name and fame, or may get attracted towards others on the basis of their good features, skin color, beauty or other attractiveness. However, whatever the reasons may be for our liking and attraction for the individuals, one thing is certain that these individuals get our valuable preference over others in terms of receiving help from us at the time of their need and emergency.

5. *Memory of the Early Rewarded Helping Behavior:* The memory of earlier experiences related to our helping behavior rewarded or punished may push us in our future social encounters to show helping or non-helping behavior towards others in need. Whenever people help accident victims by taking them to the hospital or donate

money to bear the expenses of the marriage of a poor girl and get reward in terms of blessing or public appreciation, they get the due reinforcement for making them engaged in the pro-social behavior at the time of need in future. On the other hand, the individuals who have a bitter experience of getting cheated after giving lift to a so-called needy person on their vehicle, or helping a lady at her emergency call may be found to adopt non-helping behavior not only in the similar situations but also be quite cautious and indifferent to help anybody in the future.

6. *Social Norms and Ethics:* The norms and ethical principles prevalent in a society may also prove an effective determinant for promoting pro-social behavior among the people. In the societies in which one or the other type of helping behavior is valued and rewarded and the actions performed under this behavior get promoted through the implementation of the social norms and ethical principles, there are more chances of picking up the habit of helping others at the time of their need. While following the desirable social norms, the people are found to exhibit a strong sense of social responsibility, which specifies that one should always offer help to others in their need, irrespective of the possibility of future repayment (Schwartz, 1975). Similarly, while following ethical values and moral principles, the people are found thinking that it is their moral duty to serve and help their fellow beings in their need with no selfish motive. The more value and regard the society pays to the helping behavior of its members, the greater becomes the possibility of increase in their pro-social behavior.
7. *Affording of Time and Attention:* What is utmost required for rendering help to a person in need is to spend time and pay attention over his problem or difficulty. The more time people can afford in attending and understanding one's problem, the greater are the chances of the demonstration of pro-social behavior on their part. The reverse also fit equally well in this situation. In this concern, the research work carried out by the socio-psychologists like Darley and Batson

(1973) has revealed that in general, people who remain in a hurry and do not want to afford time for looking to the problems of the needy in their vicinity, are less likely to help someone in need than the people who are not in such a hurry.

8. *Number of Bystanders:* The pro-social behavior – to help or not to help the individuals at the time of crisis or emergency – also depends on the number of bystanders. In case where a large number of bystanders are there to intervene in providing help to the needy in crisis, it makes them to think why should they and not somebody else take initiative for the purpose? In this concern, socio-psychologists like Latané and Darley (1970) and Latane and Nida (1981) have concluded through their research work that as the number of bystanders increases, the likelihood that any one bystander will help a victim decreases. On the other hand, in the situation where only a single bystander is present at the time of help needed by the victim, we usually find him to have no option other than providing assistance in the ways as possible to him according to his capacity. Besides this, more often the bystanders are seen to participate in the task of providing help to the needy in crisis on the footprint of a bystander who takes initiative and provides the needed leadership in taking responsibility of providing assistance to the victim. In this way, it is not only the number of bystanders present at the scene of crisis but also the presence of somebody among them to take initiative and inspire others to participate in the good cause of helping the needy in crisis.

within the person supposed to be helping hand to someone in difficulty. In this category we may include the factors such as: their being more *genetically predisposed* to demonstrate pro-social behavior than others; *physically healthy* for getting them to feel better in terms of their physical well-being; *skilled or competent* for performing a pro-social behavior; enjoying a *good mental health and being in a favorable emotional state*; and imbibed with the *unique personality traits and behavioral characteristics* helpful in their pro-social behavior.

External or situational factors are said to be external or situational in the sense that they are found to lie outside the person in his or her environment or situations created from time to time giving birth to a need of helping someone in difficulty. We may include in this category the factors like: *environmental conditions* such as weather conditions prevailing at the time of help given to the needy; *social inclusion and exclusion* of an individual enabling or preventing people from building the social relationships and helping attitude; the *impact of modeling* on the promotion of pro-social behavior; *impact of liking and attraction for somebody* in giving help in need; *memory of the early rewarded helping behavior*; the *norms and ethical principles* prevalent in a society; *affording of time and attention* on the part of helper; and *the number of bystanders* present at the time of help needed by the victim.

To Sum Up

The determinants or factors influencing the pro-social behavior of the individuals may be broadly grouped as internal or personal factors and external or situational factors.

Internal or personal factors are said to be internal in the sense that they are found to lie

Review Questions

1. What is pro-social behavior? Throw light on its meaning and nature.
2. What is altruism or altruistic behavior? Throw light on its meaning and nature.
3. Differentiate and distinguish among the terms helping behavior, pro-social behavior and altruistic behavior.
4. What do you understand by the term 'bystanders intervention in an emergency'? Explain why

many bystanders keep themselves away from somebody at the time of need.

5. Name the different perspectives or theories available to provide an explanation for pro-social behavior and discuss any two of them in detail.
6. Discuss in brief the following theories explaining pro-social behavior: (i) empathy-altruism theory, (ii) negative state relief theory, (iii) empathic theory, (iv) competitive altruism theory and (v) kin selection theory.
7. Discuss the various personality variables associated with pro-social behavior of the helpers.
8. Throw light on the characteristics of those being helped and comment about how people, in general, feel after receiving help from others.
9. What are the various determinants of pro-social behavior classified as internal and external? Discuss their roles in influencing and affecting one's pro-social behavior.

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UNIT IV

SOCIALIZATION AND SOCIETAL PROCESSES



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14.

SOCIALIZATION – CONCEPT, THEORIES AND AGENTS

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- Define the term socialization.
- Explain the concept of socialization by throwing light on its meaning and nature.
- Discuss the various theories of socialization.
- Elucidate psychoanalytic theory or perspective of socialization.
- Throw light on Erikson's theory or perspective of socialization.
- Tell about the social learning perspective or theory of socialization.
- Discuss the moral development perspective of socialization in the light of views expressed by Piaget and Kohlberg in their moral development theories.
- Name and describe the agents or agencies of socialization.

Introduction

Social psychology, as we have discussed in Chapter 1 of the text, concerns the studying of the behavior of individuals resulted through their interaction with the society or group in which they live and behave. For having such interplay in a proper way, the individuals living and behaving in one or the other social setup need to reach an adequate level of their social development referred to as socialization in the language of social psychology. What is this socialization? How can its nature and mechanism be explained with the help of various theoretical approaches? What are the different agents that play their respective roles in helping the process of socialization? Let us try to seek answers to these questions in this chapter.

Concept of Socialization – Meaning and Nature

Men are said to be social animals, meaning thereby that they ought to be social for their living and behaving properly in the society or community in which they live and behave. The society is as essential as food to them, and consequently they have a strong compulsion to maintain social relationships and adjustment with others. However, this does not mean that they are born with such social behavior and social qualities. Actually, all of us are very much selfish and unsocial in our earlier childhood. Our basic animal nature gets gradually changed into human social nature through a process known as socialization. It is

a very basic and simple explanation of the term socialization. However, for knowing more about its meaning and nature let us take the help of some well-known definitions provided by the thinkers and socio-psychologists.

Sorenson (1948): Socialization refers to an increasing ability to get along well with oneself and others.

Hurlock (1959): Socialization (or social development) means the attaining of maturity in social relationships.

Secord and Backman (1974): Socialization is an interactional process in which a person's behavior is modified to conform with the expectations held by the members of the groups or society of which he is a member.

Garrett (1968): Socialization is the process whereby the biological individual is converted into a human person.

Elkin and Handel (1978): Socialization may be defined as the process by which a person learns the ways of a society or social group so that he can adequately function within it.

Albrecht et al. (1980): Socialization can best be understood as such learning processes and resultant products that allow an individual to become an adequately functioning member of the society.

Let us try to see what has been conveyed by these definitions by getting them analyzed in a proper way.

- The definition given by Sorenson emphasizes that socialization of the individuals results in the improvement, increase and development of their social abilities or skills. Such improvement and enhancement, in turn, helps them in their ability of maintaining social relationships resulting in their proper adjustment to the self and others.
- The definition given by Hurlock carries a wide meaning by emphasizing that socialization makes the people socially mature. As a result, they can demonstrate a quite desirable and proper behavior with regard to the maintenance of desirable social relationships and adjustment to their socio-cultural environment.
- The definition given by Garrett is based upon the distinction made between the term *individual* and *person*. We cannot name each and everybody as person. One must be attributed with certain types of attributes and characteristics termed one's personality for this purpose. Their personality is the product of social interaction between them and their socio-cultural environment. Socialization as a process of social interaction helps the individuals for being designated as a person by imbibing essential personality traits.
- The rest of the other three definitions provided by Elkin and Handel, Secord and Backman and Albrecht, Thomas and Chadwick consider socialization, in their own ways, as a process helpful in making the individuals – the members of a society – to learn and bring a continued modification in their social and moral behavior for getting along well with others in the society. According to them, every society or community has its own social and moral norms and styles of behaving and expects from its members to make use of them in their social interaction and living. Socialization refers to the process that helps the individuals to learn the ways and means of getting fit in the norms and ways of social and moral behaving prevalent at one or the other time for their functioning well as a useful member of the society. In this sense, socialization is a life-long process that goes on continually in the people's lives for enabling them to learn new ways of social and moral behaving according to the changing needs of the time.

Socialization

A process that goes on continually in the people's lives for enabling them to learn new ways of social and moral behaving according to the changing needs of the time.

In the light of what has been discussed so far about the meaning, and nature of the term socialization we may well conclude that *socialization is*

essentially a continually and lifelong process that helps an individual to imbibe certain essential behavioral characteristics and social virtues which results into (i) his attainment of social maturity, (ii) alteration of his animal nature into humanistic social nature and (iii) seeking his proper adjustment to his self and others in the society according to the need of the times.

Theories of Socialization

Socio-psychologists, researchers and thinkers have given birth to a number of approaches and theoretical perspectives designated as theories of socialization from time to time for understanding the nature and mechanism of socialization of human beings. Let us try to discuss in brief a few important ones.

Psychoanalytic Theory or Perspective of Socialization

The development of psychoanalytical perspective and theory of socialization is credited to the work and efforts of Sigmund Freud (1856–1939). Developing his theory of psychoanalytic perspective (Freud, 1910), Freud opined that sex is the life urge or fundamental motive in life. All physical pleasures arising from any of the organs or any of the functions are ultimately sexual in nature. The seeking of such pleasures or its denial in any way decides the fate of the type of socialization and personality development achieved by the children in their growing age and later. Besides this, the structural components of the developing children in the form of id, ego and super-ego also play their significant role in the socialization and personality development of the children. Let us try to understand the socialization and personality development of the growing individuals in the light of these two distinctive phenomena.

The Psychosexual Stages and Socialization of Children

With regard to the socialization and development of children, Freud outlined five stages in a child and adolescent's development, which he called psychosexual stages. At each of these stages, sexuality (in the

form of sexual pleasure and gratification) is attached or associated with a particular part and place of the body, and gratification of the sexual urges associated with those areas of the body is essential for the socialization, adjustment and well-being of the developing child. In this connection, Freud opined that the way in which gratification of urges is handled during each of these stages determines the nature and status of the things related to his adjustment, socialization and development of personality. Lack of gratification at any of these psychosexual stages may lead the child into maladjustment and disturbance in his normal functioning and social development.

As proposed in the psychosexual stage theory, children may be found to pass through the following different stages with respect to their psychosexual development:

1. *The Oral Stage.* This initial stage of child development lasts from birth to about 18 months of age. According to Freud, the zone of pleasure for the children at this stage is their mouth, the first sex organ for providing pleasure to the children. The beginning in this direction is made with the pleasure received from the mother's nipple or the bottle. Thereafter, the children derive pleasure by putting anything, candy, a stick, their own thumb, etc. into their mouth. The need of deriving pleasure from such oral means needs to be satisfied for the children in a satisfactory way. The mother, father and other caretakers should be quite cautious of their behavior in this concern. Its denial or oversaturation may create hurdles in the proper socialization and personality development of the individuals. In this connection, as emphasized by Freud, children can get fixated if their needs are not adequately met or over saturated at a particular stage of their psychosexual development. As a result, the developing child may, then, exhibit characteristics of that stage later in life. In reference to the fixation of the individuals at the oral stage it has been found that the developing individuals who are fixated in the oral stage may want to continue to try their oral urges by over-eating, binge drinking, smoking or being infatuated

with seeing and sucking female nipples at the later stages of their development in the adulthood (Freud, 1953). The same happens with individuals on account of the denial of breast-feeding or its oversaturation on the part of the mothers during their infantile age.

2. *The Anal Stage.* The anal stage lasts from 18 months to 3 years. At this stage, the interest of the children shifts from the mouth as the erogenous zone to the organs of elimination, i.e., the anus or the urethra. They derive pleasure by holding back or letting go of the body's waste material through the anus or the urethra. The task of the children at this stage is to learn to control their bodily urges to conform to society's expectations. However, on account of the lack or improper toilet training, the developing children who are fixated at this stage may become over controlled (referred to as anal compulsive) as an adult (Freud, 1953). They may be found to see everything in its proper place to an extreme degree. Conversely, other children fixated at oral stage might become anal explosive, creating "messes" wherever they go.
3. *The Phallic Stage.* This phase starts from the age of 4 years and lasts up to six years. It is characterized with the shifting of the child's interest from the eliminating organs to the genitals. At this stage children come to note the biological differences between the sexes and derive pleasure by playing with and manipulating the genital organs.

This stage, according to Freud, may give rise to a number of complexes like deprivation and Electra complexes in girls and castration and Oedipus complexes in boys. The deprivation complex is the result of the feeling generated in the minds of the little girls that they have been deprived of the male organ by their mothers. Castration complex is generated in boys through their fear of being deprived of the male organs certainly as a result of the threat received from elders that the organ would be cut off if they did not give up the habit of playing with it. About the Oedipus and Electra complexes, Freud says that they are the result of the sexual attraction or pleasure that

children experience in the company of the parent of the opposite sex. In case the parent of the same sex frustrates the desire, expresses his or her resentment and is not friendly to the boy or girl, the child may develop an Oedipus or Electra complex by loving the opposite sex parent more and rather hating the like sex parent. In this way, the limitations, maladjustment and difficulty faced by the growing children in the phallic stage of their development may make them stuck in the phallic stage even in their adulthood by exhibiting a promiscuous or emotionally immature behavior in their social dealings.

4. *The Latency Stage.* This period starts from 6 years in the case of girls and 7 to 8 years in the case of boys and extends up to the onset of puberty. Latent means inactive, and Freud believed that during this time the sex drive goes underground (Freud, 1953). At this stage, boys and girls prefer to be in the company of their own sex and even neglect or hate members of the opposite sex. The parents and other elders should be quite careful that this hate developed during this stage for the members of the opposite sex does not become a stable or enduring function at the later stage of their development.
5. *The Genital Stage.* Puberty is the starting point of the genital stage. At this point, sexual energy becomes focused on the genital area. As a result, the adolescent boy and girl now feel a strange feeling of strong sensation in the genitals and attraction towards the members of the opposite sex. At this stage they may feel pleasure by self-stimulation of the genitals, may fall in love with their own self by taking interest in beautifying and adorning their bodies and may be drawn quite close to members of the opposite sex even to the extent of indulging in sexual intercourse. If it goes in a normal natural way in its proper limit with not hurting and causing harms to others, then it may help much in their needed socialization, but overindulgence in sex and causing harm to the opposite sex member may turn the table on the other side by developing them into an anti-social personality.

In this way, what happens to the growing individual from their early childhood to adolescence in terms of their psychosexual development carries a wide significance in terms of their proper socialization and personality development.

Role of Id, Ego and Superego in the Socialization and Personality Development of Individuals

In the course of growing of the individuals from their earlier childhood onward to the adolescence and adulthood there is a gradual emergence of these three personality structures – id, ego and superego – among human beings. The id is raw, savage and immoral basic stuff of a man's personality that is lying with him right from his birth. It is completely guided by the pleasure-seeking principle. It has no values, knows no laws, follows no rules, does not recognize right or wrong and considers only its need and appetites to be paramount. It is why we may see that there is nothing like social in the behavior and dealing of the infants and small children with others. They are altogether engaged all the time in the satisfaction of their own physical and psychological needs with no consideration of any sort to the needs, demands and expectations of others. They are crownless kings and think and also expect that the world should revolve around them. They actually need too much attention and care from others and definitely it should also be given to them in a quite proper way for their needed protection, development and welfare.

However, as they grow, the things cannot function as such. The id cannot be allowed to rule in such an autocrat fashion and hence another component or structure of one's personality named ego is found to develop among the growing children in their school going age. It begins to work as a policeman to exercise a reasonable check on the unsocial savage tendencies and unlawful activities of the children by making them learn the lessons of social living and adjusting to others in the satisfaction of their basic needs. It follows the principle of reality and acts with intelligence to control, select and decide what appetites are to be satisfied and in which way they should be satisfied. In this way, the children of this

age are found to be proceeding well on the path of their socialization and social development. However, what we term as morality and ethical sense in its actual form, it is not developed in their social behavior until the emergence of a third component of their personality known as superego during the period of adolescence.

Superego is termed as the ethical or moral arm of one's personality. It is purely idealistic and does not care for realities. Perfection rather than pleasure is its goal. In all its forms and shapes, it tries to work as a major decision-making entity that decides what is good or bad for the individual to do from the viewpoint of morality and social norms.

The socialization of children in its proper way does not take its proper root unless they are armed with the ethical component of their personality. An individual after reaching the age of adolescence thus, according to Freud, may be found to get armed with all the three components of his personality in the name of id, ego and superego. His social and moral behavior (the index of one's socialization) now rests on the balance maintained in the functioning of these three components. In this concern, it is important to note that while the id operating on the pleasure principle continuously presses for the immediate satisfaction of one's needs or wants without caring for others or the norms of the society or group of which he is a member, the superego the ethical and moral wing of one's personality in this situation tries to prohibit such gratification by exercising its veto power. Thus, in one's social behavior, many times, a war-like situation is created between the functioning of his id and superego. It is one's ego that comes for his rescue in maintaining a proper balance between the extremely dominated tendencies of his id and superego. How much success one gets in functioning as a desirable and fruitful social being in a social setup thus absolutely depends on the strength and capability of one's ego to exercise proper restraint and have needed balance between the functioning of one's id and superego in one or the other social situation. The key of one's proper socialization and social development according to Freud thus lies in the proper development and functioning of one's ego. One is social and gets adjusted to his self and society

to the extent of the development, strength and functioning of one's ego.

Thus, in view of the psychoanalytical perspective forwarded by Freud, children while passing through the successive stages of their psychosexual development, try to learn and imbibe essential social behavior and personality traits for their needed socialization under the guidance of their parents and elders. Individuals in their infantile age and early childhood may be seen to enjoy all types of love, attention and care for their adjustment and welfare on the parts of the parents and elders. However, afterwards as they grow and develop, due attempts should be properly made for helping the children to give up their socially undesirable habits and learn new ways of behaving and interacting with others (well in tune with the social norms and ethical ways of the society) by strengthening their ego capable enough in restraining and balancing the unsocial functioning of their id and idealistic policing of their superego.

To Sum Up

Psychoanalytic theory or perspective of socialization is credited to the work and efforts of Sigmund Freud. He tried to explain socialization and personality development of the growing individuals in the light of the two distinctive phenomena – psycho-sexual development and the role of id, ego and superego – the structural components of their personality.

Regarding his views about psychosexual development of the growing individuals, he outlined five stages (oral, anal, phallic, latency and genital) in a child and adolescent's development, which he called psychosexual stages. At each of these stages, sexuality (in the form of sexual pleasure and gratification) is invested in a different part of the body, and gratification of the urges associated with those areas of the body is particularly pleasurable. He believed that the way in which gratification of urges is handled during each of these stages determines the nature and status of the things related to adjustment, socialization and development of

personality. Lack of gratification at any of these psychosexual stages may lead the child into maladjustment and disturbance in his normal functioning and social development.

Regarding the role of id, ego and superego in the socialization and personality development of the individuals, Freud asserted that the id is raw, savage and immoral basic stuff of a man's personality that is completely guided by the pleasure-seeking principle. In contrast, superego is the ethical or moral arm of one's personality. It is purely idealistic and does not care for realities. Perfection, rather than pleasure, is its goal. Ego is that component of one's personality that works on the reality principle. It acts as a policeman to exercise a reasonable check on the unsocial activities of id and the unrealistic demands of the superego. The key of one's proper socialization and social development, according to Freud, thus, lies in the proper development and functioning of one's ego. One is social and gets adjusted to his self and the society to the extent of the development, strength and functioning of one's ego.

Erikson's Theory or Perspective of Socialization

Erik Erikson (1902–1994), a native of Germany settled in America, brought out a theory of socialization known as psychosocial theory of development. In his publication *Childhood and Society* (1963) he discussed his theory in detail. He posited that the psycho-social development of human beings takes place in a sequence of eight separate stages covering their entire life span instead of limiting it to their childhood and adolescence as done in the other theories of socialization and personality development.

Introducing his theory, Erikson postulated that the development of an individual is the result of his interaction with his social environment. Right from his birth, his social development puts him under specific pressures or conflicts (called crises) by making specific demands at different ages or developmental

stages of his life. The individual tries to meet these specific demands or resolve the crises by reacting psychologically in his own way, depending upon his circumstances. The complexity of the demands from society or social environment goes on increasing as the child advances on the ladder of growth and development. So, at each stage of his development, the child faces a new crisis, i.e., an issue that needs to be resolved at that particular stage of development. The way in which the 'crises' of each stage are resolved has a major bearing on the way of his socialization and development of his personality reflected in the positive and negative aspect of his social behavior. Erikson discovered eight such issues or crises of life arising at different ages or periods of one's development and linked them with the eight stages of one's psycho-social development covering one's entire life span discussed in the way as follows.

Stage I: Period of Trust vs. Mistrust (Birth to 1½ years). In the first one and a half years of life, the infant is confronted with the crisis termed *trust* vs. *mistrust*. During this period the baby is completely dependent upon its mother or caretaker for the satisfaction of its needs. The way it is nourished, handled, protected and kept safe and comfortable at this stage may provide the baby with a sense of security or insecurity, a feeling of trust or mistrust in the mother or caretaker and ultimately in its surroundings. The sense of trust or mistrust with regard to the environment gained in this way at this stage of development may then be carried over to the stages of development to follow and consequently reflected in the developing personality.

Stage II: Period of Autonomy vs. Shame and Doubt (1½ to 3 years). Having gained a primary sense of trust and security with regard to his environment, in the second and third years of his life, the child now passes through the second stage of psycho-social development. With the newly developed motor or physical skills and language ability, the child now engages in exploring his environment and experimenting with his strengths and limitations for achieving a sense of autonomy and independence. The child now needs proper safety measures against the risks involved in activities like walking, running, pulling and handling the objects of his environment

or in terms of learning undesirable language, but this does not mean that he should be denied a reasonable degree of freedom to acquire a sense of independence. Within the bounds of safety, he must be provided adequate opportunities for the acquisition of a sense of autonomy and knowledge about his limitations.

Children who are denied the opportunity to develop a sense of independence by over-protective, harsh or restrictive parents begin to doubt their ability and ultimately begin to feel embarrassed or ashamed in the presence of others. However, the development of the sense of doubt and shame within reasonable limits is not harmful. A healthy sense of doubt helps the child to set his own limits, and the development of shame helps him to develop a sense of right and wrong. Therefore, at this stage of psycho-social development, the child needs to be helped in striking a balance between the conflicting needs of his social environment to acquire a sense of autonomy and develop a sense of doubt and shame for the adequate development of his personality.

Stage III: Period of Initiative vs. Guilt (3 to 6 years): The third stage of psycho-social development between 3 to 6 years of age is characterized by the crisis of initiative vs. guilt. Equipped with the sense of trust and autonomy the child now begins to take initiative in interacting with his environment. He asks questions about each and everything, explores his environment ceaselessly, and engages in planning and carrying out activities of various kinds. The extent to which the initiative for carrying out physical and mental exploration is encouraged or discouraged by the parents and the available social environment, goes a long way in developing ability in the child to initiate, plan and carry out these activities in later life.

If the child is discouraged from taking the initiative by his parents and guardians not having faith in him, or is pulled down by unhealthy criticism, punishment or rebuke for minor failures, the child is sure to develop a sense of guilt leading to hesitation, indecision and lack of initiative in planning and carrying out his life activities. Although in case of failure he feels a reasonable amount of guilt for having failed to take the initiative at the right time or made mistakes in planning and carrying out his activities, this enables him to learn from his failures. However,

to allow this to develop into a guilty conscience is harmful to the development of the child's personality. Therefore, there is a need to resolve the crisis of *initiative vs. guilt* at this stage of psycho-social development, and it can be properly done if we allow the child to experiment with his initiative by properly supervising and guiding his activities and encouraging him to develop a habit of self-evaluation of the results of his initiative.

Stage IV: Period of Industry vs. Inferiority (6 to 12 years): Generally, by this age children begin to attend to school where they are made to learn various skills and the teachers as well as the school environment generate pressures on them to work hard in order to perform well. Parents also now begin to make demands upon the children to lend their hand with household duties or in some cases saddle them with occupational responsibilities. They have also to compete with their peers in terms of competence and productivity in school and other social situations. Now, if the child performs well in school, home or in other social environments or is admired for his intellectual or motor pursuits he will be likely to develop a sense of industry filled with a sense of achievement. Such a child will consequently be motivated to work harder and achieve more in terms of competency and productivity. On the other hand, if his performance remains inferior to that of his peers or he does not satisfy his teachers and parents with his performance, he may begin to look down upon himself and develop a sense of inferiority.

The home and the school environment thus play a very significant role in helping the child out of the industry vs. inferiority crisis. For the child, their home and school become the places where success and failure are defined. Therefore, it is the duty of the parents and teachers to structure their home and school environment in such a way as to help the students to maintain a positive attitude and view themselves as capable and valuable individuals.

Stage V: Period of Identity vs. Role Confusion (12 to 19 years): This stage, beginning with the advent of puberty, is marked with the crisis of *identity vs. role confusion*. Equipped with the sense of trust, autonomy, initiative and industry, adolescents begin to search for their own personal identity. The sudden changes in their bodies and mental functioning and the altered

demands of society compel them to ask questions of their own self like, who am I? What have I become? Am I the same person I used to be? What am I supposed to do and in which manner am I to behave?

Erikson asserts that at this stage, the adolescent's search by questioning and redefining his own socio-psychological identity established during earlier stages is definitely linked with (a) his sudden and rapid bodily changes, and (b) anxiety and pressures related to this need to make decisions about his future education and career. Consequently, the adolescent tries to search for his new role and identity. He experiments with various sexual, occupational and educational roles to understand who he is and what he can be.

The extent to which an individual is able to develop a sense of identity will depend upon the degree of success he achieves in resolving the crises related to all the previous stages. Failure in resolving the crises of those periods would be likely, at this stage, to result in role confusion and consequently the individual will not be able to find himself. He may then feel completely bewildered, not knowing what to do and how to behave on his own. He may be unable to make the decision about his educational or professional career or about making friends. The lack of self-identification and role confusion may also lead to over identification with villains and clowns, showing a type of childish and impulsive behavior or developing conformity in taste and style and intolerance of others. On the other hand, if the psycho-social development of the adolescent results in his achieving a sense of identity, it will result in the individual developing the required confidence in his ability to do things, make him properly balanced in terms of emotional reactions and will place him in harmony with his environment.

Teachers and parents can play a very constructive role in helping adolescents through this identity vs. confusion crisis. The adolescents, craving for identity, must be fully recognized and it should be clearly understood that adolescents want to be identified as adults and must, therefore, be treated as such and not as children as many teachers and parents tend to do. They should never be belittled or humiliated in front of their peers or anyone else for that matter. They must be assigned responsibilities independently or collectively and be trusted for their promises and conduct.

Stage VI: Period of Intimacy vs. Isolation (20 to 45 years): This is the sixth stage of psycho-social development, and spans the years of early adulthood. During this stage the individual tends to develop a sense of intimacy or commitment to a close relationship with another person. Throwing light on this aspect Erikson (1950), writes:

Thus, the young adult, emerging from the search for and the insistence on identity, is eager and willing to fuse his identity with that of others. He is ready for intimacy, that is, the capacity to commit himself to concrete affiliations and partnerships and to develop the ethical strength to abide by such commitments even though they may call for significant sacrifices and compromises.

Thus, during this stage, the individual seeks to form close personal attachments by merging his identity with that of another person. The relationships develop into such a close involvement that he tends to risk even the loss of his ego or image as is evidenced in the harmonious relationships between husband and wife and intimate friends, and in the ideal relationship between a teacher and his pupil. The ultimate sense of intimacy is clearly visible in terms of the mutual identity experienced at the time of simultaneous orgasms in sexual intercourse with a loved partner of the opposite sex. Another form of such intimacy is seen in sacrifices made for one's close friends or for members of one's family.

The opposite of intimacy is isolation. When one fails to develop an adequate sense of intimacy by merging one's identity with that of another person or when relations deteriorate for one reason or another, one tends to develop a sense of isolation – a pulling away from relationships and breaking off of ties. Alternatives have to be developed for intimate relationships. It is essential to maintain equilibrium in such cases as the deviation from or denial of intimate relationships is costly in terms of a normal and happy life. This does not mean, however, that isolation is altogether undesirable or harmful. A certain degree of isolation is crucial to the maintenance of one's individuality and the development of one's personality in the desired direction, but if it exceeds certain limits, it may become a serious handicap to the establishment and maintenance of close ties and may

lead to loneliness and self-absorption. The crisis of *intimacy vs. isolation* needs to be resolved by striking a balance between the two contradictory needs – the need for intimacy and the need to maintain one's individuality. The degree to which one succeeds in resolving this crisis results in securing one's adjustment with one's self and the world one lives in.

Stage VII: Period of Creativity vs. Stagnation (Middle Adulthood–45 to 65 years): An individual's life up to this stage is taken up with trying to establish himself in a professional career. Now, he needs to satisfy his need for generativity, a concern to establish and guide the next generation. This is realized through nurturing his own children, guiding and directing other young people and by engaging in some kind of creative, productive or fruitful activity that may prove beneficial to society. Instead of caring only for himself or for those in his family or friends who are close to him, he participates in the welfare of the future generation as represented by his own children, pupils, subordinates and young people in general. This is, in fact, an effort at extension of one's self and its merger with self or others in society.

As opposed to the sense of generativity, there is a tendency on the part of the individual to become egoistic and selfish. This leads to stagnation and personal impoverishment. Although it would be quite natural to pause in one's life's work to reflect upon, evaluate and consolidate one's achievements and to regroup one's energies for future productivity, an excess of this habit may result in self-indulgence and psychological invalidism. A balanced adjustment between the extremes of the need for generativity and the need for inactivity is thus required so that in the time of inactivity one may become more energetic and be able to put renewed efforts into rendering service to society and future generation.

Stage VIII: Period of Ego-Integrity vs. Despair (Old Age, About 65 Onwards): This stage of psycho-social development is associated with later adulthood or old age. Although the precise commencement of old age cannot be determined because some people remain physically and mentally active well into their 80s and 90s, others feel, look and act old even in their 50s, yet biologically speaking, old age may be said to begin when people cease to reproduce.

During this last stage of psycho-social development one is confronted with the final crisis of one's life span, termed *ego-integrity* vs. *despair*. Ego-integrity refers to the integration or culmination of the successful resolution of all the seven previous crises in the course of one's life. The successful resolution of the previous crises provides a sense of fulfillment and satisfaction to one's ego. When one reflects on one's past and feels satisfied over what has been done, one is sure to develop a positive outlook about oneself and the world around. A person with a developed sense of ego-integrity is at peace with the life he has lived and has no major regrets over what could have been or for what should have been done differently. On the other hand, persons who have not been able to successfully resolve the previous crises of the developmental stages are sure to feel differently. They look back on their lives with despair and feel dissatisfied with the way they have lived their lives. The thought that they now have no time left for changing the course of their lives and doing what should have been done makes them feel miserable and, consequently, they are doomed to develop a deep sense of despair. These people can become desperately afraid of

death. On the other hand, people who have no regrets for the way their lives have been lived and who have an admiration or love for their ego are easily able to accept the inevitability of their death and live life as fully as they can till their last breath.

At the same time, despair is not the absolute negative aspect of one's personality. To feel satisfied or dissatisfied about one or the other issue is common and natural. One may regret many mistakes and deficiencies of one's life, but this should not be stretched to the point where one develops a sense of disaffection with one's ego and begins to hate oneself and then sink into a state of utter depression. It is, therefore, essential to strike a balance between the conflicting needs of ego-integrity and despair and to successfully resolve the final crisis of one's life resulting in a well-balanced optimistic outlook for oneself and the outside world in order to live the remaining days of one's life as gracefully and productively as possible.

In a summarized form, Erikson's stages of psycho-social development covering entire life span of an individual may be represented in the manner given in Table 14.1.

Table 14.1 Erikson's Stage of Psycho-Social Development Along With the Type of Development Seen in the Socialization and Social Behavior of the Individual

<i>Stages of Psychosocial Development</i>	<i>The Person and Specific Age</i>	<i>The Nature of Socialization and Social Behavior Seen in the Individuals</i>
1. Trust vs. mistrust	Infant (birth to 1½ years)	Needs maximum comfort with minimal uncertainty to trust him/her, others and the environment.
2. Autonomous vs. shame and doubt	Toddler (1½ years to 3 years)	Works to master physical environment while maintaining self-esteem.
3. Initiative vs. guilt	Pre-schooler (3 years to 6 years)	Begins to initiate not imitate activities, develops conscience and sexual identity.
4. Industry vs. inferiority	School age child (6 years to 12 years)	Tries to develop a sense of self-worth by refining skills.
5. Identity vs. role confusion	Adolescent (12 years to 20 years)	Tries integrating many roles (child, sibling, student, athlete, worker) into a self-image under role model and peer pressure.
6. Intimacy vs. isolation	Young adult (20 years to 45 years)	Learns to make personal commitment to another as spouse, parent or partner.
7. Generativity vs. stagnation	Middle age adult (45 years to 65 years)	Seeks satisfaction through productivity in career, family and civic interest.
8. Integrity vs. despair	Older adult (65 years onwards)	Tries to seek a sense of fulfillment about the past of one's life and achievements.

To Sum Up

Erikson's theory or perspective of socialization proposes that the psycho-social development of human beings takes place in a sequence of eight separate stages covering their entire life span. These stages are: trust vs. mistrust (birth–1½ year), autonomy vs. shame and doubt (1½ year–3 years), initiative vs. guilt (3–6 years), industry vs. inferiority (6–12 years), identity vs. role confusion (12–20 years), intimacy vs. isolation (20–45 years), generativity vs. stagnation (45–65 years), and ego integrity vs. despair (65 years onwards).

According to Erikson, at each stage of their development, the people face a new crisis, i.e., an issue that needs to be resolved at that particular stage of development. The way in which the 'crises' of each stage is resolved by them has a major bearing on the way of their socialization and development of their personality reflected in the positive and negative aspect of their social behavior.

Social Learning Perspective or Theory of Socialization

Social learning perspective or theory of socialization owes its origin to the work of the famous Canadian-American psychologist Albert Bandura (1973). He concluded through his studies that most of the learning of children in terms of imbibing one or the other social traits, habits and skills of doing and performing one or the other things related to their social behavior takes place through the efforts and outcomes of their observational learning in one or the other social situations. This observational learning of the children in their social environment is carried out in a systematic procedure involving the following four stages or steps in its execution.

1. *Observation of the Behavior of Elders or a Role Model:* Children right from their quite early age try to watch closely the actions and behavior of their parents, peers and elders at their home and

neighborhood. It provides them a quite valuable opportunity to watch a live demonstration of the things done and social behavior performed by their elders and peers in real life. In addition, they may also avail the opportunity of watching the actions and behaviors of the characters of their choice on television, film or smart devices screens.

2. *Remembering the Observed Behavior:* In this step, what has been observed by the child in relation to the demonstration of the social behavior and conduct on the part of the parents, teachers, peers or elders is filed away in his memory in the form of mental images.
3. *Imitation of the Observed Behavior:* In this step, a behavior observed and remembered on the part of the child is analyzed by him in terms of its acceptability to him according to his own interests, choices or demands of the situation. After that, the child tries to imitate the actions and conduct of his role models observed in the real social encounter or on the screens of TV, films and smart devices.
4. *Reinforcement of the Imitated Behavior:* The imitated behavior needs its proper reinforcing for becoming a part of the child's social conduct and social behavior. In this final step of the social learning mechanism, thus, the type of reinforcement following the imitation act performed on the part of the child decides the fate of its further continuity or discontinuity on his end. When the child is appreciated or rewarded for his social etiquettes and conduct (observed and imitated) on his part in real life, he is led to imbibe these attributes in his social behavior. However, if he meets a setback on this account, the behavior observed and imitated fails to get learned or imbibed in his social conduct.

In this way, social learning i.e., learning through observation and modelling proves to be an effective means of learning many things concerning one's social behavior and socialization. How one displays love and anger, shows sympathy and prejudices, speaks and writes, dresses and eats, takes initiative or shies away in terms of his socialization, all depend

upon what has been observed, remembered, imitated and reinforced in context of the vicarious or model learning as propagated by the social learning theory.

To Sum Up

Bandura's social learning perspective or theory of socialization proposes that most of the learning of the individuals in terms of imbibing the one or the other social traits, habits and skills of doing and performing one or the other things related to their social behavior takes place through the efforts and outcomes of their observational learning in one or the other social situations. This observational learning of the children in their social environment is carried out by them in a systematic procedure involving the four stages or steps in its execution named as (i) observation of the behavior of the role model, (ii) remembering the observed behavior, (iii) imitation of the observed behavior and (iv) reinforcement of the imitated behavior.

Moral Development Perspectives or Theories of Socialization

Socialization aims to make the human beings social – gaining efficiency in interacting and behaving with others in a socially desirable way. By the term socially desirable way here we mean the norms and ethical standards set by the society for being observed on the part of its members in their day-to-day life and working setup. In this way, socialization or social development of the human beings is very much linked with their moral development i.e., imbibing necessary moral conduct and ethical standard on their part. In this way, socialization and social development can also be better explained on the basis of the theories of character or moral development of the growing children. However, the acquisition of moral sense or learning to behave in a socially approved way does not come overnight. Instead, it moves slowly but steadily right from birth, through infancy and childhood years and into adolescence.

How it happens across these developmental stages has been explained by a number of psychologists and sociologists through their observational studies and consequently have given birth to some theories of moral development. In this chapter, here we would be discussing two of these important theories named as Piaget's theory of moral development and Kohlberg's theory of moral development.

Piaget's Theory of Moral Development

Jean Piaget (1896–1980), famous for his theory of cognitive development, is also credited for providing a quite relevant and useful theory of moral development. For studying moral development as a developmental process like cognitive development, Piaget adopted two types of different approaches mentioned here:

1. The first of these was to observe children of different ages playing marbles, and ask them questions about the rules of the game in order to learn more about children's beliefs about right and wrong. Through his such observation and clinical interviews, Piaget (1932:65) concluded as follows:
 - Children younger than five essentially had no rules at all.
 - Children falling in the age group 5–10 years were found to observe rules, but they saw them as fixed and non-changeable.
 - Finally, by the age of 10, the children were able to think of their own rules and recognize that these could be adopted by mutual consent.
2. In his other technique, Piaget tried to present to children moral dilemmas, each consisting of a pair of stories. In one, a child (hero of the story) caused a small amount of damage. In the other, the damage done by the hero of the story was accidental but much greater. Piaget asked his clinical interviewed children which of the characters deserved to be punished the most. Piaget then tried to find out not just their answers but the reasoning they used to arrive at them.

The findings of his clinical interview based upon his second approach highlighted that while younger children merely focused on consequences (of the acts like stealing, lying, etc.) the older children went ahead by taking intent into account.

Stages of Moral Development

On the basis of the results of the observations and clinical interviews involving both the preceding approaches, Piaget concluded that the moral development of the children passes through two distinct stages of moral reasoning named (i) heteronomous stage and (ii) autonomous stage.

Let us first see how Piaget tried to conclude that a particular child is demonstrating heteronomous stage of morality or autonomous stage of morality. For this purpose, let us take one of Piaget's pair of stories, involving moral dilemma running as follows:

1. A little boy named John was in his room. He was called to dinner and went into the dining room. Behind the door there was a chair, and on the chair there was a tray with 15 cups on it. John couldn't have known that the chair was behind the door, and as he entered the dining room, the door knocked against the tray and the tray fell on the floor breaking all of the cups.
2. One day, a little boy called Henry tried to get some jam out of a cupboard when his mother was out. He climbed onto a chair and stretched out his arm. The jam was too high up, and he couldn't reach it. But while he was trying to get it, he knocked over a cup. The cup fell down and broke.

Piaget asked the children who was naughtier between John and Henry and should be punished more.

Piaget found that even though the younger children were able to distinguish between deliberate and unintentional acts, they still tended to base their judgments on the outcome of the act: the more severe the outcome, the naughtier the act. The younger children were passing through the stage of heteronomous morality. Older children (10 years or older) were able to make judgments based on the person's motives: Henry was doing something he shouldn't have been

doing, so he is naughtier. The thinking of older children thus represents the stage of autonomous morality. However, it should be noted carefully here that Piaget did not see moral development as consisting of separate stages (as in his cognitive development theory); instead, he saw moral development as progressing through two broad phases that overlap – so sometimes a child's moral reasoning will be in the heteronomous phase and at other times it will be autonomous regardless of his matured age.

Heteronomous Stage of Morality

According to Piaget in a course of their moral development, the children first pass through the heteronomous stage or phase of their morality. It usually occurs to them in the age group 5–10 years. Before that infants or other smaller children have nothing in terms of *moral realism* or *morality of constraints* is characterized with the following beliefs and behaviors on the part of younger children.

1. 'Heteronomous' means bring subject to rules imposed by others. At the heteronomous stage of morality, thus younger children (age group 5–10 years) consider rules as fixed and absolute. They believe that rules are handed down by authorities, such as God, parents, teachers and other elderly members and therefore, are permanent and unchangeable. One should not challenge or doubt the correctness or appropriateness of the rules as these should be observed in strict obedience.
2. Younger children (5–10 years) base their moral judgment more on consequences (i.e., the largeness of the amount of damage made) rather than on intentions. For example, when the younger children were made to comment on the relative acts of naughtiness, in the previously cited stories, on the part of John (who broke 15 cups while trying to help his mother) and Henry (who broke only one cup trying to steal cookies), the younger children thought that the first boy, John, did worse. In this way, their moral judgment is usually based on the amount of damage – the consequences – irrespective of the motive, good or bad, for doing the act.

3. They believe in expiratory punishment meaning thereby that punishment given to the rule breaker or doing wrong or improper things should be proportional to the gravity of consequences (damage done or naughtiness of behavior). They believe in the theory of immanent justice – if you do something bad and later slip and hurt yourself then that is your punishment.

The question arises why the younger children believe and behave in the moral realism characterized with a strict adherence to rules and duties, and obedience to authority. Piaget in this concern has tried to pinpoint two factors.

- The first reason lies in the cognitive development of these children, particularly, egocentrism. That is to say, that, young children are unable to simultaneously take into account their own view of things with the perspective of someone else. They think that everybody has the same views as they have. Their egocentrism thus leads them to project their own thoughts and wishes onto others. Since they themselves believe in the theory of immanent justice (expectation that punishments automatically follow acts of wrong-doing) and moral realism (valuing the letter of the law above the purpose of the law), they insist on obeying the rules by taking them as fixed eternal features of reality, rather than something that can be negotiated.
 - The second major cause lies in their subjugation to their elders – parents, teachers and others. In the natural authority relationship between adults and children, power is handed down from above. The relative powerlessness of young children, thus, may orient them to comply with the rules framed by the adults without question.
- Autonomous Stage of Morality*
- As the children grow in age, their thinking gets improved and developed. There is also a change in their cognitive structure from egocentrism to perspective taking. They now stop thinking that everybody thinks in the same way as they think and it makes them realize that people may differ in their moral values and judgment of the appropriateness or inappropriateness of the rules. Moreover, they now enter into the state of interaction and social relationship by getting rid of their feelings of egocentrism and self-centeredness. The mutual reciprocity and feelings of mutual respect help them to enter the autonomous stage of morality characterized as follows:
- Older children (10 years or older) come to understand that people make rules and people can change them. These are not eternal or unchangeable. The rules can be broken in some circumstances.
 - As children interact with others, develop perspective-taking emotional abilities and see that different people have different rules, there is a gradual shift from moral realism to morality of cooperation in the moral thinking and reasoning of the older children. As a result, the child of this stage may easily think that people differ in their moral views and morality is not static and universal.
 - Piaget held that for the older children belonging to the autonomous phase of morality, intentions are more important than the consequences of action and therefore, their morality should be judged on the basis of their intention-based behavior. He quoted the example of Henry, a boy who broke only one cup trying to steal cookies, in contrast to John, who broke 15 cups trying to help his mother. The older children like the younger ones did not take into account the gravity of consequences (the heavier loss in terms of breaking 15 cups) for deciding the relative inappropriateness of the behavior of John and Henry. As a proof of their maturity and entering the stage of autonomous morality, they were found to judge wrongness in terms of the intentions or motives underlying the act (Piaget, 1932:137).
 - The older children belonging to autonomous stage of morality no longer believe in immanent justice like the younger children.

- They believe in reciprocal punishment – the punishment should fit the crime.
- Older children believe in coordinating one's own perspective with that of others implying that what is right needs to be based on solutions that meet the requirements of fair reciprocity. Thus, according to Piaget, the older children may be said to acquire autonomy in taking judgments over the appropriateness or inappropriateness of an act in comparison to the younger children.

Piaget, thus, tried to sketch the process of moral reasoning and development of morality among the

children. Beginning from the stage of heteronomous morality the children, as they in their age, are seen to demonstrate autonomous morality in their reasoning and behavior. Such changes in their moral behavior, according to Piaget, result from their social interactions. In this way, Piaget emphasized the role of social interaction, mutual give and take, and cooperation as the very basis of bringing changes in the moral behavior of the younger children. It is this cooperation and interaction which makes the individuals work out resolutions or take decisions and judgments which all deem fair. In the light of his such observations, Piaget then advised parents, teachers

Table 14.2 Piaget's Two Stages Theory of Moral Development

<i>Heteronomous Stage of Morality</i> <i>(The Morality of Constraints)</i>		<i>Autonomous Stage of Morality</i> <i>(Morality of Cooperation)</i>	
	<i>Age span 5–10 years</i> <i>(typical of 6-year-olds)</i>		<i>Age span 10–12 years</i> <i>(typical of 12-year-olds)</i>
Point of view	Single, absolute moral perspective (behavior is either right or wrong) and believes that everyone sees in the same way.		Awareness of different viewpoints regarding rules. Children put themselves in place of others. They are not absolute in judgments but see that more than one point of view is possible.
Rules	Child believes that rules are fixed and unchangeable or 'carved in stone'.		Child recognizes that rules are made by people and can be altered by people. Children consider themselves just as capable of changing rules as everyone else.
Judgment of Act	Children base their moral judgment on consequences i.e., amount of damage done by an action.		Act by intentions and not by consequences. He considers wrongdoer's intention when evaluating an action.
Respect for Authority	Unilateral respect for authority, leading to feelings of obligation to conform to adult standard and obeying adult rules. Believes that wrongdoers should be punished by adults.		Mutual respect for authority and peers allows children to value their own opinions and abilities and judge other people realistically. Children obey rules because of mutual concern for the rights.
Punishment	Child favors severe punishment. He believes that punishment itself defines the wrongness of an act. An act is bad if it leads to punishment.		Child favors milder punishment that compensates the victim and helps the culprit recognize why the act is wrong, thus leading to reform. In fact, he believes in reciprocal response. A good or bad behavior on the part of his peers should be paid in same coin.
Concept of Justice	Children should obey laws because they are established by those in authority. Child confuses moral law and believes that any physical accident or misfortune that occurs after a misdeed is a punishment willed by God.		Children believe that laws or rules are established for the welfare of the individuals and society. He does not confuse natural ill-happenings with punishment for wrong doing.

and community people that they should emphasize cooperative decision making and problem solving for the healthy social interaction and cooperation among the children. It will help in nurturing moral development by requiring children to work out common grounds, interaction and mutual cooperation based on fairness.

However, as pointed out by the critics of Piaget's theory of moral development, Piaget was just a beginner in putting up his views about moral development of children. He did not go beyond childhood (the stage of concrete operation of his theory of cognitive development) for the study of the development of moral reasoning and morality among children. However, his initiation to the study of moral development among children and his assertion about the role of experience and socialization in the development of morality certainly influenced the latter psychologists especially Lawrence Kohlberg for bringing a comprehensive stage theory of moral development.

To Sum Up

Piaget's theory of moral development lays down two distinct stages of moral reasoning named heteronomous stage (5–10 years) and autonomous stage (10 years or more) for explaining the nature of moral development among developing children.

At the heteronomous stage of morality, children are found to believe and behave in the moral realism characterized with a strict adherence to rules and duties and obedience to authority. However, while reaching to autonomous stage, the older children are found to acquire autonomy in taking judgment over the appropriateness or inappropriateness of an act in comparison to the younger children. These changes in their moral behavior, according to Piaget, result from their social interactions. In this way, Piaget emphasized the role of social interaction, mutual give and take and cooperation as the very basis of bringing changes in the moral behavior of the younger children.

Kohlberg's Theory of Moral Development

Lawrence Kohlberg (1927–1987), a psychologist belonging to the Harvard University, tried to extend Piaget's work on children's moral reasoning and development. As a result of his study he got success in putting forward a theory of the development of moral judgment. The sample of his study consisted of hundreds of children belonging to different ages of childhood and adolescence from different family setups, cultures and countries.

In his concept of morality and moral judgment it may be seen that he differs from the popular view that children imbibe the sense and methods of moral judgment from their parents and elders by way of learning. According to him *as soon as we talk with children about morality, we find that they have many ways of making judgments which are not internalized from the outside, and which do not come in any direct and obvious way from parents, teachers and even peers* (Kohlberg, 1968). Going further he clarified that internal or cognitive processes like thinking and reasoning also play a major role in one's moral development, i.e., the way children make moral judgment depends on their level of intellectual development as well as on their upbringing and learning experiences (Kohlberg, 1976).

For studying the process of moral development in human beings, Kohlberg (1964) first defined *moral development as the development of an individual's sense of justice*. For estimating one's sense of justice he concentrated on one's views on morality with the help of a test of moral judgment consisting of a set of moral dilemmas. For instance, should a man who cannot afford the medicine his dying wife needs, steal it? Should a doctor mercy-kill a fatally ill person suffering terrible pain? Is it better to save the life of one important person or a lot of unimportant persons? For the purpose of creating interest among the children he interviewed, he tried to put before them these moral dilemmas in the form of the following story or narrative descriptions.

HEINZ STEALS THE DRUG

In Europe, a woman was near death from a special kind of cancer. There was one drug that the doctor thought might save her. It was a form of radium that

Table 14.3 Kohlberg’s Three Levels and Six Stages of Moral Development

Level I	Pre-moral or Pre-conventional Morality (Age 4 to 10 Years)
Stage 1:	The stage of obedience for avoiding punishment
Stage 2:	The stage of conforming to obtain rewards and favors in return
Level II	Conventional Morality (Age 10 to 13 years)
Stage 3:	Good interpersonal relationships (The stage of maintaining mutual relations and approval of others)
Stage 4:	Maintaining social order (The stage of obedience for avoiding censure by higher authority or social systems)
Level III	Post-Conventional Morality Involving Self-Accepted Moral Principles (Age 13 or not until middle or later adulthood or never)
Stage 5:	Social contract (Stage of conforming to the democratically accepted laws and mores of community welfare)
Stage 6:	Universe ethical principle (Stage of conforming to the universal ethical principles and the call of one’s conscience)

a druggist in the same town had recently discovered. The drug was expensive to make, but the druggist was charging 10 times what the drug cost him to make. He paid \$200 for the radium and charged \$2,000 for a small dose of the drug. The sick woman’s husband, Heinz, went to everyone he knew to borrow the money, but he could only get together about \$1,000 which is half of what it cost. He told the druggist that his wife was dying and asked him to sell it cheaper or let him pay later. But the druggist said: “No, I discovered the drug and I’m going to make money from it.” So, Heinz got desperate and broke into the man’s store to steal the drug for his wife. Should the husband have done that? (Kohlberg, 1963:19)

After putting such dilemma before the subject, he persuaded him to respond. However, Kohlberg was not really interested in whether the subject says “yes” or “no” to this dilemma; he wanted to know the reasoning behind the answer that can reflect his level of moral reasoning needed to assess the subject’s level of moral development. For this purpose, he put the question like, “Why do you think Heinz should or should not have stolen the drug?” For further probing he planned to ask questions like, “Do you think that Heinz had a right to steal the drug?” “Was he violating the druggist rights?” “What sentence should the

judge give Heinz, once he was caught?” In this way, many of such questions were there for Kohlberg to find out the reasoning behind his subject’s answers.

Finally with the help of the analysis of the responses Kohlberg got from his subjects, he came to the conclusion that like the Piagetian stages of cognitive development, there also exist universal stages in the development of moral values, and the movement from one stage to another depends on cognitive abilities rather than the simple acquisition of moral values of one’s parents, elders and peers. He then identified three levels of moral development, each containing two stages as shown in Table 14.3.

Let us now briefly discuss these levels and stages of morality.

LEVEL I: PRE-MORAL OR PRE-CONVENTIONAL MORALITY (4–10 YEARS):

At this level, the child begins to make judgments about what is right or wrong, good or bad. However, the standards by which he measures the morality are those of others. He is persuaded to take such judgments either to avoid punishment or to earn rewards. Development of morality at this level usually follows the following two stages:

STAGE 1: OBEDIENCE AND PUNISHMENT ORIENTATION

In the beginning, the child's morality is controlled by the fear of punishment. He tries to obey his parents and elders purely to avoid reproof and punishment. Actually, the Kohlberg's Stage 1 resembles the Piaget's first stage (heteronomous stage of morality) of moral reasoning. The child assumes that powerful authorities hand down a fixed set of rules which he or she must unquestioningly obey. To the Heinz dilemma, the child typically says that Heinz was wrong to steal the drug because "It's against the law" or "It's bad to steal", as if this were all there were to it. When asked to elaborate, the child usually responds in terms of the consequences involved, explaining that stealing is bad "because you'll get punished" (Kohlberg, 1958).

STAGE 2: INDIVIDUALISM AND EXCHANGE

At this stage of the moral development, children begin to recognize that there is not just one right view that is handed down by the authorities. Different individuals have different viewpoints. "Heinz", they might point out, "might think it's right to take the drug, the druggist would not". Since everything is *relative*, each person is free to pursue his or her *individual* interests. One boy said that Heinz might steal the drug if he wanted his wife to live, but that he doesn't have to if he wants to marry someone younger and better-looking (Kohlberg, 1963:24).

In this way, in the second stage of the pre-moral or pre-conventional level, children's moral judgment is based on self-interest and considerations of what others can do for them in exchange or return. Here they value a thing because it has some practical utility for them. They obey the orders of their parents and elders and abide by some rules and regulations, because it serves their interests.

LEVEL II. CONVENTIONAL MORALITY (10–13 YEARS)

At this level of moral development also, children's moral judgment is controlled by the likes and dislikes of others – the conventions, rules and

regulations and the law and order system maintained within society. Stealing or mercy-killing would thus be judged wrong because it is considered wrong by society at large and by the legal system. In this way, the conventional level of morality may be regarded as the level where the child identifies with authority. It is characterized by the following two stages:

STAGE 3: GOOD INTERPERSONAL RELATIONSHIPS

In the early years of the second level of moral development, the child's moral judgment is based on the desire to obtain approval of others and avoid being disliked by being declared a good boy or a good girl. For this purpose, he begins to judge the intentions and likes or dislikes of others and acts accordingly. As concluded by Kohlberg, children of this stage of moral development believe that children should live up to the expectations of the family and community and behave in 'good' ways like a good boy or good girl. Accordingly, as Kohlberg discovered many of his subjects argued that Heinz was right to steal the drug because "He was a good man for saving the life of his wife simply because no husband would have sitting back and watched his wife die." As example, Kohlberg quotes the response given by his subject Don (aged 13 years) as follows.

It was really the druggist's fault, he was unfair, trying to overcharge and letting someone die. Heinz loved his wife and wanted to save her. I think anyone would. I don't think they would put him in jail. The judge would look at all sides, and see that the druggist was charging too much.

(Kohlberg, 1963:25)

Kohlberg concluded from such responses of his subjects that by responding in such a way, they were demonstrating the level of their conventional morality because it assumes that the attitude expressed would be shared conventionally by the entire community – 'anyone' would be right to do what Heinz did.

STAGE 4: MAINTAINING THE SOCIAL ORDER

According to Kohlberg, stage 3 reasoning works best in two-person relationships with family members or close friends, where one can make a real effort to get to know the other's feelings and needs and try to help. At stage 4, in contrast, the respondent becomes more broadly concerned with *society as a whole*. Now the emphasis is on obeying laws, respecting authority and performing one's duties so that the social order is maintained. In support of his conclusion Kohlberg again cites the responses of his subjects to the Heinz story. Many of his subjects were found to utter that they understand that Heinz's intention or motive was good but they cannot condone the theft. What would happen if all of us started breaking the laws whenever we felt we had a good reason? The result would be chaos; society could not function.

In this way the children reaching the moral stage 4 begin to take moral decisions from the perspective of the society as a whole. At this stage children's moral behavior and judgments are governed by conventions as well as the laws and mores of the social system. The standards of others are now so established that it becomes a convention to follow them. The children now follow the rules and regulations of society and take decisions about things being right or wrong with a view to avoiding censure by the elders, authorities or the social system.

LEVEL III. POST-CONVENTIONAL MORALITY INVOLVING SELF-ACCEPTED MORAL PRINCIPLES (AGE 13 AND AFTERWARDS)

This marks the highest level of attainment of true morality as the controlling force for making judgments now rests with the individual himself. He does not value a thing or conform to an idea merely because of consideration of the views of others, conventions or the law and order-system of the society but because it fits onto the framework of his self-accepted moral principles. However, to reach this level is not an ordinary thing. One may be able to attain it in the beginning or middle of his adolescence

or it may be postponed for him till the middle or later adulthood or he may never attain it in his lifetime. This highest level of moral development is also characterized by two separate stages as described next.

STAGE 5: SOCIAL CONTRACTS AND INDIVIDUAL RIGHTS

At stage 5, as Kohlberg concludes, individuals begin to ask, "What makes for a good society?" They basically believe that a good society is best conceived as a social contract into which people freely enter to work toward the benefit for all. They recognize that all rational people would agree on two points: (i) getting certain basic rights, such as liberty and life, to be protected; and (ii) needing some democratic procedures for changing unfair laws and for improving society. In support of his conclusion, Kohlberg quotes the responses of his subjects to Heinz's dilemma. Many of his respondents make it clear that they do not generally favor the breaking of laws; laws are social contracts that we agree to uphold until we can change them by democratic means. Nevertheless, his wife's right to live is a moral right that must be protected.

In this way, at this stage the individual's moral judgments are internalized in such a form that he responds positively to authority only if he agrees with the principles upon which the demands of authority are based. The individual at this stage begins to think in rational terms, valuing the rights of human beings and the welfare of society. For example, at this stage in reference to the rights of the human being, the decision about mercy-killing may be left to the individual who is suffering, and if so needed, the concerned laws may be amended for the welfare of society at large.

STAGE 6: UNIVERSAL PRINCIPLES

This stage of moral development is the highest stage or perfection achieved in terms of moral reasoning and development of morality. In propagating his theory of moral development, Kohlberg believes that there must be a higher stage of moral development (as just conceived by him through his stage 6) which defines the principles by which we get the type of justice as conceived by the great moral leaders like Mahatma

Gandhi and Martin Luther King Jr. The principle of justice is universal and requires us to treat the claims of all parties in an impartial way, respecting the dignity of all people as individuals and humans. According to Kohlberg, we can reach this stage in case we begin to look at a situation purely through one another's eyes. Take the case of Heinz's dilemma; reaching this stage would essentially require that all parties – the druggist, Heinz and his wife – try to view the things from others' perspectives for seeking justice and fair solution of the problem. As a result, in the end, they would all agree that the life of the wife must be saved by sacrificing the narrow interests related to money or conventional laws.

In this way at stage 6 of our moral development the controlling forces for making moral judgments are highly internalized. The decisions of the individual are now based upon his conscience and the belief in universal principles of respect, justice and equality. He does what he, as an individual, thinks right regardless of legal restrictions or the opinion of others. Thus, at this stage people act according to the inner voice of their conscience; provide evidence of sharing, helping and defending the victims of injustice; and lead a life that they can without self-condemnation or feeling of guilt or shame.

From the preceding discussion of Kohlberg's stages of moral development, it is clear that although children begin to think about morality in terms of justice or right and wrong at a very early age, they have to wait until adolescence or adulthood for the dawning of the stage of true morality. Also, it is not essential that all people pass through the third level of moral development. Most adults are not able to cross the second level and few can reach stage 5, and among these there are very few who, being intellectually quite sound, can think rationally and base their moral judgment purely on the dictates of their conscience at the risk of life and property.

To Sum Up

Kohlberg's theory of moral development emphasizes that like the Piagetian stages of cognitive development, there also exists

universal stages in the development of moral values, and the movement from one stage to another depends on cognitive abilities rather than the simple acquisition of moral values of one's parents, elders and peers.

Kohlberg identified three levels and six stages of moral development. He named these levels as pre-moral or pre-conventional-morality (4–10 years), conventional morality (10–13 years), and post-conventional-morality (13 years onwards). The six stages associated with these levels are: (i) the stage of obedience for avoiding punishment, (ii) the stage of conforming to obtain rewards and favor, (iii) the stage of maintaining mutual relations and approval of others, (iv) the stage of obedience for avoiding censure by higher authority or social systems, (v) stage of conforming to the democratically accepted laws and mores of community welfare and (vi) stage of conforming to the universal ethical principles and the call of one's conscience.

By providing these stages, Kohlberg claimed that an individual progresses through them in order, without skipping any. Each of Kohlberg's stages builds upon the foundation laid by earlier stages but reflects a more integrated and logical consistent set of moral beliefs than those before it.

Agents of Socialization

Socialization – the process of bringing changes in the social behavior of the individuals – is purely a socio-environmental phenomenon and learned affair. The factors or agencies working for the socialization of the children therefore essentially lie in one's socio-cultural environment. We may name them as parents and family, neighborhood, peers and playing mates, school, social and religious institutions, regional and political organizations, community and clubs, means of entertainment, information and communications, mass media and smart appliances, etc. All these socializing agents as a part and parcel of one's socio-cultural environment play a quite significant role in

shaping the social behavior of the growing children in a particular way – desirable or undesirable. How do they do it? Let us illustrate by discussing the role or functions of some of the important social agencies in this concern.

1. **Parents and Family:** Family is named as the most important primary agency for socialization of the child. The home atmosphere and the family relationships exercise much influence upon the social development of the child. The child learns the first lesson of social qualities from his parents. Consciously or unconsciously, he imitates the behavior of his parents and members of the family and thus picks up so many good or bad social characteristics and behavior patterns that accompany him even up to the end of his life. The size of the family, the relationships within the family, attitude of the parents and family members socio-economic status and position of the family in the society, the traditions, culture, values and the ideals of the family – all influence the process of socialization and social development of the child. The family which provides a healthy social atmosphere and where basic needs of children are satisfied produces well behaved and socially mature individuals whereas in the homes when the family relationships are under strain and the elders possess negative social characteristics, the child is not brought up properly and consequently the socially undesirable and negative behavior is produced among children.
2. **The School and Its Atmosphere:** Socialization and social development in children is greatly influenced by the social environment and functioning of the schools. The human relationships maintained by the school, the kinds of programs and activities performed, its traditions, values and principles, the social qualities and behavior of the teachers and school mates – all influence the social development of the child. The school, having a healthy social and democratic atmosphere inculcates so many social virtues among the students while a poor and unhealthy

atmosphere of the school and the negative social behavioral characteristics of the teachers and school mates cast a bad influence upon the social behavior of the child.

3. **Peer-Group Relationship and Gang Influence:** The play mates, school or class mates also influence the social development of the child. He picks up the habits and social qualities of his companions. A good companion helps him to learn good qualities while a bad companion provides all opportunities to spoil him and give him anti-social personalities. On the credit side, through peer-group relationships and gang influence he learns to cooperate, to lead and follow, to think for a common cause and to adjust in the challenging social situations. It inculcates the sense of loyalty, sympathetic attitude and the willingness to obey social rules and regulations.
 Parents, teachers and other responsible members of society should remain very careful to see that the child gets a healthy companion. The negative influence of the peer group and the gang in the form of an unsocial behavior for development of evil social characteristics should be checked. The child should be accepted by his peer group. He should get proper environment and opportunities to mix with his peers.
4. **Neighborhood and Its Impact:** One's neighborhood is just a simple extension of one's home and the family. Whosoever may live in the neighborhood, their ways of behaving, personality characteristics and lifestyle cast a significant impact upon the social behavior and development of the growing children. The good neighborhood directs the socialization and personality development of the children to a desirable channel for imbibing socially desirable traits like tolerance, peace and brotherhood, sacrifice, respect to other's opinion, love and affection, goodwill and friendship, cooperation and helping nature, etc. On the other hand, a poor and defective neighborhood casts a quite negative and evil impact on the children taking them in a quite negative direction and shape to their social behavior and personality

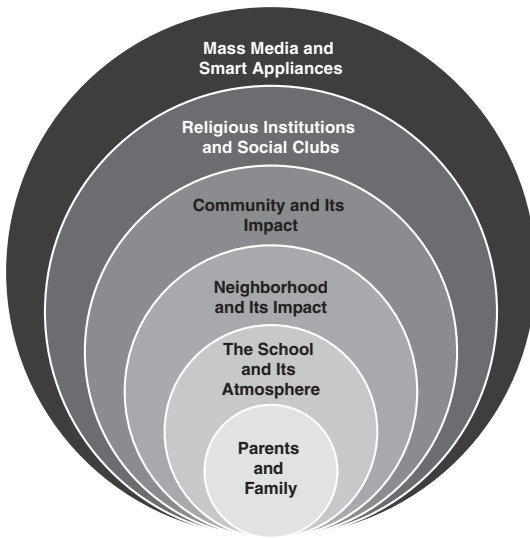


Figure 14.1 The Agents of Socialization

development and as a result they may imbibe negative traits like enmity, jealousy, disharmony, fighting, conflicts and tensions, egoism and blind competitions, etc. The process of socialization and its outcomes, thus, may be quite positively and negatively influenced as a result of the positivity or negativity present in the social behavior of the children and adults living in their neighborhood.

5. **Community and Its Impact:** As the children grow and develop in their age, the area of their social contact is widened beyond the boundaries of their homes and neighborhood. They come into contact with the children and people of the community to which they belong. Every community is characterized with the unique features of the social behavior and cultural patterns of its members. Moreover, the interaction among the members of every community including children has its unique contribution in influencing and affecting the socialization and social development of the children in a quite positive or negative way much similar to what happens through the impact exercised through the good and bad neighborhood.
6. **Religious Institutions and Social Clubs:** The social agencies like temple, church, social clubs,

etc. also influence the social development of the child. These places serve as a meeting ground for the members of the society and help in developing social contacts and relationships. The socialization and social development of an individual is greatly influenced by the traditions, values, ideals and social characteristics maintained by these institutions.

7. **Mass Media:** Mass media while playing its role as an important information, communication and entertainment agency proves a quite potent and powerful social agency for influencing and affecting the socialization and social development of growing children. In its working, mass media is found to provide a wide variety of impersonal information to a huge number of audiences of all ages via radio, television, newspapers, magazines, cinema, computers and smart phone device. In the capacity of readers, listeners, viewers and users, these mass media sources constantly inform the growing children about the changes in the social structure, customs, traditions, norms and values of the society and thus help in maintaining continuity in their process of socialization and social development in a useful way. In fact no means or instrument of social change can match the impact of mass media. What a hero or heroine does on the screen is at once imitated. The values of the life, the style of living, the traditions and cultural pattern of behaving all may go through a drastic change by the impact of these modern mass agencies in positive as well as negative ways. That is why these agencies should not be allowed to function unchecked. Society or government should exercise a desirable control and check upon the functioning of these mass media sources so that no undesirable and anti-social trend is picked up by the growing children for their needed socialization and development. As far as possible, directly or indirectly these sources should be made to function in a way helping the socialization and development of the growing children in the desired manner suiting the needs of the community and the nation.

To Sum Up

The factors or agencies working for the socialization of individuals from their early childhood essentially lie in one's socio-cultural environment. We may name them as parents and family, neighborhood, peers and playing mates, school, social and religious institutions, religious and political organizations, community and clubs, means of entertainment, information and communications, mass media and smart appliances, etc. All these socializing agents as a part and parcel of one's socio-cultural environment play a quite significant role in shaping the social behavior of the growing individuals in a particular way – desirable or undesirable.

Review Questions

1. While defining the term socialization throw light on its meaning and nature.
2. What is socialization? Discuss various theories explaining the process of socialization of the individuals.
3. What is psychoanalytic theory or perspective of socialization? Discuss in brief.
4. Discuss in detail Erikson's theory or perspective of socialization.
5. Throw light on the social learning perspective or theory of socialization.
6. Discuss the moral development perspective of socialization in light of the views expressed by Piaget and Kohlberg in their moral development theories.
7. Discuss in detail the role of various agents or agencies in the socialization of individuals.

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15.

SOCIAL CHANGE – MEANING, NATURE AND MECHANISM

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- Define the term social change.
- Tell about the nature and characteristics of social change.
- Throw light on the forms and kinds of social change.
- Name and describe the factors of social change.
- Discuss the theories of social change.
- Explain the evolutionary or linear theory of social change.
- Throw light on the cyclical theory of social change.
- Discuss the conflict theory of social change.

Introduction

Nothing in the universe is static or permanent. Change is the law of nature and thereby all things in our world always remain in a state of flux. The building we see, the river that is flowing and mountain that exists before us may not be present sometime later on. It is claimed that there was a vast ocean where we today find our Great Himalayas. However, changes do not occur only in the physical aspects of our environment. The social aspect is also very much covered in these ongoing constant changes. Everything which is included in the category of *social* also remains in the state of constant change and modification in one way or the other. Accordingly, we may witness significant changes taking place constantly in the structure and functioning of the society, the

social behavior and relations, social norms and values, and even in the attitudes and beliefs of the individuals. All of such changes occurring in the fabric of the society are usually referred to as social changes in the field of sociology and social psychology. In this chapter we would like to discuss the essentials related to the meaning, nature and mechanism of the term social change.

Social Change – Meaning and Definitions

The term social changes, in its word meaning, stands for the type of changes occurring in the social fabric of our environment. In this sense, such changes are found to take place in everything designated as *social* in its naming. In their attempts of knowing and understanding about the meaning and nature of

the term social change, sociologists and thinkers have tried to define it in their own ways. Let us try to have a glimpse of some of these definitions for our own understanding about this term.

Gillin and Gillin (1948): Social changes are variations from the accepted modes of life; whether due to alteration in geographical conditions, in cultural equipment, composition of the population or ideologies and brought about by diffusion, or inventions within the group.

Jones (1949): Social change is a term used to describe variations in, or modifications of any aspect of social processes, social patterns, social interactions or social organization.

Davis (1949): By social change is meant only such alterations as occur in social organization, that is, the structure and functions of society.

Fairchild (1944): Social change means variations or modifications in any aspect of social process, pattern or form.

Morris Ginsberg (1956): By social change, I understand a change in social structure, e.g., the size of the society, the composition or the balance of its parts or the type of its organization.

Merrill and Eldredge (1957): Social change means that a large number of persons are engaging in activities that differ from those which they or their immediate forefathers engaged in some time before.

Bottomore (1972): Social change is change in social structure (including changes in the size of the society) or in particular social institutions or in the relationships between institutions.

International Encyclopedia of Social Science (1972): Social change refers to an alteration in the social structure of a social group or society, which are actually the change in the nature of social institutions, social behaviors or social relations of a society.

Anderson and Parker et al. (1974): Social change involves alterations in the structure or functioning of societal forms or processes themselves.

B. Kuppaswamy (1975): Social change may be defined as the process in which is discernible significant alteration in the structure and functioning of a particular social system.

Zeitlin (1981): The study of social change is concerned with the processes through which societies and cultures are transformed.

Johnson (1983): Social change is change in social structure, social structural elements like values, norms, status, roles, groups, sub-groups and collectively. Hence, change in any of these structural elements may be regarded as social change. As the social system functions within its structural framework, structural change has consequences also for the functioning of the system. Therefore, social change is the change in the structure and functioning of the social system.

MacIver and Page (1985): Our direct concern as sociologists is with social relationships. It is the change in these relationships which alone we shall regard as social change.

We may see that the thinkers and sociologists have tried to take their own stand for defining the term social change in their own ways. All the definitions, after being analyzed properly, may be put into three categories – each emphasizing its own point of view in the manner as cited next.

1. **Definitions leaning heavily on social structure:** According to one group of sociologists or thinkers, *social changes are the changes taking place in the social structure or organization*. These changes, thus, may occur in various structural elements or organizational components of the society such as its various social institutions or agencies, values and norms of the society, stratification or formation of the groups in the society based on status and prestige, locality, caste, color or religion, etc.
2. **Definitions leaning heavily on social functioning:** According to another group of sociologists or thinkers, *social changes are the changes that may be noticed to occur in the functioning of the social systems*. These changes are visible in the shape of changes brought out in the mode of thinking and living of the people, the nature of the social interaction and social exchange processes, the nature of the ideals, philosophical ideas, democratic or autocratic views governing the society, values and norms running the social

system, technological and scientific progress going on in the society, etc.

3. **Definitions taking an integrated view:** This third group of sociologists and thinkers, while not leaning on any extreme, has taken a balanced stand by emphasizing that *social changes are the changes that are brought from time to time in the structure and functioning of a social system.*

In our own opinion, it is actually what happens during the social changes brought out in a sector or field of the existing system of a society such as economic, political, socio-cultural, religious, moral, technological and scientific, etc. The changes affect and influence all what happens in terms of its structural composition and its behavioral functioning. Structural composition of a social system and its functioning, thus, at all times and situations, simultaneously become a subject of social change for playing their role in the adjustment and progress of the society. A structure is useless without its functioning, and functioning is only possible through the operation of a structural system in a proper way. Structural organization and its functioning, both, therefore, should always be treated as an interdependent entity and co-traveler in the journey of social changes introduced at any time in the fabric of a society.

Social Change

The change brought out from time to time in the system of a society in terms of its structural organization and functioning.

Taking all the things viewed and discussed earlier regarding the meaning and concept of the phenomenon of social change we may conclude to define it in the words given here:

Social change is the change brought out from time to time in the system of a society in terms of its structural organization (e.g., social institutions, socio-cultural norms, mores and traditions, etc.) and as well as its functioning (e.g., social processes, social behavior and relationships, mode of living and thinking, etc.).

Nature and Characteristics of Social Change

The social changes, brought out in the social system and its functioning, are characterized with some of the essential features named and discussed as follows.

1. **Social Change Is Essentially Social:** Social change is the change that is essentially social in nature. It is applicable to only which is termed social in our environment. It does not concern with the changes occurring in our physical surroundings or environment. It is why the change occurring in the things and issues concerning our society/community is what we can term as a social change. The variation and change, thus, occurring in the structural organization and the functioning of our society/community is referred to as social change. It is to be noted clearly here, that a change is called a social change only when its influence can be felt in a social or community form. Social change is social and not individual. Social change does not refer to the change in the life of an individual. It is a change which should cover or apply to all or a considerable segment of the society or community.
2. **Social Change Is Universal:** Changes in the structure and functioning of the social system brought out by the phenomenon of social change are quite universal. They take place at all times in each and every community, society and nations in this world of ours. The universality of the phenomenon of change may be easily witnessed by looking at the graphs of population change, means of transport and communication, expansion and modernization of the scientific and technological progress and change in the mode of living and thinking in almost all the societies of world at their own speed and scale.
3. **Social Change Is Inevitable:** It means that it is quite natural for the world societies or rather to say a compulsion on their part to follow the universal phenomenon of social change. Change is an unavoidable and unchangeable law of nature. Nothing in our physical and social

world can exist for long without following the rule of change. Social change – the change in the structure and functioning of the social system – is also natural and bound to happen with no exception for its own existence, adjustment and progress.

4. **Social Change Is Continuous:** The changes going on in our society at the local and global levels witness a unique trend of continuity in their occurring. Our society on account of such ceaseless continuity of change always remains in the state of flux. Change in the fabric of the society is ever moving and continuous. Actually, as an ever-changing phenomenon it is undergoing endless changes. It is this ongoing process of continuity of the change that helps in structuring and re-structuring of the society for taking it on its new journey of renewal and progress.
5. **Social change Is Unpredictable:** For the social change, we can say with quite certainty that it is social, universal, inevitable and continuous. We also know how these social changes have occurred in our past and are occurring in the present with their impact on our social life. The only thing which we do not know about social change is how it will be going on in the future and in what way it is going to influence our life. Actually, it is too difficult to make out any prediction on the exact forms of social change. For example, urbanization and cultural integration has brought about a series of interrelated changes in our family and marriage system. But we cannot predict about the exact nature they will assume in the near future. Similarly, we can't predict about what will be the values and norms of the future society and what will be the thinking of the future generation.
6. **Speed of Social Change Is Not Uniform:** Instead of showing any uniformity, the speed of social change is uneven, irregular and relative. We may clearly note that, while the phenomenon of social change demonstrates a lot of universality in its occurrence in all societies, no such uniformity is shown by it in its speed of occurrence. In place of uniformity, a lot of irregularity, unevenness and relativity are observed

in the speed of social changes in our societies. Where in some societies its speed is rapid, it is slow in others and in some it occurs so slowly that it may not be noticed by those who live in them. We can easily witness such unevenness in the speed of the social change in modern, industrial based urban society and the traditional, agriculturally based rural society.

7. **Social Changes Are Chiefly Those of Modifications or of Replacement:** Social changes in the society are most usually and commonly witnessed through some or the other modifications or replacements made in its structural composition and functioning. Accordingly, a social change may be in the form of modifying or replacing the structural composition of the family system from the combined family system to the nuclear family system. In relation to social functioning, it may be in the form of modifying or replacing the behavior of the young generation from early rising to late rising and preferring fast food stuff and restaurant meal than the home-made preparation.
8. **Social Change Shows Chain-Reaction Sequence:** The social changes going on the structure and functioning of the society may be found to demonstrate a quite unique chain-reaction sequence in their occurring. Actually, a society functions as an integrated system with all its subsystems/components working in close cooperation and correlation with each other. Accordingly, when a particular type of change in one component of the structure or the functioning of a social system appears, it stimulates or causes the subsequent changes in the other related subsystem or component in a chain like sequence. For example, with the inclination and preference of the young generation for love marriage in place of the arranged marriage, the barriers like in caste or in religion have been removed; it has resulted in alienating the young couples from their parental families and relatives. They have begun to feel a sense of social insecurity and lack of support for the bringing up of their children especially when both are in employment. It has also resulted in

more infighting and cases of divorce. In other cases, the love marriage aspirants have started to develop friendship and dating each other or in some cases to live in relationship in the roles of husband and wife. It has created a variety of social problems like same sex marriages, unwanted pregnancies, blackmailing or blaming each other for cheating and sexually harassing, etc. In this way, a change in one aspect of the social functioning is found to ignite a change in another aspect of our social functioning giving birth to an endless chain-reaction sequence in the organization and functioning of our social system.

9. **Social Change Occurs in Its Various Forms and Modes:** There is no uniformity or set pattern for the occurrence of the social change. Social change may occur in a variety of forms and modes such as (i) in small as well as large scale, (ii) peaceful or violent in its intensity, (iii) planned or unplanned and (iv) endogenous (internal) and exogenous (external) etc.
10. **Social Changes Occur on Account of a Number of Factors or Causes:** The other distinguished feature of the phenomenon of social change lies in its causation. It has been found that a social change cannot be explained on the basis of a single factor. It is the consequence of a number of factors or rather to say a close interaction of a number of factors. A number of factors of various nature (we will be discussing all of them ahead in detail in this chapter) do combine as well as interact for causing a social change. Agreeing with this explanation, M. Ginsberg (1956) writes: "A cause is an assemblage of factors which, in interaction with each other, undergo a change." In this concern, a change may appear to be triggered by one of the factors (named as precipitating cause), but it is always associated with other factors that make the triggering possible (called as basic or inherent cause). In this way, a social change must be thought to be brought out always with the interplay of a number of causative factors – precipitating and basic.

Forms and Kinds of Social Change

The change in the structure and functioning of our social system brought out at different times and places may be found to take place in their various forms and kinds. Thinkers and sociologists have tried to classify them in their own ways (MacIver and Page, 1985; Bottomore, 1972; W.E. Moore, 1974). A few of the important classifications incorporating distinctive forms and types of social changes may be discussed as follows.

1. **Linear vs. Fluctuating Social Change:** True to its naming, this type of social change is linear i.e., continuing to follow more or less in the same direction (increase or decrease, high or low, slow or fast, rise and fall, etc.) like a straight line. Whenever, a type of social change occurring in the structure or functioning of the society is found to follow constantly the same direction of increase or decrease, rise or fall, high or low, then, it is referred to as linear social change. As example of such social change, we may cite the growth and increase (or decrease) of the population density, the production in a business establishment, growth and development in scientific knowledge, or decline in religious faith.

Fluctuating change, on the other hand, true to its naming, is the change in the structure and functioning of the society that is characterized with a lot of fluctuation in its degree of occurrence over time. In this way, it stands pole apart to the linear change that is characterized with a lot of constancy in the degree of its occurrence. For example, take the case of the system of marriage. First it was arranged, and it is now somewhat mixed – arranged as well as love marriages taking place in between male and female, while in some countries it is advancing towards same sex. In this way, the trend is so fluctuating that we cannot say what form it will be taking in the future.

2. **Small vs. Large Scale Change:** The social change may occur in the form and shape of a quite small or very large scale. In its small scale it may cover a small unit or segment of a local society, e.g., the

people belonging to a particular family in a small village celebrate the birth of a girl child (where formerly in this village of Haryana, the girl children had to die in the womb of their mothers). On the other hand, in its large scale, the social change may be found to cover a quite large area, breaking the boundaries and extending to larger and larger areas. The birth of the girl child is a thing of welcome in each and every corner of the Haryana state – a significant social change occurring on a large scale.

3. **Gradual vs. Rapid Social Change:** At times, the change in the structure and functioning of a social system takes place at such a slow speed in a gradual way that its impact is not even felt by the individuals or groups who themselves are the subjects of such change. Gradual change is quite peaceful in its nature and thereby it is also referred to as peaceful social change. The change brought out in the moral and social behaviors of the children through the formal instructions or modeling may be put in the category of gradual or peaceful change.

Rapid social change, on the other hand, refers to that change that tries to bring modification and replacement in the already existing structure and functioning of the society with a quite rapid speed and in a violent way. It is why it is also referred to as a violent social change. It is more vehemently observed and noticed by the outsiders in the social institutions or organization, and social behavior as well as social relationships existing among individuals and groups. The change introduced by the scientific and technological progress in the modern urban society is so rapid that it appears to have taken them nearly by storm. It has rapidly and more forcefully (or to say violently) affected the thinking, feeling and living of the affected individuals, groups and the society as a whole. In addition, more violent or rapid change in the society is witnessed as a result of a certain kind of political or class revolution, war and occupation or division of a country, etc.

4. **Planned vs. Unplanned Social Change:** Social change may also be divided into two types or

forms, planned or unplanned. Planned changes in the fabric of a society are brought deliberately in a planned manner by human engineering. Here plans, projects and programs are chalked out and executed by the people or a caring government for introducing a certain type of change in the structure and functioning of the society. On the other hand, unplanned social change refers to the change arrived at with no such planning or even intention of introducing it in the occurred way. As an example of such unplanned social change, we may cite the change introduced in the social structure and its functioning on account of natural calamities, such as famines and floods, earthquakes and volcanic eruption, etc. Similarly, social change arrived in a natural course gradually or suddenly as a result of foreign invasion, cultural assimilation, war and internal disturbances, etc. may also be put into the category of unplanned social change.

5. **Endogenous vs. Exogenous Social Change:** Another important classification of social change can be made in terms of its division into two types – endogenous and exogenous social changes. In its dictionary meaning, the term endogenous change stands for the change having an internal cause or origin for its occurrence. In this sense, by the term endogenous social change we mean the type of social change caused by the factors operating in the organization and function of the society itself. It is purely an internal matter of the society which is undergoing a certain type of social change in it. Such a change is being generated by society or a given subsystem of the society. The change reflected in the society in the form of growing conflicts, regionalism, intolerance towards other's religion, or caring for environmental protection, emphasis on cleanliness, flow of inter-communication within the society, etc. are some of the examples of endogenous social change.

On the other hand, in its dictionary meaning, the term exogenous change refers to the change having an external cause or origin for its occurrence. In

this sense, the term exogenous social change stands for the type of social change introduced in a social system by the external factors operating on it from outside. The changes occurring in the structure and functioning of a social system on account of foreign aggression, trade war, natural calamities, or by new factors introduced into the system from other cultures and societies such as technological transfer and brain drain, cultural diffusion, etc. are some of the examples of exogenous social change.

Factors of Social Change

Social change in the organization and function of the society is carried out by a number of factors or rather to say interaction of a variety of factors grouped and discussed as follows.

1. Biological Factors

The social change may be found to be influenced in a considerable extent by the biological factors associated with the human beings. These may be named chiefly as (i) genetic makeup and qualitative aspect of the population and (ii) biological process of natural selection and struggle for survival. Let us examine these.

The qualitative aspect of a certain population depends on the quality of content lying within the members of that population. The quality of the genetic component contributes towards providing the society the genius, inventors, powerful and great men and women for providing direction and development to the society. They are the people who may play a great role in bringing significant social change. It has been argued by a number of sociologists and thinkers that biological factors in the form of genetic inheritance and mutation play a decisive role in deciding the qualitative genetic makeup of the members of the society which in turn contribute significantly towards bringing change in the structure and function of the society. When there is mixing of the communities, castes, tribes and races through inter-group and inter-community marriages or sex relationships, then, there is no surprise to witness frequent changes in such intermixed and inter-mingled society.

Apart from this the biological factors in the shape of the process of natural selection and struggle for existence or survival also play a quite decisive role in bringing constant alterations in the social fabric. According to Darwin, the well-known biologist and evolutionist, there is a process of natural selection that is going on in all the species including human beings. Those who adapt to the change survive while others who are weaker get pushed out by a stronger section of the society. New organizations and establishments take place by eliminating those who lag behind in the struggle for survival. The weaker and the losers have to lose their own identity by merging it to the identity of the stronger and the winners. Similarly, in a particular region, the sociologically advanced communities/societies push the less advanced into a corner persuading or almost forcing them to adapt to the necessary social change. Besides this, the biological factors in the form of change in the demographic character of the society also are said to play a quite decisive role in bringing social change. We will be discussing their role in the point to follow.

2. Demographic Factors

The term demography according to Collins English Dictionary (Harper Collins Publishers) refers to the scientific study of human populations, especially with reference to their size, structure and distribution. All the factors concerning demographic character of a society in the shape of the size, numbers, composition, density and the local distribution of its population play a quite decisive role in causing social change. Take the case of change in the size of the population. Whenever in a society or region there is an increase in its population, it creates paucity of resources for its survival followed by a number of changes in its social fabric. In the Indian context, we may observe that an excessive increase in population has resulted in bringing so many alterations in the structure and function of the society, in the shape of struggling to meet the survival as well as developmental needs of the vast population. It has resulted in the increase in unemployment, shortage of agricultural land in the rural areas, migration to cities, rise in nuclear families, increase in the number of

slums, altering the nature of social relationships in a perceptible manner, and increase in the crime rate, social tension and a huge gap between rich and poor. In fact, thus, the increase in the size of the population of a society affects the whole composition and ways of living of its members in a quite notable way.

On the other hand, the demographic character reflected through a considerable decrease in the population of a society also causes a number of alarming problems resulting in one or the other types of social change. The decreasing trend in the population of a tribe or minority community may pose a danger of its extinction. The new ways and means are to be adopted for its survival by focusing on some or the other welfare schemes, means of bringing change in their social life etc. In countries suffering from population shortage, they have to depend upon the services of migrants. Their changing to the adoption of more and more technological means in agriculture, dairy farming and industrial establishments is a direct consequence of the shortage of manpower resulted through underpopulation. In some societies and countries, the underpopulation may create security problems. They can't raise a sizable army for the defense of their country and must depend on others for their security against foreign invasion. The structure and function of these societies or nations, then, undergo change in adaptation to their needs and solution of their problems.

In addition to the size of the population, its distribution and ratio also cause social change. The inequality and a sizable difference in the ratio of male vs. female and old vs. young affect the economic and social conditions of a society or nation. In the societies where the male population outnumbers the female population, there arise problems like (i) the shortage of brides for the bridegrooms, (ii) emergence of the practice of polyandry and (iii) a rise in the sex crimes and transport of brides from other regions resulting in a lot of social problems and alterations in the fabric of the society. Similarly, in the societies where the female population exceeds the male population, there arise problems like (i) shortage of bridegrooms for the brides, (ii) emergence of the practice of polygyny and (iii) a shortage of man power for the jobs and tasks specifically suited to the males resulting

in a variety of social problems and alterations in the fabric of the society. In the same sequence, if in a society there becomes a disproportionate increase in the number of the children and old people, the society becomes crippled on account of the lack of suitable young workforce for running its economy and performing a number of other works suited to the young adults. Moreover, the society has also to divert its available resources for the feeding and care of the children and old. The families have to adopt a lifestyle suiting to their caring and look after.

3. Physical and Geographical Factors

The physical things and happenings in the environment as well as certain geographical conditions play a quite major role in bringing change in the structure and function of societies at one or the other times. The following instances may provide needed evidence for certifying this fact.

- The change in physical surroundings and geographical location of a village community through the incidences, announcement and construction of a highway, establishment of a manufacturing unit, linking it through railway line, or making a state headquarter for some public utility nearby it may be found to bring a lot of opportunities for the members of the community for raising their economy and status and thus altering their ways of living in a considerable way.
- The changes brought out in the fertility of the soil, availability of water for crops through the construction of a dam or its unavailability due to sudden change of direction by a flowing river, discovery of valuable mineral resources, oil in nearby location, etc. may be found to introduce a lot of change in the living style of the concerned societies.
- The effect of certain geographical conditions prevailing in the region such as extreme cold, hot, desert type conditions, rainy season, flooded rivers, upsurge of frequent storms, etc. may alter the living of the people of that region in a particular way.

- The occurrence of natural and man-made calamities such as volcano eruption or earthquakes, rock sliding in the hilly areas, poisonous gas leakage in an area, fatal road and rail accidents, caste and communal clashes, and political or social riots, etc. may work as a great cause for social change. Moreover, the history of human civilization provides a significant testimony that a number of societies and civilizations have fallen prey to natural and man-made disasters and calamities causing a quite mentionable change in their social structure and functioning.
- Drastic changes in physical environment in the form of change in weather conditions, draught and floods, etc. often force migration of people in large numbers from one region to another region resulting in quite a big change in their social life and cultural values along with casting a sizable impact on the social life of the people living there.
- Environmental conditions and geographical location of the societies play a quite decisive role in affecting the thinking and feeling behaviors of the people, their mode of living and progressing in life. The people living in hilly areas are found to be quite hardworking, nature lovers and enthusiastic about environmental protection, in comparison to the people living in plain areas and hot climate. The ease and convenience available in the earning of livelihood may turn the people of plain areas into an idle or lethargic personality and affect their social living in the similar ways.

4. Cultural Factors

By the term culture of a society, we mean a well settled way of living, thinking and behaving of its people going on in the society since quite long. In this sense, it becomes too difficult to distinguish between the culture and social fabric of a society. The social institutions and social behavior of the people belonging to a society cannot be thought at all exclusive to what is there in the culture of that society. Values, belief systems and mode of living and behaving demonstrated

by the people belonging to a society are directly or indirectly the creations of cultural belief and values inherent in that society. In fact, the social and the cultural aspects are closely interwoven. If there is a change marked as cultural change in the form of values, beliefs and ideas, etc. in the society, it brings its correspondingly social change in the society. To illustrate this, we can see that the industrialization, urbanization and need to seek employment outside the home place have resulted in the rise of nuclear families by replacing the age-old joint family system. It has brought a considerable alteration in relationships within the family, and there has been a considerable change in the cultural values and beliefs of the affected individuals and families as a result of their seeking migration to nearby towns or far-away places having a different cultural value system. In turn, it has resulted in bringing corresponding change in the social structure and its functioning. The women in the city culture have begun to feel the need of seeking more social and economic independence, wishing that their partners help them in household jobs and children caring and demanding a major or at least equal role in family decisions.

Actually, what we witness in terms of the social change in the structure and functioning of a society from time to time is a direct or indirect creation of change in cultural values, beliefs and mode of living of that society resulted either through the invention and creation in the society itself or brought out by intermixing of the different cultures. Whatever mode and form of change may be in the culture of a society, it definitely gives speed and direction to social change for its moving further in the journey of progress and development.

5. Economic Factors

Economy is the life blood of a society. It is quite essential and vital for its survival, sustainment and development. Whatever good and bad in terms of its existing infrastructure and way of living and functioning of its members is visible in a particular society is said to be a direct or indirect contribution of the economic factors. Therefore, change in the economy of a society causes a considerable change likewise in

the structure and function of a society. The following instances may provide needed evidence for certifying this fact.

- For instance let us take a situation of substantial increase in the economy of a rural agricultural community belonging to a village or region for the reasons like (i) increase in the production by getting water for irrigation and following advice of the agricultural experts; (ii) growing cash crops and having medicine plants; (iii) getting a lot of good compensation for taking over their agriculture land on the part of private organizations or government agencies for their utilization; (iv) availability of valuable mineral resources, oil and natural gas, etc. in their vicinity; (v) establishment of industrial complex and business chains in their neighborhood; and (vi) announcement of making a new capital or establishing airport, headquarter of a reputed organization, defense establishment, etc. in its geographical location. In all such situations, it is most likely to have a sharp shot in the economy of individuals and the community as a whole in a considerable extent. The rising status or the economy of a society then brings a lot of changes in the social life of its people in its various shapes and modes. They feel comfortable in fulfilling their basic needs, and also begin to aspire for the comfortable high status living as available for the people of the good socio-economy status in the town and cities including availability of quality education to their children by admitting them to residential public school. They also develop the attitude of antagonism and competing with their fellow community people by crossing all limits much like their counterparts of the high economic status in the developed cities.
- Contrarily, there may be an opposite case where there is sharp decline in the economy of a village or ago-economy based society due to a number of factors like famine, damage of the crops, flood, earthquake, internal conflicts and clashes in the society, epidemics and fatal diseases, war with bordering countries and closing

of some nearby industrial units, etc. The decline and loss of economic means may result in scarcity of resources for day-to-day living leading to their forced migration to cities and distant places and settling somewhere out in slums of the industrial cities. All such negative happenings may bring a lot of unfavorable changes in their social setup and living. They have to bear all types of negative consequences occurring in their life such as living below the poverty line, family insecurity and lack of social respect, lack of education and proper caring of their growing children, and danger of their own or their children slipping into unsocial and criminal behavior.

- Quite significant social changes are witnessed on a large scale in a whole region or country as a result of economic factors with a mentionable rise or fall of its economy. The rise of the economy in China, for example, has brought a great change in the attitude, beliefs, and ways of thinking and living of the people of China. From a country of opium consumers and idle persons it has been converted into a big industrial and progressive leading country of the world. On the other hand, a number of war-torn and terrorism-led countries such as Syria, Iraq, etc. with a great loss to their economy have gone quite below in terms of the maintenance of the structure and functioning of the social life in a proper way.

6. Political Factors

The structure and function of a society is most likely governed by the authority (usually the political head) available for this purpose. In tribal society it may be a head of that society and in the case of countries there are heads of state belonging to the ruling political party or some self-styled dictators who seek power for ruling the country. There is a quite direct connection between the political power and the type of governance made available for bringing positive or negative changes in the society resulting into its progress or decline. The history of civilization and progress records of countries available reveals how

much influence the political factors may cast on bringing change in the structure and function of the society. In our country, wherever there has been positivity and goodness in the governance on the part of the rulers in one or the other parts or region of the country, the period is termed as a golden age in relation to the living conditions prevailing in the society. The political will and determination, enactment of appropriate laws and their proper enforcement have been sufficiently responsible for introducing proper reforms and progressive plans for improving the living standard of the people and status of the societies. In the current period, also we may properly witness the role of political powers in bringing sufficiently positive and negative changes in the attitude and thinking of their citizens along with improving or causing deterioration in the social organizations and their functions. It is no secret that how the launching of the drives like Clean India and Toilet Construction in the Rural and Slum India have turned effective in introducing social change in the developing India.

7. Psychological Factors

No change in ideas, attitudes, beliefs and living of the people in a society can be introduced in a proper way unless they are psychologically prepared for introducing such change. People of a society should first believe in change. They should themselves come forward for initiating or joining a movement for the social change and side by side try to convince or resist the people who oppose the change on baseless ground. In fact, as emphasized by Gillian and Gillian (1948), the cause of a social change (bringing change in the social structure, relationships and conditions of social living, etc.) is inherent in the psychology of the man himself. Man by nature is the lover of change. He wants to get rid of the inertia and move ahead for the satisfaction of his needs in a better way. Such craving for a change in mankind gives birth to innovative ideas and inventions resulting in the change in the existing systems and functioning of the society. Take any initiative taken by the great social reformers or unforgettable invention attempts of the scientists helpful in bringing one or the other types of social change, you will see how psychologically

strong they were in initiating and getting their ideas implemented for a social change. Social reformers and social movement leaders picked up on the psychology of the people needing change in their social circumstances and accordingly worked towards drifting the people along with their initiatives. In a number of cases, the psychological feelings of alienation, depression, discontent and dissatisfaction with the current state of affairs and status move the people for initiating, leading or becoming a part of the initiatives and movements of the social change. The stronger is the psychological wish or desire for the change, the greater speed and intensity is picked up by these attempts of social change. Satisfaction of one-time needs through a social change gives rise to other needs for being satisfied through some other new social change, and the cycle goes on further in this way for turning us and our society different than the older times.

8. Educational Factors

Education as an instrument of social change can play a great role in the construction and reconstruction of the society and life of its citizens. In all its forms and shapes – formal or informal, organized or unorganized – education received on the part of people widens the areas of their knowledge and process of thinking; brings desirable change in their attitudes towards things and issues; and prepares them to initiate, welcome and diffuse or transmit this change in others – educated or uneducated. In its various shapes and dimensions, thus, education may be found to work as an instrument of social change. Briefly, we can summarize the role of education in this concern as follows.

- Education is helpful, on one hand, in acquainting us with the fund of knowledge available for understanding the structure and function of the society in its past and present (including the socio-cultural traditions, mores, ethics, moral principles and code of conduct, stereotypes, and modes of thinking and living of the community people) and on the other hand, it helps them to equip them with the needed insight and thought

process for analyzing such accumulated fund of knowledge in terms of its usefulness to the society in the present context.

- Education enlightens the people and sharpens as well as broadens their outlook for looking at the things and issues in their clear perspective and most of the time feeling the requirement of introducing necessary change by considering it the need of the hour. It has resulted in giving up the age-old social traditions, prejudices, evils and stereotypes prevalent in the society and replacing them with the new type of change in the thinking and living of the people.
- The acquisition of new knowledge and opening of the mind with the help of education may result in the people viewing social issues from a quite broad as well as sharpened angle. They may now for example not only seem to be quite convinced about the need of environmental protection, pollution control, environmental cleanliness, women equality and empowerment, secularism, etc. But also, ready to become a part and parcel of such campaigns for bringing required change in the attitude of the masses for this purpose.
- Education helps in developing one's effectiveness in the use of communication skills. One can learn so many local and foreign languages for having needed communications to the people of different cultures, regions and countries. Such interactions and communications with the people of different communities and countries may help him to get acquainted with their mode of living and thinking including the progress made by these communities and countries through the ongoing changes in their society. Such intermixing and diffusion of ideas may help the people in feeling the need as well as utilizing means for bringing required change in the fabric of their society.
- Besides the mode of diffusion, the other equally effective or rather to say most effective way for bringing social change is the utilization of the services of science and technology. In this concern, it is no secret that this task can only be performed by having proper education for

the members of a community or country. It is the education that can help the people develop as well as make them serviceable for bringing needed changes in the setup and functioning of their society and help their nation to remain on the road map of development along with the other progressive nations of the world.

In a nut shell, it can be properly said that it is the education and its related factors that can provide a lead to diagnosis the evils, problems and maladies of a society, think about the possible means for their rectification and take the society properly on the development track by bringing needed change in its structure and functioning.

9. Technological Factors

As said earlier, science and technology may be reckoned as the most important factor or means for bringing social change. It is no secret that a long journey of social change travelled by us in this concern right from the hunting and stone-age, to the rural agriculture and cottage industry-based society and the modern industrialization and ICT based society has been totally possible through the courtesy of the development in the field of science and technology. In the present era also, the technological factors are playing a quite significant role in bringing change in the structure and functioning of the societies world over. The following instances may provide needed evidence for certifying this fact.

- Technological advances have resulted in heavy industrialization, and urbanization at the cost of hand-made cottage industries and village based rural economy. It has resulted in bringing change in the structure and function of the societies. The village people have moved to urban areas for seeking employment. There has been a large-scale migration of the skilled and non-skilled man power from nearby as well as quite far off areas. It has resulted in bringing a lot of changes in the living and thinking of the migrants, but it has also affected the social life of the former residents of these towns in a variety of forms.

- Science and technology have helped us in furthering the spread and progress in education, means of transport, information and communication, control of diseases, and production as well as utilization of the things and means that could not even be dreamed earlier. It has resulted in bringing tremendous change in the structure and functions of the social institutions and ways of living and thinking of the people in a variety of ways such as: (i) getting rid of the age-old stereotypes, prejudices and superstitions; (ii) abolishing of the social evils like Sati Pratha and child marriage; (iii) weakening of the casteism; and (iv) expectation for long living and comfortable life, etc.
- Science and technology advancement has helped in improving the agriculture production and rural economy. The Green revolution in the agriculture sectors and white revolution in dairy production in India has been possible on account of this advancement. It has resulted in bringing a lot of change in the living standard and ways of thinking of the affected communities.
- Technological advancement and knowledge have given birth to a variety of new vocations and trades such as tourism, hotel management, wedding planners, matrimonial alliance makers, and a host of employment and self-employment opportunities in the IT sector. It has made possible the vertical mobility of the society. The young generation from the poor and low status of society now can aspire and attain the highest positions in these sectors though their own merit not only in India but also have a fair chance of getting handsome employment abroad.
- Technological advancements in the modern age are growing at unimagined speed. We have witnessed for a quite long time how much alterations in the social life all-round the globe have been taking place in the social fabric with each and every technological advancement such as the invention of radio and television, satellite communication, high speed transport means, technological audio video devices, computer and mobile phone technology, use of artificial intelligence and robot technology and a lot of advancement in the food, health and medicine sectors, etc.
- The changes brought about through technological factors in our societies have reached all the different sectors of our social life in the manner such as: (i) converting the age-old joint family system to the nuclear family system; (ii) reduction in the size of families due to the invention of proper birth control methods; (iii) giving birth to women liberalism and empowerment; (iv) change in the traditional system of marriage into romantic marriage, inter-caste marriage, late marriages and even same sex marriages; (v) increase in the cases of divorce, desertion, separation and broken families; (vi) helping the individuals in getting rid of superstitions, and rigidity of the aggressive religious beliefs and activities; (vii) giving birth to capitalism with all its accompanying evils; (viii) growth of individualism in human relationships resulting in the people, especially the urbanites, feeling quite lonely in the midst of plenty; and (ix) producing human machines possessing motion but not sincerity, life but not emotion, heart but not feelings.

In this way, we can well realize how technological advancements are contributing in bringing considerable change in our social life. Technological factors have brought a significant change in our way of thinking and mode of living including the restructuring of the social institutions in its own way.

To Sum Up

Social change is the change brought out from time to time in the system of a society in terms of its structural organization (e.g., social institutions, socio-cultural norms, mores and traditions, etc.) and as well as its functioning (e.g., social processes, social behavior and relationships, mode of living and thinking, etc.).

The social changes, brought out in the social system and its functioning, are characterized with some of the essential features such as:

- Social changes are essentially social, universal, inevitable, continuous, unpredictable and non-uniform in their speed.
- They are generally concerned with the modification or replacement in the structure and functioning of the social systems and show chain-reaction sequence in their occurring.
- They are caused on account of a number of factors and occur in their various forms and modes.

The change in the structure and functioning of our social system brought out at different times and places may be found to take place in their various forms and kinds such as: (i) linear vs. fluctuating social change, (ii) small vs. large scale change, (iii) gradual vs. rapid social change, (iv) planned vs. unplanned social change, and (v) endogenous (having internal causes for its occurrence) vs. exogenous (having external causes for its occurrence) social change.

Social change in the organization and function of the society is carried out by a number of factors or rather to say interaction of a variety of factors grouped as:

- Biological factors such as genetic makeup and qualitative aspect of population and biological process of natural selection and struggle for survival.
- Demographic factors of a society in the shape of the size, numbers, composition, density and the local distribution of its population.
- Physical and geographical factors (the physical things and happenings in the environment as well as certain geographical conditions).
- Cultural factors, economic factors and political factors.

- Psychological factors (people's willingness and initiative for social change).
- Educational factors (education working as an instrument of social change).
- Technological factors (use of science and technology working as solid means for social change).

Theories of Social Change

Researchers and sociologists have tried to throw light on the phenomenon of social change through their valuable attempts in this direction. For explaining the cause and nature of these changes they have brought a number of valuable theories known as theories of social change. In this chapter here we will be focusing our discussion on a few important theories named as (i) evolutionary theory of social change, (ii) cyclical theory of social change and (iii) conflict theory of social change.

Evolutionary or Linear Theory of Social Change

Evolutionary theory of social change is based on the notion of evolution brought into the limelight first by Charles Darwin, the British biologist who propounded the theory of biological evolution. Sociologists like Herbert Spencer, Auguste Comte, L.H. Morgan, Emile Durkheim and Karl Marx, etc. have tried to propagate that society and culture also undergo the same types of linear change and demonstrate the same upward trend through time as advocated by Darwin for the biological evolution of the species on earth. On account of maintaining a linear trend i.e., moving in one direction of social change the evolutionary theory of social change is also known by the term linear theory of social change.

Charles Darwin (1859), in his theory of biological evolution by using a number of concepts like struggle for existence, survival of the fittest and principle of natural selection, tried to show that on our earth, species of organisms have evolved from simpler organisms like amoeba to the most complicated

organisms like monkeys and human beings. In such evolution from a most simple and primary organism to the most complicated and developed human beings, the direction of growth is constantly linear and it is always upward. Once an organism reaches to a higher stage of evolution, he is bound to go higher in the rank of his evolution. There is no possibility of regression i.e., going back to the lower evolutionary stage.

By taking clue from the Darwin's theory of biological evolution, the sociologists like Herbert Spencer (1914), Auguste Comte (1896), L.H. Morgan (1877), Emile Durkheim (1947), Marx and Engels (1930) and Talcott Parsons (1964), later on, tried to propagate that society and culture also undergo the same types of linear change and demonstrate the same upward trend through time as advocated by Darwin for the biological evolution of the species on earth. On account of maintaining a linear trend i.e., moving in one direction of the social change, the evolutionary theory of social change is also known by the term linear theory of social change.

All the earlier mentioned eminent sociologists, while using Darwin's thought for propagating an evolutionary theory of social change in their own ways, have leaned over a particular type of linearity maintained in their evolutionary explanation of social change. As a result, at present we may witness the availability of the theory of evolution in its three varieties or forms, named as (i) theory of unilinear evolution, (ii) theory of universal evolution and (iii) theory of multi-linear evolution. Let us examine them.

1. **Theory of Unilinear Evolution:** In this form and shape, the theory of evolution postulates that a social change always proceeds on the developmental path toward a predestined goal in a unilinear fashion. Once a society attains a certain level of progress and development as a result gradual evolutionary social change, there is no question of returning back to the previous developmental stage. The change in the structure and function of the society in this type of evolution thus, always takes place in a linear fashion and in the direction of progress and

improvement immaterial to the speed of change, slow or fast. In brief, in its mode of linear evolutionary change, change occurs in the society continually in an upward direction, continually putting it on the developmental path, leaving no chance of retracing back to the previous less developmental level.

Eminent sociologists like Auguste Comte, L.H. Morgan, Marx and Engels, Herbert Spencer, Emil Durkheim and Talcott Parsons may be named as the main propagators of the theory of unilinear evolution. While all of them commonly agreed that each society does, indeed must, pass through a fixed and limited number of stages in a given sequence of linear development, they differed in providing the list of these stages in the manner given next.

- According to Auguste Comte (1896), in their course of social change, all societies may be observed to pass through three sequential stages, namely (i) theological or fictitious stage (a stage guided by supernatural wisdom), (ii) metaphysical stage (a transitional stage replacing supernatural beliefs with abstract principles as guidelines) and (iii) positive or scientific stage (guided by evidence based on scientific laws).
- According to L.H. Morgan (1877), there are three stages in social evolution, namely (i) savagery stage, (ii) barbaric stage and (iii) civilized stage.
- According to Marx and Engels (1930), the social evolution associated with social changes in a society passes through four sequential stages, namely (i) primitive communism (having no concept of private property), (ii) slave society (emergence of private ownership in place of collective ownership), (iii) feudal society (increase in the concept of private ownership) and (iv) capitalist society (emergence of two classes, capitalist and proletariat, and struggle between them).
- According to Herbert Spencer (1914), social evolution associated with social changes in a society passes through three sequential stages,

namely (i) primitive stage, (ii) savage stage and (iii) industrial stage bringing more and more complexity to the social structure.

- According to Emile Durkheim (1947), there are two stages in the social evolution named as (i) mechanical solidarity (the characteristic of the ancient simple society reflecting through similarity in the status, role, value, beliefs and morality and togetherness spirit of its people) and (ii) organic solidarity (the characteristic of the modern complex society reflected through the rise of individualism, division of labor and differences among the people).
- According to Talcott Parsons (1964), there are four stages in the social evolution named as (i) lower primitive society, (ii) advanced primitive society, (iii) intermediate society and (iv) industrial society.

In this way, according to these different thinkers and sociologists, the process of social evolution may be seen to pass through a series of one or the other type of fixed sequential stages with each stage giving way to the next resulting in the unilinear development of the society and its people.

2. **Theory of Universal Evolution:** In explaining the change in the society, the believers and propagators of this kind and form of evolution, while agreeing with the presence of some or the other definite stages in the social evolution, differ from supporters of the unilinear perspective in their emphasizing that every society does not necessarily go through the same fixed stages of development. In its place, in the process of social evolution in their view, the culture of mankind, taken as a whole, has been found to follow a definite line of evolution. In bringing social changes, social evolution, thus, is seen to reflect universality in its occurrence as the human society as a whole passes through development in successive stages in a linear fashion. As one of the important propagators of this form of unilinear social revolution, we can name the great sociologist and thinker Herbert Spencer who tried to emphasize that human beings had

progressed from small groups to large and from simple to compound and in more general terms, from simple homogenous forms of primitive groups to complex heterogeneous social organization of modern society. Besides Herbert Spencer, the renowned anthropologist Leslie A. White and sociologist William Fielding Ogburn have also been the leading exponents of this form of social evolution. In this connection, Leslie White (1959) in his text *Evolution of Culture* has emphasized that culture of humankind as a whole develops through technological advancement in the four sequenced stages named as (i) invention, (ii) accumulation, (iii) diffusion and (iv) adjustment. William Ogburn (1922), on the other hand, in this connection, has mentioned five stages of human society development: (i) using the energy of own muscles on the part of individuals, (ii) using the energy of domestic animals, (iii) using the energy of plants (agricultural revolution), (iv) using natural resources – coal, oil and gas – and (v) harnessing nuclear energy.

3. **Theory of Multi-linear Evolution:** This brand of evolutionism has emerged as a kind of realistic alternative to the unilinear and universal brand of social evolution. It essentially recognizes that although social change implies a linear development in positive direction and the accompanied developmental stages are also definite and stratified, on the other hand it also equally identifies the different sequential patterns for the development of different culture or types of cultures in the world society. The believers and propagators of this form of liner evolution clearly emphasize that human society as a whole has undergone changes in various directions and social change is multilinear. In other words, the multi-linear form of social evolution holds that change can occur in several ways and that it does not inevitably lead in the same direction. It is why we may see that human civilizations and cultures on the global scene have evolved along a number of lines. Such a multi-linear approach, while sidelining both the earlier approaches, unilinear (straight-line evolution of each society) and

universal (progress of mankind as a whole), tries to concentrate on much more limited sequences of development for the explanation of social evolution. Thinkers and sociologists Julian Steward (1955) and Leslie White (1959) are named as the main propagators and believers in this multi-linear form of social evolution (known sometimes as neo-evolutionism). While on one hand recognizing that some social trends as merely universal (e.g., the progression from smaller to larger, simpler to more complex, rural to urban, and low technology to higher technology), it strongly emphasizes that these can come about in multiple ways and with distinct consequences.

- Theory of unilinear evolution (advocating that a social change always proceeds on the developmental path toward a predestined goal in a unilinear fashion).
- Theory of universal evolution (advocating that in bringing social changes, social evolution is seen to reflect universality in its occurrence as the human society as a whole passes through development in successive stages in a linear fashion),
- Theory of multi-linear evolution (advocating that change can occur in several ways and that it does not inevitably lead in the same direction).

The linear theory of social evolution, whether operating in one or the other forms, is subjected to a lot of criticism by modern sociologists. It is not essential for the process of social change to remain continued on the progressive side. At many times, there are reoccurrences, retrogression and many ups and downs of forward and backward movements in social change. Such variances observed in the social change have given birth to the other alternative explanations for the social change in the form of cyclical and conflict theories discussed ahead.

To Sum Up

Evolutionary theory of social change is based on the notion of evolution brought into the limelight first by Charles Darwin. It tries to propagate that society and culture also undergo the same types of linear change and demonstrate the same upward trend through time as advocated by Darwin for the biological evolution of the species on earth. On account of maintaining a linear trend i.e., moving in one direction of the social change, the evolutionary theory of social change is also known by the term linear theory of social change. At present we may witness the availability of the theory of evolution in its three varieties or forms:

Cyclical Theory of Social Change

Cyclical theory of social change stands in a direct contradiction to the previously discussed linear theory of social change as revealed through the following beliefs, assumptions and characteristics possessed on the part of this theory.

- It is not essential for the social changes to proceed always in a linear fashion i.e., following a straight-line course of continued progress and development.
- Societies and civilizations undergo changes in both upward and downward (rise and fall) movements and there is no particular direction in which it changes.
- Instead of following a linear course, the changes in the societies and civilizations occur in a cyclical mode.
- In its cyclical mode, social change is found to occur in a cycle of rise, decline, fall, recover and rising again to the original position just as we as individuals are born, mature, grow old, die and are born again as our rebirth.
- All that is progressive must also regress is the central theme of the cyclical theory. Rise and fall of empires, civilizations, groups and organizations are an evitable process in social change.

As the main propagators of the cyclical theory of social change we may name the sociologists and

thinkers such as Oswald Spengler, Arnold J. Toynbee, P.A. Sorokin and Vilfredo Pareto. Let us try to get acquainted with their contributions as well as views expressed in this concern.

1. The German thinker **Oswald Spengler** for arriving at his cyclical theory of social change studied the eight prominent cultures and civilization of the world – Egyptian, Mesopotamian, Hindu, Chinese, Classical or Apollonian, Arabian, Mayan and Western. Putting his conclusions in his text *Decline of the West* (1926) he then tried to explain the phenomenon of social change in the manner as follows.
 - The society and civilizations go under rise and fall in the same manner as people, and their families face uprise and downfall in the life.
 - Every society has a predetermined life cycle as human beings pass through their life cycle in the predetermined four stages of birth, growth, maturity and decline. Similarly, when a society or civilization reaches the advance stage in cultural development, downward march starts and its decay is inevitable. Society, after passing through all these stages of life cycle, returns to the original stage and thus the cycle of life begins again.
 - On the basis of his analysis of the civilizations, he demonstrated that “the civilizations once remained at a top are now in decline and even some of them vanished on the scene while others who were lagging behind, are now picking up the race for top position”.
2. The world-renowned British historian Arnold J. Toynbee, while upholding the views of Spengler, tried to study 21 prominent world civilizations for forming his opinion about the nature of change and progress occurring in the society and civilizations. The findings of his study have been discussed in his book *A Study of History* (10 vols.) written during the period 1934–1963 (Toynbee, 1934–63). His contributions and views regarding changes in society and civilizations may be outlined as follows.
 - Like Spengler, Toynbee emphasized that societies and civilizations pass through the stages of rise, decline, fall and re-rise like the cycle of birth, growth, death and rebirth. There are rises and falls in the history of societies and civilizations. Every society or civilization has its rise, development and fall such as the civilizations of Egypt and Mesopotamia.
 - However, unlike Spengler, Toynbee did not feel the need of pointing out or determining the length of the life cycle of a society or civilization on account of the phenomenon of ongoing social change. Instead of it, he proposed to make use of the principle of “challenge and response”, implying that those who can cope with a changing environment survive and those who cannot die.
 - While applying the principle “challenge and response”, Toynbee emphasized that the life cycle of a society, its growth and survival depends to a greater extent upon the way it can constructively respond to the challenges. It can protect itself with the decay or fall for the duration to which it is capable of fighting with the forces coming in the way of its survival and development. There are challenges before the society for sustaining its present position and facing hurdles in its development, the type of responses – positive or negative – from the people of the society becomes the deciding factor for determining the future rise and fall of the society.
3. The well-known American sociologist **P.A. Sorokin** while supporting the viewpoint of Spengler has provided a variant of the cyclical process through the propagation of his own theory in his publication *Social and Cultural Dynamics* (Sorokin, 1937–41) in the name of “Pendular theory of social change”. He has named his cyclical theory of social change as pendular theory of social change because of his proposition that the change in the society and culture oscillates like the pendulum of a clock between two points. You may have seen that the pendulum of a clock swings with the passage

of time, but ultimately it comes to its original position and re-proceeds to its previous journey. Initially in the course of its movement starting from left it travels a linear path, and after reaching its end on the righthand side, it retraces its journey to the starting point. In practice, thus, it usually traces back on the same linear path. However, while applying it to social change, Sorokin has argued that it may also occur in a somewhat curvilinear fashion instead of the linear one. If it happens, then there lies hardly much difference between the pendulum like movement of social change and cyclical social change. It is why the so claimed pendular theory of Sorokin is very much included in the broad category of cyclical theory of social change. Let us summarize what has been conveyed by the pendular theory of social change.

- Sorokin in his theory has emphasized that the process of social change, while following the pendulum like movement of a clock, oscillates between two basic kinds of cultures: the 'sensate' and the 'ideational' through the 'idealistic'. The journey of its oscillatory movement (progress on the developmental path), thus, begins from the state of a sensate culture and passes across the state of idealistic culture for reaching its destination – the state of ideational culture.
- By the term sensate culture of a society, Sorokin meant the culture appealing to the senses and sensual desires of its people. In such culture, expressions of art, literature, religion and ethics are found to appeal to the senses and not to the mind or the spirit of the people in any way. It believes in the material values and follows the philosophy of eat, drink and enjoy. It is considered hedonistic in its ethics, and stresses science and empiricism. The modern western culture is passing through the state of such sensate culture.
- The ideational culture stands pole apart to the sensate culture. It is more abstract and symbolic than the sensate culture. In its nature and impact, it is associated with the

concepts like mind, spirit and soul. Here the moral values and spiritual attitude dominate the scene in place of utilitarian values and hedonism. The absolute truth, thus, in essence here overrules the material truth of the sensate culture.

- The idealistic culture represents a mixed form of sensate and ideational cultures. In the pendulum like journey of the social and cultural change, it falls midway between the sensate and ideational cultures. In this cultural state, people of the society are found to exhibit a somewhat stable mixture of faith, reason and senses as the source of truth. Our Indian culture is passing through this intermediate stage of development in terms of social change.
5. In the sequence of the cyclical theories of social change, Italian sociologist **Vilfredo Pareto (1966)** is well known to bring out a unique theory of social change in the name of 'circulation of elites'. According to this theory, major social change in society occurs through a process named by Pareto as 'circulation of elites' – replacing one elite by another in a circular mode. Pareto has used the term elite in its two separate senses – broader and narrow. In its broader sense, according to Pareto, the term elite is used for the people of highest performance in their respective fields such as efficient and popular writers, artists, lawyers, doctors, scientists, merchants and industrialists, and even the top-ranking thieves, and criminals, etc. In its narrow sense, the term is limited for its use to the governing or ruling elites. Both types of elites (available in their broader and narrow interpretation of the term elite) are found to contribute in the rise and fall of the society in their own ways. However, with the course of time, one set of the elites (contributing at a particular time period) 'decay in quality' and lose their 'vigor'. They are replaced with another set of elites. Based on their own qualities and characteristics each set of the elites in its circulation with the passage of time is found to cause rise and fall

in the structure and functioning of the society. History of civilization across the globe tells us how under the regimes of one or the other rulers (competent and incompetent), there have been ups and downs in a circular motion in the societies. In this way as Pareto claims that in a never-ending circulation of elite societies pass through the periods of political and social vigor and decline which repeat themselves in a cyclical fashion.

To Sum Up

Cyclical theory of social change emphasizes that instead of following a linear course, the changes in the societies and civilizations occur in a cyclical mode. In this concern, the main propagators of the cyclic theory, such as Oswald Spengler, Arnold J. Toynbee, P.A. Sorokin and Vilfredo Pareto, tried to provide their own version of this theory.

In the opinion of the German thinker Oswald Spengler, every society has a pre-determined life cycle as human beings pass through their life cycle in the predetermined manner of birth, growth, maturity, decline and rebirth.

The British historian Arnold J. Toynbee tried to uphold the views of Spengler by emphasizing that societies and civilizations pass through the stages of rise, decline, fall and re-rise like the cycle of birth, growth, death and rebirth, yet like Spengler, he did not feel the need of pointing out or determining the length of the life cycle of a society or civilization on account of the phenomenon of ongoing social change. Instead of it he proposed to make use of the principle of "challenge and response" implying that those who can cope with a changing environment survive, and those who cannot die.

The American sociologist P.A. Sorokin provided a variant of cyclical process through the propagation of his own theory in the name

of "Pendular theory of social change". It emphasized that the change in the society and culture oscillates like the pendulum of a clock between two points and for its such oscillation it is found to pick up the curvilinear path rather than the straight one.

The Italian sociologist Vilfredo Pareto through his version of cyclic theory propagated that the major social change in society occurs through a process named as 'circulation of elites' – replacing one elite (highest performers in their respective fields or ruler of their time) in a circular mode. Based on their own qualities and characteristics each set of the elites in its circulation with the passage of time is found to cause rise and fall in the structure and functioning of the society.

Conflict Theory of Social Change

The propagators and believers in the conflict theory of social change emphasize that conflict is a necessary condition for change. At a given time when the institutions and practices of a society seem to be functioning well under the influence of powerful individuals and groups, actually there a strong desire for bringing necessary change in such status quo is also side by side creeping among individuals and groups feeling discontentment and dissatisfaction with the ongoing system. This dissatisfied and discontented group comes into struggle with the powerful group for introducing necessary change in the social setup and its functioning. The people belonging to the disgruntled group on the individual or group level raise their voice and struggle for change to remove evils and correct social injustices and inequalities prevailing in the society. The conflicts and struggles are, thus, quite essential in a society as without their occurrence the status quo prevailing in the society can't change by its own. It is the major and the only cause for social change in the opinion of conflict theorists and sociologists like Karl Marx, Ludwig Gumplowicz, Ralf Dahrendorf and Lewis A. Coser. Let us examine their views in the propagation and support of the conflict theory of social change.

The Viewpoint of Karl Marx

According to Karl Marx the history of all hitherto existing society is the history of class struggle. It is the phenomenon of conflict and class struggle only that can be a single cause for transforming a society. Marx provided an economic explanation for the creation of conflict and struggle in the society. Thus, the conflict and struggle in a society, according to Karl Marx, is the absolute outcome of the economic disparity and difference existing between two sections of the society – known as rich and poor. In a technology based industrialized society, the rich become richest and poor turn poorest. The poor section of the society considers that their poverty is the result of the rich section of the society who has accumulated wealth and prosperity at their cost. There, thus, two separate classes in the name of poor or rich, exploited and exploiters being created in the society give birth to the phenomenon of class struggle and it is this struggle which sets the direction of change in that society. Actually, the economic explanation for the change and progress in the society given by Karl Marx is as the offshoot of his economic theory of social change which states that economic change only occurs and produces other change through the mechanism of intensified conflict between social groups and classes of the social system. According to Marx there are only two classes in society – the bourgeoisie (those who own production) and the proletariat (those who do not own production and those who labor for the bourgeoisie). The bourgeoisie (the rulers and exploiters) believes in the status quo, and stand in opposition to any change, while the proletariat who feels exploited wants to bring change in the social system. Such differences between them become a constant source of conflict and class struggle and it is these conflicts and class struggles that work as firehouse for changing society and its systems in one or the other ways.

The Viewpoint of Ludwig Gumplowicz

The views held by sociologist Ludwig Gumplowicz in providing an explanation for the change in the society may be found to be influenced by the two main existing ideas of his times: (i) the proposition

“survival of the fittest” proposed by Charles Darwin and supported by Herbert Spencer and (ii) the proposition “Group conflicts existing in the human society since its origin” held and used for explaining social change by Karl Marx.

On the lines of Karl Marx, Gumplowicz tried to emphasize that conflict and struggle in the groups of the society (groups based on racial identities and class differences) have been the only cause for bringing change in the society throughout the history of human civilization. The group conflict theory proposed by Gumplowicz for explaining the phenomenon of social change according to Sorokin (1978) is found to convey the following four important sequential events in the evolution of human societies.

1. The human race in its most primitive period had its existence in the form of the wandering small groups having no system of their settlement and living at a fixed place.
2. These small groups used to have fierce fighting and battling with each other on account of the quite bitter feelings, prejudices and enmity lying between them for one or the other reasons.
3. The fighting and battling between them were resulting in establishing one's victory and dominance over others. The losing group was then made to surrender and lose its identity for serving under the victorious group. The victorious groups, thus, in the course of time, became bigger and bigger giving birth to the identity of the smaller and bigger states.
4. The dominant and victorious section of the merged larger group enjoyed the status and role of rulers over the weaker and defeated section of this large group. It gave birth to two opposing sections of the society in the name of ruler and ruled or exploiter and exploited. These two groups of the society have been in the constant state of conflict and struggle on account of clashes of their interests and it has led to introduce change in the structure and functioning of the society from time-to-time world over. The emergence of the rule of law and provision of the constitutional framework for ruling over a state may be cited as some of the consequences of such struggle.

The Viewpoint of Ralf Dahrendorf

The German sociologist Ralf Dahrendorf, while believing in the Marx contention that conflict and class struggle is the only cause for social change, differed and disagreed with Marx not only on the notions of class but on many other points also. For example, whereas Marx viewed social change as a resolution of conflict over scarce economic resources, Dahrendorf considered social change as a resolution of conflict over power. The main ideas and beliefs emphasized by him in this connection may be briefed as follows.

- There is hierarchy of power lying in the structure and functioning of a society. In every society, there are powerful and more powerful people lying at the top of the political hierarchy. These powerful strong people dominate and rule over the powerless and weak people. For serving its self-interest the powerful ruling group frames a number of legal laws for creating conformity and consensus in the society over the functioning of the people in the society. Its intention is to maintain status quo in the society in their favor by opposing any change in the existing structure and functioning of the society.
- According to Dahrendorf, the *power and authority* is the main attribute of a social system. Without an authority in power, a society cannot function. It is the functional pre-requisite of a society but the distribution of political power cannot be even and equal among the people or groups of the society. The power inequalities among them are bound to exist. Each and every individual or group in the society wants to capture more and more power while leaving others in the society to be ruled and exploited by them for serving their own interest. It creates conflict between those in power and the powerless, and exploiters and the exploited. The cause for social change thus, according to Dahrendorf, is not economical as viewed by Karl Marx, it is political in nature. The exploitation of the powerless based on the *principle of coercion* at the hands of the powerful thus sets the direction and intensity of conflicts among the society for

bringing needed change in the society desired by the disgruntled individuals and groups.

- Since the attaining of power is considered a potent means of satisfying the self-interests, it is enough to get the people and groups to engage in conflict and struggle with each other for snatching the power. It is also naked truth that status and power in the society can't be distributed equally or at least in the satisfactory amount among the people and groups in the society. This unequal distribution and race for gaining power for the self thus become a constant source for the conflicts and struggles among the people and groups of the society. In this way, the conflict and struggle in the society is a quite natural phenomenon. A society and ruler, no matter how powerful it may be, can't abolish the voice of dissent, conflicts and struggles in the society for a long time. Commenting over this aspect, Dahrendorf (1959) writes:

The underlying assumption is that conflict can be temporarily suppressed, regulated, channeled and controlled, but that neither a philosopher king nor a modern dictator can abolish it once and for all.

In brief, thus, the well acknowledged fact in the history of human civilization is that conflicts and struggles linked with the capturing of the power are bound to happen in all societies at all times of their history. The inequality in distribution of power is responsible for the creation of exploiters and exploited classes in a society and it is the punch of such inequality that leads to class struggle for bringing changes in the status quo of the society.

The Viewpoint of Lewis A. Coser

The famous American sociologist Lewis A. Coser has also expressed his views in favor of class conflicts and struggles for bringing social change. However, by breaking the tradition of designating conflict and struggle as a mark of unpleasant happening or negative outcomes at the hand of his predecessors and

contemporaries, he has taken a balanced stand by commenting as follows in this connection.

- A social conflict or struggle may lead to two types of consequences known as (i) positive or constructive and (ii) negative or destructive. Positive and constructive outcomes from the conflict and struggle between two sections or groups of the society may be witnessed in the case where they show differences in their ideologies for achieving a common purpose i.e., similar type of social change or progress. The conflict and clashes between the soft-liner leaders like Mahatma Gandhi and hard-core leaders like Subhash Chandra Bose led to positive outcomes (gaining independence from British rule on the part of India) on account of similarity of the goal or purpose for struggling. On the other hand, negative and destructive outcomes are visible when they have no common purpose for their struggling. Rather they may be seen to fight for serving their self-interests and working for harming and eliminating each other for their dominance and supremacy over the rivals.
- Far from being necessarily dysfunctional (bad or negative in its functioning), a certain degree of conflict is an essential element in group formation and the persistence of a group (Coser, 1956).
- No society is found to evolve smoothly to a higher level at its own. It is the conflict and struggle between groups that brings desirable change in the structure and functioning of the society. In this way, the social conflicts play a quite important role on both the fronts associated with social change i.e., bringing necessary change in the organizational character of the social institutions and exercising desirable social control for their proper regulation.
- According to Coser, the conflict in the society takes place on account of the clash and conflict in the mutual interests. These self-interests may take any form or belong to either of the political, economic or social field. However, when people and groups of society feel that their interests are not kept in view by the ruler or powerful

groups, they begin to raise their voice against the oppression and victimization and get united in their struggle for the social change. It may be quite positive and constructive and progressive in nature leading the society for its reconstruction to development and progress.

- Many times, the individuals or certain groups may be found to come into conflict with the society or ruling group in order to bring the needed social, political and economic changes in the society. The efforts made by the social reformers, scientists and discoverers, political leaders and parties all fall in the positive and constructive outcomes of the social change.
- In this way, in brief, Coser in his theory of social change, while considering the conflicts and struggles in the society between the individuals and groups as a natural phenomenon, has tried to provide more weightage to their positive and constructive role in place of their negative and destructive role as often highlighted by his predecessors and contemporaries.

The theory of social change in all its forms and shapes as propagated and supported by different sociologists has come into severe criticism on one or the other grounds. Most of the critics do not agree with the over assertion of the conflict theory propagators that conflicts and struggling is the necessary and sufficient condition for social change. The struggle might have helped in bringing social changes in some cases, but it does not mean that development and progress in the society always need conflicts and struggling for this purpose. On the other hand, it has been satisfactorily found that more often the different sections and racial groups of the society also demonstrate a quite big cooperation for achieving needed change in the structure and functioning of the society.

Commenting on the nature and usefulness of the conflict theory for explaining the phenomenon of social change in a society, Percy S. Cohen (1979) writes:

This theory is plausible, but it is not necessarily true. The contention that group conflict is a sufficient condition for social change is obviously

false. It is arguable that structured conflict, when it involves a fairly equal balance of forces, actually obstructs change which might otherwise occur. For example, in societies where there are deep divisions between regional, ethnic or racial groups, there may be little possibility of promoting economic development or welfare policies; such 'ameliorative' changes require some degree of consensus. The simple point is that conflict may lead to impasse not to change. It should be emphasized that social conflict is often as much the product of social change as the cause. And it is commonly a great obstacle to certain types of change.

To Sum Up

Conflict theory of social change emphasizes that conflict is a necessary condition for change. It is the major and the only cause for social change in the opinion of conflict theorists and sociologists like Karl Marx, Ludwig Gumplowicz, Ralf Dahrendorf and Lewis A. Coser.

In this concern, Karl Marx emphasized that it is the phenomenon of conflict and class struggle (resulted through economic disparity and difference existing between two sections of the society – known as rich and poor) that may be termed a single cause for bringing changes in the society.

On the lines of Karl Marx, Gumplowicz also tried to emphasize that conflict and struggle in the groups of the society have been the only cause for bringing change in the society throughout the history of human civilization.

The German sociologist Ralf Dahrendorf considered social change as a resolution of conflict over power rather than the economic disparity as emphasized by Karl Marx. According to him the inequality in distribution of power is responsible for the creation of exploiters and exploited classes in a society and it is the punch of such inequality that leads

to class struggle for bring changes in the status quo of the society.

The American sociologist Lewis A. Coser has also expressed his views in favor of class conflicts and struggles for bringing social change. However, he has taken a balanced stand in this concern by saying that a social conflict or struggle may lead to two types of consequences known as positive or constructive and negative or destructive. However, in this concern, he tried to provide more weightage to their positive and constructive role (e.g., gaining independence for India while differing in their approach on the part of revolutionaries and followers of the Gandhian way) in place of their negative and destructive role (fighting to serve their own interest rather than achieving common target).

Review Questions

1. What are social changes? Throw light on their nature and characteristics.
2. What are the different forms and kinds of the social changes? Discuss.
3. While defining the term social change, name and describe the factors governing the social change.
4. Name the various theories explaining the phenomenon of social change and describe any one of them in detail.
5. What is the evolutionary or linear theory of social change? Discuss and describe it in its essential detail.
6. Discuss in detail the cyclical theory of social change in all its variations as provided by the prominent socio-psychologists and thinkers like Oswald Spengler, Arnold J. Toynbee, P.A. Sorokin and Vilfredo Pareto.
7. What is the conflict theory of social change? Discuss it in its variations as provided by the eminent thinkers like Karl Marx, Ludwig Gumplowicz, Ralf Dahrendorf and Lewis A. Coser.

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16.

SOCIAL INTEGRATION – CONCEPT AND MECHANISM

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- State the meaning and concept of social integration.
- Discuss the various measures to achieve or promote social integration.
- Discuss the legislative means and administrative measures employed for achieving social integration.
- Tell about the attainment of social integration through change of attitudes, beliefs and values.

Introduction

Every society for its own survival, adjustment, well-being and progress needs a lot of cohesion, solidarity, peaceful coexistence and unity among its people and diverse sections, or social groups. “Integrated we stand and disintegrated we fall” applies well in the case of seeking welfare and development of a society – primitive or modern, democratic or autocratic, liberal or conservative, and industrial or non-industrial – existing and functioning within its framework at one or the other times. In other words, social development needs the creation of a society for all individuals and sections of the society based on the principle of equity, equality and justice with no discrimination of any kind in providing equal opportunity to all for living, progressing and participating in the social processes. It is possible only when a due emphasis as well as proper initiative is

taken by the societies for ensuring the cross-culture, and cross-sectarian coherence among its members. In other words, the societies or nations of the world need to show the spirit of integration in their societal organization and functioning for their smooth functioning and proper development. What is this social integration and how can it be ensured or promoted in a society? Let us think over it in this chapter.

Social Integration: Meaning and Concept

In its simple common meaning, by the term social integration of the individuals and groups we mean their integration, assimilation, combination or inclusion within the existing framework (structure and functioning) of a society. The dictionary meaning of the term as provided in APA (American Psychological Association) Dictionary of Psychology

also seems to be matching with this common understanding. Here it has been defined in its two following forms:

1. Social integration is the process by which an individual is assimilated into a group.
2. Social integration is the process by which separate groups are combined into a unified society, especially when this is pursued as a deliberate policy. It implies a coming together based on individual acceptance of the members of other groups.

Besides this, the term social integration has also been defined variously by the different sociologist and global social agencies in the manner as given next.

Copenhagen Declaration and Programme of Action (2008): Integration may be defined as the process of fostering societies that are stable, safe and just and that are based on the promotion and protection of all human rights, as well as on nondiscrimination, tolerance, respect for diversity, equality of opportunity, solidarity, security and participation of all people, including disadvantaged and vulnerable groups and persons.

Ferguson (2008): Social integration may be defined as the process of promoting the values, relations and institutions that enable all people to participate in social, economic and political life on the basis of equality of rights, equity and dignity. This definition excludes social integration based on force or that attempts to impose unitary identities on reluctant populations.

M. Sharon Jeannotte (2008): Social integration is one of the constellations of 'social' terms that is being used widely in contemporary policy development to describe concepts whose aim (as stated by the Copenhagen Declaration and Programme of Action) is to foster societies that are stable, safe, just and tolerant, and respect diversity, equality of opportunity and participation of all people. Other terms that often are invoked in support of this goal are 'social inclusion,' 'social cohesion' and 'social capital'.

Holt-Lunstad and Uchino (2015): Social integration is a multidimensional construct that can be

defined as the extent to which individuals participate in a variety of social relationships, including engagement in social activities or relationships and a sense of communality and identification with one's social roles.

Alba Richard (1997): Social integration is the process during which newcomers or minorities are incorporated into the social structure of the host society.

UN News Center (2015): In a broader view, social integration is a dynamic and structured process in which all members participate in dialogue to achieve and maintain peaceful social relations. Social integration does not mean forced assimilation. Social integration is focused on the need to move toward a safe, stable and just society by mending conditions of social disintegration, social exclusion, social fragmentation, exclusion and polarization, and by expanding and strengthening conditions of social integration towards peaceful social relations of coexistence, collaboration and cohesion.

Park (1921): Social integration is a process of interpenetration and fusion in which persons and groups acquire the memories, sentiments and attitude of other persons and groups and, by sharing their experience and history, are incorporated with them in a common cultural life.

Denys Correll and Mike Chai (2009): Social integration is about including all in sharing wealth through decent work, benefiting from education, health care, enjoying social protection in circumstances beyond their control and participate in decision making.

Social Integration

A process of including, incorporating and willingly assimilating the people belonging to diverse sections and groups in a social fabric with no discrimination of any sort helpful in their peaceful coexistence and collaboration to work towards their own and societal development.

The analysis of all the preceding definitions may help us to know about the meaning and nature of the term social integration, as follows.

- Social integration is the integration of all the diverse sections or groups of the society in a unified and coherent setup to work closely for the development of the society and welfare of all.
- Social integration should be viewed as one of such positive processes that attempts to include everyone in the structure and functioning of the society, especially the disadvantaged, deprived and neglected sections or classes of the society with no discrimination of any kind.
- Social integration as the process of including all in the social setup stands pole apart against the state of social exclusion as a common feature of all the present-day societies where different rules and policies, formal and informal, are observed to enable some and constrain others in gaining access and entitlement to goods, services, activities and resources.
- Social integration stands for including all in sharing what is available in the society in terms of economic and natural resources, political power, social dignity and utilization of educational and physical facilities for living a peaceful and purposeful life.
- It is the process of social integration that helps in building the just and fair societies providing all people equality of rights, equity and dignity in their living and working.
- In a socially integrated setup of a society equal opportunities and facilities are available to all the people in providing their contribution in the management and functioning of the society for its progress and well-being.
- The term social integration more precisely should be understood as the movement of minority groups such as ethnic minorities, refugees and underprivileged sections of a society into the mainstream of societies.
- By having provision to integrate and include all in the mainstream, it helps the otherwise segregated and deprived sections of the society

to have equal access to available community resources with no discrimination of any kind.

- Social integration is the blending and unifying of social groups, but it does not mean their forced assimilation. Here no attempts are made to impose unitary identities on reluctant populations. It tries to bring together various cultural, religious and ethnic groups, without losing their cultural and original identities.
- The nature and amount of social integration present in a society can be identified on the basis of the extent to which the people belonging to different diverse sections of the society interact together in social activities and cooperate jointly for the development of safety and well-being of the society.
- Social integration is focused on the need to move toward a safe, stable, just and tolerant society by mending conditions of social disintegration and social exclusion as well as strengthening conditions of social integration towards peaceful social relations of coexistence, collaboration and cohesion among the diverse groups.

On the basis of what has just been said about the meaning and nature of the term social integration we may define and understand it as *a process of including, incorporating and willingly assimilating the people belonging to diverse sections, and groups including the minorities, deprived, disadvantaged and migrants in the main stream of the society with no consideration of language, caste, creed, status, religion or race for providing them equal access to the sources and opportunities available in the society helpful in their peaceful coexistence and collaboration to work towards their own and societal development.*

Measures to Achieve or Promote Social Integration

Social integration is the basic essential for the smooth functioning and required development of a society. No society can live in peace and advance on a developmental path in a proper way, until or unless there lies a proper integration, cohesion and understanding among its people and diversified groups. It is

why the prime concern of any society/nation aiming at development should be the attainment of social/national integration.

Consequently, the need to achieve appropriate social integration has been properly felt on the part of every society conscious of its development and well-being. Even at the international level the nations of the world have been discussing from time to time a common platform about the measures for promoting social integration as an instrument of bringing necessary development among the world societies. In this connection, the promotion of social integration was adopted as one of the three core goals of the Copenhagen Declaration adopted by 117 national leaders at the World Summit for Social Development. The commitment reads as follows:

To Promote social integration by fostering societies that are stable, safe and just and that are based on the promotion and protection of all human rights, as well as on non-discrimination, tolerance, respect for diversity, equality of opportunity, solidarity, security, and participation of all people including disadvantaged and vulnerable groups and persons.

The question here may arise that what measures may be adopted for achieving and promoting social integration in a society. In this connection, in the report commissioned by the United Nations Department of Economic and Social Affairs (UNDESA) for the Expert Group Meeting on Promoting Social Integration, Helsinki, Finland, July 8–10, 2008, Dr. Clare Ferguson has emphasized that promoting social integration in a society requires attention to three different, but inter-linked, processes that shape the extent to which people are able to live and work together on an equal basis. These are:

1. **Recognition** of diverse social groups, cultures and identity in order to promote respect, dignity and cooperation.
2. **Representation** of political voice in order to ensure that the interests of different groups are taken into account in decision making and resource allocation.

3. **Redistribution** of socio-economic resources between individuals and groups in order to prevent deep disparities and fragmentation on the basis of wealth, ethnicity, region, gender, age or other social identity.

The Processes Promoting Social Integration

- Recognition of diverse social groups, cultures and identity.
- Representation of political voice for decision making and resource allocation.
- Redistribution of socio-economic resources between individuals and groups.

While chalking out a plan or policy for the social integration, a society needs to take care of the preceding three processes for taking proper initiatives for this purpose. The key policy recommendations for such implementation at the hands of the respective societies/nations have been cited by Ferguson (2008) in the manner as given as follows.

- Social justice should be established as the principle underpinning social provision. Groups of people who face major systemic barriers in participating as equal citizens should be identified. All populations should be fully registered so that they can access services, and discriminatory legislation should be addressed.
- Inclusive, democratic processes should be used to build consensus about minimum levels of social provision. Political representation of the most disadvantaged is required.
- Established standards of social provision should address access, quality and financial support for those who cannot pay where services are commercialized. Systems of redress and provisions for updating minimum standards are needed.
- The delivery of universal entitlements should be supported with appropriate and sufficient fiscal provision, targeted programs to ensure access

of disadvantaged groups, necessary normative/legal guidelines and appropriate institutional structures.

- Social protection packages should include universal entitlements to basic income, to pensions for those over 65 and appropriate disability and child allowances for the social and cultural environment.
- The institutional base for an equitable, dynamic labor market capable of providing decent work and livelihoods for all should be established. This will include support for workers' organizations in rural and urban settings.

If we take into consideration the aforementioned key processes involved in the initiation of a program for social inclusion and policy recommendations for achieving or promoting the needed social integration, we can come to the conclusion that efforts made and means employed by the society or nation for achieving social integration may be chiefly divided into two categories: (A) social integration through legislative means and administrative measures and (B) social integration through change of attitudes, beliefs and values.

Let us look into these measures in bringing integration into social fabrics of the world societies facing problems related to disintegrative tendencies.

Before thinking about the application of the preceding types of measures for social integration, we must be very clear that diversity, disparity and discrimination is a widely acclaimed phenomenon in the whole world. Therefore, it is not uncommon in the existing world societies to witness a lot of disintegrative tendencies visible in their organization and functioning in the name of religion, race, caste, creed, gender, cultural traditions, language, regions, economic and social status, as well as privileges and disadvantage experienced by its people or groups in their living and working in the society. In such a case it is indeed a most difficult and challenging task to apply one or the other types of measures for achieving the desired level of social integration in the concerned society. However, let us see how we can apply the needed measures for the purpose.

A. Social Integration Through Legislative Means and Administrative Measures

The application of these measures for achieving or promoting social integration requires on the part of the concerned government or organizational bodies of the society to prescribe and implement legislative means and legal laws for performing useful functions such as (i) promoting integration among the diversified section of the society and (ii) exercising restraint over the disruptive disintegration tendencies prevailing in the society. What the different governments or authorities can do in this direction, let us try to illustrate it by citing the work done by Indian government in this concern.

Enacting Legislative Provisions and Legal Laws

We may witness the presence of a number of different specific legislative provisions and legal laws helpful in the promotion of social integration in the Indian society such as follows.

- India has proclaimed itself a people's democracy run through the ballot based elected representatives of the people of the country. There is no discrimination of any kind shown towards the citizens in exercising their voting rights or fighting elections for the sharing of power.
- The country has a well-framed and legally secured constitution for safe guarding the interests and rights of its citizens as well serving the cause of social and national integration with the provisions such as follows.
 1. Secularism is a basic feature of the constitution which is guaranteed well through the judiciary provisions. There is no state religion and throughout the country there is complete prohibition against discrimination on the basis of religion.
 2. Our constitution has made proper provision for ensuring equality of status among people and equal opportunity for everyone to live, work and progress with a fair objective of the survival of multiculturalism,

promotion of fraternity and protection of communal as well as societal harmony in the country.

- For the implementation of the provisions related to social integration in the constitution, it has enacted a number of acts and laws specially in consideration of providing relief and protection to the minorities, disadvantaged, backward and unprivileged sections of the society. Reservation in services and educational institutions for these sections have been intentionally made for helping them to raise their socio-economic status and remove disparity and dissatisfaction growing among these deprived sections of the society. The laws have also been framed for the protection of the rights of women, children, senior citizens and disabled people for their protection, inclusion and rightful living in the society.
- The federal structure of the republic has been rightfully preserved for providing needed freedom to the states and regions of the country to progress while preserving their social and cultural identity. The constitution besides adopting Hindi and English as official languages of the country, has also given proper recognition to the regional languages for enriching and preserving the identities of the various language speaking sections of the society.

B. Social Integration Through Change of Attitudes, Beliefs and Values

It is perfectly true that integration of mind and heart along with the implementation of any physical and legal measures is very much essential for securing and achieving the needed proper social integration in a society. We need to have a needed transformation in the attitudes, beliefs and values of the people and different diversified groups of the society towards the outer groups. They must be made to see unity in diversity by providing due recognition, respect and the feelings of integration towards each other irrespective of the differences existing among them on account of their belongingness to different religions,

castes, races, socio-economic status, linguistic and regional groups, genders, minority and majority sections of the society, etc. The following measures may prove quite advantageous in this concern.

1. **Role of Educational Measures:** Education can play a quite decisive role in bringing required change in the attitudes, beliefs and values of the people not only for disengaging them from the separatist and disintegrative tendencies and behaviors but also help them much in playing an active role in the promotion of social integration. The children from their early school classes may be taught to learn a valuable lesson of unity in diversity and multi-culturalism by setting aside the narrow feelings of casteism, racism, gender inequality, socioeconomic differences, religion and regional based fanaticism, etc. The environment of the educational institutions, the system of instruction, curricular courses, writing of text books, organization of formal and informal experiences to the future generations, etc. should be so structured as to serve maximum purpose of promoting social and national integration among them.
2. **Role of Mass Media and Multimedia:** Mass and multimedia in the form of print media – newspapers, books, magazines and journals – means of information, communication and entertainment in the form of mobiles, radio, television, movies, online available audio – visual material through rapidly developing computer and smart phone linked IT devices such as Facebook, Twitter, Instagram and a number of various apps and search engine based services have given so much exposure nowadays for all the people of all ages with no barrier of any kind. It has a great potential to influence the masses with a variety of information coloring their attitudes, beliefs and values in a quite positive and negative way contributing towards integration and disintegration of the society or nation. Therefore, here becomes the responsibility of the society and the governing agencies particularly to keep a close watch on the type of material available to the masses in the form of mass media and multimedia.

3. **Role of NGOs and Social Workers:** A number of NGOs and social workers are dedicated to serve the cause of humanity and the society. They may be found to function in their respective societies as well as globally through the branches of their organization. They fight against the social injustice, discrimination and inequalities, atrocities on the weaker sections and minorities, and work for equality, equity and integration of the societies, on the national and international level. On the local and regional level, they can prove themselves as a good helping hand in bringing needed change in the attitudes, beliefs and values of the people and different groups of the society for the promotion of cohesion and integration in the society. At the time of any communal, caste or class ridden social conflicts they work as the frontline warriors for bringing peaceful understanding between the conflicting groups. Many times, they work as mediators, or help givers during the period of separation and disintegrative incidences occurring in the society. The government and local level administration agencies may utilize their voluntary services for the implementation of plans and schemes for providing justice to the disadvantaged and bringing unity and cohesion among the different diversified sections of the society.
4. **Constructive Role Played by Religious Bodies:** Many times, the unity, integrity and peaceful coexistence prevailing in the diversified sections of the society are seriously disturbed on account of the rumors spread and misunderstanding created on the part of the vested interests. It may also be surfaced by the fanaticism created on the part of some narrow-minded religious heads. Here now there arises a need of the existence of the well-reputed religious bodies and fair-minded religious heads to create a congenial environment for the peaceful coexistence, cohesion and unity among the followers of the different faiths and religions by bringing into focus the very essence of the preaching of all religions such as:

- The service to humanity and attainment of spiritual values is the real goal of every religion, no matter what ever worshipping method or rituals it may adopt for this purpose.
- No religion teaches to hate and quarrel with the followers of other religions but to love and coexist peacefully with them.
- To provide one's own contribution towards peaceful living and work for the development of the society and welfare of all is the real worshipping to one's God.

The religious bodies and head while helping in the maintenance of the secular character of a society may also help in the proper implementation of the schemes and measures for achieving and promoting integration in the structural organization and functioning of the society.

5. **Constructive Role Played by Community Bodies:** The self-help is said to be the best help that can be available to a society and community in the preservation and maintenance of the needed cohesion and integration among its people or groups. There is a need of the active contribution of some organizations and bodies established by the community people either through nomination or election for the purpose. These bodies in the name of Society Welfare Associations, Mohalla Sudhar Samities, Gram Panchayats, Block Samities and Zila Parishads, etc. can play a quite constructive role on both fronts – keeping the society or community away from the disintegrative tendencies and promoting the essentials needed for social integration. These bodies while working on a specific local level and small area are found to be quite competent and capable of handling well the things needed for maintaining cohesion and unity among the people for the needed progress of the society and welfare of the people.

In this way, we may properly visualize that measures adopted through the provisions made and programs/schemes launched and implemented by the

concerned governments, and administration and changes brought out in the attitudes, beliefs and values of the people and diverse sections of the society may help a lot in achieving cohesion and integration in the structural organization and functioning of the society.

To Sum Up

Social integration may be understood as a process of including, incorporating and willingly assimilating the people belonging to diverse sections and groups in a social fabric with no discrimination of any kind for providing them equal access to the sources and opportunities available in the society helpful in their peaceful coexistence and collaboration to work towards their own and societal development.

There is much need of achieving and promoting social integration on the part of societies or nations for their proper development and well-being. The means and measures employed for this purpose may be broadly classified as: social integration through legislative means and administrative measures; and social integration through change of attitudes, beliefs and values.

In applying the former type of measures attempts may be made by the concerned government or organizational bodies of the society to prescribe and implement legislative means and legal laws for performing useful functions such as: *promoting integration* among the diversified section of the society, and *exercising restraint* over the disruptive disintegration tendencies prevailing in the society.

On the other hand, the use of the latter type of measures emphasizes the task of working for the needed transformation in the attitudes, beliefs and values of the people and different diversified groups of the society towards the outer groups. They must be made to see unity in diversity by providing due recognition, respect and the feelings of

integration towards each other irrespective of the differences existing among them on one or the other account. With regard to the employment of specific measures for this purpose we may here mention the roles of the different social agencies such as: the system of formal education; the means of mass media and multimedia; the NGOs and social workers; religious bodies; and the organizations and bodies established by the community people.

Review Questions

1. What is social integration? Throw proper light on its meaning and concept.
2. While defining the term social integration, discuss the various measures to achieve or promote social integration.
3. How may the enactment of legislative measures and employment of legal means prove helpful in achieving and promoting social integration in a society? Discuss.
4. What types of legislative and legal measures are in vogue in our country for the promotion of social integration? Discuss.
5. "The attainment of social integration is possible well only through the change of attitudes, beliefs and values of the people in a society." Discuss the validity of this statement.

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UNIT V

GROUP LEVEL PROCESSES



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17.

GROUP DYNAMICS AND GROUP BEHAVIOR

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- Discuss the meaning and concept of Group dynamics.
- Define the term Group dynamics.
- Tell about the basic assumptions of Group dynamics.
- Define the term group and discuss the meaning and characteristics of groups.
- Tell about the types or kinds of groups.
- Explain, how groups are formed and developed.
- Discuss what makes us join one or the other groups.
- Explain, how does a group function?
- Elucidate the phenomenon "Performance of individuals in the presence of others".
- State and discuss the phenomenon of social facilitation and inhibition.
- Discuss the various theories explaining the phenomenon of social facilitation and social inhibition such as (i) drive theory, (ii) theory of evaluation apprehension and (iii) theory of distraction conflict.
- Discuss the phenomenon of social loafing.
- Explain, why does social loafing occur?
- Discuss the ways and measures for reducing social loafing.
- Discuss de-individuation (mob or crowd behavior).
- Tell about the measures for restraining de-individuation.
- Explain how the task of decision making is performed in groups.
- Throw light on the potential dangers and pitfalls in group decision making.
- Discuss the potential dangers of (i) the biased use of available information in the group, and (ii) failure to share unique information from some members, in making a group decision.
- Tell about the effects of the phenomenon of group polarization affect and groupthink on group decision making.

Introduction

It has been commonly observed and also established through various experimental studies that there are differences in the behavior of individuals when they are alone and when they are together with other individuals. An individual, as a member of a group, behaves quite differently from what they would otherwise do. As a member of the group, individuals exhibit group behavior. Group behavior is not a mere sum total of the behavior of the individuals who constitute that group. Under the influence of group behavior, even the most disciplined and responsible individuals have been found indulging in the most irresponsible and undesirable behavior. On the other hand, the most cowardly, unsocial or irresponsible ones are found contributing significantly when observed to work in a group. Therefore, it should be clearly understood that in a social group, the people's behavior rests on a different psychic level and is governed by a unique force operating in the group known as group dynamics. In this chapter let us try to examine the working of social groups and mechanism of the group dynamics.

Group Dynamics – Meaning and Definitions

Group dynamics is a relatively new concept in the socio-psychological field. It is, in fact, a new approach to the study of groups that has gained popularity since World War II. In its word composition, the term group dynamics is made out of two words – ‘dynamics’ and ‘group’. Etymologically the word ‘dynamics’ is derived from a Greek word meaning *force*. Hence ‘group dynamics’ stands for the forces operating in a group. The meaning of the term may be made much clearer in the light of some of the following definitions:

Krech et al. (1950): Group dynamics implies changes that take place within groups.

Good (1959): Group dynamics implies an interactive psychological relationship in which members of a group develop a common perception based on feeling and emotions. The inter-simulative relationships may be described by the term group dynamics.

Otto Kline Berg (1965): It is not easy to define or delimit the important area of group dynamics.

From one point of view, it represents a field of inquiry, a series of inter-related problems; from another it includes a set of techniques; from a third, a theory of the nature of groups and of interaction within groups.

Cartwright and Zander (1968): “Group dynamics should be defined as a field of inquiry dedicated to advancing knowledge about the nature of groups, the laws of their development, and their inter relations with individuals, other groups and larger institutions.”

A close analysis of the preceding definitions may make us conclude that group dynamics is that branch of knowledge that deals with the study of groups – particularly related to their dynamicity. It is therefore quite capable of answering the host of questions concerning the nature and working of groups. How are groups formed? What conditions are necessary for their growth and effective functioning? How do groups affect the behavior of individuals? In this way group dynamics acquaints us with the human behavior and social relationships that exist in the group.

Based on the ground work laid down by these definitions, we can consider *group dynamics as the study of the forces exerted by the individual on the group or by the group on the individual*. Accordingly, the aspirations, attitudes, beliefs, characters, emotions, personality and values of an individual are influenced by the group and vice versa.

Group Dynamics

The study of the forces exerted by the individual on the group or by the group on the individual helpful in acquainting us with the functioning of a group in terms of human behavior and social relationships prevailing in the group.

The group helps a person satisfy his fundamental needs and achieve a sense of accomplishment. It helps to transform the original nature of the person to human nature. Expression of instincts and emotions, formulation of ambitions, attitudes, character, habits and sentiments, values and the development

of personality of the individual is influenced by his interaction with a group.

Basic Assumptions of Group Dynamics

The basic assumptions related to group dynamics may be outlined as follows:

1. **Groups are inevitable and ubiquitous (omnipresent).** Human beings are social by nature. All over the globe, they are bound to live in groups and in fact have compulsion for forming certain groups at all places and in all periods.
2. **Groups mobilize powerful forces producing effects of utmost importance to individuals.** The very sense of identity of a person is shaped by the groups significant to him – his family, school, occupation and profession, and religious groups. The position of a person in a group may influence the way others behave towards him, his self-esteem and level of aspiration.
3. **Groups may produce good as well as bad consequences.** There is convincing evidence to show that groups can be completely good and completely bad for the welfare and progress of the individuals and the society.

Correct understanding of group dynamics allows the possibility that desirable consequences from groups can be knowingly increased. Through the knowledge of group dynamics, groups can be made to serve better ends because knowledge gives power to modify human behavior and social institutions.

Basic Assumptions of Group Dynamics

- Groups are inevitable and ubiquitous (omnipresent).
- Groups mobilize powerful forces producing effects of utmost importance to individuals.
- Groups may produce good as well as bad consequences.

To delve into the mechanism of group dynamics and related group behavior, let us examine the meaning of the term *group* and the mechanisms and functions associated with group behavior. Let us first begin by defining the term 'group'.

Groups – Meaning and Characteristics

In an ordinary sense, a group or social group is said to be a collection or aggregate of two or more objects or persons. But from the socio-psychological angle, mere collection or aggregate of people does not form a group. For knowing more about the meaning and nature of the term social group or group, let us try to pay attention over some of its definitions provided by the eminent scholars and socio-psychologists.

Krech et al. (1950): A group may be defined in terms of two or more persons in which the relations among the members are interdependent (each member's behavior influences the behavior of each of the others), and the members 'share an ideology' (a set of beliefs, values and norms which regulate their mutual conduct).

Paulus (1989): A group consists of two or more interacting persons who share common goals, have a stable relationship, are somehow interdependent and perceive that they are in fact part of a group.

Dasgupta et al. (1997): A group is a collection of two or more persons who are perceived to be bonded together in a coherent unit to some extent.

Quick et al. (2011): A group may be defined as "two or more people with common interests, objectives, and continuing interaction".

Crisp and Turner (2014): One way of defining groups that encompasses all of the qualities is in terms of entitativity. Entitativity refers to the extent to which any collection of individuals can be perceived as 'groupy'.

Barrett (2017): A group may be defined as "two or more individuals who perceive themselves as part of a unit and who influence each other and are interdependent".

Social Group

The collection or aggregate of two or more interdependent individuals who usually feel, think and act together.

A close analysis of the preceding definitions may reveal the following facts about the meaning and characteristics of the term social group or a group working in a social setting.

- A group working in a social situation necessarily consists of more than two persons.
- The individuals comprising a group are found to interact and influence each other, either directly or indirectly.
- A group is perceived as a coherent unit with a feeling of 'we-ness' and a bond of togetherness existing among the members.
- The members of a group share a common belief, goal and norms.
- All the persons comprising a group recognize well that they are part of the group.
- The members of the group in their functioning remain quite interdependent – and this applies whether the group is large or small, formally structured or loose, or focused on this activity or that. Actually, it is not similarity or dissimilarity of individuals that constitutes a group, but interdependence of fate (Kurt Lewin, 1948:165). In other words, groups come about in a psychological sense because people realize they are "in the same boat" (Brown, 1988:28).
- The relationships between the members of the group are relatively stable, persisting over an appreciable period of time.
- The interactions between the members are structured in some manner so that, for instance, each group member performs the same or similar functions each time they meet (Baron and Byrne., 2004:434).
- A group as a whole, thus, exhibits the property of *entitativity* encompassing concepts like cohesiveness, interconnectedness, similarity

and common goals as well as importance of the group and the tendency for group members to interact physically with one another (Crisp and Turner, 2014:112).

In this sense, members of a social group or group are said to be interdependent to a quite significant degree. They share common interests and aims and observe agreed rules of conduct and behavior. Moreover, a sort of belongingness or we-feeling is essential for the formation of a group. When people say, *we Teachers, we Tamils, we Laborers*, etc., it means that they are the members of a group. Under such feelings they can feel, act and think together and, therefore, can be called as the members of a group. In more clear terms, the members of a group must have a common psyche. On account of group psychology, then, the members of a group merge the individualities and begin to *feel, think and act together* at least in a particular moment at a particular place. *A group, therefore, may be defined as the collection or aggregate of two or more interdependent individuals who usually feel, think and act together.*

Defined in this manner, a number of children independently playing their respective games in a public park cannot be regarded as the members of one group. Similarly, a number of people passing through a street, each pursuing his or her way or passengers unrelated and unfamiliar to one another in a railway carriage cannot be said to form a group. They are merely in the togetherness situation at a particular place at a particular moment. Unless they feel and act together and thus share experience of each other, they cannot be said to form a social group.

In a situation when the fellow passengers of a railway carriage take note of and accommodate one another, resist a newcomer trying to enter their compartment and thus begin to think, feel and act together, their simple togetherness turns into a group. Similarly, those passing a street at a particular moment may be found to form a group when they are faced with a common danger. The children playing in the park are said to form such a group when they engage themselves in a common game.

Types or Kinds of Groups

Every one of us is a member of a group that exists in the society. Various attempts have been made to classify these groups on one ground or the other. Some of these classifications are discussed here:

Sumner's Classification

W.G. Sumner classifies the groups into two main categories. (Brown, 1960:92)

1. In-group or we-group.
2. Out-group or others-groups.

In-group or we-group is the group with which we identify ourselves. The out-group or other-group is the group, the members of which are considered outsiders by us. Therefore, there are only two categories 'we' and 'they', and an individual might belong to either in-group or out-group. Those not members of the 'we-group' are of the 'they-group'. Antagonistic feelings are often common between these groups. We do not try to understand the members belonging to out-group and we show an attitude of indifference or scorn or even hate. For example, to the white child of a racist family, a black child belongs to the out-group and therefore he hates him. In schools where gender segregation is observed, the girls or boys form two opposite groups. For the girls they belong to in-group and boys are considered to be the members of out-group. Similarly, boys consider the girls to be belonging to out-group.

Cooley's Classification

The classification suggested by Cooley is based on the degree of intimacy which the individual feels with other persons or groups or some type of "we feeling" (Brown, 1960:94). On this basis groups may be classified as primary, secondary or tertiary.

In *primary groups* there is an intimate face-to-face relationship and cooperation. We-feelings are found to a maximum degree among the members of such groups. Also, they are bound with a mutual bond of interest. The family, play-group of children

and village community are examples of primary groups.

In *secondary groups* the relationships are more or less casual. Here the relationships are usually marked by a single bond of interest. Examples of this type of groups are trade unions, professional associations, social organizations and associations, lodges and clubs.

In *tertiary groups*, the degree of intimacy or relationship is quite marginal and transient in character. The group of audience in a cinema hall and passengers in a railway carriage, etc. are the examples of such groups.

Organized vs. Spontaneous Groups

Groups may be classified as organized group and spontaneous group. In a spontaneous group, the individuals belonging to it come together naturally without any previous planning or specific purpose. But organized groups exist for some specific purposes and are formed as a result of careful pre-planning. The family, the army, the school, etc. are examples of such organized groups.

Formal vs. Informal Groups

Social groups, according to another mode of classification, can be classified as formal and informal groups.

In *formal groups*, the members of the group observe formalities and are bound by some specific rigid rules, values and norms. The group of students in a classroom is an example of a formal group. Various kinds of work organizations also belong to this category.

On the other hand, in *informal groups* members are not bound by specific rigid rules. They may enjoy liberty of thought and freedom of action and are very informal in their relationships and behavior. In informal groups we can include family, play or peer group, hobby and recreational groups, etc.

Semi-formal groups fall in between these two categories. In semi-formal groups we can include lodges, temples, social clubs and so on.

Exclusive vs. Inclusive Groups

Groups can also be classified as exclusive and inclusive groups. By the term *exclusive groups* we mean those groups in which their membership is confined or limited to certain special or well-defined class of individuals. Rotary Clubs, affiliated to Rotary International, all over the world provide membership to a certain class of people belonging to different professions and specifying certain conditions. Similarly, there are professional organizations and associations of many professionals, such as engineers, doctors, chartered accountants, lawyers, teachers, etc., that may be cited as examples of exclusive groups granting membership to the people of certain categories and qualifications.

Inclusive groups, on the other hand, may be defined as the groups whose doors for the membership are always open to anybody seeking their membership. Actually, on this account, they are found to be quite liberal and in fact always seen interested in increasing their membership for the cause they want to serve by their organization. The organizations of various political parties, charitable and social services organizations, hobbies clubs, etc. may be cited as examples of such inclusive groups.

By this sort of classification, it should not be concluded that an individual is a member of only one group and he cannot belong to more than one group. An individual may belong to many groups and can be a member of many groups at a particular time. He may be the member of his family group, class or school group, play group, club and association and others, so many primary, secondary or tertiary groups; formal or informal groups, spontaneous or organized groups, in-groups or out-groups, exclusive or inclusive groups, etc. Similarly, it should not also be considered that the classification of groups is rigid or static. The groups, whatever their structure or composition may be, are always dynamic in nature. For example, a formal group like participants in a seminar may turn into an informal group while taking tea or lunch. Similarly, a spontaneous group that has been formed spontaneously may take the shape of an organized group and a secondary group like a lodge or a hostel may perform the functions of a primary group.

To Sum Up

In layman's language, a *group* is said to be a collection or aggregate of two or more people. However, from the socio-psychological angle, a *group* refers to a collection or aggregate of two or more interdependent individuals who usually feel, think and act together. Groups may be classified as:

- *In-group* (the group with which we identify ourselves) and *out-group* (the group the members of which are considered as outsiders by us).
- *Primary* (intimate face-to-face relationship among members), *secondary* (relationships are more or less casual) and *tertiary* (relationships are quite marginal and transient in character).
- *Organized* (carefully pre-planned for serving specific purposes) and *spontaneous* (formed naturally without any previous planning or specific purpose).
- *Formal* (observing formalities and bound by some specific rigid rules) and *Informal* (quite informal in their operation with no specific rigid role to follow).
- *Exclusive* (having membership confined to a certain special class of individuals) and *inclusive* (having membership open to anybody seeking their membership).

Formation of Groups – How Are Groups Formed or Developed?

As social beings we at one or the other times are the members of one or the other groups. How does the formation of these groups take place? What are the different stages of the group formation or development? Before answering these questions related to the process of formation of a group, let us first try to think over what after all makes the people join a group.

What Makes Us Join One or the Other Groups?

As a rational being all our actions are aimed to serve some purposes. It is also very much true for our decision to join a group. In the opinion of Baron and Byrne (2004:435) people are found to join a group for serving the following specific purposes.

1. *Satisfying a Number of Social and Psychological Needs:* The satisfaction of our so many socio-psychological needs is quite vital for our well-being and survival. We have a craving for love and affection (to love and be loved by others), want to have a social company, urge to give and take in social transaction, affiliation with some social organization, etc. Such, all of our socio-psychological needs can be met with our becoming the members of one or the other social groups.
2. *Achieving What Could Not Be Achieved as Individuals:* The joining of a group may help much the individual to do a task or achieve a target that is quite strenuous or almost impossible for them to achieve single handed on an individual basis.
3. *Getting and Sharing a Lot of Knowledge and Information:* In the group we have a lot of opportunity and ease to receive a lot of information and knowledge from the sources available in the group environment that could not otherwise be possible for us.
4. *Meeting the Need of Safety and Security:* The joining of a group helps us in meeting our needs of safety and security. We feel safe and secure, not only as a member of the primary groups such as family and community, but the membership of the secondary groups such as a professional organization, union and club also provides us the needed safety and security in our social life.
5. *Establishing a Positive Self-Identity:* The membership of one or the other groups helps us in the establishment of our identity on a positive note. Our self-concept is well enhanced by considering ourselves as a member of one or the

other social groups. We, an individual, may be found to have a lot of increase in our self-perception by getting us accepted as a member of some prestigious club or organization.

The Process of Group Formation or Development

The groups have to evolve and struggle for reaching a state of well-meaning functioning. For this purpose, a rising group has to pass through certain stages of evolution and development. We can call them the stage of group formation or evolutionary development. The socio-psychologist Bruce Tuckman (1965), in this concern, has identified four stages that characterize the formation or development of groups. He has named them as stage of forming, storming, norming and performing. Let us examine them.

1. **Stage of Forming:** This is the initial and starting phase or stage of group formation. In the case of some social groups the beginning in this direction is made when some like-minded individuals come closer and decide to start a group for serving some cause. In the case of others, the individuals have to work along with others in a group for carrying out some professional business such as completing a project or doing some specific job as members of a sport team or professional workers. Whatever form or motive may be for the start-up it is the stage when members of the group come together, begin to develop their relationship with one another and learn what is expected from them. This is the stage when group formation begins and the members try to understand where others in the group stand and what the group, as a whole, stands for (Moreland, 1987). In such understanding, there always remains a scope about the purpose, structure and leadership of the group. Group members start establishing limits on acceptable behavior through experimentation. However, soon, necessary trust starts to develop among the members. This is also the time when the

tasks of the group and the members are decided and distributed among the group members. This stage is said to be complete when the members of the group start well to assume themselves as part of the group.

2. **Stage of Storming:** After passing of the first stage of group formation, this second stage creeps up in the evolution or development of a group. It is characterized with the initiation of interpersonal and intra-group conflicts and differences of opinion. These may be related to the goals of the group functioning, the division of responsibilities in the group, selection of leader, and the behavior of the members towards each other or complaint about the favoritism exhibited by the group leader. If the group is unable to come through the resolution of such conflicts, particularly related to a clear statement about its purposes and goals and their acceptance on the part of members, the group may collapse at this juncture. At this stage, therefore, it becomes important to work through the dissensions and conflicts growing in the group by resorting to the desirable measures such as establishment of clear common group goals, having necessary open discussion on the issues of dissensions and provide opportunity for everybody in the group to be heard. Gradually, with the adoption of suitable measures, the conflicts and differences in the group start settling and members begin to respect majority opinion and leadership hierarchy of the group for working together in the group.
3. **Stage of Norming:** At this third stage of group development everything seems to be normal and in a good working condition among the members of the group as their dissensions and differences gets almost settled. Expectations of one another are clearly articulated and assimilated in their routine by members of the group. They pick up the needed patterns, norms and rules of working united and fulfilling their responsibilities towards the achievement of common goals. They feel adjusted in the group and also seem to be fully satisfied with the group goals and distribution of roles and responsibilities to individual members. In this way, as a whole, members of the group come to understand how the group as a whole operates and what as individual and group members they have to do for its proper working.
4. **Stage of Performing:** As the name suggests, this final stage of group development is of action and performance. The group is now focused on its task. Therefore, now, each and every member tries to concentrate fully on giving his or her best for the full functioning and maximum output of the group towards the achievement of group goals. The understanding about each other and the spirit of working cooperatively is seen among the group members at its most at this stage of intensive performing. The members, here, now also try to learn new skills and adopt creative ideas for taking the group accomplishments at the new heights of celebrating its glories. In this way, at this stage, the group is aimed to reach the top of its functioning and accomplishments.

However, as it happens to everybody, nothing remains on a set position forever. The stage of performing – functioning fully and performing at the top – also does not last long. There may be rise and fall in the functioning of the group. It may get disintegrated or cease to be in existence due to one or the other reasons. The old members may leave and new join and it may necessitate to get engaged in a new process of forming, storming and norming for coming to a full stage of functioning and performing on the part of the group. Moreover, midway during the performing stage, the possibility of arising conflicts and growing of dissensions among the members cannot be ruled out on account of so many internal and external factors. The leadership and the group as a whole should be prepared for facing such eventualities. There should be a healthy democratic environment for having a constructive discussion on the matter of mutual discord and differences so that all may go well in the group regarding its proper functioning and continuance.

To Sum Up

Formation of groups in any social setup depends on the people's intention of becoming members of one or the other groups. In general, they are attracted and motivated to join a group for serving specific purposes like: satisfying a number of social and psychological needs; achieving what could not be achieved as individuals; getting and sharing a lot of knowledge and information; meeting the need of safety and security; and establishing a positive self-identity.

The process of group formation or development is found to involve certain specific stages such as the stage of forming, storming, norming and performing.

Stage of forming is the initial and starting phase or stage of group formation where members of the group come together, begin to develop their relationship with one another, learn what is expected of them and start to develop necessary trust among them. This stage is said to be complete when the members of the group start well to assume themselves as part of the group.

The next one, the *stage of storming* is characterized with the initiation of interpersonal and intra-group conflicts and differences of opinion arising on one or the other accounts. However, gradually, with the adoption of suitable measures, the conflicts and differences in the group start settling and members begin to respect majority opinion and leadership hierarchy of the group for working together in the group.

At the third stage, the *stage of norming*, everything seems to be normal and in a good working condition among the members of the group as their dissensions and differences get almost settled. At this stage of group development, as a whole, members of the group come to understand how the group as a whole operates and what as individual and group members they have to do for its proper working.

Stage of performing, the final stage of group development, is the stage of action and performance. The group is now focused on its task and tries to achieve its maximum and rise to its peak in its performance and fame.

How Do Groups Function?

The day-to-day working and functioning of a group depends upon some basic elements inherent in its structure and working such as (i) the role and status of the members comprising the group, (ii) the norms of the group to regulate the behavior of the members and (iii) cohesiveness – the glue that binds the members to function as a team. Let us discuss these three kinds of elements one by one.

The Roles of the Members in the Group: In the functioning of a group each and every member belonging to the group is expected to play a definite role for contributing its share in the accomplishment of the common group goals. As a matter of a formal definition we can define the term role as “a set of expected patterns of behavior attributable to a person occupying a particular position in the group” (McKenna, 2012:328). Many times, these roles are received by the members on account of their position in the organization and other times these may be assigned to them on account of their abilities and capacities or may be willingly taken by them on account of their interest and desire to do so. However, in whatever manner, the roles are there for the members comprising a group, the differentiation in terms of the specification of these roles is expected to make the functioning of the group reasonably smooth and productive by allowing the members to work according to their interests and capabilities.

While discussing the significance of the members' roles in the functioning of the groups, socio-psychologists like Shaw (1981) have tried to point about the tripartite distinction between the different aspects of the role performance in the names of (i) expected roles (the behavior expected to be performed by each member), (ii) perceived roles (the behaviors to be performed by the member according to their own perception) and (iii) enacted roles

(the behavior to be actually performed by the respective members). When there remains a proper accord among these three aspects of the role performance of the group members, the group functions well. The leader of the group and the members of the group themselves should try to maintain a proper coordination and accord among these three aspects of their role performance for ensuring the proper functioning of the group.

The Status of the Members Within the Group:

The status of the members within the group is concerned with the position and rank of the individual members in the group. Members of a group or organization are expected as well to play their role according to their status in the functioning of the group. In fact, the members belonging to a group or organization are very much conscious of their status or position and contribute always in the functioning of the groups in proportion of what is expected from them in terms of their status in the group. The awarding of higher status or position in the structure and working of a group carries a thing of significant importance on the part of the group members and it is why conferring or withholding of the status in the group to a member may work as a great morale boosting or reprimanding for his actions or behaviors in the group. One rises to the higher and higher status in the group as a fair award for his contribution in the group's functioning and rise. However, everybody in the group expects a fair treatment to him by the members of the group according to his status or position in the group. The satisfaction and dissatisfaction of the members on this account may result in influencing the functioning of the group in a quite favorable and adverse way. The leader and the members as a whole should be quite careful about this important issue concerning the status of the members for the effective functioning of the group.

The Norms of the Group: Any group or organization for its survival and proper functioning needs the establishment of certain norms – rules and principles (implicit or explicit) – and their strict adherence on the part of its members. Certainly, these norms represent the rules of the game – the behavior to be exhibited towards each other and the manner

in which responsibilities are to be exercised by the members of the group. In this way, the norms of the group, by pointing out to the members what to do and not to do, work as an effective means for regulating the behavior of the members, which in turn results in the improvement of the functioning of the group in a needed way.

The Cohesiveness in the Group: The fourth basic element associated with the proper composition and functioning of a group is its cohesiveness. Etymologically, the term cohesion is derived from the Latin word *cohaesus*, which means “adhering or sticking together”. Taking clue from such etymological meaning of the word cohesion, the term cohesion or cohesiveness existing in a group has been defined by Carron (1988:341) as a “dynamic process that is reflected in the group's tendency to stick together while pursuing its goals and objectives”. Taking this pattern of defining cohesiveness ahead, Paxton and Moody (2003) comment:

Cohesiveness is the characteristic of the group as a whole and is based upon the combined commitment of each individual to the group. When the members of the group like each other and are connected by bonds of friendship, cohesiveness is high.

Cohesiveness

The glue like tendency or characteristic of the group to keep members together as a team for achieving the common group goals.

An analysis of the preceding statements may help us in knowing about the following things about the meaning and nature of the term cohesion or cohesiveness in the group.

- Cohesion reflects a tendency or magnet-like characteristic of a group that helps in attracting as well keeping members together in the form of a solid working group or team.

- The power of this tendency of making the members stick together is known as cohesiveness present in the group. Accordingly, the term cohesiveness of the group represents the degree to which the members of a group wish to remain in the group.
- The center point of attraction or purpose of making members stick together is their striving for achieving some common interests or broad purposes of the group.
- The mutual liking of the members for each other and their loyalty and commitment for the group adds much towards keeping cohesiveness of the group at a quite higher level.
- Cohesion represents a process of group formation or team building and is therefore not static but works as a dynamic phenomenon for shaping and reshaping the structural as well as working composition of a functioning group.

In this way, a cohesive group is one in which:

1. There are quite specific common goals for the common striving of the members for a purpose.
2. Members of similar liking and background willingly join and try to retain their membership in the group.
3. In spite of facing so many odds and changing conditions, it remains intact.
4. The members are concerned with their membership and have a bond of togetherness and loyalty towards the group with a strong motivation for contributing to the group's welfare, to take part in its activities and to further its objectives to the degree possible on their part.

Usefulness of the Group Cohesiveness: Group cohesiveness is useful and essential for the proper functioning of the groups working towards attaining some specific purposes or goals for the reasons such as:

1. Increasing the motivation of the members and raising their morale (Mullen and Cooper, 1994).
2. Contributing towards the potency and vitality of the group

3. Increasing the importance of membership for group members.
4. Exerting strong influence upon the individual to behave in accordance with the group norms and expectations (McGraith, 1984).

The Factors Influencing the Group Cohesion

The factors responsible for influencing and affecting the group cohesion may be briefed as follows.

- The nature of the efforts needing to gain entry in the group.
- The type of interaction, and bond of relationships existing among the group members.
- The size of the group.
- The nature of the group goals and the degree to which these serve the interest of the group members.
- The nature and extent of the commitment or loyalty members possess towards each other and the group as a whole.
- The existence or absence of any external threat or competition anxiety among the members.
- The presence and absence of mutual conflicts and differences among the group members and possibilities of minimizing them.
- The presence or absence of democratic environment for the communication, discussion and opinion expression for the group members.
- The presence or absence of the opportunity of leaving the group with not much risk involved therein.
- The appropriateness or inappropriateness of the leadership available for the functioning of the group and interacting with the individual members.

In this way, on one hand we can understand the importance of cohesiveness for the proper existence and functioning of the social groups for attaining the specific purposes of one or the other kinds, then on the other we may also understand the value of providing attention upon harnessing the factors responsible for group cohesiveness in our favor at the utmost for keeping the group as high as possible in terms of its cohesiveness.

To Sum Up

Regarding the functioning of the groups, we may observe that their day-to-day functioning depends upon some basic elements inherent in their structure and functioning such as:

- The role and status of the members in the group (what position is given in the group and what is expected from them accordingly for the accomplishment of common group goals).
- The norms of the group, in the form of what to do and not to do, for regulating the behavior of the members.
- Cohesiveness – the glue that bind the members to function as a team.

Performance of Individuals in the Presence of Others

It is commonly observed that the performance of individuals is significantly affected in the presence of others. In general, it may lead to the enhancement or reduction in the performance level of the individuals in one or the other tasks giving birth to the foreplay of the phenomenon of social facilitation, social inhibition and social loafing. Let us discuss these.

The Phenomenon of Social Facilitation

Social facilitation refers to a social process or phenomenon in which the presence of others facilitates the enhancement in the performance level of the working individuals in a task being performed by them at that time. This phenomenon was first reported by Norman Triplett (1898) in his observation of the cyclists. He noted that the cyclists rode faster when they were racing along with other fellow cyclists than when they raced alone. In our observation in day-to-day routine life we may find that the workers perform better when they work in groups, women spin yarn more in the company of other fellow spinners, children study more and perform better in competition along with

the fellow children. These are the day-to-day examples of the phenomenon of social facilitation. However, social facilitation as a term in the field of social psychology was first used and coined by Floyd Allport (1920) to describe the tendency of people to perform better in the presence of others. In his attempt of knowing the truth of this phenomenon he conducted a number of experiments using a variety of methods involving a number of different situations of performing the tasks in the presence of others. The experimental work of Floyd Allport regarding social facilitation persuaded other scholars to experiment further in this field resulting in questioning the validity of the phenomenon of social facilitation giving birth to the phenomenon of social inhibition.

Social Facilitation

A social process or phenomenon in which the presence of others facilitates the enhancement in the performance level of working individuals in a task being performed by them at that time.

The Phenomenon of Social Inhibition

Social inhibition refers to a social process or phenomenon in which the presence of others may work to interfere with or inhibit/reduce the performance of the working individuals in a task being performed by them at that time. As a day-to-day example of this phenomenon we can quote the case when a student dancer providing a commendable performance during her training fails badly in providing her performance at the University youth festival before a sizable audience.

Social Inhibition

A social process or phenomenon in which the presence of others may work to interfere with or inhibit/reduce the performance of the working individuals in a task being performed by them at that time.

This phenomenon became apparent when the socio-psychologists testing the validity of the claim of the phenomenon of social facilitation found that the presence of others while helping in a variety of cases obstructs or inhibits the performance of the individuals at so many other times (Aiello and Douthitt, 2001). Particularly, it was noted by them (Travis, 1925; Pessin, 1933; Bond and Titus, 1983) that while the phenomenon of social facilitation stands true in the performance of the simple tasks or the tasks being perfectly skilled or practiced, it does not work well or even otherwise work in opposite for giving birth to the phenomenon of inhibition in performing the difficult and complex tasks or the task not well experienced or properly practiced before.

Now the question arises why and how it happens that the presence of others sometimes helps and other times inhibits the performance of the individuals in the tasks. The socio-psychologists have worked out some theories for providing explanation on this account. Let us discuss them.

Theories Explaining the Phenomena of Social Facilitation and Inhibition

Drive Theory: This theory owes its origin at the hands of the socio-psychologist Robert Zajonc (1965). This theory is found to provide explanation for the phenomena of social facilitation and inhibition through the occurrence of some activities under the following stages.

Drive Theory

A theory of social facilitation and inhibition emphasizing that our behavior is driven to social facilitation or inhibition depending on whether or not the dominate response evoked by physical arousal caused through a mere presence of others in the working situation suits well to our performance or not.

1. First of all, the mere presence of others results in the increase in the physical arousal of the individual.
2. The increased physical arousal, then, in turn leads to an increase in the likelihood of the dominant or well-learned response tendencies in the individual.
3. The employment of these so developed dominant and well-learned response tendencies now plays a crucial role in the performance behavior of the individual before others. It will result in social facilitation (enhancing the performance level) or social inhibition (impairing the performance level) depending on whether or not the dominate response evoked by physical arousal at the second stage used by him in his performance is correct or incorrect.

Theory of Evaluation Apprehension: The doubt expressed about the claim of the drive theory to produce increased physiological arousal at the mere presence of others for facilitating or inhibiting the performance of an individual gave birth to a theory named as evaluation apprehension theory. In this concern, credit for bringing this theory goes to the experiments performed by the socio-psychologists and researchers Cottrell et al. (1968), and Cottrell (1972).

Theory of Evaluation Apprehension

A theory of social facilitation and inhibition emphasizing that it is not the mere presence of others but the apprehension of being evaluated by others that is responsible for improving or impairing the performance of the individuals

On the basis of the experimental findings, the propagators of this theory established that it is not the mere presence of others but the apprehension of being evaluated by others that is responsible for improving or impairing the performance of the individuals. A blind folded or deep sleeping audience cannot produce evaluation apprehension among the

performing individuals, but it is the fear of being judged by a well conscious or say more knowledgeable audience that creates evaluation apprehension among the performers for influencing or affecting their performance in a better or worse way.

Theory of Distraction Conflict: Another good explanation for the performance enhancement and performance impairment of people in the presence of others came from this theory of distraction conflict brought into existence through the experiments performed by Robert S. Baron and his colleagues (Baron et al., 1978). According to distraction conflict theory, it is neither mere presence nor evaluation apprehension that cause the psychological arousal that leads to facilitation or inhibition effects, but conflict experienced between the task at hand and attending to others in the immediate surroundings (Crisp and Turner, 2014:116).

Theory of Distraction Conflict

A theory of social facilitation and inhibition emphasizing that it is neither mere presence nor evaluation apprehension that cause the psychological arousal that leads to facilitation or inhibition effects, but it is the conflict experienced between the task at hand and attending to others in the immediate surroundings, that work for the same.

Here, on one hand is the individual's intention of performing the task as properly as possible and on the other hand lies the audience and co-actors generating conflict in the shape of increased physiological arousal. Such increased arousal, in turn, enhances the tendency to perform dominant responses. If these are correct in a given situation, performance is enhanced, but, if they are incorrect, performance is impaired.

(Baron and Byrne, 2004:444)

In this way, the theories cited earlier try to explain the occurrence of social facilitation and social inhibition

associated with the enhancement or impairment of the performance of the individuals in the presence of others in their own ways. A happy synthesis of the viewpoints expressed by these theories may help in arriving at a proper explanation of such behavior.

To Sum Up

In general, the performance of the individuals in one or the other tasks seems to be significantly affected in the presence of others giving birth to the foreplay of the phenomenon of social facilitation, social inhibition and social loafing.

Social facilitation refers to a social process or phenomenon in which the presence of others facilitates the enhancement in the performance level of the working individuals in a task being performed by them at that time. This phenomenon was first reported in the year 1897 by Norman Triplett in his observation that cyclists rode faster when they were racing along with other fellow cyclists than when they raced alone. Later on, in the year 1920, Floyd Allport conducted a lot of experimental work for describing the tendency of people to perform better in the presence of others and coined the term *social facilitation* for describing this phenomenon.

Instead of getting an increase in the performance, the presence of others may cause a decrease in the performance of the individuals in the task. The socio-psychologists have named this phenomenon social inhibition. As a matter of definition, thus, social inhibition stands for a social phenomenon in which the presence of others may work to interfere with or inhibit/reduce the performance of the working individuals in a task being performed by them at that time.

For explaining the presence of others sometimes helping and other times inhibiting the performance of the individuals in the tasks, socio-psychologists have worked out some theories like drive theory, theory of

evaluation apprehension and theory of distraction conflict.

According to *drive theory*, brought out by Robert Zajonc, an individual's behavior is driven to social facilitation or inhibition depending on whether or not the dominant response evoked by physical arousal caused through the mere presence of others in the working situation suits well to his performance or not.

Theory of evaluation apprehension, brought out by Cottrell et al. (1968) and Cottrell (1972), emphasizes that it is not the mere presence of others but the apprehension of being evaluated by others that is responsible for improving or impairing the performance of the individuals.

According to the *theory of distraction conflict*, brought out by Baron et al. (1978), it is neither mere presence nor evaluation apprehension that causes the psychological arousal that leads to facilitation or inhibition effects, but it is the conflict experienced between the task at hand and attending to others in the immediate surroundings, that work for the same.

1. In the case of a group of people getting involved in shifting a heavy load from one place to another one or the other members of the group may not be putting their best but only pretending to do so.
2. In the case of working on the completion of a group project by the students of a class, there may be some students playing hide and seek by not contributing their best for the proper execution of the project.
3. There is a strange story depicting the behavior of people letting others contribute as per expectation from the group members for the success of the group task. In this story people of a particular religious group were supposed to put a certain quantity of milk in a container covered by a lid one by one with a possibility of not being seen by others while putting their share of the milk in the container. The people put the water in place of milk by assuming that a small quantity of water in a big container, supposed to be filled up with the milk contributed by others in the group, carries no significance. After when all contributed their share of milk, the container was opened by the priests to find in their surprise that it was totally filled up with water.

The Phenomenon of Social Loafing

There may be occasions in the working of the individuals in the group, when the performance of the group as a whole also gets adversely affected besides the reduction and impairment in the quality of the performance behavior of one or the other members as per expectation by the group for achieving its common goal. It happens at the times when contribution of each member in the group is not put under evaluation on an individual basis. The members have no apprehension of getting detected for not contributing towards the attainment of the group goal in a desired way. They find a golden opportunity of escaping from giving their own contribution in the expected way and letting others do the work in group tasks by taking a free ride for themselves. Let us make this situation clear by citing some examples from social life.

What happens in these examples is referred to as an outcome of a social phenomenon called social loafing on the part of socio-psychologists. It is characterized with the reduction in motivation and effort when individuals work collectively in a group compared to when they work individually or as independent co-actors (Karau and William, 1993).

Social Loafing

A social phenomenon in which people, while working in a group not put under evaluation on an individual basis, are found to escape from providing their own contribution in the expected way and let others do the work by taking a free ride for themselves.

This phenomenon of social loafing occurring in a group work (not put under evaluation on an individual basis) is quite universal. It has been found to take place across genders, age spans, cultures, social situations as well as tasks (simple or complex; cognitive or physical). Truly speaking, social loafing appears to be a basic fact of our social life. However, in all its forms or ways it is quite harmful in any process of group working. It cannot be taken too lightly. We have to think about the ways and measures of reducing its possibilities. However, before thinking about these measures we should try to know why social loafing occurs.

Why Does Social Loafing Occur?

A number of viewpoints or theoretical perspectives have been put up by socio-psychologists for explaining the social loafing behavior of the people. We can summarize them as follows.

1. *Lack of Motivation:* The main source of social loafing lies in the lack of motivation. People lessen their efforts and do not provide their best to the group since they find no purpose served on account of their hard work. It happens much in the situations when (i) group members feel that the task or the team itself has only a little value for them, (ii) they think that their contributions will not be evaluated or considered, and (iii) they feel under-appreciated within their team or group.
2. *Diffusion of Responsibility:* This term runs contrary to the owning of responsibility for the task in hand. It describes how people in a group feel individually less responsible for any task in hand (Crisp and Turner, 2014:117). Actually, in the situation when people are held responsible for the assigned responsibilities in the working of a group there are lesser chances of the incidence of social loafing. On the other hand, where no such assigning of specific responsibilities and their evaluation

on individual level occurs, people feel relaxed instead of remaining aroused for their utmost contribution. Realizing that their contribution will get lost in the crowd and at present they have the golden opportunity to get a free ride (because someone else will surely pick up the slack), they prefer to exert less effort.

3. *Collective Effort Model:* The most comprehensive explanation of social loafing comes from the application of a model named 'collective effort model' propagated by Karau and Williams (1993). The propagators of this model emphasize that when people put up their collective efforts with their full willingness in the execution of the group task there is the least possibility of the occurrence of social loafing. For explaining why there lie possibilities of putting less effort in the group work on the part of the people in comparison to when they work alone, the model suggests:

When individuals work together with others, the links (i) between their effort and the group's performance and (ii) between the group's performance and their own rewards are weaker than when individuals work alone.

(Karau and Williams, 1993)

In other words, the people resort to social loafing in the group work because they find that whether they work or do not work does not matter for the success of the group and also, they are not going to be individually rewarded or appreciated for the success of the group as happens with them when they work independently.

Ways and Measures for Reducing Social Loafing

Based on the causes inherent and the possibilities arising in the occurrence of social loafing, socio-psychologists have suggested the use of various measures and techniques (in their combination

or alone) for its reduction and controlling. We can summarize them as follows.

1. There is a need of proper identification and evaluation of the efforts of the individual members in the group task preferably throughout the execution of the group activities.
2. The work done and responsibilities shared on the part of the individual members should not only be identified but also dully rewarded through the adoption of certain specific rules and norms for this purpose.
3. The task done and responsibilities shared on the part of group members in this concern should be made more meaningful, interesting, specific and challenging for leaving little chances of social loafing.
4. It is also a good thing to provide the opportunity for the group members to choose the task they want to execute and responsibility they want to share in the group project. It gives them fewer excuses for their social loafing and work more for the team success.
5. Efforts should be earnestly made for increasing the commitment of the group members to successful task performance (Brickner et al., 1986).
6. Necessary efforts should be made for increasing the apparent importance or value of the task being executed by the group (Karau and Williams, 1993).
7. Efforts should be made to the people working in a group to provide some kind of standard of performance such as how much others are doing or their own past performance (Williams et al., 1981).
8. Social loafing can be reduced much when the group members view their contribution to the group task as unique rather than merely redundant with those of others (Weldon and Mustari, 1988).
9. In the last but not the least, efforts should be made to bring an environment of cooperation and cohesiveness in the group for reducing the chances of social loafing in the work execution (Baron and Byrne, 2004).

To Sum Up

In working situations, at times, when contribution of each member in the group is not put under evaluation on an individual basis, the members have no apprehension of getting detected for not contributing towards the attainment of group goal in a desired way. Here, they find a golden opportunity of escaping from giving their own contribution in the expected way and letting others do the work in group tasks by taking a free ride for themselves. Such behavior of theirs is referred to as an outcome of a social phenomenon called social loafing on the part of socio-psychologists. It is characterized with the reduction in motivation and effort when individuals work collectively in a group compared to when they work individually or as independent co-actors.

The factors or things responsible for the occurrence of social loafing have been identified as: lack of motivation (finding no purpose served by their hard work); no assigning of specific responsibilities and their evaluation on an individual level; and feeling on their part that whether they work or do not work does not matter for the success of the group.

For avoiding the loss affected through the occurrence of social loafing in a group work, it is always advisable to adopt meaningful measures for bringing reduction in the social loafing. The cure lies in the prevention of its occurrence, i.e., taking proper care of the things which may be considered a contributor for the occurrence of such behavior among the group members.

De-Individuation – Mob or Crowd Behavior

It is not unusual on our part to read in a newspaper and listen and view on a television channel the incidences and case like (i) a group of agitators pelting

stone or burning vehicles and buildings and causing damage to public property; (ii) an unruly group of people lynching somebody on pretext of one or the other things, (iii) a group of people attacking doctors and nurses by accusing the staff for their carelessness on the death of a patient, (iv) a mob damaging anything coming in their way after getting agitated on account of the abduction and rape of a female victim, (v) a group of audience members demonstrating quite unruly behavior in a musical concert or cultural feast, or (vi) a group of spectators or fans engaging in an unruly behavior by demonstrating a lot of violence.

These incidences and cases illustrate what we mean by the term de-individuation or crowd behavior. However, in a formal way, as a term, de-individuation has been explained and defined by socio-psychologists in the manner as follows.

Gustave Le Bon (1903): De-individuation represents the behavior collectively performed by the group of individuals at the time when they remained lost in the crowd and performed such acts that they would not have performed if they were alone.

Festinger et al. (1952): People become individuated in a group and lose their personal identity. Consequently, they do not assume responsibility for their actions and are more likely to commit acts that they would not be doing alone.

Baron and Byrne (2004): The behaviors observed during de-individuation include behaviors that usually are inhibited, such as aggression and laziness, as well as emotional, destructive and even childlike behaviors.

Barrett (2017): Often in the process of becoming a group member, the individual may lose his/her own self or may lose his/her self-awareness as well as the sense of personal responsibility; this is termed as de-individuation.

Baron et al. (2008): De-individuation may be defined as a psychological state characterized by reduced self-awareness and social identity brought on by external conditions such as being anonymous members of a large crowd.

De-Individuation

A phenomenon visible in the members of a group in the form of group behavior in which they are found to do away with their individualities and engage in an unruly crowd behavior by losing control over themselves.

In this way, we can term de-individuation a specific phenomenon that is visible in the members of a group in the form of group behavior in which people are found to do away with their individualities and engage in an unruly crowd behavior by losing control over them.

The question here may arise, after all what makes a group or mob of the people to engage in such unruly behavior characterized by the term de-individuation? The socio-psychologists and researchers, since a quite long period, have strived to work for knowing the causes lying behind such behavior. Let us discuss their attempts in this direction.

1. The sociologist Gustave Le Bon (1903) theorized on the basis of his research work that people engage in crowd behavior on account of getting developed among themselves a collective mind and mob mentality. It is characterized by making people lose their sense of responsibility and thinking on the individual level as well as weakening of their controlling system. As a result, in a mob when one person does something, others also tend to do it even if it is unacceptable to them.
2. The sociologists Festinger et al. (1952) with their research work tried to conclude that, in general, in behaving in a group people become de-individuated and lose their personal identity on account of the phenomenon of group behavior (to think, feel and act as others do in the group). Consequently, they do not assume responsibility for their actions and are more likely to commit acts that they would not be doing alone.

3. Zimbardo (1970) on the basis of his research work theorized that in behaving along with others in the group factors such as anonymity, arousal and being in the large group allow people to shed their own identity. Consequently, they neither assume responsibility for their action nor monitor their own actions resulting in the removal of their hesitation in committing quite irresponsible and undesirable behavior.
4. Postmes and Spears (1998) through their research work tried to conclude that when people behave in the group, they are more likely to obey the norms of the group and commit any type of behavior desirable or undesirable (such as shouting and hitting the players of the opposition team with some objects) and less likely to behave in accordance with the standard norms (such as showing sportsmanship and respecting the good play of the opposite team).
5. Mullen et al. (2003) on the basis of their research work proposed that it is the anonymity felt on the part of the people with the others in the crowd that works simultaneously to feel reduction in their self-awareness and social identity resulting in the demonstration of behaviors which they would never perform at their own in normal situations.

Measures for Restraining De-Individuation

Whatever the cause or causes may germinate and perpetuate de-individuation or crowd behavior among the people, it is obvious that its occurrence is neither good for the society nor the individuals themselves engaging in such behavior. Necessarily, some measures should be there for restraining and doing away with such undesirable behavior. We can broadly put these measures into two categories – internal and external.

1. *Internal Measures:* These measures may include (i) educating people about the ill consequences of their irrational and damaging behavior committed by them in the mob wave, (ii) educating

and training them for exercising control over their heightened emotions at the time of being incited or exploited by some vested and unruly elements, and, thus (iii) ultimately trying to build a general consensus and public sentiments against the undesirable mob behavior.

2. *External Measures:* In this category we may include the measures like (i) the establishment of a watchful machinery through the joint efforts of the public and government for keeping vigil and a record of the acts of de-individuation or undesirable crowd behavior, (ii) enactment of harder punishing laws for taking action against the people in the mob for working as deterrent against engaging in such unruly behavior, and (iii) taking special punishing measures against the mob of people that indulges in killing people and damaging public and private properties.

To Sum Up

The term de-individuation or crowd behavior represents the behavior collectively performed by the group of individuals at the time when they remain lost in a crowd and perform such acts that they would not have performed if they were alone. During this time, they are found to lose their self-awareness as well as the sense of personal responsibility for getting engaged in such unruly behavior.

The socio-psychologists through their own studies have identified certain causes responsible for such unruly crowd behavior of the people such as:

- Developing among themselves a collective mind and mob mentality.
- Behaving under the influence of group behavior (to think, feel and act as others do in the group).
- Behaving under the influence of the factors such as anonymity, arousal and being

in the large group allowing people to shed their own identity.

- Behaving under the norms of the crowd rather than the standard social norms.
- Reduction in their self-awareness and social identity on account of feeling anonymity with the others in the crowd.

Measures for restraining de-individuation or crowd behavior may be broadly categorized as named as internal and external. Where the internal measures employed here may call for educating the people in building a general consensus and public sentiments against the undesirable mob behavior, the external measures may include the task of enacting social and legal means for the prevention and punishing of such unruly behavior.

Decision Making in Groups: How Does It Occur?

Decision making as a term stands for “combining and integrating available information in order to choose one out of several possible courses of action” (Baron and Byrne, 2004:455). Every group informal or formal, small or large, institutional or organizational has to pass through such decision-making process at one or the other times for carrying out its one or the other functions. For taking such decisions there remains a choice such as: (i) to take decision at the individual level at the hands of the group leader all alone or including a limited number of the group members in arriving at some decision on the personal level (the procedure in use by the emperors and dictators) or (ii) involving all the members of the group in the decision-making process. However, in general, there prevails a strong belief that the decision taken by a group as a whole provides a better opportunity to make use of the collective wisdom of the group for arriving at a better decision to carry out the functioning of the group. However, there remains doubt about the validity of this assumption in the

light of the problems, potential dangers and adverse outcomes resulted through such approaches to making a decision in the group. Let us know all about it. For this, in the beginning, let us think over how the decision making occurs in the groups.

The Procedure Adopted for Decision Making in the Group

In general, when a group is set to initiate the task of working on a project or finding a solution to a problem, it prefers to involve all the members of the group in making the right decision on this account. For the purpose, all the members of the group, under the leadership of their group leader, assemble at a suitable place. Here, members may engage into an open discussion about a problem for its solution or planning about a task for its execution. All the members are given full opportunity for expressing their views and providing their suggestions in this concern one by one. Initially what is suggested by the members is then put to further discussion and debate. When it is over, the work of taking final decision appears before the group members. How do they act in such a situation? As a member or leader of a group or organization you must have experienced that certain specific rules and ways of arriving at the final decision are employed by the group at this stage. We may briefly point out them as follows.

- **Consensus:** The group members try to reach a consensus – a solution or work plan agreed and acceptable to all through some further exchange of opinion.
- **Compromise:** When no consensus is arrived for a particular plan or proposal, then attempts are made to seek compromise. For this purpose, a few plans or proposals provided by the members and adjudged suitable on the part of some other members are put to discussion for arriving at a final decision based on a compromise sought out of the differing opinions expressed in the discussed proposals.
- **Majority Vote:** When two of the above methods do not work, then, attempts are made to abide by the majority decision. Here all the previously well discussed proposals or plans of actions are

put to vote and the final decision is taken on the basis of majority opinion of the members.

- **Decision by Leader:** It is another way adopted by the group to arrive at the final decision. The members resort to this means when (i) they fail to arrive at the final decision through the methods like seeking consensus, or compromise, and (ii) in using voting for the majority decision they foresee a big danger of the sharp division and consequential rivalries created among the group members. Accordingly, members take the safest mode by leaving the entire matter of taking final decision to their group leader who then performs this task in the interest of the group's functioning in a desired way.
- **Seeking Arbitration:** To leave the matter of the final decision on the group leader may also not work well. The group leaders may feel hesitation in taking full and final decision at their own for one or the other reasons. They may not like to take risk about the proper working of their decision for the solution of the problem or execution of the group task. Besides this, they may think that their decision has every possibility to go against the proposal of one or the other section of the members, for getting them disappointed or annoyed with him. In order to employ the safest and most workable plan they may, then, approach an external body or person such as somebody senior in rank, expert in the ongoing matter or acceptable by the group as an arbitrator for making a decision for the group.

Potential Dangers and Pitfalls Faced in Group Decision Making

Whatever mode or method such as consensus, compromise, majority vote, leaving on the leader or arbitrator may be employed for the decision making in group, there remain possibilities for the turning of the group decisions as highly damaging, painful and disastrous in their after effects. In the history of civilization and countries we have a number of examples of such bad group decisions and their ill consequences. Remember the grave consequences of the bad decisions like

attacking Pearl Harbor by Japan and invading Russia by the Nazi Germany dragging both America and Russia in the war and thus unnecessarily inviting their doom in the Second World War. Question arises as to why it happens. What is responsible for arriving at such faulty decisions on the part of groups? The answer to such queries may be available in the discussion about the potential dangers and pitfalls inherent either in the process of decision making or in the minds of the decision makers. In this connection, socio-psychologists and researchers have sorted out a few important issues responsible for this mess such as (i) biased use of available information in groups, (ii) failure to share unique information from some members, (iii) the phenomenon of group polarization and (iv) the phenomenon of groupthink. Let us discuss them one by one.

Biased Use of Available Information in Groups

Decisions taken in the group turn out bad and damaging on account of the biases involved in the thinking and attitude of the group members in making fair and unbiased use of the information that is well available in the group while taking a decision for the solution of a problem or working out a plan for the execution of a group task. In this concern, the group may be found to twist and make use of the available information in a biased way for favoring a particular proposal or point of view initially emerging in the thinking or discussion among the group members. Here it is also possible that some of the members individually or in a clique formation, somehow or the other, insist or impress on all the group members to go along with their decision (based on biased and unfair twisting of the available information in their own ways) for making it a group decision without caring for the damaging consequences it may bring in the working of the group.

Failure to Share Unique Information From Some Members

In making a group decision, the group as a whole usually cares about and listens to the majority opinion – the views and perspective held by a large number of

the members that customarily consists of the more prevalent and common opinion or idea about a thing. Here the unique opinion and perspective held by one or the other group members remain unattended and are usually ignored by the majority, irrespective of the fact that these may include a new vision and right perspective quite helpful in arriving at the most appropriate decision. Throwing light on how and why it happens, Strasser and Titus (1985), on the basis of their research work, have tried to conclude:

In making a final decision, information shared by many members is more likely to be mentioned during group discussion than information held by only a single member. Why? Because many members have this information, the probability is high that at least one will call it to the group's attention. As a result, decision making groups are more likely to discuss – and discuss again – information already known to most members, whereas information known to only one or a few members is much less likely to come to the fore.

(Baron and Byrne, 2004:461)

In this way, in the group decision making, there lies a potential danger of focusing on the information which is already known and shared by most of the members for arriving at a final decision. Simultaneously, they are also found to make a serious mistake of sidelining the quite unique and useful information or idea known by a single member or shared only by a few members for reaching the best decision on the part of the group.

The Phenomenon of Group Polarization

The phenomenon of group polarization occurring in the groups also works as a potential threat in the way of taking appropriate decision by them. For throwing light on its meaning and nature, researchers and socio-psychologists have tried to define or explain it in the ways as given next.

Lamm and Myers (1978): Across many different kinds of decisions and in many different contexts,

groups show a pronounced tendency to shift towards views more extreme than the ones with which they initially began. This is known as group polarization.

Isenberg (1986): The phenomenon of group polarization may be defined as “the tendency of groups to take decisions that are extreme than the mean of the individual member's initial position”.

Baron and Byrne (2004): The tendency of group members to shift towards more extreme positions than those initially held as a result of group discussion is referred to as polarization. However, it does not refer to a tendency of groups to split apart in to two opposite camps or poles. On the contrary, it refers to a strengthening of the group's initial preferences.

A reflection on the preceding viewpoint may help us to draw the following conclusions about the meaning and nature of the term group polarization.

- Polarization refers to a phenomenon visible during the group decision making in the form of a general tendency exhibited on the part of the group members to shift their viewpoints towards a position that is similar to but more extreme than the viewpoints held by them before group discussion.
- Polarization makes the initial group decision to move from the average, that is, towards one of the two extreme poles such as shifting a moderately worded statement or a moderately risky stand taken on an issue before the discussion to a quite strongly worded statement, or a higher degree of risky position after the group deliberations.
- It is usually seen that the initial leaning or preference of a group towards a particular group decision before the group discussion gets strengthened and tilted towards a more extreme end during the group's deliberations. As a result, not only does the group shift towards more extreme views, individual members, too, often show such a shift (Baron and Byrne, 2004).
- Accordingly, under the influence of the phenomenon of polarization, there is all likelihood of remaining anonymity among the group

members for the decision taken by the group irrespective of its being characterized with some strong conviction or extreme viewpoint initially not agreed to by some members.

Group Polarization

A general tendency exhibited on the part of the group members to shift their viewpoints towards a position that is similar to but more extreme than the viewpoints held by them before group discussion.

Why such polarization occurs during the group decision making has been searched out by socio-psychologists with some of the plausible causes as follows:

1. A more common explanation for the occurrence of group polarization may come through the mechanism of *social comparison*. It is a natural craving on the part of us to get ourselves compared with others, especially with those belonging to our own group, and, then, try to show that we are not ordinary but extraordinary. It is this tendency of showing themselves quite unique and distinctive from others that makes some members or the whole of the group get polarized and adopt an extreme approach or stand on an issue while reaching to a final stage of the decision making.
2. Another good explanation for the occurrence of group polarization may be available from the viewpoint emphasized in the persuasive-information perspective. According to it, it is the persuasion effect of the strong views and opinions expressed by a majority of the group members during group discussion and a type of new information contained in them, that makes many of the individual members convinced that it is the *right* view and shift towards it with increased strength resulting in the emergence of group polarization (Vinokur and Burnstein, 1974).
3. The third explanation for the occurrence of the phenomenon of group polarization may stem from the perspective known as self-categorization in which a group member is seen to put himself in a defined category of the member of his own group and thereby identify himself well with the group. Accordingly, he may not only try to show his agreement with the opinion and views expressed by the majority of the group members during group discussion but even adopt an extreme approach for furthering a majority opinion to become a group decision and thus proving his solidarity and cohesion with the group.

However, whatever causes and factors may work in generating group polarization, the drift of the group toward polarization is a serious problem. In all its forms, it certainly interferes with the groups' ability to think in the right ways. It leads the groups to adopt positions that are increasingly extreme, and thereby make the groups take extremely one-sided disastrous decisions (Baron and Byrne, 2004) and thereby every precaution needs to be adopted by the groups while making decision for settling an issue.

The Phenomenon of Groupthink

Concept and Meaning

Another quite significant phenomenon that interferes with the ability of groups to proceed on the right-thinking path for taking an appropriate group decision is known by the term groupthink. It was first used by Irving Janis in 1972 and was later explained in one of his publications in the manner as follows.

Groupthink as a term may be considered as "a strong tendency for decision-making groups to close ranks, cognitively, around a decision, assuming that the group can't be wrong, that all members must support the decision strongly, and that any information contrary to it should be rejected".

(Janis, 1982)

In this way, the phenomenon of groupthink, once functioning, gives birth to a collective state of mind among the group members. There is now no individual thinking and acting on the part of individual members. In its place, the intention of going with the group decision prevails among the members for maintaining cohesiveness in the group. It is such perception of the term groupthink which had led to defining it as “a mode of thinking adopted by group members in which concern of maintaining group cohesion overrides the motivation to evaluate all potential courses of action as accurately and realistically as possible” (Baron and Byrne, 1996:508).

Groupthink

A strong tendency or a type of collective thinking developed among the decision-making groups forcing the members to believe that their group can never make a mistake in arriving at some decision, resulting in siding with the group with no second thought on their part.

The phenomenon of groupthink also much in the footstep of the phenomenon of polarization and inability to make use of the unique useful information possible from the individual members not only creates a great difficulty in arriving at the appropriate group decision but also has every possibility of proving too costly and disastrous for the interest of the group (Hinsz, 1993). In general, problems created and negative effects produced through the operation of groupthink in the group decision making may be briefed as follows.

- Groupthink forces the group members to think and believe that their group can never make a wrong decision or mistake in arriving at some decision, resulting in siding with the group with no second thought on their part.
- They are found to be the victim of a phenomenon known as collective rationalization, in

which all the members together try to rationalize and go by the group decision by setting aside any information that goes against the group's point of view.

- Under the influence of the phenomenon of groupthink, the group is found to insulate itself from the dissenting views, thus, creating all possibilities for generating an improper and defective decision proving harmful and disastrous for the group.

The Causes Inherent in the Development of Groupthink

The phenomenon of groupthink is found to take its root in the decision-making process of groups on account of some of the reasons highlighted by socio-psychologists in the manner as briefed next.

- One of the most influential factors responsible for the development of the phenomenon of groupthink in the task of decision making on the part of groups is the prevalence of a high level of cohesion among their group members. Such environment of the group leads the group members to develop a collective group mind discouraging the individual members from thinking beyond the decision taken by the group in any situation on an issue. The researches done in this concern have revealed that a cohesive group in comparison to a non-cohesive group easily develops groupthink (Callaway and Esser, 1984).
- Another big reason for the development of groupthink is the emergence of some types of group norms for the conduct of the group members. These norms while driving all the group members to a collective thinking by considering their group as superior and its decisions as infallible seal off any voice of dissent arising within the group and thus push the members not to think of anything beyond what is thought and done by the group. (Kameda and Sugimori, 1993).
- In many of the cases, the role of the group leaders particularly their authoritative and

dictatorial role provides a quite favorable environment for germinating and perpetuating the seeds of groupthink among the groups.

- Sometimes, the development of groupthink is resulted through the phenomenon of collective entrapment – a tendency of groups to cling stubbornly to unsuccessful decisions or policies even in the face of evidence that they are bad ones (Baron and Byrne, 2004:460).
- Groupthink is particularly said to be a product of the environment in which:
 - The group suppresses ideas that are critical or not in direct support of the direction in which the group is moving.
 - The group is denied information or lack the confidence or ability to challenge the dominant views of the group.
 - Group members are found to live in a belief that their group is superior and infallible. It cannot err and therefore it is always wise to go along with its decision.
 - There is no systematic procedure to evaluate the alternatives coming for decision making in the group.
 - The group feels high levels of stress from external threats coupled with the sign of no hope for finding its early proper solution and thus seeks safety in numbers.
 - The groups are found to make use of a system of self-censorship refraining members to comment against the group decision and taking action against the members who dare to do so.
 - The nature of the phenomenon of *groupthink* being progressive and non-resistive also proves a quite influential factor for its development. Once it takes hold in a decision-making group, pressure toward maintaining high levels of group consensus overrides the motivation to evaluate all potential courses of action as accurately as possible leaving the only way to go all along with the group (Janis, 1982).

Measures for Preventing the Occurrence of Groupthink

Groupthink carries a quite damaging effect on the decision-making ability of the groups by arresting the individual critical thinking of the members for supplying needed suggestions for taking the right decision on the part of the group. It, thus, may result in so many bad decisions resulting in too dangerous and disastrous consequences. There should be something to be done essentially for restraining and preventing its occurrence. In this concern, the following measures may prove beneficial.

- The group should try to promote democratic principles in arriving at some decision for the group. In this direction, particularly, it should encourage and promote open inquiry and skepticism among its members (Baron and Byrne, 2004:460). During the decision-making process, the members, thus, should be encouraged to challenge and evaluate the worth of the proposals arriving from one or the other sections of the group irrespective of their number.
- The leaders of the groups on account of their position and a lot of faith entrusted in them by the group members have a quite big responsibility of preventing the occurrence of groupthink. They should always remain impartial in discussion or accepting/agreeing with the proposals of the group members. Besides this, they should always promote and encourage the ideas suggested by the individuals or section of members for bringing alteration and modification in the proposal or viewpoints earlier considered for arriving at some group decision.
- It remains always better to keep an opportunity of reviewing the previously arrived decision on the part of group. The availability of this second chance should be used for asking members to evaluate the merit and demerit of the previously arrived decision, and provide their valuable suggestion for getting it revised, if needed so.
- To prevent the occurrence of groupthink, it is also better to think about the solution of a

felt problem by different sub-groups. For this purpose, the members of the group may be divided into various sub-groups each working independently for arriving at some decision in this concern. Afterwards, all may sit together for discussing and analyzing one another's proposals and then sort out to find the most viable solution by weighing all its pros and cons.

- The devil's advocate technique may also work well in the prevention of the occurrence of groupthink phenomenon. In the use of this technique, one member is assigned to play the role of devil's advocate. He dares to criticize the perspective or decision of the group members by giving his own arguments. It may open a chain of open discussion, accept or reject the earlier arrived group decision or modify and replace it by some improved one.

In this way, there may be a number of problems and pitfalls as just mentioned in the way of taking a final decision by the group for the solution of the felt problem or chocking out a workable plan for executing a group task. However, a determined group under the leadership of a capable leader may always find the ways and means of overpowering all such difficulties coming in his path for serving the interest of the group in a most appropriate way.

To Sum Up

Every group has to indulge in the process of decision making (choose one out of several possible courses of action) for carrying out its one or the other functions. For this purpose, in a democratic setup, they get engaged in the task of arriving at a collective decision by making use of all the available information and taking care of the viewpoints of all the group members. At the end, the work of taking final decision in this concern is carried out by employing one or the other mode such

as consensus, compromise and majority vote, leaving the matter to the leader or arbitrator.

In such decision making in groups, there always remain possibilities for arriving at such group decisions that may prove highly damaging, painful and disastrous in their after effects. It happens on account of the potential dangers and pitfalls inherent either in the process of decision making or in the minds of the decision makers. In this connection, socio-psychologists and researchers have mentioned certain things responsible for this mess such as: biased use of available information in groups; failure to share unique information available to one or the other members of the group; the effect of the phenomenon of group polarization; and groupthink.

The phenomenon of *group polarization* is found to affect the group decision making in a quite substantial way. It may be defined as a general tendency exhibited on the part of the group members to shift their viewpoints towards a position that is similar to but more extreme than the viewpoints held by them before group discussion. In view of socio-psychologists, it happens on account of the phenomenon of social comparison, and perspectives like the persuasive-information perspective and self-categorization perspective.

Another phenomenon known as *groupthink* also affects the group decision making in a quite substantial way. As a term it may be defined as a strong tendency or a type of collective thinking developed among the decision-making groups forcing the members to believe that their group can never make a mistake in arriving at some decision, resulting in siding with the group with no second thought on their part. In view of socio-psychologists it happens on account of the prevalence of a high level of cohesion among the group members; emergence of some types of group norms for the conduct of the group members; authoritative and dictatorial role of

the group leaders; the phenomenon of collective entrapment; and the environment conducive for the emergence of the phenomenon of groupthink.

There is a need of restraining and preventing the occurrence of the phenomenon of groupthink by taking suitable measures like:

- Promotion of democratic principles in arriving at some group decision.
- The need of playing proper role on the part of group leaders to prevent the occurrence of groupthink.
- Providing an opportunity for the review of the previously arrived decision on the part of group through the sub-groups formed for this purpose.

Review Questions

1. What is group dynamics? Throw light on its meaning, concept and basic assumptions.
2. Define the term group and throw light on the meaning and characteristics of groups.
3. Name and discuss the various modes or forms of classifying the groups into their distinct types.
4. What are groups? How do these get formed and developed? Explain.
5. Discuss and describe what makes us join one or the other groups.
6. Explain in detail the process or way of functioning of a group.
7. "The performance of individuals in the presence of others is said to be affected in a considerable way." Evaluate the truth of this statement in the light of the views expressed and research work done by the socio-psychologists.
8. State and describe the phenomena of social facilitation and inhibition.
9. Name the various theories explaining the phenomena of social facilitation and social inhibition and discuss any one of them in detail.
10. Throw light on the following theories explaining the phenomenon of social facilitation: (i) drive theory, (ii) theory of evaluation apprehension and (iii) theory of distraction conflict.
11. What is social loafing? Explain why it occurs and discuss the ways and measures for its reduction.
12. What is de-individuation (mob or crowd behavior)? Discuss the measures taken for getting it restrained.
13. What is decision making? Explain how the task of decision making is performed in groups.
14. Discuss in detail the potential dangers and pitfalls faced in group decision making.
15. Throw light on the following types of potential dangers and pitfalls faced in group decision making: (i) the biased use of available information in the group, (ii) failure to share unique information possessed on the part of some members, (iii) the effect of the phenomena of group polarization and groupthink.
16. What is group polarization? How does it affect the decision-making process in the group?
17. What do you understand by the phenomenon of groupthink affecting adversely the group decision making? Why does it occur and how can it be prevented? Discuss.

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18.

LEADERS AND LEADERSHIP

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- State what leadership is.
- Discuss the traits or qualities of leadership.
- Tell about the types of leaders and styles of leadership.
- Evaluate and differentiate between the task-oriented authoritarian style of leadership and the relationship-oriented democratic leadership style.
- Know and differentiate between the transformational and transactional leaders and their leadership.
- Define the term leadership and throw light on the various theories of leadership such as (i) universal trait theory, (ii) universal behavior theory, (iii) situation specific trait theories of leadership and (iv) situation specific behavior theories of leadership.
- Tell about the path goal theory and life cycle theory of leadership.
- Elucidate the functions of leaders.

Introduction

Every group, whether formal or informal, spontaneous or organized, has a leader. He is the person who manages the group activities and is responsible for intensifying the feeling of belongingness and interdependence among the group members. He persuades the members to feel, think and act together. In fact, the leader is one of the members of the group who, by virtue of his exceptional qualities or unique position in the group, rises to the occasion, influences the behavior of the group and directs the energy of the group to any channel – desirable or

undesirable. The groups get integrated and flourish or get disintegrated and perish as a result of the efficient or inefficient leadership. The family, playing group, hobby club, and business, social or political organizations can make progress or fail in their objectives as a result of the leadership they avail. Therefore, it is essential to know what we essentially mean by the term leadership, what its different types are and the theories running behind it, what the characteristics of a good leader are and what functions leaders are supposed to perform for serving the groups in a proper way. Let us think over these aspects in the present chapter.

What Is Leadership?

In a simple way, by the term leadership we mean all that which is done by the leader of a group for leading his group to function well in order to attain its set objectives. In the pursuit of providing a somewhat formal definition of the term leadership, socio-psychologists and researchers have tried to define it in various ways in the manner as follows.

Katz and Kahn (1966): The term leadership has three major meanings – an attribute of a position, a characteristic of a person and a category of behavior.

Shaw (1976): Leader is that member of the group who exerts more positive influence over others than they exert over him.

Barrow (1977:232): The term leadership might broadly be considered as “the behavioral process of influencing individuals and groups towards set goals”.

Yukl (2002): The term leadership may be defined as “the process through which one member of a group (its leader) influences other group members towards the attainment of specific group goals”.

Reicher et al. (2005): Leadership is a process in which one or more members of the group are allowed to influence and motivate others to help in attaining group goals.

Leadership

A behavioral phenomenon in which somebody from the group chosen or appointed as a leader of the group, is seen performing the task of leading – influencing individual members and the group as a whole for striving to achieve the group goals in the best way possible.

Let us try to analyze the aforementioned definitions to see what they actually want to convey about the meaning and nature of the term leadership.

The first definition, given by Katz and Kahn, tries to convey that leadership of a person in the group is that phenomenon that gets reflected through the specific behavioral activities of a person called leader who is attributed with some specific traits

and qualities (referred to as leadership qualities) and seen to occupy a specific position and importance among the members in the capacity of the leader of the group.

The rest of all the definitions cited consider leadership as a phenomenon or process in which one or more (in the situations of serving specific purposes) members named as leaders are found to influence the behavior of other members to act in a desirable way for attaining the specific group goals.

In this way, the term leadership refers to a behavioral phenomenon or process in which somebody from the group members chosen or appointed as a leader of the group, on the basis of the position enjoyed and qualities held, is seen performing the task of influencing individual members and the group as a whole for striving to achieve the set group goals in the best way possible for him.

The availability of the leadership, in its desirable form, is quite essential and crucial for the effective functioning of the group and it can be possible only when the group is led by somebody competent enough for fulfilling this responsibility. It is why every group, small or big, beginner or experienced, spontaneous or organized, has a leader. A leader knows where the group is going and provides the direction and resources to help it get there. Actually, he is the person who manages the group activities and is responsible for intensifying the feeling of belongingness and interdependence among the group members. He persuades the members to feel, think and act together. The members proving themselves as good leaders provide not only a vision or the motives to strive for the group but also help the members in giving their best for translating the vision into reality. Good leadership, in this way, always remains a big necessity for the success of the groups striving to achieve their specific group goals.

Traits or Qualities of Leadership

Attempts have been made to discover the essential qualities or traits possessed by the different types of leaders. For this, it has been attempted to list the traits of leadership. Parcells and Coplon (1995) made

a good attempt in this direction with the following qualities generally observable in successful leaders.

- Integrity.
- Flexibility.
- Loyalty.
- Confidence.
- Accountability.
- Candor (taking care of who is receiving the message and what the recipients are willing to take in at that time).
- Preparedness.
- Resourcefulness.
- Self-discipline.
- Patience.

In addition to the preceding, Weinberg and Gould (2007) have added to this list certain other mentionable characteristics of successful leaders such as intelligence, optimism, intrinsic motivation and empathy.

But such generalization, however general it may be, does not fit for all types of leaders. There is no single set of skills and personality traits that will make a person always a leader. Leadership, besides the important trait of one's personality, is a function of the situation. Specific situations require specific qualities in a leader. However, in spite of this, the following five characteristics or traits are essential for becoming a successful leader in all situations related to our social and professional life.

1. **Identification With the Group:** The leader must belong to the group he leads. He should have membership character of the group and should be able to make the members feel that he is one of them. He must share the values, attitudes and interests of the group and, thus, try to completely identify with the group.
2. **Superiority Over the Members of the Group:** The leader, while completely identifying with the group and being perceived by group members as one of them, must be able to show his superiority to the group members in the qualities esteemed by them. On account of his superior qualities and virtues, he can be able to

exercise effective control and coordination of the work of the group. Moreover, he can win confidence and cooperation of the members. But he apparently must not be very superior or talented. In such cases, group members do not consider him as one of them and thus do not accept his leadership.

3. **Knowing the Psychology of the Group:** The leader must have an adequate knowledge of group psychology. He should have a functional knowledge of the group mind or group behavior. Moreover, he should be able to utilize his knowledge of group psychology for proper organization and working of his group.
4. **Dynamic and Flexible:** The leader should be dynamic and flexible in his attitude, interests and other behavior patterns. In every case, he must meet his followers' expectations. He must be able to play a democratic or authoritarian role depending upon the need of the situation. He should be able to bring changes in line of action according to the demands of the situation and common wishes of his followers.
5. **Possession of Empathy:** One of the most important talents a leader needs is empathy, that is, an appreciation for and understanding of others' needs. (Empathy includes both the ability to uncover needs and sensitivity to those needs.) The empathic leader is one with the group, is helpful; he is willing to face problems, and has at his disposal a variety of problem-solving tools.

To Sum Up

The term leadership refers to a behavioral phenomenon or process in which somebody from the group members chosen or appointed as a leader of the group, on the basis of position enjoyed and qualities held, is seen performing the task of influencing individual members and the group as a whole for striving to achieve the set group goals in the best way possible.

Regarding the traits or qualities essentially found in the group leaders, socio-

psychologists have tried to point out, in their own ways, a number of personality traits being adjudged as helpful in the task of providing the needed effective leadership to the group members in one or the other situations. In spite of a lot of variation seen on their part in the naming of the traits or qualities of the leadership present among the various types of leaders, there lies unanimity among them that there are five characteristics or traits that are essential for becoming a successful leader in all situations related to our social and professional life. These may be named as: identification with the group; superiority over the members of the group; knowing the psychology of the group; dynamic and flexible; and possession of empathy.

Types of Leaders and Styles of Leadership

Different scholars and authors have adopted different modes for describing the types or styles of leadership availed by the groups for their functioning in the manner as described as follows.

1. In one of the prevalent modes of classification, the leaders are classified into the following four types:
 - (i) **Institutional leaders** like head of the school, district collector, president of a country, manager of a factory, etc. Their orders are obeyed through the hierarchies of ranks and the decisions are based on the established precedents.
 - (ii) **Dominant leaders** like Napoleon, Stalin, Nassir, et al. They lead the group due to an urge to dominate. They are autocrats and dictators.
 - (iii) **Persuasive leaders** like Gandhi, Lincoln and Nehru. They do not aim to dominate and dictate the group but to persuade the members to help and follow them.

- (iv) **Experts** lead the group on account of their acquired proficiency and skill in science, art or any other sphere. They are recognized as the authorities in their respective fields and have a line of followers among the people who are interested in that type of work.

The categories suggested are not mutually exclusive and therefore, “such a classification cannot be said to be a sound classification” (Kuppuswamy, 1971:461–462). Therefore, a more appropriate ground is needed to classify the leaders.

2. According to a **second mode of classification** suggested by the majority of socio-psychologists, the leaders and the styles adopted by them for their leadership may be classified as:

- (i) Task-oriented authoritarian style of leadership.
- (ii) Relationship-oriented democratic style of leadership.

Let us discuss this classification.

Task-Oriented Authoritarian Style of Leadership

The leaders adopting the authoritarian style of leadership are very dominant and aggressive. They are very hard task masters. Their eyes are always on the execution of tasks and attainment of goals on the part of the group members at all cost with the least care of maintaining certain kinds of soft relationship with the members. They believe in determining policies without consulting their followers and dictate every step and assign duties to them at their own count. They do not tolerate any debate and believe in action rather than planning and thinking. They typically forbid direct communication or interaction among their followers. All communication and directions must flow through them. In this way they become indispensable to the followers and the group they lead. In their absence, the group cannot function. All the autocrats and dictators belong to this category.

Task-Oriented Authoritarian Leaders

The leaders who play a dominant authoritarian role by adopting a dictatorial attitude for the execution of the group task on the part of group members.

It has been found that such type of leadership does not care for the wishes and ambitions of the members of the group or followers. It makes the members either submissive or secretly aggressive towards it. Either they depend on their leader entirely and lose all initiative, or they feel frustrated and aggressive towards the leader. While practiced in one or the other group situations – educational, family, community and professional – such type of leadership makes the group members quite dependent and submissive. All decisions with regard to the functioning of the group are always taken by the leader of the group with a least or no say of the group members.

The Relationship-Oriented Democratic Leadership Style

The leaders adopting relationship-oriented democratic leadership style are very cooperative and accommodating. They believe in building and maintaining an environment of cordial relationship with and among the team members. Accordingly, they do not dominate or dictate but persuade the members to follow them and share the power with other individuals in the groups. They win the hearts of their followers and identify themselves completely with the group they lead. They encourage group discussion and collective decision on matters of policy, allow members to choose their own work and also themselves actively participate in the work. They encourage freedom of thought and action and thus cultivate democratic values in the groups. Unlike the authoritarian leaders, the democratic leaders are flexible. They bring desirable changes in their ideas in the light of the needed group changes. They encourage interpersonal relationships and communications

among the members and make them strive hard to achieve the desired objectives. Such type of leadership, when practiced in any project work or a purposeful task being executed on the part of a group, may prove quite conducive and helpful in the development of proper group cohesion, trust and team building among the group members for the effective functioning of the group.

Relationship-Oriented Democratic Leaders

The leaders adopting democratic attitude and believing in building an environment of cordial relationship with and among the group members to seek their willingly cooperation for the execution of the group task in a desired successful way.

The question here may arise – what type of leadership or leadership style, between these two, is more suitable in the functioning of a group? Here we can say that the suitability of a particular leadership style depends upon the needs of the time and circumstances. In other words, it is not the people (leader or members) specific but situation specific. There are times of needs and crises where the autocratic style of leadership is most wanted. However, in a normal situation, it is the democratic style which needs to be more favored for getting out the better outcomes.

3. With a little variation in the preceding classification, a **third mode of classification** suggested and practiced by a number of socio-psychologists classifies the leaders and their leadership styles into three types, namely (i) authoritarian leadership style, (ii) democratic leadership style and (iii) laissez faire leadership style.

Among these three styles, two are the same and similar to those discussed in the second mode of classification under the heading task-oriented autocratic style and relationship-oriented democratic style.

Hence, here we will try to throw light only on the nature of the *laissez faire* leadership style.

The leaders adopting *laissez faire* leadership style are found to be quite relaxed and carefree and thus, play a quite passive role in leading the group. They never take any initiative in providing any suggestion for planning and execution of the group activities and also do not involve themselves in the supervision, evaluation or providing any type of feedback for the work and activities carried out by the group members. In the case of providing needed direction and guidance for the group members – on individual or collective basis – they do so only when approached by the members for the same. In fact, for their own convenience and easygoing nature, they remain always friendly and good for the group members and thus may suit a number of working groups for doing their work with no worry of getting supervised and intervened. In this way, there may exist a possibility of having a pleasant and cooperative environment for the functioning of the group but with the outcomes of low productivity in its return. Consequently, the type of leaders and their leadership style of this kind is a worst possible type of leadership available to the group. When given to the children, by the parents, elders and teachers, it may lead to their spoiling. Similarly, it may prove quite dangerous and damaging to the well-being and functioning of a social, political and business organization.

4. The fourth mode of classifying leaders and their leading styles consists in classifying the leaders into two categories, known as transformational and transactional leaders. Let us discuss these leaders and the type of leadership available from them.

Transformation Leaders and Their Leadership

Transformational leaders, in the tune of their naming, have the guts and capability of bringing a lot of changes in the life of their followers and the society to which they belong by bringing transformation and alteration in their beliefs, attitudes and overall

behavior through their own example, sincere advice and maintenance of an effective communication link with the followers. They are found to exert so influential impact upon their followers to the extent that are supposed to possess some magical powers and it is why they are also designated as the *charismatic leader*.

Transformational Leaders

The leaders who have the ability to inspire and bring transformation in the attitudes, beliefs and overall behavior of their followers for focusing on common long-term goals.

Leaders like Mahatma Gandhi, Jawaharlal Nehru, Abraham Lincoln, Martin Luther King Jr. and Nelson Mandela may be cited as good examples of such charismatic transformational leaders. Let us discuss some of the distinguished characteristics and the positive consequences they may bring in the transformation of their followers and the society. Briefly these are:

- They are found to possess a combination of such personality traits and behavioral functioning that is sound enough to inspire and motivate their followers intrinsically in a quite effective way for achieving their present goals and be a hopeful visionary of their future.
- They are able to exert a quite optimal level of influence of their behavior and personality upon their followers to the extent of getting highly trusted and profoundly admired by them. Besides this, transformational leaders are masters of impression management and thus may very well engage in many actions designed to enhance their appeal to others.
- They possess a unique capacity of individualized consideration, meaning thereby that they are found to pay individual attention to their followers, respect their individuality and care for their needs and interests.
- They are able to provide the needed intellectual stimulation – encouraging group members/

followers to think in novel ways for solving their problems and issues facing them.

- They are attributed with high levels of self-confidence, and confidence in their followers, a higher degree of concern for their followers' needs, excellent communication skills and a stirring personality style (House et al., 1991).
- Strangely, transformational leaders tend to produce two apparently contradictory effects upon the followers; on one hand, they tend to make followers dependent on them, and on the other hand, they empower followers by increasing their self-efficacy and self-esteem (Kark et al., 2003).
- Transformational leaders are able to produce a vision of the future perspective of the people and nation along with a route for attaining it (Howell and Frost, 1989).
- Transformational leadership is able to bring about quite specific types of reactions on the part of their followers such as (i) high levels of devotion, loyalty and reverence toward the leader; (ii) enthusiasm for the leader and the leader's ideas; (iii) a willingness by followers to sacrifice their own personal interests for the sake of a larger group goal; and (iv) levels of performance beyond those that would normally be expected (Baron and Byrne, 2001).

Regarding the overall impact of transformational leaders and their leadership, it definitely may be claimed that no other type of leadership can ever match the impression formation and motivation providing quality and capacity of these leaders in transforming the lives and deeds of their followers. However, the magnificent and charismatic impact of transformational leaders can lead the followers equally well on the constructive and destructive path for making their life bliss or a curse. Along with the bright signs we also have the darkest examples before us when such type of leadership involving blind faith on the leaders have turned into a great catastrophe to the followers and the society as a whole. The leadership provided by Hitler to Nazis and Germany is well known to have pushed the whole world into a war of

great destruction. The incidence of mass suicide by the followers of a sect or preacher are also well before us. As example we may reference the mass suicide by the followers of the Heaven's Gate cult in March 1997 in San Diego, USA, by believing in the claim of Heaven's Gate founder Marshall Applewhite, to have entry into Heaven for doing so.

Transactional Leaders and Their Leadership

Like transformational leaders, transactional leaders are also found to exercise powerful influence upon the followers, but they achieve their goal of leading them in a quite different way, apparently steered through the philosophy of transaction instead of transformation. Transactional leaders do not transform their followers by bringing change in their beliefs, attitudes and overall behavior for getting them inspired and self-motivated for achieving the visionary goals; they simply transact the business of making the followers/subordinates to achieve the set target of the group or organization (quite practical and not visionary) by motivating them through the transaction or exchange of the reward for their good performance and punishment for their poor performance. In their playing of such role, the transactional leaders are seen to be pole apart from the transformational leaders in their relationship with their followers/group members and functioning as a group leader. Let us see how.

- They believe in providing external motivation to their followers/subordinates instead of getting them inspired for remaining internally motivated.
- They are found to provide leadership to their followers/subordinates in a well-structured working environment governed through the well-formed policies, set rules and procedures focusing on the attainment of short-term definite goals.
- They are found to provide a specific type of leadership based on the transaction or exchange between the leader and followers/group members (Homans, 1974).

- They are quite tough and hard task-masters as well as rigid and inflexible in making their subordinates/group members to work according to the scheduled rules. For this purpose, they remain essentially vigilant and alert for making their subordinates fulfill their responsibilities. In this way, as a focused leader, they always execute their leadership in a quite sincere way for becoming instrumental in moving the group/organization towards the attainment of goal.
- Transactional leaders believe in remaining in touch with their subordinates/followers for having needed interaction and transaction with them for making them properly functioning to achieve the group goals.
- Transactional leaders are able to boost motivation, morale and productivity even in the ordinary work settings, where neither the work nor the goals being sought are highly inspiring (Goodwin et al., 2001).

Transactional Leaders

The leaders who believe in the philosophy of transaction – transaction of group business through full dedication and hard work – and set clear short-term goals and reward the group members who are helpful in meeting them.

Such type of leadership may be well located in various areas and fields related to our social and professional lives where we earnestly require a high quality of managerial qualities among the concerned leaders. It is why transactional leadership is also referred to as managerial leadership. The captain, coaches and managers of sports teams; the doctor, the police and defense organizations, CEO and head of the various sections of business establishments; the heads and in-charge officials of various government departments have to play the role of transactional leaders. All of them may be seen to lay down short-term proper goals before their subordinates/group members and emphasize their attainment in the best possible way by maintaining the needed discipline, and caring well for their motivation, evaluation

and feed-back supported through a system of well-graded rewards and punishment.

As far as the overall impact and advantages of this type of leadership is concerned, we may find that it fits well for managing the well-structured and regulated organizations or group of people aimed to achieve the short-term prior set goals within a quite closed and well-defined boundary of their functioning. However, it hardly suits the circumstances where we want to have creativity and ingenuity on the part of the group members allowing them to set their own group goals and work according to their own zeal and enthusiasm for attaining new heights in the horizon of the future as profoundly available in the company of transformational leadership.

To Sum Up

Leaders and their leadership styles may be classified in varieties of ways such as: institutional leaders, dominant leaders, persuasive leaders and experts; task-oriented authoritarian style of leadership and relationship-oriented democratic style of leadership; authoritarian leadership style, democratic leadership style and laissez faire leadership style; and transformational and transactional leaders.

As a whole, however, chiefly we usually witness the presence and functioning of task-oriented authoritarian leaders, relationship-oriented democratic leaders, transformational and transactional leaders in our social setup.

Task-oriented authoritarian leaders true to their naming are the leaders who play a dominant authoritarian role by adopting a dictatorial attitude for the execution of the group task on the part of group members. On the other hand, relationship-oriented democratic leaders are found to adopt a democratic attitude and believe in building an environment of cordial relationship with and among the group members for seeking their willing cooperation for the execution of the group task in a desired successful way.

Transformational leaders, also designated as *charismatic leaders*, have the guts and capability of bringing a lot of changes in the lives of their followers and the society to which they belong by bringing transformation and alteration in their beliefs, attitudes and overall behavior through their own example, sincere advice and maintenance of an effective communication link with them.

Transactional leaders are also found to exercise powerful influence upon the followers, but they achieve their goal of leading them in a quite different way apparently steered through the philosophy of transaction instead of transformation. They put all their energies for transacting the business of making the followers/group members to achieve the set target of the group or organization in a quite practical way for playing the role of a quite functioning and competent leader.

Theories of Leadership

What makes a person develop and be acceptable as a leader of a group? Are the leaders born or made? These are the questions the answers to which have been a matter of serious consideration as well as a subject of discussion and argument. In all, three different approaches have been adopted by scholars and researchers for this purpose implying that (i) leaders are born; (ii) leaders are made, not born; and (iii) leaders are born as well as made. These three different approaches have been responsible for giving birth to a number of specific theories of leadership discussed ahead.

Universal Trait Theory

Universal trait theory of leadership represents a school of thought believing in the theory of royal blood, great men and women or inborn trait approach. Among the leadership theories it is the oldest theory which tries to explain the leadership behavior of the people leading a group or team on the basis of the following specific assumptions and beliefs:

Universal Trait Theory of Leadership

A theory of leadership which, while believing in the notion that leaders are born and not made, holds that there is a universal set of inborn personality traits common to all successful leaders.

- Everybody cannot be a leader. It is specifically reserved for the great men and women who have the inborn traits or tendencies to rule or lead. The great men and women like Chandragupta, Lakshmi Bai – the queen of Jhansi, Shivaji, Winston Churchill, Mahatma Gandhi and Martin Luther King Jr. may be cited as examples of this great men and women or inborn leadership theory.
- Leaders are born and leadership, thus, cannot be developed or infused among individuals. Any attempt for developing it among individuals with one or the other means is futile.
- Since leadership is an inborn trait or tendency, hence a person who is capable of leading in one situation will also be successful in leading in any other situation.
- The so-called inherited personality traits of leadership visible in great men and women are quite universal. Every successful leader, irrespective of the field of the leadership, is found to be endowed with a universal set of personality traits common to all successful leaders.
- There are certainly some specific traits that distinguish leaders from non-leaders. Hence attempts may be made to make a list of the traits that great people/leaders are required to possess.
- The identification of the leaders in one or the other field may be possible objectively with the use of devices like a personality inventory.

However, this theory now stands almost unaccepted for the reasons like:

1. No such genes have been found that may carry the characteristics of good leadership.

2. Although certain traits might be helpful for a leader to have, they are certainly not essential for successful leadership.
3. The traits do not carry universal applicability for being successful leaders in all the fields related to our social life.

Concluding about the failure of this theory for explaining the leadership behavior, Cox (2007:56) writes:

The research work and studies conducted in this concern have now clearly revealed that ‘there is no such thing as a universal set of personality traits common to all successful leaders.’

Universal Behavior Theory

Universal behavior theory represents the thoughts that behavior of leadership is a learned phenomenon just as all other learned social behaviors rather than being inherited, inborn or universal like the universal trait theory. It explains the leadership behavior of the people leading a group on the basis of the following specific assumptions and beliefs:

- There is nothing like inborn characteristics or traits that may be transferable from generation to generation. No person is born with traits or aptitude for leadership.
- There stands nothing like universality of certain traits common to all successful leaders in all pursuits of life.
- In place of traits, there is a presence of a certain specific set of behaviors that helps in distinguishing leaders from non-leaders.
- Successful leaders have certain universal behaviors, such as exceptional work skill, strong work ethic, enriched cognitive understanding of the specific area of their leadership, and exceptional rapport with their group members and people in general.
- Unlike the personality traits that are innate by nature, the behaviors identified as leadership

behavior can be taught to potential leaders everywhere.

- Sincere attempts need to be made for producing the effective leaders simply for the reason that leaders can only be made, they are not born.

Universal Behavior Theory of Leadership

A theory of leadership, which while believing in the notion that behavior of leadership is a learned phenomenon rather than being inherited, emphasizes that in place of traits, there is a presence of a certain specific set of universal behaviors such as exceptional work skill or strong work ethic that makes people good leaders.

This theory is credited to give a lot for the explanation of the leadership behavior of the individuals in one or the other pursuits of our life. However, the weakest link in following the trait and behavior theories for understanding leadership behavior of individuals lies in the fact that these try to emphasize personal factors like trait and behavior at the expense of considering the intersection between the individuals and their situational constraints i.e., denying the due role to the situational factors lying between one's leadership qualities and efforts being made by them for learning the effective leadership behavior.

The consideration for such situational factors in developing leadership has given birth to two types of situation specific leadership theories known as (i) situation specific trait theories of leadership and (ii) situation specific behavior theories of leadership.

Let us discuss these two types of situation specific theories.

Situation Specific Trait Theories of Leadership

The situation specific trait theories of leadership are the theories which try to give equal weight to the personality traits and the specificity of the situation in which leadership is being developed and applied.

In this concern, a leadership theory developed by Fiedler (1967, 1978) through his contingency model provides a good example of a leadership theory that is situation specific but retains the notion of personality traits. The main ideas put forward in this contingency governed theory may be briefed as follows:

- The leadership is contingent or depends on both the variables related to an individual's personality traits and the situation in which leadership is executed.
- Although one's leadership style (associated with his personality traits and characteristics) matters much in the quality and effectiveness of his leadership, the role of situational factor cannot be ignored in any way in all circumstances.
- The suitability or appropriateness of the situation or environment in which one is making use of his leadership style is an essential condition for gaining success as an effective leader.
- The degree of effectiveness of one's leadership is highly contingent on the degree of tuning between his leadership style (associated with his personality traits) and specificity of the situation. It is why some leaders possessing some specific sets of personality characteristics or adopting a particular leadership style may be found to be quite effective in some situations but fail in others.
- The effectiveness of one's leadership depends on two factors: the personality of the leader, and the degree to which the situation is favorable to the leader in terms of having opportunities to exercise power, control and influence over the situation.
- In terms of the personality types the leaders may be of two types: (i) relationship-oriented democratic leaders and (ii) the task-oriented authoritarian leaders. According to Fiedler, relationship-oriented leaders perform best in situations of moderate favorableness, while task-oriented leaders perform best in either favorable or unfavorable situations.
- Since leadership is contingent both on the personality traits and the specificity of the situation or working environment on equal footing, the

efforts for increasing leadership effectiveness need to be done either by bringing changes in the personality traits or modifying the situation or environment. One's personality disposition cannot be easily altered and therefore the most viable alternative lies in modifying the situation or environment to the extent of its favorability to a certain type of leader. Fiedler suggests that this could be done by adjusting some aspect of organizational structure, or looking for leaders who possess personality characteristics consistent with existing structure and situational favorableness.

(Cox, 2007:60)

Situation Specific Behavior Theories of Leadership

The situation specific behavior theories of leadership are the theories which try to give equal weight to the behavior and the specificity of the situation in which leadership is being developed and applied. In this way, the main distinction between situation specific trait theories and the situation specific behavior theories lies in a basic fact that the former (exemplified through Fiedler's contingency theory) insists on looking at relatively stable personality traits as opposed to behaviors for the explanation of leadership behavior of the individuals.

The situation specific behavior theories, thus, in quite a contradiction to the trait theories view leadership as a function of the interaction between leader behavior in a specific situation and the situation itself. A number of such theories have been developed by researchers and scholars in this field to provide an explanation for the effective leadership in one or the other situation. For the illustration purpose let us here now have a brief discussion on the two important theories named path goal theory and life cycle theory.

Path Goal Theory

While providing much significance for the behavior demonstrated by the individual in his leadership, the path goal theory of leadership was popularized by

House (1971). It focuses on attaining the set goals (group and individual) by the concerned members with the support and facilitation arranged by the group leader in one or the other specific work situation. In its structure and functioning, path goal theory is a contingency model, because it is concerned with situational factors that affect leadership. Situational variables of significance in the work-related situation affecting the member's motivation and performance include (i) the personal characteristics of the group members (i.e., personality, ability, locus of control, needs and motives) and (ii) environmental constraints (e.g., the task itself, the formal structure of the working group) etc.

Path Goal Theory of Leadership

A situation specific behavioral theory of leadership focusing on attaining the set goals (group and individual) by the concerned members with the support and facilitation arranged by the group leader in one or the other specific work situation.

The effectiveness of the leader of the group in this theory is adjudged on the basis of the degree of the attainment of these goals. For this purpose, the propagators of the path goal theory advise leaders of groups keep in their consideration the following things:

- They should adopt a democratic attitude in dealing with the group members and play a role of well-meaning catalyst and facilitator.
- The members of the group are guided to be as active and sincere as possible. However, for the purpose of following a path for the attainment of the set goals on the part of the members, this path is well illuminated on the part of the leaders for helping make their journey of the goal pursuit as trouble free as possible.
- The task of illuminating the path of the group members for attaining the group goals is performed by (i) reinforcing the goal attainment

efforts of the members through appreciation and rewards, (ii) reducing or pointing out road-blocks and pitfalls on the path to success, and (iii) increasing the opportunities for personal satisfaction on route to the goal.

For example, if an athlete's goal is to break the state record in an athletic event such as javelin throw or high jump, it is the duty of the coach as a leader to facilitate it for her by arranging a suitable well rewarded training program seeking her full motivation, goal directed behavior and well-intended and satisfying efforts for accomplishing this goal.

Life Cycle Theory

Life cycle theory represents a situation specific behavior approach to leadership that places greater emphasis on subordinates' behavior than on the behavior of the leader (Hersey and Blanchard, 1977). In reference to its use in our social and professional life activities, the main things and features exhibited on the part of this theory may be briefed as follows:

- It focuses more on the behavior of the group members than on the behavior of the leader of the group. Here the level of maturity exhibited on the part of the members in their behavior sets the nature and direction of the leadership behavior adopted on the part of the group leader.
- Here maturity of the working group as a whole or of the members as individuals may be understood in terms of the job maturity and psychological maturity. Job maturity comprises three components: (i) the group's capacity to set and reach goals, (ii) the group's willingness and ability to assume responsibility, and (iii) the extent of group education and experience – in a word, competence. On the other hand, psychological maturity demonstrated on the part of members indicates the level of self-respect, self-confidence and self-esteem that each member brings to the group.

Life Cycle Theory of Leadership

A situation specific behavioral theory of leadership that puts greater emphasis on the behavior of the group members than on the behavior of the leader of the group. Here the level of maturity (job maturity and psychological maturity) exhibited on the part of the members in their behavior sets the nature and direction of the leadership behavior adopted on the part of the group leader.

- According to this theory, the effectiveness of the leader depends on three factors: the maturity of the followers, task behavior and relationship behavior. Maturity may be viewed in terms of motivation, competence and experience. Levels of maturity vary from situation to situation. Task behavior is the extent to which a leader engages in one-way communication to explain what to do, when to do it and how to do it. Relationship behavior is the extent to which a leader engages in two-way communication through social support, psychological “stroking” of followers and other facilitative behaviors. Thus, life cycle theory explores the interplay of the amount of direction (task behavior) provided by the leader, the amount of social psychological support (relational behavior) provided and the maturity level exhibited by followers with regard to group or leader’s goals. (LeUnes and Nation, 2012:154)
- As we know there are two main types and styles of leadership behavior that may be used by leaders for leading the members in one or the other work situations. These are named as task-oriented behavior and relationship-oriented behavior. Where the task-oriented behavior helps them in targeting the group’s goal, the relationship-oriented behavior demonstrated by them proves useful in facilitating positive interaction among the group members. The main feature of the life cycle theory is the development of task-relevant maturity in the group,

essentially the coordination of relationship-oriented and task-oriented behaviors (Hersey and Blanchard, 1977).

- According to this theory, the type of leadership behavior appropriate for any given situation may be mediated by the maturity level of the group members. Accordingly, with an increased maturity visible in the behavior of the members, there arises a need for an increase in the relationship behavior accompanied with a decrease in the task-oriented authoritative behavior on the part of the group leaders. In a more advanced level of maturity visible in the highly experienced and elite level of group members, the leaders are found to assume a consultant role and adopt a negotiating style for making decisions in place of giving directions, and allowing members more independence to get their job done. However, in the case of a lower level of maturity visible in the behavior of the member the cycle needs to be reversed. Here the leader needs to demonstrate a task-oriented behavior in a greater amount with the reasonable balance maintained between his task-oriented and relationship-oriented leadership styles.

To Sum Up

For providing answer to the question, what makes a person develop and be acceptable as a leader of a group, a number of theories of leadership have been put forward.

In this connection, universal trait theory, while believing in the notion that leaders are born and not made, holds that there is a universal set of inborn personality traits common to all successful leaders. On the other hand, the theory known as universal behavior theory, while believing in the notion that behavior of leadership is a learned phenomenon rather than being inherited or inborn, emphasizes that in place of traits, there is a presence of a certain specific set of universal behaviors, such as exceptional work skill, strong work ethic, enriched cognitive understanding of the specific area of their leadership

and exceptional rapport with their group members that makes them good leaders.

Rejecting the one-sided approach of accepting the notion that leaders are born or made, the situation specific theories of leadership, while maintaining a balance between these two extreme views, try to emphasize that the task of leadership development among individuals is situational specific. The situation specific theories of leadership are categorized into two main types: (i) situation specific trait theories of leadership (providing equal weight to the individual's personality traits and the situation in which leadership is executed) and (ii) situation specific behavior theories of leadership (giving equal weight to the behavior and the specificity of the situation in which leadership is being developed and applied). Fielder's contingency model provides a good example of a leadership theory that is situation specific but retains the notion of personality traits. Similarly, the theories named as path goal theory and life cycle theory (providing much significance to the role of behavior demonstrated by an individual in his leadership at one or the other situation) may be referred to as good examples of the situation specific behavior theories of leadership.

performed here by the leaders on this account. These may be such as follows:

- Setting of the group goals, missions and targets for achieving on the part of the group and communicating them well to the members of the group as well as higher authorities if needed in the functioning of the group.
- Doing necessary planning for the place and infrastructure as well as equipment, resources and other facilities needed for the functioning of the group activities.
- Planning about the finances needed and budgetary expenditure incurred in carrying out the group activities.
- Planning for the distribution of roles and responsibilities and work assignments for the performance and functioning of the group activities helpful in achieving the target group goals and missions.
- Planning for the supervision, control and evaluation of the work done or responsibilities being executed on the part of group members in terms of their individual as well as collective contribution.

B. Organizational Functions

What is being planned, as narrated earlier in the list of the planning functions, is set for its proper execution on the part of the group leaders by carrying out the organizational functions at this second stage. The needed activities performed by them on this account may be briefed as follows:

- Having adequate provision of having good communication and exchange of ideas with the members of the group through individual and open channel of group discussion.
- Communicating the policies, programs, group goals and missions, distribution of roles and responsibilities, and expectations from the group members as an individual and team in terms of their contributions and performances in a clear and understandable way.

Functions of Leaders

Leaders are quite important to their group or organization for its existence as well as proper functioning. In playing their role in this respect they are supposed to carry out a number of important functions broadly classified as planning, organizing and controlling functions (Bass, 1990). Sociologists and socio-psychologists working in this field have tried to point out some specific activities performed under these three heads. Let us discuss.

A. Planning Functions

The activities pertaining to any type of planning and policy making for the working of the group are

- Promoting healthy interaction with the members of the group as a group leader and also creating an environment of having good communication, interaction and cooperation among the group members for their team work and cohesion.
- Developing strategies for helping the group for the execution of its activities and functions in a most appropriate way.
- Being helpful to the group members in motivating, inspiring and resolving their inner and inter-group conflicts for keeping them focused on the assigned targets.
- Serving as a representative of the group for having interaction with the external agencies and other social groups/teams functioning in the social environment.

C. Controlling Functions

In all situations of the functioning of a group, it is a matter of great importance to see that what was planned and put under execution on the part of group members for the achievement of group goals is continued or proceeds well along the expected lines. It needs to exercise some well-planned and organized evaluative or controlling functions on the part of group leaders involving the activities of the following nature:

- First, establishing standard of performance for the members of the group for playing their roles in the execution of the group activities for the realization of the group goals and then measuring their performance likewise on these pre-established standards.
- Establishing a hierarchical structure of roles to be played on the part of group members in the execution of the group activities and thus creating junior and senior positions of role-playing providing scope for getting the work done by juniors to be properly supervised through their seniors in the rank.
- Encouraging self-evaluation and controlling of the work done and role played by the individual members in the execution of group activities.
- Having a close watch on the execution of the activities or roles played on the part of group members

as an individual and a team member, to reinforce and reward the proper performance as well as suggest corrective step for the poor or below standard performance of the group members.

- Recruiting new members as well as dropping old members (at the poor show of their performances or neglect of duties) whenever needed so in the interest of the group.
- Serving as an inspirational personality and ideal for the group members for showing the skilled performance in one or the other areas of group activities as well as working as a source of beliefs, and values of the group to the individual members.
- Showing courage for taking blame of the poor performance or any adverse happening in the progress of the group on his shoulders without putting the whole group under the shadow of despair and frustration.

In this way, we can see that the functions of the leaders are quite multi-dimensional in the sense to help them in exercising their role as a leader of the group effectively for achieving the group ideals and stipulated objectives in one or the other situations. To exercise his role and functions in a proper way, however, a leader has to adopt the needed flexibility of becoming traditional or progressive; democratic or autocratic; transactional or inspirational/charismatic, in his approach of leading the group at one or the other times in varying social situations.

To Sum Up

In providing leadership to their group, the leaders have to get engaged in a number of activities and carry out a number of important functions broadly classified as (i) planning functions related to planning and policy making for the working of the group, (ii) organizing functions related to the proper execution of what is being planned and included in the list of planning functions, and (iii) controlling functions related to the proper supervision and evaluation of the task execution activities of the group.

Review Questions

1. What is leadership? Discuss various traits or qualities characterizing a good leadership.
2. Describe and discuss in detail the types of leaders and their styles of leadership.
3. What do you understand by the terms task-oriented authoritarian style of leadership and the relationship-oriented democratic leadership style? Differentiate and distinguish between them in relation to their nature and effectiveness.
4. Who are the transformational and transactional leaders and their leadership? In what ways are they found to be effective and useful for the people they lead in one or the other social situations? Discuss.
5. Define the term leadership and discuss in brief about the following: (i) universal trait theory, (ii) universal behavior theory, (iii) situation specific trait theories of leadership and (iv) situation specific behavior theories of leadership.
6. What are the path goal theory and life cycle theory of leadership? Discuss in brief.
7. "Leaders have to perform a number of specific functions for leading their groups in carrying out the group activities." What are these functions and activities? Describe in brief.

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UNIT VI

SOCIAL ISSUES AND SOCIAL PSYCHOLOGY



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19.

AGGRESSION AND VIOLENCE

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- State what aggression or aggressive behavior is.
- Tell about the types of aggression.
- Know and differentiate between hostile and instrumental aggression.
- Differentiate between the terms aggression and violence.
- Discuss the different types or forms of violent behavior in our social world.
- Discuss (i) bullying (violence involving school mates), (ii) audience or spectator violence in sports, and (iii) workplace violence.
- Explain and evaluate various theories of aggression, namely (i) genetic theory of aggression, (ii) neurological theory of aggression, (iii) hormonal theory of aggression, (iv) psycho-analytical instinct theory of aggression, (v) evolutionary theory of aggression, (vi) frustration theory of aggression, (vii) social learning theory of aggression and (viii) The General Aggression Model (GAM): A Modern Theory of Human Aggression.
- Explain and evaluate the causes or determinants of aggression or aggressive behavior.
- State and evaluate the means and ways employed for the prevention and control of aggression or violence.

Introduction

Aggression and violence have been considered as a great potential danger and damaging acts for the welfare of the individuals and societies. We have the examples of great devastation resulted through the World Wars, especially what happened to Japan after being assaulted by allied forces through atom bombs. Recently, the devastation carried out in war torn countries like Syria, Iraq and Afghanistan may

tell all what can result through aggression and violence committed by one country or society against the other. Similarly, what happens in the name of Naxalites or terrorist activities in one or the other regions of the world may also tell us about the damaging consequences of aggression and violence committed by individuals or groups. Looking at such instances and activities concerning aggression and violence, we must be quite concerned about knowing

about the acts of aggression and violence. Consequently, in the present chapter we will be discussing the definitions, meaning and nature of aggression and violence, their different forms and types, causes, and theories explaining these behaviors as well as the measures adopted for their prevention and control. For this purpose, let us begin with knowing about the aggression or aggressive behavior committed by individuals or groups.

What Is Aggression or Aggressive Behavior?

Many times, you might have heard that one or the other people in your surroundings are very aggressive. By naming them so, people try to comment over their behavior that is very often dominated and colored with the intensity of emotion of anger, resentment, aggression and blind self-assertion. It may be their typical style of reacting and responding to the things, people and situations in their surroundings, at one or the other time, for seeking their adjustment and realization of their goals in their own style. The type of responses reflected in their so named aggressive behavior may include a wide range of undesirable negative behaviors such as rushing someone unnecessarily, behaving rudely and calling names to others, verbally or physically assaulting others, engaging in activities inflicting harm and loss to others, not considering another's viewpoints, needs and feelings while having communication or sharing something with others, always trying to put others down and unnecessarily demonstrating their dominance or superiority over others for one or the other things. This phenomenon is universal and happens in all walks of social and professional life and thus, in fact in other words, aggression is an all-too-common part of our social life (Branscombe and Baron (2017:363). Let us get ourselves acquainted with the nature of such aggression and aggressive behavior of the people, the theoretical perspectives explaining the aggressive behavior, causes of the eruption of such behavior and the ways and means of getting it managed one by one.

Defining Aggression

As a dictionary meaning, we find the term aggression defined in the Merriam-Webster Dictionary (1988:64) in the words: "a forceful action or procedure (such as an unprovoked attack) especially when intended to dominate or master."

In the other literature available in the form of the texts on sports psychology, authors have variously defined it in the manner as follows.

Alderman (1974:225): Aggression is the intentional response a person makes to inflict pain or harm on another person.

Baron and Richardson (1994:7): Aggression may be defined as "any form of behavior directed towards the goal of harming or injuring another living being who is motivated to avoid such treatment".

Bushman and Anderson (2001:274): Aggression is any behavior directed towards another individual that is carried out with the proximate intent to cause harm. In addition, the perpetrator must believe that the behavior will harm the target and the target is motivated to avoid the behavior.

Baron and Byrne (2001:392): Aggression may be defined as "behavior directed toward the goal of harming another living being".

Cox (2007:349): Two factors must be present in order for a behavior to be labeled aggression. First, the behavior must be aimed at another human being with the goal of inflicting physical harm. Second, there must be a reasonable expectation that the attempt to inflict bodily harm will be successful.

Myers et al. (2010:265): Aggression may be defined as "physical or verbal behavior intended to cause harm". This definition of ours excludes unintentional harm such as auto accidents or sidewalk collisions; it also excludes actions that may involve pain as an unavoidable side effect of helping someone such as dental treatment.

LeUnes and Nation (2012:188): Aggression is the infliction of an aversive stimulus on an unwilling victim with the intent to do harm and with the expectation that the act will be successful.

Aronson et al. (2020:420): Aggression is an intentional behavior aimed at causing physical harm or psychological pain to another person.

A close analysis of all the preceding definitions may help us in arriving at the following conclusions about the meaning and nature of the term aggression in context to the aggression demonstrated by the people in their social behavior:

1. As a behavior aggression is used on the part of an aggressive individual to inflict harm or injury to the other individual (a living organism). In the realm of psychology, in this way, aggression directed to someone always involves the living being. Therefore, where punching an individual or animal comes within the definition of aggression, the punching or hitting of any inanimate object such as a chair or railing, etc. is not counted as an aggressive act.
2. The harm or injury caused may be either physical or psychological. In the aggressive act, for example, the acts like deliberately hitting someone in the game of hockey with a stick on the ankles or legs or punching someone at a workplace or hitting them with some physical objects is the infliction of physical harm; purposefully embarrassing the opponent in the game, or a colleague or junior at workplace by saying something hurtful, or intimidating him is counted in the category of psychological harm or injury.
3. The inflicting of harm or injury to the other individual on the part of the aggressive persons always involves the intent of doing so. Aggressive people deliberately and purposefully try to inflict such harm or injury. The harm caused or aggression shown unintentionally on their part is not included in the definition of aggression. Therefore, the incidents like injuring a player unintentionally during athletic participation or team games, inflicting injury to someone unintentionally while colliding with them on a sidewalk, and causing pain to patients during dental treatment are not considered acts of aggression.
4. In committing aggression against others, the aggressors must be found to employ an injury inflicting stimulus with a reasonable

expectation and assurance of fulfilling their objective of harming them. Aggression, thus, is very much a planned and focused attempt on the part of the aggressors aimed to harm the opponent in their own style of attacking. That's why the attacking behavior in which there is no chance for the intended victim to be injured (e.g., aggressor and victim are separated by bars or by teammates in an athletic activity) is not termed, in a true sense, an act of aggression.

5. The individuals towards whom a stimulus (verbal or physical) is used by the aggressive individuals to cause an injury or harm to them are not prepared at all for receiving such treatment. In their mind, there was no reason to expect such undesirable and harmful behavior from the aggressors. Caught unaware in the verbal or physical abuse or assault they are, thus, very likely to be harmed or injured as per planning of the aggressors.
6. Aggression should not be mistaken merely as a simple demonstration of intense feelings or emotions like anger, resentment or anxiety on the part of the aggressor. It is a quite well thought injury involving behavior that may end in the quite damaging consequences for the involved individuals (aggressor and victim) and also to the event going on at that time in a social situation.

The preceding conclusion drawn about the meaning and nature of the term aggression may help us to understand and define it now as follows:

Aggression may be understood as a type of specific behavior on the part of the individuals called aggressor in which they are found to make use of a well thought and planned stimulus (verbal, physical or both) with a clear-cut intention as well as surety for inflicting physical or psychological injury or harm to other people (referred to as victims) who are unwilling as well as unprepared for receiving such treatment from the aggressors.

Aggression

A type of behavior demonstrated by an individual with a clear intention of inflicting physical or psychological injury to another individual.

Types of Aggression

Depending on the nature of the aggression and intention reflected in the aggressive behavior of the aggressors, aggression has been identified to exist in its two distinct forms or types named as (i) hostile aggression and (ii) instrumental aggression. Let us discuss them.

1. **Hostile Aggression:** True to its word meaning, this type of aggression involves a lot of hostility in the behavior of the aggressor towards the victim. Here the aggressor may be seen to make use of verbal or physical stimulus with a sole purpose of inflicting harm or injury to the victim in a verbal or physical form. The intent of the aggressor here is to make the victim suffer, and the reinforcement is the pain and suffering that is caused. The individuals while resorting to this type of aggression aim to harm others with the least care of achieving their goal or success in the task in hand or showing their excellency or superiority over others in that particular social situation.

Hostile Aggression

A type of aggressive behavior that stems from the feelings of anger and resentment and performed by an individual with a sole purpose of inflicting pain or injury to the targeted individual.

A good example of hostile aggression occurs in a cricket tournament when the cricket bowlers throw a high inside fast ball at the batsmen who have angered them. They do so for a clear intention of taking revenge by inflicting injury and making the opponents suffer and thus feel satisfaction on this account. This kind of aggression is often considered quite nearer to the term violence in its nature and consequences.

Instrumental Aggression: In its word meaning, this type of aggression works as an instrumental or

means in the hands of the aggressors for achieving their goal or purpose. In the social world individuals may be seen to utilize this type of aggression for registering their win or success against the individuals or group in competition. Thus, the primary consideration, here for resorting to aggression on the part of the individuals is not to inflict any injury or harm to the opponent (as happens with hostile aggression), but to avail success in their attempts for registering a victory or success against the individuals or group in competition. In comparison to the hostile aggression, instrumental aggression is more commonly utilized by individuals in different social situations especially in the field of sports, business and workplaces for getting ahead of their competitors.

Instrumental Aggression

A type of aggressive behavior demonstrated by an individual with the aim of using it as a means to achieve some goal instead of intending it for inflicting harm on the targeted individual.

It is less condemned than the hostile aggression. However, it may be equally dangerous and harmful to the victims. Take the case of the aggressive acts of the hockey players who while attempting to snatch the ball from the opponents may hit the opponents with their stick and the fast bowlers in cricket in the attempt of getting the opponent batsmen out may throw a dangerous fast ball. In doing so on their part there may arise two situations. In one, the hockey player and cricket bowler may have the hidden motives to inflict injury to the opponent player for clearing the way of success to the team. In the other, they do not have any intention to harm the opponent player, but it may happen in a quite incidental way as expressed by Anshel (1994:144) in the words given here:

The purpose of instrumental aggression is to achieve some goal. Harm or injury to another person might occur accidentally in the process of attempting to reach a goal. For example, an instrumental aggressive act would be to throw the ball inside at a fast speed to intimidate the batter; if the batter is hit, this is viewed as part of the game.

Here the bowler is not necessarily angry or revengeful towards the batter, but sees hitting the batter as instrumental in achieving the team goal of winning the game. However, aggressiveness exhibited on the part of the individuals with the other individuals in their social life or competitive events in any form – hostile or instrumental – has a damaging consequence. It should always be emphasized that aggression is aggression, it is quite unacceptable in any form or types and therefore, it should be discouraged at all levels of social behavior including competitive events.

To Sum Up

As a term, aggression may be understood as a type of specific behavior on the part of the individuals called aggressors in which they are found to make use of a well thought and planned stimulus (verbal, physical or both) with a clear-cut objective of inflicting physical or psychological injury or harm to other individuals (referred to as victims) who are unwilling as well as unprepared for receiving such treatment from the aggressors.

Aggression has been identified to exist in its two distinct forms or types named as hostile aggression and instrumental aggression. In the former type of aggression, the aggressors make use of verbal or physical stimulus to harm and injure others with an intention of making the victims suffer instead of winning or showing their excellency, or superiority over others in one or the other performance areas. The instrumental aggression, on the other hand, works as an instrument or means in the hands of the aggressors for achieving their goal or purpose. The primary consideration for resorting to such aggression on the part of the individuals is not to inflict any injury or harm to the other individuals in their social behavior or competitive event but to avail success in their attempts for registering a win or achievement of their target in dealing with others in the social behavior and competitive events.

Aggression and Violence

As said earlier in discussing the nature and consequences of the type of aggression known as hostile aggression, this type of aggression falls quite nearer to the term violence used in the world of social situations. Both are performed with a sole intention of causing harm or injury to others with a least consideration of serving some other purpose such as achieving the target in a particular work or social situation, winning the game in sport or demonstrating supremacy over others. Both are compulsorily characterized with the presence of certain negative and volatile factors such as anger, resentment, frustration or revenge, etc. However, the amount and intensity of such volatile elements is quite out of proportion in violence in comparison to the aggression of any sort. In addition, there always remain greater opportunities and possibilities of more damages and ill consequences through the outcomes of violence in comparison to the aggression (hostile and instrumental) demonstrated on the part of the individuals in one or the other social situations. However, there is a quite narrow gap between hostile aggression and violence in terms of their nature and consequences. Let us try to search for the inherent distinction lying between aggression and violence. We have known and discussed already about the distinguished features of the term aggression. Let us do it for the term violence.

- It is a type of behavior in which individuals are found, on an individual or collective basis, to get engaged quite intentionally in a behavior aimed to inflict some harm or injury to the other individuals.
- The behavior is merely aimed to inflict injury and getting reinforcement out of the pain and agony suffered on the part of the target subjected to injury and, thus, is not found to have any direct equation or connection with the achievement of any goal or specific purpose such as acquiring sport success on the individual or team level or attaining any business or social success in the encountered social situation.

- The aggressor is seen to demonstrate a quite uncontrolled volatile behavior full of anger and hostile feelings towards the target individual or group in the likewise social situations.
- In the demonstration of such uncontrolled behavior, there is a direct violation of the code of conduct and specified rules and norms prevailing in the social system on the part of the individual or group engaged in violent behavior for inflicting harm and damage to the well-being, life and properties of the target individuals or segments of the population belonging to that social system.

Violence

An unruly unsocial behavior demonstrated by an individual or group in the form of uncontrolled aggression full of anger and resentment towards the target individual, group or a social situation.

In view of the preceding meaning, nature and characteristic features of the term violence we can hereby adopt a workable definition for it in the manner as given next.

Violence may be defined as harm-inducing behavior bearing no direct relationship to the competitive goals of the behavior of the individuals or groups for attaining success in one or the other social situations and relates, therefore, to incidents of uncontrolled aggression outside the rules and norms of a social system, breaking all boundaries of decency and good behavior required on the part of the members belonging to the social system.

To Sum Up

Aggression many times may turn into violence. Both aggression and violence have many things in common such as having an intention of harming and injuring others, and characterized with the presence of certain negative and volatile

elements named as anger, resentment, frustration or revenge, etc. However, harm inducing behavior and the amount and intensity of the volatile elements are quite out of proportion in violence in comparison to the aggression of any sort appearing in the form of out of rules uncontrolled behavior displayed on the part of the violent individuals or groups towards the target individuals, groups or their properties.

Different Types or Forms of Violent Behavior in Our Social World

In general, the prevalence of the following types or forms of violence are more common in the present conflicts ridden world societies including India: (i) domestic violence, (ii) child abuse – violence against children, (iii) sexual violence, (iv) violence committed by Naxalites and terrorists, (v) bullying – violence involving school mates, (vi) audience or spectators violence in sports, and (vii) workplace violence.

In this chapter here we would be discussing the last three types of violence. The discussion about the former four will be taken in the last chapter of this text.

Bullying (Violence Involving School Mates)

The type of violence known by the term bullying usually takes place among class or school mates. In its word meaning, the term bullying stands for a type of behavior committed by a bull – harassing and intimidating others, especially the cow like creatures of its own species. In the school context, it may be defined as an ongoing misuse of power and unwanted aggressive behavior repeatedly demonstrated by the children (called bullies) through their words and deeds to other children (called bullied) with the intention of causing them physical, and/or psychological harm. It has a real or perceived power imbalance in the sense that the bully seems to enjoy more physical strength, is relatively older and stronger in power and position than the bullied and is often assisted and encouraged by the members of their group. Bullying can involve an individual or a

group misusing their power over one or more person. It can happen anywhere at school, travelling to and from school, in sporting teams, or in a workplace and activities going in and outside the school. In its occurrence, it can happen in person or online, and may be obvious or hidden.

Types of Bullying: In its occurrence, bullying may take a variety of forms like:

1. *Physical:* In this type of bullying a child is harmed physically or economically through the bullying acts such as: (i) slapping, hitting, pinching, punching, biting, kicking, pushing and shoving; (ii) locking in a confined space; (iii) doing things to get one in trouble; (iv) excluding from a group; (v) unwelcome touching; (vi) taking things, snatching or damaging belongings; and (vii) extortion.
2. *Verbal:* In this type of bullying a child's feelings are hurt through the bullying acts like: (i) name-calling, (ii) threatening and intimidating, (iii) unwelcome teasing, (iv) taunting, (v) spreading rumors, (vi) gossiping and (vii) racist or racial comments.
3. *Written or Online Bullying:* In this type of bullying a child is threatened, harassed or intimidated by the bullying acts like: (i) threatening notes and letters, (ii) making silent or abusive phone calls, (iii) sending insulting or threatening text messages, (iv) publishing someone's personal or embarrassing information online and (v) creating hate sites or starting social exclusion campaigns on social networking sites.

Audience or Spectator Violence in Sports

Spectators or members of the audience committing violence can be found in all sports not just the one or the other. Moreover, the phenomenon of sport violence is quite universal. It occurs all around the globe in competitive games and sport events. However, a few events and places like the football matches in the European countries are quite notorious in witnessing spectator violence involving enormous damage and harmful consequences.

The Nature and Types of Audience or Spectator Violence in Sports

The spectators and fans of sports are found to indulge in the activities and acts of violence generally of the following nature and types.

- Verbally abusing, taunting and teasing, putting racial remarks on the players of the opponent team.
- Giving threats of physical harm or actually inflicting physical harm and injuries to the players, coaches, referees and umpires.
- Expressing disagreement with the decisions and judgments of the referees and umpires not suited to their favorite team in a verbal and physical ways.
- Engaging in acts and behavior of violence to scare opponents.
- Committing aggression and violence to express loyalty to a team or anger at its performance.
- Giving threat and committing act of violence against the fans or spectators of the opposing teams.
- Engaging in the dual of blaming, abusing, criticizing and blackmailing the opponent players, teams, coaches, referees and umpires in face-to-face meeting and also on the coverage of media and social network.
- Engaging in riots or altercations in a routine way as an adopted tradition for settling scores with the opponent players or teams having age-old rivalries and history of clashes.

Workplace Violence

In its word meaning, the term workplace violence stands for the type of violence occurring in work settings or job places. According to Neuman and Baron (1998) workplace aggression/violence can be defined as any form of behavior through which individuals seek to harm others at their workplace.

Types of Workplace Violence: In general, we can divide the workplace violence into two major types or categories – overt and covert. Let us examine them.

Overt Violence: The overt violence at the workplace represents that type of workplace violence in which a perpetrator of violence is engaged in committing the most provocative direct physical and psychological attack on the target – colleagues or administrators – with a purposeful intention of harming them to the extent of taking their lives. The incidences of shooting, physically assaulting, calling names and insulting rudely before others in the workplaces may be cited as examples of such workplace aggression or violence. However, the occurrence of such direct overt aggression at the workplace with colleagues and administrators is quite rare. In these incidences, while some employees may indeed be the victims of such harmful and alarming physical assault including murder, vastly larger numbers are on the receiving end of less dramatic forms of aggression/violence, which is covert in nature (Bjorkqvist et al., 1994).

Covert Violence: Covert violence, in reference to its occurrence at workplaces, may be known and defined as the type of violence occurring at the job site which is covert in its nature rather than being overt – inflicting a direct harmful physical or psychological attack on the target. Arnold Bush (1961) has identified its three basic characteristics named and explained as follows:

- It tends to be verbal rather than physical and thus involves efforts to harm others through words rather than deeds.
- It is displayed in an indirect way rather than direct. It means that instead of its direct delivery to the victims, it is inflicted on the victims through indirect means such as through the actions of other agents or through assault on persons or objects valued by them (e.g., damage to the victims' property, family or friends).
- It is passive rather than active in its nature and consequences. It means that in committing such type of aggression or violence, one is seen to inflict harm on others by withholding some action rather than actively performing an action causing harm to them.

In this connection, Barclay and Aquino (2010), through their research work, have also concluded that, in most instances, workplace aggression or violence involves quite subtle behavior, such as (i) spreading negative rumors about their targets, (ii) reporting that they are getting ready to move to another company and taking important secrets with them or that they have engaged in unethical, if not illegal actions, (iii) removing equipment or resources the target people need to complete their work, (iv) expressing disapproval of projects the target people favor and (v) destroying the personal property and causing harm to their kith and kin.

While commenting further on the nature of aggressive or violent behavior shown by the people at the workplace, Barclay and Aquino (2010) also claim that in aggressing against others at work, most people follow a “cost-benefit” rule. They attempt to do the most harm to the victim while at the same time ensuring that they cannot be identified as the source of this harm (Branscombe and Baron, 2017:392).

To Sum Up

In our social world, we may witness the occurrence of the violent behavior in its so many forms. Among these, *bullying*, mostly occurring in school situations, may be defined as an unwanted aggressive behavior repeatedly demonstrated by the children (called bullies) through their words and deeds to other children (called bullied) with the intention of causing them physical, and/or psychological harm. Bullying can involve an individual or a group misusing their power over one or more person. In its occurrence, it can happen in person or online, and may be obvious or hidden.

The type of violence known as *audience or spectator violence* refers to one or the other type of violent activity on the part of people directed at players, officials or fellow spectators. Types of spectator violence include verbal abuse, the throwing of missiles (such as bottles), property destruction and physical

assaults. It is universal and occurs all-round the globe in a number of competitive individual and group games and activities.

Workplace violence is also quite common and universal, occurring all around the globe in work settings or job places. In terms of its definition, it can be referred to as any form of violent behavior through which individuals seek to harm others in their workplace. It is also seen that while aggressing against others at work, most people follow a “cost-benefit” rule. They attempt to do the most harm to the victim (colleagues, officials, organization) while at the same time, ensuring that they cannot be identified as the source of this harm.

Theories of Aggression

Theories of aggression represent the types of approaches adopted by researchers and psychologists for providing one or the other types of explanations for the aggression of individuals in their social life. As a whole, these approaches, may be classified into two categories, namely biological and psychological approaches. All the important theories of aggression owe their origin and development in these two approaches. We may classify them as follows.

A. The Theories Adopting Biological Approach:

In the category of theories adopting biological approach for the explanation of aggression we may put the theories like: (i) genetic theory of aggression, (ii) neurological theory of aggression and (iii) hormonal theory of aggression.

B. The Theories Adopting Psychological Approach:

In the category of theories adopting psychological approach for the explanation of aggression we may put the theories like: (i) instinct theory of aggression, (ii) ethological theory of evolution, (iii) frustration theory of aggression and (iv) social learning theory of aggression.

Let us now discuss all these biological and psychological theories in brief.

Genetic Theory of Aggression

Like other personality characteristics, attempts have been made to blame one's heredity or genetic composition for the criminality and aggression of the human beings. For this purpose,

1. Researchers have tried to provide evidences from the animal world – the breeding of the fighting cocks, fighting dogs and fighting bulls, etc. However, no such demonstration could be carried out for human species.
2. They have also tried to link male aggression/criminality with some chromosomal abnormality like the presence of XYY in many of the criminals by hypothesizing that chromosomal abnormality predisposes some males to aggressive/criminal behavior.

Genetic Theory of Aggression

A theory of aggression conveying that the aggressive behavior and the acts involving violence and criminality are the products of one's heredity or genetic composition loaded with the characteristics of these behaviors.

However, the researches carried out in the field of genetics and development of personality and behavioral characteristics by the host of researchers have ruled out the role of genetic composition and affirmed that delinquency, aggression or criminal behavior cannot be attributed to any type of genetic composition. The aggression shown by individuals in their social behavior neither runs in families nor does it follow the heredity law of “like begets like”.

Neurological Theory of Aggression

According to this theory the neurological functioning of the individuals has a direct relationship with their ability to modulate their behavior, especially the capacity of resisting their impulses, and understand the consequences of their performed behavior. Where the healthy functioning of their neurological structures, such as hypothalamus, the limbic system

and the temporal lobe helps them to exercise control over the aggression arousal, the unhealthy functioning or impairments in the neurological functioning may result in pushing them towards the unrestricted aggressive behavior.

In this connection, based on their studies, researchers have tried to demonstrate that aggression is generally associated with impairments in several neurological/cognitive systems, typically, the abilities to resist impulses, to modulate behavior and to understand the consequences of the performed behavior in one or the other situations. The neural basis for these cognitive skills resides in the prefrontal cortex. In general, in human beings the neurological structure named as the prefrontal cortex serves to modulate behavior including the suppression of aggressive impulses. By contrast, individuals with impairment of prefrontal function may have several abnormalities resulting from their inability to control impulses and these are the individuals who have all possibilities of getting engaged in aggressive acts. In this connection, imaging studies, both structural (MRI) and functional (PET), have shown high rates of abnormality in aggressive people with reduced volume and metabolism of the prefrontal cortex. The causative role of impairment or malfunctioning of the neurological systems has been further supported by the clinical studies of people with brain damage. In a number of observations, it has been noticed that people with prefrontal brain injuries demonstrate higher levels of aggression than that which they had shown before the injury.

Neurological Theory of Aggression

A theory of aggression insisting that aggression is the outcome of some or the other types of impairments in one's one or the other neurological/cognitive systems and their functioning.

However, with all such evidences and high claims, it should not be concluded that every person suffering from impairments or malfunctioning of the neurological or cognitive systems should necessarily be aggressive in his behavior or vice versa. Actually,

the pathology concerning one's cognitive or neurological structures has not been found a necessary and sufficient condition for causing violence or aggressive behavior and therefore the usability of the neurological theory for explaining aggression has now been almost rejected.

Hormonal Theory of Aggression

According to this theory, aggression in individuals is resulted through the imbalances caused in the secretion of hormones by their endocrine glands. One of such suspected big hormonal culprits in males is testosterone, the male sex hormone (which is 10 times higher in males than females). Commenting on the nature and role of testosterone, in causing aggression among humans, Widmeyer et al. (2002:354) write:

Testosterone is a male steroid hormone that rises sharply when boys hit puberty. Seen apparently as a body energizer, its increased level has been linked with the tendency to aggress, fighting and violence. A number of athletes are often found to take the heavy doses of this steroid for the maximization of their arousal level and excitement in the competitive sport acts. The doses can be taken in the form of testosterone gels, patches, pellets and injections.

Hormonal Theory of Aggression

A theory of aggression asserting that aggression in individuals is resulted through the imbalances caused in the secretion of hormones by their endocrine glands.

However, research work carried out for establishing a relationship between endogenous testosterone levels and aggressive behavior has concluded in negative by asserting that the relationship is not consistent. The doses of testosterone taken by athletes may help them as a good body energizer and arousal agent but it cannot be said that it definitely will lead them to aggression. It may cause certain individuals to be aggressive, but for them also, it is difficult to explain

why they are aggressive in some situations and not in others. Moreover, it also becomes harder to explain why the athletes possessing little or lower level of testosterone, for example, female athletes, can be aggressive. In this way, the hormonal imbalances cannot be said to be the necessary and substantial cause for the aggressive or violent behavior of the athletes.

Psycho-Analytical Instinct Theory of Aggression

As the main propagator of this theory of aggression, we can name the famous psychologist Sigmund Freud (1925, 1950). Let us examine his views in this regard.

- According to Freud, we all are born with two powerful instincts named as (i) Eros – life wish, manifesting itself in the sex drive; and (ii) Thanatos – death wish, manifesting in the need to aggress. Where the former (life wish) helps in living the life in full, the latter (death wish) involves self-destructiveness. The individuals prefer to get aggressed and harm others for a simple reason that the harm to oneself may be avoided by aggressing against others. The tendencies toward self-destruction and harm avoidance are, thus, absolutely instinctual and universal.
- According to Freud, in all situations, aggression is an innate or inborn behavior caused through an instinct of aggression found in living beings including humans. Accordingly, people have an innate instinct to be aggressive. It can either be expressed directly by inflicting injury and harm to others or be displaced through catharsis, blowing off the pent-up aggression through the socially acceptable means such as sport.
- In advancing the catharsis use of the instinctive aggression, the propagators of instinctive theory, including Freud, have emphasized that aggression helps the individuals to provide a way or process of releasing the pent-up emotions or tension in productive or socially acceptable channels such as getting aggressive in competitive sports or marketing the products in the highly competitive business world.

Instinct Theory of Aggression

A theory of aggression, propagated by psychoanalysts and mainly by Freud, conveying that aggression is an innate or inborn tendency in the name of death instinct found among humans.

However, as far as the validity and usefulness of the instinctive theory for explaining the aggression is concerned, we may see that in this age of widespread recognition of the existence and power of reason and volition it has quite little support and use. Researchers and users have pointed out about the drawbacks of instinctive theory in the manner as follows.

1. Unfortunately, no biological innate aggressive instinct has ever been identified (Weinberg and Gould, 2007:537).
2. Instinctive theory also fails to account for the variations in aggressiveness from person to person and culture to culture. How would a shared human instinct for aggression explain the difference between the peaceful Iroquois before white invaders came and the hostile Iroquois after the invasion. Although aggression is biologically influenced, the human propensity to aggress does not qualify as instinctive behavior (Myers, 2010:267).
3. The ongoing researches have also contradicted the claim of the catharsis value of the aggressive behavior. In this connection, Berkowitz (1965:328), while making the field of sport as an illustration case, has concluded that “sport has considerable value for our society, but we should not justify it as a safe outlet for the pent-up violent urges”.

Evolutionary Theory of Aggression

Ethologists such as Ardrey (1966) and Lorenz (1966) are said to be the main propagators of this theory. According to the evolutionary social psychologists, social behavior has evolved over time, passed down from generation to generation (Simpson and

Kenrick, 1997). In support of such evolution, they argue that most probably, this instinct developed during the course of evolution because it yielded many benefits. For example, (i) aggression and fighting serves to disperse populations over a wide area, thus, ensuring maximum use of available resources and (ii) human beings have the same need to aggress as other living beings. They need it necessarily for their security, protection and survival, and it is why nature has favored them with the gift of an instinctive behavior known as aggression. It persists because it facilitates survival of the species. Armed with the instinctive weapon of aggression, birds and animals may be found to demonstrate an inherent tendency to drive intruders out of their chosen territory, and since it is often closely related to mating, such behavior often helps to strengthen the genetic makeup of a species by ensuring that only the strongest and most vigorous individuals manage to reproduce.

The evolutionary perspective of explaining aggression in humans is attacked on account of some serious limitations and fallacy such as: (i) It is not possible to have experimental evidences for testing validity of the development of evolutionary tendencies being developed over many thousands of years, and (ii) in general, we do not turn up aggressive only for protecting ourselves or our offspring from others but also often show aggression towards our nears and dears or close relatives.

Evolutionary Theory of Aggression

A theory of aggression conveying that aggression is an innate tendency or driven behavior that has been evolved in the human beings over time.

Frustration Theory of Aggression

Frustration, as we know, represents a feeling of helplessness that develops within individuals when one or more of their motivated or goal-directed behaviors are blocked and they are deprived of getting success or realizing their target. In this situation, they are found to feel a lot of resentment and anger that can

push them to engage in an aggressive behavior. This is the basis of the frustration theory of aggression, first proposed by Dollard and his colleagues at Yale University in 1939, on the eve of World War II. According to frustration theory of aggression, "people's perception, that, they are being prevented from attaining a goal will increase the probability of an aggressive response" (Dollard et al., 1939). In its original version, this theory is said to make the following two bold assertions in its explanation of people's aggression.

1. Frustration always leads to some form of aggression.
2. Aggression always stems from frustration.

However, the viewpoint put forward in this original version of frustration theory soon came under attack by arguing that:

- The assertion that frustration always leads to aggression is not true. Not all frustration leads to aggression. Research and experience repeatedly show that:
 - (i) People often cope with their frustration or express it in non-aggressive ways.
 - (ii) In a number of cases, frustration may lead to depression and a withdrawal behavior.
- Another limitation is the assumption that if aggression is the response to frustration, then the release of this frustration, through competing in sports or watching a violent movie, should have a cathartic effect. However, this outcome has not been supported in the literature. In fact, research has shown that aggression often increases rather than decreases after subjects get into aggression or observe others engaging in aggressive activity (Anshel, 1994:151).

Revised Version of Frustration-Aggression Theory

In a reformulation of the frustration-aggression theory Leonard Berkowitz (1978, 1989) realized that the original version of the frustration-aggression theory

put forward by Dollard et al. (1939) overstated the frustration-aggression connection, so he went on for its revision. In its revised version, Berkowitz theorized that although frustration does not necessarily result in aggression, it is quite capable of creating a readiness or heightening the predisposition for aggression. For aggression to actually occur, certain stimuli associated with aggression must be present. These stimuli are cues that the frustrated person associates with aggression. An example of this phenomenon in animals according to Cox (2007) would be the “red flag” for the enraged and frustrated bull. In the presence of frustration, certain stimuli can serve as “triggers” to release a predisposition toward aggression in a frustrated individual.

The newer version recognizes that certain aggression could have causes other than frustration and that frustration could lead to behaviors other than aggression (e.g., withdrawal). It further conveys that the response to frustration can be modified by learning. Thus, an individual can learn to have some other, more productive and less aggressive response to frustration. Berkowitz (1989) even went so far as to accept the idea that a cognitive evaluation of the situation influences the extent to which frustration produces these negative feelings. People feel upset and attack their frustration causers after analyzing that the outcomes are not merely accidental and they have been deliberately and wrongfully kept from attaining their goal. In this way, increased arousal and anger triggered by frustration result in aggression only when socially learned cues signal the appropriateness of aggression in the particular situation. If the social learned cues signal that aggression is inappropriate, it will not result. For example, if a hockey player is frustrated due to the foiling of his chances of reaching the ball through a cleverer game of an opponent, he might resort to aggression of inflicting some harm to him, if he went unpunished for the similar behavior on the previous occasions. However, if he has learned that he will have to pay a heavy price for his undesirable action, the aggressive behavior is much less likely to occur.

In spite of getting more support than the original theory, the revised theory put forward by Berkowitz also has its limitations. The researches as well as experiences

of aggressive social behavior of individuals in different social situations have failed to necessarily suggest that frustration is always followed by aggression.

Frustration Theory of Aggression

A theory of aggression which in its original form (proposed by Dollard and his colleagues) conveys that all of our aggression is the result of frustration and that frustration always leads to aggression. However, now in its revised version (put up by Leonard Berkowitz) it conveys that it is not necessary for frustration to result in aggression and aggression does not carry frustration as an only cause for its occurrence. Our increased arousal and anger triggered by frustration result in aggression only when socially learned cues signal the appropriateness of aggression in the particular situation.

The Social Learning Theory of Aggression

According to this theory of aggression, aggression much like other social behavior is a learned phenomenon. It has the roots in learning theories and perspectives like classical and operant conditioning and most predominantly in “the social theory of learning” put forward by the eminent psychologist Albert Bandura (1973). In his social learning theory, he has emphasized that most of what we learn is acquired through observational vicarious learning (learning through indirect experiences) rather than the learning based on direct experiences. From the very beginning from our childhood, we learn and imbibe negativity or positivity in our behavior exactly on the lines what we observe in the behavior of the persons considered ideals for us like our parents, members of the family, companions, teachers, or characters and heroes watched over the television and movie screens.

The same is true for learning aggression on the part of the elderly persons from the social situations arising in their elder life. The aggressive behavior is learned and acquired by them by observing the behavior of their role models in one or the other social field. The process of such observational learning on the part of an individual, thus, just begins with watching the

role models behave aggressively in one or the other social situations. This behavior gets imitated as there is a strong tendency among humans to imitate a behavior which attracts or serves their purpose. As a result, the individual behaves aggressively in the same way in a similar social situation as watched by him in the behavior of his role model. After imitation, the next role for learning aggression on the part of an individual is played by him depending on the type of reinforcement he receives for his imitative behavior. If he is checked and punished for his aggression, then the story of its learning, i.e., imbibing in the behavior of the athlete ends. But if his aggression is tolerated, gets unnoticed or appreciated on the part of his fellow beings, or spectators helps in the success or win, then it has all possibility of getting imbibed by him in his social behavior. In this way, according to social learning theory, aggressive behavior in social life on the part of the individuals is acquired in two consecutive phases, first by modeling (observation and imitation of the behavior of models) and then its subsequent positive reinforcement. Reinforcement or reward received on an initiated aggressive behavior matters much in the learning of aggression because it has enough capability to convey or teach the principle that “aggression pays”.

In addition to what the individuals learn through direct experiences (by remaining present and witnessing the events in the social situations), the learning of aggression through watching of the aggressive behavior of a role model can also go on effectively with the help of vicarious (indirect) experiences such as (i) watching their aggressive behavior on the television, computer or movie screen; and (ii) its subsequent consequences – rewarding or punishing.

The Social Learning Theory of Aggression

A theory of aggression originated from Bandura's social learning theory emphasizing that most of what we learn (including the aggressive behavior) is acquired through our observational learning i.e., observing and imitating the behavior of the people considered role models by us.

Simply stated, thus the social learning theory says that people will learn and/or perform a behavior that they believe will bring them a reward, either because they have been rewarded in the past for performing a similar behavior or because they have seen others rewarded for performing that behavior. This viewpoint proposes that people learn not only how to aggress, but also when and against whom to aggress (Widmeyer et al., 2002:363).

The Bobo Doll Experiment (Bandura et al., 1963):

Stanford University professor Albert Bandura wanted to put the social learning theory into action. For this purpose, he along with his colleague performed an experiment with Baby doll (a blow-up toy in the shape of a life-size bowling pin). For conducting experiment, Bandura and his two colleagues selected 36 boys and 36 girls between the ages of 3 and 6 from the Stanford University nursery and split them into three groups of 24. One group watched adults behaving aggressively toward the Bobo doll. In some cases, the adult subjects hit the doll with a hammer or threw it in the air. Another group was shown an adult playing with the Bobo doll in a non-aggressive manner, and the last group was not shown a model at all, just the Bobo doll. After each session, children were taken to a room with toys and studied to see how their play patterns changed. In a room with aggressive toys (a mallet, dart guns and a Bobo doll) and non-aggressive toys (a tea set, crayons and plastic farm animals), Bandura and his colleagues observed that children who watched the aggressive adults were more likely to imitate the aggressive responses. The results of the study highlighted how children learn behaviors from observing others.

The General Aggression Model (GAM): A Modern Theory of Human Aggression

A quite new and advanced theory of aggression, based on social learning perspective, has been presented by Anderson and Bushman (2002) through a

model named by them as General Aggression Model (GAM). Let us examine it.

According to the General Aggression Model (GAM) presented by Anderson and Bushman, there are two sets of factors that are responsible for initiating aggressive behavior at their own separately or in combination. These may be named as (A) situational factors (factors relating to the current situation) and (B) personal factors (factors relating to the people involved).

A. Situational Factors: In this category of factors or variables, influencing aggressive behavior, we may include the factors or variables such as:

- (i) Frustration.
- (ii) Some kind of provocation from another person (e.g., an insult).
- (iii) Exposure to other people behaving aggressively (aggressive models – real or those shown in the media).
- (iv) Anything that causes individuals to experience discomfort – such as high temperature, physical pain, drill, disrespectful treatment and even a boring classroom lecture or public address.

B. Personal Factors: These factors or variables represent the variability of different kinds found among human beings. Some of the personal factors that are known for causing aggression in us are as follows:

- (i) Traits that predispose some individuals towards aggression (such as high irritability, antisocial personality, impulsivity, etc.).
- (ii) Attitudes and belief about violence (e.g., believing that it is acceptable and appropriate).
- (iii) A tendency to perceive hostile intentions in others' behavior.
- (iv) Specific skills related to aggression (e.g., knowing how to fight or how to use various weapons).

According to the General Aggression Model, these two sets of factors – situational and personal – in

turn, lead to overt aggression through their impact on three basic psychological processes – arousal, affective states and cognition.

- In connection to the arousal impact of the situational and personal factors it is seen that there is a great possibility of experiencing increase in physical arousal or excitement resulted through the influence of these factors.
- With regard to their impact on the affective states of ours, it has been noted that they can very well arouse hostile feelings and outward signs of these (e.g., angry facial expressions) among us for initiating aggressive behavior on our part.
- In their impact on the cognitive functioning of ours, they can induce us to think hostile thoughts or may bring beliefs and attitudes about aggression to our mind.

Depending on individuals' interpretations (appraisals) of the current situation and restraining factors (e.g., the presence of police or the threatening nature of the intended target person), they then engage either in thoughtful actions, which might involve restraining their anger, or impulsive action, which can lead to overt aggression actions (Branscombe and Baron, 2017:368).

Further Attempt of Modifying the Modern Theory of Human Aggression

The US socio-psychologists C.A. Anderson and B.J. Bushman (2002) have presented a modified form of their theory of aggression for explaining why people exposed to high levels of aggression, either directly or indirectly, tend to become increasingly more aggressive. In this connection, as reported by Branscombe and Baron (2017:368–369), they argued that:

Repeated exposure to the stimuli such as viewing aggressive or violent actions of others directly or indirectly in films and video games, serves to strengthen *knowledge structures* related to aggression – beliefs, attitudes, schemas, and scripts relevant to aggression. As these knowledge

structures related to aggression grow stronger, it is easier for these to be activated by situational or person variables. As a result, the people in question are truly *primed* for aggression.

GAM: A Modern Theory of Human Aggression is known to be a quite bit more complex in its understanding than earlier theories of aggression put forward by the thinkers and socio-psychologists in this concern. With its complexity, however, it is well recognized and accepted fully as a good theory representing and reflecting fully the latest progress in the field in providing a widely accepted psychological explanation for the aggressive behavior of the people, in general. Through its model supported by theoretical explanation, it properly tries to emphasize that there lies a proper link between what people think and what they actually do. In addition, it possesses enough potential for providing an accurate picture of the nature of human aggression much more than any of the earlier aggression theories. Indeed, as Bushman et al. (2016) emphasize, it has proven very valuable in terms of helping us understand the many causes of various forms of aggression.

To Sum Up

The General Aggression Model (GAM): A Modern Theory of Human Aggression (presented by Anderson and Bushman) conveys that there are two sets of factors – situational (related to the current situation) and personal (related to the people involved) – that are responsible for initiating aggressive behavior among the people. These two sets of factors, in turn, lead to overt aggression through their impact on three basic psychological processes: (i) arousal (increase in physical arousal or excitement), (ii) affective states (arousal of hostile feelings and their outwards signs), and (iii) cognition (bringing hostile thoughts, beliefs and attitudes about aggression in mind).

In their attempt of modifying this theory, the US socio-psychologists C.A. Anderson and B.J. Bushman have presented a modified form of their theory of aggression by saying,

“Repeated exposure to the stimuli such as viewing aggressive or violent actions of others – directly or indirectly strengthens our *knowledge structures* related to aggression. When this acquired knowledge structure of ours gets activated by situational or person variables, it leads to our aggressive behavior towards others.”

Causes or Determinants of Aggression or Aggressive Behavior

What causes individuals or groups to behave aggressively in one or the other social situations has been investigated and researched on the part of sociologists and socio-psychologists since a quite long time resulting in arriving some valid causes grouped into three broad categories, namely (A) Personal Factors or Determinants of Aggression, (B) Socio-cultural Factors or Determinants of Aggression, and (C) Situational Factors or Determinants of Aggression.

Let us discuss all of these causes or factors, falling in these three broad categories one by one.

A. Personal Factors or Determinants of Aggression (Causes Lying Within the Individual)

There are certain things lying within the individuals in their biological and personality makeup as well as in their habits or ways of living that may be held more responsible for inciting or aggravating the factors causing aggression on their part in social behavior related situations. We may name and discuss them as follows:

1. **Personality Makeup:** One's personality makeup is an important determinant of aggressive behavior. The researchers have concluded some of the following things in this concern.
 - (i) *The Type A Personality:* According to the psychologists Meyer Friedman and Ray Rosenman, the people in our social world may be classified as the people having A-type and

B-type personality. While the people having A-type personality are typically ambitious, high achieving, competition conscious and perfectionists in their behavior patterns, those having B-type personality are relaxed, uncompetitive and adjusted to one's self and others. The researchers while working with the individuals having A- and B-types of personalities have established that the people having A-type personality are more susceptible to aggression in comparison with those having B-type personality (Carver and Glass, 1978; Baron et al., 1985). In this regard, researchers like Dodge and Crick (1990) have further shown that the Type-A people with their established aggressive behavior patterns may interpret an ambiguous situation as deliberately provoking and as a result may be found quite often to demonstrate a hostile behavior pattern.

(ii) *The Role of Some Particular Personality Traits*: The researchers in this concern have concluded that in certain people their attribution of certain specific personality traits (in a relatively excess amount) may work as a potent cause for pushing them towards aggression (Caprara et al., 1994; Caprara et al., 1996; Gleason et al., 2004). In the case of individuals prone to aggression it may work as follows.

- **Irritability**: Certain individuals are endowed with an excess of the tendency to get irritated or angered easily. It makes them to act aggressively quite often in one or the other social situations.
- **Rumination**: Some individuals are endowed with the tendency to retain and dwell on the feelings of anger and resentment towards others, particularly those who they consider as their opponents, rivals or obstacles in their success. They thus remain in search of one or the other opportunity to retaliate against them through some calculated aggression.
- **Emotional Susceptibility**: Some individuals are endowed with the tendency of remaining emotionally disturbed and remain encircled with the feelings of discomfort and inadequacy. Filled with the sense of insecurity, therefore they remain quite prone to angry and aggressive behavior.
- **Agreeableness**: There may be some individuals who lag behind in the possession of this trait. These are the people who look for serving their own interest in place of getting on with others. Lack of agreeableness and a sort of maladjustment with the existing situation may turn them as irritable, rude and aggressive towards other individuals.
- **Narcissism**: Narcissism refers to self-love, a highly inflated and extremely positive view of oneself. The possession of such traits on the part of some individuals may lead them to get aggressive when others dare to question their highly inflated view of themselves. In general, the personality trait *narcissism* found in individuals has two distinct parts or components, namely *grandiosity* – a tendency to show-off and exhibit arrogance, and *vulnerability* – a tendency to be bitter, complaining and defensive. Research findings, here, have revealed that only the second component is related to aggression (Krizan and Johar, 2015).
- **Sensation Seeking**: Sensation seeking represents one of the personality traits found in individuals. The persons attributed with this trait are ones who are highly impulsive and want to seek thrills, excitements and adventures. They get easily bored and are always in search of new experiences. Moreover, they are less inhibited and fond of indulging in exciting events involving some risk. According to Zuckerman

(1994) their nature of sensational seeking is closely linked with the personality trait impulsivity and as a result these individuals are found to experience anger and hostile feelings more than others in magnitude as well as in frequency, making them more prone to aggressive behavior. In this connection, Joireman et al. (2003) on the basis of their research work have concluded that “those who score high on sensation seeking are high on verbal and physical aggression”.

2. **Gender Differences:** Gender differences are also found to be an important contributing factor in witnessing aggression on the part of individuals in one or the other social situations. Studies conducted in this connection have shown that males are more aggressive than females. During the social encounters, men are found to behave quite aggressively and demonstrate unprovoked aggression more than females. (Eagly and Steffen, 1986; Bjorkqvist and Niemela, 1992; Harris, 1994; Bettencourt and Miller, 1996).

The explanations for these gender differences existing between males and females showing aggression, in general, in social life may be found to emerge from the biological as well as social side in the manner given next.

- **Biological Explanation:** The biological explanation for the gender differences in aggression comes from the role played by the hormones in this regard. Our hormones are found to play a quite important role in creating aggression. Most important in this regard is *the male sex hormone* testosterone, which is associated with increased aggression in both animals and in humans. Research studies conducted on this account have discovered a quite significant correlation between levels of testosterone and aggression. Although this sex hormone testosterone has its circulation both in male and female, it has a unique

distinction of presenting itself in higher levels in males than in women. It makes a point to find out that males display a greater amount and level of aggression than females in social encounters.

Gender Difference and Aggression

Gender difference – being male and female – plays an important role in causing aggression in social encounters. Males are more prone to aggression than their female counterparts. It happens on two accounts. One is the heavy presence of the male sex hormone testosterone in the males in comparison to females, and the other is on account of learning to behave aggressively as a part of their masculinity from the early period of their upbringing.

- **Socio-cultural Explanation:** The socio-cultural explanation for the gender differences in aggression comes from the role played by the socio-cultural factors in this regard. In our society and culture preference is always given to boys over the girls in the treatment and behavior shown towards them in their upbringing. Society encourages as well as expects from the girls to be submissive, passive and gentle in their behavior towards others, while boys are encouraged and expected to be forthright and aggressive. If the boys do not show such behavior, they are teased and ridiculed for behaving like girls. The differences and discrimination in their upbringing thus may make boys to grow and learn to remain assertive and aggressive in their social behavior. In this way, boys learn to be aggressive and assertive in their behavior in order to maintain their masculine image among their elder male members.
3. **Personality Disorders:** In some cases, some particular personality disorders found in individuals may push them to behave aggressively in one or the other social situations. As examples,

here we are presenting one of these possibilities in the name of chromosomal abnormality.

The chromosomal abnormality found in individuals may work as an important factor for the demonstration of aggressive behavior on their part in one or the other social situation. Some male individuals are found to be born with an extra Y chromosomes (XYY) making them somewhat abnormal in comparison to the normal ones having only X and Y (XY) chromosomes. The researchers in their research findings such as Jarvik et al. (1973) have revealed that the individuals with such chromosomal abnormality tend to display more aggression and violent behavior in comparison to those who are not suffered with such abnormality.

4. **Alcohol Consumption:** The habit of alcohol consumption found in people has also been found as one of the significant contributors towards individual and collective aggression and violence. In this connection, social psychologists have found a close relationship between alcohol and aggressive behavior. Accordingly, it is not at all unusual to witness the scenes of aggressive behavior occurring much more often at bars, nightclubs and other places in which people consume alcohol. The research work done in this regard has also established a strong correlation between consumption of alcohol and aggressive behavior (Bushman and Cooper, 1990; Gustafson, 1990). Going further, the researchers have also claimed the existence of such a link even in the alcohol consumers who have not been provoked and who do not usually behave aggressively when sober (Bailey and Taylor, 1991; Graham et al., 2006). Likewise, in a number of situations, alcohol consumption may prove itself as an important or even the sole cause of aggressive behavior or violence committed by the individuals or groups. Actually, the intake of heavy doses of alcohol/excessive drinking is responsible for snatching from them their ability to take cognizance of the things and events going on in a social encounter

in a proper way. Under the influence of liquor, they don't remain in a position to exercise control over their emotions. A slight intentional or unintentional provocation by others at that time may invite uncontrolled heavy retaliation on their part in the form of verbal duel and physical aggression.

B. Socio-cultural Factors or Determinants of Aggression (Causes Lying in One's Socio-Cultural Environment)

A number of times, in so many situations, the aggressive behavior of the people has been found to be caused through the factors present and events or things going on in their socio-cultural environment. We can name and discuss them as follows:

1. Social Discrimination and Exclusion

The disadvantages and agonies – physical as well as psychological – suffered on the part of individuals and groups while getting discriminated and excluded in a social setup by the majority or the people and groups who have meaning in their life may prove a quite potent source of aggressive and violent behavior demonstrated by these sufferers in one or the other ways at different occasions. In a social setup people may suffer from a variety of discrimination, exclusion and rejection by others on account of socio-economic differences, or the differences and distinction crept on caste, color, creed, religion, language and regional basis. Therefore, it is not unusual in our Indian society to suffer extreme humiliation on the part of tribal, backward and scheduled caste people at the hands of the people belonging to upper castes in one or the other ways. The discriminated and excluded people do not suffer only in terms of enjoying certain economical or physical benefits and deprivation of the social company and relationship with others, but it hurts them psychologically rupturing their self-image in a considerable way. Frustrated and angered with such unjustified treatment, it is quite natural for them to *even the score* by getting engaged in aggressive

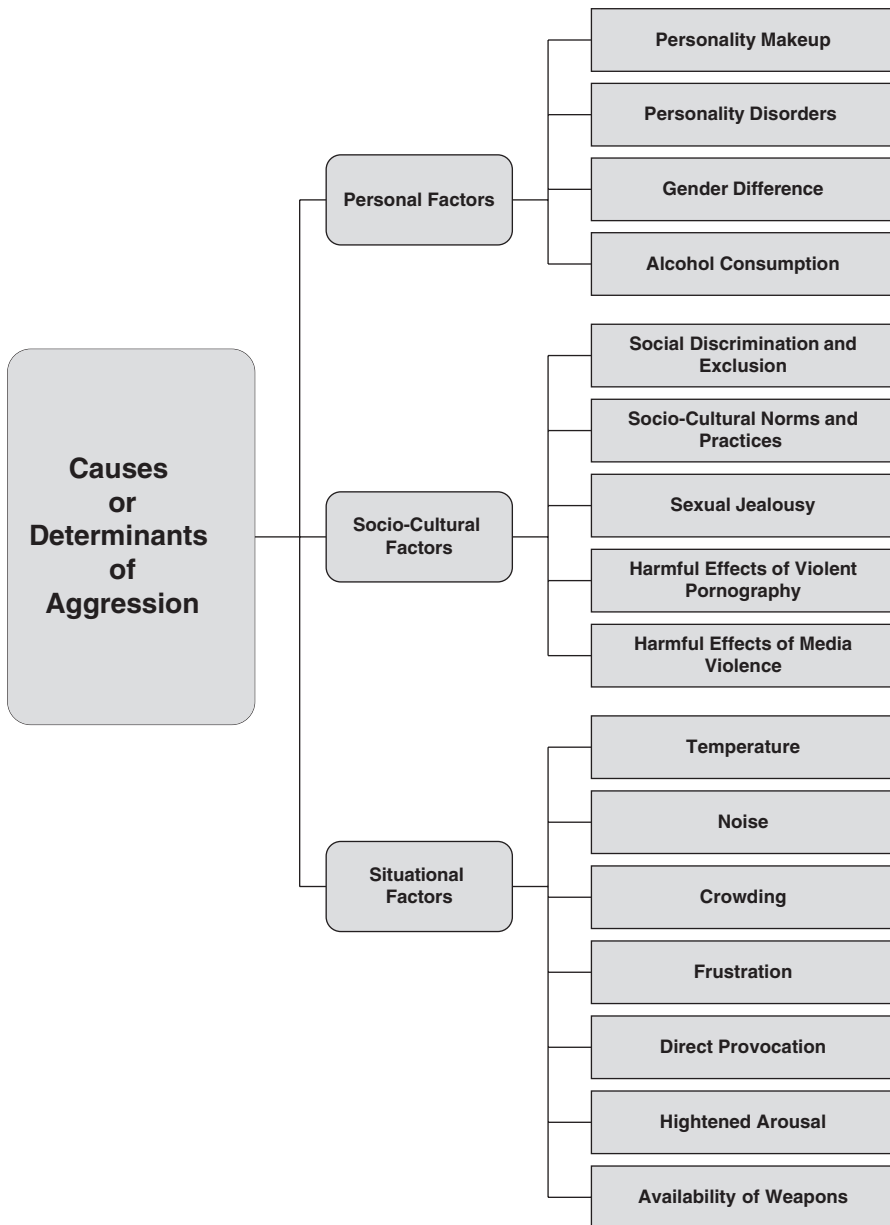


Figure19.1 Causes or Determinants of Aggression

and violent acts (e.g., vandalism or assault, or collective act of aggression and violence) against the individuals, groups and social setup as a whole who they think are responsible for their humiliation. The research work done in this connection clearly reveals that social exclusion and rejection is often a powerful trigger for aggression (Leary et al., 2006). In fact,

there is a chain-reaction effect of the process of such exclusion and rejection on the affected individuals. Being rejected or excluded by others often leads to increase in aggression by the excluded individuals which, in turn, could lead to even more exclusion – a kind of self-perpetuating, negative cycle (Branscombe and Baron, 2017:374).

2. Socio-Cultural Norms and Practices

Certain types of socio-cultural norms and practices prevailing in societies, particularly related to marriage, romance and sex relationships, may also play a quite big role in causing aggression and violence among individuals and groups. The concept of *honor saving* at any cost is very much followed in these societies. We may have the glaring examples of honor killing, on the part of Khaps existing in the Jat community in the state of Haryana, of the couples daring to engage in romance, sexual acts or marrying in the same gotra. The inter-caste and inter-faith sexual or marriage relationships are also treated in the same way. Similarly, in the community of Rajputs in the state of Rajasthan, we may witness the prevalence of the *culture of honor* – the following of the norms indicating that violence or aggression is an appropriate response for the insult inflicted at one's honor. In addition, in most of the regions and places all over India, there is a strong conviction and cultural norms prevalent against inter-faith or inter-religion romance, sexual relationships and marriages. Such acts committed by the individuals belonging to other religions, particularly to the Islam, are not tolerated by the communities following Hindu religion and according to the norms prevalent in their societies, responding to them through the acts of aggression and violence is very much appropriate. For providing a check on the occurrence of such aggression and violence on the part of the members of the Hindu community, various states of Indian Republic have recently initiated to enact the legal provision for restraining these inter-faith romance and marriage relationships.

3. Sexual Jealousy

Observations of scholars (the romantic literary figures like Wordsworth and Shakespeare and psychoanalysts like Freud) as well as social psychological researches conducted in the study of aggression have tried to point out that, in a number of social situations, sexual jealousy (the perception of a threat to a romantic relationship by a rival for one's partner) may work as one of the most potential causes of

aggression. Research studies conducted in this concern by socio-psychologists like Buss et al. (1992), Parrott (1991) and Sharpsteen (1991) have concluded that individuals who experience a sort of resentment and strong feelings of anger with a realization that their lover or beloved has 'done them wrong' by flirting with another person are usually found to think about or actually engage in the behavior targeted for punishing their lover/beloved, the rivals or both. Pointing towards gender difference found in this concern among the males and females, research studies, such as conducted by Paul et al. (1993), have also revealed that in comparison to males, females experience stronger feelings of anger at both the partner and the rival and as a result, they are more likely to react aggressively to such betrayals than the males.

4. Harmful Effects of Media Violence (Viewing of Television, Films and Videos)

Exposure to media violence (such as reading news about aggression and violence in newspapers or stories in magazines and novels, and viewing of violent scenes on television screen, films and videos) increases aggression in individuals. In this regard, a large number of research studies have conclusively demonstrated that exposure to aggressive models stimulates the viewers for imitating the similar behavior. Similarly, research studies have also properly revealed that exposure to violence in the mass media – films, television or video games – increases aggression on the part of viewers (Bandura et al., 1963; Leyens et al., 1975; Bachrach, 1986; Huesmann and Eron, 1986; Geen, 1991; Huesmann and Miller, 1994; Bushman and Huesmann, 2001; Bushman and Anderson, 2002; Anderson, 2004). A laboratory study quite mentionable in this connection was conducted by Bartholow et al. (2006), in which they found that individuals who reported that they had often played violent video games in the past directed more aggression against another person who had done nothing to provoke them than people who had rarely played such games. In this way, it can be quite appropriate to concede that there exists a convincing link between media violence and aggression.

5. The Harmful Effects of Violent Pornography

By the term violent pornography, we here mean viewing sex films or video involving violence on the part of individuals. In all its consequences, it definitely produces a quite harmful effect on the viewers. A number of studies conducted for studying this harmful effect on the viewers have revealed that violent pornography leads to aggression on account of the greater possibility of the occurrence of certain harmful effects such as follow.

- Exposure to violent pornography increases the tendency of males to aggress against females (Linz et al., 1988).
- As the viewers watch more and more of them, it may bring the desensitization effect making them react less negatively to the violence in these films.
- Gradually, the viewers of such violent pornography become somewhat accustomed and develop more callous attitudes toward such actions resulting in their acceptance and willingness towards the sexual violence including rape or forceful sex with the members of opposite or same sex.

C. Situation-Centered Factors or Determinants of Aggression

Here, the determinants or factors responsible for the aggression or violence lie outside the individuals in the situations or contexts in which it takes place. The things or factors most prominent in this concern may be named as status related to the presence of (i) temperature, (ii) noise, (iii) crowding, (iv) frustration, (v) direct provocation, (vi) heightened arousal and (vii) availability or accessibility to weapons. Let us examine the role of these factors in producing or aggravating aggression among individuals.

1. **Temperature:** Heat generation and temperature increase at the sight of a social encounter occurring on a particular place works as a quite potent factor for the generation of aggressive behavior

among individuals engaged in the social encounter. The research studies conducted in this concern reveal that when the weather becomes sufficiently hot and temperature crosses its normal limit to the extent of being somewhat stressful for the participant individuals, then it is most likely to result in creating the state of psychological imbalance for them so much so that it may add to their aggression and violent behavior (Anderson et al., 1996; Anderson et al., 1997). It happens because in the rising temperature of the weather the so desired coolness of their mind for taking appropriate cognition and judgmental decision of the activities going on at the sight of the social encounter and behavior of the other participant individuals is almost lost. They become tense and irritated, and lash out at others for one or the other reasons for getting them engaged in the verbal and physical aggression of one or the other kind. Not only the participant individuals participating in the social event or engaged in the social encounter but others present at the site as organizers, helpers or spectators are adversely affected through such abnormality of the heat and temperature.

2. **Noise:** Noise much like the heat generation and temperature increase at the sight of the social encounters also proves a quite aggravating and flaming factor for the generation and perpetuation of aggressive behavior on the part of the involved individuals. We can witness the bitterness of the noise pollution in our day-to-life in the form of making us physically as well mentally unhealthy. At the sight of the social encounter/ social event, when the level of noise pollution crosses its limits to the extent of making the individuals tense and irritable, they lose their focus for attending and interpreting the social encounter or event related information in a right way. They may misjudge and misinterpret the things going on at the sight or surroundings on account of the improper intervention and affect created by the unwanted noisy environment. In accordance of the so many research evidences available on this account, the crossing of the

normal limit of the noise at the social event or encounter sight is usually found to be an important cause for the aggravation of aggression and violence among the participants and others present at the sight.

3. **Crowding:** The crowding of the site of the social event or social encounter may also work as an important factor in aggravating and flaming the aggression not only among the participants but also others present at the sight as organizers or spectators. Here by the term crowding we mean a high density of people present at a particular place at a time. The experimental researches being done in this concern have revealed that crowding at the scene of the social event or social encounter may lead to aggression. Much like the rise in temperature and noise level, the crowding at the scene of the social event or encounter may lead to an increase in physiological arousal and psychological upset in terms of increasing their level of irritation, tension and frustration resulting in the reactionary aggression led behavior among the participants and others present at the scene. Moreover, here another type of possibility also arises in the increase of their aggression and violence on account of the realization on their part that in the crowd nobody would be able to recognize and hold them responsible for causing violence or aggression at the site.
4. **Frustration:** There may be so many things in one's socio-cultural environment that may bring frustration for an individual or group as a whole in one or the other social situation. In its one or the other forms, frustration, in general, is experienced by them when they are unable to get what is expected in a particular social situation. However, in whatever form it may be experienced, one thing is certain that frustration, suffered by the individuals or groups, on one or the other account in a social situation, may work as a potent cause or determinant for generating and perpetuating aggression or violence on their part. In this very chapter, we have already discussed the famous frustration-aggression hypothesis put by Dollard et al. (1939), stating that (i) frustration

always leads to some form of aggression and (ii) aggression always stems from frustration. In the revised version of this theory, Berkowitz (1989) has also endorsed the role of frustration in causing aggression among people by emphasizing that frustration is an aversive, unpleasant experience, and it is what makes an individual to aggress in one or the other social situations. Going further, this frustration-aggression viewpoint also helps to explain why unexpected frustration as well as the frustration viewed as illegitimate or unjustified bring out a quite stronger aggression in comparison to that brought out by the frustration that is expected or legitimate. For example, an employee who has been abruptly rebuked and badly treated by his boss without a reasonable and proper reason is likely to feel much aggrieved by such illegitimate and unjustified action of his boss. Accordingly, it is but natural, in this situation, on his part for originating the hostile thoughts, experience intense anger and seek revenge against the perceived source of frustration (that is certainly his boss in this case).

5. **Direct Provocation:** This is another major cause of aggression the roots of which lie in the faced social situations and encounters. Direct provocation leads to anger. Research studies suggest that direct provocation from others, either physical or verbal, often plays a powerful role in eliciting overt aggression (Harris, 1993; Baron and Richardson, 1994; Kowalski, 2001). In this concern, as reported by Denson et al. (2011), both men and woman get angry when they are provoked, and anger reduces impulse control. However, not everybody reacts to provocation with aggression. Whether or not we would react to provocation with aggression is influenced by many factors, and the most pronounced out of them in this concern is our attributions concerning provocation. For example, when we conclude that provocation in one or its various forms (such as expression of arrogance, harsh and unjustified criticism, and teasing) from another person was intentional i.e., deliberately performed, we become angry and engage

in strenuous efforts to reciprocate. However, on the other hand if we find that provocation was unintentional (resulted through some accidental factors or causes beyond the other's control), we are much less likely to lose our temper and behave aggressively. Thus, attributions concerning the causes behind the provocative actions of others play an important role in determining how aggressively we would react in one or the other social situation.

6. **Heightened Arousal:** In studying the role of emotions in playing their part in one's aggression, researchers have found that an increased level of our emotional arousal, irrespective of its source of generation, may play the role of an important enhancer of our overt aggression especially in the situation when we feel frustrated, get provoked by others or become too emotionally charged (e. g. sexually aroused) on account of one or the other reasons. About the different sources of increasing the level of our emotional arousal, enough for initiating and perpetuating our overt aggression in one or the other social situations, researchers have identified some important ones as loud and unpleasant noises, competitive activities including games and sports, presence or availability of weapons, some type of music and even vigorous exercise, etc. (Berkowitz, 1993; Dodge and Somberg, 1987; Christy et al., 1971; Rogers and Ketcher, 1979).
7. **Availability or Accessibility to Weapons:** It has been properly observed as well as experimentally proved that the availability or accessibility of weapons of one or the other nature increases the probability of the aggression and violence committed by the people on individual as well as collective basis in one or the other social situation (Berkowitz and Page, 1967; Klimesmith et al., 2006; Benjamin and Bushman, 2017).

This phenomenon is universal and is found to occur in all societies across the globe.

Those who are familiar with our Indian Village societies may be well acquainted with the nature of aggression and violence – individual or collective – occasionally going on there for one or the other

reasons involving their agricultural land, the damage of the crops in some way by the animals of others, the cases of minor and major sex offences against the women or violation of social and cultural norms by a particular individual or section of the society. The provability of a considerable increase in the magnitude as well as frequency in such aggression or violence have also been properly observed as well as reported. When people enjoy the easy availability or accessibility of the sharp-edged weapons, and quickly fired guns at their home with them, they seem to be more prone for getting actively engaged in the more damaging and life-threatening aggression or violence. The road-rage incidents occurring now more frequently in our country also clearly provide the needed testimony for the role of the weapons in initializing as well as aggravating the cases of aggression and violence at the site of the incident itself as well as a non-stop retaliation game going on between the involved parties for years.

Researchers like Stroebe (2015) have tried to search for the reasons lying behind the increase in aggression and violence on account of the easy availability or accessibility of weapons especially the quickly used and fired ones such as:

- The easy availability or accessibility of weapons considerably adds to their intention to commit such acts.
- Like putting fuel to the fire, it can be found to assure them that their intention, to commit more damage to the extent of killing others, will be successfully met.

In this way, conclusively, an easy availability or accessibility of weapons may be well recognized as one of the potential causes of aggression and violence. In this concern, often it is said that it is we and not the weapons who harm or kill the people, therefore we can't blame weapons for our aggression. But the things also exist otherwise. Providing a quite witty comment on this issue, Leonard Berkowitz (1981) writes:

It is true that guns don't kill, people do. But, however, we should also see that although the finger pulls the trigger, yet the trigger may also be pulling the finger.

To Sum Up

Causes or determinants of aggression may be mainly divided into three sections – person centered determinants, the socio-cultural determinants and the situation centered determinants.

The *person-centered determinants*, or the factors or causes lying within the individuals, may involve the following:

- Typical personality makeup (e.g. being A-Type person and having some specific personality traits correlated high with aggression).
- Gender differences (showing males as more prone to aggression than females).
- Personality disorders (e.g. chromosomal abnormality – the presence of an extra Y chromosomes in males).
- Alcohol consumption – the excessive drinking on the part of individuals.

Under the category of *socio-cultural determinants*, we may include the factors or causes such as:

Social discrimination and exclusion, socio-cultural norms and practices prevailing in the society, sexual jealousy, harmful effects of media violence and violent pornography.

Under the category *situation centered determinants of aggression*, we may include the factors related to the environmental conditions prevailing at the site of social encounter in the shape of:

- Heat generation and temperature recorded at the site.
- The nature and impact of the noise level, and crowding at the social event or encounter site.
- The frustration suffered by the participant individuals or spectators for one or the other reasons.
- Direct provocation incidents or accidents at the site.

Prevention and Control of Aggression or Violence

It is a well-known fact that the prevention and control of a problem well lie in the causes or factors responsible for its emergence. We have already discussed the various points of view and theoretical perspectives as well as the various factors or determinants responsible for the aggression and violence of people. A proper analysis of these perspectives and determinants of aggression may help us in knowing about what needs to be done for its prevention and control. For this purpose, let us begin with a look at the factors or determinants discussed earlier in this chapter under the heads – Personal, Socio-cultural and Situational Factors.

Personal factors are very much person-specific, and therefore there is hardly any scope in exercising restraint or control over them. Regarding reduction of the impact of socio-cultural factors in inducing or increasing aggression, we can say that efforts can be well initiated for the discontinuance of certain practices, norms and traditions, such as discrimination, exclusion, deprivation and disadvantages suffered in the society on the part of certain individuals and groups on one or the other account, such as casteism, regionalism, religionism, the prevalence of the culture of honor, etc., along with the needed reduction in the harmful effects of sexual jealousy, media violence and violent pornography. Regarding the reduction of the impact of the situational factors on aggression of the people such as heat and temperature, noise, crowd, frustration, direct provocation, heightened arousal and easy availability or accessibility of weapons, the following measures may be well adopted.

1. Making efforts to hold social events or having social encounters at the places where problems related to uncomfortable heat and temperature, noise and crowd do not arise or if they arise then efforts can be successfully made for not allowing them to become a cause of aggression or violence.
2. The situations involving or resulting in the frustration, heightening of emotional arousal and

provocation of the individuals participating in the social events or taking part in the social encounters in one or the other forms should be avoided as well as restrained in a proper way.

3. The easy availability and accessibility of sharp-edged weapons, firearms including revolvers and pistols should be properly restrained by enacting the necessary laws for their restricted use as well as imposing a ban on their public display and illegal possession.

Now take the case of different perspectives and theoretical explanations provided for the aggression and violence of the people. A proper analysis of them may help us to reveal that whatever may be claimed behind aggression by these different perspectives, one thing is certain that aggressive behavior is neither innate, inborn and inherited nor is the instinctual or situational one. Certainly, we are not the helpless pawns of our genes, instincts or situations that may compel us to behave aggressively at one or the other occasions. In all its forms and shapes, aggression does not form a part of our nature and thus must be considered as evitable – a thing or phenomenon subjected to change. Thus, it is now a well-recognized fact that aggression – irrespective of its nature and type – is a learned phenomenon. For its prevention and control we should, therefore, look for the measures and techniques that may prove helpful firstly in the stoppage of its learning and secondly for its subsequent unlearning if it intrudes somehow in our social behavior. Taking cognizance of these two important considerations, we can name and discuss the different measures or techniques adopted for the prevention and control of aggression or violence of the people in the manner as follows.

1. **Making Use of Punishment as Retaliation or Deterrence:** At most of the time in all societies and places in the world, means and measures for having provisions of punishing (delivery of aversive consequences) the people committing the acts of aggression and violence are commonly employed as a measure of retaliation (doing tit for tat for the improper behavior) and strong

deterrence (warning and threatening them for not daring to do so). It essentially includes the delivery of some or other type of aversive consequences through a variety of means such as inflicting heavy fines, putting the accused in prisons or solitary confinements, or providing physical punishments of one or the other nature for their undesirable acts of aggression and violence.

Regarding the appropriateness of using punishment as a method or technique of reducing aggression, it has been found by the researchers that it is no guarantee that it will serve its purpose of proving a good deterrence in all circumstances with all types of aggression or aggressors. Moreover, punishing an aggressor may also carry the risk of backfiring or bringing harmful side effects. Some of the views expressed by them in this concern are presented here:

- The use of strong or harsh punishment to reduce aggression usually backfires; it may put a halt to a child's aggressive behavior in the short term, but children who are physically punished tend to become more aggressive and anti-social over time (Durrant and Ensom, 2012).
- The understanding that punishment should fit the act of aggression may also not work in a proper way. Severe punishment is not likely to deter violent crime. Countries that invoke the death penalty for murder do not have fewer murders per capita than those without it (Fajnzylber et al., 2002).

With the aforementioned concerns about the effectiveness of punishment as a deterrence or retaliation measure, it should not be assumed that punishment can't work as one of the good measures or techniques for the prevention and control of aggression. Certainly, it can serve its purpose well. However, there is a proper need of paying attention

over some essentials before its employment as a measure or technique of reducing or controlling the acts of aggression and violence. For this purpose, socio-psychologists and researchers, like Bower and Hilgard, 1981; Darley et al., 2000, through their studies have recommended to pay attention over the things laid down next.

- (i) The inflicted punishment must be prompt, administered quickly after the aggression action.
- (ii) It must be consistently applied so that the aggressor knows that punishment will likely follow future aggressive actions.
- (iii) Moreover, it must be relatively strong so that its aversive qualities are duly noted by the aggressor. It is only stronger punishment that may deter people from engaging in actions they believe they can “get away with”.
- (iv) However, in every case it should be well considered that, the amount of punishment people ought to receive should be matched to the magnitude of harm they have caused through their aggression or violence. But here, the magnitude of punishment should also take account of the extenuating circumstances, e.g., the other motive for the aggressive action, such as self-defense or defense of one's family (Branscombe and Baron, 2017:393).

2. **Controlling and Management of Anger:** It is the anger that fuels aggression in most of the situations. We therefore need to adopt adequate measures for exercising restraint and control over our anger flaming for one or the other reasons towards the rivals, opponents or others in our social encounters. Aronson et al. (2020:450–451) have pointed about two important measures for the control and management of one's anger in the manner as follows:

- First it is possible to control anger by actively enabling it to dissipate. Here by the term actively enabling we mean to make use of such simple devices as counting to 10, taking deep breaths or getting involved in a pleasant, distracting activity (such as playing a game, taking a bike ride or even doing a good deed).
 - The first measure is helpful only in cooling you to some extent from the excessive heat generated through the feelings of anger and resentment. It may not prove helpful in solving the problem arising in inter-relationship with others. For the required purpose now, you have to adopt the next measure – expressing your feelings in a way that is neither hostile nor demanding. The method being adopted for this purpose is to calmly state that you are feeling angry and describing, nonjudgmentally, what you believe the other person did to bring those feelings. When such feelings are expressed between friends or partners in a straightforward, nonconfrontational manner, greater mutual understanding and a strengthening of the friendship can result (Christensen et al., 2014).
3. **Making Use of Self-Regulation or Internal Mechanism:** Nature has equipped us with a valuable gift – an effective internal mechanism known as self-regulation or self-control for restraining our anger and overt aggression. Since it is available to us at all times in all situations, decidedly, then this measure must prove a quite effective device for exercising restraint and control over our aggression. According to the research findings (Mauss et al., 2006), the use of this measure is also quite simple and effortless. In fact, when individuals have positive implicit attitudes toward regulating their own emotions, they may be able to restrain aggression almost effortlessly.
 4. **Employing the Technique of Catharsis:** The use of catharsis technique suggests to make use of some desirable channels for the release

of bottled or pent-up emotional energy that can otherwise have all probability for getting busted in the form of aggressive acts. As its origin, the use of this technique is the outcome of the psychoanalytic viewpoint of Sigmund Freud in which he asserted that if individuals give vent to their anger and hostility in non-harmful ways, their tendencies to engage in more dangerous types of aggression will be reduced (Dollard et al., 1939). Accordingly, in the use of this technique for the control of aggression, the individuals are provided opportunity to let their bottled aggressive feelings and resentment come out through some appropriate outlet such as (i) ventilating their suppressed aggression by acting it out actively – hitting or whopping the self, boxing or punching an inanimate target while screaming; or (ii) expressing their feelings to others (verbally or in writing) and opening up their mind for getting the pent-up tension released.

In a nutshell, thus the measures adopted for the control and management of aggression and violence through the use of the catharsis technique are based on a *hydraulic model* which implies accumulated aggressive energy, like dammed-up water, needs a release (Myers et al., 2010:290). The results may also be encouraging in some situations as by providing a proper outlet for emotional expression, the bottled-up resentment or anger and the subsequent tension generated in one's mind on this account is removed and one is made to feel better and lighter.

However, much of research work done by social psychologists, to evaluate the effect of the use of catharsis technique for the prevention and control of aggression, tells a different story. Accordingly, we may find a lot of voices raised against the effectiveness of catharsis as a technique of reducing aggression. In this concern, while opposing the use of catharsis, Brad Bushman (2002) went on to the extent of commenting that actually “venting to reduce anger is like using gasoline to put out a fire”.

However, with all such bitter criticism, the use of catharsis as a technique for reducing aggression and violence possesses its own merit. In our daily encounter in the kitchen, we are well experiencing with how fruitful it is to allow the pent-up steam of the cookers to outlet through the safety valve. In making use of the technique of catharsis, in a similar way, we can allow a safe outlet of our pent-up resentment and aggressive feelings through non-aggressive or non-harming ways such as (i) expressing these feelings to communicate to others in a nonjudgmental way how their behavior is affecting us, or (ii) hitting an inanimate object involving not much loss. In fact, at most of the time while making use of catharsis as a technique of managing aggression, we should try to be assertive rather than getting engaged in aggressive acts – harming self or others in one or the other ways.

5. **Unlearning of the Aggressive Behavior:** It is now well accepted fact that aggression on the part of individuals is a learned behavior in its all forms and shapes. The theories of learning, like conditioning (classical and operant) and observational learning propagated by Albert Bandura may explain how athletes learn aggression. The principles and findings of these theories can also be effectively used for unlearning of the aggressive behavior by resorting to the techniques of de-conditioning, extinction and de-valuation in the ways outlined next.

- A. *Use of the De-conditioning Techniques:*
In making use of the techniques of de-conditioning, where the undesirable aggressive behavior of the individuals is subjected to turn into a quite unpleasant experience for them, the demonstration of unaggressive and rule abiding behavior on their part should be made an encouraging pleasant experience in its outcome. In making use of this technique, thus, we can proceed in two ways.

- (i) **Providing Punishment:** Whenever, an individual is found to be engaged in an aggressive or violence act, then it should immediately be attended for providing punishment in accordance to the prevalent social norms and rules for this purpose. It can prove a good deterrent measure not only for the repetition of the aggressive behavior on the part of the involved individuals but also a mirror and warning signal for others for not engaging in the acts of aggression or violence. We have already discussed the use of this measure in essential details under the separate head.
 - (ii) **Rewarding or Reinforcing the Desirable Behavior:** Whenever an individual is behaving or doing his or her task by following the prescribed rules and social norms, remains non-aggressive in his normal or assertive social behavior, his behavior should be appreciated and rewarded in a suitable way to make him feel good and experience satisfaction and pleasure for behaving as such. It may help him in continuing with such desirable behavior and prove a good model for others to follow.
- B. *Use of the Operant Behavior Modification Technique:* Here necessary attempts may be made for shaping the desired non-aggressive assertive social behavior on the part of the individuals by making use of the operant behavior modification techniques. Here a player may be prompted and made to engage in a rule abiding non-aggressive sport behavior. As and when he responds even with the slightest sign of such desirable behavior, his behavior should be suitably reinforced with praise, promotion, opportunities, extra attention and other rewarding stimuli such as awarding stars, pins, badges, certificates, medals and trophies. The doses of such reinforcement should get increased with the
- increase in the quality of the needed social or work-related behavior demonstrated by him further in his social interaction and tasks doing activities.
- C. *Use of the Elimination or Extinction of Undesirable Behavior Technique:* In making use of this technique for the elimination or extinction of the undesirable aggressive behavior, the erring individuals may be made to go through some direct or vicarious experiences to feel heat of the devastating experiences of the aggression committed by the concerned people individually or collectively. When they see how the aggression on the part of the individuals, including the celebrities, star performers and highly praised social groups may prove fatal to the persons in their interaction, innocent ones, as well as also ruining their own career and future, it may help them in learning a good lesson for saving them from the attractive trap of acting rudely and aggressively in their social encounters.
6. **Making Use of the Appropriate Cognition Intervention Strategies:** By cognitive intervention strategies we hereby mean various forms of perception, thoughts, reasoning or inferences drawn on our part for helping us to change our ideas, behavior or outlook with respect to aggression. A few of the important cognitive intervention strategies adopted on our part for the prevention and control of our aggression may be briefed as follows.
- (i) *The Role of Apology and Forgiveness:* When apologies (admission of wrongdoing plus a request for forgiveness), from others who have caused you to get angry and tensed, are well taken in cognizance for making you cool and somewhat satisfied, then it is bound to result in a tendency to forgive and forget about his undesirable behavior on your part and thus help much in the task of controlling anger and reducing aggression in a tense situation (Ohbuchi et al., 1989).

- (ii) *Taking Care of our Attribution*: Attribution often plays a quite big role in deciding the nature of our reaction to provocation (such as direct hitting, pushing or blocking the way towards goal on the part of someone) during a social encounter. We are much more likely to grow angry and respond aggressively if we consider it to be inflicted on us quite purposefully or intentionally than if we conclude that these actions are the result of some external factors beyond his or her control, coming in to existence in a quite unintentional and accidental way. The cognizance of this fact gives birth to the possibility of the use of a technique helpful in the reduction of aggression by encouraging individuals to make such external attributions. In other words, if the people, in general, are habituated to interpret provocative actions by others as stemming mainly from external causes, the possibility of the aggressive scenes arising may be greatly reduced.
- (iii) *Overcoming One's Cognitive Deficit*: Another cognitive intervention strategy is to help the individual overcome his cognitive deficit. In our day-to-day observation, we may see that usually, when one becomes angry his ability to evaluate the consequences of his actions is reduced. In such a situation, if he is helped in overcoming this cognitive deficit, it is most likely to reduce overt aggression in a considerable way (Zillmann, 1993). Two important techniques that help us to overcome cognitive deficits in this connection are briefed as follows.
- **Pre-Attribution**: In making use of this technique, one is seen to attribute annoying actions by others to unintentional causes before the provocation actually occurs. For example, when you are scheduled to meet with someone you know for which you have a perception that meeting him may be quite irritating. However, in this case, you bring

a desirable change in your cognition by reminding yourself that he actually doesn't mean to make you angry – it's just the result of an unfortunate way of his talking and the language used by him for his communication.

- **Prevention of Rumination**: The use of this technique involves preventing us and others from getting angry and aggressive in a social encounter from ruminating i.e., thinking about previous real or imagined wrongs (Zillmann, 1993). An easy way for its accomplishment is distracting his attention from such thoughts. We can do it by engaging in distracting tasks such as participating in pleasant, absorbing activities that have no connection to anger and aggression (e.g., watching a movie or television program, reading books or magazines of our interest, playing a game, working on some complex but interesting puzzles, etc.). Our engaging in such distracting but interesting activities, helps us in getting a cooling-off period for the required vaporizing off of our anger and re-establishment of cognitive control over our behavior.
7. **Training in Social Skills**: One of the reasons why individuals indulge in aggression is that they lack some form of social skill. It is their lacking in social skills that may create problems for them in their proper self-expression, problem solving, interaction and communication with others as well as to express their anger or annoyance constructively and nonviolently. According to the socio-psychologists, that individuals, who are deficit in social skills, are insensitive to the feelings and emotions of others and are likely to become more aggressive (Toch, 1985, Langhinrichsen-Rohling et al., 2012). Thus, there is an urgent need of helping such individuals in their learning of needed social skills. For this purpose, if we try to teach

them such techniques as how to communicate anger or criticism in constructive ways, how to negotiate and compromise when conflicts arise, and how to apologize when they need to, it may considerably help in the prevention and control of aggression (Christensen et al., 2014).

8. **Reducing Frustration and Apprehensions of the Sufferer:** Frustration, in all its dimensions, as discussed earlier in this text, is regarded as one of the major sources of individual or collective aggression. It is the frustration – the blocking of his goal by someone – that directs his behavior towards aggression. Similarly, a violent agitation, aggression or violence on a mass scale may be seen to take place in society when the individuals playing here the role of aggressors reach a stage of frustration of not getting their due share without doing so. The frustration among individuals as well as in public may also creep in by the fear and apprehensions spread in society as a result of undesirable and criminal acts such as dacoity, destroying of property and taking lives of others committed by the criminals or bad elements. In all such situations, there is a need for taking measures to reduce the frustration and apprehensions of individuals and the group who is subjected to such fear, apprehension and frustration. In, general, the following measures may prove effective for the purpose.
 - Providing the individuals or parties in conflict an opportunity for seeking compromise and understanding without hurting their feelings or interests.
 - Taking measures of reducing the cases of improper and unjustified discrimination, exclusion and harassment as individuals or as the group as a whole.
 - Enacting strict legal laws and provisions of their proper implementation for taking prompt and timely steps against the law breakers and criminals and thus assuring the people and public for their safety and protection against these elements.

To Sum Up

Aggression is a learned phenomenon. For its prevention and control we should, therefore, look for the measures and techniques that may prove helpful firstly in the stoppage of its learning and secondly for its subsequent unlearning if it gets intruded somehow in our social behavior. Accordingly, in the prevention and control of aggression and violence among the individual and groups, the measures and strategies proving helpful may be cited as:

- Making use of punishment as retaliation or deterrence.
- Controlling and managing anger by making use of self-regulation or internal mechanism, or employing the technique of catharsis.
- Unlearning of the aggressive behavior through the use of techniques such as de-conditioning, operant behavior modification and elimination or extinction of undesirable behavior and providing training in social skills.
- Making use of the appropriate cognition intervention strategies such as apology and forgiveness, taking care of our attribution, overcoming one's cognitive deficit, and reducing frustration and apprehensions of the sufferer.

Review Questions

1. What is aggression or aggressive behavior? Discuss its meaning, concept and various types.
2. Discuss and differentiate between hostile and instrumental aggression.
3. What is violence? How does it differ from the term aggression? Clarify.
4. Discuss in detail the nature and consequences of the following types or forms of violent behavior:
 - (i) bullying (violence involving school mates),
 - (ii) audience or spectator violence in sports and
 - (iii) workplace violence.

5. What are the various theories of aggression? Name six of them and discuss any two in detail.
6. Describe and discuss any three of these theories of aggression: (i) genetic theory of aggression, (ii) neurological theory of aggression, (iii) hormonal theory of aggression, (iv) psycho-analytical instinct theory of aggression, (v) evolutionary theory of aggression, (vi) frustration theory of aggression, (vii) social learning theory of aggression and (viii) General Aggression Model (GAM): A Modern Theory of Human Aggression.
7. What are the different causes or determinants of aggression or aggressive behavior? Discuss them in detail.
8. Throw light on the means and ways employed for the prevention and control of aggression or violence.

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20.

ALCOHOLISM, DRUG ADDICTION AND CRIMINAL BEHAVIOR

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- Discuss the concept and meaning of alcoholism.
- Tell, how one gets habituated to alcoholism.
- Talk about the effects of alcoholism.
- Evaluate the causes of alcoholism.
- Discuss the treatment measures of alcoholism.
- Discuss the concept and meaning of drug addiction.
- Tell about the different types of drugs and their damaging effects.
- Discuss the causes of drug addiction.
- Throw light on the prevention and treatment of drug addiction.
- Discuss the concept and meaning of criminal behavior.
- Elucidate the meaning and concept of the term delinquency.
- Name and evaluate the causes of delinquency.
- Discuss the prevention and treatment measures of delinquency.
- Discuss the meaning and concept of the term crime.
- Discuss the various causes underlying crime.
- Throw light on the ways and means utilized for the prevention of crimes and treatment of criminals.

Introduction

In all societies, we may witness that they all take care for the maintenance of appropriateness and desirability in the behavior of their members. The parents, family members and teachers make attempts to motivate as well as persuade the youngster to get imbibed with the desirable habits and conduct of their behavior from a quite early age. Societies also prescribe a moral and ethical code and expect their

members to abide by the social norms in the interest and welfare of their own selves as well as the society. However, things do not always go on the lines as expected and desired. The people indulge in unsocial and undesirable behavior harmful to them and the society in one or the other ways. Such unsociability and undesirability of their behavior may prove a great germinating as well as perpetuating source for a number of social problems and issues impeding the

harmony and progress of the society. Alcoholism, drug addiction and one or the other types of criminal behavior all fall in the category of such uncalled for undesirable and antisocial behavior of the members of the society. In this chapter we would like to examine their nature, causes, consequences and ways of their prevention and control.

Alcoholism

Concept and Meaning

Alcoholism is usually referred to as excessive drinking or dependence on alcoholic beverages, which people drink for many reasons and in many ways, situations and styles. They should not all be considered alcoholics. The World Health Organization (WHO) has defined alcoholics as

excessive drinkers whose dependence on alcohol has attained such a degree that they show noticeable mental disturbance or an interference with their mental and bodily health, their interpersonal relations and their smooth social and economic functioning, or who show the prodromal (beginning) signs of such developments.

(1969:228)

Alcoholism

An addiction to the consumption of alcohol forcing an individual to indulge in excessive drinking or depending on alcoholic beverages to the extent of disrupting life and malfunctioning of behavior causing severe physiological, psychological and social damage.

How One Gets Habituated to Alcoholism

The habit of excessive drinking or dependence on alcoholic beverages is perpetuated gradually. E.M. Jellinek (1942), an authority on alcoholism, has pointed out the following four stages in the development of alcoholism.

1. *Pre-alcoholic Phase:* This initial phase lasts from two months to two years. The beginners who drink for social reasons or merely on account of curiosity find that it relieves them of anxiety and tension and as a result learn to use alcohol as a relief measure. Gradually, they begin to experience an increased tolerance for alcohol and need a large amount to reach the same stage of sedation. This phase is characterized by a gradual shift from infrequent or light to frequent or heavy drinking.
2. *Prodromal phase:* At this stage alcohol begins to be used more as a drug and less as a beverage with dependency on it increasing and manifested through the following behavioral phenomena:
 - The individuals become preoccupied with drinking, worrying where and when they will have their next drink.
 - They feel guilty about drinking and usually avoid references to alcohol in conversations. At the same time, they feel a strong urge to drink and thereby often resort to surreptitious rather than open drinking.
 - There is a sudden onset of 'blackouts' for some of the periods of drinking.
 - There is considerable memory impairment. One may remain conscious at the time of drinking but later be unable to recall the events.
3. *The Crucial Phase:* The third stage is alarming. The dependency on alcohol increases to the extent that there is a danger of an individual losing everything that one values. One may drop friends, lose jobs and leave the members of one's family including children and wife but not give up the habit of drinking. Thus, the behavior compels such people to withdraw from the social environment ending in the isolation further making them drink heavily at any time. In this phase drinking is sought to be rationalized as a source of comfort. The need for liquor becomes a constant source of worry and is detrimental to diet combined with the harmful

effects of alcohol; it deteriorates their health, lowers their sexual drive and makes them hostile towards the persons and environment, completely ruining their harmony and peace.

4. *The Chronic Phase:* This is the most critical stage where the individuals live only to drink. Their bodily systems become so conditioned that they must be supplied with alcohol or they suffer withdrawal reactions. If alcohol is not available, they are ready to consume any liquid containing alcohol like shaving lotion, hair tonic, spirit or a medical preparation. They lose control upon their behavior and prolonged bouts of intoxication often lead to marked ethical deterioration (character disorders), complete neglect of personal appearance and concern for others, impairment of mental processes and even alcoholic psychoses in some cases. In comparison with the crucial phase, the chronic phase results in the loss of tolerance for alcohol usually when even a small amount leads to intoxication. At a more advanced stage, the alcoholic admits defeat and unless he receives treatment is unlikely to give up drinking.

The Effects of Alcoholism

Alcoholism may result in severe disturbances of physiological, psychological and social functions as given next:

1. *Physiological Damage:* Almost every tissue and organ of the body is adversely affected by alcohol. Since alcoholics largely depend upon alcohol as a major source of food, they neglect their diet. Consequently, they suffer from vitamin and nutritional deficiencies. A drastic reduction in the intake of protein causes cirrhosis of the liver. Prolonged consumption of alcohol can damage the endocrine glands or cause heart failure, hypertension, shrinking and inflammation of the lining of the stomach, and capillary hemorrhage. It can also lead to the lowering of overall resistance to disease as a result of which the life expectancy of an alcoholic is considerably

reduced. The incidence of death in the case of alcoholics may occur on account of depression leading to suicide; inter-current infection, especially from respiratory infections; liver or cardiac failure; and inhalation of vomitus.

2. *Psycho-physiological Damage:* This damage may result in a number of neurological and psychotic disorders (brain syndromes) such as pathological intoxication, delirium tremens, alcoholic hallucinosis, alcoholic deterioration and Korsakoff's syndrome (a chronic memory disorder).
3. *Behavioral Damage:* Alcoholism may result in one or the other kinds of behavioral damage in the manner as follows:
 - It can cause severe deterioration in the thought processes and damage intellectual functioning. Sufficient intoxication may lead the individuals to 'black out' causing inability to remember what they said or did. Motor behavior is adversely affected on account of the deterioration in motor coordination, balance, speech and the power of sensation and perception.
 - It may cause severe personality or character disorders. There is likely to be a deterioration of personal habits, a lack of regard for one's appearance, self-image and self-respect. Following release of inhibitions, impairment of judgment, loss of emotional and motor control, disturbance in self-evaluation and indifference to self, caused by intoxication, alcoholics easily drift towards irresponsible behavior and antisocial acts.
 - Intoxication adversely affects the sex behavior of an individual who is likely to lose interest in the family. Sexual incapacity caused by alcoholism may further deteriorate the situation. Frustration, lack of inhibitions and defective intellectual and moral judgment may result in sexual deviations and crimes.

Thus, alcoholism causes psychological and physiological damage to an individual resulting in incalculable personal and social loss. For alcoholics dire social, occupational and family consequences are

relationships, and economic loss and moral degradation. It leads them to misery and frustration, and alienates them from the family and society.

The Causes of Alcoholism

Since no person is born alcoholic, the causes of alcoholism are therefore to be found within the environment of an individual. The beginning of the drinking habit and later its continuation is a learned pattern of maladaptive behavior. Drinking is learned and acquired like other personality traits and later maintained for its physiological and psychological dependence. Let us see how.

- We learn many things from the environment. The behavior patterns of the elder members of the family and society work as a model for the younger ones. Therefore, the first drink may be taken in a social gathering with other members or secretly without the knowledge of the elders. The child or a youth may be tempted to taste alcohol merely on account of the curiosity or for imitating the elders. The literature in the form of stories, fiction and plays, the movies and the observed behavior of the parents and elders make them start drinking as a learned response to develop sociability; to alleviate the feelings of isolation and loneliness; to seek a readily available source of pleasure; to boost their ego, remove hesitation and become courageous by acquiring feelings of adequacy; to seek relief from tension and worries; to remove ethical restraints to engage in undesirable, immoral or antisocial behavior without feeling guilty; and to increase sexual interest, stimulation and for acquiring a feeling of sexual adequacy.
- People learn to drink excessively as a result of its rewarding effect. As a sedative alcohol is a very quick and effective method of reducing tension, removing hesitations and easing inhibitions. It leads to a pleasurable feeling of adequacy, relief from worries and increased sociability. Such rewarding effects reinforce the drinking

behavior. One learns to depend upon drinking as the preferred solution to problems. The psychological dependence further aggravates the situation when the individual consumes more and more alcohol for seeking pleasure and getting relief from the unpleasant reality. Gradually, it leads to prolonged and excessive drinking resulting in physiological, psychological, psychiatric and social problems.

- Once the people become physiologically addicted to alcohol, drinking becomes a compulsion for their physical well-being. They experience withdrawal symptoms like craving for alcohol, tremors, perspiration, weakness, nausea, vomiting, fever, blackouts and hallucinations when they try to give up the habit. Consequently, they dare not stop drinking and this physiological dependence compels him to drink still more.

Treatment of Alcoholism

There is no single effective way to deal with the problem of alcoholism. In some cases, individuals may stop drinking apparently because of the fear of being arrested and imprisoned. But alcoholism is in fact a medical and psychological problem rather than a law and order problem. Attempts should, therefore, be made to tackle it on medical, social and psychological levels. While resorting to treatment one should have a clear knowledge of the early symptoms of alcoholism. These may include continuous and heavy drinking or uncontrolled episodic bursts of drinking; morning drinking; blackouts; gaining no pleasure in drinking; and undesirable, uncontrolled extreme behavior. It is, then, time to take corrective measures given next:

1. *Institutionalization and Hospitalization:* It is better to arrange institutionalization and hospitalization for the treatment of acute alcoholic intoxication. In many cases, compulsory hospitalization is not needed, but it is important to keep the alcoholics away from aversive life situations and keep their behavior under control.

2. *Clinical Investigation:* It should include investigations like full blood count, chest and skull radiography, and liver function tests; as a result proper medical treatment should be provided for the deficiency and damage.
3. *De-intoxication:* The first step in treating alcoholics is de-intoxication, that is, removal of alcoholic substances from the body and treatment of withdrawal symptoms. At this stage much care should be taken to compensate the alcoholic's dietary deficiencies.
4. *Deterrent Measures:* After de-intoxication the following deterrent measures in the form of aversion therapy are commonly used for restraining the patients from drinking.
 - The patients may be given drugs like disulfiram (Antabuse) or citrated calcium carbamide (Abstem) for helping them resolve not to drink. These drugs cause episode of intense illness if the individual drinks alcohol and thereby act as strong deterrents in preventing drinking.
 - In making the patients develop a hatred for alcohol a substance which produces nausea and vomiting when taken with an alcoholic drink is given. With repetition, it results in a conditioned aversion to alcoholic drinks.
 - Shock therapy may also be used as an effective measure to cause aversion for liquor. Sometimes the shocks received from the adverse life situations may prove valuable in treating alcoholics.
5. *Psychotherapy:* When the patients have stopped drinking, they may be given group or individual psychotherapy for helping them gain insight into their behavior and develop more effective adjustment techniques other than alcohol or drug addiction. However, its use is not recommended with alcoholics who are basically sociopathic. A therapist has to work hard with alcoholics. The chronic alcoholics are usually liars and unable to keep their promises of never drinking again. Fruitful results can be achieved by making the patient realize or learn that a life without alcohol can be more satisfying than a life completely submerged in it. In every case the basic personality must be evaluated with the reactive events leading up to the drinking and the pattern of alcoholic behavior. The amount of support from families and whether the employment or work is still open to them require investigation.
6. *Socio-therapy:* This treatment involves the modification of environmental situations, change in attitude, and the provision of healthy social gatherings and groups. It is directed towards counseling the patients' wife, husband or family and helping them make a readjustment in the family and community setting. To heal their social contacts in the form of a religious gathering, social clubs emphasizing inspirational and spiritual elements may also prove useful in the treatment of alcoholics. The staging of plays, cultural programs, showing of movies emphasizing the ill effects of alcoholism and the tranquility of life may also prove valuable. Religious gatherings purify the path of the individuals. They may be helped by the Almighty or religious ideas, certainly a power greater than their own self, for admitting their mistakes, controlling their drinking with the provision of emotional support. The participation in the social groups like Alcoholic Anonymous (a group composed of people who have given up drinking) may also prove useful for alcoholics to enjoy social fellowships to gain insight into their behavior and overcome their addiction.

Duration of Treatment and Follow-Up: The duration of treatment in the case of alcoholics depends largely on the severity of the case. If they remain away from alcohol for five years, they can usually be regarded as cured. But there are many chances and incidences for relapse which is frequent in the first two years. Great care should thus be taken in follow-up when treatment is over.

To Sum Up

The term alcoholism refers to excessive drinking or dependence on alcoholic beverages to the extent of disrupting life and malfunctioning of the behavior causing severe physiological, psychological and social damage.

The habit of excessive drinking or dependence on alcoholic beverages is perpetuated gradually under some specific phases. In this concern, the initial pre-alcoholic phase lasts from two months up to two years and is characterized by a gradual shift from infrequent or light to frequent or heavy drinking. In the second prodromal phase, alcohol is used more as a drug and less as a beverage. In the third crucial phase the dependency on alcohol increases to the extent that there is a danger of losing everything that one values. In the last 'chronic phase' the individual lives only to drink.

Alcoholism costs alcoholics quite dearly. They are likely to be ruined in terms of their physical and mental health, emotional and social relationships, and economic and moral assets. Regarding the reasons for becoming alcoholic, it can be safely said that no person is born alcoholic and therefore the causes of alcoholism are purely environmental. Drinking is learned and acquired like many personality traits and later maintained on account of its physiological and psychological dependence that it provides.

Regarding the treatment provided to the alcoholics for getting rid of their problem, we can properly observe that alcoholism is a medical and psychological problem rather than a law and order problem. Therefore, for dealing with it, beginning is made with the diagnosis of its early warning signals and then resorting to measures like: (i) keeping away alcoholics from any aversive life situation and controlling their behavior, (ii) subjecting them to essential clinical investigations, (iii) de-intoxicating, (iv) using deterrent measures in the form of aversion therapy, (v) providing group or

individual psycho-therapy for gaining insight into their behavior and adequate adjustment and (vi) providing socio-therapy involving modification of environmental situation and improvement of social adjustment.

Drug Addiction

Concept and Meaning

Drug addiction, like alcoholism, is also detrimental to the individual, and the society. It concerns an abnormal use of certain drugs like hashish, charas, marijuana, cocaine, LSD, valium, Dexedrine and mephedrone. The excessive use of these intoxicating drugs leads to increased tolerance and physiological or psychological dependence. With prolonged use, the body system habituates to the particular drug so that larger doses are necessary to maintain similar intoxicating effects. Consequently, the individuals develop an increasing physiological and psychological dependence on the drugs to the extent that they feel miserable whenever a particular drug is not administered. They begin to show withdrawal symptoms like lack of appetite, loss of weight, constipation, restlessness, nervousness, nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, disinterest in sexual and social relationships and even epileptic seizures or acute brain syndromes in some cases. Besides, there is an intense craving for a particular drug which they try to gratify regardless of consequences. When this happens, the individual is said to be addicted to a particular drug.

Drug Addiction

A state of acute intoxication, detrimental to the individual and to society, produced by the prolonged and excessive use of a drug and characterized as: an intense craving to consume it regardless of consequences; a tendency to increase the dosage with time; physiological and psychological dependence on the effects of the drug; and manifestation of particular withdrawal symptoms on abrupt discontinuation of the drug.

Thus, drug addiction is a state of acute intoxication, detrimental to the individual and to society, produced by the prolonged and excessive use of a drug, natural or synthetic, and characterized by (a) an intense craving or compulsion to obtain or consume it regardless of consequences, (b) a tendency to increase the dosage with time, (c) physiological and psychological dependence on the effects of the drug and (d) manifestation of particular withdrawal symptoms on abrupt discontinuation of the drug.

Drugs – Types and Effects

Depending upon the nature of their effects, drugs may be classified as stimulant, sedative and deliriant (mind blowing).

1. *Stimulant Drugs*: These drugs stimulate the brain and sympathetic nervous system resulting in alertness and increase in response and motor activity. The major drugs of this category are nicotine, cocaine, caffeine and amphetamines like benzedrine, dexedrine and methedrine. The addiction to stimulant drugs makes an individual dependent, physiologically and psychologically on their ever-increasing doses for the continuous stimulation of sense organs. In the long run it results in severe loss of appetite and weight, constipation, increased anxiety and irritability, sleep deprivation, gradual impairment of intellectual functioning and periodic episodes of delirium.
2. *Sedative Drugs*: These drugs slow down the activities of an organism and diminish the responses of the brain and nervous system. As a result, these are used as pain relievers and sleep inducers and may be classified as narcotics and hypnotics. The major narcotic drugs are opium, morphine, heroin, codeine, Demerol and methadone; hypnotic drugs include barbiturates like Amytal, Nembutal and Seconal, and non-barbiturates like bromides and paraldehyde chloral hydrate. The prolonged use of sedative drugs leads to increasing tolerance and physiological as well as psychological craving for them. The

immediate effects are pleasant and there is relief from pain and lessening of voluntary movements followed by euphoria. But these effects are short-lived and are followed by a negative phase of craving for more of the drug and the consequent ill effects. The addiction to narcotics results in loss of appetite and weight, constipation, lack of sexual desire and social interests. Unlike narcotics, the addiction to barbiturates and other hypnotics primarily affects the brain resulting in intellectual impairment and disturbance of the motor functions dependent on the cerebellum.

The sudden withdrawal of sedative drugs results in dangerous withdrawal symptoms like restlessness, nervousness, excessive perspiration, nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, severe headache, marked tremors, cardiovascular collapse and painful muscular cramps. In the case of hypnotics, the withdrawal reactions may lead to epileptic seizures and delirium. If not treated in time, the seizures can cause death. Tranquillizers like meprobamate also result in addiction and have the same results as with most of the sedatives.

3. *Deliriant or Mind-Blowing Drugs*: These drugs produce transient states resembling psychoses resulting in marked confusion, distortion in thought processes, delirium, illusions and hallucinations. Marijuana produces a euphoric state involving increased self-confidence and a pleasant feeling of relaxation characterized by floating imagination. There is a considerable distortion of the sense of time and space. In some cases, the individual becomes irritable. There is a marked impairment in the motor and intellectual functioning but the users usually think that their efficiency has increased. This false sense of adequacy gives rise to incidents of reckless driving and other antisocial episodes. In many individuals the intoxication of marijuana may produce acute psychotic reactions as found with hallucinogenic drugs. The most popular mind-blowing or hallucinogenic drug is LSD – 25 or lysergic acid diethylamide. Other hard drugs of

this category are mescaline (an alkaloid and the active ingredient of peyote), psilocybin (a crystalline powder from the mushroom) and bufotenine. The outward symptoms of LSD and other hallucinogenic drugs addiction bear a strong resemblance to the behavior of schizophrenic patients. There is marked confusion, muddling in one's thinking and development of visual and auditory hallucinations. There is a false sense of well-being and the patient gradually develops a high tolerance and dependence. Another drug of this category which is most abused is methamphetamine (speed) taken in the form of intravenous injection. Prolonged use of this drug results in malnutrition, brain damage, disturbance of the heart rhythm, and a dangerous impulsive, paranoid unpredictable behavior.

Causes of Drug Addiction

Drug addiction is caused in a similar way as alcohol addiction. The actual pattern of tolerance and physiological as well as psychological dependence on a particular drug is the result of the learning process. No one is born a drug addict but actually becomes so in emulating the behavior of parents, friends and other members of society. The first dose may be taken in the form of prescribed medicine or out of curiosity, pursuit of fun and pleasure, looking for new thrills, new kicks and the possibility of a mystic experience. Some resort to drugs for the sake of company and others may seek escape from boredom. The behavior is reinforced and rewarded on account of the false impression of adequacy and well-being, temporary relief from anxiety, pleasant reverie, and short-lived pleasing effects or state of euphoria created by the drug. Gradually, larger and larger doses are needed for same results and one becomes dependent, physiologically as well as psychologically, on a particular drug. Thus, what begins as an innocuous experiment ends in disaster.

According to experts, stress is a great factor in turning an individual into a drug addict. The highly competitive, success-oriented style of living today creates long odds for a large number of young people. There is crisis of character and deterioration in values.

While the aims of life and values of the elders are meaningless, the job opportunities for the youth are rare. The education serves no purpose and there are inhibitions and taboos. All this leads one to stressful situations. One tries to seek instant relief from frustration, tension, anxieties and depression by resorting to drugs. Others use drugs to free themselves from their inhibitions, and some turn to drugs because of guilt, shame, anxiety or disappointment in life.

Prevention and Treatment of Drug Addiction

Drug addiction is not a law and order problem as is imagined in certain circles. It is predominantly a social and psychological problem. Addicts should be distinguished from criminals who supply them with drugs and live off their misery. The irony of addicts is that they depend on drugs to the extent of pathological craving so powerful that they try and manage to get the drug regardless of legal or other obstacles. The following measures prove fruitful in the treatment of drug addicts.

1. *Compulsory Hospitalization:* Compulsory institutionalization and hospitalization is a major step in the treatment of drug addicts. If the doctors wait until the patient voluntarily seeks effective treatment, they may well wait until the patients die. Drug addicts do not want treatment, they want drugs and in their usual surroundings and environment they can't be deprived of drugs. The admission in hospitals may be able to cover the following major risks:
 - Rejection by family and society that can neither understand nor manage the patient makes the patient depressed. This situation worsens when drugs are not available during the withdrawal phase.
 - The tendency to go on to harder drugs or mixed drugs to get the desired effect may lead to disaster.
 - There is a risk of killing himself by the patient on account of an accidental overdose or committing suicide when profoundly depressed

- or a misadventure under the intoxicating effects of drug.
 - There is a danger of infection or other complications when the drug is injected in the body by the individual.
2. *De-intoxicating or Drying-Out the Patient:* Attempts should be made to de-intoxicate or dry-out the patient. It may be achieved through (i) the 'cold turkey' procedure, that is, sudden total discontinuation of drugs; (ii) giving the patient progressively diminishing doses of drugs leading towards complete cessation; and (iii) substituting a less addictive drug and later seeking gradual reduction of intake.
 3. *Medical Measures:* With some patients, especially psychotic addicts, ECT or tranquilizing drugs may prove quite helpful. Adequate care is to be taken for the provision of antibiotics as there is an inherent danger of possible infection. The withdrawal reactions should also be controlled as they lead to physical or mental disaster. Adequate dietary measures in the form of glucose and vitamins are to be ascertained for compensating the drug deficiency and also adequate feeding and fluids should be ensured.
 4. *Psychological Treatment:* Psychological treatment of drug addicts needs patience and time. Long-range psychotherapy and socio-therapy is essential if the patient is to learn to face his problems and seek adjustment in society without the use of the drug.
 5. *Long-Term Therapy and Rehabilitation:* Long-term therapy is also essential. It may be achieved as follows:
 - Re-personalization: The drug addicts should be helped to form a proper relationship with therapists, doctors and nurses before they can re-establish any personal identity.
 - Specific Therapy: Withdrawal reactions and complications should be well guarded against with the help of specific drugs. For example, epileptics may need anti-convulsant, or schizophrenics may need phenothiazines.

- Re-socialization: The drug addicts must learn to socialize and adjust without the aid of drugs.
- Re-occupation: Once cured, the drug addicts should be helped in seeking employment and occupational adjustment. They need to be trained in the job skill and in persistence so that they may be accepted by their employers.
- Re-housing: They should be helped in getting adequate family adjustment and re-establish themselves by learning to accommodate and fend for themselves.

The duration and extent of long-term therapy depends upon the patient's potential and the original level of maturity which the patient has reached. If adequately cared through therapy and rehabilitation, the patient should be able to lead a full life and to develop his potential abilities.

Prevention

The primary task in the prevention involves educating the public about the causes and consequences of drug addiction. There is a need of restructuring unhealthy environment and reduction in the problems leading to frustrations, tensions and anxieties among the youth. Job opportunities have to be increased and the education system reshaped to include job-oriented and employment-based courses. The energies of students and youth should be channeled into constructive and creative projects like rural reconstruction, welfare of the society and nation, and helping the needy and the poor. This will give them a sense of purpose, an opportunity for adventure and new experiences which they seek by taking drugs. In outlining measures to prevent and control drug addiction the report of a committee headed by Dr C. Gopalan, Director-General, Indian Council of Medical Research, has enunciated the following five basic points for this purpose:

1. Society can never be free of drugs, the reason being that drugs have specific individual and social purposes and as long as they are not met by other healthier means, drug use or abuse will continue to exist.

2. Efforts should be made to reduce the drug evil to the minimum by attacking it at various points, all along the line instead of concentrating the significant efforts at one point.
3. Drug abuse, which is a term of deviance, cannot be treated in isolation from other forms of deviance and an attempt at creating any special machinery for the control of the abuse will be counter-productive.
4. One should not lose one's perspective and create gigantic and costly structures to deal with the drug problems whose significance is limited in comparison with several other problems facing the country.
5. All the drugs form a continuum and any over-zealous effort to control one drug may lead to an increase in the use of another drug.

At present there are several central ministries in India dealing with one or the other aspect of the drug-addiction problem. For controlling lack of coordination and bringing efficiency the committee has given the following suggestions:

- There should be an integrated machinery like national advisory board with the health minister as its chairman, and comprising representatives of all other ministries and professional organizations concerned with the problem. It will help in the formulation of a comprehensive and balanced policy to prevent and control drug abuse.
- The committee suggested legislation and a single central law instead of many laws dealing with the problem resulting from the dependence-producing drugs. The severity of control and regulation should depend upon the extent to which the drug finds use in medical practice, its potential for abuse and the gravity of the consequences. On this basis it has been suggested that hallucinogens like LSD, heroin, hashish and charas should be prohibited since these are harmful and have no medicinal value.
- The committee wants deterrent penal provisions against the smuggling of and trade in drugs on

the lines of other leading countries like Japan, USA and Singapore. Whereas addicts should be regarded with sympathy as sick persons and should be permitted, under certain conditions, to possess specified drugs in specific quantities, the traffickers should be dealt with firmly.

To Sum Up

Drug addiction is a state of acute intoxication, detrimental to the individual and to society, produced by the prolonged excessive use of a drug. Drugs may be classified as stimulant, sedative and deliriant depending upon the nature of their effects. There are stimulants like nicotine, cocaine, caffeine and amphetamines; sedatives like opium, morphine, heroin and methadone; and hypnotics like barbiturates, and non-barbiturates, and deliriants like marijuana, LSD and methamphetamine.

Causes of drug addiction are purely environmental and drug addiction is a matter of learned behavior, and an inadequate adjustment to the stresses of life and style of living.

Prevention and control of drug addicts involve measures like: educating the public to understand causes and consequences of drug addiction; re-structuring unhealthy environmental conditions and reducing the problems leading to frustration, tension and anxieties among the citizens; prohibiting low medicinal value and harmful drugs; and enforcing deterrent penal provisions against the smugglers and traders in drugs.

Treatment of the drug addicts involves: compulsory hospitalization; de-intoxicating; adoption of medical measures; introduction of psychological treatment; and arranging for long-term therapy and rehabilitation.

Criminal Behavior – Concept and Meaning

The terms 'crime' and 'delinquency' are legal ones and their meaning varies from country to country and in the same country from one state to another. In our country juvenile delinquency refers to the

antisocial or criminal activity of the child (below 16 years of age for boys and 18 years for girls) which violates the law. In true context, the same activity would have been a crime if it was committed by the adult.

Criminals: People of 21 years age and above committing an antisocial behavior or act serious enough for getting them convicted by the court of law in our country for violating the provisions of Indian Penal Code (IPC) and the Criminal Procedure Code (CPC).

Delinquents: The children or youths (minor in age, i.e., below 16 years of age in the case of boys and 18 years for girls) committing an antisocial behavior of the same nature that would have been termed a crime if committed by an adult of 21 years of age or above.

Young or Youthful Offenders: The individuals aged 16–21 among boys and 18–21 among girls committing antisocial acts serious enough to be in violation of the provisions of Indian Penal Code (IPC) and the Criminal Procedure Code of our country.

Problem Children: The children up to 7 years old committing an antisocial behavior of any nature even termed as crime under the provisions of IPC and CPC of our country.

In India, any person of 21 years and above convicted by the court for violating the provision of Indian Penal Code (IPC) and the Criminal Procedure Code (CPC) is a criminal. Of course, there are state laws which vary from state to state. For example, in some states or part of a state, liquor consumption, except for medical reasons, may be considered a crime, whereas in others it may not be so. Similarly, for legally labeling an individual in the age group, 7 to 18 as delinquent, he must be convicted by the court for violating the provisions of the Children's Acts, the IPC and the CPC.

The individuals between 18 and 21 who violate the provisions of IPC and CPC are midway between criminals and delinquents and are labeled 'young' or 'youthful' offenders. After the trial by the court, they are sent

either to the institution or to prisons, depending on the seriousness or nature of their crimes and circumstances.

The individuals below the age of 7 (even although committing such offences as covered legally in the term delinquency) are not labeled delinquents but are termed problem children, for it is felt that they are not mature enough to distinguish between the legal and the illegal or between right and wrong.

Delinquency

Concept and Meaning

Criminal behavior or tendency to commit crime in any society or nation is not only found among the adults, but minor children and adolescents also. These individuals are known as juvenile or young delinquents. Juvenile delinquents, therefore, are criminals minor in age legally from 7 to 16 in the case of boys and 7 to 18 years of age in the case of girls. On account of their age the delinquents are also referred to as minors with major problems. They violate the law of the land and commit offences like thefts, gambling, cheating, pick-pocketing, murder, robbery, dacoity, destruction of property, violence and assault, intoxication, vagrancy, begging, kidnapping, abduction and sexual offences. The term 'juvenile delinquents' or 'young delinquents' means the children or youths (minor in age) who deviate seriously from the norms of their culture or society and commit offences such as murder and robbery or those that are strictly age related such as age drinking liquor and sexual activities. Juvenile delinquency should, therefore, be considered a serious challenge to the well-being of the society. The young delinquents, if not handled properly, become a source of concern for the society.

Delinquency

A type of unsocial behavior committed by the children or youths (minor in age) deviating seriously from the norms of their culture or society and involving offences such as murder and robbery or those that are strictly age related such as drinking liquor or smoking.

Causes of Delinquency

1. **Hereditary Factor:** The early researches held heredity responsible for delinquency. The claim of hereditarians like Henry, Maudsley, Tredgold and Dugdale that delinquency is inherited was tested by William Healey, Cyril Burt, Conrad and Jones, Wingfield and Sandiford. They concluded that delinquency is not inherited and therefore it is unjustified to blame heredity for delinquent behavior.
2. **Constitutional or Physiological Factors:** Defective constitution or glandular systems were also thought to be the cause of delinquent behavior. Udai Shanker (1958:30) observes that "poor health, short or too big stature or some deformity which gives rise to feeling of inferiority, dispose one to more aggression, as a compensatory reaction for his inadequacies". Consequently, this leads to delinquent behavior. Apparently, this alienation seems to be well founded but it is not so, for not much scientific evidence has been reported in its support so far. However, in some cases, it may be taken as one of the causes of delinquent behavior.
3. **Intelligence Factor:** While earlier writers like Lombroso and Goddard emphasize that the most important cause of delinquency and crime is low grade mentality, Burt, Healey, Bronner, Merrill and others deny that delinquents are mentally retarded. In fact, a direct causal relationship between intelligence and delinquency is doubtful. High intelligence is no guarantee for good behavior. Often persons with superior intelligence have been found to be the leaders of notorious gangs and antisocial organizations. Sometimes it is argued on the basis of the statistics that since the majority among the delinquents possesses low intelligence, defective intelligence therefore causes delinquency. But this conclusion is not well founded. The collected statistics, in such cases, may represent an unreal picture. An intelligent individual may not be caught red handed, whereas someone with low intelligence may always be taken in custody. Moreover, defective intelligence may lead to delinquency in one situation and may be a barrier to it in another situation. Hence, low intelligence alone cannot be held responsible for delinquent behavior.
4. **Environmental and Social Factors:** It has been proved that delinquent behavior is a learned reaction. Delinquents do not inherit delinquent characters from their parents or ancestors but are made so by the uncongenial environment and social conditions. Udai Shanker (1958:30) observes that "delinquency is not inherited; it is the product of social and economic conditions and is essentially a coefficient of the friction between the individual and the community. The most important causes of antisocial behavior are environmental and sociological in character". It is therefore the uncongenial environment of the family, school, neighborhood and society which should be blamed for the delinquent behavior of the children since they pick up delinquent traits in such situations. We shall now see how environment is responsible for the delinquent character formation among minors.

Home Environment and Delinquency

A defective and deficient family environment is a fertile ground for the germination of delinquency. As a matter of fact, family life and delinquency are closely related. Findings of various studies indicate that the family environment, where the following relationships or conditions prevail, is most susceptible to delinquency.

- Broken home – where the family is incomplete due to death, desertion, separation or divorce.
- Improper parental control.
- Unusual jealousy and rivalry among the siblings or children within the family and reactions like, "My parents gave him more love than they gave me."
- The delinquent and criminal behavior of the parents or other family members.
- Domestic conflicts.
- Economic difficulties and poverty of the family.

- Dull, monotonous and uninteresting home environment.
- Denial of reasonable freedom and independence to the youngsters.
- Maltreatment and injustice done to the youngsters.
- Lack of proper physical and emotional security.

In such situations and environmental surroundings, the children do not get the opportunity for the satisfaction of their basic needs. They become victim of the emotional problems like inferiority, insecurity, jealousy or being thwarted which make them a mal-adjusted individual and consequently turn them into a hostile, rebellious and antisocial personality. Thus, uncongenial home conditions deserve to be blamed for juvenile delinquency and in all circumstances the root cause of delinquent behavior must be investigated in family background and home environment.

Uncongenial Environment Outside the Home

Whereas home provides the roots for the delinquent behavior, the social environment outside the home nourishes it by supplying some substitute for the satisfaction of unsatisfied basic needs and urges. For example, the peer group or gang presents itself as a substitute for family love and belongingness. It also satisfies the need for recognition and gives an individual the opportunity for self-dependence and adventurism. Delinquent acts of the peer group lead them to delinquent behavior and to engage in delinquent acts. Neighborhood and the places of social contracts and situations where the elder members of the society engage in anti-social activities, or the mass media like newspapers, books, magazines and cinema that acquaint children with immoral and anti-social acts, provide temptation for the youngsters to become delinquents.

Maladjustment in School

In many cases of delinquency, uncongenial school environment can be a significant emulating factor. It brings about serious maladjustment and consequently increases the probability of delinquent

character formation. Such environment may involve the following elements:

- Defective curriculum.
- Improper teaching methods.
- Lack of co-curricular activities.
- Lack of proper discipline and control.
- Slackness in administration and organization.
- Antisocial or undesirable behavior of the teachers.
- Maltreatment and injustice done to the child.
- Failure or backwardness.

To conclude, delinquency is an environmental and social disease. Delinquent acts are learned and acquired acts. No child is born delinquent nor is delinquent behavior the product of genes. Thus, delinquents are not a specific type of human beings born with innate, physical, mental or emotional characteristics. They are normal individuals with normal needs and desires. Like other normal children they also want to love, to be loved and to satisfy the need for security and recognition. The denial of these basic needs leads to maladjustment and makes them hostile and rebellious. Thus, delinquent behavior is a reaction or resentment against the prevailing social and environmental conditions. It is a revolt against parents, teachers or social organizations which do not provide them the essential environment for the satisfaction of their basic needs and urges.

Prevention and Treatment

Delinquency, besides being a legal problem, is basically a psycho-social problem. All delinquents are essentially maladjusted personalities and the result of faulty upbringing and maltreatment. The solution of the problem requires preventive and curative measures.

Preventive Measures

Initially these involve improvement of the social or environmental conditions which thwart the satisfaction of the basic needs of the individual. Some of the following suggestions may work well in this direction.

Parental Education: Parents should be aware of the psychology of delinquency so that they can treat and handle their children with understanding and provide them an environment for the satisfaction of their basic needs and urges. It requires parental education which may be provided through guidance services, clinics and voluntary social services.

The Child's Company: Parents, family members and school authorities should keep a close watch on the activities and social environment of the children and take care so that they do not fall in bad company. Antisocial elements and criminals often seek out youngsters for their own purposes. Attempts should be made to save children from them, and they should be educated in keeping away from such elements.

Substitute Environment: It is difficult to bring a change in the defective family environment or the influences of the neighborhood and peer group. In such circumstances, children should be removed from their original environment and placed either in foster homes or well-managed reformatories and special schools so that they may be provided with a healthy environment for their emotional and social adjustment.

Rectifying School Education and Environment: School environment should be healthy and congenial. The curriculum, methods of teaching, discipline, class-room behavior of the teacher and the social atmosphere of the school should be rectified so that children do not involve themselves in emotional and social maladjustment problems. The attitude of teachers who impose their authority on children and do not understand their basic needs should be changed. The headmaster as well as the teachers should be familiar with the psychology of individual difference and delinquency.

Treatment or Curative Measures

The problem of juvenile delinquency should not be regarded as a penal problem. It is an educational and welfare problem. Juvenile delinquents should not be put behind bars and treated through the penal system. Delinquents require rehabilitation and re-education for which special legal provisions should

be made. The legal dealings with the juvenile delinquents have been changed in the progressive communities of the world.

In our own country also, we have made the specific legal provision for dealing with the delinquents in the name of Juvenile Justice Act characterised with the following provisions and features.

- A juvenile who has committed an offence can be dealt with only by a juvenile court. A juvenile court differs from other courts in its philosophy, objectives and functions. The juvenile court is constituted by qualified magistrates and is assisted by honorary social workers. Special knowledge of child psychology and child welfare is an essential qualification for every member of the court. The proceedings in respect of a juvenile are not public and only specified persons are allowed to attend the proceedings. The disclosure of name, address or other particulars relating to a juvenile which can lead to identification of such juvenile is prohibited.
- No delinquent juvenile can be tried in the same way as an adult under the court of criminal procedure. A delinquent juvenile can also not be charged and tried with an adult. Under the Act a juvenile cannot be sentenced to death or imprisonment. If the court comes to the conclusion that the child has committed the offence charged with, then it can pass several types of orders ranging from releasing the child on probation of good conduct and placing him under the care of any parent/guardian or fit institution to directing that the juvenile be sent to a special home.
- Rehabilitation has been made an integral part of the institutional programs. Every neglected and delinquent juvenile has not only to be provided accommodation, maintenance and facilities for education, vocational training and rehabilitation but also the facilities for development of his character and necessary training for protecting himself against exploitation. The importance of after-care has been recognized as essential for rehabilitation of the juvenile in the community.

The Act provides for the setting up of after-care organizations for juveniles after they leave the juvenile homes or special homes, to help their readjustment, resettlement and rehabilitation as self-reliant, socially useful citizens. Many state governments have established comprehensive after-care schemes, the objectives of which are the following:

- a. To extend help, counselling, guidance, support and protection to all released juveniles whenever necessary.
- b. To help a released juvenile to overcome his mental, social and economic difficulties.
- c. To impress upon the juvenile the need to adjust his habits, attitudes, approaches and value schemes on a rational appreciation of social responsibilities and obligation and the requirements of community living.
- d. To help the juvenile to make a smooth adjustment to his post-release environment.
- e. To encourage the juvenile in making satisfactory readjustment with his family, neighborhood and community.
- f. To assist the juvenile in functioning as a self-reliant, socially useful citizen.
- g. To assist in the process of the juvenile's physical, mental, vocational, economic, social and attitudinal post-release readjustment and ultimate rehabilitation.
- h. To complete in all respects the process of the juvenile's final readjustment, resettlement and rehabilitation.

As a follow-up measure contemplated under the Juvenile Justice Act, the Scheme for Prevention and Control of Juvenile Social Maladjustment has been implemented by the Ministry of Welfare since 1986–87 to provide financial support to states/Union territories for setting up or upgrading observation homes/juvenile homes/special homes/after-care organizations and for the training of functionaries.

As a result of such legal provisions in our country and influenced by what is happening in other countries, our attitude towards delinquency is also

changing. It has now been realized that children who are called delinquents are ill primarily in their inability to conform to the social milieu. Consequently, in most of the states, the Children Act has been enforced and some have gone ahead in the work of rehabilitation and re-education of the young offenders. Separate child welfare boards for dealing with the problem of delinquency have been established and approved schools have come into existence. Some states encourage voluntary organizations to take custody of the delinquent children. Provisions for the care of the neglected and destitute children are also made so that they do not become delinquents. Some states have started foster care programs which envisage the court giving custody of a child to a responsible person. There is, however, the need to arouse public consciousness on this problem. No government can solve a social problem without public cooperation. Therefore, there is a need for a change in our attitude towards delinquents so that they may be helped in their readjustment and rehabilitation.

To Sum Up

The violation of the law of the land and committing legal offences is termed criminal behavior and the person who exhibits such behavior is termed a criminal. However, when such offences are committed by individuals, minor in age (in legal sense from 7–16 years in the case of boys and 7–18 years in the case of girls in our country), they are termed delinquents and not criminals, and their criminal behavior is known as delinquency.

Causes of delinquency are inherent in one's defective and uncongenial home, family and other socio-cultural environmental conditions instead of hereditary or biological factors. While the causes for the delinquent behavior are provided by uncongenial home and family environment, the social environment outside the home nourishes it by supplying substitute for the satisfaction of unfulfilled desires and needs.

Preventive measures taken for dealing with the problem of delinquency aim at

improving the social or environmental conditions and may involve parental education, protecting the child from bad company and antisocial environment, providing substitute for the defective environment and rectifying the school education and environment.

Regarding the employment of curative measures, we should remember that delinquents cannot be cured through legal punishment. The curative measures employed for them, thus, should involve appropriate psychological and rehabilitation attempts on the part of government or voluntary organizations. Moreover, there is a need of bringing change in our attitude towards delinquents and delinquency. As a constructive approach towards delinquency, it is a welcome sign to note that appropriate steps in our country in this direction are now taking their roots well in the shape of enacting the Children Act and making provision for the reformatories, approved schools, foster-care programs and remand homes, etc., on the pattern of other developed countries.

found to show a history of juvenile delinquency. Both delinquency and crime have a similar tendency characterized by unique reaction pattern of aggression against the social set-up. The causes underlying crimes are therefore similar to those of delinquency.

The biological factors – like defective heredity and intelligence, poor constitutional makeup or glandular disturbances – have not been found to play any substantial role in the causation of criminal behavior. The view that a criminal is born has almost been discarded in favor of the socio-psychological environmental factors being responsible for the criminal tendency in an individual.

It should be observed that criminal behavior may have a variety of forms and degree of severity. It may range from an offence which is committed once in a lifetime to a lifestyle of criminal behavior. Hence the pathology involving socio-psychological causes also varies from crime to crime and criminal to criminal. A criminal behavior is not necessarily generated and developed by a single factor or factors.

The criminals are always the victims of social mal-adjustment arising out of the defective environmental conditions and unfavorable circumstances of life. Some of these situations may be summarized as follows:

Crime

Concept and Meaning

Crime may be defined as an act prohibited by law of a country or state or a failure on the part of an individual to perform an act that is prescribed by that law. In a legal sense, a person of 21 years and above convicted by the court of law for violating the provision of IPC and CPC is labelled a criminal in our country and the illegal act for which he is convicted is known as crime. Any behavior like pick-pocketing, gambling, burglary, robbery, theft, dacoity, rape, kidnapping and abduction, attempts at suicide, murder, riots, destroying another's property, sexual assault, prostitution, cheating, counterfeiting, failure to deposit taxes and revenue, etc., are termed criminal behavior.

Causes Underlying Crime

Although it is not essential for a delinquent to become a criminal yet, in many cases, adult crime has been

1. *Learned as a Professional Art:* Criminal behavior may be learned like any professional act or art like tailoring, wood work or haircutting from the parents or the members of the family, community or race. The perpetuation of a particular criminal behavior like burglary, prostitution, theft or bootlegging among certain tribes, castes or races are some other examples.
2. *The Impact of Defective Family Environment:* The uncongenial home environment contributes to criminal character formation. It is often the result of broken homes through desertion, divorce, separation or the death of one or both parents. Moreover, the defective and deficient environment created by unfavorable intra-familial tensions and conflicts, lax parental control, poverty, sibling rivalries and maltreatment is insufficient to fulfill the basic physiological and psychological needs of children in the family. In

order to gratify their physical, social and emotional needs they are lured and sometimes forced on to the path of crime. Not only young members of the family but also the adults may be forced to lead a life of criminals on account of the frustrations caused by deficient family environment and unhealthy interpersonal relationships. For example, sex frustration may lead one to promiscuity, prostitution or even causing murder, rape or other similar offence.

3. *Economic Factors:* Poverty, unemployment, desire for the pleasures of life, competition to earn money by any means, evils of industrialization all contribute in pushing an individual towards criminal behavior.
4. *Degradation of Moral Values:* The crisis of character and degradation of moral values in society also cause criminal-character formation. Crimes such as the call-girl rackets in posh colonies and luxury hotels, adulteration of food and drugs, forgery, counterfeiting of money, bank robberies, black money transactions, smuggling, bribery and selling secrets of one's own country can be attributed to lack of moral values.
5. *Environment Outside the Family:* Whereas defective home environment and circumstances provide the basic causes for criminal behavior, the criminal environment outside the home nourishes it by providing substitute for the gratification of unsatisfied needs and cherished goals. Neighborhood, community and places of social contacts where there are opportunities for mixing with criminal characters attract and even push the individuals into the world of crime. The unhealthy impact of the mass media, especially cheap literature, obscene pictures, photographs and films encourage individuals towards crime.
6. *Social System and Denial of Justice:* The defective social system and traditions lead to circumstances where an individual learns criminal behavior. For example, the dowry system, dominance of men in the social setup and the status of a widow give rise to complications leading towards crime. The gulf between the rich and the poor, caste differences, hatred towards other

communities, races, linguistic groups, sects and religions, and the exploitation of laborers and landless farmers by landlords often lead to strained relationships and crimes.

7. *Mental Illness and Abnormal State of Mind:* Sometimes crimes are committed by mentally ill persons in an abnormal state of mind. The compulsive behaviors like kleptomania of the neurotics and abnormal behavior of the sexual deviants may lead to crime. Similarly, psychotic individuals classified as criminally insane may commit a variety of offences depending upon the situation and the state of their mind. Under the influence of liquor and drugs, offences are committed not by the professional criminals and socially and emotionally maladjusted individuals but by normal people. Individuals suffering from senile brain degeneration and mental deficiency may also be found responsible of certain offences committed in an abnormal state of mind without realizing the consequences of their behavior.

Prevention and Treatment

The remedy for criminal behavior demands preventive and curative measures.

Prevention: The preventive measures involve improvement of social factors and environmental conditions that are responsible for the germination and perpetuation of criminal behavior. The problem is a gigantic one and needs the cooperation of parents, members of the family, neighborhood, community, school or college authorities, religious heads, police and government officials responsible for the social and psychological environment of the inhabitants of a society. The following measures may be fruitful in the prevention task:

- Since today's delinquents are tomorrow's criminals, maximum efforts should, therefore, be made for the prevention, control and treatment of all the identified delinquents.
- There is a great need for social reforms and breaking social and caste barriers.

- The task of narrowing the gulf between the rich and the poor, linguistic groups and religious sects should be given priority.
- The importance of moral values should be inculcated. There should be an end to the crisis of character threatening the existence of the moral base and legal codes of our society.
- The system of education and national planning need rethinking and re-modification for minimizing economic difficulties of our youth and adults.
- The problem for unemployment has to be checked and the professional dissatisfaction as well as frustration affecting the vast population of the younger generation should be curbed.
- Attempts should be made to minimize undesirable influence of literature, films and other mass media.
- The parents, elders, government authorities, social, religious, educational and political leaders should be such that they become ideals of socially desirable behavior.
- The society should feel the necessity of providing social and legal justice to its citizens. In case of environmental deprivations and hazards of life, the affected individual should be helped, protected and rehabilitated.

Thus, there is a need for modifying the environmental conditions so that one does not fall victim to social and emotional maladjustment or isn't lured by the criminals and drifted by instinctive behavior to commit crimes.

Treatment and Rehabilitation

The old notion that criminals are born and nothing can be done for reforming and rehabilitating them still holds its ground. The law enforcement is still largely punitive and revengeful. Even in many civilized societies and developed countries the treatment provided to criminals is still in terms of tooth for tooth and eye for eye. The criminals are isolated from society, kept in prisons and punishments such

as lashing, severing of hands and legs, hanging are given in public not to deter the criminal from further offences but also to prevent others from indulging in such acts. However, as a result of an increase in the knowledge of human behavior and criminal psychology, there have been changes in the attitude of the general public, police officials and government authorities towards criminals and crime. It is now felt that for most criminals, their behavior is a part of the larger pattern of personality maladjustment. Criminal behavior is nothing but a social disease and criminals are ill primarily in terms of their inability to conform to the social milieu. With serious psychological and psychiatric problems, they need hospitalization as well as medical and psychological treatment as curative measures for their illness.

The change in attitude has ushered a new era in the management of jails which are now called correctional institutions. The progressive prison authorities are now adopting a constructive attitude towards criminals. In addition to the custodial care, the responsibilities in terms of the possible attempts to re-socialize, readjust and rehabilitate the criminals are clearly felt. The emphasis is on the study of each prisoner as an individual, as a victim of circumstances and to provide them the medical aid and psychological treatment, training and help needed for their restoration to society as a self-supporting and law-abiding citizen. The effectiveness of the curative and reformatory measures lies in modifying the behavior of criminals and equipping them with the necessary art and skill for playing a useful role in the society.

Some of the measures used in this new constructive reformatory approach are:

1. The crimes committed by delinquents or young offenders and also by the relatively normal adults during periods of acute stress and deprivation have very little chances of being repeated unless they are compelled to do so again. Also, the majority of new criminals are accidental criminals who commit an offence by chance or mishap. The environment of the prisons,

coupled with their association with hardened criminals, often convert them to a life criminal. Attempts should be made to keep them out of prisons by granting probation and making provisions for their adequate supervision by competent probation officers.

2. The constructive approach calls for change in the environment of the prison and treatment of prisoners as human beings in need of sympathy and affection in understanding their behavioral problems.
3. Many countries are now experimenting with open prisons which do not have fences or outer walls and their dormitories are neither locked nor guarded. There are open fields with situations where prisoners are provided opportunities to work for which they are paid. Their expenses are met out of their earnings which are partly sent to their families. Occasionally, they too are sent to meet their families. There is an environment of mutual love, understanding and trust prevailing in the prison providing sufficient opportunities for the modification of their behavior. They are made to learn useful social skills and readjustment in the society.
4. The ideal humanitarian approach that all prisons should be converted into hospitals – the criminals are usually mentally ill, socially mal-adjusted and psychologically handicapped individuals – is taking root in prisons of many countries. Efforts are also being made to study criminal behavior, to investigate its causes and to find ways of modifying it. The cooperation of the physician, psychiatrist, social worker and legal authorities is well sought by prison authorities for the treatment of abnormal and antisocial behavior of the inmates.
5. In some countries useful rehabilitation programs are being adopted for the welfare of criminals. In our country, the rehabilitation of the dacoits of the Chambal valley by Sarvodaya leaders may be cited as a good attempt in providing opportunities for leading a self-supporting and law-abiding life.

To Sum Up

Crime may be defined as an antisocial act prohibited by the law of the land. In a legal sense, people of 21 years and above convicted by the court of law for violating the provision of IPC and CPC are labelled as criminals in our country and the illegal act for which they are convicted is known as crime.

Regarding the causes underlying crime, it can be well inferred that criminals are always the victims of social maladjustment arising out of the defective environmental conditions and unfavorable circumstances of life. Accordingly, criminal behavior is essentially a learned pattern of maladaptive and antisocial behavior resulting through a close interaction of unfavorable social, psychological and psychiatric factors.

The preventive measures for criminal behavior involve the improvement of social and environmental conditions that are responsible for the germination and perpetuation of the criminal behavior. On the other hand, for the treatment and rehabilitation of criminals, the basic requirement demands a change in outlook and attitudes towards criminals and crimes so that criminals may be provided with hospitalization, medical and psychological treatment as curative measures for their serious socio-psychological and psychiatric problems. They should be understood sympathetically, studied individually, treated medically and psychologically, trained and helped educationally as well as vocationally, and finally, rehabilitated to become self-supporting and law-abiding citizens in the interest of their own and the society.

Review Questions

1. What is alcoholism? Throw proper light on its concept and meaning.
2. Define the term alcoholism and explain how one gets habituated to alcoholism.

3. While throwing light on the causes of alcoholism, tell how alcoholism proves damaging and harmful to people and society.
4. Discuss in detail the treatment measures employed for alcoholics.
5. What is drug addiction? Throw proper light on its concept and meaning.
6. Define the term drug addiction and throw light on the use of the different types of drugs and their damaging effects for the drug addicts.
7. What is drug addiction? How is it caused? Discuss the necessary measures employed for its prevention and treatment.
8. What is delinquency or delinquent behavior? Throw light on its meaning and concept.
9. While defining the term delinquency, throw light on its causes or factors responsible for its emergence.
10. Discuss in detail the preventive and curative measures taken for dealing with the problem of delinquency.
11. What is crime or criminal behavior? Throw light on its meaning and concept.
12. While defining the term crime, throw light on the probable causes underlying criminal behavior.
13. Discuss in detail the ways and means utilized for the prevention of crimes and treatment of criminals.

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21.

OTHER SOCIAL ISSUES AND PROBLEMS

Learning Objectives

After going through this chapter, you will be able to:

- Know about the meaning and concept of poverty.
- Throw light on the ill consequences of poverty.
- Discuss the efforts for dealing with the issue of poverty.
- Throw light on the measures employed in our country for dealing with the issue of poverty.
- Know about the meaning and concept of the term unemployment.
- Throw light on the ill impacts of unemployment.
- State what can be done for dealing with the unemployment problem of our country.
- Know about the meaning and concept of corruption.
- Discuss the causes underlying corruption.
- Tell about the ill consequences or adverse impacts of corruption.
- State what can be done for dealing with the issue of corruption in our country.
- Know about the type of aggression and violence prevalent in society.
- Discuss domestic violence.
- Know about the problem of child abuse (violence against children).
- Throw light on the issues and problems related to sexual violence.
- Discuss the violence committed by Naxalites and terrorists in our country.
- Know and discuss some contemporary social issues facing the Indian society such as: (i) same gotra and intra-khap marriages, (ii) inter-caste marriages, (iii) inter-faith or inter-religion marriages, (iv) same sex marriages, and (v) the transgenders and their rights.

Introduction

As a person, group, community or society if we exist, we are supposed to be under flux of social and cultural changes. Such changes always do not guarantee for providing us a comfortable problem-less living. As a result, it is not at all surprising to

note the presence of one or the other types of social issues and problems in the functioning of a society all over the world at all time periods of its history. These social issues and problems faced by the world societies and their people are quite wide and varied differing in their nature, intensity and consequences.

We have already discussed three of such social problems, namely alcoholism, drug addiction and criminal behavior in the previous chapter. In this chapter, we are going to discuss some of the burning social issues and problems being faced by the world societies, particularly in reference to our own country. Specifically, here we would be discussing the social issues and problems like (i) poverty; (ii) unemployment; (iii) corruption; (iv) various types of aggression and violence prevalent in society; and (v) the issues and problems arising on account of the same gotra, inter-caste and inter-faith love affairs and marriages, and challenges posed by the same sex marriages and transgenders' struggle for equal rights. For this purpose, let us start here with the discussion about the issue concerning poverty.

The Issue Concerning Poverty

Meaning and Nature

Poverty is a quite major social issue and problem for all the societies and nations of the world all over the globe. The term poverty has been defined in the Merriam Webster Dictionary as "the state of one who lacks a usual or socially acceptable amount of money or material possessions".

We see that, here, in this definition one's poverty has been interpreted in two senses – one in its usual form and the other as socially acceptable. It leads us to conclude about the two distinct types or forms of the poverty of the people, families and communities. We can name them as (i) absolute poverty and (ii) relative poverty.

- Absolute poverty, in terms of the usual or most common interpretation of the term poverty, stands for the type or form of the poverty of the people, family and community in which they are found to suffer from the complete lack of the means necessary to meet their basic needs. However, here also the differences may arise in terms of the interpretation of the term basic needs. When taken in its narrow meaning, it usually stands for meeting one's most

basic personal needs such as food, clothing and shelter. However, with the change in the socio-economic status of the people and families we may find that in the list of basic needs, now it is quite common to enlist the needs like access to clean drinking water, sanitation and health care, better housing, better education of the children, proper road and transportation facilities, etc. In this type of poverty, the basis on which we label a person, family or community as poverty ridden is the same. It remains quite independent of their permanent location or era.

- Relative poverty, on the other hand, stands for the type and form of poverty that is relative. It is said to occur when a person or family is unable to meet a minimum level of standard of living, compared to others in the same time and place. The basis on which we define relative poverty varies from place to place and time to time. For example, in a locality where most of the residents are living in properly constructed brick houses, the families having thatched roof houses are likely to be termed as poverty ridden families but not when some of the people and families in the same locality and time period are bound to live in tents or even forced to live on pavement.

Now question here may arise as to how to take decision about the state of poverty of people and family in a particular society at a particular time period. It is taken on the basis of drawing an index of poverty that may be found to differ from place to place and time to time at the same place. Every state and county, therefore, may be found to draw an index or poverty line grounded on the income and facilities being enjoyed for living by its people for determining how many of its people are living in poverty.

In whatever ways the poverty of the people gets defined or picks up its absolute or relative form, one thing is quite certain: that its impact and consequences are always quite damaging and devastating for the suffering people, families and the community as a whole. Briefly we may state it as follows.

The Ill Consequences of Poverty

Poverty is a curse in itself. In all its forms and shapes, it results in quite devastating and damaging consequences not only for the affected individuals, families and communities, but the society and humanity as a whole also have to bear the blunt of these consequences. In brief we may outline the ill consequences of the poverty in the manner as follows.

- The deaths or suicides on account of the starvation and lack of economic support.
- Malnutrition problems suffered on the part of pregnant mothers, and children leaving a quite damaging effect on the health and well-being of mothers and developing children.
- Occurrence of severe health problems, diseases and untimely loss of lives on account of the lack of essentials such as proper sanitation, clean water, health care and medical facilities.
- Access to good schools, healthcare, electricity, safe water, proper transportation facilities, and other critical services remains elusive for living a worth life for a number of people and families living below the poverty line in a particular society.
- The blockage and obstacles suffered in the path of the proper development and progress in life from early childhood on account of a lack or denial of educational facilities, skill learning and opportunities for seeking employment (self or otherwise), etc.
- Maladjustment, depression and frustration resulted in their life on account of discrimination and deprivation suffered by them at the hands of the well off in the society on account of the poverty.
- Compelling the parents to make their children to serve others in the form of child labor, slaves and prostitutes.
- What is termed as class struggle is absolutely the fight between haves and have nots, the so-called poor and rich. It is the typical consequence of poverty of the section of a people who believe that they are poor on account of the haves enjoying economic,

social and political power. As inequality increases, heightened poverty is likely to cause increased tensions in society visible in the form of increases in the rate of crimes, terrorist or Naxalite activities, etc.

- One thing is also quite typical with the impact of poverty on people, families and communities; that is once inflicted with it, it becomes quite difficult for coming out from its vicious circle. Poverty is a difficult cycle to break and often travels from generation to the generation. For those able to move out of poverty, progress is often temporary. Sudden economic shocks, food insecurity and climate change may threaten their gains and push them back into poverty.

The so mentioned ill consequences of poverty remind us about taking appropriate timely measures for the reduction and alleviation of poverty of the people, family and community. The problem is quite serious and big in size. It needs the multi-dimensional efforts from international, national, regional, local and individual platforms.

Efforts for Dealing With the Issue of Poverty

For the eradication and providing necessary help to the needy poor people and community, well intended efforts are always needed. Personal contribution of the people in this concern also matters much. If people decide to educate themselves and learn skills for gaining meaningful employment, work with all their sincerity in doing their job, avoid getting habituated with bad habits such as alcoholism, drug addiction and indulging in meaningless disputes, violence and criminal behavior much can be achieved by them with their own efforts for reducing and eradicating their poverty. Regarding other measures adopted for this purpose, where at their local level, the governments of the respective countries need to do their best at the international level, the United Nations and the World Bank are major advocates in reducing world poverty.

The World Bank has an ambitious target of reducing poverty to less than 3% of the global population by 2030. Some of its actionable plans to eliminate poverty include the following:

- Installing wells that provide access to clean drinking water.
- Educating farmers on how to produce more food.
- Constructing shelter for the poor.
- Building schools to educate disadvantaged communities.
- Providing enhanced access to better health care services by building medical clinics and hospitals.

Measures Employed in Our Country

Right from gaining independence, adequate measures and attempts have been made by the Government of India in close cooperation of the state governments for the eradication of poverty. Through its Poverty Alleviation Programs, it is trying to reduce the rate of poverty in the country by providing proper access to food, monetary help and basic essentials to the households and families belonging to the BPL (below poverty line) category. BPL is set by the Government of India based on a threshold income. The households or individuals having an income below this threshold value are considered to be under the below poverty line. In its simple meaning, the poverty line is the minimum income required to purchase the basic goods and services that are essential to satisfy the basic human needs.

At present, the major programs and schemes under operation for the alleviation of poverty may be briefed as follows.

1. *Jawahar Gram Samridhi Yojana (JGSY)*: The main aim of this program is the development of rural areas. Infrastructure – i.e., roads to connect the village to different areas, and also other social, educational (schools) and infrastructure like hospitals. Its secondary objective is to give out sustained wage employment to the rural people.
2. *National Old Age Pension Scheme (NOAPS)*: The scheme provides pension to all old people who are above the age of 60 who could not fend for themselves and did not have any means of subsistence. The pension rate has now been revised from Rs 200 to 2000 a month.
3. *National Family Benefit Scheme (NFBS)*: It aims to provide a sum of Rs 20000 to the beneficiary who will be the next head of the family after the death of its primary breadwinner. The breadwinner is defined as a person who is above 18 who earns the most for the family and on whose earnings the family survives.
4. *National Maternity Benefit Scheme (NMBS)*: This scheme provides a sum of RS 6000 to a pregnant mother who is aged above 19 years in three instalments. The sum is provided normally 8–12 weeks before the birth in three instalments and can also be availed even after the death of the child.
5. *Annapurna Scheme (AS)*: It aims to provide 10 kg of free food grains to the eligible senior citizens who are not registered under the National Old Age Pension Scheme.
6. *Integrated Rural Development Program (IRDP)*: It aims to raise the families of identified target groups (small and marginal farmers, agricultural laborers and rural artisans) living below the poverty line through the development of sustainable opportunities for self-employment in the rural sector.
7. *Pradhan Mantri Gramin Awaas Yojana (PMGAY)*: It is aimed to provide affordable housing to rural people by 2022.
8. *Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 (MGNREGA)*: It is aimed to provide at least 100 days of guaranteed wage employment in a financial year to all the families of rural areas whose adult members opt for unskilled labor-intensive work.
9. *Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yozna (PMJDY)*: It is aimed to guarantee access to financial services, such as basic saving and deposit bank accounts, insurance coverage of Rs 2 lakh and life insurance cover of Rs 30000.

10. *Self-Employment Program (SEP)*: It is aimed to provide financial assistance to urban poor for setting up gainful employment ventures/enterprises suited to their skill, training and aptitude.
11. *Deendayal Antodaya Yozna: National Urban Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NULM)*: It is aimed to enable poor to access gainful employment and employment through skill training and placement, subsidy to urban poor, shelters to urban homeless, social mobilization and institutional development.
12. *Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi Yozna (PMKSNY)*: It is aimed to provide income support to the farmers and their families. Under this scheme, all small and marginal farmers will be provided with income support of Rs 6000 per year in three instalments which will be deposited directly to their bank accounts.
13. *The Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Yojana (PMGKY)*: It is aimed to provide free food grains to the BPL families – 5 kg of wheat/rice and 1 Kg of pulses per family.
14. *Pradhan Mantri Shram Yogi Maan-Dhan Yozna (PM-SYMY)*: It is aimed to provide an assured monthly pension of Rs 3000/- per month after attaining the age of 60 years to the workers in the unorganized sector such as street vendors, rickshaw pullers, agricultural workers, mid-day meal workers, construction workers or workers in similar other occupations.
15. *PM Jan Arogya Yojana (PMJAY), Ayushman Bharat program*: It aims to provide medical facilities for the poor by opening 1.5 lakh health centers across the country and providing an insurance cover of Rs 5 lakh, targeting the poor, deprived rural families and identified occupational categories of urban workers' families.
16. *Training of Rural Youth for Self-Employment (TRYSEM)*: It aims to help unemployed rural youth between the ages of 18 and 30 years to acquire skills for self-employment.
17. *Sampoorna Grameen Rozgar Yojana (SGRY)*: The program is self-targeting in nature and aims to provide employment and food to people in rural areas who live below the poverty line.
18. *Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY)*: It aims to enable a large number of Indian youths to take up industry-relevant skill training that will help them in securing a better livelihood.
19. *Start Up India Scheme (SUIC)*: It aims at developing an ecosystem that helps in the promotion and nurturing of entrepreneurship across the country.
20. *Stand Up India Scheme (SUIS)*: It aims to facilitate at least one SC or ST borrower and at least one woman borrower to take bank loans between Rs 10 lakh and Rs 1 crore per bank branch for setting up a greenfield enterprise.

To Sum Up

Poverty is a major social issue and problem for all the societies and nations of the world. As a term it stands for the state of one who lacks a usual or socially acceptable amount of money or material possessions. The decision about the state of poverty of people and family in a particular society at a particular time period is taken on the basis of drawing an index of poverty and then drawing a poverty line. The families or individuals having an income below this threshold value are considered to be under the below poverty line (BPL). In its simple meaning, the poverty line is the minimum income required to purchase the basic goods and services that are essential to satisfy the basic human needs in one or the other social setup.

Poverty is a curse in itself. In all its forms and shapes, it results in quite devastating and damaging consequences not only for the affected individuals, families and communities but the society, and humanity as a whole also has to bear the blunt of these consequences.

For poverty eradication and providing necessary help to the needy poor people and community, well intended efforts are always needed. For this purpose, where at the international level, the United Nations and the World Bank are providing necessary

assistance for this purpose, at the local level the governments of the respective countries need to do their best. In our country, the Government of India in close cooperation of the state governments is fulfilling its responsibilities right from the independence of the country. In this concern, at present, a number of useful programs and schemes are under operation for the alleviation of poverty in the country.

The Issue Concerning Unemployment

Meaning

Unemployment is also known and termed as a quite major social issue and problem before the world communities especially the developing and undeveloped countries of the African and Asian continents. As a term, unemployment may be defined as a state or condition of the people occurring in their life when they are unable to get employed (engaged in the income generating work activities) in spite of their desperate search for it.

The III Impacts of Unemployment

The unemployment of the people of a family or community is well linked with its economic health. Higher the number of persons unemployed in a family/community, greater is the possibility of its being poverty ridden. Apart from becoming a major source of the generation of poverty, and proving a major obstacle in the normal progress and development of a society or nation, unemployment of the people is found to result in so many other adverse consequences as follows.

- It may become a major cause and source for the generation and perpetuation of a number of so many undesirable practices, unsocial behaviors and misconduct on the part of unemployed adults. Indulgence in the illegal and wrong activities for earning money like chain

snatching, vehicle lifting and conducting robbery acts are thus very much associated with the unemployment of our youths and adults.

- The unemployed youths and adults have a greater possibility of being lured and entrapped by the culprits and bad elements in adopting their illegal profession and criminal activities.
- The depression and frustration caused on account of a long chain of unemployment may push them towards alcoholism, drug addiction and one or the other types of criminal behavior. In addition, it may become a major source for their withdrawal behavior and suicide attempts leading to a great loss to the human resources of the society.
- The unemployed youths are more prone to indulge in the quite damaging antisocial violent behavior such as terrorism and Naxalite activities. Expressing his views on this aspect, our late President V.V. Giri once commented: "Unemployment is the problem of problems. Unemployment has made our youths Naxalites. Educated youth are deprived of all deserving comforts and their growing discontent has given scope for the speedy growth of Naxalism."

How to Deal With the Unemployment Problem of Our Country

In our country we are facing unemployment problem at a quite large scale. It is proving a quite colossal waste of human resources for impeding the tempo of economic development of our country. There have been attempts in the past and some are still going on by the government agencies for dealing with the unemployment problem such as follows.

1. *Population Control:* Since the rising population of the country is one of the major contributors and causes for unemployment in our country, attempts have been made to exercise control over it. However, these have not proved sufficient. A new venture with some strict social and legal provision is awaited to deal with this major social issue impeding the progress of the country in so many ways.

2. *Introducing Needed Reforms in the Syllabi of School and College Education:* What is taught and learned in schools and colleges should be in proper tune with the capacity of the educated youths for becoming useful wage earners. We have talked about and attempted for its attainment through various commissions, committees and education policies, but of no significant gains in this direction. Up to this stage, we have seen that our school and college education has failed to do so. It has been a major cause of aggravating the situation more and more by adding in a number of educated unemployed youths. In case we try to analyze the status of unemployed youths in our country, we may find that among them largely, we have a huge number of the educated youths schooling and graduating in one or the stream of non-technical and technical education. They are all seeking white colored jobs preferably in the government services. We have a dire scarcity of the technical and field work-oriented educated people in our country such as electricians, mechanical service providers for the repair work of the water and sewerage systems, vehicles, electronic and computer technology-based equipment and services. There is a need of developing a proper attitude towards the manual labor and capacity of learning and using skills for doing the needed manual and mechanical work or spirit of getting engaged in the self-employment means. Let us hope that the new National Education Policy introduced recently may help in achieving the needed objectives in this direction.
3. *Providing Education and Training in Acquiring Needed Vocational Skills:* Each vocation and platform of providing employment to the needy youths requires a substantial level of one or the other specific skills needed for doing the activities related to that vocation or work platform. Our educated youths seriously lack in the acquisition of these skills and that is why they are compelled to stand in the endless queues of unemployed. There is an urgent need for focusing on the task of providing skill development education and training to the unemployed youths and adults so that they may be absorbed in the private and public sector ventures or find themselves capable of seeking self-employment.
4. *Making Attempts for the Needed Infrastructure and Required Facilities for Establishing and Promoting Industrial Units:* There must be a great push from all angles – government and non-government agencies – for the establishment and promotion of the industrial units in all parts of the country depending upon the favorable conditions available there for the same. The required infrastructure in the form of land, road construction, adequate provision of electricity, water and other energy related means, etc. should be made available to these units with the needed economy. As far as possible there should be hardly anything coming in their way as a hurdle from the side of government machinery for starting and running their units in a proper way.
5. *Encouraging Individuals and Groups for the Entrepreneurship in the Manufacturing Sector:* Instead of job-searching in the already established industrial units or work platforms – government or non-government – the unemployed or even the employed ones should be encouraged to pick up the idea of *entrepreneurship and self-employment* for not only getting themselves self-employed but also generating jobs for others. All possible efforts for providing due incentives, needed skill and information, land facilities, bank loan and subsidies, etc. should be done well in this direction. A suitable environment in the country with the initiatives like “vocal for local” should be generated in the country so that the manufactured goods or services provided through these newly coming *entrepreneurs* may be properly welcome and accepted by the people of the country along with the possibility of its import to other countries.
6. *Bringing Needed Reforms for Raising Economy in the Agriculture Sector:* The magnitude and proportion of the rampant poverty and unemployment is most visible in rural India. It is because the work done in the agriculture sector is less

productive and low-income generating means for the engaged people, and there is quite a lack of opportunities for the people depending on the agriculture income for utilizing their spare time to do other income generating activities. There should be thus quite sincere efforts for bringing needed reforms in the activities of the rural sector for making it more productive and income generating for the engaged people. Moreover, there should also be a mass drive for bringing attitudinal changes, equipping them with needed skills, providing incentives and facilities for getting them engaged in other income generating ventures such as dairy products, poultry, rural crafts, vegetables and fruits based small manufacturing units.

7. *Providing State Support Through the Launching of Special Programs and Schemes:* Suitable steps are also needed to be taken by government from time to time for looking into the problem of unemployment in the country. It should come to help the needy people by initiating reforms, and bringing the remedial programs and schemes in action. Government of India in proper collaboration of the state government and local self-government has tried to deal with the issue of unemployment of its youths and adults by introducing a number of useful programs and schemes (already mentioned earlier in our discussion of the alleviation of poverty in the country such as (i) Integrated Rural Development Program (IRDP), (ii) Training of Rural Youth for Self-Employment (TRYSEM), (iii) Jawahar Rozgar Yojana (JRY), (iv) Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MNREGA), (v) Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY), (vi) Start Up India Scheme (SUIS), and (vii) Stand Up India Scheme (SUIS), etc.

To Sum Up

Unemployment is also known and termed as a quite major social issue and problem for our country. As a term it may be defined as a state

or condition of the people occurring in their life when they are unable to get employed (engaged in the income generating work activities) in spite of their desperate search for it. Regarding its impact, it may be seen that the unemployment of the people of a family or community brings out a number of quite serious ill consequences for them besides making them poverty ridden in its quite damaging form.

In our country we are facing an unemployment problem at a quite large scale. There have been attempts in the past and some are still going on by the government agencies for dealing with the unemployment problem through the adoption of measures like population control, reforming the syllabi of school and college education, providing education and training in acquiring needed vocational skills, making attempts for the needed infrastructure and required facilities for establishing and promoting industrial units, encouraging individuals and groups for the entrepreneurship in the manufacturing sector, bringing needed reforms for raising economy in the agriculture sector, and providing state support through the launching of special programs and schemes such as Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MNREGA) and Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY).

The Corruption Issue

Meaning

Corruption is another big social issue and problem that seems quite universal affecting adversely the functioning of every society and nations all over the globe irrespective of their being rich or poor; democratic or autocratic; developed, developing or undeveloped. In our country also it is a quite widely acknowledged and deeply rooted phenomenon or practice rampant in many ways in all spheres and fields of our social life. By the term corruption, here in a legal sense, we mean an illegal act carried out

by an individual in the form of abuse of a trusted position in one of the branches of power (executive, legislative and judicial) or in some political, social or other organizations of a private or public sector with the intention of earning illegal material benefit to self or for others.

Causes Underlying Corruption

The generation and perpetuation of corruption in the societies or organizations – public or private – is found to be an outcome of an array of several, inter-related factors – economic, social, moral, political and administrative – discussed as follows.

1. It is true that very often we may notice that poverty and low earning is a big factor in compelling or luring people to accept bribes. However, it cannot be termed as the necessary and sufficient cause for demanding or accepting bribes. The people getting higher salary, good wages and sound economic condition may also be equally found to engage in this illegal practice.
2. In the establishments – public or private sector – the probability of arising corruption is quite more where the employees enjoy unbridled freedom for exercising their power and making decisions. In the environment of loose administration and absence of proper check-up and control exercised by some supervisory agencies, the employees may feel free in demanding and accepting bribes.
3. The ambiguity and non-clarity in the enforced public rules and regulation may also prove quite often a major cause of corruption. Unclear regulations may bring a lot of inhibition and hurdles on the path of the people thus indirectly forcing them to pay a bribe for getting the required service from the concerned government department.
4. The acceptance of bribery (giving and taking of bribe) as a common or customary practice for taking and providing one or the other services in the public sector is also one of the major causes of the rampant corruption in the government departments. It is not considered a bad practice, unholy thing or illegal practice since everybody practices it at one or the other occasions for taking out of turn illegal services.
5. The corruption is found to be more rampant in the organizations and government departments where the political environment is more favorable for its occurrence. As the king so the subjects, this saying proves true in the spread of corruption from top to bottom. Whenever in a country the top level of the ruling party or monarchy is corrupt, it becomes a model for getting imitated by the lower strata giving way to the unbridled rising in the amount of corruption.
6. However common the acceptance of bribing may be in the public, one thing is most certain in this connection that everybody fears to give and take it in the open (in full cognizance of others in public). Where there is a lack of transparency in the working of the government departments providing a major loophole in terms of secret transaction of bribing, there are always more chances in the increase of its occurrence.
7. The non-making of bribing as a criminal act or not paying required attention for punishing the offenders in a suitable way, also, may become a potent reason for its increase in a society or nation. “Nothing will happen, take bribe with no hesitation, and if somehow caught, no worry, pay a heavy bribe and all will be usual.” The prevalence of such type of attitude and sentiment among the people in general has also been responsible for providing corruption as one of the major reinforcing platforms.

III Consequences or Adverse Outcomes of Corruption

Whatever causes or factors may contribute for the germination and perpetuation of corruption, its occurrence in a society, organization and nation certainly casts a quite damaging impact over their functioning, development, progress and overall welfare in a number of ways.

1. It becomes a major cause of degradation in the moral values of a society. The easy money rolled out through corruption corrupts and degrades the people's way of living in a number of adverse ways.
2. It creates lack of transparency and a lack of control by supervisory institutions and thus becomes a stumbling block in establishing rule of law in the proper functioning of administrative machinery in the society or organization.
3. The society or organizations are very much deprived of the required talent for doing many of the jobs or work activities essential for their proper functioning and development on account of the rampant corruption. The doors for suitable or qualified persons to a particular job activity are almost closed because of their allotment to the individuals ready to pay for it or return the favor in any other way.
4. A number of developmental projects carried out by the state agencies or local self-governments suffer unnecessarily on account of the corruption rampant in the government departments or implementing agencies. There is also a huge wastage of economic resources of the country on this account.
5. It is the corruption that proves a stumbling block in the proper accessibility of due benefits aimed for benefitting the poor, unemployed, senior citizens and widows, scheduled caste and tribes, handicapped and families of martyrs. Most of the money and benefits meant for them goes in the pockets of those taking bribes for acting as middlemen for this purpose.
6. The tasks related to providing essential services to the public by the government agencies also suffer adversely. Here the poor and morality ridden gentleman are the most sufferers as they have no capacity or are morally hesitant to pay what is known as "suvidhashulk" (comfort tax) to the concerned government officials or middlemen.
7. The most devastating effects of the rampant corruption in government offices and politicians become visible in the economic, business and industrial sectors responsible for the economic development of the country in the following ways.
 - It discourages the local as well foreign investors and establishments to invest and establish their industrial projects.
 - It proves a stumbling block for providing any proper opportunity and incentives to the entrepreneurs, small investors and start-ups.
 - The survival of the small company and contractors also becomes too difficult on account of the bribe paying capacity and political contacts of the large companies and big contractors. In the presence of monopoly and absence of healthy competition, the country has to face a great loss in terms of the quality manufacturing and work output.
8. Corruption also casts a quite damaging effect on the tax collection output of a country. By taking bribes, officials exempt or levy lesser taxes on some tax payers. Most of the money meant for the government treasury thus goes directly in the pockets of corrupt tax officials resulting in a heavy loss in the government revenue.

How to Deal With the Issue of Corruption in Our Country

Corruption, as we have seen is quite fatal for the health and well-being of a society, organization and nation. We in our country are also feeling its blunt in so many ways. All of our progress and development including the maintenance of proper economic health, and implementation of the projects and schemes for the welfare of the citizens quite seem to be in jeopardy on account of the corruption rampant in each and every corner of the functioning of the government machinery. The question arises: What should be done in dealing with this vital issue? The solution of a problem, as we know, is always inherent well in the factors or reasons responsible for its occurrence. Let us also offer some plausible solution of the problem of corruption on this ground.

1. Since paying of low salary or wages to the employees may become a possible source of corruption, therefore it should be well observed that there must be sincere efforts for paying due consideration over the salary level of the employees.
2. There must be due attempts for doing away with the ambiguity and non-clarity of the rules and regulations so that the people may not be compelled to bribe the concerned authority in order to avoid embarrassment or penalty for not following the proper procedure or complying with the enforced rules and regulations for the one or the other official work or public services.
3. There must be little scope for the government officials for taking their own decision in deciding the actions to be taken on the violation of rules and regulations on the part of the people. The automaticity of action taken should be established here for abolishing the possibility of allowing/denying the asked permission, or exempting and reducing the size or amount of the penalty/tax levying.
4. The supervisory functioning should be properly established, monitored and controlled in an appropriate way for making a department or organization work in a sincere and honest way with no scope of demanding and accepting bribes on the part of its employees for one or the other public work or services. What they do, and how they function and deal with the public should have desirable transparency. They should be made to feel that their illegal acts of bribing will remain no secret and they are liable to be prosecuted for their illegal act. In this concern, wherever more technologically based system will come into operation, the more possibility will arise to exercise control over the issue of corruption through the resulted transparency in public dealing.
5. There is a need of bringing desirable attitudinal change towards corruption on the part of people in general. Bribing should not be taken as granted, a phenomenon that is unavoidable, a practice that is normal and bears no immorality and illegality. Efforts should be made to generate negative feelings and attitudes towards bribing from early childhood through a well-planned scheme of moral education. In daily life the parents and responsible members of society including those in power and authority should come forward to act as good exemplary of anti-bribing. Those indulging in corruption should be duly noticed, morally and socially condemned and booked for the legal proceedings, thus creating an environment not of tolerance but penalization against corruption.
6. It is true that when there is scarcity of opportunity of employment and promotion, there is a competition for availing it by hook and crook. The same also occurs with the establishments and people putting their bids and tenders for obtaining some permission and contract by giving the bribing amount as a part of their investment. The solution lies in the maintenance of transparency in the proceeding of these activities and instilling a feeling of confidence in the fairness of the game. Once it is done, it will surely help in stopping the urge of bribing among the people as a shortcut or better means for serving their ends.

In this way, the clarity observed in the framing of rules and regulations, simplifying their implementation, creating proper awareness and negative attitude towards the evil of giving and taking bribes and transparency observed in the functioning of government departments and public dealing with the help of the developed technological means may prove quite helpful in dealing with the problem of corruption. The phenomenon of inducing fear among the offenders may also work well as a warning signal and workable deterrent of not getting engaged in illegal acts. This fact may also be properly utilized in dealing with the issue of corruption. The people as a giver or receiver of bribes should remain fearful of being exposed and punished heavily for their illegal acts and we will see that it will help in getting desired results in exercising proper restraint over the rampant corruption.

To Sum Up

Corruption is also a quite big and major social issue and problem before our nation. By the term corruption, here in a legal sense, we mean an illegal act carried out by an individual in the form of abuse of a trusted position while working in an organization with the intention of earning illegal material benefit to self or for others.

The generation and perpetuation of corruption in societies or organizations – public or private – is found to be an outcome of several interrelated factors – economic, social, moral, political and administrative. With a quite loose provision of restraining or deterring punishing measures, the giving and taking of bribery have become a common and almost acceptable practice in the public or private sector of our society. We in our country are feeling its blunt in so many ways including the impediment of all of our progress and implementation of the projects and schemes for the welfare of the citizens. The measures for dealing with this issue are urgently needed on the part of law enforcing agencies with the required cooperation of the people on this account. These may include (i) clarity observed in the framing of rules and regulations for its deterrence and simplifying their implementation, (ii) creating proper awareness and negative attitude towards the evil of giving and taking bribes, (iii) observing transparency in the functioning of government departments and public dealing with the help of the developed technological means, and (iv) inducing fear among the offenders to work as a warning signal and workable deterrent of not getting engaged in illegal acts.

Aggression and Violence Prevalent in Society

Aggression and violence of one or the other nature prevalent in society is also a quite big issue and

major problem. In all its forms and shapes it creates a great hurdle in the peaceful living and general welfare/well-being of the members of the society along with impeding development and progress of the society/nation in a big way. Regarding the types of violence rampant in our society we may particularly name them as: (i) domestic violence, (ii) child abuse – violence against children, (iii) sexual violence and (iv) violence committed by Naxalites and terrorists.

Let us discuss all these four types or forms of violence one by one.

Domestic Violence

Meaning: As a word meaning, the term *domestic violence* stands for a type of violence domestic in nature. In this sense, it needs to be considered as the type of violence involving the members of a family. Traditionally in our societies the term domestic violence has been more often used for the aggression and violence against the female folks on the part of a single member – man or woman – or collectively by more than one family member in its one or the other forms. More broadly and accurately, the term domestic violence, as asserted by Crisp and Turner (2014:240), however, needs to be defined “as verbal or physical aggression and violence towards any member of one’s family”.

The cases reported with police, legal and social helping agencies as well as coming into notice from our daily observations also may point out the occurrence of domestic violence in its quite varied and broad form among the families. In general, thus, we may note the occurrence of the following forms or types of domestic violence in society.

1. *Violence Committed by Husbands Against Their Wives:* Here we may include the cases related to wife beating or assaulting physically or emotionally in a variety of ways by their husbands (or in some cases vice versa). In our society, it may be found to be prevalent in a greater degree particularly among the illiterates, rural communities and laborers.

2. *Violence Committed by Family Members Against a Particular Female Member*: Here we may include the cases where a single female member is made a target of aggression and violence for one or the other grounds. In this concern, the violence against a newly married woman on the part of her in-laws, particularly mothers- and sisters-in-law, is quite common in our society.
3. *Violence Committed by the Son and Daughter-in-Law Against Their Aged In-Laws*: Here we may include the cases where the aged parents are subjected to physical and psychological harms at the hands of their own sons along with daughters-in-law.
4. *Violence Committed by One or the Other Family Members Against the Child of Their Own Family*: Here a child is found to be a victim of the aggression and violence committed towards him or her by one or the other members of the family including sex violence.
5. *Familicide (Extreme Violence Within Families)*: Here in this type of family violence, individuals are found to kill their own spouse and one or more of his/her own children.

Measures for Dealing With the Problem

For dealing with the problem of domestic violence, we have to take measures first for its prevention. But if it occurs in one or the other ways, its cure and treatment should then also be kept in view. The following ways and means may be adopted for this purpose.

A. Providing Needed Awareness About the Problem and Its Solution

There must be a genuine attempt for adopting public education as a basic strategy for dealing with the issue of domestic violence with the objective of carrying out some specific functions such as the following.

- Creating proper awareness among the sufferers of domestic violence that they are getting tortured and subjected to harassment and maltreatment of one or the other kind on account

of the malicious, offensive and socially undesirable as well as legally criminalized behaviors of their own kith and kin.

- Making efforts to bring desired change in the attitudes of the public for removing the ill-conceived ideas, stereotypes and values that condone or ignore domestic violence such as (a) males are made to dominate and women to be tolerant about the behavior of their husbands and other family members; (b) women provoke, can tolerate or even enjoy a certain level of violence from their spouses; (c) children should tolerate and obey what is asked by the elders without questioning; and (d) there should be enough tolerance among the family members for the incidence of domestic violence for the cause of maintaining the family as an intact unit, etc.
- Getting the public adequately equipped with the necessary information about the existence of some or the other social agencies, NGOs and helpline besides calling police with their address and phone numbers for getting needed help in distress.
- Making the people know that “right to be free from domestic violence or the threat of domestic violence is a fundamental and universal human right and it is preserved by legal laws in every country”. We have legal acts and provisions for the same in our country in the manner as follows.

(i) *Legal Provision for Domestic Violence Against Women*: Dowry Prohibition Act 1961: It was meant for making the act of giving and receiving dowry a crime. In an effort to provide it more teeth, two new sections, Section 498A and Section 304B, were introduced into the Indian Penal Code in 1983 and 1986.

Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act (PWDVA) 2005: It provides quite effective protection of the rights of women guaranteed under the constitution who are victims of violence of any kind occurring within the family and for matters connected thereto. It recognizes four types of domestic violence: physical; verbal and emotional (including

not having a child or a male child, marrying without consent); economic (including violence related to stridhan, dowry, property); and sexual (includes sexual abuse and marital rape).

(ii) *Legal Provision for Domestic Violence Against Children*: National Commission for Protection of Child Rights: A statutory body for ensuring the protection of child rights including the protection from cases of domestic violence.

The Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, 2012: It specifically stands for helping children with sexual abuse.

(iii) *Legal Provision for Domestic Violence Against the Elders*: There is no specific law for protection of elderly from torture as mentioned in national policy for older persons of India. However, in the name of their maintenance and welfare we have a law named as: Maintenance & Welfare of Parents & Senior Citizens Act-2007.

B. Measures for Helping the Victims in Distress

Helping the victims of domestic violence in their time of need is a typical and complex issue. It needs the cooperative efforts of the public and the law enforcing agencies including the victims themselves in the ways and means as follows.

- The first opportunity to be helped in distress lies with the victim themselves. They should, through an awareness program, make themselves capable of protecting themselves from the damage caused through domestic violence. It is better for them to have in confidence somebody from their family, relatives, friends or neighbors, to tell them about their problem so that these people may keep a vigil to notice what is happening to them by their formal or informal visits, or communications through phones. At the time of distress or any possibility of such the victims should themselves try to contact them first for necessary help.
- Regarding getting legal help and protection they should be helped or they themselves should try to approach the organization or authority like

an NGO, women/child or senior citizens organizations or the police, whichever is most easily accessible.

- After receiving information about the distress of the victims, it is the duty of the NGOs and police officials to provide the needed assistance and help to the victims at the spot in the manner as per requirement of the situation.
- It is the duty of the police officials for booking the perpetrators of violence and helping the victims to get legal assistance.

To Sum Up

As a term domestic violence may be defined as "verbal or physical aggression and violence towards any member of one's family. In general, thus, we may notice it to be occurring in its various forms or types such as: violence committed by the husbands against their wives, violence committed by the family members against a particular female member, violence committed by the son and daughter-in-law against their aged in-laws, Violence committed by one or the other family members against the child of their own family and familicide (extreme violence within families).

For dealing with the problem of domestic violence, it starts by making people aware about the various legal provisions existing in our country for the purpose such as:

- Dowry Prohibition Act 1961 and Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act -PWDVA, 2005 for dealing with the domestic violence against women.
- National Commission for Protection of Child Rights, and The Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, 2012) for children.
- Maintenance & Welfare of Parents & Senior Citizens Act-2007 for dealing with the violence against the elders.

Next comes the task of helping the victims of domestic violence in their time of need. Here, it is needed to arrange for the cooperative efforts of the public and the law enforcing agencies including the victims themselves in a quite cautious and appropriate way.

Child Abuse (Violence Against Children)

The aggression and violence committed against children on the part of adult members of the society in a physical, verbal or emotional form resulting in their pain and suffering in one or the other ways and affecting their life in a quite negative and adverse way is commonly known by the term child abuse. In its variety and form, child abuse may be categorized into four distinct types known as follows.

Child Abuse

The type of violence committed against children on the part of adult members of the society in its various forms such as physical, psychological, neglect and sexual.

1. *Physical Abuse*: In such type of abuse, the child is subjected to maltreatment and assault on the part of adults in the physical form resulting in physical harm and agony usually surfaced through the following physical indicators:
 - (i) Unexplained bruises and welts on the body parts suggesting the use of instruments like belt buckles, electric cords, hunters, sharp edged objects, etc.
 - (ii) Unexplained burns in the shape of cigarette burns, utensils or kitchen appliances burns, rope burns on the body parts.
 - (iii) Infected burns or wounds indicating delay in treatment.
2. *Emotional/Psychological Abuse*: In such type of abuse the child is subjected to maltreatment and misbehavior on the part of adults in an emotional or psychological form inflicting mental/

psychological pains, agonies and wounds on the mind and heart of the suffering child. In their actual happening, the emotional or psychological abuse may include a chronic pattern of criticism, coercion, humiliation, accusation or threat to one's physical and social safety.

3. *Neglect Abuse*: In such type of abuse, the child is subjected to maltreatment and ill behavior on the part of caring adults in the form of neglecting and showing indifference to the satisfaction of his or her basic needs – physical and socio-psychological. In such a situation parents and members of the family may be found to show negligence/indifference for maintaining proper hygienic conditions, providing food and eatables at the needed time in an appropriate way, caring for the proper clothing, living, vaccination and immunization at the proper time, caring for their schooling and proper education, socialization and culturalization and emotional channelization in a proper way.
4. *Sexual Abuse*: In such type of abuse, the child is subjected to maltreatment or assaults on the part of sex offenders (adults as well as peers) in the form of undesirable and unwanted sex behavior and harm or pain causing sexual activities against the wishes and welfare of the victim. The range of sexual abuse committed to children is quite wide. The behavior and activities like passing remarks or uttering indecent words, touching body parts especially the nipples, lips, buttocks, genitals of the female child with a motivated ill intention, engaging in oral and physical sex with the children (male or female) and causing harms to their genitals and body parts in the form of rape and coercion, etc. all fall in the domain of sexual abuse. Moreover, the range of people who may be found to commit such sexual abuses is also quite wide. Any person of any age, background and relationship having a developed sexual libido and more powerful than the victim, can be found to commit sexual abuses to the developing children.

How to Deal With the Problem of Child Abuse

The problem of child abuse is universal. The issue is quite vital since its after effects are quite damaging to the victim as well for the family and society as a whole. The following efforts may prove quite helpful in dealing with this problem.

1. **Educating the Parents and Elders:** Parents as well as elders in the family are the real well-wisher of their children. However, in search of the well-being of their children they are many times misguided to resort to hard punitive measures like neglect or physical abuse of their loving children. Therefore, there is a need to teach alternative methods of disciplining the child in place of physical abusing. They should also be warned not to resort to neglecting or depriving their children with the satisfaction of their basic needs – physical and socio-psychological – as it may lead to the path of maladjustment and inadequate development harmful to them and society. Emotionally, children should not be felt starved and essential measures must be taken by the parents for the preservation and promotion of their mental health. Parents and elders need also to be educated properly for preventing the cases of sexual abuse. They must have a proper rapport with their developing children and try to get skilled in noting any unwanted sudden changes in the behavior of their children. By winning their confidence and trust, they should try to go in the deep of the crisis of physical, emotional and sexual abuse perplexing the mind and heart of their children. The physical symptoms regarding child abuse should be well noted and cared for by them for helping the children to disclose any incidence of abuse inflicted on them. In addition, the parents should also be helped in seeking remedy to the victimized child through a number of available legal provisions, community help centers and counselling services.
2. **Educating the Teachers:** Like parents and elders, teachers also need to be properly educated with the dealing of the issue of child abuse by learning and equipping them with the following things:
 - Awareness about the rights of the child including the legal provisions available for the enforcement of these rights.
 - Knowledge and skill related to the warning signs for child abuse.
 - The enforcement of constructive and self-imposed discipline in place of adopting hard punitive measures in the form of physical abusing or neglecting.
 - The ways and means of securing cooperation of the parents, community people, NGOs and government agencies for the protection of child rights and prevention of child abuse.
 - The means and ways of establishing rapport and winning the confidence and trust of the children for knowing about their problems related to abuse or maltreatment by the elders or peers.
 - Providing needed guidance and counselling for the children for the purpose of making them aware of their rights, need and means of preventing abuses and maltreatment to them by the elders.
3. **Educating the Children:** It is also essential for the children to acquire needed information, knowledge and skills for getting them properly equipped for protecting themselves from the possible maltreatment and abuse on the part of their elders and peers. For this purpose, the children should be helped by the parents, family members, NGOs, teachers and government agencies working for the education and welfare of the children to acquire knowledge and skills related to the following.
 - Awareness about their rights, known as right of the children and agencies (government as well as nongovernment) helpful in securing these rights to them.
 - Ways and means of securing needed help at the time of distress while subjected to

physical or sexual abuse on the part of elders and peers.

- Awareness of the type of touch, physical contact and behavior shown towards them by the elders and peer that could be signaled as sexual abuse.
- Ability to make use of self-defense methods or techniques for protecting themselves from the physical and sexual abuse.
- Providing cooperation to the parents, teachers, guidance personnel and government agencies for the prevention as well as follow-up actions related to child abuse.

4. **Making Legal Provisions Concerning Child Rights and Child Abuse:** There needs to be established a quite functionable legal provision in a country concerning child rights and child abuse. In our country, apart from the provision laid down in the constitution, we have established the National Commission for Protection of Child Rights as a statutory body under the administrative control of the ministry of Women and Child Development, Government of India. It works for ensuring the implementation of all laws, policies, programs and administrative mechanisms as enshrined in the Constitution of India and also the UN Convention on the Rights of the Child. In addition to dealing with the protection of child rights, the commission enjoys the privilege of being armed with The Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, 2012 specifically for helping children with sexual abuse.

The Act defines a child as any person below 18 years of age, and regards the best interests and well-being of the child as being of paramount importance at every stage, to ensure the healthy physical, emotional, intellectual and social development of the child. It defines different forms of sexual abuse, including penetrative and non-penetrative assault, as well as sexual harassment and pornography, and deems a sexual assault to be “aggravated” under certain circumstances, such as when the abused child is mentally ill or when the abuse is committed by a person

in a position of trust or authority vis-à-vis the child, like a family member, police officer, teacher or doctor. People who traffic children for sexual purposes are also punishable under the provisions relating to abetment in the Act. The Act prescribes maximum term of rigorous imprisonment for life, and a fine.

To Sum Up

The aggression and violence committed against children on the part of adult members of society is generally known by the term child abuse. In its variety and form, it may be categorized into four distinct types such as:

- Physical abuse (maltreatment and assault on the part of adults in the physical form resulting in physical harm and agony to the victim).
- Emotional/Psychological abuse (maltreatment and misbehavior on the part of adults in an emotional or psychological form inflicting mental/psychological agonies to the victim).
- Neglect abuse (maltreatment and ill behavior on the part of caring adults in the form of neglecting and showing indifference to the satisfaction of the basic needs of the child).
- Sexual abuse (sexual maltreatment or assaults on the part of adults as well as peers to the victim).

For dealing with the problem of child abuse, certain helpful measures are: educating the parents, elders, teachers and the children themselves, and making legal provisions and establishing appropriate administrative machinery concerning child rights and child abuse. In our country, for making legal provision to deal effectively with the problem, we have enacted The Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, 2012 and established the National Commission for Protection of Child Rights incorporating the issue of helping children with sexual abuse.

Sexual Violence

The term sexual violence stands for some or other types of violence committed on any member belonging to either sex – male or female – by an individual or group of individuals. In societies, its occurrence is usually visible in its two more prominent forms – sexual harassment and rape. Let us examine these.

Sexual Violence

The type of violence committed on any member belonging to either sex – male or female – by an individual or group of individuals usually visible in its two more prominent forms – sexual harassment and rape.

Sexual Harassment: It refers to an undesirable and unwelcome verbal, visual or physical conduct of a sexual nature committed on the part of an offender to intimidate, tease and harass the victim on one hand and also satisfy his or her own sexual desire and motive on the other. It can be expressed in forms like passing comments and degrading remarks; making unwanted sexual advances towards the victim; and sexual assault of a physical nature (but not a rape in this case).

Sexual Assault in the Form of Rape: It is a quite serious type of sexual violence and heinous crime of a physical nature that is committed towards the victim – the female – on the part of an individual or group of individuals. However, the definition of rape is not universal. It differs from country to country according to its legal provisions.

For example, in our own country according to Section 375 of the Indian Penal Code (IPC), a man is said to commit “rape” if he:

- (i) Penetrates his penis, to any extent, into the vagina, mouth, urethra or anus of a woman or makes her to do so with him or any other person; or
- (ii) Inserts, to any extent, any object or a part of the body, not being the penis, into the vagina, the urethra or anus of a woman or makes her to do so with him or any other person; or

- (iii) Manipulates any part of the body of a woman so as to cause penetration into the vagina, urethra, anus or any part of body of such woman or makes her to do so with him or any other person; or
- (iv) Applies his mouth to the vagina, anus, and urethra of a woman or makes her to do so with him or any other person.

In this way, we may see that the concept of rape as provided in the preceding definition, although mentioning the different types of offending sexual acts in this concern, is quite biased. It's not gender neutral. It does not take into consideration the non-consensual sexual acts on a man by a woman and it always considers woman as victim. Similarly, it does not take into consideration, the non-consensual sexual acts going on between the adult members of same sex or with the third gender.

In comparison, the US legal provisions have a quite broader concept of the term rape. Here it is defined as: “The penetration, no matter how slight, of the vagina or anus with any body part or object, or oral penetration by a sex organ of another person, without the consent of the victim.”

In this definition, you may see the purposeful use of the word person for making the concept of rape as gender neutral. It clearly conveys that the gender of the victim and perpetrator may be any one – male, female or neutral.

As far as the incidences of rape going on in the different societies or countries, it may be clearly inferred from the news coming on from the mass media including the online communications, as well reported in the crime reporting by the states, that it is quite universal and is getting increased day by day in its frequency, intensity, the manner and conditions in which it is committed as well as the intensity of cruelty and brutality perpetrated to the rape victims. It may occur as result of physical force (having sex under actual or threatened violence) or through *incapacitation*: having sex with a victim who has been induced into a blackout with Rohypnol (“roofies”), who is drunk and or otherwise drugged, or who has passed out (Breiding et al., 2014).

Moreover, it is neither related to any age and gender of the persons involved and relationships, familiarity or unfamiliarity lying between them, nor confined to any particular reason for its occurring. We can witness the incidences of rapes going on with quite small babies to the quite old aged, by minors, adults and aged people with no consideration of their age or gender. There are reports of rapes committed by quite close relations, even such as rapes of their own daughters by fathers, or sexual exploitation and rape of male children and adolescents by the closest female members.

Dealing With the Issue of Sexual Violence

As far as our country is concerned here it is the women who are more often subjected to sexual harassment and rape by the men folks. Therefore, here we would be discussing the measures for dealing with the sexual assaults going on with women. The measures taken for this purpose may be divided into two categories – social measures and legal measures.

1. According to the former, we must realize that sexual violence against women is not absolutely a legal issue and the social factors associated with it cannot be ignored. We may see that in one or the other form the attitudes prevalent in our society towards women and the treatment provided to them in our society contribute to making them a target of sexual violence. As a patriarchal society, we provide more importance to men and thus term the women folk as second-class citizens. In their upbringing in our families, girls are subjected to a lot of discrimination. A girl's wishes and her opinion/consent are not considered as important as that of a boy's. From the treatment received by her in her family and also looking at the same received by her mother, the female child learns to be subservient from the very beginning of her childhood. Later on, in the schools and also in other working and social situations, the elder girls and married women are made to feel that they are made to serve, obey and tolerate the behavior

and conduct of the male members including that related to sexual violence. Therefore, there is a need of bringing desired change in the prevailing attitudes towards women as well as improving conditions that are responsible for the widespread sexual violence against women. There must be an all-round conscious effort for stopping discrimination against the female child. There must be necessary changes in the curriculum of the school from primary onward for bringing a desirable attitudinal change. Boys should be taught to avoid disrespecting girls through lewd remarks and leering at them. To teach about gender sensitization by parents and teachers is also needed for the required learning regarding the sensitivities and boundaries of man-woman relationships. They should learn about gender equality and mutual respect. In addition, attempts should also be made in creating an environment for not allowing and showing tolerance towards the cases of committing sexual violence against the women folk.

2. The social measures of any effective strength are not sufficient for dealing with the sexual violence issue. These should be essentially supported by laying down and implementing legal provisions. In a real sense, we need both social and legal measures for tackling this vital social issue. It is worth quoting here late Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru who once remarked: "Legislation cannot by itself normally solve deep rooted social problems. One has to approach them in other ways too, but legislation is necessary and essential and hence that it may give that push and have educative factors, as well as the legal sanctions behind it, which help public opinion to be given a certain shape" (1961). On the latter front of providing legal protection to the victims of sexual violence, we have adequate provision of booking and punishing the offenders under the Indian Penal Code. The perpetrators of sexual violence against women according to these provisions are liable to get not only the imprisonment for certain duration, but also may get death penalty depending upon the

seriousness of the committed offence. However, much hue and cry is always raised with regard to their proper implementation. For their proper implementation, the law and order machinery of the state (police or special protection force fixed for this purpose) should show exemplary needed quick action for (i) responding to any call or clues about the possibility or occurrence of sexual violence, (ii) preventing the occurrence of the serious happenings with the victims, (iii) booking and arresting the culprits and (iv) producing them for judicial proceedings in the court by taking care of the available evidence.

To Sum Up

The term sexual violence stands for the violence committed against any member belonging to either sex – male or female – by an individual or group of individuals usually visible in its two more prominent forms – sexual harassment and rape.

As far as our country is concerned here it is the women who are more often subjected to sexual harassment and rape by the men folks. We need both social and legal measures for tackling this vital social issue. The social measures taken for helping them on this account include the efforts made for bringing desired change in the prevailing attitudes towards women as well as improving conditions that are responsible for the widespread sexual violence against women. Such social measures should then be essentially supported by laying down and implementing legal provisions. Much in this concern is required to be done always on the part of the law and order machinery of the state (police or special protection force fixed for this purpose). They should show exemplary needed quick action for helping the victim in crisis and booking, arresting and producing the offenders for judicial proceedings in the court by taking care of the available evidence.

Violence Committed by Naxalites and Terrorists

Naxalite activities and terrorist acts committed by the quite known as well as unknown groups of people who claim to be the disgruntled, revenge taker, social activists and religious fanatics are seen now-a-days to spread terror and commit quite serious types of violence and crimes against the innocent people. Let us examine terrorism and Naxalite violence.

Terrorism: The term terrorism or terrorist acts going on around the globe can be defined as “the use of unexpected violence to intimidate or coerce people in the pursuit of political or social objectives” (Gurr et al., 1989:201).

As examples of a few ghastly and catastrophic, terror spreading acts around the globe, we may cite the following.

- It was September 11, 2001, when as an act of terrorism, four aircrafts were hijacked in the USA. Two of these were crashed into the twin towers of the World Trade Center in New York and one was crashed into the Pentagon in Washington, D.C. How one can forget the devastation caused by these attacks, killing several thousand people and destroying the quite valuable infrastructures.
- It was the morning of July 7, 2005, when a group of four suicide bombers killed themselves along with 52 innocent people while exploding the bombs carrying out by them on three underground trains and bus in central London.
- It was November 26, 2008, when 10 members of Lashkar-e-Taiba, the notorious terrorist organization, carried out 12 coordinated shooting and bombing attacks lasting four days across Mumbai. The attacks, which drew widespread global condemnation, began on Wednesday, November 26 and lasted until Saturday, November 29, 2008. In this terrorist act, at least 174 people died, including nine attackers, and more than 300 were wounded.
- It was Sunday, December 13, 2001, when a five-member suicide squad comprising Lashkar-e-Taiba and Jaish-e-Mohammad terrorists

attacked Indian Parliament house, while the Lok Sabha was in session resulting in a 45-minute gun battle in which eight policemen and one parliament staffer were killed.

- Four heavily armed terrorists in 2016 attacked Indian Army's 12 Brigade headquarters in Uri town of Jammu and Kashmir. It was reported as "the deadliest attack on security forces in Kashmir in two decades", where 18 soldiers were killed. In this chain of attacking security forces, another deadly terror attack was carried out, in the year 2019, killing at least 44 CPRF personnel and injuring another 20, when a JeM terrorist drove an explosive-laden SUV into a convoy of vehicles in Pulwama district of J&K.

In all such terrorist activities we can note that these acts are performed by quite disgruntled groups of individuals, found indulged in the terror spreading acts by getting instigated, lured and brainwashed by the determined groups of smugglers, religious fanatics, social and political activists sometimes involving the states/countries for carrying out state sponsored terrorism (e.g., the terrorist activities conducted in India by Pakistan as a part of a covert war against India).

The Naxalite Acts of Violence

The other gruesome acts of violence involving the killing of innocents and destruction of public and private properties in our country are carried out by the group of individuals known as Naxalites or Naxals. In its origin and functioning, it is concerned with the Naxalite-Maoist insurgency – an ongoing conflict between Maoist groups (called as Naxalites) and the Indian government since 2005. Spreading around half of India's 28 states, now it has been mostly confined to the states of Chhattisgarh, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Maharashtra. The Naxalites more often target the police, para-military security forces, government workers, developmental projects carried out in their areas, the business magnets working in their area for extorting money and tribal population in the name of alleged espionage activities and also threatening them to join their cadre. The violence

committed by them on this account shows no limits. They can go to any extent of torturing, killing, robbing and destroying public and private properties. As examples of their gruesome acts, we are citing here what they have done through their violent acts.

- It was February 15, 2010, when dozens of Naxalite Maoist insurgents ambushed Indian security forces in Silda in West Bengal resulting in the death of 24 paramilitary personnel of the Eastern Frontier Rifles, along with the several believed to be abducted.
- It was April 6, 2010, when Naxalites carried out a series of attacks on security convoys in Dantewada district in the state of Chhattisgarh causing a quite big loss of life. It killed 76 (consisting of 74 paramilitary personnel of the CRPF and two policemen) and wounded 50 others. A few days afterwards, on May 17, a Naxalite landmine destroyed a bus in Dantewada district, killing up to 44 people including several Special Police Officers (SPOs) and civilians.
- On May 28, 2010, Naxalites carried out the derailment of a Kolkata–Mumbai night train killing at least 150 persons.
- It was May 25, 2013, when Naxalites attacked a rally led by the Indian National Congress in Sukma village in Bastar Chhattisgarh, killing about 29 people. They killed senior party leader Mahendra Karma and Nand Kumar Patel and his son while in the attack another senior party leader Vidya Charan Shukla was severely wounded and later succumbed to death due to his injuries.
- It was March 11, 2014, when Naxalites carried out an attack in Chhattisgarh killing 15 security personnel and one civilian in Tongpal village of Sukma district in south Chhattisgarh, while they were engaged in a road opening exercise in the area.
- On June 4, 2015, Naxalite militants ambushed a convoy of six Dogra regiment in Manipur's Chandel district killing 18 Army men.
- On May 1, 2019, Naxalites conducted an IED blast resulting in the deaths of 16 policemen, including a driver, in Gadchiroli, Maharashtra.

- Recently, on November 13, 2021, the Naxalite militants carried out the deadliest ambush in the Northeast in the last six years, killing an Army Colonel officiating as the commanding officer of 46 Assam Rifles, killing his wife and their 6-year-old son along with four personnel of the paramilitary force near the India-Myanmar border in Churachandpur district of Manipur state.

In all such cases of violence committed on the part of the group of Naxalites in different parts of our country we may note that these acts represent a certain type of retaliation carried out against the government machinery for expressing the feelings of their anger and resentment creeping among them for one or the other reasons. In this concern, a number of analysts have arrived at a conclusion that Naxalism is a natural outcome of the abject poverty, deprivation, exploitation, injustice and poor socio-economic conditions prevailing in the regions. In this way, in dealing with the issues and problems related to Naxalism and terrorism, there is a need of resolving it in two ways: (i) adopting constructive and heart winning means and (ii) adopting strict disciplinary measures. While taking the former type of measures, attempts are made for going into the root cause of dissensions, grievances, frustration and anger among the people of the affected region and then suitable remedial measures should be taken for making them feel normal and be part of the mainstream of the nation. In adopting the latter measures, government machinery needs to be geared fully with a cooperative effort of the security personnel of neighboring states and center for using force to make the terror-spreading culprits surrender or eliminated. With the adoption of this two-sided approach, it is a welcome sign that there has been a lot of positive output in dealing with the problem of Naxalism. The terrorists' activities are also well in the grip of being in control except in the J.K. region where our neighboring enemy is fighting an undeclared war on our ground by making use of the state sponsored terrorists. With the recent development in J.K administration and renewed determination of the security forces it is well hoped that things will get improved in defeating the objectives of the enemies of the country.

To Sum Up

Violence committed by Naxalites and terrorists is a quite serious type of violence and crime committed against the innocent people.

As a term terrorism can be defined as "the use of unexpected violence to intimidate or coerce people in the pursuit of political or social objectives". Terrorism is a global phenomenon. Terrorist activities, thus, are perpetrated all around the globe by known or unknown groups of people who try to justify their ghastly acts in the name of Jihad (religious war), social justice or political vendetta. As examples of terrorist acts committed by the terrorists of one country against other, we may here name the sir attacks carried on September 11, 2001, at the twin towers of the World Trade Center in New York and the Pentagon, Washington, D.C., and the attempt of suicide bomber terrorists killing 52 innocent people in London on the morning of July 7, 2005. In India too, every day, we are facing its blunt especially from the Islamabad backed terrorist outfits.

The other gruesome acts of violence involving the killing of innocents and destruction of public and private properties in our country are carried out by the group of individuals known as Naxalites or Naxals. Spreading around half of India's 28 states, now it has been mostly confined to the states of Chhattisgarh, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Maharastra.

In dealing with the issues and problems related to Naxalism in the Naxalite activities affected states, and terrorist activities in the most affected state of Jammu and Kashmir, there is a need of resolving it in two ways: (i) adopting constructive and heart winning means for making them feel normal and be part of the mainstream of the nation and (ii) adopting strict disciplinary measures in the form of gearing government machinery fully with a cooperative effort of the security personnel of neighboring states and center for using force to make the terror-spreading culprits surrender or eliminated.

Some Contemporary Social Issues Facing the Indian Society

In addition to the social issues and problems discussed earlier there are some typical types of social problems that we are facing today in contemporary Indian society. These may be identified as (i) issues and problems arising on account of same gotra, intra-khap, inter-caste and inter-faith marriages; (ii) same sex relationships and marriages; and (iii) trans-genders and their rights. Let us look into them one by one.

Same Gotra and Intra-Khap Marriages

In Indian society, in all Hindu families, marriages in the same gotra (clan lineage/descendance of the family) are not permitted under its traditional matrimonial system. The individuals belonging to same gotra are regarded as siblings on account of their being descended from the same family. Their marrying each other thus has been a subject of taboo. It has been therefore a common practice to inquire about the kula gotra (meaning clan lineage) of the bride and groom while proceeding on a marriage proposal. Such restriction of not marrying in the same gotra has been responsible for creating a lot of difficulties for the bride and grooms' families belonging to different castes and regions of our country. It has limited the area of their choice too much as they have been forced to take care of two taboos – one is to marry within their caste, tribe or regional identity and the other to avoid two gotras (belonging to bride and groom).

However, for doing away with such hurdles imposed on account of the taboo on same gotra marriages, a workout is now in practice on the part of the families of brides and grooms. In this workout, for dealing with a same gotra marriage, the ritual of Kanyadan of the bride in the marriage ceremony is performed by the family of different gotra (usually the bride's maternal uncle and aunt). Such workout for dealing with the issue of same gotra marriage, although serving the needed purpose, is adopted rarely at the consent and willingness of both the families – bride and groom – and usually remain

questionable by many others in the society. It is not getting digested at all by some sections of our society such as the Jat community in Haryana where the same gotra and the intra-khap marriages are vehemently opposed. In Haryana, there are villages where all people of Jat community are found to belong to the same gotra, such as Hooda, Kadyan, Malik, Sangwan, etc. Not only that, there are clusters of villages known as khaps where people of the Jat community follow a type of bhaichara (brotherhood) on account of belonging to same gotra or clan (descendants of the likewise gotra). The marriages between the couples of these villages are a subject of taboo as these are supposed to be binding with the relationship of brother and sister. Anybody violating this restriction on the same gotra and intra-khap marriages is supposed to bear the brunt of the khap panchayat. The khap panchayat is an assembly of elders in Haryana who belong to the same clan or caste, overseeing community affairs including the sanctity of marital unions across villages of the khap. These khap panchayats continue to hold sway in parallel with the state machinery and are perhaps more powerful than the elected panchayats (Panchayats under the shadow of the 'khaps').

The incidences of torturing of the couples and their families including the honor killings thereby have been in enforcement in the Jat community of Haryana under the unwritten dictate of the khap panchayats on the same gotra and intra-khap marriages, even though they have no legal sanction to do so. Village communities are known to enforce khap rulings with brutality. The following incidences may reveal the horror spread and consequences to be faced on the part of the violators.

1. Ravinder Gehlawat and his wife Shilpa had been married for less than four months when they were marched out of their village – Dharana in Jhajjar district of Haryana – by men of the local community and warned never to return. Their fate was sealed on April 24, 2009, when the local khap panchayat ruled that they had violated the local tradition of barring men and women from marrying, if the couple belongs to the same gotra,

or khap. The couple were compelled to leave the village or face consequences. (reference (i))

2. In 2013, Nidhi Barak, 20, and Dharmender Barak, 22, belonging to the Gharnavati village in Rohtak District, eloped and went to neighboring Delhi. The girl was lynched by her family, and the boy beheaded within an hour of their return to the village with an understanding that their families would finally allow them to marry. (reference (ii))
3. In 2017, newlywed couple Manoj and Babli was killed by bride Babli's family following a khap ruling that they belonged to the same gotra and were thus siblings, and any union between them incestuous. (reference (iii))

In spite of the needed attempts of the people of villages to introduce needed social reforms in the modern age of today, supported with the court ruling of declaring acts of the khap illegal, the people in the villages dare not to break the taboo on the same gotra and intra-khap marriages. This practice, added with the killing of the girl child, has been responsible for a lot of difficulties faced by the Haryana Jat community males in getting brides compelling them to make their purchase from the remote areas like Assam, Bengal, Bihar, Madhya Pradesh and even Kerala.

To Sum Up

The same gotra and intra-khap marriage is quite a big social issue and problem for some sections of our society particularly the Jat community in Haryana. In Haryana, there are villages where all people of Jat community are found to belong to the same gotra, such as Hooda, Kadyan, Malik, Sangwan, etc. Not only that, there are clusters of villages known as khaps where people of the Jat community follow a type of bhaichara (brotherhood) on account of belonging to the same gotra or clan (descendants of the likewise gotra). The marriages between the couples of these villages

are a subject of taboo as these are supposed to be binding with the relationship of brother and sister. The incidences of torturing of the couples and their families including the honor killings thereby have been in enforcement in the Jat community of Haryana under the unwritten dictate of the khap panchayats (the assembly of elders) on the same gotra and intra-khap marriages, even though they have no legal sanction to do so. In spite of the needed attempts of the people of villages to introduce needed social reforms in the modern age of today, supported with the court ruling of declaring acts of the khap illegal, the people in the villages dare not to break the taboo on the same gotra and intra-khap marriages. This practice, added with the killing of the girl child, has been responsible for a lot of difficulties faced by the Haryana Jat community males in getting brides compelling them to make their purchase from the remote areas like, Assam, Bengal, Bihar, Madhya Pradesh and even Kerala.

Inter-Caste Marriages

Another big issue faced by the contemporary Indian society is related with the holding of inter-caste marriages. The term inter-caste marriage here stands for the kind of matrimonial union taking place when two people from different castes fall in love with each other and decide to get married. It arises on account of the very evil of the caste system which is so much ingrained in the minds of the Indian people that the issues and problems related to it are quite hard to resolve. The vehement opposition and non-acceptance of the inter-caste marriage is one of them. These are banned throughout the country and breaking of this taboo is considered a major offense and unacceptable by the elders of the society. Any proposal and affair of their children leading to the inter-caste marriage is liable to face stiff resistance and non-approval on their part with the following reasons forwarded by them on this account.

- Marriage is a sacred institution and signifies a union of not just two individuals, but two families. Therefore, before getting tied in a matrimonial alliance the intended couple should try to maintain its sanctity by weighing all pros and cons for themselves and their families.
- The arranged marriages within one's own caste and consent of the families of brides and grooms always remain better than the love affair based inter-caste marriages as the latter are liable to fail and the couples are bound to suffer a lot of difficulties in getting adjusted to each other's demands and way of life. The differences in the culture and family upbringing begin to creep up after some time, giving birth to dispute and quarrelling between them. These get aggravated more in the absence of the support of their families resulting in separation, divorce and even the incidence of domestic violence, killing and suicides.
- The results of tying the knot in the inter-caste marriages do not affect only the engaged couples but the families involved also suffer on one or the other account. They are likely to face a social boycott at the hands of their community and relatives. There are problems in getting their other sons and daughters married in a normal way.
- They love their children and do not want to get them trapped unnecessarily on account of their inter-caste marriage into serious social problems such as their cultural, social, economic and occupational adjustment in the society. They fear about their future as well as their own on account of the possible problems resulted through such marriages. Apart from being not accepted by the community and ridiculed, there are instances where these couples are found to face difficulty in seeking or remaining in the employment of their own and their family members.
- These marriages in their opinion are nothing but to invite troubles at their own. There is constant fear of facing hard measures taken on the part of community head e.g., khap panchayat

dictation, honor killings and a set of challenges faced by the family to deal with on an almost daily basis.

- They also fear about the children of inter-caste marriage. These children may be made a subject of ridicule, discrimination, harassment and social boycott on the part of their peers, teachers, school authorities and community people.

Inter-Caste Marriage

A kind of matrimonial union taking place when two people from different castes fall in love with each other and decide to get married.

In this way, the couples engaging in inter-caste marriages are likely to face stiff resistance from their elders on account of the one or the other plea taken by them in this concern. With the change of the times and need of the hour, however, there has evolved a considerable change in the attitude of the elders with regard to their acceptance of the inter-caste love affair and matrimonial alliance of their children. On account of the drive of population control, now most of the parents have a quite limited number of children, i.e., a boy and girl. They can hardly now afford to cut off or disown their children even after they have gone their ways to marry against their will and resistance.

The acceptance shown by the parents and the families, in this concern, is much more seen in the urban circle in comparison to the rural one. However, one thing seems to be quite common in both the circles. The people belonging to a Hindu community in both urban and rural society are found to demonstrate almost no resistance to a certain types of inter-caste marriages. The parents and families of the girls are ready to ignore the caste condition if the boy belongs to the upper caste. Similarly, the parents of the boys are also ready to ignore the caste condition if the girl belongs to the upper caste. However, both of them – parents of the boys and girls – are not ready to accept an inter-caste matrimonial alliance proposed by their ward with a member of the

caste lower than their own. The degree of resistance shown by the parents and families is much more visible in the cases where their daughters fall in love and want to seek alliance with the groom belonging to the untouchable caste. In case of the urban locality, the couples here may not be subjected to such harsh treatment, torture and brunt of social boycott and honor killing as faced by them in the rural society. However, there are cases of punishing them severally up to extent of their killings. For the illustration purpose, here we cite a few cases.

1. In September 2018, the 24-year-old Perumalla Pranay, a Dalit youth, was hacked to death in a small village belonging to Telangana, Andhra Pradesh in broad daylight by a man suspected to have been contracted by his pregnant wife's father Maruthi Rao. The alleged offence committed by Pranay belonging to the Mala (Dalit) caste, was that he dared to fall in love and marry 21-year-old Amrutha Varshini belonging to the upper caste Vaishya. (reference (iv))
2. Haresh Kumar Solanki, a 25-year-old Dalit youth, was murdered on the evening of July 8, 2019, in Varmor village in Ahmedabad. The 'crime' he allegedly committed was that he had dared to fall in love with and marry a woman from the upper caste. Eight family members of his wife Urmila, who was two-months pregnant, hacked him to death while a women's helpline team was trying to negotiate with the father, Dasrath Singh Jhala, to send his daughter back to her husband's home. (reference (v))
3. During the same month of July 2019, to ensure her Dalit husband doesn't meet the same fate as Haresh Solanki, Sakshi Mishra from Uttar Pradesh, the daughter of BJP's Bithari Chainpur MLA Rajesh Mishra alias Pappu Bhartaul, put out a video asking the police for protection from her father and "his dogs (henchmen)", who have allegedly threatened to kill her husband Ajitesh and his family. (reference (vi))

In this way, we may notice that in our Hindu society, the inter-caste love affairs and marriages between the

Dalit and an upper caste bride are not at all accepted and the Dalit youth has to suffer more often by facing a gruesome murder. On the other hand, if an upper caste youth commits such acts with a lower caste girl including the untouchable, he is not to face such murderous assaults.

With the passage of time now, changes are rapidly taking place in the attitude of Indian society especially in the urban towards the inter-caste love affairs and marriages. In the rural society also on account of the skewed sex ratio – the shortage of the brides – more acceptance is visible for such alliances. The Dalit boys are also getting acceptance on the part of the parents and families of upper castes if they are found to enjoy power and status on account of their political position, being an official or some big businessman or celebrity. With the observation of the trend going on, it can be well assumed that the restrictions of any nature will not be hampering the way of the youths in getting engaged into inter-caste love affairs and marriages.

To Sum Up

Inter-caste marriages are also proving a quite big problem for the contemporary Indian society. The term inter-caste marriage here stands for the kind of matrimonial union taking place when two people from different castes fall in love with each other and decide to get married.

The rigidity of the caste system prevalent in our society is responsible for the vehement opposition and non-acceptance of the inter-caste marriage throughout the country and breaking of this taboo is considered a major offense and unacceptable on the part of the elders of the society. Consequently, it is quite common in our society to witness the incidence of the couples daring to tie in inter-caste marriage relationship facing the brunt of social boycott, torture and honor killing at the hands of their kith and kin or caste people.

However, with the passage of time now, changes are rapidly taking place in the attitude of Indian society especially in the urban areas towards the inter-caste love affairs and marriages. In the rural society also on account of the skewed sex ratio – the shortage of the brides – more acceptance is visible for such alliances. In this concern, even the Dalit boys are also getting acceptance on the part of the parents and families of upper castes if they are found to enjoy power and status.

Inter-Faith or Inter-Religion Marriages

Inter-faith marriages are also proving a quite big social issue and problem for the Indian society. By the term inter-faith marriage, we mean the kind of matrimonial union that takes place when two people belonging to different faiths or following different religions fall in love with each other and decide to get married. As a secular and democratic country, India has a constitutional provision of providing freedom for its citizens to follow any faith or religion of their choice. The citizens of the country are thus found to follow a number of different religions such as Hindu, Muslim, Sikh, Christian, Jain, Buddha and Parsi, etc. All of them have their own separate code of conduct and marriage acts for tying the knot. It has been a common practice as well as the requirement imposed by these religious communities to have affairs and marriages within their communities. The majority religion is the Hindu religion, and the followers of other religions make up minorities. The Jains, Sikhs and Buddhists all are the offshoots of the Hindu religion, therefore not much resistance is shown by the elders of these communities to having inter-religion matrimonial alliance of their youths within these religious groups. Christian and Parsi communities have quite negligible presences in India, and Hindu youths have little opportunities for falling in love and getting married. Aside from all these religious communities, however, love affairs and marriages between the Hindu and Muslim couples are quite a thorny issue and big problem even at this stage of too much liberalization, modernization and

freedom to marry at will on the part of the new generation. It is much more complicated and problematic in comparison to the issues related to the same gotra and inter-castes love affairs and marriages and is not at all acceptable in any way to the families and communities as a whole. The couples daring to engage in such affairs and alliances have to bear the brunt of ill consequences in one or the other different ways. They are cut off from their families and may become the subject of ridicule, rejection and social boycott from their relatives and community people. They may also assume the difficulties faced by them in their occupational adjustment and concerning the future of their children. This may, although painful, be tolerated by them somehow but what to say about the role of religious fanaticism. The dear and near of the couples may take it as a slap on their honor and thus may be prompted to engage in the act of honor killing of the couples. The situations get even worse with the interference of the religious fanatic groups found in both the Hindu and Muslim communities. They always are in search of declaring war against the inter-faith love affairs and marriages and consider it their moral duty to punish the offenders in their own ways.

As a democratic and secular country, India has the provision of the Special Marriage Act for facilitating the inter-faith couples to have their marriage performed and legally recognized. Any couple can register under this act as an alternative to religion-specific laws by providing a district marriage registrar with their names, home addresses and photographs, which are then displayed in the registrar's office for 30 days (now extended to 60 days under the new laws in some States). After such display, anybody in the public is free to file an objection if they need so, although on some specific grounds such as: neither partner should have a living spouse or someone is underage or incapable of consent due to "unsoundness of mind". It may appear all right, but the publishing of personal details has all inherent dangers for putting inter-faith couples at risk of family arm-twisting, or worse from the religious fanatics. In 2018, Ankit Saxena, a Hindu man, was stabbed to death in New Delhi, allegedly by the relatives of his Muslim girlfriend. Facing such risks, many couples choose to convert and marry instead under religious law.

Inter-Faith Marriage

A kind of matrimonial union that takes place when two people belonging to different faiths or religions fall in love with each other and decide to get married.

In comparison to Hinduism, Islam here gives more opportunity and acceptance of such marriages after due conversion. In consequence thus, relatively, the Muslim community is not too adamant to accept the married couple in their life stream, if the groom or bride belonging to Hindu community embraces Islam for getting married. Whenever, a Muslim youth needs to have matrimonial alliance with a Hindu girl, the marriage can be performed under the Islamic laws after embracing Islam on the part of the girl. In such a situation, the Hindu girl is thus fully acceptable by the family as well community of the Muslim boy. The reverse is not true with the Hindu community. Since according to the Indian marriage system, the married couple has to live with the parents and family of the groom, a Hindu girl after being converted into Islam suffers less problems in getting adjusted to her married life. As a consequence, there have been more cases of inter-faith marriages where Hindu girls have been found to get converted to Islam for getting married to Muslim boys. It has led the Hindu fanatics to raise a new slogan “Love Jihad” for providing resistance to such inter-faith marriages by alleging that the Muslim community is having a hidden agenda for increasing their population by encouraging their youths to trap and lure the Hindu girls in love affairs and then compel them to embrace Islam before getting married. Influenced by such opinion, a number of State Governments in Indian Republic have brought out a new legislation imposing a ban on “unlawful religious conversions” and “Interfaith marriages with the sole intention of changing a girl’s religion”. A jail term up to 10 years has been stipulated for the boy in this offence. Although Indian courts of justice have not given their verdict in favor of the decisions of the States Governments yet, the

implementation of this act has been started by the concerned states. A new controversy with respect to the occurrence of inter-faith marriages especially in the case of love affairs and marriages between a Muslim boy and Hindu girl have, thus, started in the country from the year 2020. The social activists are terming the actions under this new act as a breach of the personal freedoms of youths loving and marrying at their will. It will take time to settle this major issue requiring the needed change in the attitude of the people for accepting the reality of providing freedom to the new generations for their intended inter-faith marriages.

To Sum Up

Inter-faith marriages also may be seen as a big social issue and problem for our society. By the term inter-faith marriage we mean the kind of matrimonial union that takes place when two people belonging to different faiths or religions fall in love with each other and decide to get married.

The people and communities belonging to different religions in our society have their own separate code of conduct and marriage acts for tying the knot. It has been a common practice as well as the requirement imposed by these religious communities to have affairs and marriages within their communities and taboo the inter-religion affairs and marriages. In this concern, love affairs and marriages between the Hindu and Muslim couples, in particular, are quite thorny issues and a big problem for us throughout the whole country. The couples daring to engage in such affairs and alliances have to bear the brunt of quite damaging and brutal consequences in one or the other different ways. The dear and near of the couples, as well as the religious fanatic groups found in both the Hindu and Muslim communities, may take it as a slap on their honor and thus may be prompted to engage in the act of honor killing of the couples.

As a democratic and secular country, India has the provision of a Special Marriage Act for facilitating the inter-faith couples to have their marriage performed and legally recognized. However, there are so many difficulties in reality that it is hard for the couples (except in the case of celebrities and powered ones) to get their own way in their inter-faith affairs and marriage.

Same Sex Marriages

Same sex marriages are the typical creation of the new wave emerging globally in the youths to have homosexual affairs and relationships between themselves. It has given birth to a most typical and complex issue in society in the demand for same sex marriages between two people. As a term, 'same sex marriage' stands for the kind of matrimonial union that takes place when two people belonging to same sex (male or female) fall in love with each other and decide to get married.

In the realm of making love and getting married, it is the most complicated and unacceptable thing on the part of the parents, families and communities in comparison to all previously discussed issues concerning the same gotra, intra-khap, inter-caste and inter-faith love affairs and marriages. In Indian society, parents and families of the boys and girls seeking same sex marriages now are getting puzzled with this new complex problem with the expression of the following sentiments in this concern.

Look, we can seek compromise somehow in one or the other ways with the same gotra, inter-caste and interfaith marriages of our sons and daughters, but what to say about the same sex marriages. These same sex couples would not be able to produce the children of their own and it will put a complete full stop in carrying out the inheritance of our family further in the future. What would be the impact on other children – will they not pick up the path of homosexuality like their brothers and sisters? Moreover, how

would we be able to show our faces to our relatives, friends and community people and the resulting social boycott of our family on their part? It will not be in the interest of these same sex couples as they are bound to face a number of problems in their overall adjustment in the coming future.

Same Sex Marriages

A kind of matrimonial union that takes place when two people belonging to same sex (male or female) fall in love with each other and decide to get married.

When we look at the social interaction and day-to-day living of these homosexual or gay individuals, we may notice that there arises almost no problem on their parts in making friendship and living in relationship like intimate partners in the same room, but the problem starts as soon as they try to show their intimacy of love affairs in public and decide to get married. It is here they have to face stiff resistance from their parents, family members and community people besides being a soft target of public ridicule, criticism and discrimination. Moreover, in our country the same sex marriages have not been able to get legal recognition yet for getting them registered under any religious matrimonial laws including the Special Marriage Act. In the absence of such social and legal protection, the same sex couples are likely to face a lot of other problems arising in the civil and legal areas such as adoption of a child, seeking property rights, getting employment, renting accommodation and living within a community setup, protection against domestic violence and buying family health insurance, etc.

The global scenario, in the matter of social and legal recognition of the same sex marriages, is quite different. The recognition of same sex marriages is considered to be a human right and civil right and consequently, human rights and civil rights organizations all over the world are quite vocal and active for supporting this issue. With their active support,

there has been a continuous rise in the support for the recognition of same sex marriages in 29 countries belonging to the developed and developing democratic countries of the World.

Regarding the position of our country, homosexuality has been the subject of taboo and stiff opposition on the part of Indian society. Legally, also, under section 377 of the Indian Penal Code, sex or marriage with persons of the same gender has been made punishable by law. With the changes in this respect happening world over and the legal fights of the individuals and social organizations, the Supreme Court of India on September 6, 2018, gave a verdict for the decriminalization of homosexuality under section 377 of the IPC and thus made gay sex legal.

After getting success in the decriminalization of section 377 of the IPC in 2018, the issue concerning the legality of same sex marriages has been a subject of the legal cases filed in the Indian courts. However up to this time, same sex marriages have not been able to get their legal recognition. The overall progress in this concern may be stated briefly as follows.

- A number of State courts in their ruling have recognized the rights of same sex couples who live together. In the year 2020, for example, the Uttarakhand State High Court stated in its ruling that “same-sex couples have the right to live together, even though they may not have the right to get married”.
- In the same year, a case was filed in Delhi High Court to seek the legal recognition of same sex marriage. In its hearing in the month of September 2020, India’s solicitor general argued that “our laws, our legal system, our society and our values do not recognize marriage, which is a sacrament, between same-sex couples”.
- In order to have an alternative way other than registration under Hindu marriage law for the legal recognition of same sex marriages, a lesbian couple petitioned the Delhi High Court to allow same sex marriages as part of the Special Marriages Act in 2020. A further hearing at the High Court in this case is pending in the court.
- In a bid to approach the Highest Court of Justice, a public interest litigation (PIL) seeking to legalize same sex marriage under the Hindu Marriage Act was filed in the Supreme Court of India during the later months of the year 2020. Here, the petitioners in their appeal have argued that there is no language in the act preventing same sex marriage and that nowhere in the act is marriage restricted to “only between man and woman”. The hearing of this case is still to be done by the Honorable court.
- Contending that the Supreme Court only decriminalized homosexuality, but did not legitimize it, the Government of India told the Delhi High Court on February 25, 2021, that there’s no fundamental right to seek recognition for same-sex marriage. Same sex individuals living together as partners and having a sexual relationship is not comparable with the Indian family unit concept of a husband, a wife and children, which necessarily presupposes a biological man as a ‘husband’. The parliament has designed and framed the marriage laws in the country to recognize only the union of a man and a woman to be capable of religious sanction, and thereby claim legal and statutory sanction. Any interference with the same would cause complete havoc with the delicate balance of personal laws in the country. The further hearing in this case has been adjourned till April 2021.
- Reacting to it, Onir, the Indian film maker (best known for his film *My Brother . . . Nikhil*, to deal with AIDS and same sex relationships) has commented, “The SC has empowered us by decriminalizing the sexual act between two consenting adults, but we are still not empowered with our civil rights as equal citizens, we haven’t been empowered with our right to love, get married, and aren’t being treated as equal citizens.”

In this way, the struggle for seeking legal recognition of same sex marriages is still going on in India. In any case if it would be possible in the near future then a provision will likely be made under the Special Marriages Act much like existing for the inter-faith

marriages, since the matter is not limited to Hindu gay/lesbian couples but it also covers the followers of other faiths/religions.

To Sum Up

As a term, 'same sex marriage' stands for the kind of matrimonial union that takes place when two people belonging to same sex (male or female) fall in love with each other and decide to get married.

In the realm of making love and get married, it is the most complicated and unacceptable thing on the part of the parents, families and communities in comparison to the same gotra, intra-khap, inter-caste and inter-faith love affairs and marriages. Consequently, it is not uncommon to witness the type of stiff resistance faced by these couples from their parents, family members and community people besides being a soft target of public ridicule, criticism and discrimination.

Moreover, in our country same sex marriages have not been able to get legal recognition yet for getting them registered under any religious matrimonial laws including the Special Marriage Act. In the absence of such social and legal protection, the same sex couples are likely to face a lot of other problems arising in the civil and legal areas.

Transgender Persons and Their Rights

The word transgender is composed of two words – trans and gender. Trans means beyond or altered and hence the word transgender is associated with the description of the people who are beyond a gender in their description or in which there occurs a change or alteration in their previous gender. According to the Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act, 2019, enacted by the Parliament, Government of India, “transgender person” means a person whose gender does not match with the gender assigned to that person at birth and includes trans-man or trans-woman (whether or not such person has undergone

sex reassignment surgery or hormone therapy or laser therapy or such other therapy), person with intersex variations, genderqueer and a person having such socio-cultural identities as kinner, hijra, aravani and jogta (The Gazette of India).

As indicated in the definition, we may see that actually, the term transgender is an umbrella term that is used for a wide variety of people such as:

1. *The people whose gender identity or gender expression differs from the sex assigned to them at birth.* Such people are generally categorized as male transgender (trans-man) and female transgender (trans-woman). The term male transgender stands for the people who were born as female but now identify as male. For a clear distinction we may name them as FTM (Female Transferred to Male). The term female transgender applies for the people who were born as male but now identify as female. For a clear distinction we may name them as MTF (Male Transferred to Female). Such gender transference may be affected through medical or non-medical means. We will discuss it later on.
2. *The people found to possess intersex variations and named as intersex people* may also fall in the category of transgenders. As a matter of definition, people whose bodies fall in the vast continuum between “male” and “female” are often known as intersex people. The intersex variations found in these people may be of quite varying nature. For example, some people may be born with XY chromosomes (male characteristic) but have female genitals and secondary sex characteristics. Others might have XX chromosomes (female characteristic) but no uterus, or might have external anatomy that doesn't appear clearly male or female. At the time of birth most of these intersex people are identified and brought up as female or male on the basis of the outwards appearance of their female or male anatomy, but later on, they may not find themselves fit in these roles and thus may need their transformation in the role and behavior suited to them by going on the needed medical treatment

or living and behaving as the gender that better matches their internal sense of who they are.

3. *The person labelled as genderqueer* may also fall in the category of transgender. By the term genderqueer we mean the people who do not subscribe to conventional gender distinctions but identify with neither, both, or a combination of male and female genders. As a result, we may not be able to identify and describe their gender as male or female. The other term used for genderqueer people is non-binary, standing quite opposite to the term binary referring to the two categories male and female.
4. *The persons labelled as gender non-conforming* may also be included in the category of transgenders. By the term gender non-conforming we mean the people not conforming to gender stereotypes. For example, someone's clothes, hair-style, speech patterns or hobbies might be considered more "feminine" or "masculine" than what's stereotypically associated with their gender.
5. *The persons labelled as bigender* are also found to be named as transgenders. By the term bigender we mean someone who identifies as both man and woman.
6. Apart from the preceding, the *persons having such socio-cultural identities as kinner or hijra*, in our society are also labelled as transgenders. There is a quite big community of these people in our country. The children who are neither capable of being identified as male nor as female at their birth are usually picked up by the kinner or hijra community for being added in their community.

Transgender

A term used for the people whose gender does not match with the gender assigned to them at birth and includes trans-men or trans-women, or described and labeled as intersex (the people whose bodies fall in the vast continuum between "male" and "female"), gender queer, gender non-conforming, bi-gender, and people having such socio-cultural identities as kinner and hijra.

In this way, we may see that the term transgender, in the capacity of an umbrella term, stands to be used for a quite diverse people identified as trans-men or trans-women, or described and labelled as intersex, genderqueer, non-binary, gender non-conforming, bigender and having such socio-cultural identities as kinner or hijra in our society.

The most mentionable attribute about the transgenders is that their gender identity is different from the sex or gender assigned to them at their birth. By the term gender identity here we mean the people's innate or internal knowledge of their own gender – i.e., their knowledge that they're a man, a woman or another gender.

Difficulties and Problems Faced by Transgenders

The transition from the gender assigned to transgender persons at the time of birth to their self-identified gender at the later stage is full of a lot of difficulties and problems. They may need one or the other types of surgery and therapies that may prove quite taxing and painful along with the expenditure involved in doing so. If they start living and behaving at their own as per their self-identified gender, they may invite serious risk of convincing people about their self-identified gender. Here lies every possibility that they may be mishandled, discriminated and harassed on account of one or the other types of misunderstanding created about them about such self-disclosure. However, as a whole whether they undergo sex transition surgery or start living and behaving as per their self-identified gender, transgender persons are likely to face many challenges in their adjustment and living in the society pointed out as follows.

1. They may face a challenge of getting acceptance from the members of their community including their parents, family members, neighbors, classmates, co-workers and close friends.
2. They may face harassment, intimidation, threat, insulting behavior and ridiculing, etc. within their social and work environment.

3. There is lot of discrimination, marginalization and stigma exhibited towards them in almost every sphere of the social life – community gatherings and public places, educational institutions and workplaces proving a big stumbling block in their proper education, getting rented accommodation, dining in a restaurant, accessing public bath rooms or seeking employment and getting promotions in an establishment as well doing their own business.
4. They may face great difficulty in accessing available public health care systems and medical services as most of the medical personnel and doctors are reluctant to examine and treat them on account of their gender identity. Further cases of harassment, inappropriate behavior and sexual violence exhibited towards them in the public health care system are also proving a great obstruction for them in availing the health care and treatment facilities.
5. On account of the lack of educational and employment opportunities, more often the transgender community have no option other than begging and engaging in sex work with the risk of contracting sexually transmitted diseases and living in extreme poverty.
6. They may face a big problem in terms of seeking legal recognition and protection. In this concern, the big challenge is the availability of the needed identity documents. The lack of these documents obstructs their path of availing basic civil rights and facilities related to every aspect of their lives. Without identification, one cannot travel, seek admission in school, open a bank account and access a number of services that are essential to function in the society such as the right to vote and seek election, inheritance rights, domicile proofs, marriage certificates, passport and visa documents, getting accessibility and benefit from a number of welfare schemes and projects by the respective governments, and a host of other such facilities requiring the valid identity documents.
7. There is also the safety issue arising before transgenders. They may be taken as a quite soft

target for exploitation at the hands of the people of the society in schools, community places and working places. They are more often found the victims of physical assaults and sexual violence not only at the hands of the miscreants and anti-social elements but the well thought civilized people.

Such things occurring with the transgenders essentially need urgent consideration on the part of the communities and the concerned governments. They should be protected and helped in availing all that is due to them in securing their civil rights, human rights and facilities much like the other fellow citizens. It is in this context that Government of India has brought out a legislative act known as Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act, 2019 along with the establishment of the National Council for Transgender Persons for the proper implementation of this act. The provisions laid down under this act start with a legal definition of the term transgender and then attempts have been made to lay down adequate provisions for ensuring adequate welfare measures for transgenders by declaring that the transgender person shall have a right to be recognized as such in accordance with their self-perceived gender identity. For the required purpose, the Act lays down adequate measures for (i) protecting transgenders from possible discrimination and ill treatment at the educational institutes, community living and workplaces; (ii) accessing essential public facilities much like those enjoyed by other fellow citizens such as provision of separate toilet facilities for the transgenders; (iii) helping them in seeking identity documents by laying down directive to the concerned judicial authorities for issuing the needed identification documents to transgenders on their application for this purpose; (iv) laying down provisions to formulate welfare schemes and programs to facilitate and support livelihood for transgender persons including their vocational training, self-employment and support for the expenses incurred in their sex transition; and (v) making the violation of their human rights and discrimination and misbehavior towards them a punishable act.

However, apart from such legal protection, what is needed most for the welfare of transgenders is the proper attitudinal change on the part of us as the community people towards them. It is the lack of public understanding of transgender people that works as the prominent reason for facing discrimination and ill-treatment towards them in the society. There is, thus, a greater need of proper awareness about them and their human rights in the public. It is good that a favorable environment is growing rapidly worldwide in this concern for recognizing and accepting transgenders in the form and way of their self-identified gender identity. Along with their self-struggle through a united front of LGBT (Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual and Transgender) community supported by the International Human Rights bodies and social organizations, transgenders are now well under the process of accessing the provisions of civil and human rights and it is hoped that they will feel ease in the living of their life fully to their satisfaction much like the other fellow citizens in the near future.

To Sum Up

Transgender as an umbrella term is used for a quite diverse people whose gender does not match with the gender assigned to them at birth and includes trans-men and trans-women, (whether or not they have undergone sex transformation surgery or therapy) and those described and labelled as intersex (the people whose bodies fall in the vast continuum between “male” and “female”), genderqueer (the people who do not subscribe to conventional gender distinctions but identify with neither, both, or a combination of male and female genders), gender non-conforming (people not conforming to gender stereotypes), bigender (the people who identify as both men and women) and people having such socio-cultural identities as kinner and hijra.

Transgender people, whether they undergo sex transition surgery or start living and behaving as per their self-identified gender, face a lot of difficulties and hardships in

their development, progress, adjustment and living on account of their non-acceptance or rather to say a quite negative and adverse attitude shown towards them on the part of the community people, private and public sector organizations, government authorities and also even the law enforcing agencies.

Such sort of the things occurring with the transgenders essentially needs urgent consideration. They should be protected and helped in availing all that is due to them in securing their civil rights, human rights and facilities much like the other fellow citizens. It is in this context that Government of India has brought out a legislative act known as the Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act, 2019 along with the establishment of the National Council for Transgender Persons for the proper implementation of this Act. However, apart from such legal protection, what is needed most for the welfare of transgenders is the proper attitudinal change on the part of us as the community people towards them. There is thus a greater need of making well-organized attempts for the proper awareness about them and their human rights in the public.

Review Questions

1. What is poverty? Throw light on its meaning, concept, ill consequences and harmful impacts.
2. “Poverty remains a quite serious issue and problem before any government coming to power in our country.” While commenting on the seriousness of this problem, throw light on the measures employed in our country for dealing with this problem.
3. What do you understand by the term unemployment? Throw light on its meaning and concept.
4. Define the term unemployment and discuss its ill impacts and adverse outcomes for the unemployed, their families and society or nation as a whole.
5. While throwing light on the problem of unemployment faced by our country, state what can be done for dealing with it appropriately.

6. What is corruption? Throw light on its meaning and concept.
7. While throwing light on the causes underlying the rampant of corruption in such a large scale in our country, talk about its ill consequences and discuss the ways and means for dealing with it.
8. What is domestic violence? In what different forms is it prevalent in our society? Discuss the measures for dealing with this problem.
9. What do you understand by the term child abuse? In what forms and shape it is prevalent in our society? Throw light on the measures for dealing with it in an appropriate way.
10. Throw light on the issues and problems related to sexual violence in our country and its possible remedy.
11. Discuss the violence committed by Naxalites and terrorists in our country in terms of its nature, adverse outcome and possible means for dealing with it.
12. Throw light on the following contemporary social issues facing the Indian society in relation to their nature, impact and possible measures of dealing with them in a suitable way: (i) same gotra and intra-khap marriages, (ii) inter-caste marriages, (iii) inter-faith or inter-religion marriages, (iv) same sex marriages and (v) the transgenders and their rights.

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